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Writing to Read, Reading to Write

SECOND EDITION

Alison Kuehner

Mc Graw Hill

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Alison Kuehner

Ohlone College

Mc Graw Hill

WRITING TO READ, READING TO WRITE

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About the Author

ALISON KUEHNER

Courtesy of Andrew Brown

Alison Kuehner loves teaching students. She was fortunate to discover her passion for teaching during her senior year of college working as a peer tutor, where she enjoyed the challenge of helping fellow students effectively express their ideas in writing. After earning an undergraduate degree in English literature from the University of California, Berkeley, and a master's degree in literature from the University of Chicago, she became a teacher, earning an English credential through the Graduate School of Education at the University of California, Berkeley, and a master's in reading instruction at Cal State East Bay.

Although she enjoyed her time teaching middle school and high school students, Professor Kuehner is most inspired and energized by the diversity and potential of community college students. She has taught a range of courses at Ohlone College in Fremont, California, for thirty years, including literature and composition courses; developmental and reading and writing classes; and online, hybrid, and traditional classes. Over the years, she has honed her skills as a teacher, thanks to her students' feedback and advice, and her colleagues' willingness to share and collaborate.

When Professor Kuehner is not teaching, she enjoys reading, spending time with her family and friends, and riding her bike, swimming, and playing soccer. She is married to a physicist; they have two children. They live in the San Francisco Bay Area with two overweight cats.

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A Note from the Author

Nationwide, composition programs have experienced profound shifts in the past years with a move toward including more students in transfer-level classes. In many states, including where I teach, legislation mandates that students who place below college level must have a path to complete a transfer-level composition course within one year. This shift has encouraged acceleration of the developmental sequence and a reimagining of strategies to teach first-year students, such as in corequisite classes, to ensure that all students will be successful at the transfer level. Even in states and at institutions without such mandates, composition courses have a greater diversity of students with a wider range of academic backgrounds and preparedness than ever before. Meeting the needs of all students, regardless of their prior academic achievement, requires intentional instruction and resources.

Well before the legislative mandate, my colleagues and I redesigned the English curriculum at our college in light of compelling research and evidence that students, regardless of their educational backgrounds or placement test scores, had a considerable capacity to achieve. We realized that if we set high standards while providing appropriate academic and motivational support, students typically labeled as "not college ready" as well as students on-level could succeed in rigorous classes. The time, effort, and thought that went into developing a new curriculum at my college is reflected in this brief rhetoric that may be used to educate the diversity of students in college-level composition as well as in the corequisites that will support them.

This approach within *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* enables students with varying levels of preparedness to meet the objectives of college-level composition courses is built on three key pillars:

1. **Building Skills in Reading, Writing, and Critical Thinking.** Reading, writing, and critical thinking are the foundation of students' academic success. Strategies for tackling college-level materials are explained and demonstrated; students apply and practice these.
2. **Providing Scaffolding and Support.** Scaffolded lessons and activities develop students' academic literacy skills in a logical progression, beginning with foundational coverage of reading and writing processes, moving through comprehension and summary to analysis, evaluation, synthesis, and research.

3. **Taking a Student-Centered Approach.** This means meeting students where they are, honoring their intellect, interests, and varied life experiences, and providing the guidance they need to succeed academically.

In short, *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* offers strategies drawn from years of experience teaching students at every level, enabling them to achieve college-level composition learning outcomes. The challenges of curriculum change are real; a tried and tested approach can transform students.

Alison Kuehner

Preface

Preface to the 2nd Edition

Writing to Read, Reading to Write presents **reading, writing, and critical thinking** as meaningful and complementary endeavors that form the foundation of students' academic success. Treating reading and writing as recursive processes, each chapter builds on these skills to help students at all levels achieve college-level writing. **Scaffolding and support** for these skills are embedded in every chapter in the form of guided practice and explicit instruction around strategies for successful first-year writing. This **student-centered approach** to the writing course is supported by a robust selection of digital assignments, assessments, and study tools in McGraw Hill Education's Connect Composition platform.

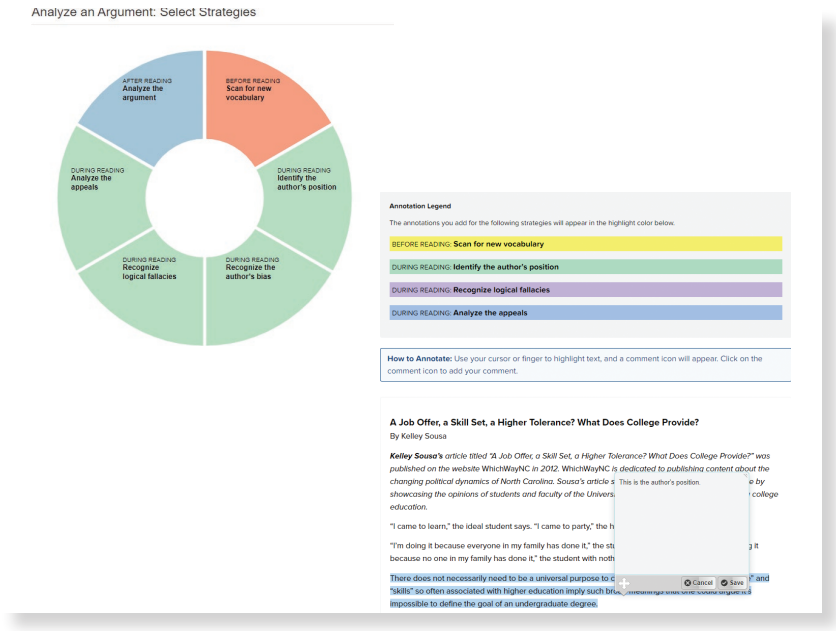
An Emphasis on Reading, Writing, and Critical Thinking

Recognizing that students often come to the composition course lacking the reading and critical-thinking skills necessary to produce college-level writing, *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* builds in support for developing these complementary and intertwined skills. With *Writing to Read, Reading to Write*, students will develop their reading, writing, and thinking skills in a logical progression, beginning with foundational coverage of reading and writing processes, and building up to the strategies and skills students will apply to their own academic work.

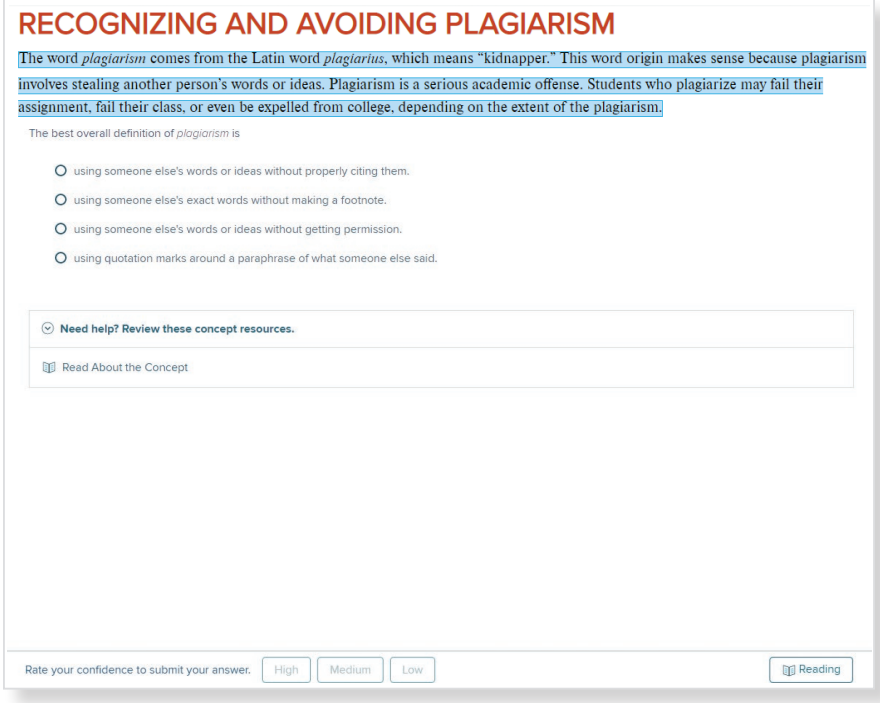
Reading

A focus on reading strategies, such as previewing, annotating, and summarizing, gives students who are underprepared for the first-year composition course, or in the corequisite support sections, a chance to practice those skills, and continually apply and build on them, as they embark on college-level work. For on-level students, these reading strategies reinforce best practices for engaging with challenging texts.

- **Annotated Reading selections** help students identify a reading's key elements, such as its thesis or claim, main points, support and evidence, and key vocabulary, providing much-needed support in academic reading skills, for students at all reading levels.
- **"Before Reading," "During Reading,"** and **"After Reading"** exercises support each reading selection, enabling deep comprehension of the selections, necessary for students to produce thoughtful prose. Online in Connect these assignments can be completed in Power of Process, which prompts students to be active readers as they preview, annotate, and reflect on the readings in the text.



- An **Anthology of Theme-Based Readings** offers 25 additional reading selections, allowing students to apply their reading, writing, and thinking skills to readings of their choice.
- **SmartBook 2.0**, found online in Connect, uses adaptive assessments to create a personalized reading experience customized to individual student needs.



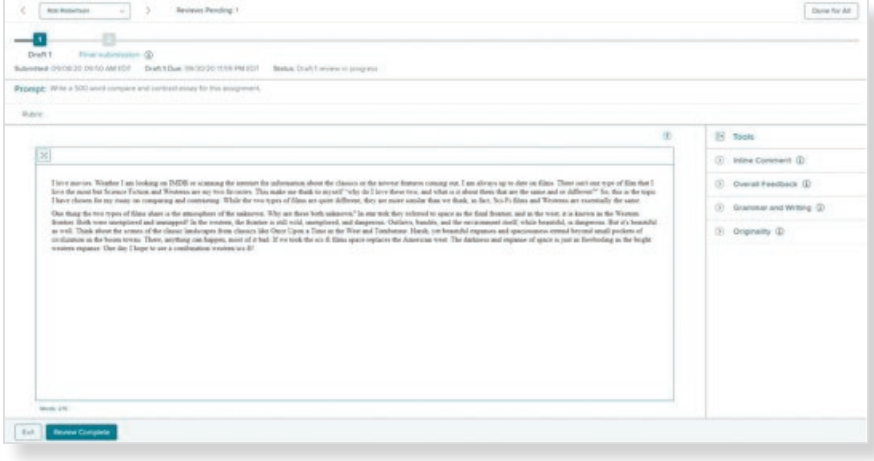
SmartBook continually adapts to pinpoint knowledge gaps and focus learning on concepts requiring additional study. It supports student engagement and helps students and instructors track progress in achieving reading and study goals.

- **Power of Process**, also in Connect, provides strategies that guide students in learning how to critically read a piece of writing or consider a text as a possible source for incorporation into their own work. After they progress through the strategies, responding to prompts by annotating and highlighting, students are encouraged to reflect on their processes and interaction with the text. In this way, Power of Process guides students to engage with texts closely and critically so that they develop awareness of their process decisions and ultimately begin to make those decisions consciously on their own—a hallmark of strategic, self-regulating readers and writers.
- **Instructors can choose from 100 readings** in the Power of Process reader or from *Writing to Read, Reading to Write*, or they can upload their own readings. In keeping with McGraw Hill's commitment to equity, diversity, and inclusion, 50% of the readings in both the text and in Power of Process are written by Black, Indigenous, and People of Color (BIPOC) authors.

Writing

A process-oriented, recursive approach to writing supports students' reading, writing, and learning, no matter their level upon entering the course. Students will learn how to use writing to call up background knowledge before reading or to reflect on a text after reading; they will write to generate and explore ideas, and to draft, edit, revise, and proofread their own college-level texts.

- At the end of each chapter, **Reading and Writing Activities** guide students through selecting a topic, prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, and proofreading to develop a complete piece of writing.
- **Pair and Share activities** are strategically placed throughout the reading and writing activities, offering peer-review opportunities at various stages of the writing process.
- Online in Connect's **Writing Assignment Plus**, students benefit from just-in-time learning resources as they draft responses to writing prompts. The built-in



In Writing Assignment Plus, instructors can provide summative and directive feedback on students' work. A customizable scoring guide provides assessment transparency to students, while allowing them to see why and how to improve.

grammar checker and originality detection alert students to issues before they submit their work and offer resources that direct them on how to correct errors within the context of their own writing, empowering them to achieve their writing goals.

- **Connect Composition** grants students four years of access to the complete *Connect Composition Handbook*, which features coverage of style, grammar, and mechanics, as well as up-to-date guidance on MLA and APA documentation styles. In Connect Composition, teachers can also assign a range of assessments, including quizzes and tests, that are tied to the handbook.

Critical Thinking

Each chapter is based on a thought-provoking question to encourage inquiry and critical thinking. Students will develop an academic mindset, critically reading, evaluating, and responding to texts of various kinds and alternating points of view.

- **A broad selection of readings** aligns with thoughtfully chosen themes that provide a structure for student learning and a foundation for understanding reading, writing, and research processes. By reading related articles, students have an opportunity to understand a topic in depth, and the text provides students with more material with which to draft their resulting work.
- **Engage with the Reading** questions following each reading selection prompt students to think critically about the text, explain complex passages, or respond to an author's arguments with their own ideas or analysis. The strategies they encounter through their engagement with other texts will build understanding of writing strategies and how they could apply to their own writing projects.

Scaffolding and Support for the First-Year Course

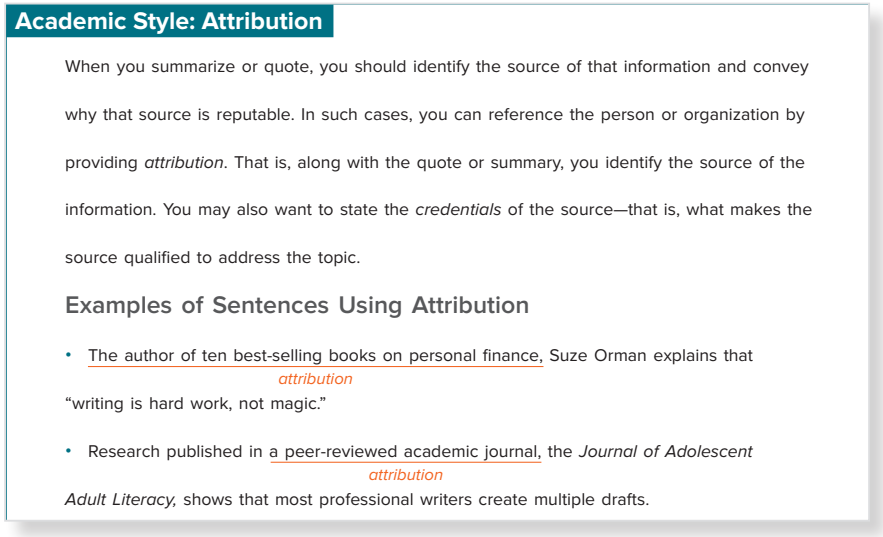
The structure of *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* has been carefully designed to guide students through a logical progression of skills, with each new topic building on the last.

- **Reading, writing, and thinking critically.** Part 1, Welcome to College Reading, Writing, and Thinking, introduces students to the right mindset for college success, foundational reading strategies, the nature of the writing process, and the fundamentals of an academic essay.
- **Focusing on academic reading and writing.** Employing skills from Part 1, in Part 2 critical academic writing skills are developed with a focus on single texts. Students will engage in important strategies, including summarizing the ideas of others, responding thoughtfully to texts, and critically evaluating texts.
- **Engaging with multiple texts.** Building on Parts 1 and 2, in the third section students deal with multiple texts, enhancing the essential elements of reading and writing by demonstrating how students can compare or synthesize different sources in an objective analysis or through critical evaluation, as well as how they can develop original arguments supported by various sources.

- **Conducting research and citing sources.** Part 4, Research and Documentation, guides students through the research process, including how to locate and evaluate sources, how to write an informative or argumentative academic research paper, and how to analyze and incorporate visuals.
- **Reading to expand perspectives and understanding.** Part 5, Anthology of Theme-Based Readings, is a collection of diverse views on themes students and their teachers may wish to read and write about. Readings are intentionally selected to spark critical and creative thinking and to inspire students' writing.

In addition to the logical structure of the text, further scaffolding is provided throughout.

- **Writing prompts** are offered at two levels, those that require students to meet the core objectives of the first-year writing course, and a selection of **Challenge Choice** prompts that require a bit more reading, researching, and thinking. Offering students additional options for completing the writing assignment empowers all students to succeed.
- For students who struggle with sentence-level clarity, or who are new to the expectations of college-level writing assignments, **Academic Style boxes** provide professional and student writing examples that model a range of writerly concerns related to academic prose, such as writing clear, concise sentences or integrating quotations, encouraging students to read as writers and to emulate strong writing.
- Reading, writing, and research skills are further supported by **Adaptive Learning Assignment**. Found in Connect, Adaptive Learning Assignment provides each student a personalized path to learning concepts instructors assign in their course. The assignments continually adapt to the individual, identifying knowledge gaps



Academic Style: Attribution

When you summarize or quote, you should identify the source of that information and convey why that source is reputable. In such cases, you can reference the person or organization by providing *attribution*. That is, along with the quote or summary, you identify the source of the information. You may also want to state the *credentials* of the source—that is, what makes the source qualified to address the topic.

Examples of Sentences Using Attribution

- The author of ten best-selling books on personal finance, (attribution) Suze Orman explains that "writing is hard work, not magic."
- Research published in a peer-reviewed academic journal, (attribution) the *Journal of Adolescent Adult Literacy,* shows that most professional writers create multiple drafts.

and focusing on areas where remediation is needed. All adaptive content—including questions and integrated concept resources—is specifically targeted to, and directly aligned with, the individual learning objectives being assessed in the course.

A Student-Centered Approach

Throughout the chapters, students are reminded they are at the center of their learning and must actively participate to be successful as they read, write, think, and engage with assignments. By offering varied approaches to writing projects and a range of reading selections, this program meets students where they are, encourages them to adopt a college mindset, and to achieve the goals of the course.

The New Three *R*s: Relevant, Representative, and Reflective

While reading, writing, and critical thinking encapsulate the academic mindset of the book, engaging students with relevant topics, representative readings, and opportunities for reflection is at the heart of the text.

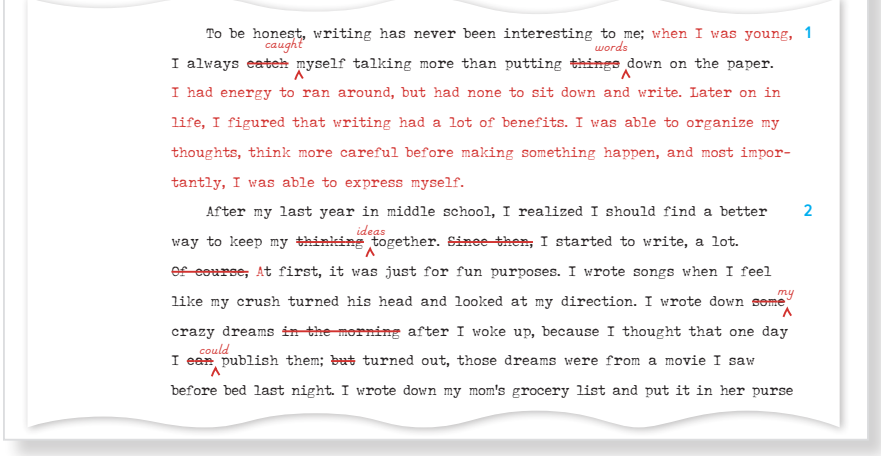
- **Relevant.** Themes and readings were chosen for their potential to connect to students' lives. Throughout the text, students are encouraged to understand how academic topics and research connect to the larger world or to the communities around them, as well as to their own lived experiences.
- **Representative.** Featured professional authors and student writers represent the variety of experiences and backgrounds of today's students, including second-language learners, writers of color, and first-generation college students.
- **Reflective.** Chapters present diverse views on a chosen theme, prompting students to question texts, discover new perspectives, and draw their own conclusions.

Spotlights on Student Writing

One chapter at the conclusion of each section profiles real college students and showcases their written work. This **Spotlight on Student Writing** feature gives students

FIGURE 3 One Student's Second Draft

Writing is a Tool (Revising version), by Jane Nguyen. Used with permission.



To be honest, writing has never been interesting to me; when I was young, 1
I always ~~catch~~ caught myself talking more than putting ~~things~~ words down on the paper.
I had energy to ran around, but had none to sit down and write. Later on in
life, I figured that writing had a lot of benefits. I was able to organize my
thoughts, think more careful before making something happen, and most impor-
tantly, I was able to express myself.

After my last year in middle school, I realized I should find a better 2
way to keep my ~~thinking~~ ideas together. ~~Since then,~~ I started to write, a lot.
~~Of course,~~ At first, it was just for fun purposes. I wrote songs when I feel
like my crush turned his head and looked at my direction. I wrote down ~~some~~ my
crazy dreams ~~in the morning~~ after I woke up, because I thought that one day
I ~~can~~ could publish them; ~~but~~ turned out, those dreams were from a movie I saw
before bed last night. I wrote down my mom's grocery list and put it in her purse

an opportunity to practice the skills they gained in the previous chapters in a more holistic fashion, and by using actual student work. Students will have additional opportunities for reading and annotating a variety of student papers to analyze the writing, practice peer review, and apply annotation and evaluation strategies to improve their own writing. Perhaps most importantly, in these Spotlight sections, students will find inspiration in the writing of their fellow student writers.

Accessible e-Book and Online Resources

The 2nd edition of *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* offers an improved reading experience for all learners. Enhancements include improved e-book functionality for viewing annotated readings and editing marks, and assignments in Connect that are WCAG compliant.

At McGraw Hill Higher Education, our mission is to accelerate learning through intuitive, engaging, efficient, and effective experiences, grounded in research. We are committed to creating universally accessible products that unlock the full potential of each learner, including individuals with disabilities.

What's New in the Second Edition

Eight new chapters with an emphasis on academic literacy skills such as

- Spotlight on Student Writing: Literacy Narrative
- Writing Summaries
- Critically Evaluating Texts
- Rhetorical Analysis
- Comparing Texts
- Synthesizing Texts
- Reading Visuals
- MLA and APA Documentation

Six new chapter themes focused on contemporary issues such as

- How Can We Help People Who Are Unhoused?
- When Should Americans Be Involved in Foreign Conflicts?
- Should We Support a Universal Basic Income?
- How Does Climate Change Affect Inequity?
- How Free Is Speech on Campus?
- What Is Real News and What Is Fake News?

Twenty-five additional readings tied to new themes in the Part 5 anthology including

- What Barriers Do College Students Face?
- How Can We Help People Who Are Unhoused?

- What Makes Life Meaningful?
- America: Land of the Free?
- What Makes a Persuasive Argument?

An alternative Table of Contents aligns all of the readings with the essay types represented in the text, including a variety of writing genres, such as speeches, research papers, rhetorical analyses, and works of literature and a focus on equity and inclusion:

- More than 50% of the readings are by BIPOC authors.
- Liberal and conservative viewpoints are represented throughout.
- Language has been professionally reviewed for sensitivity and acceptance.

More examples and greater variety of student writing include

Published Student Writing

- "To Sleep or Not to Sleep, That Is the Question" by Courtney Roberts
- "A College Lecture on Confederate Statues Made Me Realize I'm Squelching Free Speech on Campus" by Kevin Weis
- "Academia, Love Me Back" by Tiffany Martinez
- "3 Approaches for Confronting Microaggressions" by Tyrone Fleurizard

Model Papers

- "Writing Is a Tool" by Jane Nguyen (first and second drafts and final paper copy)
- "The Good, the Bad, and the Math" by Alejandra Jimenez
- "Involuntary Resignation" by Veronica Alvarez
- "What Makes One Happy?" by Michelle Asadulla
- "Money, Friends, Purpose, and Happiness" by Kristen Chen
- "The Two-Way Correlation Between Sleep Disturbances and Dementia" by Xiaoyan Huo
- "Segmented Sleep: Nature vs. Nurture" by Renee Burke
- "Taking Refuge: Climate Migration in the United States" by Jamie Ferrante (a draft and final paper copy)

Features to support academic literacy include

- Academic Style boxes in each chapter
- Annotated Reading Selections
- Coverage of formatting and citation that reflects the latest guidelines published in the *MLA Handbook*, 9th edition, and the *Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association*, 7th edition

Support for Instructors

Annotated Instructor's Edition

Alison Kuehner created the annotations in the *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* Annotated Instructor's Edition to share her course-proven in-class activities and teaching tips. Marginal notes also alert instructors to handouts and resources, as well as Power of Process and Adaptive Learning Assignments in the *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* Connect course.

Instructor's Manual

Today's first-year composition course, and the corequisite support course, requires new ways of teaching. The Instructor's Manual for *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* includes three parts:

1. Using *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* in first-year composition. Includes areas of integration, sequencing, additional essay prompts, and sample syllabi.
2. Using *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* in corequisite courses. Includes a general framework for teaching first-year composition with a corequisite support course, as developed by a board of instructors teaching corequisites around the country.
3. Corequisite Board of Advisor recommendations. McGraw Hill Education partnered with a team of thirteen instructors at the forefront of corequisite education today to develop a list of recommendations for instructors and institutions launching their own corequisite programs.

Additional Resources

These additional teaching resources are downloadable from the Online Learning Center. Please contact your local McGraw Hill representative for the username and password to access these resources.

- Pacing Guides for activities in a composition course and a composition course with a corequisite class. These charts provide a suggested pacing guide for introducing and teaching the primary activities in each chapter. Instructor-led activities are typically introduced by the teacher in class. Group practice is a chance for students—in pairs, in small groups, or as a class—to engage in an activity. Independent work can be accomplished by students during class time or at home.
- Topical PowerPoint presentations. The topical organization of fifteen chapter PowerPoints allows for maximum flexibility across traditional composition sections and support courses. All PowerPoint presentations are fully accessible.
- Preformatted readings for Power of Process. Each reading in *Writing to Read, Reading to Write* is available to be uploaded to accompany a Power of Process assignment.

Acknowledgments

Writing may seem like a solitary act, but it is not. So many people have helped me along the way to creating this book. My initial thanks goes to Team JAM: Jennifer Hurley and Meghan Swanson-Groupa, the J and M in our triad, who ventured forth with me to revise the English curriculum. I am forever indebted to Katie Hern, Summer Serpas, and the many amazing folks involved in the California Acceleration Project, especially Guillermo Colls, Andrew Kranzman, and Julia Raybould-Rodgers, my fellow honey badgers in crime, who inspired me to be a better teacher. My longtime colleague Bruce Bennet, who read early drafts, and faithful friend, Thea Johnson, never stopped believing that a textbook could come from my class handouts.

My thanks to the many reviewers who provided insightful comments and excellent suggestions on drafts of the book: Emory Abbott, *Georgia State University*; Kelly Anthony, *Ozarks Technical Community College*; Joni Cay Appleton, *Missouri State University*; Nolan Belk, *Wilkes Community College*; A. Beshears, *Murray State College*; Sarah S. Bruton, *Fayetteville Technical Community College*; Karen Campbell, *Grayson College*; Kenneth Chacón, *Fresno City College*; Kathleen Chrismon, *Northeastern Oklahoma A&M College*; Sharon Cline, *Youngstown State University*; Jane Cowden, *Ozarks Technical Community College*; Howard Cox, *Angelina College*; Jenny Crisp, *Dalton State College*; Linsey Cuti, *Kankakee Community College*; Dewayne Dickens, *Tulsa Community College*; Steven Dooner, *Quincy College*; Helen Doss, *City Colleges of Chicago*; Ellen Dugan-Barrette, *Brescia University*; Juanita Eagleson, *University of the District of Columbia Community College*; Rodger Eidson, *Georgia Perimeter College*; Ruth Engel, *Tarrant County College*; Sarah Fish, *Collin College*; Gabrielle Fletcher, *North Central Texas College*; Dane K. Galloway, *Ozarks Technical Community College*; Kimberly George, *Temple College*; Alexandra Graham, *Missouri State University*; Karen Holley-McKinney, *Georgia Perimeter College*; Andrew Howard, *University of the District of Columbia Community College*; Steve Kaczmarek, *Columbus State Community College*; Laurel Kornhiser, *Quincy College*; April Lawson, *Mississippi Gulf Coast Community College*; Marianne Layer, *Grayson College*; Dina Levitre, *Community College of Rhode Island*; Paul Long, *Baltimore City Community College*; Heather Mashburn, *Georgia Piedmont Technical College*; Brook Mayo, *Asheville Buncombe Technical Community College*; Jeannine Morgan, *St Johns River State College*; Reyna Muñoz, *El Paso Community College*; Jeff Newberry, *Abraham Baldwin Agricultural College*; Katie Pagan, *Brescia University*; John Pleimann, *Jefferson College*; Cassandra Powell, *City Colleges of Chicago*; Melodie Provencher, *Youngstown State University*; Brian L. Reeves, *Lone Star College*; Stacey Santoro-Murphy, *Joliet Junior College*; Lynne D. Schneider, *Alabama State University*; Sam Sonnier, *Blue Ridge Community College*; Kirk Swenson, *Georgia Perimeter College*; Donna Knepper Taylor, *Arizona Western College*; Marlea Trevino, *Grayson College*; Roy Turner, *Lone Star College*; Jeanne Urie, *Tulsa Community College*; Danielle Wagner, *North Central Texas College*; Charles Warnberg, *Brookhaven College*; Jeana West, *Murray State College*; Wei Yan, *Saint Louis Community College*.

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Thank you, thank you, to my amazing team at McGraw Hill, for supporting a second edition, and for making it a much-improved text. This includes Erin Cosyn, for her guidance through the revising process and for making thoughtful contributions to the text; Cara Labell, for her consistently positive support and good ideas; Carrie Burger, for her wonderful efficiency in securing readings; Carey Lange, for her keen editing eye; and especially Elizabeth Murphy, for being a true collaborator in shaping this second edition. It has been rewarding to work with you all.

PART ONE

Welcome to College Reading, Writing, and Thinking

1 Introduction to College Reading, Writing, and Thinking

2 Active Reading

3 The Writing Process

Spotlight on Student Writing Process: Literacy Narrative

4 The Writing Product

Spotlight on Student Writing: Response Essay

CHAPTER 1

Introduction to College Reading, Writing, and Thinking

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Identify strategies for college reading, writing, and learning.
- Recognize key factors in succeeding in college.
- Read and write about students' mindsets.
- Develop a critical-thinking mindset.

Theme: How to Develop a Successful College Mindset?

Having the right mindset is crucial to college success. Successful students also have strategies for approaching their reading and writing assignments. They are motivated and interested in studying and actively engage in learning. This chapter considers the kinds of reading and writing expected in college and identifies strategies and attitudes to help you succeed.

IDENTIFYING STRATEGIES FOR SUCCESS

The illustration shown in Figure 1.1 represents what it takes to be successful. In the image, the iceberg represents success itself. Above the waterline is what people see, such as a successful person. Below the waterline is what people do not see, such as the characteristics that make people successful. Before reading further, stop and think:

- How does each characteristic below the waterline help create success?
- Why is the illustration titled "The Iceberg Illusion"?

FIGURE 1.1 The Iceberg Illusion

Sylvia Duckworth. Used with permission.

In this chapter, you will read about what it takes to be successful in college. For instance, persisting when reading, working hard when writing, and being dedicated to a college education are hallmarks of successful college students. College students develop good study habits. Moreover, most successful college students are not daunted by failure or disappointment; they are willing to make sacrifices to prioritize their learning. As you read through the chapter, think about how the images in this illustration reveal the "hidden" characteristics of success.

The survey shown in Figure 1.2 identifies strategies you may already be using—or could be using—for reading, writing, and learning. Taking this assessment will help you pinpoint areas of strength and areas for improvement.

Identify how frequently you use the reading, writing, and learning strategies listed in Figure 1.2 by circling the number that best represents how often you engage in each activity. Respond honestly: there are no right or wrong answers. Then complete the activities that follow the survey.

FIGURE 1.2 College Reading, Writing, and Learning Survey

College Reading: How Often Do You Do the Following When You Read?					
	Never	**Rarely**	**Sometimes**	**Often**	**Always**
1. Preview the reading by looking at the title and introductory material.	1	2	3	4	5
2. Understand why I am reading the assigned material.	1	2	3	4	5
3. Read and reread the material.	1	2	3	4	5
4. Realize when I understand what I have read and when I do not.	1	2	3	4	5
5. Make notes in the margins or highlight the text when I read.	1	2	3	4	5
6. Ask questions before, during, and after reading.	1	2	3	4	5
7. Pause periodically to summarize or to restate in my own words what I've just read.	1	2	3	4	5
8. Identify the main ideas and examples in the reading.	1	2	3	4	5
9. Look up unfamiliar words and understand how they are used in the reading.	1	2	3	4	5
10. Discuss the reading with other students or the instructor.	1	2	3	4	5
College Writing: How Often Do You Do the Following When You Write?					
11. Understand the purpose of a writing assignment.	1	2	3	4	5
12. Brainstorm or prewrite to get ideas before writing.	1	2	3	4	5
13. Write with my audience in mind.	1	2	3	4	5
14. Write several drafts of a paper.	1	2	3	4	5
15. Reread my writing to check that it has a clear thesis and is logically organized.	1	2	3	4	5

continued

	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
16. Reread my writing to check that sentences are clearly and correctly written.	1	2	3	4	5
17. Ask the instructor or a tutor to read my draft and give me feedback.	1	2	3	4	5
18. Start working on my writing as soon as I get an assignment.	1	2	3	4	5
College Learning: How Often Do You Do the Following When You Learn?					
19. Keep trying to learn even if I have a setback or failure.	1	2	3	4	5
20. Work as long and as hard as I need to do well.	1	2	3	4	5
21. Accept challenging assignments.	1	2	3	4	5
22. Work with classmates to understand the assigned material.	1	2	3	4	5
23. Get help from others when I need it.	1	2	3	4	5
24. Reflect on what I am learning and how it applies to me or my life.	1	2	3	4	5

College Reading, Writing, and Learning Survey Scores

1. Add up the numbers you circled in each category in Figure 1.2—reading, writing, and learning. Write down the total for each. Then, using the score for each category, check the following assessments to determine where your strengths lie and where you can improve.

College Reading Scores Assessment

50–40 You use many strategies that can benefit your reading. Reading is an area of strength for you.

39–30 You sometimes use effective reading strategies but could learn more strategies and apply them more often. Reading is an area of some strengths and some room for improvement.

29–10 You would benefit from learning more reading strategies and using them regularly. Reading is clearly an area to improve.

continued

College Writing Scores Assessment

40–32 You use many strategies that can benefit your writing. Writing is an area of strength for you.

31–24 You sometimes use effective writing strategies but could learn more strategies and apply them more often. Writing is an area of some strengths and some room for improvement.

23–8 You would benefit from learning more writing strategies and using them regularly. Writing is clearly an area to improve.

College Learning Scores Assessment

30–24 You have an effective attitude toward learning. This is an area of strength.

23–18 You sometimes have an effective attitude toward learning but could learn more about effective ways to learn. This is an area of some strengths and some room for improvement.

17–6 You would benefit from changing your attitude toward learning. This is clearly an area to improve.

2. Using your answers to question 1, identify the areas you most need to improve in reading, writing, and learning for college.
3. Review the places in the survey where you circled 1 or 2. Write down the strategy associated with that score. As you read through this textbook, take notes on what that strategy involves and why, how, and when you should use it. If you did not circle 1 or 2, consider looking at places you marked as 3.

RECOGNIZING KEY FACTORS FOR SUCCEEDING IN COLLEGE

Why are some students more successful in college than others? It would be nice if we could simply say, if you just study every day for ten hours or if you eat healthy snacks while you read, you will succeed. Unfortunately—or maybe fortunately—life is more complicated than that. Many factors contribute to college success, including your

- Approach to college reading.
- Approach to college writing.
- Motivation and interest (short- and long-term goals).
- Beliefs about learning.

College Reading: Sinking In

Look at Figure 1.3 and consider: *What do you like to read, and why?* You may read for a variety of reasons: personal, emotional, intellectual, and practical. Reading is a way of discovering new ideas, sharing information, and getting in touch with others. Reading can be a source of knowledge and of personal pleasure.

FIGURE 1.3 Reading and Writing—Content and Purpose

What We Read and Write: Content	Why We Read and Write: Purpose
• Tweets, blogs, texts, Instagram posts, or other social media postings	• Interact socially with friends, family, or interest groups.
• Magazines, school newspaper, local newspaper, informational Internet sites	• Learn about community, neighborhood, school, or the wider world.
• Novels, graphic novels, manga, poems, songs	• Understand human feelings, experience different times and places, escape reality, or let imagination soar.
• Bible, Koran, Torah, religious texts	• Think deeply about values and morality.
• Books about hobbies, manuals, lists	• Gain practical advice or help.

Much of what students learn in school is communicated through reading—through textbooks, articles, and scholarly publications. Reading, along with writing, is the means by which people interact, share concepts and knowledge, communicate ideas and information, and test theories and evidence.

Your college courses will involve reading various kinds of **texts**—printed or written documents such as textbooks and other books, articles, essays, and websites that you will read and study. There is no *one* way to read these different texts; however, knowing which reading approaches work well for the assigned reading, the course expectations, and your own abilities can help you get the most from your reading. Successful college students read to understand rather than to memorize information. They do not just run their eyes over the page and cram for the test. Instead, they work hard to understand what they read by checking their comprehension as they go along.

In one study of students in an introductory accounting course, the academically successful students had a reading approach the researchers termed **sinking in**. That is, these students took time to *sink into* the material, which means they

- Read slowly and concentrated on the text.
- Took notes while reading.
- Highlighted important topics and main ideas.
- Reread difficult passages.
- Reviewed previous chapters or their class notes while reading.
- Persisted in their reading even when the material was difficult.
- Asked for help when they needed it.

In contrast, the students who did not do well in the class read quickly and superficially, or **skimmed**, just to get the reading done. They were more likely to skip over difficult information or tell themselves that they would come back to the reading later and review it more carefully. They rarely did. In contrast, the successful students did not wait to clear up their confusion; they dealt with it right away.

To sum up: Successful college students read with the intent to learn. They persist if the reading is difficult and immediately try various strategies for resolving confusion.

College Writing: Giving It Time and Effort

Look at Figure 1.3 again and consider: *What do you write, and why?* Just as you read for a variety of purposes, you may write for many reasons: personal, emotional, intellectual, and practical. Like reading, writing is a way of sharing information, getting in touch with others, and discovering new ideas.

In college, students write often. They may take notes during class or as they read. Students might be required to compose papers, respond to short-answer test questions, or write essay exams. Just as it is important to be an effective reader, it is important to be a skillful writer. So, what makes for strong writing in college?

College professors value the complexity of ideas and intellectual risk taking. That means your professors will expect more than grammatically correct sentences: they will expect you to read carefully, apply **critical thinking** by actively questioning arguments and assessing evidence, and express your thoughts clearly. In addition, to produce an academic paper, you may need to

- Conduct research on a topic.
- Use information from class readings and lectures.
- **Analyze** (break down into parts to understand the whole).
- **Evaluate** (determine the value or significance).
- **Synthesize** (combine different ideas into a new whole).

The advice "Don't wait until the night before it is due to write your paper" certainly applies in college. Why? Effective writing takes time and effort. As a strategic student and writer, you will want to go through the stages of the writing process. You will need to

- Spend time before you write to read and reread class materials.
- Take notes on your reading.
- **Brainstorm** (discuss informally with others) or **freewrite** (write continuously without regard to grammar and spelling errors) to generate a lot of ideas quickly.
- Make an **outline**, or a writing plan, to prepare to write.
- Compose a first **draft** (an initial version of your paper).
- Revise your first draft, often several times.
- Ask someone else to read your drafts or reread your paper yourself.
- Check over your work before turning it in.

One college professor advises first-year students to think of writing as a skill that they are learning–like painting a picture, driving a car, or playing baseball. As a student, you must practice that skill to improve. The more you practice your writing, the better your writing will get. Figure 1.4 summarizes the key strategies for successful college reading and writing.

FIGURE 1.4 Strategies for College Readers and Writers

For both reading and writing, practice and persistence are the keys to success.

College Reading	College Writing
Sink In	**Invest Time and Effort**
• Read critically	• Think critically
• Actively engage with text	• Express thoughts clearly
Some Reading Strategies	**Some Writing Strategies**
• Preview	• Brainstorm or freewrite
• Take notes	• Outline or plan
• Reread	• Draft
• Review	• Reread and rewrite
• Self-test	• Edit sentences
• Check vocabulary and comprehension	• Proofread for errors

Motivation and Interest

Students' motivation to learn and interest in learning are fundamental to success. Consider the experience of Andrew Paine, who dropped out of college after two years of partying with his friends and getting poor grades. Looking back, he observes, "I didn't know what direction I was going in. There wasn't really a light at the end of the tunnel" (qtd. in Shea). (Note: Throughout the text you will see information in parentheses—usually, the author's last name and sometimes additional information, as in the preceding sentence. This information indicates the source of the quotation used in the sentence. Turn to the list of works cited at the end of the chapter for more information on the source.)

If people do not know why they are in college (if they lack concrete short- and long-term academic goals) or if they are going to school to please their parents or because all their friends are going, they may not be genuinely interested in attending class or studying. Under any of these circumstances, they may not do well in college.

Successful students are typically those who have a goal: they know what they want to study, or they have a career path in mind. Other successful students are motivated simply by their desire to learn or by their enjoyment of intellectual pursuits. Prospective students need to ask themselves whether they truly want to be in college. They should be able to give clear and heartfelt reasons for their choice. People who find that they do not really want to be in college might think about what other productive activity they would prefer to do instead, at least until they feel ready to take on college work.

Andrew Paine, for instance, spent time away from college, until he discovered that he was interested in environmental science. When he was ready, he returned to college, explaining that his time away from studying helped him sort

out his priorities. "Now, I'm getting the most out of college academically," says Paine. "It really worked out" (qtd. in Shea).

Beliefs about Learning

Finally, students' ideas about learning can influence their college success. Students who believe that luck, chance, a bad instructor, or a difficult assignment determines whether they will succeed do not have control over their learning. In contrast, students who believe that *they* have the power to learn hold an advantage over students who believe they have little or no such control.

Consider the example of Roy, a student in a difficult introductory psychology course. Roy believes that

> *effort is the absolute key to learning a subject. Talent and ability go to waste without effort. . . . [E]ffort means reading to learn, striving to retain, applying material to life situations, and redoing, reading, and studying as often as necessary. (Beyeler 309)*

Roy's attitude toward learning is that *he* has to *work hard* to do well in college. This is most likely one factor that made him a successful student and earned him a B+ in his challenging psychology class. In short, successful college students

- Understand that they must be independent, active learners.
- Know what is expected of them by their professors and in their classes.
- Know why they are reading and have strategies for comprehension.
- Understand that good writing requires time, effort, and practice.
- Are motivated to learn and interested in learning.
- Believe they are in control of their learning.

READING AND WRITING ABOUT STUDENTS' MINDSETS

So far, you have seen that taking an active role in learning is a prerequisite for college success. Let's review what being active entails. First, as a reader, remember to employ well-established reading strategies and practice persistence to ensure that you genuinely understand what you read. That is, before reading, think about the topic and what you will read. Then during and after your reading, use writing not only to enhance your reading comprehension but also to develop your writing competence. Second, as a writer, be sure to prewrite, draft, reread, and revise your work to improve its quality. Third, have a positive attitude toward your education and take the ultimate responsibility for it.

Having a positive mindset is so basic that some researchers judge a student's attitude to be one of the biggest predictors of success. In "Brainology," the reading selection that follows, you will review research showing that what students believe about their learning and how they respond to challenges make a big difference in their academic success.

READING SELECTION

"BRAINOLOGY: TRANSFORMING STUDENTS' MOTIVATION TO LEARN"

In this reading the author uses American Psychological Association (APA) style to indicate source information. Notice that some sentences include parentheses, inside of which are a name and date: (Dweck, 2006). These are parenthetical *citations*, or references to research. The name is the researcher's last name, and the date indicates when the research was published. A list, headed "References," arranged by the researchers' last names, and including full publication information, appears at the end of the reading. As pointed out earlier, in the text portions of this book, citations are also given for quoted or referenced material, but in a different style (called Modern Language Association, or MLA, style), which uses the author's last name and source page number in parentheses.

Before Reading: Predict; Recognize Prior Knowledge

Look over "Brainology: Transforming Students' Motivation to Learn" before you answer these questions. For instance, read the comments that immediately precede the reading—and then examine the title and the headings in the reading. Write answers to these questions using complete sentences.

1. What do you think the reading will be about? For example, what could *brainology* mean? How might brainology relate to a student's motivation to learn?
2. What do you already know about human intelligence? Is intelligence fixed, or can it change?

During Reading: Annotate

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

3. Try reading the selection in "chunks." That is, use the boldface headings to divide the reading into sections, or chunks, and then read one section at a time. After reading a section, stop to reflect on the important ideas, using the headings as a guide. Write down the main ideas in your own words.
4. As you read, mark any lines you find interesting or thought-provoking or particularly agreeable.
5. As you read, mark any lines that confuse you or you find disagreeable.

Brainology: Transforming Students' Motivation to Learn

By Carol S. Dweck

The National Association of Independent Schools, Winter 2008

Carol Dweck, professor of psychology at Stanford University, spent many years trying to understand how people deal with failure and what that means for their future success. Her ideas about fixed and growth mindset came out of this research. In this article, she argues that students' beliefs about their brains and about learning powerfully impact their achievement.

This is an exciting time for our brains. More and more research is showing that our brains change constantly with learning and experience and that this takes place throughout our lives. 1

Does this have implications for students' motivation and learning? It certainly does. In my research in collaboration with my graduate students, we have shown that what students believe about their brains—whether they see their intelligence as something that's fixed or something that can grow and change—has profound effects on their motivation, learning, and school achievement (Dweck, 2006). These different beliefs, or mindsets, create different psychological worlds: one in which students are afraid of challenges and devastated by setbacks, and one in which students relish challenges and are resilient in the face of setbacks. 2

How do these mindsets work? How are the mindsets communicated to students? And, most important, can they be changed? As we answer these questions, you will understand why so many students do not achieve to their potential, why so many bright students stop working when school becomes challenging, and why stereotypes have such profound effects on students' achievement. You will also learn how praise can have a negative effect on students' mindsets, harming their motivation to learn. 3

Mindsets and Achievement 4

Many students believe that intelligence is fixed, that each person has a certain amount and that's that. We call this a *fixed mindset*, and, as you will see, students with this mindset worry about how much of this fixed intelligence they possess. A fixed mindset makes challenges threatening for students (because they believe that their fixed ability may not be up to the task), and it makes mistakes and failures demoralizing (because they believe that such setbacks reflect badly on their level of fixed intelligence).

Other students believe that intelligence is something that can be cultivated through effort and education. They don't necessarily believe that everyone has the same abilities or that anyone can be as smart as Einstein, but they do believe that everyone can improve their abilities. And they understand that even Einstein wasn't Einstein until he put in years of focused hard work. In short, students with this *growth mindset* believe that intelligence is a potential that can be realized through learning. As a result, confronting challenges, profiting from mistakes, and persevering in the face of setbacks become ways of getting smarter. 5

To understand the different worlds these mindsets create, we followed several hundred students across a difficult school transition—the transition to seventh grade. This is when the academic work often gets much harder, the grading gets stricter, and the school environment gets less personalized with students moving from class to class. As the students entered 6

seventh grade, we measured their mindsets (along with a number of other things) and then we monitored their grades over the next two years.

The first thing we found was that students with different mindsets cared about different things in school. Those with a growth mindset were much more interested in learning than in just looking smart in school. This was not the case for students with a fixed mindset. In fact, in many of our studies with students from preschool age to college age, we find that students with a fixed mindset care so much about how smart they will appear that they often reject learning opportunities—even ones that are critical to their success (Cimpian et al., 2007; Hong et al., 1999; Mangels et al., 2006; Nussbaum & Dweck, 2008). 7

Next, we found that students with the two mindsets had radically different beliefs about effort. Those with a growth mindset had a very straightforward (and correct) idea of effort—the idea that the harder you work, the more your ability will grow and that even geniuses have had to work hard for their accomplishments. In contrast, the students with the fixed mindset believed that if you worked hard it meant that you didn't have ability, and that things would just come naturally to you if you did. This means that every time something is hard for them and requires effort, it's both a threat and a bind. If they work hard at it, that means that they aren't good at it, but if they don't work hard, they won't do well. Clearly, since just about every worthwhile pursuit involves effort over a long period of time, this is a potentially crippling belief, not only in school but also in life. 8

Students with different mindsets also had very different reactions to setbacks. Those with growth mindsets reported that, after a setback in school, they would simply study more or study differently the next time. But those with fixed mindsets were more likely to say that they would feel dumb, study less the next time, and seriously consider cheating. If you feel dumb—permanently dumb—in an academic area, there is no good way to bounce back and be successful in the future. In a growth mindset, however, you can make a plan of positive action that can remedy a deficiency (Heyman et al., 1992; Hong et al., 1999; Nussbaum & Dweck, 2008). 9

Finally, when we looked at the math grades they went on to earn, we found that the students with a growth mindset had pulled ahead. Although both groups had started seventh grade with equivalent achievement test scores, a growth mindset quickly propelled students ahead of their fixed-mindset peers, and this gap only increased over the two years of the study. 10

In short, the belief that intelligence is fixed dampened students' motivation to learn, made them afraid of effort, and made them want to quit after a setback. This is why so many bright students stop working when school becomes hard. Many bright students find grade school easy and coast to success early on. But later on, when they are challenged, they struggle. They don't want to make mistakes and feel dumb—and, most of all, they don't want to work hard and feel dumb. So they simply retire. 11

It is the belief that intelligence can be developed that opens students to a love of learning, a belief in the power of effort and constructive, determined reactions to setbacks. 12

How Do Students Learn These Mindsets? 13

In the 1990s, parents and schools decided that the most important thing for kids to have was self-esteem. If children felt good about themselves, people believed, they would be set for life. In some quarters, self-esteem in math seemed to become more important than

knowing math, and self-esteem in English seemed to become more important than reading and writing. But the biggest mistake was the belief that you could simply hand children self-esteem by telling them how smart and talented they are. Even though this is such an intuitively appealing idea, and even though it was exceedingly well-intentioned, I believe it has had disastrous effects.

14 In the 1990s, we took a poll among parents and found that almost 85 percent endorsed the notion that it was *necessary* to praise their children's abilities to give them confidence and help them achieve. Their children are now in the workforce, and we are told that young workers cannot last through the day without being propped up by praise, rewards, and recognition. Coaches are asking me where all the coachable athletes have gone. Parents ask me why their children won't work hard in school.

15 Could all of this come from well-meant praise? Well, we were suspicious of the praise movement at the time. We had already seen in our research that it was the most vulnerable children who were already obsessed with their intelligence and chronically worried about how smart they were. What if praising intelligence made all children concerned about their intelligence? This kind of praise might tell them that having high intelligence and talent is the most important thing and is what makes you valuable. It might tell them that intelligence is just something you have and not something you develop. It might deny the role of effort and dedication in achievement. In short, it might promote a fixed mindset with all of its vulnerabilities.

16 The wonderful thing about research is that you can put questions like this to the test—and we did (Kamins & Dweck, 1999; Mueller & Dweck, 1998). We gave two groups of children problems from an IQ test, and we praised them. We praised the children in one group for their intelligence, telling them, "Wow, that's a really good score. You must be smart at this." We praised the children in the other group for their effort: "Wow, that's a really good score. You must have worked really hard." That's all we did, but the results were dramatic. We did studies like this with children of different ages and ethnicities from around the country, and the results were the same.

17 Here is what happened with fifth graders. The children praised for their intelligence did not want to learn. When we offered them a challenging task that they could learn from, the majority opted for an easier one, one on which they could avoid making mistakes. The children praised for their effort wanted the task they could learn from.

18 The children praised for their intelligence lost their confidence as soon as the problems got more difficult. Now, as a group, they thought they weren't smart. They also lost their enjoyment, and, as a result, their performance plummeted. On the other hand, those praised for effort maintained their confidence, their motivation, and their performance. Actually, their performance improved over time such that, by the end, they were performing substantially better than the intelligence-praised children on this IQ test.

19 Finally, the children who were praised for their intelligence lied about their scores more often than the children who were praised for their effort. We asked children to write something (anonymously) about their experience to a child in another school, and we left a little space for them to report their scores. Almost 40 percent of the intelligence-praised children elevated their scores, whereas only 12 or 13 percent of children in the other group did so. To me this suggests that, after students are praised for their intelligence, it's too humiliating for them to admit mistakes.

The results were so striking that we repeated the study five times just to be sure, and each time roughly the same things happened. Intelligence praise, compared to effort (or "process") praise, put children into a fixed mindset. Instead of giving them confidence, it made them fragile, so much so that a brush with difficulty erased their confidence, their enjoyment, and their good performance, and made them ashamed of their work. This can hardly be the self-esteem that parents and educators have been aiming for. 20

Often, when children stop working in school, parents deal with this by reassuring their children how smart they are. We can now see that this simply fans the flames. It confirms the fixed mindset and makes kids all the more certain that they don't want to try something difficult—something that could lose them their parents' high regard. How *should* we praise our students? How *should* we reassure them? By focusing them on the process they engaged in—their effort, their strategies, their concentration, their perseverance, or their improvement. 21

"You really stuck to that until you got it. That's wonderful!" 22

"It was a hard project, but you did it one step at a time and it turned out great!" 23

"I like how you chose the tough problems to solve. You're really going to stretch yourself and learn new things." 24

"I know that school used to be a snap for you. What a waste that was. Now you really have an opportunity to develop your abilities." 25

Brainology 26

Can a growth mindset be taught directly to kids? If it can be taught, will it enhance their motivation and grades? We set out to answer this question by creating a growth-mindset workshop (Blackwell et al., 2007). We took seventh graders and divided them into two groups. Both groups got an eight-session workshop full of great study skills, but the "growth-mindset group" also got lessons in the growth mindset—what it was and how to apply it to their schoolwork. Those lessons began with an article called "You Can Grow Your Intelligence: New Research Shows the Brain Can Be Developed Like a Muscle." Students were mesmerized by this article and its message. They loved the idea that the growth of their brains was in their hands.

This article and the lessons that followed changed the terms of engagement for students. Many students had seen school as a place where they performed and were judged, but now they understood that they had an active role to play in the development of their minds. They got to work, and by the end of the semester the growth-mindset group showed a significant increase in their math grades. The control group—the group that had gotten eight sessions of study skills—showed no improvement and continued to decline. Even though they had learned many useful study skills, they did not have the motivation to put them into practice. 27

The teachers, who didn't even know there were two different groups, singled out students in the growth-mindset group as showing clear changes in their motivation. They reported that these students were now far more engaged with their schoolwork and were putting considerably more effort into their classroom learning, homework, and studying. 28

Joshua Aronson, Catherine Good, and their colleagues had similar findings (Aronson et al., 2002; Good et al., 2003). Their studies and ours also found that negatively stereotyped students (such as girls in math, or African-American and Hispanic students in math and verbal areas) showed substantial benefits from being in a 29

growth-mindset workshop. Stereotypes are typically fixed-mindset labels. They imply that the trait or ability in question is fixed and that some groups have it and others don't. Much of the harm that stereotypes do comes from the fixed-mindset message they send. The growth mindset, while not denying that performance differences might exist, portrays abilities as acquirable and sends a particularly encouraging message to students who have been negatively stereotyped—one that they respond to with renewed motivation and engagement.

Inspired by these positive findings, we started to think about how we could make a growth-mindset workshop more widely available. To do this, we have begun to develop a computer-based program called "Brainology." In six computer modules, students learn about the brain and how to make it work better. They follow two hip teens through their school day, learn how to confront and solve schoolwork problems, and create study plans. They visit a state-of-the-art virtual brain lab, do brain experiments, and find out such things as how the brain changes with learning—how it grows new connections every time students learn something new. They also learn how to use this idea in their schoolwork by putting their study skills to work to make themselves smarter. 30

We pilot-tested Brainology in 20 New York City schools. Virtually all of the students loved it and reported (anonymously) the ways in which they changed their ideas about learning and changed their learning and study habits. Here are some things they said in response to the question, "Did you change your mind about anything?" 31

> *I did change my mind about how the brain works . . . I will try harder because I know that the more you try, the more your brain works.*
>
> *Yes . . . I imagine neurons making connections in my brain and I feel like I am learning something.*
>
> *My favorite thing from Brainology is the neurons part where when you learn something, there are connections and they keep growing. I always picture them when I'm in school.*

Teachers also reported changes in their students, saying that they had become more active and eager learners: "They offer to practice, study, take notes, or pay attention to ensure that connections will be made." 32

What Do We Value? 33

In our society, we seem to worship talent—and we often portray it as a gift. Now we can see that this is not motivating to our students. Those who think they have this gift expect to sit there with it and be successful. When they aren't successful, they get defensive and demoralized, and often opt out. Those who don't think they have the gift also become defensive and demoralized, and often opt out as well.

We need to correct the harmful idea that people simply have gifts that transport them to success, and to teach our students that no matter how smart or talented someone is—be it Einstein, Mozart, or Michael Jordan—no one succeeds in a big way without enormous amounts of dedication and effort. It is through effort that people build their abilities and realize their potential. More and more research is showing there is one thing that sets the great successes apart from their equally talented peers—how hard they've worked (Ericsson et al., 2006). 34

Next time you're tempted to praise your students' intelligence or talent, restrain yourself. Instead, teach them how much fun a challenging task is, how interesting and 35

informative errors are, and how great it is to struggle with something and make progress. Most of all, teach them that by taking on challenges, making mistakes, and putting forth effort, they are making themselves smarter.

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After Reading: Reflect on the Text

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

6. Review your annotations and recall the lines from the reading you marked as interesting or thought-provoking or that you found particularly agreeable. Write down these lines. Put quotation marks around the words you copied from the text to indicate these are the author's words. After the last quotation mark, write the author's last name, Dweck, and the text page number in parentheses. Then explain why you agree with the lines or find them interesting or stimulating.

7. Review your annotations and recall the lines from the reading that confused you or that you found disagreeable. Write down these lines. Put quotation marks around the words you copied from the text to indicate these are the author's words. After the last quotation mark, write the author's last name, Dweck, and the text page number in parentheses. Then explain why you find the lines confusing or disagree with them.

Engage with the Reading

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. In writing, explain the main ideas from "Brainology: Transforming Students' Motivation to Learn" and give specific examples of how these ideas relate to your learning, your attitude toward college, or your success as a student.
2. In writing, give specific examples of how the main ideas from "Brainology: Transforming Students' Motivation to Learn" relate to your life *outside school*—your relationships, your hobbies, your job, and anything else.
3. The last section of the reading has the heading "What Do We Value?" According to the author, what do people in our society value? What *should* they value? Do you agree with the author about what people do value or should value?

Academic Style: Introductory Phrases to Acknowledge Sources

When writing about a reading, such as summarizing or quoting from a text, it is important to let readers know which text you are writing about. One way to provide this information is to add an *introductory phrase* that identifies the author or the title of the reading.

You can craft such an introductory phrase by writing, for example, "According to . . ." or "In the article . . ." at the beginning of the sentence and then stating the article title and/or the author's name. After your introductory phrase, place a comma. Then write the main idea (subject and verb) of the sentence. "Introductory phrase + main idea of reading" is a useful sentence pattern you can use to state the main idea of a reading in your own words.

Example Sentences Using Introductory Phrases That Acknowledge the Source

- According to Stanford professor Carol Dweck, students who believe their intelligence
  introductory phrase acknowledging source

can be developed (growth mindset) are more academically successful than students who believe their intelligence is set (fixed mindset).

- In the article "Brainology: Transforming Students' Motivation to Learn," Carol Dweck
  introductory phrase acknowledging source

describes her research that shows praising students for hard work is more motivating than praising their intellect.

DEVELOPING A CRITICAL-THINKING MINDSET

When faculty from universities, state colleges, and community colleges were surveyed to determine what reading, writing, and thinking skills they felt were important for student success in college, more than 75% identified the following four "intellectual habits of mind" as most crucial:

> Exhibit curiosity . . .
>
> Experiment with new ideas . . .
>
> See other points of view . . .
>
> Challenge their own beliefs . . . (*Academic Literacy 13*)

These habits of mind—to be open to new ideas and to test one's thinking—are part of developing a critical-thinking mindset. When you exercise critical thinking, you do not simply accept what you read or what you are told. Rather, you question, check, and assess that information. For instance, after reading Carol Dweck's ideas about fixed and growth mindsets, you might be *curious* to find out more about how Dweck developed her theories. You could *experiment* by applying Dweck's ideas of fixed and growth mindsets to people you know to determine whether these mindsets explain people's actions and behaviors. You might investigate *other points of view*, such as whether other researchers support—or disagree—with Dweck's theories. You might observe whether your *own beliefs* fit neatly into the categories of fixed and growth mindsets. "Strategies for Critical Thinking" will help you get started on developing critical-thinking skills.

The next reading is designed to start you down the critical-thinking path. You will read further research by Dweck and others that suggests students' mindsets are determined not only by internal factors, such as beliefs about learning, but also by external factors, such as income.

Strategies for Critical Thinking

- Question what you see, hear, or read by asking whether the ideas seem valid and are supported by logical reasons and convincing evidence.
- Evaluate the quality of the support for ideas, looking for convincing and sufficient evidence that an idea is acceptable.
- Consider the source of the information, including the qualifications or expertise of the person or organization providing the ideas and support.
- Seek out other points of view that challenge or question what you have read and compare them to each other.
- Have an open mind and be willing to change your own thinking if you read or hear ideas that are more compelling or convincing than what you originally thought.

READING SELECTION

"IMPACT OF POVERTY ON STUDENTS: ALL IN THEIR MINDS?"

Before Reading: Preview; Predict

Look at the reading selection title and read the information that immediately precedes the reading. Then write responses to the following using complete sentences.

1. Look at the title of the reading selection. What do you think the reading will be about? For instance, what impact could poverty have on a student's mindset?
2. The first subheading in the reading selection includes the phrase *Deficit Ideology*. What do you think this means? How could a deficit ideology relate to a fixed or growth mindset?

During Reading: Annotate

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

3. Try reading the selection in "chunks." That is, use the boldface headings to divide the reading into sections, or chunks, and then read one section at a time. After reading a section, stop to reflect on the important ideas, using the headings as a guide. Write down the main ideas in your own words.

4. As you read, mark any lines you find interesting or thought-provoking or particularly agreeable.
5. As you read, mark any lines that confuse you or that you find disagreeable.

Impact of Poverty on Students: All in Their Minds?

By Mary Ellen Flannery

NEA Today, 29 September 2016

Carol Dweck's ideas about fixed and growth mindsets have become popular with educators since the publication of her book Mindset: The New Psychology of Success *in 2006. Some people, however, question whether mindsets alone can account for student success or failure, or whether it is fair to focus on students' beliefs about their learning when other issues may be more powerful predictors of academic success. In this article, published by the National Education Association, the author describes Dweck's further research on the links between poverty, mindsets, and achievement.*

Students from low-income families who believe that they can develop skills and do better in school if they work hard and practice—a "growth mindset," in other words—may be buffered from the effects of poverty on student achievement, a Stanford University study has found. 1

But students who live in poverty are less likely to have growth mindsets. Instead, they have what researchers call a "fixed mindset," or the idea that intelligence and skills are more like foot size or eye color: an unchangeable trait. 2

The topic of growth vs. fixed mindsets, and their effects on student achievement, has been a popular—and controversial—one since Stanford's Carol Dweck published her book, *Mindset: The New Psychology of Success* in 2006. But the recent Stanford study, which involved 168,000 10th-grade students across all of Chile, is the most expansive, and goes the furthest to explore how family income interacts with mindset. 3

Typically, students from low-income families score worse on standardized tests than their wealthier peers. But the researchers found that poor students with growth mindsets performed just as well as wealthy students with fixed mindsets. 4

"Strikingly, students from low-income families (the lowest 10 percent) who had a growth mindset showed comparable test scores with fixed-mindset students whose families earned 13 times more (80th percentile)," said the study, which was published in the *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, and co-authored by Dweck, Susana Claro, and David Paunesko, all of Stanford. 5

The problem is students from low-income families are much less likely to have growth mindsets. "At the extremes, students from the lowest-income families were twice as likely to endorse a fixed mindset as students from the top-income families and schools," according to the study. 6

Growth Mindset in Students—Deficit Ideology? 7

But is a focus on "growth mindset" just another way of blaming individual students for problems that are institutionalized and overwhelming? Is it another way of saying, hey, if you can't succeed, then there must be something wrong with you?

In his blog *The Becoming Radical*, Furman University education professor P. L. Thomas, a former South Carolina high school English teacher, points to the dangers of "deficit ideology," or the belief that unsuccessful people lack something within themselves to be successful—like grit, or positivity. This kind of thinking discounts the effects of external forces, say racism or poverty, while also overlooking the benefits of wealth and privilege. 8

"Consequently, we routinely demand of children in the worst situations of life—through no fault of their own—that they somehow magically set aside those lives when they walk into school," Thomas points out. This may be an appealing idea, but it's something that most adults can't do, he adds. 9

The problem, some advocates say, is not that the more than half of all American children who live in poverty have the wrong mindset. The problem is that more than half of all American children live in poverty. 10

The researchers do address these concerns: "To be clear, we are not suggesting that structural factors, like income inequality or disparities in school quality, are less important than psychological factors. Nor are we saying that teaching students a growth mindset is a substitute for systemic efforts to alleviate poverty and economic inequality. Such claims would stand at odds with decades of research and our own data." 11

Rather, they say, their work reveals the way structural inequalities can lead to psychological inequalities, and hopefully suggest ways that educators can more effectively support these students. 12

How It Works in the Classroom 13

Almost every teacher—98 percent—surveyed recently by the Education Week Research Center agreed that using growth mindset in the classroom can improve learning. And, importantly, nearly as many also say it will improve instruction.

The catch is that only about 20 percent strongly believe that they're good at fostering growth mindset in students, and they have even less confidence in their colleagues and administrators. Eighty-five percent said they would like to get professional development in this area. 14

Since publishing her book, Dweck has identified a few ways that teachers are more likely to find success with using a growth mindset in their classes. For one thing, "a growth mindset isn't just about effort," she told *Education Week*. "Students need to try new strategies and seek input from others when they're stuck. They need this repertoire of approaches—not just sheer effort—to learn and improve." 15

She also suggests that educators remember that effort is a means to an end, which is more learning. Effort is not the end goal itself. "Too often nowadays, praise is given to students who are putting forth effort, but *not learning*, in order to make them feel good in the moment: 'Great effort! You tried your best!'" she writes. A better approach, she suggests: "When [students] are stuck, teachers can appreciate their work so far, but add: 'Let's talk about what you've tried, and what you can try next.'" 16

Dweck also suggests that it's equally important to consider whether teachers themselves have a fixed, or growth, mindset, and to help them adopt a deeper, true growth mindset that will show up in their classroom practices. The key to this, she says, is acknowledging that we all are a mixture of fixed and growth mindsets, and we should watch carefully for our fixed-mindset triggers. 17

After Reading: Reflect on the Text

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

6. Review your annotations and recall the lines from the reading you marked as interesting or thought-provoking or that you found particularly agreeable. Write down these lines and put quotation marks around them to indicate that they are the author's words. After the last quotation mark, write the author's last name and the text page number in parentheses. Then explain why you agree with the lines or find them interesting or stimulating.
7. Review your annotations and recall the lines from the reading that confused you or that you found disagreeable. Write down these lines and put quotation marks around them to indicate these are the author's words. After the last quotation mark, write the author's last name and the text page number in parentheses. Then explain why you find the lines confusing or disagree with them.

Engage with the Reading

1. What did researchers find out about the link between poverty and a fixed or growth mindset? What did they find out about the link between students' mindsets and their achievement? Did these links surprise you? Why or why not?
2. The reading selection raises the question whether "a focus on 'growth mindset' [is] just another way of blaming individual students for problems that are institutionalized and overwhelming." What does this quote mean? Do you agree with the quote?
3. Do you have experience with or knowledge of schools in low-income neighborhoods versus those in wealthier communities? Using your knowledge or experiences, explain the differences between low-income and high-income schools and how or why different schools could influence student achievement.
4. Do you feel you come from a low-income family or a high-income family? Do you believe that your family's income influences your mindset as a student? Explain and give examples.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

analyze To break down into parts to understand the whole.

brainstorm To discuss informally with others.

critical thinking The process of actively questioning arguments and evaluating evidence.

draft A version of a paper or other document.

evaluate To determine value or significance.

freewrite To write quickly and continuously in complete sentences but without regard to grammar and spelling errors.

outline A written plan for writing, separating main ideas from supporting points.

sinking in Reading slowly and carefully, usually to understand information.

skim To read or look over quickly, usually to find the main ideas.

synthesize To combine different ideas into a new whole.

text Any printed or written document, including textbooks, other books, articles, essays, and websites.

Chapter Summary

- Successful college students read to learn, persist in the face of difficulties, and try various strategies for resolving confusion.
- College writing requires time and effort; going through a process and practicing lead to more effective writing.
- Being motivated and being interested to learn are keys to college success.
- Successful college students believe that they can learn and have control over their learning.
- College requires students to think critically about what they read and keep an open mind to new ideas.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each of the following exercises, using complete sentences for your responses.

1. The chapter "Analyzing Visuals" includes an image that contrasts a growth mindset and a fixed mindset. Create an infographic that shows the habits of successful versus unsuccessful college students. Write a brief summary for the image to explain the habits.

2. Explain in writing what you plan to do to be successful in your college classes.
3. If you completed the survey (in Figure 1.2), review your answers and consider the information in this chapter. What reading, writing, and learning strategies will you use this semester in your college classes?
4. Reflect on your reasons and motivations for attending college. Why are you in college? What are your learning goals?

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CHAPTER 2

Active Reading

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Recognize reading and writing as processes.
- Preview and freewrite before reading.
- Identify the topic, thesis, and main ideas in a reading.
- Annotate and summarize a reading.

Theme: What Is the Effect of Multitasking on Learning?

Multitasking refers to doing many things at the same time. Look at the photograph in Figure 2.1. How is the individual multitasking?

Do you multitask? For example, while you are studying, do you also text on your phone or listen to music? Do you think multitasking makes you *more* productive—or *less* productive? In this chapter, you will read articles about how multitasking affects college students and employees. You will learn strategies that will help you read with understanding. Specifically, because reading and writing are complementary processes, you will learn how to use writing before, during, and after reading to aid comprehension, help reflect on the reading, and connect the reading to your life.

REALIZING READING AND WRITING AS PROCESSES

College requires students to be active readers and skillful writers. As with any skill, such as playing a sport or drawing a picture, getting better takes practice. Skillfull writing and attentive reading do not happen all at once. A *process* is involved.

As part of the reading process, strategic readers engage in many activities before, during, and after they read to ensure they comprehend and think

FIGURE 2.1 **Multitasking with Everyday Tasks**

Bananastock/Alamy Stock Photo

critically about what they read. Study Figure 2.2, which identifies some strategies readers can use during the reading process to understand the material. While this is not a complete description of *all* the things readers do, it is a good start.

Moreover, strategic readers rarely read just once. Often, a first reading helps them grasp the main idea or get an overview—the "big picture"—of the passage.

FIGURE 2.2 **What Strategic Readers Do during the Reading Process**

Then a second reading may be more analytical or more focused. Even two readings may not be sufficient when readers are faced with understanding challenging or new material. The point is that the reading process is **recursive**; that is, it involves going back over what was read, sometimes many times.

Much of what you learn in college comes through reading. When you are reading, you want to understand what you read: comprehension is an essential goal. Sometimes it is possible to read all the words on a page and still not truly comprehend what you have read. To explore this idea, try the Read for Comprehension activity.

Read for Comprehension

First, read the following short passage, entitled "The Breakaway vs. the Peloton":

> At the pointy end of the peloton, Team Sky controlled the field. However, on the descent a breakaway formed. Relegated to Sky's slipstream, no others could bridge the gap. Finally, a rampaging chase group headed home but were unable to catch the five-man breakaway.

Now test yourself on the material you have read, and answer the following questions.

1. Who controlled the field?
2. What happened on the descent?
3. Who could bridge the gap?
4. How many men were in the breakaway?
5. Summarize the paragraph—that is, restate the main ideas using your own words.

You were probably able to answer correctly questions 1–4 in the Read for Comprehension activity but had trouble with the last item, which asks you to **summarize** the paragraph. Could you successfully explain the main ideas of the paragraph? Did you really understand what you read? Maybe you guessed that the passage is about a sport. Chances are, you did not really understand it—unless you know something about professional road race cycling. Maybe if you had done some background reading or had **prior**, or background, **knowledge** about cycling or had participated in a bike race yourself, the passage would have made more sense to you.

The point is that you can read all the words on a page and even successfully pass a test on a reading passage without processing and truly understanding what you read. When you are a college student, this kind of mindless reading does not serve your goals well. Instead, you want to engage actively with your reading and understand what the author is saying. Writing about the reading in your own words can test your comprehension.

To sum up: College reading requires thinking. Read actively by engaging in the reading process and by using writing to test your comprehension.

PREVIEWING BEFORE READING

Before you read, it is a good practice to preview the reading material. **Previewing** involves thinking about *what* you will be reading: the subject of the reading. It also involves thinking about *why* you are reading: the purpose for your reading. Think of previewing as a warm-up, like stretching before you exercise. Previewing prepares you mentally for the serious work of reading (see "Strategies for Previewing a Reading").

Specifically, previewing can activate your prior knowledge so you will better understand and remember what you read. For instance, if you had read introductory material about the short passage "The Breakaway vs. the Peloton," you might have learned it described a stage in the Tour de France. Moreover, if you had seen the passage in the context of a publication, you might have recognized that the author was a former professional bike racer and that the passage was published in a cycling magazine. These clues could establish context for the passage and help you read with a clearer idea of the situation.

Strategies for Previewing a Reading

- Read any *introductory* or *summary* material to identify the main ideas.
- Identify the *author* and *publication* to provide background information and context.
- Look at the title and the *headings* to get an overview of the topic.
- *Skim*, or *glance quickly over*, the reading to get a feeling for its organization.
- Consider the *length* of the reading to estimate how much time you will need to read it.
- Recognize *why* you are reading the material to help you focus on your purpose as you read.

You can also skim the text to prepare to read. Train yourself to glance at key places, especially the title and the headings. Your goal is to get an overview of the reading and its organization—how the author has structured and presented the content—and the main points, which are often embedded in the title and headings. Then, after previewing, you can read carefully to understand the key concepts and study the topic in depth.

Finally, consider why you are reading. Do you need to know the information for a test? Must you use it in an essay? Knowing your reading purpose can help you focus on the relevant ideas or details, and take notes on useful information.

Before you read the first article in this chapter, preview the content by answering the "Before Reading" questions. The previewing questions are general—that is, you can apply them to most of your reading and in this way make previewing a habit.

READING SELECTION

"ONLINE STUDENTS MULTITASK MORE (NOT IN A GOOD WAY)"

Before Reading: Preview; Identify Your Purpose; Recognize Prior Knowledge

Skim the reading "Online Students Multitask More (Not in a Good Way)" that follows. Then write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

1. Read the information in italics below the article title. What can you learn from it about the reading?
2. Who is the author? Where was the article published? Who might be the readers?
3. What is the main topic of the reading?
4. How is the information organized? How long is the reading?
5. What is your purpose for reading?
6. What do you already know about this topic? Freewrite about it for five minutes.

During Reading: Connect with the Text

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

7. As you read, mark any lines you find interesting or thought-provoking or particularly agreeable. Explain why you agree with the lines or find them interesting or stimulating.
8. As you read, mark any lines that confuse you or you find disagreeable. Explain why you find the lines confusing or disagree with them.

Online Students Multitask More (Not in a Good Way)

By Doug Lederman

Inside Higher Ed, 20 February 2019

Inside Higher Ed *publishes news focused on community colleges and four-year universities. In the following article, the author, Doug Lederman, a founder and an editor of* Inside Higher Ed, *describes research on the multitasking habits of college*

students while attending in-person or online classes. The findings suggest students, to their detriment, multitask more frequently during online classes; however, other experts question whether comparing online to in-person classes overlooks other important concerns.

Study finds that even those who are inclined to stray do so less in face-to-face classes—presumably because instructors and peers are watching. What are the implications for online learning? Is all multitasking bad?

Andrew Lepp wasn't surprised—and wouldn't expect most people familiar with higher education to be surprised—by the headline finding of a study he and several colleagues published last week: that students in online courses said they engaged in more noneducational multitasking than did their peers in in-person courses. 1

"I would have bet anything that students would have multitasked more in online courses," said Lepp, a professor of recreation, park and tourism management at Kent State University. "In that way this study just confirmed what's obvious." 2

But "where it gets interesting," Lepp said of the study he and his colleagues published this month in *Sage Open*, is in the finding that students who were deemed to have similar levels of inclination to multitask were much less likely to do so in face-to-face classes than in online courses. 3

What that suggests, Lepp said, is that something about in-person courses constrains students from engaging in the texting, web shopping and other behaviors that are widely shown as impeding learning. 4

What is that something? "The presence of the teacher and other students who might look sideways at a student who is multitasking," Lepp asserts. 5

Lepp and his co-authors—Jacob E. Barkley, also an education professor at Kent State; Aryn C. Karpinski, an associate professor at Kent State; and Shweta Singh, a doctoral student at Purdue University—have done significant work on students' use of smartphones and the relationship to academic success. They take as an article of faith that multitasking and other forms of distraction from academic work are problematic for students. 6

Their current study was inspired by an incident two years ago in which Lepp and Karpinski happened upon a student entering data into a spreadsheet on a desktop computer, streaming Netflix on a laptop and using headphones to listen to her smartphone. Asked what she was listening to, the student said, "'Oh, that's my online biology course,'" according to Lepp. His reply: "Yikes!" 7

After scanning the literature and failing to find studies assessing the role of multitasking in online courses, the researchers undertook one. They asked a sample of nearly 300 Kent State students who had taken both fully online and face-to-face courses—the vast majority of whom lived near the physical campus—a series of questions about their behaviors in the two settings. 8

As seen in the table below, students said they were about 25 percent more likely to engage in the set of behaviors (listening to music, texting, social networking, internet browsing and the like) in online rather than in in-person courses. 9

TABLE 2 Comparison of Multitasking Behaviors in 100% Online Versus Face-to-Face Courses

Multitasking Behavior	Online Courses					Face-to-Face Courses					
	n	*M*	Median	*SD*	IQR	*M*	Median	*SD*	IQR	|Z|	*p*
Texting	291	3.35	3.00	1.124	1.00	2.74	3.00	1.081	1.00	7.925	<.001
Email	291	2.71	3.00	1.261	2.00	1.88	2.00	0.986	1.00	9.448	<.001
Social networking	291	2.88	3.00	1.267	2.00	2.43	2.00	1.190	2.00	5.349	<.001
Watch videos	291	2.54	3.00	1.257	3.00	1.25	1.00	0.633	0.00	11.689	<.001
Off-task Internet	291	2.96	3.00	1.193	2.00	2.46	3.00	1.172	2.00	5.629	<.001
Video games	291	1.36	1.00	0.791	0.00	1.25	1.00	0.726	0.00	1.949	=.05
Music	291	3.27	3.00	1.326	2.00	1.31	1.00	0.747	0.00	13.143	<.001
Talking	291	2.84	3.00	1.176	2.00	2.19	2.00	1.054	2.00	7.915	<.001
Doodling	291	1.85	1.00	1.152	1.00	2.27	2.00	1.244	2.00	5.544	<.001
SCALES	291	2.64	2.56	0.731	1.00	1.97	1.89	0.612	0.78	16.541	<.001

Note. Frequency of behavior assessed with 5-point Likert-type scale (1 = *never,* 5 = *always*); individual items compared with Wilcoxon signed-rank test for related samples; scales created by summing individual items and dividing by number of items (nine). Scale means compared using dependent sample *t* tests. IQR = interquartile range.

Lepp, A., Jacob E. Barkley, Aryn C. Karpinski, and Shweta Singh. "College Students' Multitasking Behavior in Online Versus Face-to-Face Courses." *SAGE Open* (January 2019).

Students who had greater "multitasking tendency" (as measured by something called the Polychronic-Monochronic Tendency Scale) were, unsurprisingly, more likely to multitask in online settings than were those who scored low on the test. But the same was not true in face-to-face courses. 10

"In other words," the researchers wrote, "students who have positive attitudes about multitasking and prefer to multitask appear to better control this academically disadvantageous behavior in face-to-face courses." They attribute the students' "control" heavily to what Lepp called the "norms of the classroom"—essentially, pressure from peers or the instructor *not* to multitask. 11

Lepp and his colleagues are careful to note that many students who take online courses, particularly working adults and those far from physical campuses, do so because this is their best or only option. 12

The findings, then, are most relevant for undergraduate students with "sufficient access to traditional face-to-face courses—that is, students already enrolled at traditional 'brick and mortar' universities and living on or near campus," they write. For those students, "those teaching online courses should place emphasis on discouraging students' multitasking behavior while recognizing that the methods for doing so may be very different than in face-to-face courses." Additionally, "the developers of online courses should explore technological and pedagogical solutions aimed at keeping online learners focused on their primary task in the absence of a physically present instructor." 13

Limitations of the Study 14

Experts on online education took issue with multiple aspects of the Kent State study, even as they acknowledged that multitasking is a problem in many settings.

George Veletsianos, holder of the Canada Research Chair in Innovative Learning and Technology at Royal Roads University, in British Columbia, cited a common complaint about research like this: the tendency to compare online and face-to-face courses as if all online courses (or all face-to-face courses, for that matter) were the same. Were the online courses synchronous or asynchronous? Were they predominantly lectures or did they engage students with active learning? 15

"A better (and fairer) comparison for this study," Veletsianos said in an email, "would have been between courses of the same modality that included variations in something like class size or pedagogy. Such an investigation would allow us to evaluate the question of whether students are more likely to multitask when enrolled in larger vs. smaller class sizes. Or, whether pedagogy has an impact on multitasking, which I suspect it does (e.g., are you more likely to multitask when listening to a lecture or when actively working in a group to develop a solution to a posed problem?)." 16

Laura Gibbs, an online instructor at the University of Oklahoma who blogs frequently about technology and learning, raised similar questions in a blog post entitled "Attention-Policing and Online Proctoring: Thoughts on a Study." 17

"Online and face-to-face are delivery modes; they are not course designs," she wrote. "To say that online courses are alike because they are online is like saying that rocky road ice cream and tater tots are the same because you find them in the freezer section. Yes, being frozen is an important part of rocky road ice cream and of tater tots, but that does not mean they are the same thing . . . Studying online courses versus face-to-face courses is meaningless unless you know more about the courses in question, and about the students, than just the delivery mode." 18

Gibbs also balked at the researchers' suggestion that it would be an improvement to limit students' ability to multitask in online settings in the same way they might feel restricted in face-to-face courses. 19

"Is policing, in-person or remotely, the best way to help students develop better self-awareness and self-regulation? I don't think so," she wrote. "One of the things I like about teaching online is that it means I can give the students so much more freedom, and also so much more responsibility, so that they can, perhaps, learn new things about the best strategies for their own learning." 20

If students *choose* to multitask, she argues, they might have good reasons to do so: because they need more information to understand something, they're cramming for a test in another course—or because they are bored, which just might be the professor's fault, she says. 21

"We need to ask students about their reasons, and students need to learn to interrogate their own reasons," Gibbs writes. "That's how you develop self-regulation. Sweeping generalizations, especially technophobic generalizations, are not going to help." 22

Veletsianos agreed that understanding why students are multitasking is essential for suggesting possible solutions. "Are they engaging in such behavior because our pedagogies are uninteresting, because other media are distracting them, because they believe they can multitask when in actuality this is rarely the case?" he said. "The former might require us rethinking how we teach, while the latter might require us to equip students with better study skills." 23

What might instructors or institutions do to diminish multitasking that is distracting? Might social pressure work? 24

"Assuming that social pressure reduces the incidence of multitasking, pedagogical practices that heighten instructor-student and student-student interactions might reduce 25

multitasking," Veletsianos wrote. "One could include further opportunities for collaborative problem solving or small-group tutorials. In theory, reducing the amount of time that students work in isolation might reduce multitasking. Another approach might involve including information in assignments/activities that exert social pressure intended to reduce multitasking. For instance, one could imagine a timed assignment in which students are given 60 minutes to solve a problem and prior to the start of the activity they are provided a message that says something similar to this: 'peers who multitask have reported the following X negative consequences' (e.g., not being able to finish on time, earning a lower grade, and so on)."

After Reading: Summarize; Reflect

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

9. To check your comprehension, rewrite the main ideas of the reading in your own words.
10. Review your annotations and then consider this: What ideas in the text are new to you? What ideas in the text conflict with what you already knew before you started reading?

Engage with the Reading

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Research cited in the article indicates that students in online courses engage in more off-task multitasking than students in in-person classes. Based on your experiences as a student, do you believe this is true? Why or why not?
2. One criticism of the study by Lepp is that not all online courses are the same; some are synchronous and others asynchronous, some are small and others large. What do you believe are the most important factors in keeping students engaged in a class, whether online or in-person?
3. Do you believe the criticisms of Lepp's study are valid? Why or why not?

IDENTIFYING THE TOPIC, THESIS, AND MAIN IDEAS IN A READING

An important step in comprehending what you read is to locate the main ideas and the important information.

Topic versus Thesis

It is helpful to know the difference between a *topic* and a *thesis.* The **topic** of a reading can be found by answering the question: *What subject is the reading about?* The answer would be a word or phrase that describes the reading's subject. For instance, if you were asked the topic of the first reading in this chapter, you might answer "multitasking and online students," because that is the general subject of the reading.

The **thesis** of a reading is an answer to the question: *What does the author say about the topic?* The answer should be expressed in a complete sentence. For example, if someone asked you about the author's attitude toward the topic of the

first reading, you might answer, "Students taking classes online multitask more frequently than students taking in-person classes." Often the thesis is referred to as the main idea of the reading. Figure 2.3 contrasts a topic with a thesis.

FIGURE 2.3 Topic versus Thesis

Topic	Thesis
Is the subject of the reading.	Combines the subject of the reading and the author's attitude toward that subject.
Is expressed in a word or phrase.	Is expressed in a complete sentence.
Example: multitasking and online students	Example: Students taking classes online multitask more frequently than students taking in-person classes.

Identifying Main Ideas

Often writers break up the thesis (the overall main idea) and explain it in different parts of the writing. So, in addition to locating the topic and thesis, you should determine the related main ideas the author presents throughout the reading.

Fortunately, most college texts are written to provide information and, therefore, authors make their main ideas clear by giving strong clues. Knowing where to look for these main idea clues can help you recognize crucial information. Study "Strategies for Locating Main Ideas" to understand where to locate important ideas in a reading.

Strategies for Locating Main Ideas

Use the following clues in the reading itself.

- **Title and headings.** The title often identifies an overall main idea in the reading, while a heading usually points to the main idea of a particular paragraph or section.
- **Opening sentence in a paragraph.** The first sentence of the paragraph often states its main idea, in which case it is called the *topic sentence*.
- **Last sentence in a paragraph.** The closing sentence may sum up the main idea of a paragraph. In fact, sometimes the main idea of a paragraph is stated in both its opening and closing sentences or in both the opening and closing sentences of a section of the reading.
- **Examples.** Writers often use examples to explain important points and concepts. When you see an example, look for a main idea stated in the text right before or immediately after the example.
- **Repetition.** Writers sometimes repeat words or phrases to stress a main idea.
- **Key words.** Words that represent important concepts or subjects can help readers locate main ideas.
- **Highlighted words and phrases.** A special type style, such as bold or italic type, calls attention to important words and ideas.

Academic Style: Signal Verbs

When summarizing, paraphrasing, or quoting, you can acknowledge the source of information, as well as reflect the tone of the source, by using a *signal verb*. Well-chosen signal verbs show an understanding of an author's purpose. For instance, using a neutral verb, such as *states*, indicates the author is writing to inform. If the author has a strong opinion, then a verb such as *argues* or *asserts* would indicate the writer is developing an argument.

Signal Verbs and Their Purposes

Neutral			
believes	observes	says	tells
explains	reports	states	thinks
Argues For			
argues	claims	emphasizes	proposes
asserts	declares	offers	reasons
Argues Against			
contradicts	disagrees	objects	rebuts
criticizes	disputes	opposes	refutes
States Indirectly			
hints	implies	insinuates	suggests
Concludes			
concludes	decides	determines	finds
Gives Support			
cites	describes	references	supports

Examples of Sentences Using Signal Verbs

- Based on her research, assistant professor Zheng Wang concludes that college students enjoy multitasking while studying because "it makes them feel good."
  signal verb

- In the article "Don't Multitask: Your Brain Will Thank You," the author, Issie Lapowsky, describes multitasking as doing two things at the same time.
  signal verb

ANNOTATING AND SUMMARIZING

One strategy to actively engage while reading is to mark the main ideas in the text. Additionally, think meaningfully about a reading and record your reactions to the text. These practices will help you stay focused on and involved in your reading.

Annotating a Text

Some students think that taking notes must involve extensively highlighting the reading with a brightly colored marker, but highlighting information often does not promote understanding and critical thinking. Other techniques for marking up a text may be more effective. Some research indicates that if students *selectively underline* key words or phrases, as well as *restate main ideas in their own words*, they will better understand what they read.

Although there is no one right way to mark a text, it is a good idea to develop a *system* for **annotating**, or taking notes (see "Strategies for Annotating"), and to understand the *purpose* of annotation.

Strategies for Annotating

- **Write brief summaries in the margins.** Writing summaries in your own words, rather than copying words or phrases from the reading, will help you understand and remember what you read. It will also help you avoid unintentional *plagiarism*, a serious academic offense involving using someone else's words or ideas as if they were one's own. Summarize in a clear, concise manner so that you can reread your notes.
- **List multiple ideas in a clear way.** For instance, if the text notes that there are "three causes," you could number the three causes; if the text describes causes and effects, you could use arrows to show the relationships.
- **Note examples.** The text's examples not only promote understanding of concepts but also may be a useful way to demonstrate your knowledge on tests or in essays. Moreover, examples typically indicate that a main idea is close by in the reading, because if a concept is important, there is often an example to illustrate it. You can mark examples with a particular code, such as "EX."
- **Put key information into charts or graphs.** Pulling out important information from the text and organizing it is one way to make it your own. You may more clearly see the relationships among ideas, or among ideas and examples, in a chart or graph.
- **Jot down possible test questions.** If you are reading to prepare for a test, anticipate test questions. As you read, look for material that you believe will be on the test. If you can frame the information in the form of a question, do so as you are reading.
- **Note and seek clarification of confusing ideas.** You can mark unclear passages with a question mark. Ask your instructor during lecture or office hours to explain the concept, or get your classmates' help. Do not skim over important information; instead, work hard to make sense of it.

continued

- **Underline key words and phrases.** After reading and annotating, underline key words and phrases in the text that will help you recall important information. Use your annotations in the margin to guide your selection of key phrases or sentences—that is, the ones that best sum up the important ideas.
- **Note your reactions.** If you have any questions, thoughts, associations, or responses concerning the reading, note them in the margin as you read so that you will not forget them. Reactions to the text may help you form questions, develop responses, or make connections among topics.

As you gain experience marking your texts, you may develop your own codes for annotating. For instance, you might highlight main ideas in color and circle examples. Whatever symbols or markings you use, be clear and consistent so that you will always know what your marks mean.

Summarizing a Text

An important part of annotating is to write brief summaries in the margin. As we saw earlier in this chapter, to summarize means to condense the information and to rewrite it in your own words. As the Read for Comprehension activity, earlier in this chapter, demonstrates (the "Breakaway vs. the Peloton" paragraph), accurately summarizing a text is an important strategy for assessing comprehension. Moreover, an effectively written summary may be valuable in your own writing, for example, as background information on a topic or as evidence to support your original thesis.

"Strategies for Summarizing" is a step-by-step guide for writing summaries of main sections of a reading, using "Multitasking May Hurt Your Performance but It Makes You Feel Better" as an example.

Strategies for Summarizing

The examples for these steps are from the reading selection "Multitasking May Hurt Your Performance but It Makes You Feel Better."

1. **Chunk the reading by dividing it into logical groups.** If the reading includes subheadings, the paragraphs under each subheading constitute a group. If there are no subheadings, look for connections between paragraphs to create logical groups.

   Example of chunking the reading: In "Multitasking May Hurt Your Performance," the first two paragraphs (or the first two sentences) summarize the research findings. Then the next seven paragraphs describe a study on multitasking. Paragraphs 1–2 could be considered one chunk, and paragraphs 3–9 another chunk.

continued

2. **Identify the main ideas in each section of the reading.** Look for clues to the main ideas, such as key words that signal main ideas. Look in key places in the text, such as topic sentences or concluding sentences in paragraphs, for main ideas. Use headings or titles, too, as a guide to main ideas.

   Example of figuring out the main idea from key words: The words "a new study suggests" or "the findings provide" indicate a summary of the research conclusions. Moreover, their placement at the beginning of the reading suggests these are main ideas.

3. **Focus on key words or phrases that exemplify the main idea.** No need to underline the entire sentence; rather, focus on the key concepts most important to the main idea. This technique will help you to condense the information.

   Example of main idea sentence with key words and phrases underlined: "The findings provide clues as to why multitasking is so popular, even though many studies show it is not productive."

4. **Jot down the key words or concepts in your own words**. You do not have to write a sentence on the first attempt. Instead, write as much of the main ideas as possible in your own words. Use fresh words and new ways to rephrase the ideas. If you cannot replace key words or if phrases are especially well written, then you may include these in your summary with quotation marks around them.

   Example of key concepts written in own words:

   - "feel good" = provide satisfaction
   - "not productive" = not effective

5. **Rewrite the overall main idea in your own words in a complete sentence.** It may take several attempts to write a summary sentence that is accurate and complete, and that uses your own words.

   Example summary, first draft: People like to multitask even though they are not good at it, because it makes them feel good.

   Comment: Too much like the original text. Rewrite using more of your own words.

   Example summary, second draft: Even though they do not do it well, people get satisfaction from multitasking because it makes them feel good in the moment.

   Comment: Better, but *good* is vague and the sentence is wordy. Replace with a more specific word and revise for conciseness.

   Example summary, final draft: While multitasking may provide satisfaction in the moment, it harms effectiveness overall.

   Comment: Much better.

continued

6. **Credit the source of the summary.** When you summarize other people's ideas, you must give them credit for their thinking. You can do this by either (a) writing the author and title of the reading at the beginning of your summary sentence or (b) including the author and page number in parentheses after the summary sentence.

   Example of crediting a source by citing the title of the reading at the beginning of the sentence: According to the article "Multitasking May Hurt Your Performance but It Makes You Feel Better," Ohio State University researchers have found that while multitasking may provide satisfaction in the moment, it harms effectiveness overall.

   Example of crediting the source by citing the author and page number in parentheses after the sentence: Researchers have found that while multitasking may provide satisfaction in the moment, it harms effectiveness overall (Ohio State University 34).

Study Figure 2.4, which provides annotations for the reading selection "Multitasking May Hurt Your Performance but It Makes You Feel Better." The article was annotated after several readings. In the middle is the article.

- In the right margin of the article are brief summaries of the main ideas and supporting examples, which are highlighted in blue.
- In the left margin are the reader's reactions ("responses") to the reading and definitions of unfamiliar words, which are highlighted in orange.

Notice that the annotations are consistent and well organized. They do not overwhelm the text. Rather, they selectively point out the thesis, the main ideas and examples, and the reader's reactions. In fact, if you skim the reading paying attention to the highlighted passages, you will be rewarded with a brief summary of the reading. Effective annotations such as these will enhance your

- Comprehension: to understand while reading.
- Reaction: to think and respond to the reading.
- Review: to look over your notes before class, before discussions, or in advance of tests.
- Writing: to select and include important information from the text when writing a paper.

FIGURE 2.4 Annotated Article

Responses and Definitions

Main Ideas and Examples

Multitasking May Hurt Your Performance but It Makes You Feel Better

Ohio State University, 30 April 2012

What does "media multitasking" mean?

COLUMBUS, Ohio—People aren't very good at media multitasking—like reading a book while watching TV—but do it anyway because it makes them feel good, a new study suggests.

Thesis = While multitasking may provide satisfaction in the moment, it harms effectiveness overall.

Media = means of mass communication like broadcasting or Internet.

The findings provide clues as to why multitasking is so popular, even though many studies show it is not productive.

Researchers had college students record all of their media use and other activities for 28 days, including why they used various media sources and what they got out of it.

Example: Study of college students shows more good feelings but lower productivity if multitasking when studying.

I can relate to getting an "emotional boost" when studying and checking social media posts.

The findings showed that multitasking often gave the students an emotional boost, even when it hurt their cognitive functions, such as studying.

"There's this myth among some people that multitasking makes them more productive," said Zheng Wang, lead author of the study and assistant professor of communication at Ohio State University.

Main Idea: Students think feeling good means they are working well.

Interesting point that one feels more satisfied, but isn't really productive.

"But they seem to be misperceiving the positive feelings they get from multitasking. They are not being more productive—they just feel more emotionally satisfied from their work."

Example: Watching TV while reading makes studying fun.

Take, for example, students who watched TV while reading a book. They reported feeling more emotionally satisfied than those who studied without watching TV, but also reported that they didn't achieve their cognitive goals as well, Wang said.

The example of watching TV seems a bit dated; watching YouTube videos or TikTok is more popular for students.

Main Idea: False feeling of increased productivity because of multitasking.

"They felt satisfied not because they were effective at studying, but because the addition of TV made the studying entertaining. The combination of the activities accounts for the good feelings obtained," Wang said.

Wang conducted the study with John Tchernev, a graduate student in Communication at Ohio State. Their results appear online in the *Journal of Communication*.

Responses and Definitions

Main Ideas and Examples

Wang said many studies done in laboratory settings have found that people show poorer performance on a variety of tasks when they try to juggle multiple media sources at the same time: for example, going from texting a friend, to reading a book, to watching an online video.

Main Idea: Multitasking is popular despite impairing performance.

But surveys show that media multitasking is only becoming more popular. The question, Wang said, is why do people do so much multitasking if it actually impairs their performance?

"impairs" = weakens, damages

To answer that question, Wang said they had to move out of the laboratory and into real life. They recruited 32 college students who agreed to carry a cellphone-like device and report on their activities three times each day for four weeks.

I wonder if studies are done on college students because they multitask more often than other people?

Example: Study of college students who self-reported their multitasking

The participants reported on each media use (such as computer, radio, print, television) and subtypes (for computer use, whether they were web browsing, using social networking, etc.). They reported the type of activity, the duration, and whether any other activities were performed simultaneously (in other words, whether they were multitasking).

They also provided their motivations for each activity or combination of activities from a list of seven potential needs, including social, fun/entertainment, study/work, and habits/background noise. For each need, they reported the strength of the need on a 10-point scale, and whether those needs were met on a 4-point scale.

Maybe this finding suggests that students need to take a break when faced with an "increased cognitive need" and therefore multitask. Maybe students need to stop studying and go do something else, rather than try to do two things at once.

The results showed that participants were more likely to multitask when they reported an increase in cognitive needs (such as study or work) or habitual needs or both.

Main Idea: Multitasking happens in response to "cognitive" or "habitual" needs.

That means, for example, that the students were more likely to multitask when they needed to study (a cognitive need).

But one of the key findings of the study is that this multitasking didn't do a very good job of satisfying their cognitive needs which actually motivate the multitasking in the first place, Wang said. That's probably because their other media use distracted them from the job of studying. However, the

Main Idea: Multitasking does not help students with intellectual needs, although it makes them feel good.

Responses and Definitions

Main Ideas and Examples

students reported that the multitasking was very good at meeting their emotional needs (fun/entertainment/relaxing)—interestingly, a need they weren't even seeking to fulfill.

In addition, the results showed that habits played an important role in the use of media multitasking.

"Our findings showed that habitual needs increase media multitasking and are also gratified from multitasking," she said.

Main Idea: Multitasking does not help students with intellectual needs, although it makes them feel good.

Ha! I can relate; lots of my friends seem addicted to their smartphones and to constantly checking their social media accounts.

This suggests that people get used to multitasking, which makes them more likely to continue.

"We found what we call a dynamical feedback loop. If you multitask today, you're likely to do so again tomorrow, further strengthening the behavior over time," she said.

Main Idea: The more someone multitasks, the more they want to keep multitasking.

"This is worrisome because students begin to feel like they need to have the TV on or they need to continually check their text messages or computer while they do their homework. It's not helping them, but they get an emotional reward that keeps them doing it.

"It is critical that we carefully examine the long-term influence of media multitasking on how we perform on cognitive tasks."

Main Idea: Multitasking creates an emotional reinforcement to keep doing it, although it's counterproductive.

The study was supported by a grant from the National Science Foundation.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

annotating Marking, highlighting, or taking notes on a text.

previewing Quickly reviewing the content of a text before reading it.

prior knowledge Information that a reader already knows about a subject.

recursive Referring to a process that repeats or goes back over.

summarize Restate the main ideas in one's own words.

thesis The topic of a reading plus the author's opinion about that topic, expressed in a complete sentence.

topic The subject of a reading, expressed in a word or phrase.

Chapter Summary

- Active reading is a process that involves understanding, writing, and thinking about what you read.
- Previewing and freewriting before you read can prepare you mentally to do the serious work of reading.
- Identifying the topic and then locating and marking the thesis and main ideas in a reading can help you to understand what you read.
- Annotating by marking, taking notes on, and summarizing a text can help you actively read, learn, and respond to a text.
- Consistently applying the writing strategies of freewriting and annotating while reading will aid your comprehension and help you develop a response to your reading.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each of the following exercises, using complete sentences for your responses.

1. List the writing strategies that best help you understand what you read. These could be strategies covered in this chapter or ones you have developed on your own.
2. What have you learned about multitasking from reading the articles in this chapter? How might you apply that knowledge to your own study habits or reading behavior? Give examples from the readings and/or from your own experience to explain.
3. Locate an article (not in this chapter) on multitasking. Read the article and annotate it, following the strategies in this chapter for locating main ideas and annotating a reading.

Credits

pp. 30–34: Lederman, Doug. "Online Students Multitask More (Not in a Good Way)." *Inside Higher Ed*, 20 Feb. 2019. https://www.insidehighered.com/digital-learning/article/2019/02/20/students-multitask-things-unrelated-course-work-more-online. Used with permission. **pp. 41–43:** Grabmeier, Jeff. "Multitasking May Hurt Your Performance but It Makes You Feel Better." *Research and Innovation Communications,* The Ohio State University. Used with permission.

CHAPTER 3

The Writing Process

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Recognize writing as a process.
- Define the purpose of a writing task.
- Choose a writing topic and generate ideas.
- Compose a rough draft.
- Revise, edit, and proofread drafts.

Theme: How Do Writers Write?

What do you picture in your mind's eye when you hear the word *writer*? You may—or may not—be surprised that writers are a diverse group of people. In this chapter, you will read the advice given to aspiring writers by Black authors of novels, young adult fiction, and memoirs. You will also read the recommendations to college student writers given by a college professor who has written many books and articles.

What do you think writers do to write? Do they sit and think until ideas come into their heads and flow onto the page? That is unlikely. As discussed in the chapter "Introduction to College Reading, Writing, and Thinking," writing requires considerable time and effort. Author Suze Orman sums up her approach to writing:

> *Writing is hard work, not magic. It begins with deciding why you are writing and whom you are writing for. What is your intent? What do you want the reader to get out of it? What do you want to get out of it? It's also about making a serious time commitment and getting the project done. (Ryan 165)*

Orman's comments are sound advice not only for writing books but for writing in college.

In this chapter, we will consider what it means to be a writer and why writing is important. We will also examine the process most writers engage in, from the idea stage to a finished piece of writing.

AN OVERVIEW: UNDERSTANDING WRITING AS A PROCESS

Recall the reading process described in the chapter "Active Reading." Strategic writers go through a similar process as they write a paragraph, an essay, or any other text. Figure 3.1 illustrates the writing process.

Strategic writers typically think and read before they write. They write more than one draft, often composing a first draft to get ideas onto paper and then using subsequent drafts to organize and improve those ideas. Writers apply critical reading skills to evaluate their work carefully. Like the reading process, the writing process is recursive, which means going over paragraphs or papers multiple times (and sometimes, painfully, back to the start) when writing.

FIGURE 3.1 The Writing Process

DEFINING THE PURPOSE OF A WRITING TASK

Writing can help you in college in many ways. It can help to clarify your thinking on a topic, understand what you have read, or remember what you heard in class. For instance, freewriting before reading activates prior knowledge of a topic; annotating a text while reading enables you to identify important ideas; and reflecting in writing after reading allows you to assess the author's main points.

Sometimes the writing you do in college will be for your own study purposes. For example, taking notes during class to remember important concepts or rewriting your notes to prepare for an exam might involve writing that only you will see.

Other times, instructors assign writing. Writing assignments may be designed for students' learning or to enable an instructor to see what students know or do not know. It is important to understand the purpose of assigned writing and therefore how to approach the assignment. We can place assigned writing into two broad categories:

- **Low-stakes writing**, which tends to be informal writing for your own learning.
- **High-stakes writing**, which is more formal writing that will typically be read and evaluated by an instructor.

In Figure 3.2, we review the features and purposes of these two types of writing.

Whether you engage in low-stakes or high-stakes writing, take your writing seriously and put in your best effort. Low-stakes writing assignments often lay the groundwork for high-stakes writing assignments, so playing your A game during low-stakes writing can pay off with a quality piece of high-stakes writing.

FIGURE 3.2 Low-Stakes versus High-Stakes Writing

	Low Stakes	High Stakes
Purpose	Writing to learn	Writing to demonstrate learning
Goal	Process information or discover ideas	Show mastery of material or original thinking
What It Looks Like	May be messy, disorganized, or contain errors	Is professional, polished, and proofread
Examples	• Jot down three things you learned in class. • Freewrite possible answers to a test question. • Explain the process you used to figure out a math problem. • Write a rough draft of a paper.	• Record a lab report in a biology class. • Compose a paragraph answer to a question on a midterm exam. • Put together a research paper in a history class. • Write an essay in an English class.
How It Is Assessed	• Typically not graded but may be assessed for completeness or for fulfilling requirements	• Typically graded

PREWRITING

Let's assume you have a writing assignment for a college class. Whether you are writing for yourself or for a graded assignment, getting started may feel like the hardest part. You must have a writing idea in mind; then you must think of something to say. It can be easy to get stuck trying to come up with the perfect topic or even just *any* topic for writing. Strategic college writers know that beginning to write may be hard, and they have several strategies for getting started.

Choosing a Topic

Your writing topic may depend on your assignment, your instructor, or your class goals. Some instructors will provide general suggestions for writing and allow students to narrow down the topic. For instance, your instructor might ask you to select a common problem for college students and propose a solution. In this case, you could select any important topic to write about that is relevant to college life—for example, the problem of maintaining mental and physical health as a student or the challenges of studying and working while in college. Or the instructor might encourage you to write about whatever interests you most. With this type of assignment, you can select *any* topic, usually with instructor approval. See "Strategies for Selecting a Writing Topic" for ideas on choosing a compelling topic.

Strategies for Selecting a Writing Topic

- Understand the requirements of the assignment. Can you select your own topic, or must you choose a topic the instructor has provided?
- Select a topic you are interested in and would enjoy writing about.
- Select a topic about which you have something thoughtful to write.
- Check with the instructor to confirm that your topic is appropriate for the assignment before writing.

Generating and Organizing Ideas

Once you have a topic, start thinking about that topic and begin preparing to write. Writers typically do not write straight through their assignment from beginning to end; instead, many writers start with warm-up exercises—just as you might warm up before going for a five-mile run. This stage in the writing process is called **prewriting** (the prefix *pre-* means "before") because the thinking, reading, and writing prepare you to compose a first draft. Have you ever told a funny story to a friend and realized later that you could have added more details to make the story even better? Prewriting gives you the chance to think of more good ideas to use when you write the first draft and can therefore save time later in the writing process.

Let's imagine that you are taking a psychology course in which you are studying the effect of sleep on memory and learning. The instructor assigns the class to write on this topic: *Explain the relationship between sleep and learning.* You have to apply the information from class to yourself or to college students in general. How should you proceed? Here are some strategies you might use to generate ideas.

Review. Review your assigned readings, lecture notes, or class notes. Look for ideas, details, and examples related to the topic you are exploring. Take notes on ideas related to your topic or annotate the readings. Figure 3.3 shows an example from a review of class materials.

FIGURE 3.3 Sample Annotated Text

Text	Your Notes
The National Sleep Foundation has found that 63 percent of college students, on average, do not get enough sleep. This causes 15 percent of students to fall asleep in class semi-regularly and lose 30 percent of the knowledge they have gained during the class time when paying attention.	*Good use of statistics to show lack of sleep interferes with learning*

Freewrite. Recall that *freewrite* means to write quickly and continuously. To help shape your ideas, write down everything you can think of related to the topic. Do not worry about grammar or spelling; just get as many thoughts onto the page as you can. Some writers use a timer to motivate themselves to write for a certain length of time, such as ten minutes. When you have finished freewriting, review your work to look for strong ideas you might use to develop your writing, as well as examples or details to support those ideas. Figure 3.4 shows a partial example of freewriting.

FIGURE 3.4 Sample Freewriting

College students need sleep; that's because they work hard studying, and some even work, too—they have jobs. This means they get home late and stay up late studying, then have to get up and go to class . . .

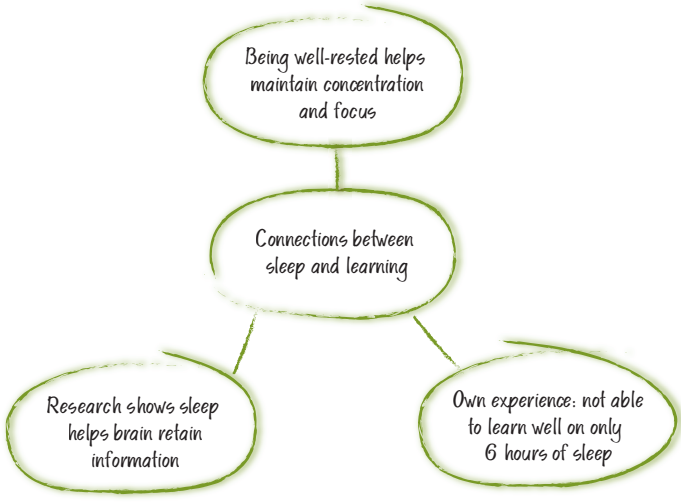
List. Listing also involves putting ideas down on the page, but in a list form, such as a bulleted list. For instance, if you have to compare two subjects, you might list characteristics or examples of each. Notice in Figure 3.5 how the writer begins to organize information by lining up contrasting details under each heading.

FIGURE 3.5 Sample Lists

Benefits of getting enough sleep	*Drawbacks of not getting enough sleep*
• *Research shows rested brains think better and retain more information* • *Can pay attention in class and learn more* • *Feel better physically and emotionally*	• *Sleep deprivation makes people forgetful* • *Increases the chances of falling asleep during class and missing information* • *Makes people feel cranky, irritable*

Create a Graphic Organizer. A **graphic organizer** is a visual representation of the relationships among ideas. An organizer might use shapes or lines to show these connections. To get started writing, you might prefer a visual approach that puts ideas in a few words, with the connections shown between or among words or ideas. You can write the main idea in the middle of a page (take your pick—use a circle or square or any shape that works for you) and then link to supporting examples, details, and information in connected bubbles. Figure 3.6 shows an example of a graphic organizer.

FIGURE 3.6 Sample Graphic Organizer



Outline. To begin organizing your ideas before writing, try outlining. An *informal outline* indicates in brief what to include in the parts of a paragraph or paper—the beginning, middle, and end—as in the following example. Outlines show the main ideas, as well as the supporting information, often by indenting or numbering the support under main ideas (see Figure 3.7).

FIGURE 3.7 Sample Informal Outline

Main Idea: Sleep is important for college students' success
- *Support: Research shows that well-rested brains function better*
- *Support: Example of working late and taking early morning class—not successful strategy*
- *Support: Example of changing work hours to get enough sleep and did better in class*

Closing: Sleep is critical to being a good student.

Discuss the Topic. To generate ideas, you could discuss the topic with classmates, family, or friends. You can suggest ideas and see what other people think

about these—if they feel your ideas make sense or are interesting. You can brainstorm for examples to support your ideas, asking others whether the examples are effective or asking for further support (see Figure 3.8).

FIGURE 3.8 Sample Discussion

Jenna: *I'm writing a paper about how college students need to get enough sleep to do well academically. So, I'm thinking of using the time I was working the late shift at a convenience store as an example in the paper. Do you think this would work?*

Jordan: *I like that idea. I remember how you fell asleep in that 8 a.m. class one time! That story will really make the paper more interesting.*

DRAFTING

Once you have chosen a topic, engaged in serious thinking, and dedicated prewriting time to that topic, you are ready to compose a draft—an attempt at creating a complete piece of writing. As in most stages of the writing process, there are various strategies—and no one "right way"—to compose a draft. Some writers like to write fluidly and discover their ideas during the process of drafting, while other writers prefer to think and plan carefully before attempting a draft. Of course, many writers fall somewhere in between. But we can call these two basic approaches to drafting either **discovery writing** or **planned writing**.

Discovery writing suggests you have a general idea of what you want to say but use a draft to figure out what you *really* want to say. For instance, the American writer Joan Didion explains her drafting process as discovery writing: "I write entirely to find out what I am thinking, what I am looking at, what I see and what it means" (Popova). In a draft, you might explore ideas, test out examples, or experiment with approaches to the writing assignment.

In contrast, a planned writing approach may start with an outline or the key points to be covered in the draft. The first writing, then, would describe, elaborate on, or give examples of those ideas. Professor Yetta Goodman, who writes academic books, explains that she uses "an outline or organizational chart" to plan her professional writing.

In both approaches, it is important to get the ideas down on paper and to explain and support those ideas, but not be overly worried about spelling or grammar errors or making the writing sound polished. Refining your writing will come later in the writing process. Remember that drafting is primarily concerned with developing your ideas. In the following reading, "Advice for Aspiring Black Writers, from Black Writers," you will learn about different writers' approaches to writing. As you read, consider the strategies that professional writers use that you might apply to your own writing process.

READING SELECTION

"ADVICE FOR ASPIRING BLACK WRITERS, FROM BLACK WRITERS"

Before Reading: Preview; Predict

Look at the reading selection title and read the information that immediately precedes the reading. Then write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

1. Based on your preview of the reading selection, what advice do you think Black writers will give to other aspiring Black writers?
2. Skim the article and note the authors' names and their works. Are you familiar with any of these writers? If so, what do you know about them or their writing? If not, what can you guess are their topics or types of writing?

During Reading: Annotate; Make Connections

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

3. Mark any words, phrases, or sentences in the selection that you find interesting or thought-provoking or that you find particularly meaningful. Then explain why you find the text interesting or stimulating.
4. Mark any words, phrases, or sentences that confused you or that you did not find meaningful. Then explain why you find the lines confusing or irrelevant.

Advice for Aspiring Black Writers, from Black Writers

By Taylor Bryant
NYLON, Feburary 2017

To celebrate Black History Month, NYLON, *a magazine with a focus on pop culture and contemporary fashion, ran a series of articles celebrating Black culture. In the following piece, various published Black authors share their advice for other Black writers, ranging from how to think about the craft and purpose of writing to how to persist when writing gets tough. Each author's advice is prefaced with their name and the title of their book.*

Natashia Deon, author of *Grace* 1

"Write magic. Write the story you'd love to read but most of all, write the story you feel you must write because no one can do it like you can. Even on days you're sure that's a lie. Write as if no one has ever written on the subject before. The same is not identical. Learn the difference by reading, living, and traveling, even if that's just to the town next door. Discover the thing that only you, because of your life and experience,

would know. Three people standing in the same room watching the same event will experience it differently. Show us why God put you in that room. Show us the piece of the puzzle that only you're holding. Help humanity to understand itself better. We need your wisdom. But if you're writing primarily to make money and not for the art, the significant responsibility, or the love, forget everything I've just said and simply do what's been done well before and build a platform that'll get you seen."

2

Gary Gershoff/WireImage/ Getty Images

Jesmyn Ward, author of *The Fire This Time*

"Persist. This is a hard business to navigate: Writers in general, and black writers in particular, will face a lot of rejection in publishing. You have two tasks as a writer: the first is to do the work. Hone your craft: read, write, revise, repeat. Enrich your voice. Become the best writer you can be. Your second task is to submit your work. Brave rejection after rejection after rejection until you find the one person in publishing who says yes, who understands and believes in your work and will open the door for you. You can weather a thousand noes; all you need is one yes."

Mychal Denzel Smith, author of *Invisible Man, Got the Whole World Watching: A Young Black Man's Education*

3

Jesse Dittmar/Redux

"I'm asked this question a lot, especially by younger black writers, and I often struggle because I still feel like I need so much advice myself. In response, I've always said 'keep writing,' which is the safest and, upon reflection, most useless answer. If you're a writer, you'll keep writing. Saying that doesn't require much thought on my part, and the person asking gets to walk away feeling like they engaged them. But [. . .] we really don't have the luxury of passing on safe and useless advice. So what I'll say now is this: Take the power of words seriously. Understand the tradition of using the written word to fight back, to speak truth to power, to communicate with the oppressed, and to reassure the marginalized they are not forgotten. This doesn't mean everything you write must be targeted at dismantling institutions of oppression—we need levity and lightheartedness to help survive these times as well—but that you understand and accept the responsibility that the written word carries, and the particular conditions that have produced the black literary condition, so that you approach everything you do with that in mind. Write, not only for the prestige, but because our very lives depend on it."

Nicole Dennis-Benn, author of *Here Comes the Sun* 4

"Be as liberal as possible in the creative process. By liberal, I mean do not edit yourself in terms of cultural references and/or over explaining. Ask yourself why you're writing and who you're writing for. Know in your heart that there is no such thing as one story, and therefore there will be room for you at the table. At the end of the day, your authentic voice and heart will speak to readers. Do not be deterred by rejection. Keep writing, keep knocking on doors, keep sending out work. Never have only one project that you're working on. The minute one story gets published or rejected, there should be another one waiting in the wings. Be serious about writing. Treat it as you would a job, not a hobby. Lastly, seek successful mentors who are invested in seeing your growth; avoid anyone who projects their journey on you and/or attempts to clip your wings once you begin to soar."

Cole Lavalais, author of *Summer of the Cicadas* 5

"God's will, karma, and fate are all different ways to describe the plot of the human condition. Moments after our first bedtime stories, we learn life has order. When unexpected events occur, we look toward our varying belief systems, or develop belief systems, to connect meaning and impose order on those events. This order, or structure, functions as a way of mollifying the chaos of human existence, helping us to comprehend what can often be incomprehensible. Understand your audience is deeply invested in this relationship between events and meaning (plot), and your audience will both consciously and unconsciously bring those expectations to the page. As writer and architect of the worlds you create, you may choose to fulfill, complicate, and challenge the connections and disconnections between structure and meaning. You may even choose to ignore those expectations completely, but you must do it knowing that your readers will not."

Terry McMillan, author of *I Almost Forgot about You* 6

"Write as if you're telling a story to a friend. Write as if no one is ever going to read it. Don't write to compete with other writers. Don't edit while writing a draft or you'll never finish."

Angie Thomas, author of *The Hate U Give* 7

Marla Aufmuth/Getty Images for Massachusetts Conference for Women 2019

"I didn't want to write *The Hate U Give.* The characters, the setting, and the plot were first born in a short story I wrote for my senior project in college back in 2010/2011. I always knew it would be about a girl, Starr, who was living in two different worlds a lot like I was at the time—a mostly white, upper class school, and a mostly black, poor neighborhood. I also knew that she would lose her best friend at the hands of a police officer. The characters and plot were so vivid to me that, at times, it was hard to keep the short story . . . well, short. One of my professors encouraged me to write it as a novel after graduation. I played around with the idea, but for years I couldn't bring myself to write it. I had several reasons, though. Whether they're good or not is up for debate, but they were reasons nonetheless.

"Reason one: I had a 'heart book.' No, I don't mean a cardiology book. I mean that one idea that so many of us writers set our hearts on being THE ONE; like a soulmate in book form. Sometimes, we've had the idea for years. Sometimes, it takes us years to write a single draft. But we just know that it will be the one that will get us in the door. Unfortunately, it doesn't always work out that way. For me, my heart book was a fantasy series for younger readers. I wrote and rewrote the first book for years. I also received rejection after rejection for years. The entire time, that short story from senior year kept coming back to me. But there was no way it would get me in the door of publishing. Why? 8

"Reason two: I was afraid it was too diverse. Unfortunately, I think a lot of marginalized writers understand this one. I am eternally grateful for We Need Diverse Books, the grassroots organization that advocates for diversity in children's literature. It is kicking down doors and walls that have limited the lenses presented in children's books. But the work of We Need Diverse Books is recent; it is also ongoing. As the idea of turning that short story into a novel bounced around in my head, diversity in Young Adult novels was rare. Books where black girls were more than sassy sidekicks were rare. And books about black girls dealing with police brutality? Even rarer. 9

"That leads to reason three: I was afraid of it. Period. When I first wrote that short story in college, I was pissed. I was also in pain. Oscar Grant had recently lost his life in Oakland, California, and his death was a headline. It led to me hearing conversations on my college campus that made me want to scream as Oscar was blamed for his death more than the officer who pulled the trigger. Instead of screaming, I wrote. It was cathartic—I allowed all of my anger and sadness to fall into my words. I knew I'd have to do the same thing if I wrote it as a novel, and that it may make some readers uncomfortable; especially the mostly-white gatekeepers of publishing. 10

"I could probably list a million more reasons why I didn't want to write *The Hate U Give,* but one thing outweighs them all: I had to write it for myself. I couldn't focus on whether it would be the idea that would get me in the door. I couldn't worry that it was too diverse. I couldn't be concerned that it would make someone uncomfortable. I had to see it come to life on the page. It was one of the best decisions I've made. 11

"So writers, learn from my mistakes: Let your heart explore other stories, let your characters be their unapologetic selves, and write the book that you're afraid to write. Above all, write it for yourself. You won't regret it." 12

Kaitlyn Greenidge, author of *We Love You, Charlie Freeman* 13

"Keep going. Honor your own sadness and frustration, but keep going. Even when your work is met with blank stares, or misunderstanding. Write about what you wish to write about, not what people tell you you ought to write about. And most importantly: Don't assume you are the first or the one and only. It's very seductive to believe you're the only black person who has ever noticed 'X.' If you dig deep enough, though, you know that there have always been those of us who were off-kilter, who loved Dvorak or understood the relationship between String Theory and Russian architecture or whatever thing that gets you going. Don't give into the seductive myth of being the one and only. Once you let that go, the work gets less lonely and the company you keep can expand, and when another black writer comes who wants to geek out over what you want to geek out about, you know you've found a friend and an ally. Not a rival, as the wider world would want you to believe."

After Reading: Identify Audience; Identify Purpose

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

5. Consider the audience: Who are the intended readers of this text? Do you think readers other than the intended audience can also benefit from the ideas in this selection?
6. Think about the purpose: Do the authors want the audience to be informed, instructed, or persuaded? Could there be more than one purpose? Explain.

Engage with the Reading

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Review your annotations from exercise 3 under "During Reading," and select the writing advice given by professional authors that you can identify with. In your own words, explain that advice and how or why you feel it applies to you.
2. Review your annotations from exercise 4 under "During Reading," and select the writing advice given by professional authors that you do not find useful or relevant to you. In your own words, explain that writing advice and why you do not find it useful or relevant.
3. Look back over your annotations and your answers to exercises 1 and 2 above. Then describe your own writing process and purposes, how they are similar to or different from those of professional writers, and how you might change your writing routine to improve them.

Academic Style: Attribution

When you summarize or quote, you should identify the source of that information and convey why that source is reputable. In such cases, you can reference the person or organization by providing *attribution*. That is, along with the quote or summary, you identify the source of the information. You may also want to state the *credentials* of the source—that is, what makes the source qualified to address the topic.

Examples of Sentences Using Attribution

- The author of ten best-selling books on personal finance, (attribution) Suze Orman explains that "writing is hard work, not magic."
- Research published in a peer-reviewed academic journal, (attribution) the *Journal of Adolescent Adult Literacy,* shows that most professional writers create multiple drafts.

REVISING, EDITING, AND PROOFREADING

Writers go through multiple drafts before completing a finished work. For instance, in her book *Bird by Bird: Some Instructions on Writing and Life*, author Anne Lamott describes the process of writing a terrible first draft to get her ideas down on paper. She then improves her first draft to create a better second draft and finally a third draft that is publishable. When Lamott writes her first draft, she hopes no one will read it. When she develops her subsequent drafts, she reads her writing carefully. She thinks about how someone else might read her writing. In other words, she starts shaping her writing for a reader. We call this "writing with a reader in mind." In this way, Lamott is continuing the writing process by revising, then editing and proofreading her writing.

Revising for Content and Organization

Revising involves focusing on the content of the writing—the ideas, examples, or details; the organization; and the logical flow. When revising, writers think about the "big picture" of their writing, such as whether their writing has a clear focus, their ideas are supported by evidence or examples, and their organization makes sense. Revising often means making big changes in the first draft. For instance, a writer might take out a paragraph or move it to another part of the writing. The writer might add—or remove—details or examples or even completely rewrite the introduction or conclusion. As you reread and revise your paper, ask yourself questions like those shown in "Strategies for Revising."

Strategies for Revising

1. Does the writing respond to the assignment? If not, can you change it to respond to the topic, or do you need to start all over again?
2. Does the writing have a clear focus or point to make? Can you underline a sentence or two in the paper that sums up your main idea?
3. Can you develop the ideas with more examples, details, or information from the readings? If so, add more support to the writing.
4. Do ideas progress logically from one section to the next and from one sentence to the next? If not, can sections or sentences be logically connected with transitions?
5. Are there any parts of the paper that seem out of place or not relevant? Can you move these to other places in the paper, or should you take them out?
6. Is there more you can say on the topic? If so, add more sentences or paragraphs.

The following reading selection, an interview with writer Mike Rose, explores ideas about the writing process and, in particular, how he feels about writing and strategies for drafting. Pay close attention to Rose's suggestions for revising his writing and how reading plays a key role in his writing process.

READING SELECTION

"WRITING AS A PROCESS: AN INTERVIEW WITH MIKE ROSE"

Newspaper and magazine articles such as the following reading selection sometimes include interviews with experts, authors, or other knowledgeable people. If an interview is recorded verbatim—that is, word for word—the reporter will indicate who is speaking before the words. Often quotation marks are not used; instead, the speaker's name or initials are included before their words.

Before Reading: Recognize Prior Knowledge

Look at the reading selection title and read the information that immediately precedes the reading. Then write responses to the following using complete sentences.

1. Do you think that writing is hard work? That it is fun? Or is it sometimes both or neither? Explain your answer.
2. What role do you think reading plays in the writing process? For instance, do writers have others read their writing? Do writers read to improve their own writing? Explain.

During Reading: Annotate; Make Connections

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

3. Mark any text you find interesting or thought-provoking or that you find particularly agreeable. Then explain why you agree with the text or find it interesting or stimulating.
4. Mark any text that confuses you or you find disagreeable. Then explain why you find the text confusing or disagree with it.

Writing as a Process: An Interview with Mike Rose

By Tina Arora

InterActions: UCLA Journal of Education and Information Studies, 2010

Mike Rose began his academic career as a working-class student, the son of Italian immigrants, but eventually became a professor at the University of California at Los Angeles. He has written many articles and books about college students, especially about the challenges new college students face and their potential to be successful.

TA: You enjoy writing and publishing and you did say that you ask your students to look at the jewels that are present at their feet and write about what they're involved in. Where does this enthusiasm come from or what motivates you? 1

MR: That's a really good question. You know, there's times when the writing is a joy, but, more often, it's not. It's, it's difficult, taxing, work that seems to slam me constantly up against my limitations. My limitations as a thinker, the limitations of my knowledge, the limitations of what I can do with language, all of my own insecurities. But writing for me is driven, in a way, because it's a means that I have to try to explore and express, a means to explore something that bothers me, or something that I think is not right or wrong-headed. Writing is my toolkit to pursue those issues. If I were a lawyer, I would have the law and the courts. If I were a physician, I would probably be doing certain kinds of medicine in certain kinds of communities. But the toolkit that I have at my disposal is this ability to write, something I have developed over many, many, many years of practice. 2

When I was a young man, I wrote poetry, I had these fantasies of becoming a poet. Now, I was never a very good poet, but I think I learned a lot about the craft of writing by doing it, and then I carried that skill into my professional and academic writing. Caring about style, worrying about the sound of the language as well as what ideas the language is trying to convey. In fact, there's not a separation between the sound of the language and the ideas it conveys. If I can hit the right pitch with the language, then that advances the idea all the more. And conversely, if the ideas are shoddy, the idea isn't carefully wrought, then the language is going to fall apart, for me, anyway. 3

I wish I could tell you that writing is pure pleasure, that I sit down at the desk at 8 in the morning, and the next thing I know it's 5 in the evening, and I've had this blissful day lost in thought. But, no, it's not at all like that. If somebody had a little camera on me, and they traced out the patterns of my writing day, there would be dozens upon dozens of times when I'm getting up from the chair and going to the refrigerator, and getting up from the chair and going for a walk, and getting up from the chair and trying desperately to think of anybody I can call. 4

TA: So, it is similar to what other people go through . . . 5

MR: It is . . . it is what many students who I've worked with go through. There's no difference. I guess I'm just committed to it. I know that if I stick at it long enough, something will come out of it. Plus, I have to say, over the years, I've been blessed enough to cultivate a large number of people who I can trust to give me honest feedback. I purposefully make sure I have a diversity of readers, people who come at the world in a different way from the way I do so that I can get all the feedback I can. If I'm writing about particular people like in the book *Possible Lives: The Promise of Public Education in America*, then, of course, they became part of the critical loop as well. I would send them the stuff I wrote and we would begin this exchange about the material, which then would lead to further discussion. 6

So that's my writing process. It's probably similar to a whole lot who are gonna be reading this interview. It has its moments of pleasure and moments where the words do seem to come, but it has many more moments of just being stymied and going back to your books and trying to find the right train of thought, and getting up to get a snack, 7

and waking up in the middle of the night with an idea and scribbling on a notepad only to look at it in the morning and realize it's not such a great idea after all. That's just the way it is.

TA: What do you believe is the efficient way to train research apprentices/student researchers in understanding writing and becoming effective and prolific writers? 8

MR: We've created here in the department of Social Research Methodology these two writing classes, one for professional writing and one for people who want to write for broader audiences. So, I'm a firm believer that you really can learn a lot about how to do this work, do it better and do it with more grace. But, as I was just saying a moment ago, that doesn't guarantee that it's going to be easy or effortless, I mean I don't think any good performance is. There's no good performance in any domain that doesn't come without its cost, its pain and difficulty. 9

I think that young researchers, first of all, can put themselves in situations where they can learn more about the craft involved both in framing their research projects and writing about them. They can do that through courses. And they can do that through aligning themselves with a very good editor who's not just going to edit for them but teach them as well. They also can go out of their way to find those other people, their peers or mentors, who respond well to their writing and form relationships with them where they read each other's writing. 10

I'm also a firm believer in reading good stuff. When you find authors who write well in your discipline or people who just write well, a favorite novelist, read them and read them like a writer, rather than reading them like a reader. In other words, read them with an eye to figuring out what it is they do that makes their writing work so well. You read them analytically, you read them with an eye to stealing a trick or two. So I think there are a lot of things that students can do to help themselves become better writers. 11

And also, as I was talking about earlier, remember that writing is hard for everybody, I do think sometimes that students carry in their minds the assumption that for other people composing is an effortless enterprise, this effortless activity, when, in fact, it is difficult for everybody. I think just even understanding that up front keeps you at the keyboard rather than allowing yourself to give into the feeling of inadequacy, thinking that it's only you who are going through this awful stuff. It's more the norm than you think. 12

After Reading: Find Supporting Details

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

5. Rose says that although sometimes "writing is a joy . . . more often . . . it's difficult, taxing, work." What details in the text show that writing is a joy? What details in the text show that writing is hard work?
6. Rose states that students can "learn a lot" about how to write well. What details in the reading describe what students should learn about writing?

Engage with the Reading

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Rose mentions that he appreciates having a "diversity of readers" who can give him "honest feedback" on his writing. Why do you think having different kinds of people read and respond to a writer's work is helpful?
2. Review your annotations and select a sentence or two that you find thought-provoking—either because you agree with Rose or because you disagree. Explain why you agree or disagree.
3. Compare your process for writing to Rose's. For instance, do you feel writing is hard work or that it is a joy, or both? Do you like to get feedback from lots of different people? Do you read to get ideas? Explain.

Editing Sentences and Proofreading for Errors

Editing writing involves focusing on the "little details," such as sentences and words, checking that these are clear and that they make sense. **Proofreading** means reading writing carefully, looking for errors, such as grammar or punctuation mistakes, and correcting these. Examples of what you might do to edit your writing include the following:

- Rewriting sentences to be clear or correct.
- Combining sentences to make the writing more concise.
- Selecting new words to make ideas more clear or vivid.

In *Bird by Bird: Some Instructions on Writing and Life*, the writer Anne Lamott explains this stage as "the dental draft, where you check every tooth" (25–26), or rather, when you check every word and sentence to be sure it is clear and correct and effectively expresses your ideas.

Editing and proofreading come in the final stages of the writing process. Review "Strategies for Editing and Proofreading" for suggestions about how to edit and proofread your paper.

Strategies for Editing and Proofreading

- **Read your paper slowly and aloud.** Be sure you are reading what is on the page and not what is in your head. Put your finger under each word as you read. You might notice that you accidentally left out a word or maybe typed the same word twice.
- **Read your paper several times.** It is not possible to catch everything with one reading. Read through your paper first for clarity of sentences, then again for word choice, and a third time to check grammar, spelling, and punctuation.

  First reading: Read each sentence carefully and think about whether it is clearly and correctly written. Will a reader understand what you mean in that sentence? Are there vague words that can be replaced? Know that readers will encounter your writing one sentence at a time, so each

continued

sentence must make sense and advance your ideas. If a sentence does not "sound right," then stop, mark it, and try to fix it. Try rewriting the sentence several different ways. Also consider whether the sentence needs to be moved to another part of the essay or maybe taken out.

Second reading: Read your writing thinking about the words. Ask yourself whether words are well chosen to say exactly what you mean. Avoid vague words (*really, sort of, very, many*); use specific, precise, and vivid words or details. Look particularly at the nouns and verbs in the sentences. Most often, strong writing uses specific nouns and active verbs. For instance, rather than write that Naomi's childhood was traumatic (*traumatic* is a vague word), you could be more specific about why her childhood was traumatic: *Naomi was eleven years old when she dived into a lake and hit her head on a rock.* (*Traumatic* was replaced with more specific nouns and description.)

Third reading: Check the grammar, punctuation, and formatting. For instance, you might circle each piece of punctuation to check that it is appropriate. Be sure you have followed your instructor's guidelines for setting up the writing, including heading or formatting.

Finally, after correcting sentences, words, or other errors, give your essay one last read through to be sure the writing makes sense and is correct.

Activity 3.1 Evaluate Topics

To plan a piece of writing, review and evaluate the writing topics that follow by marking how interesting you find each one. Check "Interesting topic," "Maybe I could write on this topic," or "Can't relate to this topic" for each topic.

1. Some people love to write; others hate it. Some people enjoy creative writing, such as poems, songs, and blogs; others prefer informational writing, such as reports and research. Describe your feelings about writing. In your response, consider the following:
   - When do you like to write? Describe a situation when writing was enjoyable for you.
   - When is writing challenging for you? Are there times when you hate to write? Describe a situation when writing was difficult for you.

   ☐ Interesting topic
   ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
   ☐ Can't relate to this topic

2. Describe your past experiences with writing in school. In your response, consider the following:
   - Describe one particularly good experience you had with writing in your past education (this could be in an English class or in another subject). Explain why it was positive.

- Describe one particularly bad experience you had with writing in your past education and explain why it was unpleasant.

☐ Interesting topic
☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
☐ Can't relate to this topic

3. Describe your experiences with low-stakes and high-stakes writing assignments in school and what you learned from these assignments. In your response, consider the following:
   - Give an example of a low-stakes writing assignment you engaged in. Describe the assignment and to what degree it helped you to learn.
   - Give an example of a high-stakes writing assignment in school. Describe the assignment and to what degree it helped you to learn.

☐ Interesting topic
☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
☐ Can't relate to this topic

4. Describe your earliest memories with reading and writing, or your experiences with reading and writing growing up as a child. In your response, consider the following:
   - How did you learn to read or write? Describe what you remember about learning to read or write at home or at school and the feelings you associate with these processes.
   - What were reading and writing like in your family? Did family members read to you as a child or encourage you to write?

☐ Interesting topic
☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
☐ Can't relate to this topic

Activity 3.2 Choose a Topic and Generate Ideas

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Review your responses to Activity 3.1. Choose a topic to write about. What topic did you select, and why?
2. Based on what you have read in this chapter, select one strategy for generating and organizing ideas. Use that method to generate ideas for the topic you chose.

Pair and Share

- With a classmate, discuss the topics you each selected in Activity 3.2. Explain why you each chose the topic you did.
- With a classmate, compare the strategies you used to generate ideas for the topics in Activity 3.2. Explain which methods you found most helpful for producing good ideas.

Activity 3.3 Write a First Draft

Follow the directions for both of the following exercises.

1. When you are writing a first draft, do you generally feel more comfortable engaging in discovery writing or planning before writing? Explain.
2. Review your writing topic and prewriting (from Activity 3.2). Build on your prewriting by writing a first draft. Give yourself permission to write without worrying about grammar or spelling or correctness; know that you can revise and improve your writing later.

Activity 3.4 Revise a First Draft

Follow the directions for each exercise below.

1. Study the sample first and second drafts in the chapter "Spotlight on Student Writing Process: Literacy Narrative," and notice the changes between the drafts. Writing that was removed is crossed out, while writing that was added is in purple. Why do you think the writer made the changes? How do the changes improve the draft? Do you agree with the changes that the writer made? Are there parts of the writing you would have kept in or taken out that the writer did not? Explain your answer.
2. Review your first draft from Activity 3.3. Revise your first draft, paying close attention to content and organization.

Pair and Share

- With a classmate, compare your answers to exercise 1 in Activity 3.4. Discuss what changes—changes that were made or should have been made—would most improve the first draft.
- Exchange your second draft with a classmate. Make suggestions to each other about which parts of the writing to keep and which parts to take out, as well as where to add information or where it is not needed. Also, make suggestions about the organization: how to reorganize or make the organization clearer.

Activity 3.5 Edit and Proofread a Second Draft

Follow the directions for each assignment.

1. Turn again to the sample third draft. The additions in the second draft are in purple, and the additions in the edited and proofread third draft are in blue. Writing that was removed is crossed out. What changes were made in the third draft (blue)? Why do you think the writer made the changes? How do the changes improve the draft? Do you agree with the revisions the writer made? Explain your answer.
2. Review your second draft. Revise your second draft, paying close attention to the sentences and words.

Pair and Share

- With a classmate, compare your answers to exercise 1 in Activity 3.4. Discuss which changes—changes that were made or should have been made—most improve the second draft.
- Exchange your third draft with a classmate. Make suggestions to each other about which parts of the writing to edit or revise or correct. Also make suggestions about the sentences and the words.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

discovery writing Drafting by starting with a general idea and then writing to figure out what to say.

editing A final stage in the writing process in which writers focus on improving the clarity and logic of sentences and words.

graphic organizer A visual representation of the relationships among ideas.

high-stakes writing Formal writing that will typically be read and evaluated by others.

low-stakes writing Informal writing for study or learning purposes.

planned writing Drafting by starting with an outline or key points and then writing to describe, elaborate on, or give examples of those ideas.

prewriting Thinking, reading, and writing as preparation to compose a first draft.

proofreading Reading writing carefully to correct errors in grammar, spelling, or punctuation.

revising A stage in the writing process in which writers focus on improving the ideas and organization of the writing.

Chapter Summary

- Strategic college writers use a recursive writing process—circling back through writing process steps as necessary.
- Assigned writing in college falls into two broad categories: (a) low-stakes writing, which tends to be informal writing for your own learning, and (b) high-stakes writing, which means more formal writing that will typically be read and evaluated by an instructor.

- After evaluating and choosing a topic that is appropriate to the assignment, the writer can employ various prewriting strategies—reviewing class materials, freewriting, listing, creating a graphic organizer, outlining, and discussing—to generate ideas and launch the writing process.
- A draft is an attempt to create a complete piece of writing, when the writer is most concerned about getting ideas down onto paper, whether by discovering ideas while writing or planning and then writing.
- Revising a draft involves focusing on the content, such as the ideas, examples, or details, and the organization, including the logical flow of the writing.
- Editing a draft requires focusing on sentences and words, checking that these are clear and that they make sense.
- Proofreading means reading the writing carefully, looking for errors such as grammar or punctuation mistakes, and correcting these.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each of the following exercises, using complete sentences for your responses.

1. Create an illustration that shows Mike Rose's writing process or that shows your writing process.
2. What have you learned about the writing process from reading the articles in this chapter or from reading the chapter itself? How might you apply that knowledge to your own writing? Give examples from the readings, from your own experience, or from both to explain.
3. How does reading help someone become a better writer? For instance, when should writers read, or how should they read, during the writing process? Give examples from this chapter or from your own experience, or from both.

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Credits

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SPOTLIGHT ON STUDENT WRITING PROCESS

Literacy Narrative

As you have learned, reading and writing require time, effort, and practice. Successful writers, including student writers, engage in a process as they develop and shape their ideas, draft, revise, edit, and polish their writing. While writing may seem to progress in a linear fashion, that is not always the case, as writers often need to rethink, reread, and rewrite to create a strong piece of prose.

In this Spotlight chapter, you will follow one student's writing process, Jane Nguyen, as she selects a topic, prewrites, drafts, edits, and revises her writing before completing a finished piece. Although this writing was a low-stakes assignment, the student took this writing project seriously: as an opportunity to write as well and as clearly as she could about herself as a writer.

DEFINING THE PURPOSE OF THE WRITING TASK AND PICKING A TOPIC

English and composition instructors sometimes ask students to reflect on themselves as writers. An assignment such as this may be a low-stakes, first-day, in-class writing or a high-stakes, take-home, graded paper.

In this case, students were asked to select from one of four topics for their writing. The instructor assigned and explained the writing task on the first day of class, then allowed students to work on their responses at home and turn them in the following class session. The purpose of the assignment was to help them reflect on themselves as writers and to provide the instructor with information about how students feel about writing. The response would be awarded points for completion, but it would not be graded and was therefore a low-stakes writing assignment.

First-Day Writing Assignment

> ***Prompt:*** *This first writing assignment is designed to help me learn a little about who you are, as a reader or as a writer. Write a short essay (about 250 words) in response to one of the following prompts. Please write honestly and provide specific details and examples. You will earn 20 points for completing this assignment. Write your essay at home and bring it our next class meeting.*

1. Some people love to write; others hate it. Some people enjoy creative writing, such as poems, songs, and blogs; others prefer

informational writing, such as reports and research. Describe your feelings about writing. In your response, consider the following:

When do you like to write? Describe a situation when writing was enjoyable for you.

When is writing challenging for you? Are there times when you hate to write? Describe a situation when writing was difficult for you.

2. Describe your past experiences with writing in school. In your response, consider the following:

   Describe one particularly good experience you had with writing in your past education (this could be in an English class or in another subject). Explain why it was positive.

   Describe one particularly bad experience you had with writing in your past education and explain why it was unpleasant.

3. Describe your experiences with low-stakes and high-stakes writing assignments in school and what you learned from these assignments. In your response, consider the following:

   Give an example of a low-stakes writing assignment of yours. Describe the assignment and to what degree it helped you to learn.

   Give an example of a high-stakes writing assignment in school. Describe the assignment and to what degree it helped you to learn.

4. Describe your earliest memories with reading and writing, or your experiences with reading and writing growing up as a child. In your response, consider the following:

   How did you learn to read or write? Describe what you remember about learning to read or write at home or at school and the feelings you associate with these processes.

   What were reading and writing like in your family? Did family members read to you as a child or encourage you to write?

The student's process for picking a topic:

- The student read and thought about each topic, not only how interesting it would be to write about the topic but also how much she would have to say on the topic.
- The student thought it would be interesting to write about past experiences writing in school. Since she attended high school in Vietnam and college in America, the student worried that the paper may not be coherent or focused so rejected topic 2.
- The student was not sure if she understood the terms *low-stakes* and *high-stakes* writing so decided to avoid topic 3.
- The student was not sure she could recall early memories of reading and writing so did not select prompt 4.
- The student determined that she had the most to say about prompt 1, since she sometimes enjoyed writing and sometimes felt writing was a struggle. The student knew she could use examples of current experiences with writing in the paper.

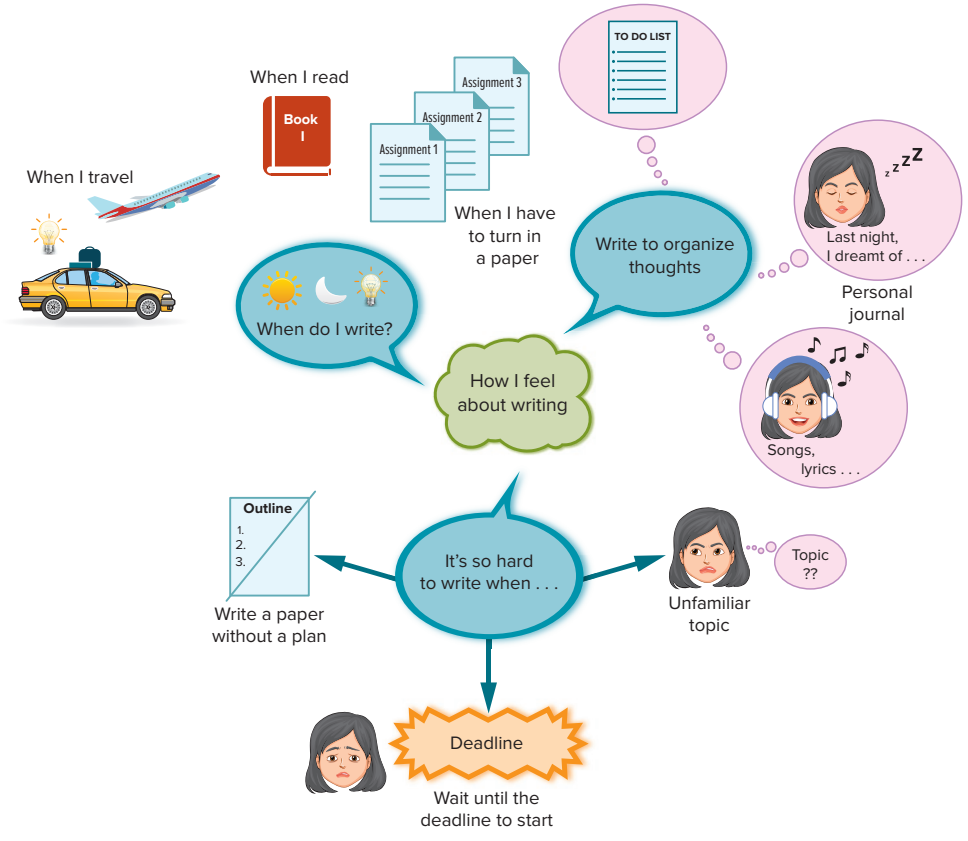
PREWRITING

When the student had time to review the topic and begin writing, she thought about how best to get started. Since the prompt did not require any reading, just a reflection on one's own life, the student decided to sketch out ideas. This student enjoyed seeing ideas visually so developed a graphic organizer that used not only words to answer the prompt but also images.

The student started by focusing on key words in the prompt: *"Describe your feelings about writing."* These feelings became the starting point, or center, for the graphic. She then thought about other parts of the prompt, such as *"When do you like to write?"* and *"When is writing challenging for you?"* The student tried to answer these questions in the graphic organizer. Since the writing assignment asked for specific details and examples, and since the prompt suggested thinking of "specific situations," she added details to the graphic to show the particular incidents when she enjoyed or did not enjoy writing. The student's graphic organizer appears in Figure 1.

FIGURE 1 One Student's Graphic Organizer

Jane Nguyen. Used with permission.



DRAFTING

With ideas on paper in the form of a graphic organizer, the student felt confident she could begin drafting a response to the assignment. The student wrote a first draft quickly, trying to get down as many ideas as possible related to the topic. When she got stuck in the writing and could not think of what to say, the student looked at her organizer to find new ideas or examples to include. She did not worry about organization or correctness in the writing; instead, the student wanted to be sure to develop the ideas and write at least 250 words. She knew she could reread and revise the writing later. The student's first draft appears in Figure 2.

FIGURE 2 One Student's First Draft

Writing is a Tool (Drafting version), by Jane Nguyen. Used with permission.

To be honest, writing has never been interesting to me. I always catch myself talking more than putting things down on the paper. However, after my last year in middle school, I realized I should find a better way to keep my thinking together. Since then, I started to write a lot. Of course, at first, it was just for fun purposes. I wrote songs when I feel like my crush turned his head and looked at my direction. I wrote down some crazy dreams in the morning after I woke up, because I thought that one day I can publish them; but turned out, those dreams were from a movie I saw before bed last night. I wrote down my mom's grocery list and put it in her purse before she went out to the store; and of course, those things on the list are my favorite treats. When I made my way to high school, I realized I could write to improve my grades at school. I began to put more efforts into turning my dreams journal into a personal journal. I began to create to-do list for myself, so I will not forget any important things I have to get done. I began to write longer songs with more meaningful lyrics, mostly about positivities because we can never get enough of those. After maintaining my writing habit throughout high school, I moved to college and started to be familiar with "assignments". That is when I realized I have to write in some cases, no matter if I want to or not. I wrote more and more after I purchased a smartphone. I wrote on the bus, in the car, on an airplane; whenever something comes up to my mind, I wrote it down on my phone. In addition, I like to highlight and mark my books with a lot of colors and margins notes. A colorful book will help me more when I need to find a piece of evidence I will need in my paper. However, writing has its own challenges when it comes to college writing. It is hard to look at a blank page on a computer knowing that the words count for this paper is two thousand

continued

FIGURE 2 **One Student's First Draft** (*continued*)

words. Writing is impossible without a plan. To me, the word "deadline" always has one meaning: I'm dead if I waited till the due day to start writing my paper. Last but not least, being unfamiliar with the topic that I was assigned for is also a difficulty for me. In order to write about something I have never heard before, I should do some researches before thinking about the topic. The thinking process is only fun, when I make up questions and ask myself to answer them.

REVISING

Since the student created a graphic organizer and immediately after composed a first draft, she decided to put this writing away for some time. She felt by taking a break, she could return to the first draft, then to read it with fresh eyes and renewed energy.

When the student returned to working on the first draft, she read it focusing on making the ideas clearer and better organized. She crossed out unnecessary information and added specific examples and details (marked in red ink). She also clarified the organization by changing the order of information and by adding transitions (also in red). The student's second draft appears in Figure 3.

FIGURE 3 **One Student's Second Draft**

Writing is a Tool (Revising version), by Jane Nguyen. Used with permission.

To be honest, writing has never been interesting to me; when I was young, 1
I always ~~catch~~ *caught* myself talking more than putting ~~things~~ *words* down on the paper. I had energy to ran around, but had none to sit down and write. Later on in life, I figured that writing had a lot of benefits. I was able to organize my thoughts, think more careful before making something happen, and most importantly, I was able to express myself.

After my last year in middle school, I realized I should find a better 2
way to keep my ~~thinking~~ *ideas* together. ~~Since then,~~ I started to write, a lot. ~~Of course,~~ At first, it was just for fun purposes. I wrote songs when I feel like my crush turned his head and looked at my direction. I wrote down ~~some~~ *my* crazy dreams ~~in the morning~~ after I woke up, because I thought that one day I ~~can~~ *could* publish them; ~~but~~ turned out, those dreams were from a movie I saw before bed last night. I wrote down my mom's grocery list and put it in her purse

continued

FIGURE 3 **One Student's Second Draft** (*continued*)

before she went out to the store; and of course, those things on the list are my favorite treats. When I made my way to high school, I realized I could write to improve my grades at school. I began to put more efforts into turning my dreams journal into a personal journal. I began to create to-do lists for myself, so I ~~will~~ would not forget any important things I have to get done. I began to write longer songs with more meaningful lyrics, mostly about ~~positivities~~ positivity because we can never get enough of ~~those~~ it. After maintaining my writing habit throughout high school, I moved to college and started to be familiar with "assignments". That ~~is~~ was when I realized I ~~have~~ had to write ~~in some cases~~, no matter if I wanted to or not. I wrote more and more after I purchased a smartphone. I wrote on the bus, in the car, even on an airplane; whenever something comes up to my mind, I wrote it down on my phone. In addition, I liked to highlight and mark my books with a lot of colors and margins notes. A colorful book will be more helpful to me ~~more~~ when I need to find a piece of evidence ~~I will~~ needed ~~in~~ for my paper. However, writing has its own challenges when it comes to college writing. Being unfamiliar with the topic that I was assigned for ~~is~~ was also a difficulty for me. In order to write about something that I have never heard before, I should do some researches before thinking about the topic. It is hard to write when you look at a blank page on a computer knowing that the words count for this paper is two thousand words and you have nothing in mind. Writing is impossible without a plan or an outline. It is just like the 80/20 rule. If you put 80% of your effort to do the thinking process, then you would only need 20% of your effort to start writing. On the other hand, ~~To me,~~ the word "deadline" always has one meaning to me: I'm dead if I waited untill the due day to start writing my paper. We cannot wait till time runs out, and hope for some miracle. As writing requires some thoughtful thinking, it also requires some time, too. ~~The thinking process is only fun, when I make up questions and ask myself to answer them.~~

Writing is not as hard as some people think it is. Only when you have no ideas of what you are writing about, or you do not give yourself enough time to write, that's when everything gets harder. At the end of the day, writing is not only about getting that good grade at school, but it is also a tool to sharpen our thoughts. 3

EDITING AND PROOFREADING

The student felt confident that the second draft was an improvement over the first draft. She also felt confident that the writing was on topic and an appropriate length for the assignment. However, since this was the first writing in a college English class, the student wanted to make her best effort. She decided to put the second draft away for a while, then reread it to ensure it was as effective as possible and expressed the ideas well.

The student read the second draft thinking carefully about language. She read the draft slowly, sentence by sentence, looking for ways to improve the words and sentences. Then she read it yet again to check for errors and correct these. The student's third draft, with changes highlighted in blue, appears in Figure 4.

FIGURE 4 One Student's Third Draft

Writing is a Tool (Editing and Proofreading version), by Jane Nguyen. Used with permission.

When I was young, writing was never interesting to me. ~~To be honest, writing has never been interesting to me; when I was young,~~ I always ~~catch~~ caught myself talking more than putting ~~things~~ words down on the paper. I had energy to ~~ran~~ run around, but had none to sit down and write. Later on ~~in life,~~ I figured that writing had a lot of benefits. I was able to organize my thoughts, think more carefully before making a decision ~~something happen~~, and most importantly, I was able to express myself. 1

After my last year in middle school, I realized that I should find a better way to keep my ~~thinking~~ ideas together. ~~Since then~~, I have started to write a lot since then. ~~Of course~~, At first, it was ~~just~~ only for fun purposes. I wrote songs about what I felt like when my crush turned his head around and looked ~~at~~ in my direction. I wrote down ~~some~~ my crazy dreams ~~in the morning~~ after I woke up, because I thought that one day I ~~can~~ could publish them; ~~but turned out,~~ Ironically, those dreams were from a movie I saw the night before ~~before bed last night~~. I wrote down my mom's grocery list, and put it in her purse before she went ~~out~~ to the store; of course, those things on the list ~~are~~ were my favorite treats. When I made my way to high school, I realized I ~~could~~ should write to improve my grades at school. I began to put more effort into turning my dreams journal into a personal journal. I began to create to-do lists for myself, so I ~~will~~ would not forget any important things I ~~have~~ had to get done. I began to write longer songs with more meaningful lyrics, mostly about ~~positivities~~ positivity because we ~~can~~ could never get enough of ~~those~~ it. After maintaining my writing habit throughout high school, I moved 2

continued

FIGURE 4 **One Student's Third Draft** (*continued*)

to college and started to be familiar with "assignments". That ~~is~~ was when I realized I ~~have~~ had to write ~~in some cases,~~ no matter if I wanted to or not. I wrote more and more after ~~I purchased~~ purchasing a smartphone. I wrote on the bus, in the car, and even on ~~an~~ the airplane; whenever something ~~comes~~ came to m ind, I wrote it down on my phone. In addition, I liked to highlight and mark my books with a lot of colors and margin notes. A colorful book will be more helpful to me ~~more~~ when I need to find a piece of evidence ~~I will needed in~~ for my paper. However, writing has its own challenges when it comes to college writing. Being unfamiliar with the topic that I was assigned ~~for is~~ was also a difficulty for me. ~~In order to~~ To write about something that I have never heard of before, I should do some research~~es~~ before ~~thinking about~~ analyzing the topic. It is hard to write when you look at a blank page on a computer knowing that the word~~s~~ count for this paper is two thousand words and you have nothing in mind. Writing is impossible without a plan or an outline. It is ~~just like~~ similar to the 80/20 rule. If you put 80% of your effort into doing the thinking process, then you would only need 20% of your effort to start writing. On the other hand, ~~To me,~~ the word "deadline" always has one meaning to me: I'm ruining the paper if I wait until the due day to start writing ~~my paper~~ it. We cannot wait till time runs out, and hope for some last-minute miracle. As writing requires some thoughtful thinking, it also requires some time, too. ~~The thinking process is only fun, when I make up questions and ask myself to answer them.~~

Writing is not as hard as some people think it is. Only when you have no 3
ideas of what you are writing about, or you ~~do~~ are not ~~give~~ giving yourself enough time to write, that's when everything gets harder. At the end of the day, writing is not only about getting that good grade at school, but it is also a tool to sharpen our thoughts.

FORMATTING THE PAPER

Even though this writing was a low-stakes assignment, the instructor wanted students to format their papers a certain way: in MLA (Modern Language Association) style. The student reviewed the guidelines for MLA style, including how to set up a heading, how to title a paper, how to

format the body paragraphs, and how to number the pages. She added these elements to the third draft, shown in Figure 5.

The student felt she had worked hard, put in her best effort, and prepared a polished, professional-looking paper. The final copy was ready for submission.

FIGURE 5 Final Copy

Jane Nguyen, Writing is a Tool, 2018. Used with permission.

Jane Nguyen
Professor Kuehner
English 151RW
1 September 2018

Writing Is a Tool

When I was young, writing was never interesting to me. I always caught myself talking more than putting words down on the paper. I had energy to run around, but had none to sit down and write. Later on, I figured that writing had a lot of benefits. I was able to organize my thoughts, think more carefully before making a decision, and most importantly, express myself.

After my last year in middle school, I realized that I should find a better way to keep my ideas together. I have started to write a lot since then. At first, it was only for fun purposes. I wrote songs about what I felt like when my crush turned his head around and looked in my direction. I wrote down my crazy dreams after I woke up, because I thought that one day I could publish them. Ironically, those dreams were from a movie I saw the night before. I wrote down my mom's grocery list and put it in her purse before she went to the store; of course, those things on the list were my favorite treats. When I made my way to high school, I realized I should write to improve my grades at school. I began to put more effort into turning my dreams journal into a personal journal. I began to create to-do lists for myself, so I would not forget any important things I had to get done. I began to write longer songs with more meaningful lyrics, mostly about positivity because we could never get enough of it.

After maintaining my writing habit throughout high school, I moved to college and started to be familiar with "assignments." That was when I realized I had to write, no matter if I wanted to or not. I wrote more and more after purchasing a smartphone. I wrote on the bus, in the car, and even on the airplane; whenever something came to mind, I wrote it down on my phone. In addition, I liked to highlight and mark my books with a lot of colors and margin notes. A colorful book will be more helpful to me when I need to find a piece of evidence for my paper. However, writing has its own challenges when it comes to college writing. Being unfamiliar with the topic that I was assigned was also a difficulty for me. To write about something that I have never heard of before, I should do some research before analyzing the topic. It is hard to write when you look at a blank page on a computer knowing that the word count for this paper is two thousand words and you have nothing in mind. Writing is impossible without a plan or an outline. It is similar to the 80/20 rule. If you put 80% of your effort into doing the thinking process, then you would only need 20% of your effort to start writing. On the other hand, the word "deadline" always has one meaning to me. I'm ruining the paper if I wait until the due day to start writing it. We cannot wait till time runs out, and hope for some last-minute miracle. As writing requires some thoughtful thinking, it also requires some time.

Writing is not as hard as some people think it is. Only when you have no ideas of what you are writing about or you are not giving yourself enough time to write, that's when everything gets harder. At the end of the day, writing is not only about getting that good grade at school, but it is also a tool to sharpen our thoughts.

Chapter Activities

1. Study Figure 2 ("One Student's First Draft") and Figure 3 ("One Student's Second Draft") and notice the changes between the drafts. The additions in the second draft are in red, and writing that was removed is crossed out. Why do you think the writer made the changes? How do the changes improve the draft? Do you agree with the changes that the writer made? Are there parts of the writing you would have kept in or taken out that the writer did not? Explain your answer.

2. Study Figure 3 (“One Student’s Second Draft”) and Figure 4 (“One Student’s Third Draft”). The additions in the edited and proofread third draft are in blue. Writing that was removed is crossed out. What changes were made in the third draft (blue)? Why do you think the writer made the changes? How do the changes improve the draft? Do you agree with the revisions the writer made? Explain your answer.

CHAPTER 4

The Writing Product: Academic Essay Fundamentals

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Recognize essay structure.
- Analyze a writing prompt.
- Draft a tentative thesis and essay plan.
- Write an effective essay introduction.
- Compose essay body paragraphs
- Write a strong concluding paragraph.
- Revise and edit to improve an essay draft.

Theme: Why Is Sleep So Important?

Statistics show that many college students do not get the recommended eight hours of sleep each night. For instance, one published research study, titled "Sleep Problems in University Students," found that 60% of college students suffer from "poor sleep quality" and close to 8% have insomnia (Schlarb et al., 2017). Are you surprised by these statistics? What might account for students' lack of sleep?

In this chapter you will read about sleep—in particular, why it is important to get a good night's rest. You will read two essays about sleep: one essay composed by an undergraduate student and another written by a PhD candidate and researcher. As you work through the chapter, you will learn what an essay is and what are some fundamentals of academic writing.

ANALYZING ESSAY STRUCTURE

In this chapter, we focus on essays: often the product of the writing process. An **essay** is a piece of writing that expresses an author's point of view on a topic. Essays are the most typical and fundamental type of student writing. You will learn the basic essay structure by reading about and examining essays.

Essay Parts and Their Purpose

Essays usually have three basic parts: an introduction (beginning), a body (middle), and a conclusion (end). Each part serves a particular purpose. Each part of an essay and its purpose are described here:

1. The **introduction**
   - Draws readers in and makes them want to read the essay.
   - Clearly establishes the topic, or subject, of the essay.
   - Presents the writer's **thesis statement**, a sentence that sums up the main idea of the essay and states the writer's opinion on the essay topic.
2. The **body** explains, supports, and develops the thesis. Each **body paragraph**
   - Has a clear main idea, stated in a *topic sentence*.
   - Includes supporting sentences that provide personal examples, quotations from readings, or researched information.
   - Ends with a *closing sentence* that sums up the paragraph's main idea.
3. The **conclusion**
   - Briefly summarizes or synthesizes the information presented in the body of the essay.
   - Ends with a final thought for readers and gives a sense of closure.

A Published Student Essay

Figure 4.1 shows a sample essay (with annotations) entitled "To Sleep or Not to Sleep: That Is the College Student's Eternal Question," written by an undergraduate student. The essay, published in the online journal *Grey Matters* at the University of Washington, illustrates the different parts of an essay.

As you read the essay in Figure 4.1, you will notice parentheses follow some sentences. In the parentheses are the names of authors whose ideas or words are used in that sentence in the essay. Typically, a page number would also appear in the parenthetical citation after the author's name; however, since the sources are found online, no page numbers are needed. At the end of the essay is a works cited page that provides more information about the author's work. This citation style is called MLA (Modern Language Association) style and is often used in English classes. However, because the essay is a published paper, it does not have the full MLA heading it would have if it were submitted to an instructor for a class assignment. Know that different disciplines use different citation styles to fulfill the important requirement that writers give credit to the sources of information they use in their papers.

FIGURE 4.1 Published Student Essay

Source: Roberts, Courtney. "To Sleep or Not to Sleep: That Is the College Student's Eternal Question." *Grey Matters*, 23 Nov. 2013. Copyright © 2013 Grey Matters Inc. Used with permission.

Annotations for Evaluation

How Effective Is the Writing?

Annotations for Comprehension

Identify the Thesis, Main Ideas, and Support.

Courtney Roberts

Professor Kuehner ENG 102

23 November 2013

The heading identifies the author and the date of the paper.

To Sleep or Not to Sleep: That Is the College Student's Eternal Question

A catchy title identifies the paper's topic and draws in the reader.

Ironically, I am currently in Odegaard, the University of Washington's 24-hour library, writing an article about sleep deprivation at one in the morning. As I am writing, I am wondering how many of my classmates are planning to take advantage of the library's hours to pull an all-nighter to cram for their midterms tomorrow. College students have been identified as a population group especially affected by sleep loss (an estimated 73% of students) (Buboltz et al.), which I am quite confident any college student or graduate would agree with. Sometimes, particularly around final examinations, it seems that sacrificing a couple hours of sleep is the only way to earn the "A." However, many years of research have shown that sleep deprivation is detrimental to cognitive ability (Buboltz et al.).

The introductory paragraph sets the essay topic (sleep), gets the reader's attention (with personal details), and states the *thesis*.

Sleep improves your cognitive ability by facilitating learning and memorizing new information in two ways. First, sleep aids restorative processes in the brain. When we are sleep deprived, we are not able to focus our attention as well—which we all know from personal experiences like trying to sit through a lecture the day after a long night (Smith and Lapp). Last month, the Nedergaard lab at the University of Rochester Medical Center published a groundbreaking paper in *Science* regarding the mechanism behind the restorative function of sleep. Their research shows that the restorative function of sleep is a result of a heightened ability to clear out the day's built-up, potentially neurotoxic waste from the interstitial space in the central nervous system (Xie et al.). During sleep there is a 60%

The first body paragraph includes a *topic sentence* (highlighted), provides supporting information (from research), and ends with a closing sentence (how sleep rejuvenates the brain).

increase in the interstitial space, causing a significant increase in the rate of convective exchange of cerebrospinal fluid with interstitial fluid (Xie et al.). This then leads to an increase in the clearance of ß-amyloid, a protein that is the main component of amyloid plaques and associated with diseases such as Alzheimer's (Xie et al.). Clearing out these potentially toxic waste products thus allows our brains to be rejuvenated in the morning (Xie et al.).

Second, sleep is thought to help with memory consolidation ("Sleep"). There are three different steps in memory processing: acquisition, consolidation, and recall ("Sleep"). During acquisition, new information is introduced into the brain ("Sleep"). Consolidation refers to the stabilization of the memory and recall to the ability to access the information after it has been stored ("Sleep"). Both acquisition and recall only occur while we're awake; however, research has suggested that memory consolidation takes place during sleep ("Sleep").

The second body paragraph includes a *topic sentence*, supporting sentences (to explain how memory works), and a closing sentence (linking memory consolidation to sleep).

There is no known mechanism of memory consolidation during sleep currently; however, many researchers think that specific characteristics of brainwaves, such as slow wave and rapid eye movement sleep, are associated with the formation of different types of memory ("Sleep"). One example comes from a study performed by Smith and Lapp. Smith and Lapp monitored honors psychology students during summer break and the consecutive weeks following final examinations during winter break. After final examinations, there was an increase in the number of rapid eye movements during the fifth REM period of sleep from the number made during summer break. These results suggest that an increase in the number of rapid eye movements during 5th period REM sleep—not the length of time spent in REM—accompanies extensive learning (Smith and Lapp). Other such correspondences between different sleep brainwave characteristics and types of learning have also been demonstrated (Smith and Lapp). It is quite likely that different types of learning and memorizing are accompanied with different changes in brainwave characteristics ("Sleep").

The third body paragraph includes a *topic sentence*, supporting sentences (from research studies), and a closing sentence (to explain the theory).

In addition, the study by Smith and Lapp also reported another interesting finding. When asked how well they thought they performed on the study's test, the sleep deprived students rated their performance significantly higher than non–sleep deprived students. Yet, the sleep deprived students still performed significantly worse than their counterparts (Smith and Lapp). A proposed explanation is that since the students were sleep deprived, they had to expend more effort to complete the task, which caused the students to think that they had performed better since they had tried harder. From this, the researchers proposed that many students are unknowingly sabotaging their own performance by choosing to sleep-deprive themselves before a complex cognitive task (Smith and Lapp).

The fourth body paragraph provides supporting sentences (from a study) and a *topic sentence* (that sleep deprivation harms performance and judgment).

All the research so far points to sleep being necessary for optimal cognitive ability. But, so what? We're still college students, and we're still going to have the same incredible amount of work and activities as always. It's the eternal problem of the college student. Yet, when students contemplate the question of "to sleep or not to sleep?" the research shows that sleep should be chosen over the extra couple of hours of studying.

The concluding paragraph briefly synthesizes information in the essay (sleep is necessary) and cleverly ends with a final thought to provide closure (students should get more sleep).

Works Cited

A works cited page at the end of the essay gives sources used in the essay in MLA style.

Buboltz, Walter C., Jr., et al. "Sleep Habits and Patterns of College Students: A Preliminary Study." *Journal of American College Health*, vol. 50, no. 3, 2001, pp. 131–35, https://doi.org/10.1080/07448480109596017.

"Sleep, Learning, and Memory." Division of Sleep Medicine at Harvard Medical School, 2007, healthysleep.med.harvard.edu/healthy/matters/benefits-of-sleep/learning-memory.

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Xie, Lulu, et al. "Sleep Drives Metabolite Clearance from the Adult Brain." *Science,* vol. 342, no. 6156, 18 Oct. 2013, pp. 373–77, https://doi.org/10.1126/science.1241224.

ANALYZE A WRITING PROMPT

Sometimes you will be given a choice of topics for a writing assignment; other times you will be assigned a specific topic. In either situation, understanding the essay assignment is important to successfully complete the task.

Recall that **prompts** are the directions for writing assignments giving the topic and specific directions for how to write about the topic. An essay prompt may consist of more than one sentence. Some statements or questions in a prompt may help you think about the topic; some may give examples of what you might write about; others may be the specific directions or your purpose for writing. It is important to read the prompt carefully and annotate its main points so that you fully understand what is required. Consider the following prompt.

> **Prompt:** College faculty are considering the question, "When should classes start in the morning?" Write an essay to present at a faculty meeting that explains when classes should begin in the morning and why this start time would be beneficial for students.

The question in the prompt—"When should classes start in the morning?"—asks you to think about the topic. The second statement—"explains when . . . and why"—gives the purpose for writing. As you carefully read a prompt, look for key words that

- Identify the *purpose* for writing (to inform, to instruct, to argue, or to persuade).
- Indicate the *audience.*
- Describe the *subject* of the essay.

You can remember these key features with this memory device:

PAS = **P**urpose, **A**udience, **S**ubject

Think about making a "pass" over the prompt, and underline or highlight the important words that help you understand the assignment. An annotated version of the sample prompt might look like Figure 4.2.

FIGURE 4.2 Sample Annotated Prompt

Essay Prompt	Annotations
Prompt: College faculty members are considering the question, "When should classes start in the morning?" Write an essay to present at a faculty meeting that explains when classes should begin in the morning and why this start time would be beneficial for students.	*Purpose = Explain when classes should begin and give reasons why; to persuade* *Audience = College faculty* *Subject = College classes and start time*

Next you will read an essay written by a graduate student and researcher that starts by asking why people need to sleep and presenting various theories as explanations. This article begins with an imagined dialogue between the author and an alien from another planet. It also uses APA (American Psychological Association) style to cite sources with the author and date of publication.

READING SELECTION

"WHY DO WE SLEEP? THERE ARE PLENTY OF THEORIES, BUT NOBODY REALLY KNOWS FOR SURE"

Before Reading: Predict; Identify Audience

Write the answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

1. Read the title of the reading selection and the italicized information preceding the essay. What do you think is the essay's topic?

2. Consider the author and the work in which the essay was published. Who do you think might be the intended audience?
3. Freewrite on the question, "Why do we sleep?" using your own experiences or what you know, have learned, or have read.

During Reading: Find Main Ideas; Find Support

Practice annotating by completing the following activity.

4. As you read, mark the thesis. If the thesis is not directly stated, write it in your own words.
5. As you read, identify the main ideas.

Why Do We Sleep?
There are plenty of theories, but nobody really knows for sure

By Teodora Stoica

Scientific American, 25 January 2019

The author, Teodora Stoica, is a PhD candidate in the Translational Neuroscience Department at the University of Louisville, and writes about science on her personal blog CuriousCortex. *In the following article, published on the* Scientific American *website (a magazine focused on science topics), Stoica explains what researchers know and do not know about the reasons why people need to sleep.*

Try to explain to an alien why we sleep. Give it your best shot. 1

"Well, we get tired. And our brain needs to rest."
"I see. So, you find another way to defend yourself during rest?"
"Well . . . no. Our body is paralyzed, and we lose consciousness."
There is an awkward pause. The alien tilts its head, feigning understanding.
"But! We sometimes dream!"
"Dream?"

Blindly, unaware of how ridiculous you sound, you continue with unprecedented speed and cadence: "Yes! Dreams are fantastical stories projected from the mind *into* the mind, sometimes mixed with things that have *already* happened!" 2

You catch your breath, and smile idiotically. 3

"And . . . this helps with survival?"
"Well . . . no. Sometimes the content confuses us in waking life," you suddenly realize.
The alien blinks silently a few times, furrowing his non-eyebrows:
"Let me see if I understand. Your species spends one third of their lives paralyzed watching fantasy movies?"

It is reasonable to assume the human race is doomed at this uncomfortable juncture in the conversation, and aliens will plan their stealthy attack during this incapacitated, seemingly futile stage of our existence. 4

But sleep isn't futile. In fact, theories on sleep assert its role in reenergizing the body's cells, clearing waste from the brain, and supporting learning and memory. It can even regulate mood, appetite and libido. Yet what precisely happens in our head when it hits the pillow? E.T., you got some learnin' to do. 5

Reflections on why we sleep have existed since the beginning of recorded history. Some 2,000 years ago, Leucippus, the first "atomist," described sleep as something that happened to the body when "the excretion of fine-textured atoms exceeds the accretion of psychic warmth." Fanciful. 6

Another famed ancient, Lucretius, thought sleep is caused by the spirit being attacked and weakened into a state of senescence by mysterious air particles. Absurd. Lastly, Aristotle distinguished sleep and waking as diametrically opposed phenomena characterized by the absence or presence of perception. On the money. He stated: "Sleep is induced by the exhalations of ingested foods which thicken and heat the blood, rising to the brain where they are cooled before coalescing in the heart." 7

Well at least he had the brain part right. Indeed, electroencephalographic (EEG) data measuring brain waves have categorized sleep into two states: non-REM (or NREM, further divided into stages S1, S2, S3 and S4) and REM, which repeat every 90 minutes several times during the night. 8

When overcome by drowsiness but still awake, brain waves become slower, increase in height (amplitude) and become more synchronous (alpha waves). The first official stage of sleep serves as transition between awake and sleep, and is characterized by theta waves, which are even slower in number (frequency) and greater in amplitude than alpha waves. Many sleep-deprived individuals experience microsleeps (frighteningly, while driving!), which are second-long temporary sleep episodes where theta waves replace alpha wave activity. Most people are not even aware they were asleep. 9

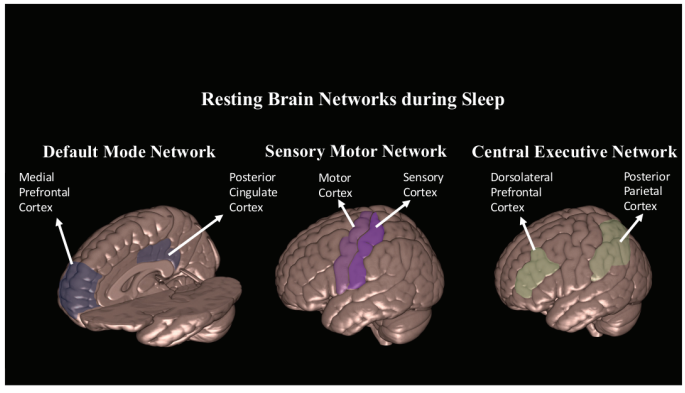
During stage 2 sleep, theta wave activity continues, interspersed with oscillations between the thalamus, a region of the brain regulating sleep, and the rest of the cortex. Stages 1 and 2 are relatively "light" stages of sleep, where waking up is easy and the sleeper might not recognize they were asleep at all. 10

Onto stage 3 and 4, characterized by delta waves, the slowest and highest amplitude brain waves, the most unlike waking brain waves. Since delta sleep is the deepest sleep, it is the most difficult stage in which to wake sleepers, and when they are awakened, they are usually sleepy and disoriented. Interestingly, delta sleep is when sleep walking and sleep talking is most likely to occur. 11

During NREM sleep, sensory information continues to be transferred and encoded in a similar way to the brain when awake—especially at the level of sensory cortices. As sleep progresses, reactivity and awareness decrease. Perceptual activity becomes progressively autonomous. The mind becomes focused inwards and becomes less constrained by input from the external environment. 12

This pattern is visualized in analyses examining resting-state networks, networks of brain regions activated synchronously. The data show that two networks remain active similarly to when awake: the default mode network and sensory motor network. The default mode network is activated during self-generated thought (daydreaming), while the sensory network is activated during stimulus perception. Connectivity to the central executive network, a network active during higher-order processing such as inhibition, is reduced (Figure 1), letting thoughts roam fancy free and creating illogical scenarios where dragons mothered by a platinum beauty queen roam the planet—for example. 13

FIGURE 1. The resting state networks (RSNs) involved in sleep.



Teodora Stoica. Used with permission.

Finally, the one Freud was all excited about: REM. This stage gets its name from the darting eye movements that accompany it (Rapid Eye Movement). Interestingly, it is also characterized by a sudden and dramatic loss of muscle tone—effectively paralysis. Importantly, it is neurologically identical to waking (dyssynchronous brain waves) and further characterized by variable changes in blood pressure, heart rate and overall breathing rate. And of course, dreams. 14

Plato was the first to muse psychologically about dreams, stating: "In all of us, even the most highly respectable, there is a lawless wild beast nature, which peers out in sleep." This presages Freud's wish-fulfillment theory of dreaming yet doesn't neurologically explain that thing Martin Luther King, Jr., had in 1963. 15

Firstly, dreams are *not* hallucinations. While they share some characteristics in common with clinical disorders such as schizophrenia, hallucinations are defined by whole-brain activation. They are veridical movies projected onto reality that the individual remembers well. Dreams, in contrast, are characterized by primary and secondary sensory cortices activation, coupled with disrupted recruitment of the frontal cortex, gate keeper of important higher-order functions like inhibition. If the dream is imbibed in high emotional content, the limbic system is also implicated. 16

Critically, lack of frontal function opens the floodgates to reduced self-awareness and bizarre dream contents, while restricting any incoming information and creating a tight self-contained dream loop. This is perhaps most poetically described by Heraclitus, who commented on the subjective nature of dreams in his memorable phrase, "for those who are awake there is a single, common universe, whereas in sleep each person turns away into his own private universe." 17

A note on lucid dreaming—being aware that you're in a dream. A few studies have found evidence for increased activation of the prefrontal cortex during lucid dreaming, compared to normal REM sleep. The area's typical *de*activation is responsible for the socially inappropriate behaviors and inability to reason logically that is sometimes experienced during dreams, if they are remembered upon waking. 18

In case you don't remember your dreams, you can always Google them. Seriously. The Google artificial neural network is like a computer brain, inspired by the central nervous system of animals. When given free rein to create images out of white noise, it outputs beautiful, intricate, Escher-esque images, what Google engineers are terming "AI Dreams." The neural network's dreams are being used to understand how a computer can make sense out of nonsense—or learn. 19

We've arrived at E.T.'s original inquiry: "But *why* do we sleep?" The easiest answer is, we don't yet know, but theories abound. One theory has to do with sleep playing an important role in memory consolidation, that is, a memory's ability to stick. Research suggests REM sleep strengthens weakened neural circuits holding past memories to prepare them for future cognitive processing, in addition to filtering out unnecessary memories. A study by Poe, et al. (2014) articulates this: "The evidence points to an overall function of embossing of synaptic circuits to add definition to and integrate memories, distinguishing them from the noise introduced to synaptic weights throughout wakefulness." 20

Termed the "synaptic homeostasis hypothesis," it suggests that during sleep there is widespread weakening of connections (synapses) throughout the brain. This is thought to counterbalance the overall strengthening of connections that occurs during learning when we are awake. By pruning away excess connections, sleep effectively "cleans the slate" so we can learn again the next day. Interfering with this scaling down process can, in some cases, lead to more intense (and perhaps unwanted) memories. 21

Another theory, since E.T. doesn't seem impressed, is that sleep is restorative: it flushes out toxins. During sleep, the space between brain cells increases, allowing toxic proteins to be flushed out. It's possible that by removing these toxins from the brain, sleep may stave off neurodegenerative diseases like Alzheimer's. Indeed, in an October 2013 issue of the journal *Science*, researchers published the results of a study indicating that the brain utilizes sleep to flush out toxins. This waste removal system, they suggest, is one of the major reasons why we sleep. 22

While we don't have a precise overarching definition of sleep's function, it impacts different physiological and psychological purposes including cleaning up brain toxins and consolidating information into memory, so it is possible that each of these theories can be used to explain why we sleep; we just haven't worked it out. Give us a break, E.T., we're asleep most of the time. 23

After Reading: Map the Text

Refer to the reading selection as you answer the following questions using complete sentences.

6. Review your annotations to determine which paragraph or paragraphs make up the introduction to this essay. How does the writer use the introduction to get your interest? Does she succeed in making you want to read the essay? Why or why not?
7. Review your annotations to determine which paragraph or paragraphs make up the body of this essay. Do the body paragraphs provide enough information to convince you of the thesis? Which pieces of support do you find most convincing?
8. Which paragraph or paragraphs make up the conclusion to this essay? Does the conclusion give the writer's opinion on the topic and end thoughtfully? Explain.

Engage with the Reading

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Why does the author mention Leucippus, Lucretius, and Aristotle's theories about sleep? Do you think reviewing these ancient ideas helps or distracts from current explanations of what scientists know about sleep?
2. Did you find this reading challenging? Which parts were hardest to understand and which parts were easier? Explain.
3. Compare your ideas about why people need to sleep from before reading this article to after reading. Did your thinking change or develop? Explain.

Academic Style: Appositives

One special type of attribution is an *appositive,* which is a noun or noun phrase that gives descriptive information about a noun. The appositive usually appears immediately after the noun, although it can appear right before the noun. An appositive that comes after a noun is typically followed by a comma or enclosed within commas. An appositive can give more information about a person, an organization, a publication, or any other noun.

continued

Examples of Sentences Using Appositives

- Carol Dweck, professor of psychology at Stanford University, *appositive* believes that a student's mindset can powerfully affect learning and academic achievement.

- *Education Week,* a nonprofit news organization that focuses on K–12 education, *appositive* surveyed teachers about the effect of a growth mindset on students' learning.

DRAFTING A TENTATIVE THESIS AND AN ESSAY PLAN

You have chosen an essay topic, carefully read and annotated the prompt, and done some prewriting and reading on the topic. You feel ready to begin writing. Where do you start?

Tentative Thesis

Writers often produce many *drafts* (attempts at writing) before completing a final essay. To get started on your first draft, try writing a **tentative thesis** (or **working thesis**), your first effort at a thesis statement that will guide the initial draft. Your thesis will most likely change as you write the paper, but a working thesis will provide a focus to get started. It may be a general statement of the topic and your approach to the topic, as the following sample tentative thesis shows:

> **Sample tentative thesis:** College students do not get enough sleep.

In this tentative thesis, the subject is *college students and sleep*; the words *do not get enough* express the writer's attitude. However, the thesis is general. It does not state why college students do not get enough sleep, why this might be a problem, or even if there is a particular group of students who suffer more than others from lack of sleep.

Keep your purpose and audience in mind as you develop your thesis. For instance, Courtney Roberts, in her essay "To Sleep or Not to Sleep," uses research to *inform* readers that sleep deprivation leads to impaired cognitive ability. If you are writing about what colleges can do to encourage students to get enough sleep, you might *persuade* college administrators to take specific actions to improve students' quantity of sleep. Also consider your audience: for whom are you writing? Further refine your tentative thesis with your audience and purpose in mind. Here's an example.

> **Revised Tentative Thesis Statement–Informative:** Many years of research have shown that sleep deprivation is detrimental to cognitive ability.

This tentative thesis is informative because it explains why lack of sleep harms people's ability to think clearly; the explanations are supported by research and evidence.

> **Revised Tentative Thesis Statement—Persuasive:** The campus student health center should inform students about the benefits of getting sufficient sleep.

This tentative thesis is persuasive because it urges the campus student health center to take action to ensure students are better educated about sleep.

Essay Plan

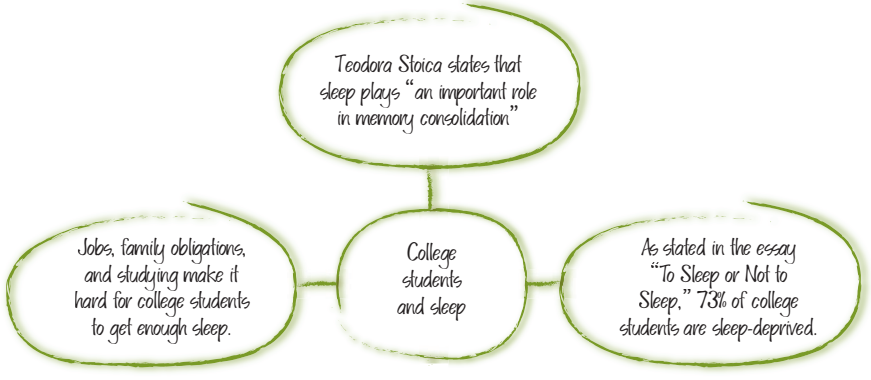
After you have selected a topic and written a tentative thesis, the next step is to generate ideas for your essay. Then you can review those ideas with an eye to identifying the ones you can use. In particular, give attention to which ideas relate to the purpose of the essay and what support will appeal to your audience. For instance, college administrators who are interested in the experiences of many students might be persuaded by research or statistics, while students who are interested in their own behaviors and health might respond better to personal examples.

You can choose one or more of the following prewriting strategies: reviewing assigned readings, lecture notes, or class notes; freewriting; listing; creating a graphic organizer; outlining; or discussing. Often it is useful to use several prewriting strategies to generate more ideas. For instance, Figure 4.3 shows a graphic organizer that includes details from the reading selection ("Why Do We Sleep? There are plenty of theories, but nobody really knows for sure"), details from the "Published Student Essay" (Figure 4.1), and ideas from freewriting about the essay topic.

For a first draft, you might want to plan a three-part organization featuring the following elements.

- Introduction (a beginning), in which you first present the topic and state your main idea (the thesis)
- Body (a middle), in which you provide support for your thesis
- Conclusion (end), in which you conclude the main points of the essay

FIGURE 4.3 Graphic Organizer: College Students and Their Sleep Habits



Next, think about how you will flesh out each part of the essay. At this stage in the writing process, you might take your prewriting and your notes from annotated readings and create an essay plan, a rough outline to organize your thinking. A plan, such as the one shown in Figure 4.4, will change as you write and develop the essay but should provide a launching point for your first draft.

FIGURE 4.4 Sample Essay Plan

Tentative Thesis: College students, especially those at community colleges, do not get enough sleep because many are juggling work, school, and a family life. Foregoing sleep, however, is counterproductive to learning.

Body Paragraph 1: Sleep deprivation is a serious issue for college students.

Body Paragraph 2: Working students have a hard time getting enough sleep.

Body Paragraph 3: Studying can interfere with getting a good night's sleep.

Body Paragraph 4: Family life can keep some students up late.

Body Paragraph 5: Social activities can also keep some students up late.

Body Paragraph 6: Students need to figure out how to get enough sleep or they won't learn.

Conclusion: While many demands—academic, career, family, and social—keep students from getting the sleep they need, college students must find ways to balance those demands to successfully achieve their academic goals.

WRITING AN EFFECTIVE ESSAY INTRODUCTION

When readers pick up an essay, they do not necessarily know what the essay will be about. It is the job of the essay's introduction to ease readers into the paper—to help them move from the world around them into the world of the essay. Writers have various strategies for starting essays. Not all strategies work well in all situations, but knowing the different options can lead to a successful approach.

Sensible Strategies for Introductions

Writers know that they have only one chance to make a good first impression on their audience. So the very beginning of the essay must demonstrate that the

work has valuable content and must engage readers' interest. The following examples show the opening sentences in possible introductions. (The writer would need to follow these opening lines with additional sentences to fully develop the paragraph.) These time-honored strategies for crafting strong introductions include

- **Introduce and summarize source text(s).** Academic writing often requires analysis of texts read in class or located through research. In this case, it is a good move to name the sources in the introduction. Give the title of the text, state the author's full name, and briefly summarize the text. Note that after stating the full name, you should refer to the author only by the last name.

  Example: According to Mary A. Carskadon, a professor at Brown University and author of the article "Forget A's, B's, and C's—What Students Need Is More Zzzz's," most college students do not get enough sleep. Carskadon explains that the average college student sleeps seven and a half hours each night, when students should be getting eight and a half hours to be fully rested.

- **Give background information.** Imagine that your readers are educated but not necessarily familiar with the topic. In the introduction, briefly tell them what they need to know about the topic to understand the essay. For instance, you might explain key terms or important ideas, state authoritative opinions or findings about the topic, or provide factual information.

  Example: Scientists who have studied sleep have developed different theories to explain why sleep is necessary for human beings. Researchers believe that sleep may serve various purposes, such as recharging the brain, releasing important hormones, consolidating learning, and repairing cells.

- **State an interesting fact or statistic.** While reading about the topic in preparation for writing, you perhaps came across a fact or statistic that sparked your interest. You might use this detail to get your readers interested in the topic, too.

  Example: A recent study published in the *Journal of Adolescent Health* shows that 70% of college students receive less than the recommended eight hours of sleep per night.

- **Ask a provocative question.** Questions can make readers think. Asking a thought-provoking question, one that does not necessarily have an easy answer, can be a good way to pique your readers' interest in the topic and encourage them to read on to find the answer.

  Example: Sleep takes up almost one-third of a person's life. When people sleep, they are not apparently doing anything productive—not eating or drinking, not working or playing. So why do people sleep? What purpose does sleep serve in people's lives?

- **Tell a story.** Describing your own experience can help readers personally connect with the topic. You can tell a story about something that happened to

you or to someone you know, or you might describe what happened to a person you read or heard about in relation to the topic.

Example: My first semester in college, I had a brilliant plan. I would take all my classes in the morning and therefore have afternoons free to study and evenings to hang out with friends. The only problem with this plan was my friends liked to stay up late, and I had to get up early for a math class that met at 8:00 a.m. Halfway through math, I would find my eyelids closing and my head drifting toward the desk. It was embarrassing to be caught by the professor napping, and worse news for my grade point average.

- **Begin with a quotation.** A quotation can be from a world-famous person, from a campus figure, or in some cases even from your grandmother, as long as it clearly relates to the topic. Quotations pull readers in and help them think concretely about the topic.

  Example: The American novelist and journalist E. W. Howe once said, "There is only one thing people like that is good for them; a good night's sleep." Yet most Americans do not get a good night's sleep.

Introductions to Avoid

Just as there are many effective strategies for writing introductions, there are also strategies that do not capture readers' interest and are therefore best avoided. The beginning of a possible introduction is shown in the following examples.

- **Providing unnecessary dictionary definitions.** Although you will inevitably need to define or explain some important terms in an essay, avoid defining terms that readers know. Also resist giving dictionary definitions that do not help readers understand the essay's thesis, as in the following example.

  Avoid: According to Merriam-Webster's dictionary, *sleep* means "the natural state of rest during which your eyes are closed and you become unconscious." College students are often sleep deprived.

- **Making sweeping generalizations.** Sometimes students are taught to start with a general idea and work down to a specific idea (their thesis) in the first paragraph. Although this can be a reasonable strategy, beginning with a statement that is *too* broad may not provide a sufficiently clear connection to the topic.

  Avoid: Sleep is a big problem in the world today. Every day there are many people who do not get enough sleep.

- **Stating the obvious.** Assume that your readers are an educated audience. If you start out by stating what readers should already know, readers will not be excited about reading the rest of the essay.

  Avoid: Sleep is very important in a college student's life. If students do not get enough sleep, they will feel tired.

WRITING BODY PARAGRAPHS

Body paragraphs are the heart of any essay. As a reader, you will examine body paragraphs carefully, looking for supporting information. As a writer, you will use body paragraphs to support your thesis and convince readers that what you say is true. You can use the basic paragraph structure—topic sentence, supporting sentences, and closing sentence—to develop body paragraphs in an essay. You can also use the various paragraph patterns—analogy, cause-effect, classification, comparison-contrast, definition, description, example (or illustration), narration, and process—to organize information.

Academic writing often follows a pattern that represents a particular way of thinking about main ideas and support. Academic essay writers accordingly aim to do several things in a body paragraph, such as

- Present the *main point*, often in a topic sentence.
- Give *support* for the main idea, such as examples, details, quotations, facts, and statistics.
- Provide an *explanation* for how the support illustrates the main idea.
- Provide a *closing sentence* that sums up the main idea.

Study the example in Figure 4.5 to understand how a paragraph can use different kinds of support for its topic sentence.

FIGURE 4.5 Sample Body Paragraph

Body Paragraph	Annotations
One reason for not getting sufficient sleep is work. College costs money, so students need to work to pay tuition or buy books. A 2019 report by the Association of Community College Trustees found that 68% of community college students hold down a job while taking classes. Moreover, the same study showed that 60% of community college students work 16 or more hours per week. My best friend, Alex, who works at a shop in the mall, exemplifies those students. Alex works from six o'clock until closing time, which can be ten on weekdays or eleven on weekends. Then Alex has to stay after the store closes to straighten up the shelves, do inventory, and lock up. Alex often does not get home until after midnight. Other students I know take on extra hours at work during the holiday season in November and December, which is also when term papers and final exams are coming up. Extra hours at work and extra work at school mean less time to sleep. It's a dilemma for many students who work to pay for college, but who then lose the sleep they need to do well in college because they are working.	*Topic Sentence* *Support: Statistics* *Support: Statistics* *Support: Example* *Support: Example* *Support: Explanation* *Closing Sentence*

WRITING A STRONG CONCLUSION

The last paragraph of the essay should help readers arrive at a satisfying conclusion. It should communicate a reason why the information in the essay is important. As a reader, look to the conclusion to pull together the essay's main ideas. As a writer, use your conclusion to help readers see the value of the information in the essay.

Sensible Strategies for Writing a Conclusion

The conclusion is the writer's opportunity to have the final say on the essay topic. A strong conclusion leaves the reader feeling satisfied that the topic has been explained well and that it was worthwhile to have read the paper. Choose from the following strategies for creating a conclusion that hits the mark.

- **Ask yourself, "So what?"** A good way to end your essay is to consider the question "So what?" In other words, why is your topic important? Why does it matter? Answer questions like these in the last paragraph.
- **Come full circle.** Look back at your introduction to get inspiration for the conclusion. For instance, if you began with a story, you might end with the resolution of that story. If you started with a question, you might end with the answer.
- **Synthesize.** Often a conclusion can be more specific about the main idea of the essay than the introduction can be. After presenting information and support in the body paragraphs, you can pull these details together—*synthesize* them—in the final section, explaining clearly and concisely how the support reinforces the main idea.
- **Go beyond.** Although your conclusion should not introduce completely new ideas into the essay, you *can* suggest that readers think about the logical consequences of the ideas you presented. For instance, if the essay analyzed a problem, the conclusion may suggest a solution. If the essay looked at an issue, the conclusion might help readers come to a new understanding of that issue. A thoughtful conclusion might even help readers connect the important ideas in the essay to their own lives.

Conclusions to Avoid

Some strategies for ending essays should be avoided because they are not interesting or effective. Some are listed here.

- **Summarizing by unnecessarily repeating information.** Often students are instructed to summarize the essay or to repeat the thesis in the conclusion. Although it is possible to do so effectively, simply repeating what you have already stated can seem tedious or unnecessary.
- **Being vague or indecisive.** You might weaken your main idea if you undercut your argument by making an unhelpful qualifying statement such as "Everyone can have a different opinion on this topic." If you have asserted a thesis and supported that thesis, then stick by it to the end.

- **Introducing new ideas or new support.** Important ideas and support belong in the body paragraphs, not in the conclusion. If you find yourself developing a new idea with supporting evidence, consider writing another body paragraph before composing the conclusion.

REVISING AND EDITING TO IMPROVE AN ESSAY DRAFT

The first draft is usually the beginning of an essay writing assignment. Experienced writers know that they must reread and rewrite their first draft several times until their paper meets the expectations of the assignment and of their readers, as well as of themselves as writers. After composing a first draft, writers should take a break—for an hour or even a day—and then reread the draft with fresh eyes.

Revising a draft involves looking at its organization and support to resolve problems in these areas. When reading an essay to revise, be sure the various sections do what they are supposed to do.

- First, determine whether the essay has a clear thesis and the draft stays focused on the thesis.
- Next, look at the body paragraphs to determine whether they have topic sentences and closing sentences related to the thesis. In addition, information in each body paragraph should relate closely to the topic sentence and thereby support it in a compelling way.
- Finally, check that the essay has an introduction that establishes the topic and captures the reader's interest and that the draft ends with a satisfying conclusion.

Use the checklist in "Strategies for an Effective Essay" to focus on the various parts of the draft, ask critical questions, and resolve any problems.

Strategies for an Effective Essay

1. Does the essay have a clear thesis?
   _____ Yes.
   _____ Could be improved. (Describe how the thesis could be clearer.)
2. Does the essay have an introduction that sets the topic for the paper and attracts the reader's interest?
   _____ Yes.
   _____ Could be improved. (Describe how the introduction could be improved.)
3. Do the body paragraphs have clear topic sentences and closing sentences?
   _____ Yes.
   _____ Could be improved. (Identify where the topic sentences or closing sentences could be clearer.)

continued

4. Do the body paragraphs include compelling supporting information?
   _____ Yes.
   _____ Could be improved. (Explain how.)
5. Does the essay have a satisfying conclusion?
   _____ Yes.
   _____ Could be improved. (Explain how.)

Another strategy for revising is to read your draft and write comments in the margins. Alternatively, you can ask a trusted individual, such as a tutor or a knowledgeable classmate, to do so. During the first reading of a first draft, take care to examine the thesis, the body paragraphs and supporting evidence, and the introduction and conclusion for effectiveness. Focus on positive aspects of the essay, unclear parts, and specific areas needing improvement. The essay draft in Figure 4.6 has been annotated with comments to help with revision.

FIGURE 4.6 Draft of an Essay, with Comments

Essay Draft	Comments on Draft
Sleep deprivation is a serious problem for college students. According to Mary A. Carskadon, a professor of psychiatry and human behavior at Brown University, college students who do not get enough sleep "report lower grades and more trouble with coursework." There are many reasons why college students do not get enough sleep.	*Good to include a quotation in the beginning to show importance of sleep.* *Thesis: Be more specific: identify reasons.*
Ironically, students who do not get enough sleep report lower grades, but that might be because students have to study. Often they study late into the night, and that keeps them from getting a good night's sleep. Although it's not the best thing to do, some students stay up the night before a test cramming or stay up the night before a paper is due writing their essay. Staying up until the wee hours of the morning means that they lose sleep. Students may also drink coffee or energy drinks to keep themselves awake. So in an attempt to get good grades, students may actually be getting poorer grades because they are depriving themselves of sleep.	*Make this the topic sentence?* *Include more evidence or details in paragraph to show how poor study habits interfere with sleep.* *This detail seems out of place.* *Nice concluding sentence that sums up the dilemma for students.*
When they are not studying, students like to spend time with their friends and socialize. No longer in high school, college students can stay up as late as they like. And the temptation when everyone else is talking, partying, having a good time is to join in the fun. There's no parent to tell the student when to be home or go to bed. So students often lose track of time in the quest to have fun. Plus some students work. Not all students can party. They have to work to support themselves and help pay for school and this adds stress to their lives and makes them lose sleep.	*Make topic sentence more clearly related to sleep?* *Maybe write a separate paragraph about how work makes students sleep-deprived?*

FIGURE 4.6 **Draft of an Essay, with Comments** (*continued*)

Essay Draft	Comments on Draft
College students face many demands, but they still need adequate sleep. Sleep researcher Teodora Stoica tells us that sleep is necessary for "strengthening of connections that occur during learning when we are awake" and that sleep clears our brains "so we can learn again the next day" (qtd. in Kuehner 127). Roberts, in her paper "To Sleep or Not to Sleep," explains how sleep improves our thinking and ability to retain information. This means that sleep is necessary for college students to process their learning.	*Good idea to reference the reading and explain why sleep is important.*
	Explain Roberts's ideas in more detail.
One solution to the problem of students not sleeping enough was pointed out in the article "Forget A's, B's, and C's—What Students Need Is More Zzzz's." The article stated that at the University of Arizona an advertising campaign helped students understand the need for sleep. A little bit of sleep can go a long way toward making students feel better and get better grades. Maybe more schools should help educate students about good sleep habits.	*Conclusion could be stronger, more definite statement about sleep and more realistic solutions.*

If you read and assessed your own draft, you should review the comments and make changes to improve the writing. If someone else read and commented on your draft, evaluate the comments thoughtfully before acting. You might have received some helpful suggestions for improving the essay. However, you might also have received feedback that is unclear or does not serve the purpose of your paper. As the author, *you* need to decide how best to revise your writing. Take the comments that make sense and will improve the draft, and revise accordingly. Finally, read your draft carefully to edit the sentences and words, and to proofread for correctness. After revising, continue the writing process to polish your paper.

Figure 4.7 shows a revision of the draft essay in Figure 4.6 that takes into account the comments in Figure 4.6.

FIGURE 4.7 **Revised Draft of an Essay**

Sleep deprivation is a serious problem for college students. One statistic, cited in the article "To Sleep or Not to Sleep" estimates that 73% of college students do not get enough sleep (Roberts 121), while more recent research finds that 60% of college students suffer from "poor sleep quality" and almost 8% of college students experience insomnia

FIGURE 4.7 Revised Draft of an Essay (*continued*)

(qtd. in Schlarb et al.). These statistics indicate that a substantial number of college students are not getting the recommended amount of sleep that they need to do well in their classes. In fact, sleep deprivation has been linked to poorer grades and a lower quality of life (Schlarb et al.), even to depression and suicidal thoughts (Becker et al.). Given these issues, why don't college students get enough sleep? The answer is that for many students who are juggling work, school, and a social life, a good night's sleep is the last priority. Foregoing sleep, however, is counterproductive to being a successful student.

One reason for not getting sufficient sleep is work. College costs money, so students need to work to pay tuition or buy books. A 2019 report by the Association of Community College Trustees found that 68% of community college students hold down a job while taking classes. Moreover, the same study showed that 60% of community college students work 16 or more hours per week. My best friend, Alex, who works at a shop in the mall, exemplifies those students. Alex works from six o'clock until closing time, which can be ten on weekdays or eleven on weekends. Then Alex has to stay after the store closes to straighten up the shelves, do inventory, and lock up. Alex often does not get home until after midnight. Other students I know take on extra hours at work during the holiday season in November and December, which is also when term papers and final exams are coming up. Extra hours at work and extra work at school mean less time to sleep. It's a dilemma for many students who work to pay for college, but who then lose the sleep they need to do well in college because they are working.

When they are not working, students like to spend time with their friends or family. No doubt it's important for a student's mental health to have downtime and connect with others. Indeed, "late-night socializing" is noted as a challenge to good sleep in the research study on "Causes and Consequences of Sleepiness among College Students" (Hershner and Chervin). This makes sense given that younger students right out of high school can stay up as late as they like. These students may be tempted to hang out and party, to have a good time. After all, part of the

FIGURE 4.7 Revised Draft of an Essay (*continued*)

college experience is late-night bull sessions and freedom from parents who set the rules for getting home and going to bed. These students often lose sleep in the quest to have fun.

Not all students can party, though. Some students have a family they are responsible for. The same research study cited previously notes that "early or late obligations" are factors that cut into sleep (Hershner and Chervin). Students who are parents might have to get up early to prepare children for school. Then, in the evenings, student parents might need to pick up their kids, feed them dinner, help them with homework, and put them to bed before they can hit the books themselves. Whether having fun with friends or being a good parent, students are people with personal lives that can sometimes make them choose that over sleep.

Ironically, often students do not get enough sleep because they have to study. Although it's not the best strategy, some students stay up the night before a test cramming or stay up the night before a paper is due writing their essay. Other more responsible students, like my friend who works at the mall, may be able to study only after they come home from work. That means staying up until two or three in the morning to complete their reading and assignments. To keep themselves awake, these students may drink coffee or energy drinks, which then make it hard to go to sleep. Indeed, the Hershner and Chervin research study cites "caffeine and energy drinks," as well as "stimulant use," as factors that prevent college students from having a good night's sleep. In an attempt to achieve good grades, students may actually be getting poorer grades because they are depriving themselves of sleep.

College students face many demands, but if they truly want to succeed as college students, they need adequate sleep. Sleep researcher Teodora Stoica tells us that sleep is necessary for "strengthening of connections that occur during learning when we are awake" and that sleep clears our brains "so we can learn again the next day" (qtd. in Kuehner 127). Roberts, in her paper "To Sleep or Not to Sleep," explains how sleep improves our thinking and ability to retain

FIGURE 4.7 Revised Draft of an Essay (*continued*)

information. She points to research published in Science suggesting that sleep clears out toxic waste when we sleep, allowing our brains to function more effectively. Moreover, even though we can learn new information while we are awake, our brains consolidate or store information we have learned during the day when we sleep at night (Roberts). This means that sleep is necessary for college students to process their learning.

It's hard being a college student: studying and working, maintaining a social life and meeting family obligations, often keep students from getting their much-needed sleep. Students must try to prioritize their lives and recognize they can't do everything well if they are sleep deprived. Solutions might include cutting back on the number of classes in a term or the number of hours at work, foregoing some social events during midterm and final exam times. One thing that should not be sacrificed, however, is getting a good night's sleep.

Works Cited

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Stoica, Teodora. "Why Do We Sleep?" *Scientific American*, 25 Jan. 2019.

Activity 4.1 Choose a Prompt for an Essay on Students and Sleep

Select one of the prompts that follow to help you focus your reading and plan an essay about sleep as you navigate through this chapter.

1. What happens when people, especially college students, do not get enough sleep? Describe the effects of lack of sleep on a student's study, work, or personal life. Write your essay directed at your fellow students.
2. The college staff wants to know, "What can colleges do to encourage students to get enough sleep?" Write an essay to present to faculty, staff, and administrators at your college's health center explaining your perspective on this question.
3. Write an essay for your college newspaper giving advice to your fellow students about what college students can do to be sure they get enough sleep. In your essay, identify some activities that might be keeping students from getting enough sleep, such as working, using social media, or studying late at night, and suggest solutions for dealing with these obstacles.
4. Write an essay to be published in the *Chronicle of Higher Education*, a publication for college faculty and administrators, explaining the main reasons why college students do not get enough sleep. Write the essay from a student's point of view.
5. As a project for your health class, write an essay persuading students that getting a good night's sleep is in their best interest and describing ways to get enough sleep. Imagine this essay will be e-mailed to every student on campus as part of a back-to-school health campaign in the beginning of the fall semester.
6. The published student essay (Figure 4.1) concludes that when college students consider whether or not to sleep, "Sleep should be chosen over the extra couple of hours of studying." Write an essay aimed at fellow college students in which you explain when it might be acceptable or necessary for students to choose *not* to sleep so they can engage in some other activity. Be specific about when, why, and what students might do instead of sleeping, and justify those choices.

Activity 4.2 Annotate an Essay Prompt

Complete the following exercise.

Review the essay prompt you selected in Activity 4.1. Annotate the prompt, identifying the essay's PAS—purpose, audience, and subject.

Activity 4.3 Prewrite

Complete the following exercises.

1. Using the topic you selected for Activity 4.1, do some freewriting, brainstorming, or listing about that topic by jotting down ideas.
2. Using the topic you selected for Activity 4.1, review the reading selections in this chapter, looking for ideas related to your essay purpose and information that would appeal to your audience.

Activity 4.4 Write a Tentative Thesis and an Essay Plan

Complete the following exercises.

1. Create a graphic organizer that includes details from the reading selection and any ideas from brainstorming, freewriting, or listing related to your essay topic. Put your main idea in a center circle, and add links to connecting circles that have supporting examples, details, and information.
2. Using your graphic organizer, write a tentative thesis statement.
3. Create a plan for your essay using your tentative thesis and the information in your graphic organizer. Include notes for each part of the essay: introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion.

Activity 4.5 Read and Write Introductions

1. Review the first paragraph of the essay "To Sleep or Not to Sleep" in Figure 4.1. What strategy does the writer use in the introduction? Might you use a similar strategy to begin your essay? Explain.
2. Review the first paragraph of "Why Do We Sleep?" and your response to exercise 6 from the reading selection's "After Reading" activity. What strategy does the writer, Teodora Stoica, use to begin her essay? Might you use a similar strategy to begin your essay? Explain.
3. Review your notes from Activities 4.2, 4.3, and 4.4. Select one of the sensible strategies for writing an introduction and compose an introduction for your own essay.
4. Review your notes from Activities 4.2, 4.3, and 4.4. Select one of the sensible strategies for writing an introduction—a different one from what you used in exercise 3—and compose another introduction for your essay.

Pair and Share

With a classmate, exchange and read your two introductions (from exercises 3 and 4 in Activity 4.5). Explain which introduction you find more effective and why.

Activity 4.6 Read and Write Body Paragraphs

1. Review the body paragraphs of the essay "To Sleep or Not to Sleep" in Figure 4.1. Might you use similar paragraph structures in your essay? Explain.
2. Review the body paragraphs in the reading selection ("Why Do We Sleep?") and your answer to question 7 in the "After Reading" activity for the reading. Might you use similar paragraph structures in your essay? Explain.
3. Review your notes from Activities 4.2, 4.3, and 4.4. Try writing a body paragraph for your essay. Begin with a topic sentence, provide support and explanation for that topic sentence, and include a closing sentence.
4. Review your notes from Activities 4.2, 4.3, and 4.4. Write as many more body paragraphs as you need to develop the ideas for your essay.

Pair and Share

With a classmate, exchange your body paragraphs (from exercises 3 and 4 in Activity 4.6). Suggest more strategies to develop the main ideas in each body paragraph, such as with information from readings or with more examples or details.

Activity 4.7 Read and Write Conclusions

Complete the following exercises.

1. Review the conclusion of the essay "To Sleep or Not to Sleep" in Figure 4.1. What strategy did the writer use? Might you use a similar strategy to end your essay? Explain.
2. Review the conclusion of the reading selection "Why Do We Sleep?" and your response to exercise 8 in the "After Reading" activity for the reading. Might you use a similar strategy to end your essay? Explain.
3. Review your notes from Activities 4.2, 4.3, and 4.4. Select one of the sensible strategies for writing a conclusion and compose a conclusion for your own essay.
4. Select one of the sensible strategies for writing a conclusion—a different one from what you used in exercise 3—and compose another conclusion for your essay.

Pair and Share

With a classmate, exchange your two conclusions (from exercises 3 and 4 in Activity 4.7). Explain which conclusion you find more effective and why.

Activity 4.8 Read to Revise a Draft

Use the essay you wrote for the activities in this chapter to complete the following exercises.

1. Study Figures 4.3 and 4.4 and notice the changes between the first draft and the revised draft. Why do you think the writer made the changes? How do the changes improve the draft? Do you agree with the changes that the writer made? Are there parts of the writing you would have kept in or taken out that the writer did not? Explain your answer.
2. Use "Strategies for an Effective Essay" to revise your essay by reading your draft and completing the checklist.
3. Read your essay and your comments on it. Mark parts of the draft that are effective or ineffective. Focus on concerns such as organization, coherence and unity of body paragraphs, and effectiveness of the introduction and conclusion, but not on grammar and spelling.
4. Read your essay again, focusing on the sentences, word choice, and correctness. Make any changes needed to improve the writing.

Pair and Share

- Give your essay draft to a classmate or someone else you trust and ask that person to complete the checklist in "Strategies for an Effective Essay."
- Give your draft to a classmate or someone else you trust and ask that person to write comments on it, looking at what is effective or not and making suggestions for improvement. Have your reader focus on the thesis, organization, and support, not on grammar and spelling.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

body The middle section of an essay, which explains, supports, and develops the thesis.

body paragraph A paragraph in the middle of the essay that provides support for the essay's thesis.

conclusion The end of an essay, in which the writer summarizes the information presented in the body of the essay or gives final thoughts.

essay A piece of writing consisting of several paragraphs that expresses an author's point of view on a particular topic.

introduction The beginning of an essay, which establishes what the essay is about, sets the tone, gets the reader's interest, and introduces the thesis statement.

prompt Directions for a writing assignment including the topic and specific instructions for writing about the topic.

tentative (working) thesis An initial thesis statement that guides a writer during drafting.

thesis statement A sentence that gives the topic of the essay and the writer's opinion on the essay topic.

Chapter Summary

- Essays, which are the most typical type of student writing, consist of an introduction, a body, and a conclusion.
- Before writing an essay, it is a good practice to carefully read and annotate the prompt to ensure you understand the subject, audience, and purpose of the assignment.
- To get started writing a first draft, you may find it helpful to compose a tentative thesis and create an essay plan.
- An effective introduction sets the essay topic, gets the reader's attention, and states the thesis.
- Each body paragraph includes a topic sentence and closing sentence and provides essential supporting information.
- The essay's conclusion should communicate why the information in the essay is important and help readers feel satisfied about the ideas and their value.
- Revising a draft involves rereading and rewriting with the goal of improving the writing.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Locate an essay about sleep in your college library. Identify the essay's introduction, body, and conclusion by annotating the work. If it is not feasible to annotate the essay, determine which paragraphs compose the different parts of the essay by referring to them by paragraph numbers.
2. Evaluate the essay about sleep that you found in the library (from exercise 1). Using complete sentences, comment on the effectiveness of the essay's introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion. Explain your evaluations.

3. Now that you know the importance of sleep, what, if anything, will you do to change your sleep routine? Explain using information from the readings in the chapter, as well as your own experiences.

Work Cited

Schlarb, Anita A., Anja Friedrich, and Merle Claßen. "Sleep Problems in University Students—An Intervention." *Neuropsychiatric Disease and Treatment,* vol. 13, 2017, pp. 1989–2001.

Credits

pp. 86–89: Stoica, Teodora. "Why Do We Sleep?" *Scientific American,* January 25, 2019. Used with permission.

SPOTLIGHT ON
STUDENT WRITING

Response Essay

In this Spotlight chapter, you will practice reading and writing skills to evaluate any piece of writing, including your own writing and the writing of other students. You will apply annotation skills to student writing, with an eye toward revising and editing.

ANNOTATING TO EVALUATE STUDENT WRITING

Annotating your own writing can help you to better understand its structure and effectiveness. You might also read and annotate a classmate's writing to provide feedback to improve the paper. An effective strategy when reading to annotate is to read the paper at least two times.

- During a *first reading,* focus on understanding the main ideas and examples to ensure that the purpose and organization of the writing are clear.
- On a *second reading*, focus on evaluating the paper by assessing the strengths of the writing or considering what could be improved. Note what is effective about the writing so that the writer will retain those parts, but also point out where the writing is weak so the writer can revise and improve those parts.

After each reading, make annotations. Here are some strategies for successful annotations:

First Reading: Annotations for Comprehension

- Note the title to identify the topic.
- Underline main ideas, such as the thesis or concluding statements, to discover the paper's organization.
- Mark examples to determine the support for the main ideas.
- Write brief summaries of main ideas and examples in the margin to reinforce your comprehension of the writing.

Second Reading: Annotations for Evaluation

- Look for places in the paper where the writing is effective and label those places with words such as "Good" or "Strong."
- Be specific about what is effective. For instance, rather than writing "Good example," you can write "Good example of how you worked hard in school to be successful."

- Look for places in the paper where the writing could be improved and label those places using words such as “Unclear” or “Confusing.” Avoid judgmental terms like “Bad” or “Boring.”
- Be specific about what is not effective. For instance, rather than writing, “Confusing sentence,” you can write, “I don’t understand why you mention your dog eating your homework or how that relates to failing math.”
- Ask questions if you are not sure whether the writing is effective. For instance, you might ask a question about how the paper is formatted or whether the writer needs to use examples from the reading.

SAMPLE STUDENT PAPERS

This Spotlight chapter includes two sample student papers to read and consider. The first student paper is marked to demonstrate effective annotations. The second paper is not marked; you can use it to practice annotating.

The students responded to a specific writing prompt. After reading Carol Dweck’s article “Brainology,” students had a choice of prompts to write about, including the following.

> ***Writing Prompt:*** *Carol Dweck’s research indicates that students with growth mindsets are more successful academically than students with fixed mindsets. Based on your experience and observations, do you agree that a growth mindset leads to greater academic success than a fixed mindset?*

The two student papers—Alejandra Jimenez’s “The Good, the Bad, and the Math” and Veronica Alvarez’s “Involuntary Resignation”—were written in response to this prompt. For this assignment, which was the first paper due in the course, students were encouraged to explain Dweck’s ideas about fixed and growth mindset and to use their own experiences or observations to reflect on Dweck’s ideas. As you read, notice how the students respond very differently to Dweck’s ideas and how each uses her own experiences to support her response.

The first paper, by Jimenez, is annotated by a reviewer. First, the reviewer read the paper to understand the writer’s thesis, main ideas, and examples. Then the reviewer reread the paper to evaluate the strengths and weaknesses of the writing. Notice there are annotations on the paper itself, in the right margin, and in the left margin. Here is an explanation of these annotations:

- **Annotations in the right margin.** The title, thesis, and main ideas are summarized in the right-hand column to check comprehension and are highlighted in blue on the paper. Examples are indicated with the abbreviation “EX” and briefly summarized.
- **Annotations in the left margin.** Responses to the paper, such as what is effective, what is not clear, or questions the reader had, appear in the left column and are highlighted in orange on the paper.

Notice the paper is not overly marked up. Writing too many comments can be overwhelming and counterproductive for the reviewer and for the writer. Instead, most reviewers strive to highlight the main ideas and examples and to include a few well-chosen comments that focus on the most important aspects of the writing. Review this annotation strategy by studying Jimenez's paper. Then practice reading and annotating by applying these strategies to the second student paper, which is not annotated.

Annotations for Evaluation

Annotations for Comprehension

Jimenez 1

Alejandra Jimenez

Professor Kuehner

English 151RW

20 September 2015

Fun title!

The Good, the Bad, and the Math

Title suggests topic: math and growth and fixed mindsets

In Carol Dweck's article, "Brainology: Transforming Student's Motivation to Learn," she states that people have different types of learning mindsets; "fixed" or "growth" mindset. With her research, she has found that many students have a "fixed" mindset, which is when the student believes that he or she cannot change or enhance their intelligence. They think that they either have an innate intelligence or they do not. In contrast to a "fixed mindset," people with a "growth" mindset believe that they can improve their intelligence through hard work and perseverance. Dweck claims that having a growth mindset can make a person do better academically than someone with a fixed mindset. I agree that people with a growth mindset do better academically than those with a fixed mindset because a person with a growth mindset wants to learn and improve, while a person with a fixed mindset gets held back. The amount of

Good explanations of fixed and growth mindsets

Is it OK to use "I" in the paper or in the thesis?

Thesis responds to the prompt—agrees with Dweck

Clearly sets up focus on math in rest of paper

times I have heard students say that they are "bad at math" is a grand one. Unfortunately, I was one of them. I had a fixed mindset in math. I for one thought I would never improve in math but with enough effort and a growth mindset, I did.

EX: how she changed from fixed to growth mindset; connects fixed mindset to herself in math

Be more specific about "people"—maybe say "students"

Dweck states that people with a fixed mindset "worry about how much . . . intelligence they possess." They think that the amount of intelligence they have cannot be altered. They believe that what they have is all they are going to get. They do not seem to believe that they can reach their full potential. They give up right away without even trying. This is exactly what I thought when it came to math. Every year I dreaded my math class because it was the only class I felt behind in. Everyone else seemed to fully understand the material except for me. All I could think was, "They get it, you do not, and there is nothing you can do about it." I felt embarrassed. I decided not to try in math at all so people would think that the only reason I was failing was because I would not do my work and not because I did not understand the material. Little did I know that with a growth mindset and perseverance I could change all of that.

EX: quote from Dweck

Strong quotes in this paragraph

Main idea: has a fixed mindset in math

EX: quote to show a fixed mindset

EX: not trying, not doing work

Dweck also states that people with a growth mindset "understand that even Einstein wasn't Einstein until he put in years of focused hard work." People with a growth mindset know they will not be as smart as, say, Einstein right away, but they know that they do have the potential to become very intelligent. They are motivated by this; they want to have the feeling of accomplishing something. They do not mind all the hard work they have to put in because they want to reach their full potential, and in the end, that is the main goal. It is as Jane Austen once wrote, "The distance is nothing when one has a motive. . . ." What I think this quote means is that no matter how long it takes people to accomplish something, it should not matter because they have this strong motivation to get to their destination. I feel that they do better academically because they do not believe that they are bad at something, they just feel that they need to improve. This was a turning point for me.

Clear explanation of Dweck's growth mindset

EX: quote from Dweck

Is it necessary to write "I think"?

EX: quote from Austen

Main idea: switches from fixed to growth mindset

In my math class I began to realize that many of the students were not "good" at math because they were born with that natural ability; it was due to the fact that they put all the effort they had into getting a better grade. This made me want to try my hardest the rest of the year. Every day in my class, I would ask questions and ask for help. Whenever there was a chance for extra credit, I would take it. I would constantly do practice tests every day. By the end of the year, I had received a B in the class and I was proud of myself. It felt great to finally have a high grade in math. I did not stop there however. Knowing that I was capable of getting a B, I decided to aim for a higher grade. To this day I am working on getting an A in my math class. Even if I do not get a high grade right away, I know that I am able to achieve it as long as I put effort into it.

In the end, my experience has led me to the conclusion that a growth mindset can definitely lead to academic success. With a fixed mindset, I did not achieve anything. On the other hand, with a growth mindset, I became "good" at math. Dweck demonstrates that a fixed mindset should not be a limitation but rather be motivation to develop a growth mindset. Having a fixed mindset can negatively affect academic achievements if one feels incapable of reaching his or her goal, but with enough willpower, it can change from a weakness to a strength.

Very good point! Hard work is necessary to learn math

EX: working hard and asking questions

Effective details about what a growth mindset looks like

EX: getting a good grade

Strong sentence

Main idea: with a growth mindset, did well in math

Main idea: growth mindset and improvement in math reinforces the thesis

Work Cited

Dweck, Carol. "Brainology. Transforming Students' Motivation to Learn." *Independent School Magazine,* National Association of Independent Schools, winter 2008, https://www.nais.org/magazine/independent-school/winter-2008/brainology/.

STUDENT PAPER

Now it is your turn to read and annotate a student paper. Use the annotation strategies and the examples of annotations on Jimenez's paper to guide you as you review Alvarez's paper.

Before Reading: Predict

Respond to the following using complete sentences.

1. Consider the title of the paper. How do you think the student will respond to Dweck's ideas? For instance, do you think she will agree or disagree with Dweck?

During Reading: Annotate; Evaluate

Complete the following exercises.

2. As you read, underline the writer's thesis and main ideas. Then briefly summarize these in the margins. Identify the examples.
3. What do you think are the most effective aspects of Alvarez's paper? Be specific by referencing words or sentences, examples, or paragraphs that you feel are especially strong and jotting down why.
4. Are there any parts of the paper you feel could be improved? If so, identify these specifically by referencing words or sentences, examples, or paragraphs and noting how these could be stronger.

Veronica Alvarez
Professor Kuehner
English 151RW
15 February 2016

Involuntary Resignation

In the article "Brainology," author Carol S. Dweck states that by having a fixed mindset we have less probabilities of being successful rather than the ones with a growth mindset. But . . . is this true? Can we guarantee that we will be successful by having a growth mindset? I admit I do agree with Dweck's observations of both mindsets: putting in effort and challenging ourselves with new things to increase our intelligence (growth mindset) is indeed more beneficial for us compared to convincing our mind that intelligence is a talent that we either have or not (fixed mindset). However, throughout my life, I have observed and known many people that started with a growth mindset and ended up converting into a fixed mindset. How is this possible? After experiencing high school in two different countries—Mexico and United States—I was able to notice that those who switched into a fixed mindset did not do it because they wanted to, but because they realized that they had no other option and gave up. In some places, putting effort into learning and being academically successful is still not enough. In Mexico, for example, if students do not have enough money to attend and actually graduate from a prestigious school, even if they have a growth mindset, there is a very low possibility that they will achieve their dream job . . . or any job. Having a growth mindset does not guarantee our success.

When I read the article "Brainology" for the first time, I was amazed by the author's splendid explanation about fixed and growth mindsets. I enjoyed reading it so much that I decided to read it a second time, but this time there was a specific sentence that caught my attention in which

author Dweck described the fixed mindset in a student: “They don’t want to make mistakes and feel dumb—and, most of all, they don’t want to work hard and feel dumb. So they simply retire.” After reading this, it made me think for a moment. Do students really retire because they have a fixed mindset and don’t want to feel “dumb,” or because they lost the motivation to keep studying? But really, both mindsets can drop out of school because of lack of motivation—not only fixed mindsets. After studying the first two years of high school in Mexico, I realized that there are many bright minds that are being wasted there; so many students with a growth mindset that, because of life circumstances, do not get to be as successful as they could. In order to obtain success, in whatever place that we happen to live in, we need money to attend a college or university. Of course, there are many financial aids and scholarships that can help students to not drop out because of their economic problems. However, being a student without enough resources to attend a distinguished school becomes quite more complex when they live in Mexico; if they do not come from a wealthy family, it is almost impossible to even think of getting a degree in whatever major that it is that they want to study. It is at this point that growth mindset students start to assimilate the crude reality of not being able to keep studying, and, therefore, not obtaining the job they aspire to. Their motivation to study and keep putting effort into school soon comes to an end, and everything related to school seems simply pointless since they know they will be unable to accomplish their dreams. These students did not retire because they did not want to make mistakes or feel “dumb,” neither because they did not work hard enough . . . but because their opportunities of becoming successful were too low to come true. They were forced to have a fixed mindset.

After reading “Brainology” for a third time, I was able to notice that Dweck briefly talks about changing fixed mindsets into growth mindsets, but does not talk about growth mindsets turning into fixed mindsets. Does it seem too impossible for that to happen? To change a positive mind into a negative one? Believe me it is possible. Those students in Mexico with growth mindsets and shallow economic income became an involuntary fixed mindset; they once had motivation

and wanted to learn; they wanted to succeed and not give up, but were never given the opportunity to prove so. Living in Mexico was a great experience, but unfortunately it is very easy to change a student's mentality into a fixed mindset over there. I remember having a growth mindset before moving from California to Mexico. Attending school was an adventure full of new and fresh experiences for me, I enjoyed learning new things everyday, and the fact that I was getting good grades out of it was just a bonus. As I began my sophomore year in high school, I started to realize how my life would be if I stayed in Mexico. At that point all I knew was that I had to graduate high school there and that I had to find a way to be successful without worrying my parents economically. Thinking about my future gave me anxiety and made me cry for days; I did not know what was going to happen after graduating high school. The only way I could keep studying was if I attended a college that was two hours away from my house; nonetheless, it was almost impossible to get accepted, and acceptance still did not guarantee students they would get a decent job after. The stress was unreal; it got to the point in which I did not care anymore. No matter how much effort I put into school, money always came in first. I realize now that I started having a fixed mindset; I had no motivation at all and school started to be more of a load than an enjoyment. This should have not been an exception for me to stop having a growth mindset, but again, the possibilities of being successful in these circumstances are almost nonexistent—it can make a student lose interest in school very easily. Moving back to the U.S. was truly a blessing; once again I have a growth mindset and all the intentions of putting as much effort as I can on my studies and future.

In conclusion, we cannot base our success on whatever our mentality is; situations and issues in our life can make our mindset change even if we do not expect it to. A growth mindset student can lose motivation for school in any moment just like a fixed mindset: they both face the same risks of giving up. As I said in the beginning, I agree with Dweck that growth mindsets have more possibilities of succeeding than a fixed mindset, but it does not guarantee that they will indeed accomplish their academic dreams or get the job they aspire to. Growth

mindset students can face major complications that can be more than they can handle, forcing them to give up and change into a fixed mindset. They did not stop trying because they were lazy or afraid of challenges, but because they lost the motivation that made them want to learn. The truth is, we can change our mentality and change it again and therefore cannot expect all growth mindsets to succeed and think always the same, nor does it mean that all fixed mindsets retire because they are afraid and think their intelligence is limited. Our life and mentalities have a background that is too complex to be defined by whether we succeed because we are smart or we do not succeed because we are not.

Work Cited

Dweck, Carol. "Brainology. Transforming Students' Motivation to Learn." *Independent School Magazine,* National Association of Independent Schools, winter 2008, https://www.nais.org/magazine/independent-school/winter-2008/brainology/.

After Reading: Summarize; Evaluate

Complete the following exercises.

5. Review your annotations and write down what you feel are the two or three main strengths of the essay, as well as any areas that need improvement.
6. Did you have any questions about the writing? If so, write these down.
7. Do you feel Alvarez demonstrates a good understanding of Carol Dweck's ideas? Why or why not?
8. Do you feel Alvarez responds with her own original ideas and critical thinking to Dweck's ideas? Why or why not?

PEER REVIEW

An important strategy for becoming a strong reader, a skillful writer, and a critical thinker is to test your ideas by getting feedback from others. Writers often ask readers they trust to give them advice, such as what is working well, what is not clear, or what could be improved in the writing. For instance, in the chapter "The Writing Process," Mike Rose explains how he relies on "a diversity of readers" to give him "honest feedback" on his writing. "The College Reading and Writing and Learning Survey" in the chapter "Introduction to College Reading, Writing, and Thinking" includes "ask the instructor or a tutor to read my draft and give me feedback" as a strategy choice. This valuable feedback can be considered and then used to revise or edit the paper.

The process in which writers share their work with classmates and provide constructive criticism is called *peer review.* (A peer is someone of equal standing, so your fellow classmates are your peers.) A valuable part of the writing process, peer review requires careful reading, thoughtful writing, and critical thinking to provide the most effective, useful feedback. You can use the same annotation strategies discussed in this chapter to review your classmates' writing. That is, you can read to understand the writer's main ideas and examples and then read again to indicate strengths of the paper and where the writing could be improved.

Peer review involves at least two people: the writer of the paper that is being reviewed and the reader of the paper whose job it is to provide feedback. Each person must perform their role as best as possible by using the following strategies.

Strategies for Readers Giving Feedback

- **Stay focused.** Consider the assignment and whether the writing achieves the goal of the assignment.

- **Understand the writing.** Identify the writer's thesis and main ideas, as well as the examples.
- **Provide positive feedback.** Focus on strong aspects of the writing—anything you think the writer does well, such as clearly stating a main idea, giving support for ideas, writing strong sentences, or using original thinking.
- **Offer constructive criticism.** Reflect on how the writing could be improved—anyplace the writing is not strong, such as where the writer does not respond to the topic, strays from the main point, does not clearly explain the ideas from the reading, or writes unclear sentences.

Strategies for Writers Receiving Feedback

- **Read and reflect.** Consider the reader's comments and be sure you understand what these mean; ask for clarification if need be.
- **Own your paper.** Focus on feedback you believe reflects valid strengths or weaknesses of your writing. You do not need to accept all criticisms as valid; use your own good judgment and remember this is your paper.
- **Apply feedback.** Use feedback to improve your writing. If you can build on your strengths, then do so. If you can revise weak parts, then make changes.

Spotlight Activities

1. If you are currently working on a piece of writing for your English class or for any other subject, annotate the writing. Identify the main ideas and examples; then review the writing, looking for areas of strength and places where the writing could be improved. Use your annotations to help you improve the writing.
2. If you completed a writing assignment for your class, exchange your writing with a classmate. Read and annotate each other's papers to understand and evaluate the writing.

Credits

pp. 112–115: Alejandra Jimenez, The Good, the Bad, and the Math, 2015. Used with permission; **pp. 116–119:** Veronica Alvarez, Involuntary Resignation, 2016. Used with permission.

PART TWO

Essential Elements of Academic Reading and Writing

5 Summarizing Texts

6 Responding to Texts

7 Critically Evaluating Texts

8 Rhetorical Analysis

Spotlight on Student Writing: Synthesis Essay

CHAPTER 5

Summarizing Texts

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Read to summarize.
- Draft a summary.
- Revise, edit, check, and proofread a summary.

Theme: What Is the Purpose of a College Education?

The chapter "Active Reading" provided strategies for annotating and summarizing to support reading comprehension. You can build on these strategies to write a summary that others may read. For instance, sometimes summarized information is included in a research paper to provide background on an issue or in a speech to support an argument. Other times a summary may be a complete text, such as explaining a scientific theory on a biology midterm or restating key ideas from a political document on a history final.

In this chapter, you will learn to write a freestanding summary; that is, the goal of the writing is to summarize another text. Along the way, you will examine the chapter's theme of the purpose of a college education.

READING TO SUMMARIZE

When reading to summarize, an important goal is comprehension. To comprehend a text, you must understand the important words, the organization, and the main ideas. Reading a text several times allows you to deepen your understanding. With each reading, you can focus on different aspects of the text.

Applying Vocabulary Strategies

When reading about new subjects, especially in college, you will frequently encounter unfamiliar words. Strategies for Defining Unfamiliar Words outlines an approach to understanding words you may encounter in your reading.

Strategies for Defining Unfamiliar Words

1. **Make a first pass over the text.** That is, read to get the gist of the text. Get an overview of the content and structure of the reading. Mark unfamiliar words, but do not (yet) stop to define these. As long as you understand the main ideas of the passage, just keep reading.
2. **Read the text a second time.** On this reading, work hard to figure out the meaning of unfamiliar, unknown words. Use any of the following strategies, preferably in this order—context clues, word analysis, and the dictionary—to understand the meaning of words.
3. **Use context clues to figure out the meaning of unknown words.** Look first for context clues (information in the text) for the meaning of unknown words. Words are often defined in the reading passage; look for definitions in parentheses after a word or inside commas or dashes. For example, if in an article about brain activity you saw the phrase "synapses (connections between nerve cells)" you would know that synapses are the connections between nerve cells in the brain. Sometimes examples in the text can help you understand the meaning of key words.
4. **Try word analysis.** Word analysis, or breaking a word into parts, is one way to figure out the definition. For instance, if in an article about the brain you encountered the word *prefrontal cortex* you could deduce that prefrontal is the lobe before (*pre-*) the part of the brain that is in the front area (*frontal*) of the skull. This strategy works if you recognize parts of the word, such as prefixes and roots, and know their meaning.
5. **Use a dictionary to confirm or check the meaning of words.** If you feel you do not know the meaning of an unfamiliar word or are guessing the meaning, then turn to a dictionary to check the definition. Keep in mind there can be different dictionary definitions for a word. Read all of them and decide which is most appropriate for how the word is used in the reading. For instance, if you encountered the word *sheath* when reading about the brain and looked this up in the dictionary, you would select the definition that a sheath is a structure around a living tissue, and not that a sheath is a cover for a knife or sword, since living tissue exists in the brain.

Understanding a Reading's Structure

Understanding how a text is organized can help identify the main points, which in turn can help you summarize those points. Start by chunking the text to be summarized into logical groups. (Recall from the chapter "Active Reading" that chunking means grouping related sections—or *chunks*—of the reading.)

- First, identify the basic parts of the text, such as introduction, body, and conclusion (see the chapter "The Writing Product").
- Use main idea clues ("Active Reading"), such as headings and topic sentences, to pinpoint main ideas in the body of the text.
- If the text has section headings, these are good indicators of chunks of related ideas.
- A text without section headings requires you to find connections among related paragraphs; you can group and "label" related paragraphs with your own headings.
- Know that chunks can be one paragraph or many paragraphs.

Annotating and Summarizing Main Ideas

After you have read and reread to define unfamiliar words and understand the organization, you are ready to annotate and summarize the main ideas of sections.

- **Annotate** by underlining key words and phrases and topic sentences in each chunk of the reading. Use headings as clues to main ideas. For instance, a section titled "Overeating" might focus on college students' eating too many calories. (Tip: Use "Strategies for Locating Main Ideas" in the chapter "Active Reading" to locate main ideas.)
- **Summarize** by using your own words to restate the main idea of each chunk of the reading. As a rule, do not include details and examples, as these are not the main ideas. However, sometimes it is effective to combine specific examples into a generalization. For instance, you might summarize details about potato chips, soda, and French fries as "unhealthy snacks." (Use "Strategies for Summarizing" in "Active Reading" to annotate the text.)

Figure 5.1 illustrates how to read and annotate an article to (1) identify and define unfamiliar words, (2) recognize the organizational structure and chunk the reading, and (3) annotate and summarize the main ideas of each chunk. Each of these reading and writing strategies might have been accomplished in a separate reading of the article.

The article presents the author's view about the purpose of a college education. He speaks from his background as president of the Learn-Work Innovation at Kaplan College.

FIGURE 5.1 **Annotated Reading: Article with Chunking (shown by color brackets)**

Vocabulary Defined

Summary of Sections

What's the Purpose of College?
By Brandon Busteed

***Forbes*, 10 April 2019**

{Many Americans have begun to ask whether college is worth it. And who's to blame them? With college tuition rising at astronomical levels, it's reasonable to think prospective consumers will do a more careful "return on investment" calculation. But instead of asking whether it's worth it, we'd be better off asking a different question: what's the *purpose* of college? Without nailing this answer, it's impossible to discern whether it will be or was worth it. Even more importantly, being clear about the purpose of college also helps us make the most of it.}

People ask about the monetary value of college, when they should ask why go to college.

discern = perceive or recognize (dictionary)

Introduction

{The problem is that our national narrative about "college" has created a decidedly false dichotomy between the two primarily professed purposes of college. There is the camp that says college is about preparing a person for work—to help them get a good or better job. In fact, this is by far the most commonly cited reason for why Americans value higher education—to get a good job. The other camp says college is about more broadly preparing a person for success in life—to be an engaged and enlightened citizen capable of thinking critically and communicating clearly, ultimately able to thrive in their well-being. Make no mistake, many of us see the purpose of college as both a job-driven and a life-driven purpose. But our dialogue is horribly stuck in the muck of an either/or debate on these two fronts.}

dichotomy = a division between two things (context clues + dictionary)

Some people think college should enable people to find a career; other people think college should empower people in their lives.

First main idea section

{It's time to end the either/or debate and embrace the reality that college's purpose is both. College is about *both* preparing people for a job (and helping them advance their careers and earnings) *and* to thrive in their overall lives. Findings from a Gallup-Bates College study released today give us convincing evidence of the importance of both/and—as well as point us toward an improved framework for thinking about the purpose of college.

The author believes college should be about both having a good job and having a good life.

Framework = basic structure (context clues + dictionary)

What if the purpose of college is finding one's own, individual purpose? And what if achieving this is critically linked to finding purposeful work? Here are the study highlights:

The author cites a study for support.

- Eighty percent of college graduates say it's important to derive a sense of purpose from their work.
- Yet, only 38% of graduates strongly agree they have discovered work that has a satisfying purpose.
- For graduates with low levels of purpose in their work, only 6% are thriving in their overall well-being. But graduates with high purpose in their work are *ten times more likely* to be thriving in their well-being (59%)!
- The top two drivers of a graduate achieving purpose in their work are whether they had an applied job or internship and someone who encouraged their goals and dreams during college.
- These findings are true for all generations of graduates, but especially true for Millennials who are more likely to derive purpose from their work than other sources and in looking back on their college experience are more likely to regret not having had real-life work experiences.
- Finally, graduates who are reflective are 67% more likely to have purposeful work.}

The study shows that after graduating from college people want a meaningful job, and if they have a meaningful job they are happy with their lives.

Second main section

{What does all this tell us? It tells us that graduates value both purpose and work—and in fact, find the most purpose *in* and *from* work. It tells us that we still have a lot of room for improvement in helping graduates achieve purposeful work. It tells us that if you care about one's well-being, you'd be smart to help them find purposeful work—because that boosts their odds of thriving by ten times. It tells us there are two very, *very* important aspects of college that we should ensure no graduate misses the mark on: applied work experience and faculty, staff, and students who embrace a culture of caring about one another's goals and dreams. And it tells us that a classically liberal arts element of college (teaching students how to be reflective) is powerfully linked to their job success.}

College students want both a meaningful life and a meaningful career.

Colleges need to do better to help their students achieve both these goals.

Classical liberal arts = teaching students how to be reflective (context clues)

Third main idea section

{What more do we need to end the silly debate about the purpose of college as job training vs. life training? If we view it too narrowly as job training, we miss the purposeful elements that bring work to life. And if we view it too broadly as life preparation, we lose focus on the single most important aspect of bringing life to its fullest through work. Work is not just about a paycheck; it's also about a purpose. Helping graduates achieve purposeful work may indeed be the purpose of college.}

Conclusion

The purpose of college should be to help students gain a meaningful job that will give them a satisfying life.

DRAFTING A SUMMARY

Annotating a text is what you do for yourself, to help you read thoughtfully and understand what you read. When you write a formal summary, you write not only for yourself but also for an audience: your instructor. So, you must write carefully and correctly to ensure that your summary is complete and accurate.

Preparing to Write a Summary

Recall from the chapter "Active Reading" that a summary is a restatement of someone else's ideas, usually ideas in a reading. A summary puts the main ideas into your own words; a summary is shorter than the original reading; a summary restates *all* the main ideas in the reading.

Your annotations create a basic plan for your summary. In fact, if you have read and annotated the text, you have completed the first steps in "Strategies for Writing a Summary."

Strategies for Writing a Summary

1. Read the text several times.
2. Be sure you understand the reading, including all the important words.
3. Group or chunk related sections.
4. Identify the main ideas.
5. Rewrite the main ideas in your own words by composing a one- or two-sentence summary of each section.
6. Put the one- or two-sentence summaries together to create a draft.
7. Write an opening sentence that summarizes the overall main idea of the reading and identifies the source.

continued

8. Revise the draft summary for organization and main ideas.
9. Edit the draft for flow and transitions.
10. Check the draft for accuracy and originality.
11. Proofread the draft for clear and correct writing.

After reading and annotating the text, start drafting by combining the one- or two-sentence summaries of each section of the reading. Write these in the same order as in the original text to create a rough draft summary. Figure 5.2 shows a rough draft summary composed by combining the annotations on the reading.

Be aware that this rough draft is a start on a summary; it needs more polishing and proofreading to be acceptable.

FIGURE 5.2 Rough Draft Summary of Reading

People ask about the monetary value of college, when they should ask why go to college. Some people think college should enable people to find a career; other people think college should empower people in their lives. The author believes that college should be about both having a good job and having a good life. The author cites a study for support. The study shows that after graduating from college people want a meaningful job, and if they have a meaningful job they are happy with their lives. College students want both a meaningful life and a meaningful career. Colleges need to do better to help their students achieve both these goals. The purpose of college should be to help students gain a meaningful job that will give them a satisfying life.

Writing the Opening Sentence

In addition to summarizing all the main ideas throughout the article, you should state the overall main idea, or the *thesis* of the reading, in the opening sentence of a summary. This is not your thesis, but rather the author's thesis and often an expected convention in writing a formal summary.

How do you go about summarizing the reading as a whole in this way? First realize it is often not possible to write a thorough thesis on your first attempt. Rather, be prepared to take notes, draft, and revise the thesis.

- A good place to start is to jot down notes about the topic of the reading. Ask yourself, "What is the article about? What does the article tell readers about the topic? What are the main ideas?"

- Then, from these notes, create a sentence.
- Next, revise the sentence for completeness and clarity. You may need to write and rewrite until the sentence effectively expresses the main idea of the reading.
- Additionally, because you are summarizing ideas that are not your own, you must give credit to the source. The first sentence should include the author's name and/or the title of the reading, as well as a statement of the overall main idea. (See the section Academic Style: Introductory Phrases to Acknowledge Sources in the chapter "Introduction to College Reading, Writing, and Thinking" to review how to write an effective opening sentence.)

Figure 5.3 demonstrates the process for writing a summary thesis.

FIGURE 5.3 **Creating a Thesis for a Summary**

Notes about topic:

- *Purpose of college*
- *One purpose is finding a career*
- *Another purpose is finding meaning in life*
- *This doesn't have to be an either-or choice*

Sentence that combines notes:

The purpose of college can be both to find a career and to find a purposeful life.

Sentence revised for completeness:

The author rethinks the argument that college should be either to find a job or become a citizen by arguing that the purpose of college can be both to find a satisfying career and to find a purposeful, meaningful life, because these two goals are related since college graduates find meaning in their lives through purposeful work.

Sentence revised for conciseness and clarity:

The author argues that the purpose of college can be both to find a satisfying career and to find a purposeful life, because these goals are intertwined.

Sentence with source credited:

Brandon Busteed in his article "What's the Purpose of College?" argues that the purpose of college can be both to find a satisfying career and to find a purposeful life, because these goals are intertwined.

REVISING AND EDITING, CHECKING AND PROOFREADING A DRAFT SUMMARY

Once you have completed a first draft summary, including writing an opening sentence, you should revise it, checking for appropriate organization and accuracy. You should also edit sentences to create a smooth and logical flow of ideas. You must check that the summary is both accurate to the original text and written in your own words. Finally, proofread to ensure that the grammar and spelling are correct.

Revising

The organization of a summary should follow the same organization as the text being summarized. This is because a summary is not an original essay but a restatement of someone else's ideas. If you create a draft by writing your annotations in the same order in which the related ideas appear in the text, your summary should be correctly organized.

Also check for any vagueness, edit out unnecessary details, and be sure you have accurately represented the author's ideas. For instance, check for these common mistakes novice summary writers make and understand how to avoid them:

- **Vague:** Every sentence in a summary should restate a key idea from the original text. Avoid writing statements such as "The author talks about the purpose of college." Instead, state exactly what the author believes is the purpose of college.
- **Too detailed:** A summary should focus on main ideas, so it would be a mistake to include very specific details from a reading, even if these are interesting details, such as how 6% of college graduates who feel their work lacks purpose have satisfying lives.
- **Inaccurate:** Your goal as a summary writer is to restate the author's ideas. Check that you have not misrepresented the author, by writing a statement such as "The author cannot decide between two competing purposes for attending college," if the author believes there can be more than one legitimate reason to attend college.

Editing

If you compose a summary by putting together one- or two-sentence summaries of each section, you may find that each sentence reads like a separate idea. To address this issue, look for ways to make transitions between the different section summaries during the editing process. For a smooth flow of ideas, use transitional words and strategies to connect ideas between sentences and within a paragraph (see Academic Style: Making Writing Flow).

Notice, for example, how choppy the ideas are near the beginning of the draft summary in Figure 5.4. A more effective style uses transitions and connects ideas between sentences.

Checking

Before you put the finishing touches on your summary, you must ensure you captured the author's ideas accurately and used your own words to restate those

FIGURE 5.4 Revising Choppy Writing by Adding Transitions

Draft Summary (Choppy Writing)	Revised Writing (with Transitions)
People ask about the monetary value of college, when they should ask why go to college. Some people think college should enable people to find a career; other people think college should empower people in their lives. The author says that college should be about both having a good job and having a good life. The author shows a study for support. The study showed that after graduating from college people want a meaningful job and if they have a meaningful job they are happy with their lives.	*People question the monetary value of college, when they should ask instead what the purpose of college is. Some believe the purpose of college is to find a career, while other people think college should empower people in their lives. The author settles that debate by asserting that college should be about both having a good job and having a good life. For support,* the author cites a *study showing that after graduating from college people want a meaningful job and if they have a meaningful job they are happy with their lives.* (transition word; links information from one sentence to the next; transition word; links information from one sentence to the next; transition word)

ideas. You can do this by rereading the original text and checking your draft carefully against this. Remember, as in all your academic writing, you must give credit to your sources, whenever you use ideas or words from those sources. In a summary, credit the author's ideas by acknowledging the source in the opening sentence; then use your own words to restate those ideas.

However, often you can inadvertently copy phrases from the original passage and neglect to quote these. Since copying phrases from a source is a common error in summary writing and because this constitutes plagiarism, let's spend time looking at examples of what is an acceptable summary and what is not.

Patchwriting Plagiarism

Patchwriting is a term that describes writing that "patches" together pieces of an original text to create a new text. However, since the new text includes many phrases from the original and often in the same order, this is not acceptable. Read the original passage in Figure 5.5; then study the example of patchwriting. You should see that phrases from the original passage are incorporated into the patchwriting plagiarized summary and highlighted in bold. Even though these phrases may be

FIGURE 5.5 Example of Patchwriting Plagiarism

Original Passage	Unacceptable Summary
The problem is that our national narrative about "college" has created a decidedly false dichotomy between the two primarily professed purposes of college. There is the camp that says college is about preparing a person for work—to help them get a good or better job. In fact, this is by far the most commonly cited reason for why Americans value higher education—to get a good job. The other camp says college is about more broadly preparing a person for success in life—to be an engaged and enlightened citizen capable of thinking critically and communicating clearly, ultimately able to thrive in their well-being.	Busteed explains that **the problem is that** we have **created a false dichotomy between the two primary purposes of college: the camp that says college is about preparing a person for work** and **the other camp that says college is about preparing a person for success in life.**

changed somewhat ("created a false dichotomy" instead of "created a decidedly false dichotomy") the phrasing is so similar as to be considered plagiarism.

Copying without Quoting

Sometimes when you summarize, you may be tempted to "borrow" a writer's words or phrases. If so, you must quote these. A good rule is to quote three or more words in a row from the original passage.

Example of a Summary That Copies without Quoting

*Busteed explains how believing that there are only two opposing reasons to attend college—to discover a career or to become a well-rounded person—**creates a false dichotomy**.*

Comment: In this example, the phrase "creates a false dichotomy" echoes the phrase in the original passage: "created a decidedly false dichotomy." It would be more appropriate to incorporate the author's words and give him credit for these by quoting the phrase in the summary.

Proofreading

Lots of time and effort goes into writing a summary, starting with reading, understanding, and annotating the original passage, to drafting, revising, editing, and checking the draft. One final step, the proofreading stage, is crucial to creating a polished, professional summary. For one thing, if you created a rough draft summary by combining notes on the reading, you might find that not all sentences are clearly written. Check that sentences and verb tenses are grammatically correct.

- **Correct sentences:** When summarizing from annotations, you may find incomplete or sentence fragments. For example, the opening sentence in Figure 5.6 is a sentence fragment, because there is no subject after the introductory phrase. The sentence fragment can be corrected by including a subject before the verb, such as "the author."

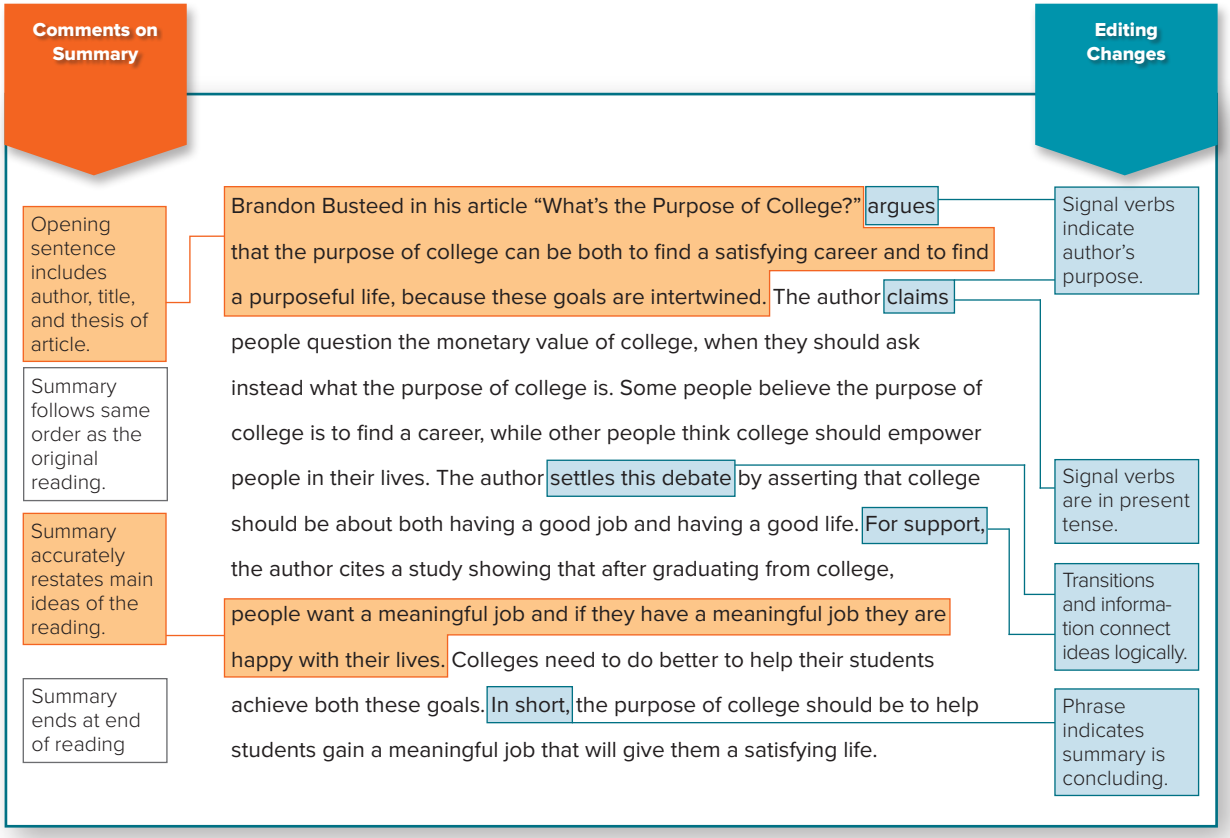
FIGURE 5.6 Example of a Corrected Sentence Fragment

Sentence Fragment	Correct Sentence
In the article "What's the Purpose of College?" argues that the purpose of college can be both to find a satisfying career and to find a purposeful life, because these goals are intertwined.	*In the article "What's the Purpose of College?" the author, Brandon Busteed, argues that the purpose of college can be both to find a satisfying career and to find a purposeful life, because these goals are intertwined.*

- **Verbs and verb tenses:** It is usual to write a summary in the present tense. So, for instance, you should write that "research *shows* . . ." (present tense) rather than "research *showed*" (past tense). As you read your summary, check that the verbs are in present tense and adjust any that are not. Finally, use strong signal verbs to indicate the author's thinking (see the chapter "Active Reading").

To review your final draft, use the Checklist for Revising, Editing, and Proofreading a Summary to assess the content, organization, and writing. In addition, check out Figure 5.7 to see how the rough draft summary was revised, edited, and proofread to create an improved final draft.

FIGURE 5.7 Final Draft Summary



Checklist for Revising, Editing, and Proofreading a Summary

1. Does the summary include *all* the main ideas?
   _____ Yes
   _____ No. Here is what is missing: _____
2. Does the summary follow the *same order* as the original reading?
   _____ Yes
   _____ No. Here is where it is out of order: _____
3. Is the summary written using *your own words*?
   _____ Yes
   _____ No. Here is where you need to use your own words more: _____
4. Does the summary *accurately* restate the main ideas?
   _____ Yes
   _____ No. This is why not: _____

continued

5. Does the summary include an *opening sentence* that gives the title and/or author and sums up the overall main idea?
   _____ Yes
   _____ No. This is why not: _____
6. Do the main ideas *flow logically*?
   _____ Yes
   _____ No. This is where you need transitions: _____
7. Does the summary include appropriate and present tense *signal verbs*?
   _____ Yes
   _____ No. This is where you need to change the verbs or the verb tense: _____
8. Is the summary written using *complete sentences*, no fragments?
   _____ Yes
   _____ No. This is a sentence fragment: _____

Academic Style: Making Writing Flow Logically

As a writer, you want your readers to move smoothly through your sentences. Readers should be able to follow your ideas and thinking. You can aid readers by creating writing that "flows." While you might think that adding transition words will make writing progress logically, that is not the only strategy you can employ to make your writing easy to read.

Note: The examples are written by a psychology student writing a paragraph about sleep and learning, the same topic used in the prewriting examples earlier in the chapter "The Writing Process."

Strategy 1: Keep the Focus of Your Sentences on the Topic of the Paragraph

If the paragraph is about sleep and learning, then include *sleep* or *learning* in most sentences. Doing this ensures that most sentences will focus on the topic of the paragraph.

Sleep is an important ingredient to help college students learn better. According to researchers, sleep helps the brain consolidate and retain information.

continued

Strategy 2: Link the End of One Sentence to the Beginning of the Next Sentence

If you end a sentence by writing about one topic, then begin the next sentence by writing about the same topic. In this way, you link ideas from one sentence to the next.

My first semester of college, I had a job that required me to work late and a class that required me to get up early. Rising at 6:30 a.m. to get to an 8:00 a.m. class on time meant that I was not well rested or in a mood to pay attention in class.

Strategy 3: Use Transitional Words and Phrases to Show the Relationships between Ideas

Transitional words and phrases, also known as **transitions**, show the relationship among ideas in a piece of writing. Selecting appropriate transitional words can help readers see the connection among ideas.

Many college students do not get enough sleep. In fact, the National Sleep Foundation estimates that 63% of college students are regularly sleep deprived.

SUMMARIZING AN ARTICLE

For additional practice in reading and summarizing a text, this chapter includes one more reading about the purpose of a college education. You can read, reread, and annotate the text to identify and define unfamiliar words; recognize the organizational structure; chunk the content; and summarize the main ideas of each section. Then draft a summary; create an opening sentence; and revise, edit, check, and proofread the summary.

READING SELECTION

"EDUCATION IS THE ANSWER TO MANY OF LIFE'S CHALLENGES"

Before Reading: Predict

Write the answers to the following questions using complete sentences

1. Read about the author and the overview of the reading. What do you think Donald Guy Generals will tell students about a college education?

During Reading: Analysis and Comprehension

2. Make a first pass over the text. That is, read to get an overall sense of the speech to understand the content, the structure, and the main ideas.
3. If there are any parts of the speech that are unclear or confusing, mark these with a question mark.

Education Is the Answer to Many of Life's Challenges

By Donald Guy Generals

Philadelphia Tribune, 9 September 2018

Donald Guy Generals, President of the Community College of Philadelphia, wrote the following article in response to a government report that asserted the "war on poverty is over." Generals argues that education not only lifts individuals out of poverty but sustains and supports whole communities, and therefore resources must be directed to low-income students.

Headline: "U.S. Government proclaims, the war on poverty is over." Really? 1

According to a report by the White House Council of Economic Advisers, historical standards for what constitutes poverty have improved and therefore the anti-poverty movement has been a success. While this analysis may take into account those historical factors that describe conditions of poverty, it grossly understates the human suffering and intergenerational character of poverty as viewed by those of us who continue to fight this insidious war. 2

Admittedly, a full understanding of poverty and the solutions for reducing the rate of poverty are not easy. Economists continue to debate about which factors contribute most to poverty: for example, is education the single most important factor causing poverty; or, are there other factors such as family structure, parental educational status, racism, class division and, or, social inequality? Can the pathway out of poverty be determined solely by the quality of education one receives; or, are there other variables that are equally determinant—and if so, where should our priorities lie? Of course this academic exercise has little real world relevance. Any practitioner in the war on poverty knows that it takes all of the above—all the time. In fact, to view education in isolation or independent of any other factors related to community life loses sight of its comprehensive and organic nature. Education is not an end in and of itself. It is a means to a far greater outcome: prosperous and healthy living, social equality, economic wellbeing. Quality education is infused throughout the life of the community extending far beyond the classroom. It can serve as the source for community problem solving, cultural and social advancement and economic prosperity. Since the Enlightenment and the advent of Western democracy, the purpose of education has been foundational to every aspect of community and personal life as well as future aspirations. 3

Creating a successful educational environment intended to advance the interests of our communities requires a vision that organically aligns our efforts both vertically and 4

horizontally. The vertical alignment between our educational institutions, or what is referred to as a K-16 model—must take into account what we already know about educational theory and student learning. New knowledge builds on prior knowledge and deep thinking requires synthesis, integration and application which are reinforced from one level of learning to the next. In an effort to build on this concept, the Community College of Philadelphia and the School District of Philadelphia engage in a number of early-college, dual enrollment and middle college initiatives. These programs have a high level of continuity between the high school and college level learning experience. On average, students who take part in the programs do better in college, graduate from college sooner and attack the cost of higher education head on. Aligning the school curriculum with workforce, business and community needs creates a horizontal alignment. Career and technical pathways provide students with the opportunity to take short-term certificates and then move directly into the workforce or parlay those certificates into higher levels of learning and credentials. Embedding civic engagement, internships and clinical rotations into the curriculum allows our students to apply their classroom learning experiences to real life conditions. Similarly, students are able to volunteer in the community whereby the community setting becomes part of their formal classroom—extending the educational reach of the college into the community.

5 The good news about higher education is that students who graduate with a post-secondary education have a life time earning potential 66 percent higher than those without a college degree. However, the current challenge is the expected gap between post-secondary degree attainment levels and the economy's need for a trained and educated workforce by 2025. According to the Lumina Foundation, 65 percent of new jobs will require some college education. Currently, only 46 percent of the adult population hold a post-secondary credential. Also, common thinking suggests that issues of access and opportunity have largely dissipated due to financial aid and the open access mission of the community college. That is not necessarily the case.

6 Poverty's reach inhibits too many who seek a college education and, more importantly, it impacts those who have managed to make it through the doors of the community college but then are confronted with life's conditions making it near impossible to succeed. Hunger, food insecurity, homelessness and housing insecurity have become far more common among college students. Colleges must provide support services that go beyond the traditional academic and student support programs. Community College of Philadelphia provides a food pantry for hungry students; the Single Stop program helps students to deal with housing issues, hunger and legal services. Our Foster Care project helps those who have aged out of the foster care system; and our Center for Male Engagement helps men of color confront the issues of racism and related institutional hostilities. There are many more programs and services provided by the College to help students succeed despite economic and social hardships. They are all essential components to a quality higher education experience.

7 Despite the obstacles caused by poverty, those who are able to persevere do quite well and therefore demonstrate the importance of a higher education credential in combating the scourge of poverty. For example, according to a New York Times article

in 2017, Community College of Philadelphia ranks within the 98th percentile of colleges whose graduates are able to move up the Social Mobility index by 2 or more income quintiles. This is a powerful indicator of the College's success and evidence of the impact higher education can have on poverty.

There is much to be proud of, but much needs to be done. Reducing the poverty rate requires a coordinated effort by institutions of education, government, business and civic enterprises. 8

After Reading: Engage with the Reading

4. What most interested you about Generals's remarks? Which of his ideas or examples resonated most with you?
5. Explain to what extent you agree or disagree with Generals's ideas about the ability of education to "answer many of life's challenges." Give examples from your own experiences to support your opinion.

Pair and Share

1. With a partner, review any parts of the reading that were confusing to you (from question 3) and try to clear up your confusion.
2. With a partner, compare your reactions to Generals's ideas about education (questions 4 and 5). Try to reach a consensus as to what is important about getting an education.

Activity 5.1 Analyze Prompts for Summarizing a Text

Read and rate the following essay prompts in order of interest to you. Keep your selected prompts in mind, as you will need to plan a summary based on one of these.

Solid Prompts

1. Write a summary of Donald Guy Generals's article "Education Is the Answer to Many of Life's Challenges."
2. Research and locate an article about a topic of interest and write a summary.
3. Research and locate a graph or infographic related to education and write a summary.
4. Research and locate a graph or infographic on a topic of your choice and write a summary.

Challenge Prompts

5. Write a summary of Donald Guy Generals's article "Education Is the Answer to Many of Life's Challenges." Then research and locate an article that

presents a different view about the purpose of an education. Write summaries of both articles.

6. Research and locate two articles that present divergent views about the purpose of a college education. Write summaries of both articles.
7. Find two articles from Part 5 of this textbook that present different views on a similar topic. Write summaries of both articles.
8. Research and locate two articles that present divergent views on a topic of your choice. Write summaries of both articles.

Activity 5.2 Apply Vocabulary Strategies for Defining Unfamiliar Words

Read the text you will summarize. As you read, keep a list of any words the author uses that are unfamiliar to you. Then, using one or several of the strategies described in "Strategies for Defining Unfamiliar Words," define these words. Read the selection again. With your new vocabulary at hand, did your understanding or experience of the reading change?

Activity 5.3 Identify and Summarize Main Ideas

Annotate the text you will summarize, identifying the main ideas and noting the "chunks" or sections either in the margin or in a separate document. Write one- or two-sentence summaries of each section of the text.

Activity 5.4 Draft a Summary Paragraph

Using complete sentences, draft an appropriate summary. See Figure 5.2 for an example of a draft summary.

Activity 5.5 Create a Thesis

Review your work from Activities 5.3 and 5.4. Then, using the process outlined in Figure 5.3, create a thesis. Incorporate that thesis into your draft summary.

Pair and Share

Exchange your draft with a partner. Read each other's work to evaluate its "flow." Refer to the strategies listed in the Academic Style box, "Making Writing Flow," and give one another feedback by each writing comments in the margins of the draft. Point out passages that are working well and places where the flow of the writing might be improved.

Activity 5.6 Check for Plagiarism

Review your work from Activity 5.5 and reread the original piece you are summarizing. Check carefully that you have not copied from the original without quoting or that your summary is not patchwriting. Revise as needed.

Activity 5.7 Proofread

Review your work from Activity 5.6 and read your summary, looking closely at sentences and verb tenses. Check that sentences are complete and that verbs are in the present tense.

Activity 5.8 Check Your Draft

Review your draft, answering each of the questions in the Checklist for Revising, Editing, and Proofreading. If you answered "No" to any of the questions, you likely have identified an area, or areas, that need improvement. Address those issues to produce a final draft.

Pair and Share

Exchange your draft with a partner. Read each other's work using the questions in the Checklist for Revising, Editing, and Proofreading to give one another feedback. Explain where and how the summary could be improved.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

patchwriting A form of plagiarized writing that "patches" together pieces of an original text to create a new text, but that includes many phrases from the original often in the same order, and therefore is not original writing.

transitions Words and phrases that show the relationship among ideas in a piece of writing.

Chapter Summary

- When reading to summarize, an important goal is comprehension. To comprehend a text, you must understand the important words, the organization, and the main ideas.

- After reading and annotating a text, draft a summary by combining notes on the main ideas with an opening sentence that identifies the author, title, and thesis of the reading.
- Revise, edit, check, and proofread a summary draft by paying attention to organization and accuracy; smooth and logical flow of ideas; originality of language; present tense and signal verbs; and complete sentences.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Reread and annotate this chapter. Then write a summary of it.
2. If you are taking another class that requires a textbook, read and annotate a chapter from that textbook. Then write a summary of that chapter.

Credits

pp. 127–129: Busteed, Brandon. "What's the Purpose of College?" *Forbes*, 10 Apr. 2019. https://www.realcleareducation.com/2019/04/10/what039s_the_purpose_of_college_47025.html. Used with permission; **pp. 139–141:** Generals, Donald Guy. "Education Is the Answer to Many of Life's Challenges." *Philadelphia Tribune*, 9 Sept. 2018. Used with permission.

CHAPTER 6

Responding to Texts

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Read critically.
- Identify types of support.
- Use the SOS organizational pattern—summary, opinion, and support.
- Draft a response essay.
- Organize and develop body paragraphs.

Theme: What Makes People Happy?

A **response essay** (also known as a reaction paper) is a common college assignment. A response paper is a short essay that conveys a reaction to one or more texts. Often its goal is to encourage reflection and critical thinking. In a health science class, students might reflect on an author's opinion that health care professionals must understand their patients' cultural backgrounds; or in a communications course, students may respond to a journal editorial claiming that social media facilitate bullying. Outside the classroom, film reviews, newspaper editorials, political debates, and online opinion pieces are also typical responses to others' ideas. These writings are an attempt to persuade people to think carefully about which ideas are sound and which are not.

In this chapter, you will read about research on happiness. The articles consider whether money makes people happy and whether having possessions or engaging in particular experiences produces happiness.

READING CRITICALLY

In a response paper, you will most likely do three things: summarize the material, give your reaction to it, and explain and support your response. When reading with the goal of responding, an effective strategy is to read the text at least three times.

1. First read to get an overview of the text. Summarize the author's main ideas and identify the support for these.
2. Second, assess the type of support the author uses to convince readers of the main ideas.
3. Finally, respond by considering to what extent you agree or disagree with the author's main ideas.

IDENTIFYING TYPES OF SUPPORT

Assessing support is one way to respond to an author's argument. Authors use support to convince readers that their main points are believable. If that support is strong, then it makes sense to agree with the author; if the support is weak, questioning the author's conclusions is a valid response.

Although there are different ways to categorize support, we will use four basic types, as identified by Professor Jennifer Hurley of Ohlone College. Hurley calls these "the four Es of support": factual **e**vidence, **e**xpert testimony, **e**xplanation, and **e**xamples. Most successful writers use a mixture of these different types of support to make their ideas convincing.

Factual evidence refers to grounds for belief based on the use of facts or statistics. A **fact** is a statement that can be proved true.

> Example of a fact: "Dunn and colleagues (2008) conducted three studies that examined the relationship between Americans' spending habits and their self-reported happiness" (Grohol, para. 2).
>
> **COMMENT:** This information can be checked; it is either true or false that three studies were conducted in 2008 by Prof. Dunn focused on Americans' spending and happiness, and therefore is a fact.

A **statistic** is a particular type of fact, one that is expressed in terms of numbers.

> Example of a statistic: "Nearly 60 percent of people living in the UK [United Kingdom] rate their happiness as at least a seven out of 10" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman).
>
> **COMMENT:** This is a statistic because it uses a percentage ("nearly 60 percent") and a numerical rating ("seven out of 10") to express a fact.

Expert testimony is the use of the words or ideas of an *expert*—a person or an organization with experience, knowledge, skill, and/or training in the subject or content area. The testimony can be a direct quote of the expert's exact words or a paraphrase of the expert's ideas.

> Example of expert testimony: At the end of an article about happiness and meaning in life, an author quotes the famous psychiatrist Carl Jung as saying, "The least of things with a meaning is worth more in life than the greatest of things without it" (qtd. in Smith).
>
> **COMMENT:** Because Jung is a famous psychiatrist, the quote is credible support from an expert.

Explanation involves expressing reasons why an idea is true. Explanation requires strong critical thinking or logical reasoning. Some common methods of explanation are using logical reasoning, imagining the possible consequences of certain actions, pointing out flaws in another person's argument, or making an analogy between two concepts.

> Example of explanation: To understand why people in developed countries are only slightly happier than people in less affluent societies, Pew researchers speculate that after a certain point, increasing income does not make as much of a difference in life satisfaction (Zolfagharifard and Gillman).
>
> **COMMENT:** The researchers provide an explanation for the data; the data are factual evidence, but the researchers' interpretation of these data is an explanation.

An **example** is a specific case that supports or illustrates the main idea or other ideas. Writers use examples to make writing clear and vivid; examples can also add emotional appeal. Examples may come from the author's own experience or observations or from an outside source, such as research or a reading.

> Example of an example: At the end of the reading selection "More Money *Does* Make You Happier," the authors include examples of two survey participants who comment on whether they feel money makes them happy (Zolfagharifard and Gillman).
>
> **COMMENT:** These honest comments of real people spark the reader's interest and help support the survey results.

Reading and rereading a text to identify the main ideas and support can begin the process of responding to a text. Put your reading skills to the test as you read—and reread—the first article about what makes people happy.

READING SELECTION

"MORE MONEY *DOES* MAKE YOU HAPPIER"

Before Reading: Ask Questions, Identify Audience

Write responses to the following exercises in complete sentences.

1. Consider the title of the essay, and freewrite about the relationship between money and happiness. Why might more money "make you happier"?

2. Review the information that immediately precedes the reading. Who is the intended audience? What clues help you identify the audience?

During Reading: Annotate, Find Main Ideas, Find Support

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

3. Annotate the reading by marking main ideas and support for the main ideas in the right margin. Identify the following types of support: factual evidence, expert testimony, explanation, and examples. (NOTE: Not all articles include all four types of support.)

More Money *Does* Make You Happier

By Ellie Zolfagharifard and Ollie Gillman

MailOnline, 30 October 2014

This news article, published online by a British news organization, reports on an international survey about happiness. The survey asked people in 43 countries to rate their happiness on a scale of 0 to 10, with 0 representing the most miserable life and 10 the best life. The results found that people in wealthy countries tend to be happier with their lives than people in poor countries, which inspired the headline "More Money Does *Make You Happier."*

More money does make you happier, with people from rich countries like Britain saying they are happier than citizens of poorer nations. 1

Nearly 60 percent of people living in the UK [United Kingdom] rate their happiness as at least a seven out of 10, higher than most other rich countries. However, some wealthy nations, including France and Japan, are still miserable, with barely half of their citizens happy with their lives. 2

Morale has dropped slightly in the UK, the report by the Pew Research Center, in Washington [DC] found. The number of people saying they were satisfied with their life dropped [one percentage point] from 59 percent to 58 percent, in the last seven years. 3

Germany saw a rise of 13 percent in the same time, possibly because Germans were less affected by the economic downturn than other Western nations. Meanwhile, only 43 percent of people surveyed in Japan said they were satisfied with their lives, while slightly more than half of the French said they were happy. 4

The only developed nations to have higher satisfaction levels than the UK were the U.S. and Israel, while the lowest ratings were found in Egypt, Kenya, and Tanzania. Emerging markets in Asia saw the biggest rise in citizens' satisfaction over the seven-year period, the global survey suggested. Levels of self-reported well-being in fast-growing 5

nations like Indonesia, China, and Malaysia now rival those in the U.S. and Europe, who traditionally topped the happiness charts.

And women in particular are growing more satisfied with their lifestyles as a result, the research found. 6

The study confirmed that rises in national income are closely linked to personal satisfaction. The pollsters asked people in 43 countries to place themselves on a "ladder of life," with a scale from 0 to 10 and the top rung [10] representing the best possible life and the bottom the worst. Pew carried out the same survey in 2002 and 2005 in most of those countries, enabling researchers to look at trends over time. 7

But the data also suggested that there is a limit to how much happiness money can buy. For example, 56 percent of Malaysians rated their life a "seven" or higher on the ladder, significantly more than the 36 percent in Bangladesh, a poor country. Yet the public in Germany, which has far higher gross domestic product per capita than Malaysia, expressed a life satisfaction level of 60 percent, just four [percentage points] more than Malaysia. 8

While wealth appears to contribute to happiness, other research has indicated it is far from the only factor. Women tend to be happier than men, for example, and unmarried and middle-aged people tend to report lower levels of well-being than married and younger people, respectively. 9

The Pew survey [was] based on 47,643 interviews in 43 countries with adults 18 and older between March and June. It found that people in emerging and developing economies prioritize a few essentials in life, including their health, their children's education, and safety from crime. Fewer people in those economies said Internet access, car ownership, free time, or the ability to travel is very important in their lives. 10

The survey saw significant gains in personal satisfaction in Indonesia, where 58 percent of those polled placed themselves on the seventh-highest rung of the "ladder of life" or above, up from 23 percent in 2007 [and in] Malaysia, where 56 percent put themselves in that same upper range, up from 36 percent seven years ago. In Vietnam, which wasn't included in the 2007 survey, 64 percent said they were on the seventh-highest rung or above. The Associated Press asked people in those three nations what they thought of the findings. 11

"Money can't secure happiness," said Nguyen Thi Mai, 66-year-old retired teacher from Vietnam. "There are people who don't have any money, but they lead a happy life because family members love and respect each other. But there are rich families where husbands and wives often quarrel and children are addicted to drugs." 12

"Money can buy lots of happiness for me because I am very materialistic," said businessman Tony Wong in Malaysia. "But that's not the only thing that makes me happy. Money is number one on my top five list, followed by health, family, dogs, and friends." 13

After Reading: Summarize, Reflect on the Text

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

4. Review your annotations of the main ideas. Write a brief summary of the reading.
5. What is the purpose of this article? How do you know?
6. Review the reading again, and annotate by jotting down your reactions to the ideas and support in the left margin.

Engage with the Reading

Complete the following exercises.

1. The reading begins by stating that "people from rich countries like Britain [say] they are happier than citizens of poor nations" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). What support in the article confirms this statement? Is there any support that contradicts this statement?
2. In the middle of the reading, the authors note that "other research has indicated that [wealth] is far from the only factor [that contributes to happiness]" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). What other factors, according to the reading, influence people's happiness?
3. At the end of the reading, the authors quote two individuals: a teacher from Vietnam who says, "Money can't secure happiness" (qtd. in Zolfagharifard and Gillman) and a businessperson from Malaysia who says, "Money can buy lots of happiness" (qtd. in Zolfagharifard and Gillman). Which person's opinion do you agree with more? Give support for your answer.

USING THE SOS ORGANIZATIONAL PATTERN

Responding to a reading can be challenging because you must develop your own original thoughts. Having a specific strategy for writing a response can be valuable. One approach is to respond to the author's *main ideas* by stating whether you agree or disagree with those ideas and why. You can do this by following the SOS pattern, which stands for "summary, opinion, support," when writing a paragraph or paper (Figure 6.1).

FIGURE 6.1 SOS Response Organizational Pattern

Summary	A brief summary of, or quotation illustrating, the main idea to which the responder is reacting.
Opinion	A statement of whether and to what extent the responder agrees or disagrees with the main ideas.
Support	Evidence for the responder's opinion, such as the four **Es** of support: factual evidence, expert testimony, explanations, and examples.

Summary

A response usually begins with a brief summary of an idea or example from the source to which the writer is responding. The summary may be necessary because some readers may not be familiar with the original source. Yet even if readers have read the original text, a summary both refreshes their memory of the main ideas and focuses the writer's response. In place of a summary, the responder

might choose to quote (for instance, to capture a person's precise words). The responder must judge whether a summary or quotation is the most compelling way to introduce the main idea from the reading.

SUMMARY: The article "More Money *Does* Make You Happier" reported on a Pew Research study that surveyed people in 43 different countries and found that having more money makes people happier (Zolfagharifard and Gillman).

Opinion

After the summary, the responder states an opinion about the source—for instance, saying how much he or she agrees or disagrees with the main ideas. The responder's opinion can be stated indirectly, as in the assertion "Those who feel money buys happiness are misguided." Or it may be expressed directly, for example, by writing "I agree" or "I disagree."

However, whether it is appropriate to use the first-person pronoun (*I*) in your own writing will depend on the assignment, your audience, and your instructor's directions. Be aware that in academic writing, the first person is often thought to be inappropriately informal and unprofessional.

OPINION: Money cannot always make people happy.

Another consideration when giving an opinion is to **qualify** your response to a main idea, which means to modify, limit, or restrict it. In other words, you might believe that the author's idea is correct in certain situations but not in others. For example, you might agree that money makes people happy, but only up to a certain point. Once people have enough income to eat well, live comfortably, and support their family, more money may not make for more happiness. Think carefully about whether you agree or disagree with an author's idea and to what extent.

QUALIFIED OPINION: Money allows for a certain level of material comfort but cannot make people truly happy in their personal lives.

Strategies for Indicating Agreement or Disagreement

Since it can be tricky to successfully state your opinion without using the words "I agree" or "I disagree," you might try using one of the following sentence patterns to respond to an author or to an argument.

Sentences Indicating Agreement

The argument is strong/logical/well reasoned because . . .

The author is correct/accurate/convincing because . . .

continued

Sentences Indicating Disagreement

The argument is weak/illogical/misleading because . . .

The author is incorrect/mistaken/unconvincing because . . .

Sentences Indicating Some Agreement and Some Disagreement

While X [state the idea you agree with] is true/valid/relevant, it is also important to consider [state why you disagree].

Although the author rightly/accurately/reasonably asserts [state the idea you agree with], the author is not correct/right about [state the idea you disagree with].

Support

In a response, you must also provide support for your own ideas. In fact, most of a written response should be devoted to supporting your ideas with facts, statistics, examples, explanations, and/or expert testimony. For instance, if you believe that money contributes to personal happiness, you might use *factual evidence*, such as statistics from surveys, to show that higher-income people report greater happiness than lower-income people. Or you might use an *example* of a person who is well off and happy. You might further *explain* how money can buy a student a good education, allow a family to go on a vacation, or enable a young couple to purchase a home, all of which can contribute to personal happiness.

SUPPORT: In the Pew survey, people in some developed countries, such as France and Japan, indicated that "barely half of [them are] happy with their lives" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). In contrast, people of some less developed countries, such as Malaysia, indicated that more than half of them are happy. These survey results show that there is not a simple connection between having money and being happy. As a teacher who is quoted at the end of the article explains, "There are people who don't have any money but they lead a happy life because family members love and respect each other. But there are rich families where husbands and wives often quarrel and children are addicted to drugs" (qtd. in Zolfagharifard and Gillman).

Once you have gone through the steps of summarizing the main idea, giving your opinion about the main idea, and then supporting your opinion, you can put these elements together to create a response paragraph as shown in Figure 6.2.

Finally, look for the SOS pattern when you are reading a response, and use it to write a response. Be aware, though, that these three elements do not always appear in this exact order.

FIGURE 6.2 **Sample Response Paragraph**

The article "More Money Does Make You Happier" reported on a Pew Research study that surveyed people in 43 different countries and found that having more money makes people happier. However, this conclusion is misleading, because money cannot always make people happy. For instance, in the Pew survey, people in some wealthy countries, such as France and Japan, indicated that "barely half of [them are] happy with their lives" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). In contrast, citizens of some less well-off countries, such as Malaysia, indicated that more than half of them are happy. These survey results show that there is not a simple connection between having money and being happy. As a retired teacher at the end of the article explains, "There are people who don't have any money but they lead a happy life because family members love and respect each other. But there are rich families where husbands and wives often quarrel and children are addicted to drugs" (qtd. in Zolfagharifard and Gillman). Money may not make people happy with their families or their personal lives. As we know from the Beatles, money can't buy us love.

READING SELECTION

"CAN MONEY REALLY BUY HAPPINESS?"

Before Reading: Ask Questions, Identify Purpose

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Consider the title of the essay; freewrite to answer the question, "Can money really buy happiness?"
2. Consider the information that immediately precedes the article: When you read the text, will you be instructed, informed, or persuaded, or some combination of these purposes?

During Reading: Identify Text Organization

Write responses to the following exercise using complete sentences.

3. As you read and reread, annotate the article's organizational pattern. In particular, identify where in the reading the author (a) summarizes or quotes from other readings or other people's ideas to which he is responding, (b) gives his opinion, and (c) supports his opinion.

Can Money Really Buy Happiness?

By John Grohol

PBS This Emotional Life

On his blog post, the author, a psychologist, discusses research related to the connection between money and happiness. He both summarizes that research and responds to it with ideas of his own. Grohol is on the editorial board of the journal CyberPsychology & Behavior *and is a founding member of the Society for Participatory Medicine.*

It turns out that whoever said money can't buy you happiness was wrong. 1

Money can buy you happiness, as long as you give some of the money away, or use it for an experience rather than buying a product. 2

Dunn and colleagues (2008) conducted three studies that examined the relationship between Americans' spending habits and their self-reported happiness. The first study was a national survey conducted on 632 Americans that asked respondents to detail their income and spending habits. The participants were also asked to rate their general happiness level. 3

The researchers found that two things were significantly correlated with greater general happiness levels—higher income and spending on gifts for other people or money given to charity. Although past research has been inconsistent in its finding that people who are rich generally are happier than people who are less well off, more recent research finds that the wealthy are indeed considerably happier than those with average or poor incomes (Lucas & Schimmack, 2009). 4

One could argue, "Well, hey, of course having more income can make you happy . . ." But maybe it's related to either the dollar amount given or the fact that people who are more likely to give money to others or to charity are just inherently happier people by character. So the researchers set out to examine those hypotheses in two separate follow-up experiments. 5

In a small, second study, 16 employees were asked about their general happiness levels before and after receiving their annual bonus. No matter what the size of the actual bonus, employees who spent more of their bonus money on others or charity reported greater general happiness levels than those who spent more of it on themselves. 6

Finally, in a third study of 46 people, researchers discovered that participants who were directed to spend a small amount of money on others (either $5 or $20) reported greater feelings of happiness than those who were directed to spend the same amounts on themselves. Again, the dollar amount didn't matter. 7

The third study suggests that even when the choice isn't ours, we still feel the happiness effects of giving away money to others—even when the actual value is small. 8

Other recent research sheds more light on the relationship between happiness and money, too. For instance, Nicolao et al. (2009) found evidence that confirmed previous research that we are also generally happier when we spend money on experiences—like a vacation—rather than material things. But here's the catch—we're happier only when those experiences are positive (not so much when they are negative). 9

So indeed, money can buy you happiness—as long as you give some of it away. A good thing to keep in mind this holiday season. 10

References

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Lucas, R. E., & Schimmack, U. (2009). Income and well-being: How big is the gap between the rich and the poor? *Journal of Research in Personality, 43*(1), 75–78.

Nicolao, L., Irwin, J. R., & Goodman, J. K. (2009). Happiness for sale: Do experiential purchases make consumers happier than material purchases? *Journal of Consumer Research, 36*(2), 188–198.

After Reading: Summarize

Complete the following exercise.

4. Review your annotations and write a brief summary of the reading using complete sentences.

Engage with the Reading

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Do you agree with the author's assertion that money can buy happiness "as long as you give some of the money away, or use it for an experience rather than buying a product"? Why or why not? What support can you give for your opinion?
2. At the end of the article, the author points to research indicating people are "happier when [they] spend money on experiences—like a vacation—rather than on material things." Do you agree with this finding? What support can you give for your opinion?
3. The second research study included 16 people; the third study had 46 participants. Do you think that studying 16 or 46 people is a sufficient number on which to base conclusions about most people? Explain why or why not.
4. Which reading do you find more convincing—"More Money *Does* Make You Happier" or "Can Money Really Buy Happiness?" Explain your answer.

DRAFTING A RESPONSE ESSAY: THE SOS ORGANIZATIONAL PATTERN

Although a response paper might be more personal than other types of academic papers, it must nonetheless follow the basic structure of essay writing, including having an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion. Just as you can use

the SOS (summary, opinion, support) pattern to write a response paragraph, you can apply the SOS pattern when writing essays.

For instance, you can use the introduction to summarize the ideas to which you will respond. You will want to present the author's idea in an *objective* manner—that is, in factual statements rather than in statements based on your own opinions. This step demonstrates that you accurately understand the author's idea.

Then, as your thesis statement, respond to the reading's ideas by stating your opinion clearly and in a way that separates your idea from that of the author's. You can indicate indirectly whether you agree or disagree by writing a statement such as "More money can buy happiness, but only if the money is spent wisely." Alternatively, if it is appropriate to use first person in your writing, you can state directly "I agree" or "I disagree."

Next, support your own ideas in body paragraphs, devoting most of your response to this part of your essay. For instance, if you agree (or disagree) with the author, provide support of your own (factual evidence, expert testimony, explanation, and/or examples) for your ideas. If you believe that the author's support is, or is not, convincing, then explain why. In the body paragraphs, you may need to quote or summarize more material from the original source.

Finally, end with a conclusion that summarizes the main points of your response and leaves readers with a sense of closure.

Following the SOS pattern can help you develop the first draft of a response essay. Once you have completed a draft, you will want to review it and revise as needed. The checklist in "Strategies for Writing a Response Essay" outlines the elements of an effective written response to a reading.

Strategies for Writing a Response Essay

_____ Does the essay summarize or quote a main idea from the text?

_____ Does the essay clearly state an opinion about the main idea?

_____ Does the essay give factual evidence, expert testimony, explanations, and/or examples for support?

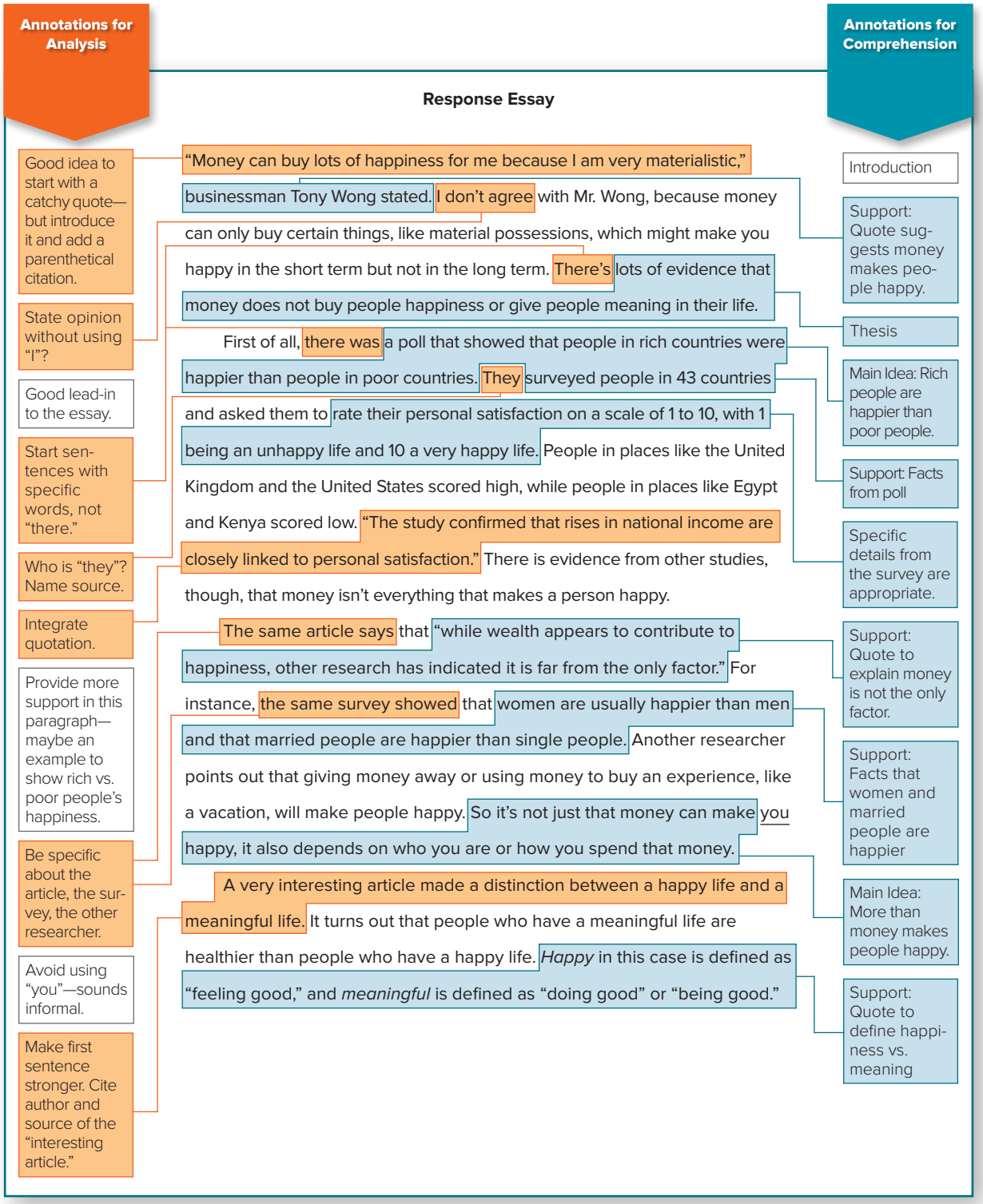
_____ Is the essay logically organized (with an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion)?

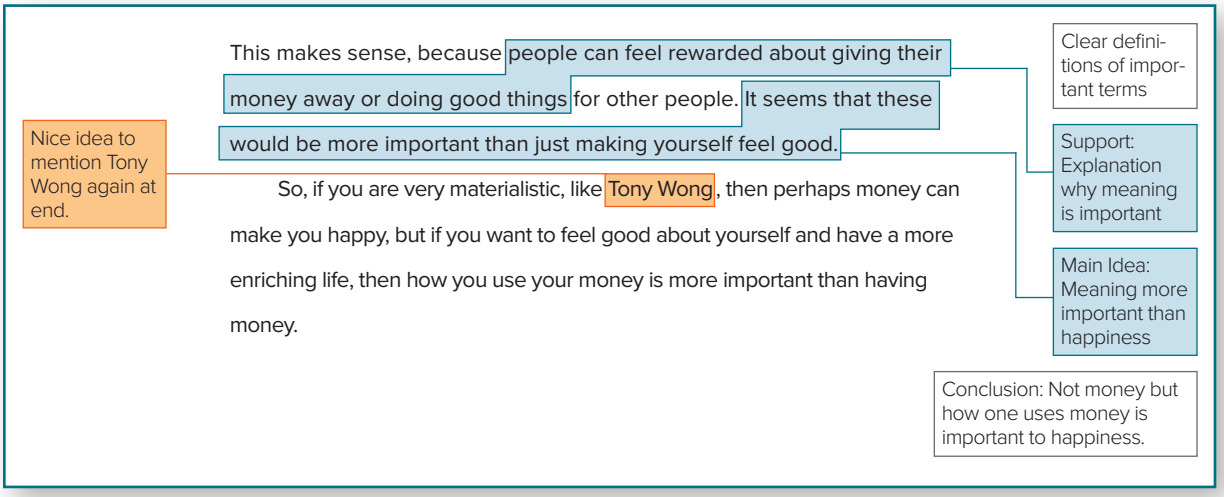
_____ Are the sentences clearly written, and are the transitions from one idea to the next smooth and logical?

_____ Has the writing been revised for unity and coherence, and proofread for errors?

Review the draft of a response essay in Figure 6.3. The draft has been annotated at the left to point out places where the draft is successful or where it might be improved. On the right margin are annotations to identify the thesis, main ideas of the body paragraphs, and support to indicate ways the draft could be made more effective.

FIGURE 6.3 Draft of a Response Essay





ORGANIZING AND DEVELOPING BODY PARAGRAPHS

For all essay types, including response essays, you need to make good decisions about which ideas you will respond to first, second, third, and so on in the body paragraphs. In a response essay, you are building a case for your position in relation to the text to which you are responding. You want to proceed in a logical order. Here are some strategies for ordering body paragraphs to ensure a successful outcome.

Chronological Order

Some essays are best organized in **time order**, also called **chronological order**. Among these are **narrative essays**, those that tell a story. Opting for a chronological order might also make sense for a response essay.

For instance, if you are composing a response to a series of surveys about people's happiness, you might write about the earliest surveys in the first few body paragraphs and then use later paragraphs to examine how subsequent survey results have changed, and why.

Climactic Order

Another organizational strategy, especially for argumentative or persuasive essays, is **climactic order**, which involves beginning the body paragraphs with the weakest point and working up to the strongest point. An essay using climactic order builds to a *climax*—a high point—and leaves readers with a powerful last impression.

For instance, in an argument claiming that money can buy happiness, you might point out in the first body paragraph how money can put food on the table. In the second body paragraph, you might explore how money can pay

the rent and other living expenses. These early body paragraphs lead into paragraphs on what you might argue is money's most important benefit: funding an education. In turn, you might say, putting money into education can lead to a satisfying career that can create lifelong meaning and happiness. By ending with money's key benefit (paying for an education), the one most likely to produce both a happy and a fulfilling life, you have built up to your most compelling point.

Climactic order can also be employed in reverse. Sometimes it is effective to begin an essay with a powerful point to get the reader's attention or to impress upon the reader the importance of the topic. For example, beginning an essay with examples of how the lack of money sometimes forces people to choose between two important things—such as buying essential prescription medicines and paying the rent—might also be an effective organization for illustrating how having money can help people lead happier lives.

Simple-to-Complex Order

With **simple-to-complex order**, you begin your body paragraphs with a point that should be easy for readers to grasp and then proceed in later paragraphs to more difficult points. This way, you start readers on familiar ground before introducing complexity.

Notice that the reading selection "More Money *Does* Make You Happier" begins with the straightforward idea that more money makes people happier. However, as the article progresses, it is clear that this equation is not so simple: people in rich countries are sometimes only a little bit happier than their counterparts in developing countries. Moreover, wealth is not the only factor in determining happiness, because women tend to be happier than men. In this way, the reading proceeds from the most obvious to the least obvious points.

Development of Depth and Detail

Whereas *order* refers to the sequence of paragraphs in an essay, particularly the body paragraphs, *development* refers to the depth of information within paragraphs, particularly the body paragraphs. Whether they are writing a response essay or some other type of essay, most beginning writers make the mistake of not providing enough factual evidence, expert testimony, explanations, or examples to support their ideas. In fact, the most convincing essays often include a variety of evidence drawn from the four Es of support.

Notice, for example, that the reading selection "More Money *Does* Make You Happier," while providing a lot of *factual evidence* in the form of information and statistics from a Pew Research study, also *explains* the results of the study (why people in some countries are more or less happy) and provides *quotations* from ordinary people about the survey results. Thus, this short article uses several types of support.

Figure 6.4 shows how the response essay in Figure 6.3 could be revised to be more effective.

FIGURE 6.4 **Revised Response Essay**

Money Can't Buy Happiness

An article first published in the British news source *The Daily Mail* in October 2014 reported on an international survey revealing that people from rich countries described greater levels of satisfaction with their lives than did people from poor countries. The article's title, "More Money *Does* Make You Happier," implies that being rich equates with being happy (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). However, that title is misleading: while having money can make a person happy, other evidence suggests how people spend their money or whether people have meaning in their life is more important than being rich.

The international survey, conducted by the Pew Research Center, questioned people in 43 countries and asked them to rate their personal satisfaction on a scale of 0 to 10, with 0 being a miserable life and 10 a very happy life. People in places like the United Kingdom and the United States, where incomes are high, scored high, while people in places like Egypt and Kenya, where incomes are low, scored low. Because of this connection, "The study confirmed that rises in national income are closely linked to personal satisfaction" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). In other words, rich people seem to be happier people.

However, in this same article there is evidence that questions this simple connection. The authors explain: "The data also suggested that there is a limit to how much happiness money can buy" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). For instance, Germans, who are generally well off, rated their lives only a few percentage points higher than people in Malaysia, where incomes are not as high. Also, other evidence suggests that income is not the only factor that influences one's happiness. For example, the same survey showed that women are usually happier than men and that married people are happier than single people (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). At the end of the article, Nguyen Thi Mai, a retired teacher from Vietnam, is quoted as questioning the link between money and happiness: "There are people who don't have any money but they lead a happy life because family members love and

FIGURE 6.4 Revised Response Essay (*continued*)

respect each other. But there are rich families where husbands and wives often quarrel and children are addicted to drugs" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). Nguyen is correct: money cannot guarantee a happy family or a healthy lifestyle.

Moreover, evidence from other studies suggests that having money does not make a person happy. John Grohol, PhD in psychology, reports on studies that show money can make people happy *only if* they give their money away or use that money to buy an experience, such as a vacation, rather than buying a product. This makes sense. When I think of the things that have made me the happiest in my life, I think about experiences I have had, such as traveling to Hawaii with my family. We hiked the rugged Na Pali coast trail; we snorkeled in blue waters and saw amazing colored fish; we laughed and played on the beach. In contrast, I cannot remember any possession I bought as giving me such fond memories or making me feel connected to the people I love or to the natural world around me.

Perhaps there are people who truly enjoy having money and being rich. Tony Wong, a businessman from Malaysia, seems to be one of these, as he says, "Money can buy lots of happiness for me because I am very materialistic" (qtd. in Zolfagharifard and Gillman). Mr. Wong claims that money is at the top of his list of things that make him happy, followed by "health, family, dogs, and friends" (qtd. in Zolfagharifard and Gillman). But maybe Mr. Wong has his priorities mixed up. After all, he puts his dogs before his friends. For those of us who are not "very materialistic"—who care more about people than possessions—having money may not be as important as having people we love and friends we can depend on. The idea that friends and family are a greater source of happiness than money is confirmed in part by research in *The Wall Street Journal*. In the article, a San Francisco State University professor, Ryan Howell, explains that while people may *think* material possessions will give them lasting happiness, in fact his studies show people are happier when they buy experiences, like vacations or concert tickets,

FIGURE 6.4 Revised Response Essay (*continued*)

than when they buy products (Blackman). In the same article, Thomas Gilovich, a psychology professor at Cornell University, confirms Howell's research and explains that when experiences are "shared with other people [they] giv[e] us a greater sense of connection" (Blackman). In other words, human relationships and experiences are more important than possessions for true happiness.

So for people who are very materialistic, like Tony Wong, perhaps money can make them happy. But for people who want to be happy and have a more enriching life, then how to use money is more important than having money itself. Money can't buy happiness or health; give it away or enjoy it with your family and friends instead!

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Activity 6.1 Analyze Prompts for Writing a Response Essay

Read and rate the following essay prompts in order of interest to you.

Solid Prompts

1. The first reading selection in this chapter, "More Money *Does* Make You Happier," reports on the Pew Research Center's international survey of life satisfaction. The title of that reading gives the conclusion that "more money *does* make you happier" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman). Write an essay directed at your classmates in which you summarize the survey findings. State whether you agree or disagree that more money does make people happier, and why.
2. At the end of the reading selection "More Money *Does* Make You Happier," two individuals are quoted. One says, "Money can't secure happiness," and the other says, "Money can buy lots of happiness" (qtd. in Zolfagharifard and Gillman). Write a response to **either** person, stating that you either agree or disagree about whether money can buy happiness. Explain your view.
3. In the second reading selection in this chapter, "Can Money Really Buy Happiness?" John Grohol concludes, "Money can buy you happiness, as long as you give some of the money away, or use it for an experience rather than buying a product". Do you agree that giving money away or spending money on experiences can make you happier than keeping money or buying material possessions? Write a response to Grohol in which you agree or disagree with his conclusion, and give reasons for your response.
4. Locate an article on a topic of your choice about which you feel strongly and write a response. In your response, state to what extent you agree or disagree with the author and why.

Challenge Choices

1. Consider both the reading selections in this chapter. Write a response in which you state to what extent you agree or disagree with the authors' findings and why.
2. At the end of the reading selection "More Money *Does* Make You Happier," two individuals are quoted. One says, "Money can't secure happiness," and the other says, "Money can buy lots of happiness" (qtd. in Zolfagharifard and Gillman). Write a response to **both** people, stating that you either agree or disagree about whether money can buy happiness. Explain your view.
3. Locate two articles on a topic of your choice about which you feel strongly and write a response to these readings. In your response, state to what extent you agree or disagree with the authors' ideas and why.

Activity 6.2 Prewrite about the Prompts

Review the prompts in Activity 6.1. Select one prompt and do some prewriting on the topic.

Activity 6.3 Draft a Response Paragraph

Keeping in mind the prompt you selected, write a paragraph using the SOS organizational pattern. In your paragraph, respond to one of the main ideas from the reading selection.

Pair and Share

- Read your SOS paragraphs from Activity 6.3 and analyze the paragraph by asking these questions: (1) Is the *summary* accurate and detailed? (2) Is the *opinion* clearly stated? (3) Is the *support* sufficient and convincing?

Activity 6.4 Analyze Drafts

Review Figure 6.3 ("Draft of a Response Essay") and Figure 6.4 ("Revised Response Essay"). Then answer the following questions using complete sentences.

1. What improvements have been made in the revised response essay in Figure 6.4? That is, in what ways is the writing more effective than in the draft in Figure 6.3? Note at least three positive changes, and explain how they improve the essay. In particular, consider paragraph order and development.
2. Use the checklist "Strategies for Writing a Response" to evaluate the revised response essay in Figure 6.4. Does the revised draft fulfill the items in the checklist?

Activity 6.5 Draft a Response Essay

Review your work from Activities 6.1 through 6.4 and draft a response essay.

Activity 6.6 Check Your Draft

Review your draft using the checklist in "Strategies for Writing a Response." Note what areas you feel are strong and what areas you feel need improvement.

Pair and Share

- Exchange your draft with a partner. Give one another feedback by each writing comments in the margins of the draft. Point out passages that are working well and places where the writing might be improved. Make specific and helpful comments.

Activity 6.7 Revise Body Paragraphs for Order and Development

Review your essay draft from Activity 6.5 to complete the following exercises.

1. Consider whether the body paragraphs in your essay draft are in an effective order. What order did you use? Would revising the order make the essay more effective?
2. Review your essay draft and judge whether there is sufficient support throughout and especially in each body paragraph. Recall the four Es of support and consider how you might use them to strengthen your support. Are there places in the essay where more specific information can be added to bolster your support?

Pair and Share

- Exchange your essay draft with another student. Use the checklist in "Strategies for Writing a Response" to evaluate each other's essays.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

climactic order Organization that begins with the weakest point and works up to the strongest point.

example A specific case (from personal experience, observation, reading, or research) that supports or illustrates an idea.

expert testimony The words or ideas of an *expert*—a person or an organization with experience, knowledge, skill, and/or training in a particular subject or content area.

explanation The expression of reasons why an idea is true through the use of critical thinking or logical reasoning.

fact A statement that can be proved true or false.

factual evidence Grounds for belief based on the use of facts (statements that can be proved true or false) and/or statistics (facts expressed in terms of numbers).

narrative essay An essay that tells a story.

qualify To modify, limit, or restrict a statement, such as by making exceptions.

response essay An essay that gives personal reflections to and demonstrates critical thinking about a text.

simple-to-complex order Organization that begins with a point that should be easy for readers to grasp and then proceeds to more difficult points.

statistic A fact that is expressed in terms of numbers.

time order (chronological order) Organization according to time, such as oldest to newest or newest to oldest.

Chapter Summary

- When reading to respond to a text, you must read critically to identify the main ideas, examine the support the author uses to convince readers of the main ideas, and consider to what extent you agree or disagree with the main ideas.
- Writers use a variety of evidence—specifically factual evidence, expert testimony, explanations, and examples—to support ideas.
- A common organizational pattern for writing a response is SOS (summary–opinion–support), which involves summarizing a main idea or support from the reading, stating your opinion as to whether you agree with the idea or the support, and giving support for your response.
- You can use the SOS organizational pattern to draft a paragraph or an essay in response to a reading.
- You should take care to determine the most logical order for the body paragraphs in a response essay and develop the paragraphs in depth, with sufficient detail.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Imagine that you have been asked to participate in a debate at your school about happiness. Your audience is your fellow students. The debate topic is “Money Can Buy Happiness.” Would you agree with this proposition? Why or why not? Write a multiple paragraph speech to your fellow students presenting your ideas, along with support. Take whatever position you want, and defend it.

2. If you completed the first chapter activity, consider how you could respond to the position you took and defended in question 1. Write a multiple paragraph speech explaining why you disagree with the position you took in your speech and give support for your response.

Work Cited

Smith, Emily Esfahani. "Meaning Is Healthier Than Happiness." *The Atlantic*, 1 Aug. 2013, www.theatlantic.com/health/archive/2013/08/meaning-is-healthier-than-happiness/278250/.

Credits

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CHAPTER 7

Critically Evaluating Texts

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Read critically to evaluate different types of support.
- Use relevant criteria to critique support.
- Write a critique essay.
- Revise for effective development and support.

Theme: How Can We Help People Who Are Unhoused?

Whereas the chapter "Responding to Texts" discussed responding to a reading by agreeing or disagreeing with an author's main ideas, this chapter focuses on **critique**, which involves examining and evaluating the support and reasoning underlying the author's main ideas. A critique is much like a response, except that a critique focuses primarily on an author's support, while a response focuses on the writer's ideas.

Your college classes will often require you to think critically—say, about a text, a work of art, a theory, or an argument. Critique provides a method for such analysis. In an art class, for example, you might critique a painting or photograph to understand why it is considered a masterpiece; in a political science class, you might critique presidential campaign ads to understand voter appeals. Outside academia, professional reviewers critique new music and movies to help potential customers decide if they want to spend their money on these entertainments. In each case, a critique examines something to arrive at a judgment about it.

In this chapter, you will read about policies to end homelessness; specifically, you will read an article explaining the Housing First program and a critique of that program. In the process, you will learn how to evaluate an author's use of support and write a critique.

READING TO CRITIQUE

Just as you need to read and reread a text before responding to the author's ideas, you need to read and reread a text before critiquing the author's support. As you read recursively in this way, consider different aspects of the text.

1. A first reading provides an overview by focusing on the main ideas and the author's support for them.
2. A second reading examines how the author supports the main ideas, identifying the different types of support.
3. A third reading concentrates on critiquing the support by using appropriate criteria.

CRITIQUING SUPPORT

Authors use support to prove that their main ideas are valid. So, if their support is weak, you could argue that the authors' main ideas are weak because they are not adequately proved. Conversely, if the authors' support is strong, you might respond that they have a powerful argument.

How can you determine if an author's support is strong or weak? One strategy is to use **criteria** to evaluate the support. First, identify the type of support. (Recall from the chapter "Responding to Texts" "the four Es of support": factual evidence, expert testimony, explanation, and examples.) Then, apply the appropriate questions to evaluate that type of support.

To illustrate how to apply these questions, we will focus on arguments related to the chapter theme of how to help homeless people.

Critiquing Examples

Examples can make writing vivid and interesting. They can show that main ideas are true, that they happen in real life. Nevertheless, examples are often considered the weakest form of support. Main ideas supported only by examples, especially examples from personal experience (sometimes called **anecdotal evidence**), may not be reliable because such examples are limited. Usually examples are used along with facts, statistics, or expert testimony to make a more convincing argument.

Questions to Evaluate Examples

- **Are the examples realistic or typical?**
  Authors are limited as to how many examples they can give, so those that are provided should be representative or typical of other examples. For instance, if an author provides an example of a person who is unhoused because of job loss, to be convincing that person should represent a typical case.

continued

- **Are the examples convincing?**
  Although it might seem obvious that an author should provide only convincing examples, sometimes an example is not on topic. For instance, in an article about causes of homelessness, if an author gave an example of a family displaced from their home because of war, that would be weak support to explain why individuals in a country not at war are unhoused.
- **Is there a sufficient number of examples?**
  Determining whether there are enough examples to prove a main idea depends on how large the author's claim is versus how much support is provided. For instance, if the author makes a small or narrow claim—such as arguing that the job training program in the local community is an effective means to prevent homelessness—then the author may only need a couple of examples of individuals who have successfully completed the program and remain housed to support the claim. However, if the author has a bigger main claim—for instance, arguing that a national job training program can effectively prevent homelessness—then one or two examples of local people would not be sufficient. Readers would need to see examples of job training programs in various cities nationwide that included different people before being convinced.

Critiquing Expert Testimony

Evaluating expert testimony involves determining whether the person or organization whose ideas are being quoted or paraphrased is reliable. Reliability can be assessed by looking at a person's or group's **credentials**, or qualifications, to make an informed opinion, such as education, expertise, experience, and objectivity. Ideally, information about a source's credentials can be located in the source itself, for instance, in the headnote, in a summary of the author's background, or in the reading itself. If no information is given about a source's credentials, you may need to research the source to determine whether it is credible.

Questions to Evaluate Expert Testimony

- **Does the expert have a noteworthy level of education on the subject?**
  If a person's education has involved studying a topic or discipline for a substantial period of time—say, many years—that individual probably has developed expertise in it. For example, a sociology professor might be considered an expert on unhoused communities.

continued

- **Has the source conducted research in a relevant area?**
  Research usually indicates that a person has studied a topic or field deeply. Research is **peer reviewed**—that is, examined by experts in the same field—to determine its reliability and hence its acceptability for publication. For example, a journal article analyzing statistics about rates of homelessness would be trustworthy.
- **Does the person have firsthand or other experience related to the topic?**
  Direct personal observation or firsthand experience is often the basis for identifying facts and understanding the significance of facts in context. So, for example, a news reporter who interviews homeless people in shelters would have **credibility**.
- **Is the expert unbiased—that is, free of association with individuals or groups that might make the expert in favor of or against the subject?**
  Being objective, and therefore fair, gives a person credibility. In contrast, having an association with a group that represents only one side of an issue might indicate bias and thus lack of credibility. For instance, a neighborhood group might not be reliable spokespersons on the safety of building a homeless shelter in their community. A researcher studying the connection between homeless shelters and community safety would more likely be unbiased.

Critiquing Explanation

Explanations come up often in readings. Sometimes writers explain how facts, statistics, examples, or expert testimony supports their main ideas. They use reasoning to help readers see the connection between the support and those main ideas. Other times writers anticipate how readers will criticize their ideas. In such cases, they might explain why those criticisms are wrong.

Questions to Evaluate Explanations

- **What are the author's reasons for believing the main ideas?**
  The author should be able to explain why each main idea is valid. For instance, if the author argues that providing housing for people will be effective to end homelessness, then the author should explain why or how housing will solve the problem of homelessness.

continued

- **Does the author respond to expected criticisms of the main ideas?**
  Many ideas are debatable. Successful writers anticipate criticism by raising those objections and responding to them. For instance, an author who argues that more support services will alleviate homelessness should deal with the likely criticism that support services would cost money.

Critiquing Factual and Statistical Evidence

Facts and statistics are usually considered strong evidence because we assume they are true. However, that does not mean we cannot question them, especially their source and accuracy. Moreover, sometimes facts and statistics can be presented in a misleading way.

Questions to Critique Facts and Statistics

- **What is the source of the facts or statistics?**
  Facts and statistics should come from reputable sources to be convincing. Be suspicious of facts stated by unnamed "experts," as well as statistics that come from unidentified "research." Facts and statistics should originate with named sources that readers can check.
- **How up to date are the facts or statistics?**
  Often the date of facts and statistics is important. For example, a statistic from five years ago showing the number of unhoused people in New York City might be out of date if the rate of homelessness has increased over the past several years.
- **How precisely and meaningfully stated are the facts or statistics?**
  Facts and statistics should be specific, precise, and meaningful. For instance, using a statistic that gives too wide a range, such as noting that 5% to 25% of unhoused people suffer from mental health issues, is not precise and meaningful because there is a significant difference between 5% and 25%. Also avoid presenting factual information in an ambiguous way. For example, to say that 100,000 unhoused people suffer from depression or addiction is misleading because it is not clear how many suffer from depression versus how many suffer from addiction.

The annotated article "What Housing First Really Means" (Figure 7.1) is both an explanation and a defense of a program called Housing First. In this piece, a blog post on the *National Alliance to End Homelessness* website, the writer relies on explanations and experts to support his position; the main ideas and support are annotated in the following example.

FIGURE 7.1 **Annotated Article Identifying Main Ideas and Support**

Main Ideas and Support

What Housing First Really Means
By Ben Cattell Noll

***NAEH,* 18 March 2019**

No two people experience homelessness the same way. Some have a mental health diagnosis, some do not. Some are living with addiction, others are not. Some spend each night in shelter, while others sleep in doorways, cars, or encampments.

Yet, everyone experiencing homelessness shares one thing in common: they do not have a safe or appropriate place to live.

Main idea = Homeless people lack housing

Similarly, it is unlikely that any two people have the same path out of homelessness. Some will find long term stability by reconnecting with family or friends. Others will find new housing, get a new job, or connect with benefits that quickly allow them to exit homelessness on their own. Some will need more intensive supports like rapid re-housing or permanent supportive housing to help them find housing, pay for it, and maintain it.

Yet, there is one thing that can resolve anyone's homelessness crisis: reconnecting with permanent housing.

Main idea = Housing can solve the problem of homelessness

Housing First (Not Housing Only)

This is what we mean by Housing First: that homelessness is a problem with a solution, and that the solution is housing. For everyone. Whether you follow the rules or not. Whether you are "compliant" with treatment or not. Whether you have a criminal record or not. Whether you have been on the streets for one day or ten years. Permanent housing is what ends homelessness. It is the platform from which people can continue to grow and thrive in their communities.

Housing First is a philosophy that values flexibility, individualized supports, client choice, and autonomy. It never has been housing only, and it never should be.

Supportive services are part of the Housing First model. That might include formal support services, like a doctor, therapist, or social worker. It might involve informal supports, like connecting with family, friends, or faith groups.

But, in Housing First, these supports are not prescribed; people have the agency to select the supportive services they need and want, tailoring their supports to their own unique situation.

Qualified main idea = Providing housing along with offering voluntary support services can solve the problem of homelessness

One Size Does Not Fit All

However, in communities across the country, many service providers, politicians and concerned citizens continue to dismiss Housing First as a "one-size-fits-all" approach. Oddly enough, the alternatives recommended frequently include approaches like transitional housing, or drug and alcohol treatment programs. By their very nature, these approaches assume people experiencing homelessness have a predictable set of needs and must complete a prescribed process in order to be "ready" for housing.

Summarizes criticisms that Housing First is a "one-size-fits-all" solution

The Housing First approach is the polar opposite of a one-size-fits-all approach. Nothing in the Housing First philosophy precludes someone from pursuing the services, supports and housing that they need and want. If those services include mental health or addiction treatment, they are connected to it. If the housing they want is sober living, they are free to select it. Nobody is required to participate in a service that they do not want in order to receive or retain housing. In fact, requirements like these would assume a singular, "one-size-fits-all" path from homelessness to housing.

Responds to criticisms of Housing First approach

The Leaders Agree

In his plenary speech at the 2019 Solutions for Individual Homeless Adults National Conference in San Diego, Matthew Doherty, Executive Director for the U.S. Interagency Council on Homelessness (USICH) provided a passionate defense of the model:

Expert testimony, USICH director

"We have the opportunity to not waste precious time on endless debates regarding whether Housing First works for 'this population' or 'in this community' and to resist bogus arguments that a focus on Housing First imposes a one-size-fits-all solution on people or programs. We can speak the real truth that Housing First approaches are the opposite of one-size-fits-all and help ensure that we don't leave anyone behind."

He was echoed later in the conference by Housing and Urban Development (HUD) Secretary Ben Carson who stated that "the evidence then and now supports Housing First."

Expert testimony, HUD Secretary

USICH recently issued a "resource roundup" of some of the best articles, videos and tools to help communities understand and implement the Housing First model. It is a great place for anyone to start to gain an understanding of the principles and practice of the approach.

Simple, but Not Easy

Housing First is not easy. Recruiting landlords is not easy—especially when applicants have limited income or credit, or a history of evictions. Helping someone re-learn the intricacies of tenancy is not easy. Navigating a bureaucracy to secure mental and physical health care is not easy.

But, Housing First is simple. Nothing in any person's history or present precludes them from being able to be housed.

While the challenges to getting into that housing and maintaining it may be many, the goal is the same: housing is the solution to homelessness.

Main idea = Housing can solve the problem of homelessness

PREPARING TO WRITE A CRITIQUE ESSAY BY EXAMINING SUPPORT

You can begin a critique by reading carefully, understanding the author's thesis, and identifying the types of support for the thesis, as in the example annotated article. Then apply questions for different types of support by taking one of two approaches:

- Examine *all* the support.
- Focus on the *most important* support.

Examination of All Support

Evaluating all of a writer's support involves identifying the different types of support throughout a reading and applying the key questions for each. With this procedure, you will not overlook any support, and you may discover new ideas. For instance, to examine the full range of the support for the reading selection in Figure 7.1, a reader should apply the questions for critiquing expert opinion, to appraise the reliability of the quoted experts and to examine the explanations by applying the appropriate questions.

Examination of the Most Important Support

Sometimes the most important support in a reading is obvious. For instance, the selection in Figure 7.1 includes two quotations from two different experts. Moreover, because these quotations appear in a section titled "The Leaders Agree," it is clear they are being used to support the author's position. Examining the use of expert testimony would be a strategic place to begin a critique.

In addition to annotating, you can critique the support by "pulling out" information from the text and embedding it into a chart or graphic organizer, or creating a list. These tools have the advantage of focusing on the support and the critique of the support. Although it might seem like more work to create a chart (Figure 7.2), an organizer, or a list, these strategies allow you to organize your writing and thinking and can pay off in the form of a thoughtful critique essay.

Remember that information about an expert's credentials may be located in the source itself or by researching the expert to determine the credentials.

FIGURE 7.2 Chart to Critique Expert Opinion in a Reading

Questions for Critiquing Expert Opinion	Critique of Expert Opinion: Matthew Doherty
• What **education** does the expert have?	Doherty has a master's degree in public administration from the University of Washington.
• Has the expert **researched** the subject?	No research, but Doherty was appointed by President Barack Obama to lead the U.S. Interagency Council on Homelessness.
• Does the expert have **firsthand experience** with the topic?	Doherty has worked with various homeless agencies.
• Is the expert **biased**?	Doherty most likely has a liberal bias given that he was appointed by a Democratic president (Obama) and later fired by a Republican president (Trump).

DRAFTING A CRITIQUE ESSAY USING THE SOS PATTERN

You might find the SOS (summary-opinion-support) organizational pattern reviewed in the chapter "Responding to Texts" useful for structuring a critique essay.

- **Summarize** (or paraphrase or quote) support from the reading in an objective way. This step demonstrates that you accurately understand the author's support, reminds readers of the original reading, and focuses the critique.
- State your **opinion** on the support by applying appropriate criteria and then identifying to what degree the support is effective or ineffective. One strategy is to turn the questions for critiquing support into statements. For instance, you can state, "The author does not provide a sufficient number of examples" or "The quote is convincing because it comes from a credible expert."
- **Support** your evaluation. For instance, if you believe the author does not provide a sufficient number of examples, then point out how many examples are included, why that number is insufficient, and what would be a more convincing number. Conversely, if you believe that the author's support is convincing, then explain why and give supporting details from the reading to show why.

Composing an effective critique essay can be challenging. You will want to review your annotations, reading notes, and writing notes to build a first draft. If you feel uncertain about how to proceed, try following the basic plan for a critique essay in Figure 7.3, in which each body paragraph applies the SOS pattern.

FIGURE 7.3 Basic Plan for a Critique Essay

1. Introduction
   - 1.1. Give background information about the topic
   - 1.2. Introduce the reading under critique: provide author's name and title
   - 1.3. State thesis: your opinion of the support in the reading
2. Body paragraphs [NOTE: Write as many body paragraphs as needed for a complete critique of the reading using the following steps for each paragraph]
   - 2.1. Summarize an important piece of support
   - 2.2. Give your opinion of that support
   - 2.3. Support your opinion by explaining why the support is effective or not
3. Conclusion
   - 3.1. Briefly sum up your critique of the reading
   - 3.2. End with a thoughtful observation about the topic

To understand how to write a critique, it can be helpful to read and examine a critique. In a report titled *Housing First and Homelessness: The Rhetoric and the Reality*, Stephen Eide, senior fellow at the Manhattan Institute, critiques the "Housing First" policy that he claims has "come to dominate the government response to homelessness."

Note that Eide's paper uses the *Chicago Manual of Style* (CMS), rather than MLA, to cite sources. In CMS, in-text citations are indicated with a superscript number at the end of a sentence that leads to a source listed at the end of the paper.

READING SELECTION

EXAMPLE CRITIQUE

Before Reading: Predict

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Consider the title of the report and the heading in the excerpt. What will the author argue in his report and in this section of the report?

During Reading: Annotate

2. As you read and reread, annotate the article's organizational pattern. In particular, identify where the author introduces the reading under critique and where he summarizes and critiques support.

Housing First and Homelessness: The Rhetoric and the Reality

By Stephen Eide

April 2020

Stephen Eide is a senior fellow at the Manhattan Institute for Policy Research, a nonprofit, public policy think tank. Following is an excerpt from a multipage report by Eide examining the policy known as "Housing First." In the executive summary, Eide writes, "This report contributes to the debate over homelessness policy by assessing Housing First's rhetoric—the claims made by proponents—in light of the available evidence."

III. Cost-Effectiveness

One of the most famous statements in defense of Housing First came in Malcolm Gladwell's 2006 *New Yorker* article "Million-Dollar Murray."[74] This article, which the 1

Bush administration had a hand in setting up,[75] detailed the struggles of a "high utilizer": a man in Reno, Nevada, whose homelessness and alcoholism placed a costly burden on the local healthcare and criminal-justice systems. The central claim of Gladwell's article was that homelessness was "easier to solve than to manage" because placing people in permanent housing will lead to less usage of other service systems—most notably, hospitals and jails, thus saving money. Similar cost-savings claims have been central to the rhetoric over ending homelessness.[76]

2 But in the academic literature, the cost-savings argument for Housing First is treated with more skepticism. Here is an area where RCT-level [randomized-control trial] rigor truly matters. Studies that have a "pre-post" design look at the reduction in costs of hospitals, jails, and so on, that result when a cohort is moved from the streets to stable housing. Homeless people who are put into permanent supportive housing programs often have extraordinarily high health costs immediately before their placement. But someone who costs the healthcare system $100,000 in a given year is not necessarily going to cost the healthcare system $100,000 every year of his adult life.[77] The reduction in costs, following a high utilizer's housing placement, may have as much to do simply with a "regression to the mean" than the virtue of the Housing First/PSH intervention.[78]

3 Moreover, high utilizers such as Million-Dollar Murray and people with untreated schizophrenia who have lived for years on the street are unrepresentative of the homeless population as a whole. Not only a minority, they are a minority of the chronic homeless.[79] They are certainly unrepresentative of the "working poor" or "down on their luck" homeless often cited in the media. The 2015 Family Options Study, prepared for HUD, examined various housing interventions among a pool of more than 2,000 homeless families with moderate social needs, over a three-year period. The permanent housing intervention was more successful in achieving housing stability than temporary housing interventions, but it was also more expensive.[80]

4 Governments can't save costs from people who don't make much use of expensive service systems, to begin with. Some homeless may have low service costs because they're "service-resistant," a particularly significant problem for the mentally ill. Another reason that many of the homeless may be low utilizers is that they live in a jurisdiction with limited mental health and substance-abuse services[81] (states vary dramatically in their investment in behavioral health).[82] "Usual care," the control with which some studies compare Housing First interventions, can vary widely between jurisdictions. "Usual care," in the case of New York City, means a $2 billion shelter system. But, in other communities, to build a Housing First–oriented homeless services system might mean building the first homeless services system that they ever had.[83]

5 This is not to say that homeless services systems shouldn't focus on "high utilizers," or that, in some cases, they may yield short-term savings on jails and hospitals for certain individuals. But Housing First's success with different homeless populations has been cited as evidence of its merit as a systemwide organizing principle, applicable for the entire homeless population.[84] The evidence is weak that a systemwide application of Housing First—for the benefit of the many different types of homeless people—would generate net savings for taxpayers.

Notes

74. Malcolm Gladwell, "Million-Dollar Murray," *The New Yorker* (February 5, 2006).
75. Dennis P. Culhane, "The Costs of Homelessness: A Perspective from the United States," *European Journal of Homelessness* 2, no. 1 (December 2008): 105.
76. Ibid., "Among advocates for the homeless in the US, a truism has long held that homelessness is more expensive to society than the costs of solving the problem." Philip Mangano, quoted in Erik Eckholm, "New Campaign Shows Progress for Homeless," *New York Times* (June 7, 2006): "Cost-benefit analysis may be the new compassion in our communities."
77. Tracy L. Johnson et al., "For Many Patients Who Use Large Amounts of Health Care Services, the Need Is Intense Yet Temporary," *Health Affairs* 34, no. 8 (August 2015): 1312–19; National Academies, Permanent Supportive Housing, 4, 17, notes very large differences between what RCTs have found vs. what prepost studies have found in terms of both cost savings and health.
78. Ly, "Housing First Impact on Costs," 482; Stefan G. Kertesz et al., "Permanent Supportive Housing for Homeless People–Reframing the Debate," *New England Journal of Medicine* (December 1, 2016): 2116.
79. Kertesz and Johnson, "Housing First: Lessons from the United States," 224: "Housing First can almost 'pay for itself,' but only when it targets a costly clientele who represent only a very small portion of the chronically homeless."
80. Daniel Gubits et al., "Family Options Study: 3-Year Impacts of Housing and Services Interventions for Homeless Families," HUD, Office of Policy Development and Research, October 2016, exhibit 9-5: 114.
81. Culhane, "Costs of Homelessness," 103–4.
82. HHS, Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration, "National Mental Health Services Survey (N-MHSS): 2017 Data on Mental Health Treatment Facilities" (August 2018); Jaffe, D.J., and E. Fuller Torrey, "Funds for Treating Individuals with Mental Illness: Is Your State Generous or Stingy?" (December 12, 2017). mentalillnesspolicy.org.
83. Culhane, "Costs of Homelessness," 103: "Areas with more limited public services overall may well have fewer costly service users among the people who are homeless, meaning that there are few costs to offset as a result of an intervention."
84. See "Letter to the Honorable Darrell Issa," HUD (August 9, 2017): 3–4.

After Reading: Summarize and Evaluate

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

4. Where does the author summarize the policy that he is critiquing? Do you feel his summary is fair and objective?
5. What is the author's criticism of this policy? Do you believe his criticisms are clearly stated?
6. How much space in the critique does the author devote to explaining his critique, and what support does he give? Do you feel his explanations and support are convincing? Why or why not?

REVISING A CRITIQUE FOR DEVELOPMENT AND SUPPORT

Revision is a crucial step for writing a strong critique. An effective critique explains clearly, concisely, and completely why an author's support is convincing or not. Keep these key guidelines in mind:

- Be clear about which piece of support you are critiquing.
- If summarizing or paraphrasing, specifically restate the author's support.
- When quoting, include enough information so the reader of your critique can recall the context for the quotation.
- When identifying to what degree the support is effective or not, use a concise statement such as "This example is convincing" or "The facts are not from a named source."
- Finally, when explaining your evaluation, detail your thinking completely. Explanation is one area where writers often underdevelop their arguments. Assume that not all readers will evaluate the evidence in the same way and you must therefore explain your thinking fully. Moreover, even if readers evaluate the support in the same way as you, they often appreciate having the critique described in detail.

Compare the following two examples of an excerpt from a critique that examines Ben Cattell Noll's statement on the *National Alliance to End Homelessness* website in support of the Housing First policy (Figures 7.4 and 7.5). Notice how the second example (a revised draft) is more effective than the first (an early draft) because the revised version presents a more complete, more in-depth judgment.

FIGURE 7.4 **Early Draft: Ineffective Critique**

The author quotes two experts in support of the Housing First policy. Quoting these experts is convincing because they both have experience with housing policy.

Comment

Although this critique identifies the use of expert testimony as "convincing" because both experts "have experience with housing policy," the writer provides no details about these experts or their involvement with housing policies.

FIGURE 7.5 Revised Draft: Effective Critique

In one section of his blog titled "The Leaders Agree," the author quotes two experts in support of the Housing First policy. The first expert, Matthew Doherty, was appointed by President Obama to serve as the Executive Director for the United States Interagency Council on Homelessness, while the second expert, Ben Carson, was appointed by President Trump to be the Secretary of Housing and Urban Development. Quoting these experts is convincing because they both have experience with housing policy at the national level. Moreover, one was appointed by a Democratic president, the other by a Republican president, which makes this bipartisan support of Housing First compelling evidence in its favor and proof that "leaders" do indeed agree with this policy.

Comment

This critique is specific about the credentials of the experts quoted in the reading and considers other criteria, such as possible bias, when assessing the strength of using these experts for support.

Academic Style: Quote Sandwich

The chapter "Responding to Texts" focused on integrating quotations into your sentences. When you select quotations, you should explain to readers why that quotation is important. Do not assume readers will know; it is your responsibility as a writer to provide an explanation of how the quotation supports your point or why the quotation is significant. You can think of writing a "quote sandwich" with a layer before the quotation, the quotation being the filling, and another layer after the quotation. This is a pattern to follow:

continued

- Introduce the quotation: provide context for the quotation and give the source.
- Integrate the quotation: make the quotation a part of your own sentence.
- Follow up the quotation with your own words and ideas: explain how the quotation proves your point or why it is significant.

Quote Sandwich	Comments
Arguing that the Housing First policy is not cost effective, Eide points to a 2015 Family Options study which found that "permanent housing intervention was more successful in achieving housing stability than temporary housing interventions, but it was also more expensive." Eide seems to undercut his own argument with this evidence, since although providing permanent housing was more costly, it was also found to be successful in creating stable lives for formerly unhoused families.	*Context for quotation* *Integration of quotation* *Explanation of quotation*

Tips for Writing a Quote Sandwich

Here are some phrases you can use to introduce a quotation:

- The author states/argues/claims . . .
- According to [author] . . .
- In the article [title of article] . . .
- According to [author] in the [article] . . .

These are some phrases you can use to begin your explanation:

- In other words, [author] believes . . .
- The essence of this argument is . . .
- In short, this means . . .

Activity 7.1 Pick a Prompt

Review the essay prompts, rate them in order of interest to you, and select one.

Solid Prompts

1. Write a critique of Ben Cattell Noll's blog post "What Housing First Really Means." What is most effective about his post? What is least effective?
2. Write a critique of the excerpt from Stephen Eide's report "Housing First and Homelessness." What is most effective about the report? What is least effective?
3. Select any of the readings in this book and write a critique of the article. Be sure that the article is making an argument (rather than informing the reader) and using sufficient evidence to make the critique worthwhile.

Challenge Choices *These prompts are more challenging because they require research and engagement with multiple texts.*

4. Write a critique of both Reading Selections assessing the use of support. Arrive at a conclusion as to which reading is more convincing than the other.
5. Locate and write a critique on Stephen Eide's complete report, "Housing First and Homelessness: The Rhetoric and the Reality."
6. In the Reading Selection "Housing First and Homelessness," Eide mentions Malcolm Gladwell's 2006 *New Yorker* article, "Million-Dollar Murray." Locate Gladwell's article and write a critique on it.
7. Select any two readings in this book that are on a similar topic and critique both readings. Be sure that the readings are arguments (rather than informing readers) and use sufficient evidence to make the critique worthwhile. Then arrive at a conclusion as to which reading is more convincing than the other.

Activity 7.2 Identifying Main Ideas and Support in a Reading

Read the text several times. Annotate the reading using Figure 7.1, "What Housing First Really Means," as a model for how to annotate the text.

1. Annotate for the main ideas and support.
2. Identify the types of support.

Activity 7.3 Critiquing Support in a Reading

Review your annotations from Activity 7.2 and refer to the questions for critiquing support (pages 169–172).

1. Locate a place in the reading where the author uses an example for support. Critique it by applying at least one of the questions for critiquing examples.

2. Locate expert testimony that the author uses for support. Critique it by applying at least one of the questions for critiquing expert testimony.
3. Locate a place in the reading where the author uses an explanation for support. Critique it by applying at least one of the questions for critiquing explanation.
4. Locate a fact or statistic the author uses for support. Critique it by applying at least one of the questions for critiquing factual and statistical evidence.

Activity 7.4 Preparing to Write a Critique Essay

1. Examine *all* the support in the reading under critique. Your method to evaluate that support might be to create a chart like that shown in Figure 7.2, or a graphic organizer, or a list, or some combination of these methods.
2. Determine which piece of support is *most important* in the reading under critique. Create a chart, a graphic organizer, or a list to evaluate that support.
3. Select one of the essay prompts and use the prewriting strategy of your choice to get started writing a critique essay.

Activity 7.5 Drafting a Critique Essay

1. Review the readings in this chapter, looking at the introductory paragraphs in particular. Also, review the section "Sensible Strategies for Introductions" in "The Writing Product" chapter. What are some effective strategies the writers use to begin their writing? Apply one of these strategies by writing an introduction for your critique essay.
2. Draft an essay based on your prewriting from Activity 7.4, exercise 3, and using your introduction from exercise 1. Apply the basic plan for writing a critique essay (see Figure 7.3) if you find that helpful.
3. Review the readings in this chapter, looking at the titles in particular. What are some effective techniques for titling a critique? Apply one of those strategies to compose a title for your own critique essay.

Activity 7.6 Revising for Development and Support

Pair and Share

Exchange drafts with a partner and assess each other's critiques.

1. Carefully reread the introduction. Assess how well the critique writer provides complete background information about the topic and about the reading under critique, and make suggestions for improvement as needed.

2. Select one of the body paragraphs in the draft of the essay. Consider how to improve the draft by addressing the following questions: (a) What additional context might the critique writer's summary, paraphrase, or quotation of the support provide? (b) How might the writer express the evaluation of the support more clearly and concisely? (c) What would make the explanation of the critique more complete and detailed?
3. Carefully reread the conclusion. Make specific suggestions as to how the writer could more completely reinforce the critique of the reading.

Activity 7.7 Revising a Critique Essay

1. Evaluate the introduction in your critique draft, taking into account the feedback you received from your partner in Activity 7.6, exercise 1. Revise as needed to make the introduction complete.
2. Evaluate your critique draft by taking into account the feedback you received from your partner in Activity 7.6, exercise 2. Then revise to make improvements.
3. Evaluate the conclusion of your critique draft, by taking into account the feedback you received from your partner in Activity 7.6, exercise 3. Revise as needed.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

anecdotal evidence Examples from personal experience.

credentials Qualifications, such as those to make an informed opinion.

credibility The capacity to be believed.

criteria (singular, **criterion**) Standards by which to judge.

critique Careful judgment by giving an opinion about strong and weak aspects.

peer reviewed Examined by experts in the same field.

Chapter Summary

- To critique a text, read critically to identify the writer's support for the text's main ideas and apply appropriate criteria to evaluate that support.
- Depending on the type of support—examples, expert testimony, explanation, or factual evidence—different criteria are used to evaluate the support.

- When preparing to write a critique, either systematically evaluate all the support or concentrate on the most important pieces of that support.
- The SOS organizational pattern can be useful for structuring a critique essay.
- Revision is essential for ensuring that a critique explains clearly, concisely, and completely why a writer's support is convincing or not—that is, for making certain that the critique presents an in-depth judgment.

Chapter Activities

Refer to the readings in this chapter to answer these questions.

1. Based on what you have read about Housing First, what is the strongest evidence that this policy will help homeless individuals? Write a short essay addressing this question.
2. Based on what you have read about Housing First, what are the drawbacks of this policy? Write a short essay addressing this question.

Credits

pp. 173–175: Noll, Ben Cattell. "What Housing First Really Means." National Alliance to End Homelessness, March 18, 2019. https://endhomelessness.org/what-housing-first-really-means/. Used with permission; **pp. 178–180:** Eide, Stephen. "Housing First and Homelessness: The Rhetoric and Reality." Manhattan Institute for Policy Research, Report April 2020. Used with permission.

CHAPTER 8

Rhetorical Analysis

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Recognize the context of a reading.
- Identify audience and purpose.
- Identify appeals: ethos, pathos, and logos.
- Describe tone.
- Distinguish connation and denotation of words.
- Write a rhetorical analysis.

Theme: When Should Americans Be Involved in Foreign Conflicts?

Should you believe what you read in the newspaper? Can you trust the commentary on your social media feed? Should you buy that product that promises to improve your health and well-being? Should you take action to support a cause promoted by an organization?

To answer these questions, you must be able to analyze a persuasive argument. You must discern whether the claims are reasonable and the author is credible, whether the argument is supported by logical evidence and by appropriate appeals. In short, you must understand how arguments, language, and persuasive techniques can be used to influence your thinking and your actions so that you can make sound decisions.

In this chapter, we will reflect on an important question, one that affects the nation's security and the country's economy, that impacts people's lives both in the United States and in other countries, and that can have political and social repercussions around the world. That issue is, When should Americans be involved in foreign conflicts? We will consider America's involvement in the war in Vietnam in the 1970s, as well as the dedication and sacrifice of American soldiers during World War II.

RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

A **rhetorical analysis** examines a text in terms of rhetoric. Rhetoric means the art of effective or persuasive speaking or writing, especially by use of language, while analysis means to break apart something to consider how the parts contribute to the whole. For instance, the chapter "Responding to Texts" considered how to break a text into the important main ideas, so as to respond to these. The chapter "Critically Evaluating Texts" examined how to identify the support, to critically assess the effectiveness of an argument. This chapter dissects the language and rhetorical strategies an author uses to create a persuasive piece and therefore understand how and why or even if the argument is persuasive.

In short, a rhetorical analysis focuses on not only what authors or speakers say but also how they express their ideas: their tone, their choice of words, and appeals to their audience.

CONTEXT

Before analyzing a piece of writing or a speech, you must understand the context. **Context** includes the factors that surround a text, such as the following:

- **Situation:** When and where the text was produced and what the issue is
- **Author:** Who the author or speaker of the text is and what this person believes
- **Audience:** Who the intended or actual audience is
- **Purpose:** What the goal or reason is for the text

Understanding the context will enable you to immerse yourself in the author's argument. A reasonable first step in a rhetorical analysis is to place yourself in the author's position and imagine why this author is using certain words or making certain appeals. For instance, it would be appropriate for a minister speaking to a congregation to quote from the Bible to convince listeners that peace, rather than war, is the best course of action. In contrast, an army general addressing the U.S. Senate might quote from former military leaders or commanders in chief, drawing on past precedent to argue that engagement in war makes sense. What works in one situation with one audience may not be persuasive in a different situation with a different audience to achieve a different purpose.

Let's look specifically at these various features of a text, particularly how to locate and identify these.

Situation and Author

Most texts provide information about when and where a text was produced and by whom. Most texts also provide information about the issue and often the author's position on the issue. When you encounter a text, look for the following information and ask the following questions.

- **Date:** When was the text produced?
  Look at the beginning or end of a text to find the date of publication or production.
- **Occasion:** Where was the text printed or published, or where was a speech given?
  Scan the beginning or end of a text to discover the situation when the text was written or the speech given; the title may also provide clues.

- **Author:** Who produced the text?
  Look at the beginning or end of a text to find the author's name and information about the author's credentials or affiliations. If you are not familiar with the author, do some further research to learn more about that person.
- **Issue:** What was the topic of concern?
  Review any front matter that summarizes the speech or text, or that explains the controversy; the title may also provide clues to the topic.
- **Position:** What does the author believe about the issue?
  Read any front matter that summarizes the speech or text, or that explains the author's position; the title may also provide clues to the author's argument.

For example, suppose in the process of conducting research on the Vietnam War, you discover a reference to a speech by Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., titled "Beyond Vietnam" in the college library's database. The database provides information about the source, from which you can deduce the date, occasion, author, issue, and author's position by reading carefully (Figure 8.1). Moreover, the database also includes front matter before the speech (headnote) that helps to confirm information.

FIGURE 8.1 Analyzing a Source for Context

Database Information		Analysis
Subject:	Speeches; Vietnam War; Poverty; African Americans; Independence Moments; Foreign Policy	**Issue** = the Vietnam War
Location:	Riverside, New Jersey, United States (US)	**Occasion** = speech in Riverside, New Jersey
Title:	Speech: "Beyond Vietnam"	
Headnote On April 4, 1967, Dr. Martin Luther King delivered his seminal speech at Riverside Church condemning the Vietnam War. This is the speech in its entirety.		**Date** = April 4, 1967 **Speaker** = Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. **Position** = Opposition to the Vietnam War

PURPOSE AND AUDIENCE

Another important aspect of context is the author's purpose and intended audience: why the author is writing and for whom the piece is written. As a reader, this knowledge will help you understand what information is included in the text

and why. It will also help you respond critically, as you consider whether the writer achieved the purpose and wrote appropriately for the audience.

Purpose

Three categories of writing goals that are typically found in readings and speeches can help you understand the purpose of a reading. These goals are

- *To inform* means to tell, explain, or give information.
  A news article that explains the decisions and actions made by the US government that led to sending American soldiers to Vietnam is an example of writing to inform.
- *To persuade* means to convince readers to change their minds or to take action.
  A speech encouraging young people not to enlist in the military and that gives reasons why is an example of writing to persuade.
- *To entertain* means to provide enjoyment to readers, to make them laugh or smile.
  A political cartoon that pokes fun at the president of the United States is an example of a text that entertains.

While these three categories could appear in any speech or text, academic writing most typically centers on texts that seek to inform or to persuade readers or viewers.

Intended and Specific Audience

Audience is simply who the text is written for. A starting point for understanding the intended audience is to consider whether the target reader is either

- A *novice*: a beginner or a person with general knowledge on a topic, or
- An *expert*: an experienced or knowledgeable person on a topic.

For instance, newspaper articles are usually written for general, nonexpert readers. High-level scientific articles, on the other hand, are likely to be written for experts in a particular field of science.

It is also useful to think about the *specific audience*—the subset of readers to whom the material is directed. For example, the specific audience for a chemistry lab manual is chemistry students, and for a statistics textbook it is students in a statistics class. Sometimes readers can get clues about the specific audience by looking at

- Who the writer or speaker is.
- Where the writing is published or where a speech is given.

For instance, a student writing in the school newspaper is probably writing mainly for other students. A doctor publishing an article in a medical journal is likely to be writing for other doctors or health professionals. For some publications, such as magazines, it may be helpful to know who the readers typically are. For example, *The Atlantic*, a magazine focused on cultural and political affairs, is aimed at a college-educated audience, whereas *Sports Illustrated*, with a focus on professional sports, tends to appeal to sports fans. If you are not sure about the audience for a publication, ask a librarian or your instructor or do a little research to find out more about the publication's target readership.

APPEALS

As we learned in "Responding to Texts," writers use support to convince readers of their thesis. Support often focuses on logical reasoning, providing facts and statistics, or quoting from experts. Writers, too, can use other strategies to convince readers their thesis is valid, such as emotion. Aristotle, a Greek philosopher, believed that three main strategies make an argument persuasive: ethos, logos, and pathos.

- **Ethos** involves the author presenting themselves as a credible authority on a subject.
  For example, someone speaking about a technical subject might present themselves as an expert by mentioning certain qualifications. Someone arguing for a cause might highlight personal experience with and commitment to that cause.
- **Logos** refers to the use of reasoned argument to persuade.
  Logos, which includes logical reasoning and evidence, is often the basis for academic writing, which is concerned with facts, evidence, research, sound reasoning, and logical conclusions.
- **Pathos** evokes the audience's emotions.
  Pathos might involve speaking in a passionate way, using vivid imagery, or trying to provoke outrage, empathy, or any other emotional response in the audience.

These three **appeals** are considered integral parts of rhetoric, and a given author may combine all three of them to convince the audience.

That said, not all appeals will be persuasive in every situation; one needs to consider how appropriate the appeal is, given the audience and purpose. For instance, a four-star general giving a speech claiming "we are winning the war" may suggest a strong ethos for elected officials who would view the general as an expert, but newspaper reporters might be more skeptical of the general's motives and ethos. Using logos, such as facts and statistics, showing job growth and economic gains during and after a war might be compelling evidence to economists that a war was worth fighting but may not be convincing proof for parents of soldiers who lost their loved ones. Appeals to pathos, such as patriotism and heroism, may convince some American citizens to enlist to fight in a foreign conflict but may not be persuasive if addressed to pacifists who are morally opposed to war.

TONE AND DENOTATION AND CONNOTATION OF WORDS

Tone

Tone refers to how a piece of writing or a speech sounds. For instance, does the speaker sound angry or sad? Is the writer emotional or calm? Reading a piece aloud (or hearing the speaker read the speech) can help distinguish the tone. Also, think about how a certain tone might persuade a certain audience. Figure 8.2 lists some examples of words to describe different tones.

FIGURE 8.2 Examples of Tone Words

• Angry	• Emotional	• Logical
• Calm	• Excited	• Sad
• Concerned	• Hopeful	• Sarcastic
• Disappointed	• Humorous	• Sympathetic

Keep in mind that a writer's tone can shift. The writer may begin with a sad tone, evoking a tragedy, but end on a more optimistic tone, suggesting ways to avoid future tragedies.

To understand tone, read the following statement by Muhammad Ali. First some context: Muhammad Ali was a heavyweight boxing champion, drafted by the US Army in 1966 and called for service in 1967. As a conscientious objector to war and as a Muslim, he refused to join the army, was arrested, and was convicted of violating the Selective Service law, a decision that was later overturned by the US Supreme Court. In the following speech Ali explains why he would not be enlisting to fight in Vietnam. Try reading this aloud and consider what tone Ali takes.

> *Why should they ask me to put on a uniform and go ten thousand miles from home and drop bombs and bullets on brown people in Vietnam while so-called Negro people in Louisville are treated like dogs and denied simple human rights?*
>
> *No, I am not going ten thousand miles from home to help murder and burn another poor nation simply to continue the domination of white slave masters of the darker people the world over. This is the day when such evils must come to an end. I have been warned that to take such a stand would put my prestige in jeopardy and could cause me to lose millions of dollars which should accrue to me as the champion.*

To understand tone, consider the words and sentences, and what these sound like. For instance, you might have identified Ali's tone in the following ways:

Tone	Words From Text that Illustrate Tone
Angry	*"Why should they ask me to put on a uniform and go ten thousand miles from home and drop bombs and bullets on brown people in Vietnam while so-called Negro people in Louisville are treated like dogs and denied simple human rights?"*
Righteous	*"This is the day when such evils must come to an end."*

Denotation and Connotation

Writers think carefully about language. They consider not only what words mean precisely but also how words or phrases convey feelings they want to evoke in readers. The literal meaning of a word—its dictionary definition—is the **denotation** of the word. The suggested or implied meaning of a word—such as the associations or feelings we might have about a word—is the **connotation** of the word. For instance, the words *nosy* and *curious* mean about the same: "inquisitive." *Nosy*, however, has a somewhat negative connotation, while *curious* has a more positive connotation. When developing arguments, writers often choose words or phrases with strongly positive or negative connotations to persuade readers of their point of view.

In Muhammad Ali's speech (earlier), he used powerful, evocative words. Let's consider the denotation and connotation of some of those words.

> *Ali's words: "No, I am not going ten thousand miles from home to help murder and burn another poor nation simply to continue the domination of white slave masters of the darker people the world over."*
>
> **Word:** Murder
>
> **Denotation:** To kill another human being
>
> **Connotation:** Negative
>
> **Word:** Domination
>
> **Denotation:** To exercise control over someone
>
> **Connation:** Negative

Consider why Ali uses words with negative connotations to depict an action to which he is opposed. By suggesting that enlisting as a soldier means to help "murder" and to continue "domination" of other peoples, Ali bolsters his argument that he is morally opposed to the war.

READING TO ANALYZE RHETORIC

When reading to analyze a text for rhetoric, you should not only understand the author's main argument and support, as you would when reading any source, but also consider other important aspects of the text. You should examine the text carefully to

- Understand the issue and the context.
- Identify the writer and audience.
- Identify the author's position on the issue.
- Locate appeals.
- Describe the tone.
- Recognize the connotation of words.

The questions before, during, and after the Reading Selection will help you read a text with an eye toward rhetorical analysis.

READING SELECTION

"REMARKS AT A UNITED STATES-FRANCE CEREMONY COMMEMORATING THE 40TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE NORMANDY INVASION, D-DAY"

Before Reading: Understand Context

Write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

1. Review the headnote before the reading selection, as well as the title of the piece. What is the date when the text was produced, and what is the occasion? Who is the speaker, and what is the issue?
2. Look closely at the headnote before the reading selection, as well as the title of the piece. Who is the audience? What is the purpose?

During Reading: Annotate for Position, Appeals, and Tone

3. As you read and reread, annotate the reading by noting the speaker's position on the issue and the appeals, including ethos, pathos, and logos, given to support his position.
4. As you read and reread, pay attention to the tone and the connotation of words. Jot down descriptive words to capture the tone or to reflect the connotation of words.

Remarks at a United States-France Ceremony Commemorating the 40th Anniversary of the Normandy Invasion, D-Day

By President Ronald Reagan

6 June 1984

During World War II, American, British, and Canadian forces landed over 150,000 soldiers on a stretch of beach in the Normandy region of France. Many historians attribute this invasion to the beginning of the end of the war. Forty years after the troop landing, then-American President Ronald Reagan paid tribute to the soldiers, many of whom lost their lives. In his opening remarks, President Reagan recognizes French President Francois Mitterrand.

Mr. President, distinguished guests, we stand today at a place of battle, one that 40 years ago saw and felt the worst of war. Men bled and died here for a few feet of—or inches of—sand, as bullets and shellfire cut through their ranks. About them, General Omar Bradley later said, "Every man who set foot on Omaha Beach that day was a hero." 1

No speech can adequately portray their suffering, their sacrifice, their heroism. President Lincoln once reminded us that through their deeds, the dead of battle have spoken more eloquently for themselves than any of the living ever could. But we can only honor them by rededicating ourselves to the cause for which they gave a last full measure of devotion. 2

Today we do rededicate ourselves to that cause. And at this place of honor, we're humbled by the realization of how much so many gave to the cause of freedom and to their fellow man. 3

Some who survived the battle of June 6, 1944, are here today. Others who hoped to return never did. 4

"Someday, Lis, I'll go back," said Private First Class Peter Robert Zanatta, of the 37th Engineer Combat Battalion, and first assault wave to hit Omaha Beach. "I'll go back, and I'll see it all again. I'll see the beach, the barricades, and the graves." 5

Those words of Private Zanatta come to us from his daughter, Lisa Zanatta Henn, in a heart-rending story about the event her father spoke of so often. "In his words, the Normandy invasion would change his life forever," she said. She tells some of his stories of World War II but says of her father, "the story to end all stories was D-day." 6

"He made me feel the fear of being on that boat waiting to land. I can smell the ocean and feel the seasickness. I can see the looks on his fellow soldiers' faces—the fear, the anguish, the uncertainty of what lay ahead. And when they landed, I can feel the strength and courage of the men who took those first steps through the tide to what must have surely looked like instant death." 7

Private Zanatta's daughter wrote to me: "I don't know how or why I can feel this emptiness, this fear, or this determination, but I do. Maybe it's the bond I had with my father. All I know is that it brings tears to my eyes to think about my father as a 20-year-old boy having to face that beach." 8

The anniversary of D-day was always special for her family. And like all the families of those who went to war, she describes how she came to realize her own father's survival was a miracle: "So many men died. I know that my father watched many of his friends be killed. I know that he must have died inside a little each time. But his explanation to me was, 'You did what you had to do, and you kept on going.'" 9

When men like Private Zanatta and all our allied forces stormed the beaches of Normandy 40 years ago they came not as conquerors, but as liberators. When these troops swept across the French countryside and into the forests of Belgium and Luxembourg they came not to take, but to return what had been wrongly seized. When our forces marched into Germany they came not to prey on a brave and defeated people, but to nurture the seeds of democracy among those who yearned to be free again. 10

We salute them today. But, Mr. President, we also salute those who, like yourself, were already engaging the enemy inside your beloved country—the French Resistance. Your valiant struggle for France did so much to cripple the enemy and spur the advance of the armies of liberation. The French Forces of the Interior will forever personify courage and national spirit. They will be a timeless inspiration to all who are free and to all who would be free. 11

Today, in their memory, and for all who fought here, we celebrate the triumph of democracy. We reaffirm the unity of democratic peoples who fought a war and then joined with the vanquished in a firm resolve to keep the peace. 12

From a terrible war we learned that unity made us invincible; now, in peace, that same unity makes us secure. We sought to bring all freedom-loving nations together in a 13

community dedicated to the defense and preservation of our sacred values. Our alliance, forged in the crucible of war, tempered and shaped by the realities of the postwar world, has succeeded. In Europe, the threat has been contained, the peace has been kept.

Today the living here assembled—officials, veterans, citizens—are a tribute to what was achieved here 40 years ago. This land is secure. We are free. These things are worth fighting and dying for. 14

Lisa Zanatta Henn began her story by quoting her father, who promised that he would return to Normandy. She ended with a promise to her father, who died 8 years ago of cancer: "I'm going there, Dad, and I'll see the beaches and the barricades and the monuments. I'll see the graves, and I'll put flowers there just like you wanted to do. I'll feel all the things you made me feel through your stories and your eyes. I'll never forget what you went through, Dad, nor will I let anyone else forget. And, Dad, I'll always be proud." 15

Through the words of his loving daughter, who is here with us today, a D-day veteran has shown us the meaning of this day far better than any President can. It is enough for us to say about Private Zanatta and all the men of honor and courage who fought beside him four decades ago: We will always remember. We will always be proud. We will always be prepared, so we may always be free. 16

Thank you. 17

After Reading: Analyzing Rhetoric

Complete the following exercises.

5. What is President Reagan's position on the Normandy invasion, and where does he most clearly state this?
6. What emotional appeal (pathos) is President Reagan using when he includes Private First Class Peter Robert Zanatta's words and those of his daughter, Lisa Zanatta Henn?
7. Does President Reagan make use of logical appeals (logos)? Are logical appeals appropriate in this situation?
8. How would you describe the tone of the speech?
9. What words are associated with the Normandy invasion? What words are associated with the state of affairs forty years after the invasion?

Engage with the Reading

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. In the beginning of the speech, President Reagan mentions President Lincoln and alludes to the Gettysburg Address. Do you feel this allusion is fitting for the occasion and audience?

2. In the middle of the speech, President Reagan alludes to President Mitterrand's involvement in the French Resistance. Do you feel this allusion is fitting for the occasion and audience? (If you are not familiar with the French Resistance and President Mitterrand's role in it, research and read about this.)

PREPARING TO WRITE A RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

Reading and annotating a text is an excellent start on a rhetorical analysis. To build on that beginning, consider creating notes from your annotations and organizing these. You can do this by reviewing the parts of a rhetorical analysis, providing examples from the text for each part, then assessing the effectiveness of the rhetoric.

Recall that to write an effective rhetorical analysis, you should identify the purpose of the piece as well as the appeals, tone, and words used to persuade readers. You can start by summarizing the speaker's goal, then listing the ways that the speaker attempts to achieve the goal, including use of ethos, pathos, logos, tone, and connotation of words, or any other persuasive devices you can identify. Following is an example of the start of notes—identifying the goal and one part of the analysis (Figure 8.3). A complete set of notes would include comments about all the rhetorical strategies used by the speaker.

FIGURE 8.3 Example of Notes

Goal: President Reagan honors soldiers, particularly Americans and those who lost their lives, who participated in the Normandy invasion during World War II.

Pathos: Reagan suggests these soldiers were heroic and their sacrifices were for a worthy cause.

Once you have understood the goal and listed ways the writer or speaker attempts to achieve the goal, review the text for examples of those strategies. You can quote or summarize information. You should have multiple examples of the rhetorical strategies (Figure 8.4).

FIGURE 8.4 Example of Support from the Reading

Examples of Pathos

- President Reagan quotes General Omar Bradley: "Every man who set foot on Omaha Beach that day was a hero."
- President Reagan alludes to President Lincoln's Gettysburg Address when he says the soldiers "gave a last full measure of devotion" to a cause.
- President Reagan reads from a letter by the daughter of a soldier who participated in the invasion, acknowledging his "strength and courage" in the face of fear and death.
- President Reagan calls the soldiers "liberators" and says they represent the "triumph of democracy"; because of them "This land is free" and "We are free."
- President Reagan repeats words, such as "democracy" and "free" and "cause."

With a list of rhetorical strategies and examples of these from the text, you can begin to assess the effectiveness of the rhetoric (Figure 8.5). Consider the following questions.

- Does the rhetorical strategy help achieve the goal?
- Would the rhetoric persuade the audience?
- Is the rhetorical strategy appropriate for the situation?

FIGURE 8.5 Example of Evaluating the Rhetoric

Evaluation of Pathos

When President Reagan reads from a letter by the daughter of a soldier who participated in the invasion, he honors the bravery of the soldiers. Readers can understand from a powerful firsthand account the "strength and courage" the soldiers must have had to take "those first steps through the tide to what must have surely looked like instant death."

Organized and thorough notes identifying the various rhetorical strategies, providing multiple examples, and evaluating these should prepare you to write a paper.

WRITING A THESIS

After reading carefully, annotating the text, and taking notes that identify and assess the rhetorical strategies, you should review your notes to formulate a thesis. A thesis should do the following:

- Identify the main arguments in the text
- Identify the persuasive devices

Speakers may use many rhetorical strategies, but you should focus on the ones that are most compelling or that are hallmarks of the text. For instance, if the speaker evokes emotional appeals, you would point these out in your analysis; conversely, if the speaker relies significantly on appeals to logic, you would focus on these. Selecting three to four prominent rhetorical strategies will most likely lead to a well-developed analysis.

Once you select the focus points for your paper, compose a working thesis. The thesis (Figure 8.6) should do the following:

- Identify the main goal or argument in the text
- Identify the persuasive devices used to support those arguments or goals
- Evaluate the effectiveness of the persuasive devices

FIGURE 8.6 Example of a Thesis

> On the occasion of the 40th anniversary of the Allied invasion at Normandy during World War II, President Ronald Reagan delivered a speech honoring the soldiers who fought and gave their lives. Relying on emotional appeals and the testimony of a veteran's daughter, he persuasively portrays the soldiers as brave and heroic in the face of fear and death, fighting for the cause of democracy and freedom.

To ensure your thesis is not simply a summary of the author's argument or a list of rhetorical strategies, include words that indicate your assessment or evaluation of the rhetoric. Figure 8.7 lists some examples of words you might use to evaluate.

FIGURE 8.7 Examples of Evaluative Words

Strong Argument	Weak Argument
• Convincing	• Unconvincing
• Credible	• Dubious
• Effective	• Questionable
• Logical	• Illogical
• Persuasive	• Unpersuasive
• Reasonable	• Flawed

INTRODUCING A RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

Your introduction should situate readers to the argument you will analyze. You may want to review your notes about the context of the text and include the author and audience, the purpose, and issue to prepare readers to understand the goal of the text (Figure 8.8). In this way, you would lay the groundwork for a rhetorical analysis and for your own thesis.

FIGURE 8.8 Example of an Introduction

Introduction	Context
World War II was a struggle between the Allied forces, including America, Great Britain, and France vs. the Axis powers of Germany, Italy, and Japan. It was also a struggle between fascist dictators, like Hitler and Mussolini, and democratic societies, such as America. For a while, Germany and the Axis powers had the upper-hand in the war, that is until the Normandy invasion of over 150,000 Allied soldiers on Omaha Beach in Southern France. This effort was seen by some historians as the turning point in the war. Forty years after, on the anniversary of the Allied invasion, President Ronald Reagan delivered a speech to fellow dignitaries honoring the soldiers who fought and gave their lives. Relying on emotional appeals and the compelling testimony of a veteran's daughter, he persuasively portrays the soldiers as brave and heroic in the face of fear and death, fighting for the cause of democracy and freedom.	*Background information on the topic* *Situation and date* *Author and audience* *Issue and position*

WRITING A BODY PARAGRAPH

The body of the paper is where you will explain and support your analysis, and convince your readers of your assessment of the argument at hand. As in any essay, each body paragraph should be controlled by a main idea that links back to the thesis. In fact, you can use your thesis to organize your paper, as in Figure 8.9.

FIGURE 8.9 A Paper Plan

Introduction and Thesis

- On the occasion of the 40th anniversary of the Allied invasion at Normandy during World War II, President Ronald Reagan delivered a speech honoring the soldiers who fought and gave their lives. Relying on emotional appeals and the testimony of a veteran's daughter, he effectively portrays the soldiers as brave and heroic in the face of fear and death, fighting for the cause of democracy and freedom.

Paragraph 1: Using the words of the daughter of a soldier, Reagan powerfully evokes the bravery of soldiers who faced fear and death.

FIGURE 8.9 A Paper Plan (*continued*)

Paragraph 2: Relying on the authority of respected men, such as General Omar Bradley and President Abraham Lincoln, Reagan convincingly acknowledges the sacrifices of soldiers.

Paragraph 3: Reagan repeatedly calls the soldiers "heroes" and alludes to their "courage" to honor them.

Paragraph 4: Most compelling, Reagan links the soldiers' sacrifice to a larger cause, to the greater good of democracy and freedom from which the current audience benefits.

Conclusion: Emotional appeals and the testimony of others enable Reagan to craft a moving speech honoring the soldiers living and giving their sacrifices meaning.

Body paragraphs can be organized by focusing on key arguments or important goals of the text. A rhetorical analysis might also be organized around persuasive strategies, such as use of ethos, logos, and pathos (Figure 8.10). However, organizing the paper around arguments has the built-in advantage of focusing readers on the argument, then explaining how the rhetorical strategies work to support the arguments. It keeps the paper from becoming a list of strategies.

FIGURE 8.10 Example of a Body Paragraph

Paragraph	Comments
To honor the soldiers who participated in the invasion, Reagan relies on a powerful firsthand account from a soldier who was on the beach in Normandy: Private First Class Robert Zannatta. Zannatta's daughter, in a letter to the president, described "the strength and courage of the men who took those first steps through the tide to what must have surely looked like instant death." These words, read by Reagan, powerfully evoke the bravery of soldiers who faced carnage and death yet forged ahead in their duty. Furthermore, Reagan recounts from the letter that Zannatta was "a 20-year-old boy having to face that beach" who "watched many of his friends be killed." Listeners must admire the strength of such a young soldier determined to fight and possibly die, and his fortitude to persist. Listeners to Reagan's speech would know that thousands of men perished that day; therefore, the words of a soldier who "kept going on" are a persuasive testament to courage.	*Argument* *Persuasive strategy: pathos* *Example of pathos* *Explanation of effect* *Persuasive strategy: pathos* *Example of pathos* *Explanation of effect*

A generic outline of a rhetorical analysis might look like this:

Argument 1

- Persuasive strategy
- Example: quote or summary
- Explanation of effect
  - Repeat as needed
  - Persuasive strategy
- Example
- Explanation

Argument 2

- Persuasive strategy
- Example: quote or summary
- Explanation of effect
  - Repeat as needed
  - Persuasive strategy
- Example
- Explanation

CONCLUDING A RHETORICAL ANALYSIS

You can end your rhetorical analysis by

- Synthesizing your own analysis of the argument.
- Drawing a conclusion about the effectiveness of the argument.

You might also consider why your analysis matters or how it is relevant to real life. For instance, in the case of analyzing President Reagan's speech, a conclusion might sum up that his argument was persuasive for his audience because of Reagan's credible use of others' testimony and strong use of emotional appeals. However, one might question whether all causes are worth fighting for or which wars are worth the loss of lives.

Activity 8.1 Evaluate Prompts for Writing a Rhetorical Analysis Paper

Evaluate the writing topics by marking how interesting you find each one. Check "Interesting topic," "Maybe I could write on this topic," or "Cannot relate to this topic" for each prompt.

Solid Prompts

1. Write a rhetorical analysis of President Reagan's speech commemorating the 40th anniversary of the Normandy invasion, paying close attention to

audience and purpose; appeals such as ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

2. Research and locate a speech opposed to involvement in the Vietnam War, such as Martin Luther King, Jr.'s, speech "Beyond Vietnam" or Muhammed Ali's statement against induction. Then write a rhetorical analysis of that speech, paying close attention to audience and purpose; appeals such as ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

3. Research and locate another presidential speech, other than President Reagan's used in this chapter. Write a rhetorical analysis of that speech, paying close attention to audience and purpose; appeals such as ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

4. Research and locate a speech that argues either for or against American involvement in a foreign conflict, such as World War II or the invasion of Iraq. Then write a rhetorical analysis of that speech, paying close attention to audience and purpose; appeals such as ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

5. Research and locate a speech on a topic of your choice. Then write a rhetorical analysis of that speech, paying close attention to audience and purpose; appeals such as ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

Challenge Choices

These prompts are more challenging because they require analysis of two speeches, rather than one.

6. Research and locate two speeches by President Reagan (see Part 5: Anthology of Theme-Based Readings of this textbook to locate another speech by Reagan). Then write a rhetorical analysis of both speeches, paying close attention to audience and purpose; appeals such as ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words. Look for similarities in the style of these speeches.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

7. Locate the Gettysburg Address by President Lincoln, which President Reagan alludes to in his speech commemorating the 40th anniversary of the Normandy invasion (see Part 5: Anthology of Theme-Based Readings of this textbook). Then write a rhetorical analysis of both speeches, paying close attention to audience and purpose; appeals such as ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words. Determine how persuasive each speech is, based on your analysis.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

8. Research and locate two speeches on a topic of your choice that deal with a similar issue but take opposing positions. Then write a rhetorical analysis of both speeches, paying close attention to audience and purpose; appeals such as ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words. Determine which speech is more persuasive, based on your analysis.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

Activity 8.2 Analyzing a Source for Context

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Select one of the essay topics from Activity 8.1 and select the speech or speeches you will write about. Jot down notes on what you already know about these speeches or the topic.
2. Review the speech for context and determine the following factors:
   - Situation: When and where the text was produced and what the issue is
   - Author: Who the author or speaker of the text is and what this person believes
   - Audience: Who the intended or actual audience is
   - Purpose: What the goal or reason for the text is

3. Read any information that appears before or after the speech, such as a headnote. Determine what the issue is and, if possible, the author's position on the issue.
4. Read the text carefully to locate the author's position on the issue.

Activity 8.3 Reading and Annotating to Analyze a Source for Appeals and Language

Review your responses in Activity 8.2. Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Review the text, paying close attention to ethos. Annotate the text to determine how the author attempts to establish credibility.
2. Review the text, paying close attention to pathos. Annotate the text to determine how the author uses emotional appeals or language to support a position.
3. Review the text, paying close attention to logos. Annotate the text to determine how the author uses logical reasoning or factual information to support a position.
4. Review the text, paying close attention to the tone. Annotate the text to describe and illustrate the author's tone.
5. Review the text, paying close attention to word choice. Annotate the text to describe and illustrate the connotation of important words or phrases.

Activity 8.4 Preparing to Write a Rhetorical Analysis: Taking Notes

Review your responses in Activity 8.3. Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Take notes on the source by listing the author's goal, the important rhetorical strategies used to achieve that goal (ethos, pathos, logos), tone, and connotation of words, or any other persuasive devices you can identify.
2. Include multiple examples from the text, such as quotations or summaries, to illustrate each rhetorical strategy listed in exercise 1.
3. Evaluate the effectiveness of each rhetorical strategy (from exercises 1 and 2) by explaining how well it works to support the author's goal.

Activity 8.5 Writing a Thesis and Planning the Paper

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Review your annotations and notes from Activities 8.3 and 8.4. Select the most prevalent or most compelling persuasive devices authors use to support their position.

2. Review your work from exercise 1 and formulate a thesis for your rhetorical analysis. Your thesis should identify the main goal or argument in the text, identify the persuasive devices used to support those arguments or goals, and evaluate the effectiveness of the persuasive devices.
3. Using your notes and thesis statement, create a paper plan or outline. The plan or outline should include the focus for each body paragraph: an important goal of the text, specific persuasive strategies used to support the goal, examples of the persuasive strategies from the text, and an explanation of their effect.

Activity 8.6 Drafting a Rhetorical Analysis

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Draft an introduction for your rhetorical analysis paper. Consider reviewing your notes about the context of the text (see Activity 8.2), and include the author and audience, the purpose, and the issue to prepare readers to understand the goal of the text.
2. Using your paper plan (from Activity 8.5) and your annotations and notes (from Activities 8.3 and 8.4), draft the body paragraphs of your analysis. Be sure to include multiple examples of the persuasive strategies from the text and an explanation of their effect in each body paragraph.
3. Reread your paper draft (from exercises 1 and 2); then draft a conclusion. Consider synthesizing your analysis of the argument and drawing a conclusion about the effectiveness of the argument. You might also include why your analysis matters or how it is relevant to real life.

Activity 8.7 Revising a Rhetorical Analysis

Follow the instructions in the exercise.

1. Reread your draft (from Activity 8.6) and use the "Strategies for an Effective Essay" in "The Writing Product" chapter to revise your draft.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

appeals Support used to convince an audience of the claim, including ethos, pathos, and logos according to Aristotle.

connotation The suggested or implied meaning of a word.

context The factors that surround a text, including situation, author, audience, and purpose.

denotation The literal meaning of a word.

ethos How the author presents themselves as a credible authority.

logos Strategies used to appeal to an audience's logical reasoning.

pathos Strategies used to evoke an audience's emotions.

rhetorical analysis Examining a text in terms of rhetoric.

situation The date and occasion for a piece of writing or a speech.

tone How a piece of writing or a speech sounds.

Chapter Summary

- A rhetorical analysis examines a text in terms of rhetoric. Being able to analyze a text for rhetorical strategies and understand the persuasive devices can help you make sound decisions.
- Analyzing the context of a piece of writing or a speech—situation, author, audience, and purpose—is the first step in a rhetorical analysis.
- Appeals, including ethos, pathos, and logos; tone; and connotation of words are persuasive devices an author can use to convince readers of a certain position.
- When writing a rhetorical analysis, you will need to read and annotate the text, take notes, and organize notes into a paper plan to focus on and give examples of the most compelling persuasive devices.
- A rhetorical analysis should not only focus on the author's position and the persuasive devices used to support that position but also evaluate the effectiveness of the appeals and language.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Write a rhetorical analysis of this chapter, or of any chapter from a college textbook, noting the features and use of language that make the information accessible for college students.
2. Select a topic of interest to both faculty and students at your college. Then compose two pieces of persuasive writing—one aimed at students and one at faculty—to convince them of your position on the topic. In your writing, consider your audience and purpose, and use appropriate appeals (ethos, pathos, and logos), tone, and connotation of words.

Credits

p. 193: Ali, Muhammad. *Champion Takes Greatest Struggle*. Freedom, Justice and Equality! Muhammad Speaks, April 28, 1967; **pp. 195–197:** The Ronald Reagan Presidential Library & Museum.

SPOTLIGHT ON STUDENT WRITING

Synthesis Essay

This Spotlight chapter highlights how summaries and quotations from readings and other sources are synthesized into essays to build a strong piece of writing. First is an annotated student paper showing how the student incorporates textual evidence, such as quotes and summaries, from various readings and other sources to support the thesis. Then you can annotate a second essay to practice analyzing student writing. Last, you can apply these same reading, annotating, and analysis strategies to your own paper or to your classmates' writing to determine the effectiveness of essays that synthesize readings in writing.

ANALYZING ESSAY STRUCTURE AND USE OF EVIDENCE

Annotating a piece of writing helps you to understand the writer's ideas and how the writer delivers those ideas. Analyzing a writing's structure can also suggest strategies to use in your own writing. For instance, noticing how a writer begins the paper with a thought-provoking question may inspire you to start your essay with a provocative question.

Recall when reading to annotate a text, an effective strategy is to read at least two times. The first reading is to understand the writer's message. The second reading is a chance to examine the writing analytically and understand what makes it work.

Here are some strategies for successful annotations.

First Reading: Annotations for Comprehension

- Note the title to understand the topic.
- Underline main ideas, such as the thesis, topic sentences, or concluding statements, to discover the paper's organization.
- Mark examples, quotes, and summaries to determine the support for the main ideas.
- Write brief summaries of main ideas and examples in the margin to reinforce your comprehension of the writing.

Second Reading: Annotations for Analysis

- Evaluate the introduction: Does it establish the topic, get the reader's attention, and state the thesis?

- Examine the body paragraphs and determine whether these have topic sentences that relate to the thesis and relevant supporting information, such as quotations and summaries.
- Analyze the conclusion: does it explain why the information in the essay is important and does it come to a satisfying end?
- Determine if evidence is used effectively, such as whether support is relevant to the main ideas and thesis, quotes are integrated grammatically, and summaries are specific and detailed.
- Assess whether the title effectively represents the focus of the paper.

ANALYZING STUDENT PAPERS

This section of the chapter includes two student papers to read and consider. The first student paper is annotated so you can see an example of effective analytical annotations. The second paper is an opportunity to practice analytical annotations.

To understand what makes people happy, especially the role that wealth plays in happiness, students read various articles, examined graphs, and watched TED Talks. Their papers are in response to the following prompt.

> ***Writing Prompt:*** *What makes people happy human beings? For instance, does it make people happy to have money or to give money away? Is happiness determined by how people live their lives or by the people with whom they spend time? Does happiness involve doing meaningful work or experiencing pleasure? In your essay, explain what defines happiness and what makes people happy.*

Michelle Asadulla's essay "What Makes One Happy?" deals specifically with the question of whether money makes people happy. The essay directions include this additional requirement:

> ***Requirement:*** *In this essay, you will create an argument and use evidence from readings, videos, or graphs for support. You should draw on at least two of the resources (the articles, graphs, and videos provided) to support your answer. You may also include your own or other people's experiences.*

The first paper is annotated as follows:

- **Annotations on the paper.** The thesis and the paragraph main ideas are highlighted in blue on the paper as well as the support for main ideas.
- **Annotations in the right margin.** The title, thesis, and main ideas are summarized in the right-hand column to demonstrate comprehension. The introduction and conclusion are identified as essay parts. Main ideas and support are distinguished in the body paragraphs to establish the relationship between thesis, main ideas, and support.

- **Annotations in the left margin.** The different parts of the paper are marked in orange and analyzed with brief comments, such as whether the introduction sets the topic and gets the reader's attention, whether body paragraphs have support from the readings, and whether the conclusion brings the paper to a satisfying close.

Review this annotation strategy by studying the first student paper. Then practice reading, annotating, and analyzing by applying these strategies to the second student paper, which has not been annotated.

Annotations for Analysis:
Assess what is effective and what can be improved

Annotations for Comprehension:
Identify the thesis, main ideas, and support

Michelle Asadulla

Professor Kuehner

ENGL-151RW

19 October 2020

What Makes One Happy?

Title indicates topic is happiness.

Maybe begin with a definition or a question, not both.

First paragraph is introduction.

Happiness is defined as "having luck" in Middle English, but the majority of people do not define happiness this way and instead define it as "feeling or showing pleasure or contentment." Happiness is neither measurable nor profitable, yet people seek it above all. So what makes one happy? The birds chirping early on a sunny morning, your favorite TV show, or waking up and feeling blessed you were able to live another day. These make up a small fraction of one's happiness; however, money, good health, love and so forth are most commonly mentioned when defining what makes an individual happy.

Is "so forth" necessary?

Readings and the authors are effectively introduced.

Ismail Zafar, author of the blog "Happiness VS Money," and Ellie Zolfagharifard and Ollie Gillman, authors of "More Money Does Make You Happier," explain what makes people happy, including money, depending on who or what it is being spent on. According to numerous articles, graphs, and discussions, the key to happiness is the balance of wealth and how one uses it.

Clear thesis statement

Introduction ends with thesis.

Topic sentence sets up main ideas of paragraph but use parallel structure to make ideas clearer.

According to Zafar, money can buy happiness only when it is given away to those in need, rather than spent all on oneself, or used for an experience. Within his article, Zafar explains an experiment conducted by Dunn and colleagues which looked at the relationship between Americans' spending habits and their self-reported happiness. The first study, which was a national survey, included 632 Americans and asked the respondents to describe their income and habits and to rate their happiness in general. The researchers found two significant correlations when it comes to general happiness: higher income and spending on others. In other words, higher income allows one to spend more money on others which leads to greater happiness. Zafar states:

Main idea: Giving money away creates happiness.

Support: Research studies

Support: First study

Specific details about the research studies support the main idea.

Support: Quote from expert

A stronger quote would state that giving money away makes wealthy people happy.

> Although past research has been inconsistent in its finding that people who are rich generally are happier than people who are less well off, more recent research finds that wealthy people are indeed considerably happier than those with average or poor incomes.

For example, people who are rich generally are happier because they have more money left over to donate to charities or people in need. However, this does not mean one must be rich to donate or spend money on others to be happy. In the second, small study, 16 employees were asked about their general happiness before and after receiving their annual bonus. No matter the size of their bonuses, employees who spent more money on others or charity reported greater general happiness levels than those who spent more on themselves. Other research Zafar discusses is the correlation between money, happiness, and experience, such as "Nicalao et al. (2009) [who] found evidence that confirmed previous research that we are also generally happier when we spend money on experiences—like a vacation—rather than material things." Zafar concludes money can indeed buy happiness—as long as some is given away.

Support: Second study

Specific details about the research studies support the main idea.

Support: More research

Concluding sentence reinforces main idea that giving money away creates happiness.

Maybe be more specific about how people should give their money away?

Do you mean "graph" rather than "study"?

In a study conducted by the University of Michigan called "How Happy Are You?," the graph concludes that with an increase in one's income, an increase in happiness occurs as well. The graph also shows that an

Main idea = Wealth is correlated with happiness.

individual who makes above $100k is happy and there were no individuals who were "not too happy" based on their income. However, the group of individuals who made up 100% of the "very happy" category were the incomes of those with more than $250k. The least happy individuals were those whose incomes were below $10k (individuals with the lowest income analyzed in the study) with 21% of those "not too happy." Furthermore, the graph vividly implies that the higher the incomes were, the higher the "very happy" category escalated as well. These conclusions convey income and happiness are heavily correlated.

Effective summary of details from the graph

Concluding sentence reinforces main idea that wealth is correlated with happiness.

Integrate the quotation to make it fit better into the discussion.

"Nearly 60 percent of people living in the UK [United Kingdom] rate their happiness as at least 7 out of 10, higher than most other rich countries. However, some wealthy nations, including France and Japan, are still miserable, with barely half their citizens happy with their lives" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman 2). Money certainly is not the only factor to one's happiness due to another factor—how the money is being spent.

Main idea = Factors other than wealth also create happiness.

For example, there are two people living in the Bay Area. One of the individuals' earns an annual income of $60k and the other earns $250k. The one making $60k only has enough money to survive while the better-off individual has more opportunities to spend money on vacations or whatever fits their wants (if they can afford their wants). The individual making less will certainly be less happy than the individual making more because they are working just as hard, if not harder, only to make far less and barely survive.

Support: Example

Interesting and realistic example

Zolfagharifard and Gillman end their news article with Tony Wong, a businessman in Malaysia, who explains that "Money can buy lots of happiness for me because I am very materialistic. But that's not the only thing that makes me happy. Money is number one on my top five list, followed by health, family, dogs, and friends." According to Wong, money is his number one source of happiness, but of course there are other contributors to his happiness, which is expected from a wealthy individual.

Support: Example

Well-chosen quotation

Use a more effective transition.

Lastly, in the TedTalk "Money Can Buy Happiness" Michael Norton, a Harvard Business School professor, challenges the way many individuals think about money. He starts off his speech explaining how winning the lottery makes one unhappy for two reasons: 1. the individual spends all the money, leading up to being in debt, and 2. friends and family find them and beg them for money. This leads to more debt and worse relationships than they had before winning the lottery. Norton explains:

Support: Expert

These ideas seem related to Zafar's research; maybe put these paragraphs closer together?

> Maybe the reason why money doesn't make us happy is that we are always spending it on the wrong things. In particular, we are always spending it on ourselves. And we thought, what would happen if we made people spend more money on other people?

Norton and colleagues conducted an experiment on a campus at University of British Columbia in which they gave envelopes (including some money) to students, stating either: "By 5 p.m. today, spend this money on yourself," or "By 5 p.m. today, spend this money on somebody else." The end result of this experiment was those who spent the money on others felt happier, while those who spent the money on themselves felt neither different nor happier. Norton concluded that it does not matter how much money one has or spends, what really matters is that the money was being spent on someone other than themselves.

Support: Research

Main idea: Spending money on others leads to happiness

Money is the key to happiness with the consideration of other factors, such as who or what the money is being spent on, whether it was spent on an experience, and so forth. Ismail Zafar, Ellie Zolfagharifard and Ollie Gillman, in their articles all explain how the use of money makes one happy and which contributions correlate with money to make an individual happy. Whether an individual is materialistic or not, money grants many opportunities for happiness when spent correctly.

Conclusion synthesizes main ideas.

Is "so forth" necessary?

Mention Norton, too?

Succinct final statement

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STUDENT PAPER

Now it is your turn to read and annotate a student paper. Use the annotation strategies and the examples of annotations on the first student paper to guide you as you review the second student paper.

Before Reading: Predict

Write answers to these questions using complete sentences.

1. Review the writing prompt. What does the writer need to do to create a successful paper?
2. Read the "Requirements" for the essay assignment. What does the writer need to do, in addition to addressing the prompt, to create a successful paper?

During Reading: Annotate

Complete the following exercises.

3. As you read, annotate the writer's thesis and main ideas. Also mark the evidence used to support the thesis. Identify the introduction, body of the paper, and conclusion.
4. As you read, analyze how effective the thesis, main ideas, and support are.

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Professor Kuehner
English 151RW
19 October 2020

Money, Friends, Purpose, and Happiness

What exactly does it mean to be happy? Or better yet, what brings about happiness? Happiness is the state of being emotionally and physically comfortable and content. People indulge in activities that allow them to achieve this state of satisfaction. Some believe that money brings joy because it fulfills basic needs while others emphasize the importance of health as a key factor to happiness. On the other hand, many people spend quality time with others because it brings delight, but others argue that living a meaningful life is crucial to a content life. All these are plausible answers because joy and satisfaction are tailored to everyone's needs and desires. Even though people have different expectations, there is some common ground as to what makes people happy. People strive to be materially satisfied, aim for emotional security, indulge in meaningful events with others, and aspire to live a purposeful life, because these all bring happiness, which is the state of joy, satisfaction, and comfort.

Happiness derives from being content with what one has. In the graph "How Happy Are You?" Betsey Stevenson and Justin Wolfers at the University of Michigan show the results of a survey that asked participants to report on their income and their level of happiness. People with an annual income of $100k to $150k reported to be very happy or fairly happy. Unhappiness was more commonly reported by participants in the income range of $50k to $75k and gradually increased as income value decreased, with 21% of unhappy individuals reporting income less than $10k (Stevenson and Wolfers 202). These results suggest that people need a certain level of wealth in order to fulfill their basic needs and feel content with their status. Those who have low income are constantly struggling to make ends meet. These people find it harder to improve their quality of life because they are

living on tight budgets and can't spend money on the things they love. In Graham Stephan's video "Money Can Buy You Happiness: Here's Why," Stephan cites Purdue University's study on the relationship between income and happiness. In 2018, Purdue expanded this research by sampling more than 1.7 million people throughout 164 countries. The results showed that the "$75,000 figure was ideal for emotional well-being . . . but $95,000 was ideal for what they call 'life evaluations'" (Stephan). These results appear to confirm that people need to make, on average, $75k annually to fulfill their everyday needs, but need $95k in order to achieve their interests and goals. Both of these studies show that money is an important factor in an individual's level of happiness. Wealth isn't enough to make us happy, but poverty makes happiness impossible.

While money allows for a certain level of material comfort, people aren't truly content with their personal lives if they are not comfortable emotionally. In Zolfagharifard and Gillman's article "Money Does Make You Happy," people in developed nations, such as the United Kingdom, the United States, and Israel, have high self-reported satisfaction rates; however, "some wealthy nations, including France and Japan, are still miserable, with barely half of their citizens happy with their lives" (198). This finding shows that while most citizens from wealthy countries are satisfied with their lives, money does not guarantee joy and satisfaction. Income contributes heavily to happiness, but perhaps other factors, such as stress, social norms, safety, and health, can also affect the emotional well-being of an individual.

Zolfagharifard and Gillman elaborate on this idea by presenting research showing that "women tend to be happier than men [and] unmarried and middle-aged people tend to report lower levels of well-being than married and younger people" (199). The results of this study show that gender, marital status, and age all play a role in one's emotional well-being. Men are less satisfied with their current status, possibly because they often experience the pressure of supporting a family. Unmarried individuals have to support themselves financially and may also experience more loneliness. Elderly people face deteriorating

health, which can decrease happiness. Zolfagharifard and Gillman also note that many people prioritized "their health, their children's education and safety from crime" over wealth, which further supports the idea that "while wealth appears to contribute to happiness . . . it is far from the only factor" (199). With an overall increase in qualities of life, people tend to look for emotional enjoyment since their materialistic needs are covered.

Once material desires and emotional needs are secured, people look forward to engaging in meaningful activities with others to maximize feelings of joy. In John Grohol's article "Can Money Really Buy Happiness?" the author explores the correlations between levels of happiness and the ways money is spent. In one study, "employees who spent more of their bonus money on others, or on charity, reported greater general happiness levels than those who spent more of it on themselves" (Grohol 206). In another study, participants who were instructed to spend money on someone else also showed high levels of happiness, illustrating that "even when the choice isn't ours, we still feel the happiness effects giving away money to others—even when the actual value is small" (Grohol 206). Grohol explains that people enjoy the experience much more than the actual value of the object itself. Whether it's dining in a Michelin three stars restaurant or grabbing coffee at Starbucks, the level of delightfulness is the same because people relate more to the experience of content derived by spending quality time with others than on what the money was spent on. It's the process of doing something meaningful that counts towards an individual's level of happiness. The time spent picking out a present for someone is more valuable than the actual object, because we derive so much satisfaction from seeing the elated reaction of the person receiving the gift. A similar experiment was conducted by Michael Norton, a professor at Harvard Business School. In his TED talk "How to Buy Happiness," Norton and his team handed cash to students at University of British Columbia to spend either on themselves or on someone else and the results showed that people who spent money on others increased their happiness whereas those who spent money on

themselves were neither more or less happy. Taking the same scenario into a business setting and determining whether team members who spent money on each other would be more productive, the results once again proved that the pro-social teams sold "more stuff than the teams that only got money for themselves" (Norton). With the money given to them, the pro-social team bonded by cashing in the money for a group activity and felt motivated to perform better as a whole. Both studies show that the dollar value wasn't what provided satisfaction, but the idea of spending quality time with, or helping someone in need, whether it's a coworker, a friend, or a complete stranger. The motion of giving or partaking in a meaningful event is much more rewarding than a couple of crisp bills.

Another important aspect of achieving happiness is living a life with purpose. This idea sounds abstract and vague because the definition of purpose is different for each individual. Living a meaningful life might mean finishing college, finding a high-paying job, meeting the ideal significant other and having a family together. For many, these examples epitomize living a decent life; but living with purpose requires a more spiritual and holistic approach. A meaningful life means understanding who we are and what we want in life. In the TED talk "There's More to Life Than Being Happy," Emily Esfahani Smith suggests that storytelling is one of the four pillars of happiness. Storytelling helps bring clarity to the events that happen in life and helps people understand who they are. Instead of listing the facts that occurred, Smith urges the audience to revisit and revise their stories to find "new insights and wisdom" and to find "that good that sustains [us]" (Smith). Smith provided an example of a friend, Emeka, who was severely injured after playing football. Emeka transformed from a selfish man, before the injury, to a man who found purpose in serving others, after the incident. This type of "redemptive story," as psychologist Dan McAdams describes it, can only be achieved if people accept the struggles and learn from the pain to establish a meaningful life (Smith). Emeka had a good life prior to his accident, but that accident stripped away his passions. Instead of feeling depressed, Emeka accepted his situation, rediscovered himself, and

found his purpose of serving others. Smith also brought in a personal anecdote about her father's survival of a heart attack. Lying there preparing for surgery, her dad "repeated [Smith's and her brother's] names like a mantra" and he found the power to live (Smith). For her father, belonging in the family and his duty as a father gave him something to hold onto to survive the heart attack. Both Emeka and Smith's father survived tragedies that took away their happiness; however, these struggles helped them come to terms with themselves, rediscover their values, and find purpose and meaning in their lives. Discovering self-worth and a sense of purpose through storytelling is one of the important aspects of achieving happiness.

Happiness is the condition of feeling emotionally and physically content and is achieved by fulfilling both emotional and physical needs, partaking in significant activities with others, and living a life with purpose. Money can provide a certain level of happiness, since it can be exchanged for daily necessities. Emotional well-being is also important to a healthy and content life. As social beings, humans need to be actively involved with others to achieve the sense of belonging and acceptance. Putting time and effort into meaningful activities with others can provide that sense of joy and satisfaction. Lastly, happiness can be achieved through finding purpose in life. What constitutes a happy life is different for each individual, but these four essential elements are the basis for joy and pleasure in life.

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After Reading: Analyze the Writing

Complete the following exercises.

5. What is the writer's thesis? Is it clearly written?
6. Consider the introduction. Does it get your attention and establish the topic of the paper?
7. Examine the body paragraphs. Do the main ideas support the thesis? Does the writer use sources and summaries effectively to support the main ideas?
8. Do you feel the conclusion brings the essay to a logical and satisfying end?
9. Do you feel the student effectively responds to the writing prompt? Why or why not?

ANNOTATING AND ANALYZING FOR PEER REVIEW

In addition to annotating to evaluate student writing, you can also annotate to provide feedback for yourself or for other students. For instance, you can use "Checklist for Analyzing a Synthesis Essay," shown here, to review and revise your own paper. Or you can exchange papers with a classmate and complete the checklist as a way to provide feedback.

Checklist for Analyzing a Synthesis Essay

- Does the introduction establish the topic, get the reader's attention, and state the thesis?
- Do body paragraphs have topic sentences that relate to the thesis?
- Do body paragraphs contain relevant supporting information, such as quotations or summaries, from the readings?
- Is evidence used effectively to support the main ideas? Is there a logical connection between the evidence and the main idea of a paragraph?
- Are quotes integrated grammatically into sentences? Is there context for each quote? Is the source of the quotation acknowledged?
- Are summaries specific and detailed? Is the source of the summary identified?
- Does the conclusion explain why the information in the essay is important and bring the essay to a satisfying end?
- Does the title effectively represent the focus of the paper?

Spotlight Activities

1. If you have completed an essay for your English class, read and annotate your paper to analyze your writing. You might also use "Checklist for Analyzing a Synthesis Essay" to check the effectiveness of your writing.
2. If you have completed an essay for an English assignment, exchange your paper with a classmate. Read and annotate the paper; then use "Checklist for Analyzing a Synthesis Essay" to provide feedback by answering each question about your classmate's paper.
3. Did you feel that one of the student papers was more convincing than the other, or were they equally effective? Explain your answer.
4. What have you learned about writing an effective essay synthesizing readings from studying the two student papers in this section?

Pair and Share

Discuss your answers to question 3 in the Spotlight Activities. What did you feel was effective about the two student papers? Did you agree that one essay was more effective, or were they equally effective?

Credits

pp. 211–215: Asadulla, Michelle. "What Makes One Happy?" October 19, 2020. Used with permission; **pp. 216–221:** Chen, Kristen. "Money, Friends, Purpose, and Happiness." October 19, 2020. Used with permission.

PART THREE

Reading and Writing about Multiple Texts

9 Comparing Texts

10 Synthesizing Texts

11 Arguing with Texts

Spotlight on Student Writing: Argumentative Synthesis Essay

CHAPTER 9

COMPARING TEXTS

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Read to identify parallel points of comparison.
- Take notes on a reading by listing, charting, or diagramming to compare information.
- Apply organizational patterns for comparing or contrasting, such as the block method and point-by-point method.
- Write a compare-contrast thesis statement.
- Plan a compare-contrast essay.
- Develop transitions between paragraphs.

Theme: Should We Support a Universal Basic Income?

Comparing (to note similarities) and **contrasting** (to point out differences) should be purposeful: to help understand issues, make a judgment, and arrive at a conclusion about what is being compared. For instance, contrasting two management models might lead to conclusions about which style might better fit the industry in which you want to work, while comparing approaches to policing may suggest which is most effective to keep citizens safe.

In this chapter, you will compare and contrast arguments for and against universal basic income. Universal basic income (or UBI) is essentially a payment, typically by a government to its citizens, with the intent that people receiving a guaranteed amount of money each year can live above the poverty line. In exploring the chapter's theme, you will consider the advantages and disadvantages of this approach to financially aiding individuals and therefore whether such an approach is worth supporting.

READING TO IDENTIFY PARALLEL POINTS

Before comparing and contrasting, ensure there is a basis for comparison; that is, ensure there is enough in common to justify the comparison or contrast. For instance, it might not make sense to compare an opera singer to a rapper, because they are two very different singers; but it might make sense to compare one opera star to another, or one rap artist to another.

To begin, you can make a list, chart, or diagram to understand these similarities and differences, then determine whether a basis for comparison exists (Figure 9.1). Do not be overly concerned at first whether your points are accurate; as you read and research the topic, you can confirm or revise your initial ideas.

As you list similarities and differences, look for **parallels**—related or matching characteristics—between the things being compared or contrasted. For instance, the title of one article, "Would a Universal Basic Income Make Us Lazy or Creative?" suggests giving people money might be a disincentive to work (and therefore "make us lazy") or might be a motivating force to encourage people to take on interesting projects (and therefore "make us . . . creative"). So, *work incentive* is a parallel point of comparison in this case.

If you can align points in this way, the comparison will be more logical. Not all points in an argument, however, have parallel points of comparison. For instance, someone might argue that a universal basic income would allow parents to stay home to raise their children. There may be no parallel point in response.

When reading to compare or contrast two (or more) things, make notes about the similarities and differences between the objects of your comparison. You can make notes on the text itself or pull out the main points of comparison from the reading to see them clearly, to quote or summarize these, and to organize them in a table or chart.

FIGURE 9.1 Listing Ideas about UBI

Arguments for UBI	Arguments against UBI
• Everyone gets a salary	• Some people work to earn money; others do not
• Eliminates government entitlement programs, such as welfare and food stamps	• Creates a new, expensive government bureaucracy
• Shows people they are valued as human beings	• Devalues and discourages going to work
• Parents can stay at home to raise their children	

READING SELECTION

"A UNIVERSAL BASIC INCOME: WHAT DIFFERENCE MIGHT IT MAKE?"

Before Reading: Predict

Write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

1. What do you think might be some advantages of a universal basic income? Why might some people support UBI?
2. What might be some disadvantages of a universal basic income? Why might some people oppose a UBI?

During Reading: Annotate

3. As you read and reread, annotate the reading by noting the advantages and/or the arguments in support of a UBI and the disadvantages and/or the arguments against a UBI. Be alert for parallel points—related or matching characteristics—to use for understanding the arguments on both sides.

A Universal Basic Income: What Difference Might It Make?

By Christine Morley, Phillip Ablett, and Jenni Mays

Social Alternatives, August 2019

Social Alternatives *is a journal promoting discussion about contemporary social, political, economic, and environmental issues. One volume was devoted to debate over universal basic income. This reading selection is an excerpt; the excerpt compares UBI to the current system of government financial support and considers the advantages and criticisms of UBI. Note that the journal uses English spelling conventions and follows Harvard referencing style.*

Universal Basic Income

Unlike our current system of income support, a Universal Basic Income (UBI hereafter) is paid to each citizen, not a family or household, regardless of income or assets; and it is obligation-free, which means it is a right that is not tied to work requirements (Scialabba 2017; Van Parijs 1991, 1992, 2005). 1

Instead of blaming victims, as is evident in our current system, BI recognises that capitalist economies have failed to provide adequate paid employment opportunities for all who need them, and that this situation may worsen in the future unless radical policy changes occur. Hence BI can act as a safety net to prevent precariousness. As Steensland (2006: 1289) states: BI is 'premised on a structural view of poverty that challenge[s] the 2

normative and programmatic grounds for categorizing the poor based upon their perceived worthiness'.

3 Commenting on the US context, Steensland (2006) suggests liberal capitalist societies do not guarantee a BI security for all citizens because of our embeddedness in notions of the 'undeserving poor', with the corresponding view that some members of society are not worthy of government assistance. Our current system punishes people who accept the low-income, training-poor jobs that generally represent the only employment options available to welfare-recipients.

4 Conversely, given that BI is designed as a universal scheme, recipients are not subjected to judgement, ridicule and stigmatisation (Van Parijs 2005: 14). In addition, because BI provides a regular income (regardless of paid work), it removes the poverty trap associated with accepting low paying jobs (or even worse, poverty traps of income support programmes that claw back earnings from paid work); thus creating an incentive to work for BI recipients by increasing incomes (Scialabba 2017; Van Parijs 2005: 4). This is appealing for proponents of BI, both on the left and right of politics. Moreover, it redresses the costly over-bureaucratisation of the existing system by removing administrative complexities associated with targeting and assessing for eligibility (Jenkins 2019: 29; Tomlinson 1991).

5 The precarious nature of work reflects our current context in which the power of unions, and consequently industrial conditions, have been significantly eroded in many sectors since the Work Choices legislation by the conservative Howard Government in 2005 (Commonwealth of Australia 2005). This has exacerbated casualised, uncertain, potentially exploitative working conditions, which solidify the disadvantage experienced by the precariat (Standing 2014). A key benefit of BI in this context is the steady income it will provide for those with precarious work (Standing 2014; Stern, 2016). Given the significant correlation between unstable income and mental distress (Ferguson 2017), Jenkins (2019: 27) points out 'Obviously, a GBI [Guaranteed Basic Income] would reduce the anxiety and income instability of this situation, providing a cushion for those who cannot work' (Jenkins 2019: 27); and also reduce the stress-related adverse health impacts of continually having to look for a job (Howgego 2019). Moreover, a BI would allow 'people to choose not to work for periods of time or to refuse to work for inadequate remuneration' (Jenkins 2019: 27). Therefore, a BI would significantly reduce the vulnerability experienced by the precariat because it would provide the financial means to leave workplaces that do not offer reasonable conditions. As Jenkins (2019: 28) notes, workers who are not treated well would be able to withdraw from exploitative or unjust conditions with BI providing a 'permanent strike fund'. She further notes that 'It is possible that a GBI could mobilize individuals into looser, more ad-hoc collectivities that are better suited to contemporary forms of precarious or contract labour than more bureaucratized institutions such as trade unions' (Jenkins 2019: 28). Observing this almost three decades ago, Van Parijs (1991: 105) similarly argued that: '. . . there is no doubt that an unconditional income confers upon the weakest more bargaining power in their dealings with both potential employers and the state' (Van Parijs 1991: 105).

6 In improving industrial freedoms, a BI could also potentially insulate workers against the poverty resulting from expected mass job losses associated with increasing automation of the labour market. While some commentators fear that introducing a BI could lead to an acceleration of job losses created by technology (Bruun and Duka 2018;

Jenkins 2019), others researching the impact of technological advances suggest that significant job losses will occur (Ford 2015) with or without a BI. According to Savchuk (2019: 44), for example, 'A growing chorus of Silicon Valley executives ha[ve] called [a universal basic income] policy inevitable, as automation threatens to displace one-third of American workers by 2030, raising the spectre of unemployed masses rioting in the streets'. Savchuk (2019: 44; see also Standing 2014) further notes that the rapid consequences of technology for employment have initiated several BI trials in places including Barcelona, Namibia, Canada, Finland, Kenya, India, Uganda, and Switzerland. These BI pilots are crucial for creating the conditions for implementing a BI and embedding environmental justice, liberty, gender equality, social and democratic citizenship, a flexible and just labour market and shared ownership of the commons (Young and Mulvale 2009: 3).

Moving beyond right-to-work initiatives, which frame 'work' narrowly in terms of a paid employment, a key benefit of BI is that it provides an opportunity to choose an occupation, whether that role is paid or not. Hence BI offers a potential redefinition of work that involves valuing 'activities that combine creativity, conceptual and analytic thought and manual or physical use of aptitudes' (Perez 2003 cited in Harvey 2005: 8; see also Scialabba 2017: 20) that may have a range of potential benefits for society as a whole. Furthermore, the concept of BI potentially transforms 'work' from being a commodity that is regarded only for its exchange value, or its capacity to foster the acquisition of more material resources, into a much wider proposition (Jenkins 2019: 27). This redefinition of work potentially has implications for addressing the devaluing of 'women's work', including community work and unpaid child care and domestic labour in the private sphere. It enables people (including men) to devote time to such socially necessary and valuable labour (Howgego 2019). While a BI would not facilitate this directly, 'indirectly[,] it could set into motion a variety of forces that de-stratify the very notion of women's work' (Jenkins 2019: 31). Other gender equity promoting potential impacts of BI include opening up options for women's further education or occupations of their choice. As an individual provision, women would have greater financial security, bargaining power, and the means to leave violent relationships (Jenkins 2019: 31). 7

BI's transformation of 'work' from being a commodity that is only thought of for its exchange value, involves a shift to a more inclusive construction that offers choice and opportunity to pursue sustainable, meaningful activities (Jenkins, 2019: 32). Van Parijs (1991) argues that in de-commodifying the idea of work, BI aligns with social and environmental justice in the pursuit of sustainable lifestyles that are not resource intensive. 8

Concerns about a Universal Basic Income (BI)

Indeed, BI offers much hope in eradicating poverty, contributing to a more socially just society. However, not everyone shares this view (Harvey 2005; Maskivker 2018; Tcherneva and Wray 2008: 3; Young and Mulvale 2009). Young and Mulvale (2009: 4) summarise the key concerns about BI as 1) providing a disincentive to work, 2) being too expensive to be politically viable and 3) formalising a lack of reciprocity, that is giving resources to those who may apparently 'contribute nothing in return' (see Elster 1986; White 1997). 9

As critical educators, we find these critiques uncompelling: Firstly, there is no evidence to support the notion that a BI provides a disincentive to work. Within a capitalist society, it is unlikely that people will cease to desire material possessions 10

beyond that which they will be able to afford with a BI. Indeed for two years from December 2016, the Finnish government conducted a trail of BI with 2000 people who were unemployed. At the conclusion of the experiment they found when comparing the income, employment status and general wellbeing of this group with a control group of 5000 who continued to receive the usual unemployment benefits, there was little variation in the number of days employed; this indicated that the BI provided no disincentive to work. However, the trial did impact the group receiving the BI in positive ways, as they reported significantly less stress and better health than the control group (Howgego 2019).

11 Secondly, while some critics (such as Harvey 2005) talk about the high cost of BI as being prohibitive to implementation, we reject this claim, acknowledging that the potential taxation base of our nation is considerable. In our view, introducing a wealth tax and appropriately taxing the rich, would be absolutely necessary to ensure that the BI is adequately funded and can genuinely provide an adequate standard of living. Australia's untapped taxation revenue is considerable and could indeed be used to fund a BI. According to the Australian Tax Office's third tax transparency report (cited in Hutchens 2017) 36% of multi-national firms and large companies paid next to no tax, even when they received excessively large revenues (such as Adani's $724 million revenue; see Hutchens 2017 for full list). If we were to tax these companies at the same rate as individuals who earn over $180,000 (that is at 45%), the potential tax from these companies alone would be enough to sustain a full BI and introduce tax equity (Stevens and Simpson 2017: 120).

12 Thirdly, any critique about the lack of reciprocity denies the many ways that people make contributions to society that are unpaid. Their contributions may be significant even though they are not recognised. We would also point to Sayer's (2016) argument that highlights how costly the wealthy elite's monopoly of resources is for the rest of humanity.

13 Critiques of BI that are more arguably persuasive include that it would not recompense involuntarily unemployed workers for their lack of waged labour (Harvey 2005). We agree, but if paid at a level that is above the poverty line and appropriately indexed, BI would protect people against poverty and related stresses including the stigmatisation associated with being a welfare recipient. Harvey (2005: 29) warns that a BI would not 'compensate people who preferred non-waged employment for the work they performed'. This is not entirely accurate as many people engage in unpaid work without compensation or recognition. Setting BI at an adequate level supports people to pursue unpaid activities of their choosing, which in itself is compensatory. Further, many 'non-waged' citizens spend their time hunting for jobs that do not exist (Watts 2016: 77) instead of performing other labour that might be preferable and productive. Harvey (2005: 29-30) also notes that BI 'would be unlikely to lead to any increase in the availability of paid employment for those people who want it' and 'could not be counted on to force an improvement in the quality of low wage work and might even cause it to decline'. We would agree with the first point, for BI makes no claim about increasing paid employment opportunities. We also concede that it would not necessarily improve the quality of employment; but if people had a reliable BI, as noted earlier, they would not be forced to accept poor quality work in order to survive.

14 Harvey (2005) argues that 'rather than eliminating "bad" jobs, a BI guarantee might subsidize them, allowing employers to lower wages rather than raise them'

(Harvey 2005: 36). Related to this, other critics suggest BI may 'make it even easier for capital to dictate its terms to labour, since they know that workers will be taken care of by the state' (Gorz 1999: 82). Outlining an alarming scenario, (Gorz 1999: 82) suggests that in addition to widespread dismissals and lowering wages, 'employers might defer wage demands back to the state and tell unions to negotiate with public bodies in order to increase their GBI allocations'. We agree, particularly within our neoliberal policy dominated context, that these are concerns are valid. Current legislation that allows exploitative practices and insecure conditions must be changed to improve the industrial protections of all workers. This should include protections of the minimum wage so that BI is not able to be used to merely 'subsidize capital' (Gorz 1999: 82). We also emphasise that while BI should replace other kinds of direct income support that are means tested and stigmatised, it must not be used to justify any cuts to other social security measures that support health, education, welfare and other kinds of social infrastructure (Jenkins 2019: 28).

After Reading: Summarizing to Compare

Refer to the preceding Reading Selection as you answer the following questions. Write your answers in complete sentences.

4. Identify at least three points in this Reading Selection that you could use to compare the advantages and disadvantages of universal basic income, or to compare the arguments for and against universal basic income.
5. In your own words, write a summary of the advantages and disadvantages of universal basic income, or the arguments for or against universal basic income from the article, using the points you identified in question 4.

Engage with the Reading

1. Which advantages cited in the article might make you want to support universal basic income? Explain.
2. Which disadvantages might make you *not* want to support universal basic income? Explain.

COMPARING SOURCES AND SYNTHESIZING INFORMATION

To continue the example from the preceding section, if you are considering the arguments for and against universal basic income, you might begin by listing your own ideas, then read to gather more information and ideas. You can synthesize the information from your reading with your initial ideas in several ways.

1. **Incorporate information under an existing parallel point.** For instance, if you included a point of comparison about the value of work, you might add a quote or summarized example that illustrates that point from the reading.

2. **Create a new point.** For example, if you discover from your research that government programs have not been consistently implemented and that studies on universal basic income have not always been well designed, a new point might be about the research into universal basic income—whether it offers proof that universal basic income will work as intended.
3. **Alter an existing category.** For instance, you might revise your point about "everyone gets a salary" if you find out that universal basic income programs do not apply to people above a certain income level.
4. **Relocate information.** For example, if you realize your initial idea that "Parents can stay at home to raise their children" is similar to an example in the reading about taking care of elderly parents or homeschooling children, you could group these examples together.

Reading to Synthesize Additional Information

Have you ever brainstormed about a topic? If so, you probably have experienced that sometimes the first idea that pops into your head is not as good as the second or third or even fifth idea. In fact, the point of brainstorming is to get *lots* of ideas in the expectation of getting *better* ideas.

In the same way, reading more about a topic can help you be a better writer by giving you more ideas and information about the topic. Reading can provide new thoughts or new ways of considering a topic, which in turn can help you write a more informed essay than you otherwise might. So, as you read and take notes, do not worry about having too much information. Usually, it is better to have too many ideas and more information than you will actually use. Later, you can select the most relevant or important points for your writing. A sound strategy is to keep reading about your topic until you feel you are no longer learning anything new.

READING SELECTION

"AMERICA'S REAL 'FREEDOM DIVIDEND': HARD WORK AND PRO-BUSINESS POLICIES"

Before You Read: Preview

Answer the following questions in complete sentences.

1. Consider the article's title. What do you think the author will argue about universal basic income?
2. The author, Larry Elder, is a conservative. What values do conservatives support? Do you think these values would lead to supporting or to opposing a universal basic income?

During Reading: Annotation

3. As you read and reread, annotate the reading by noting the advantages and/or the arguments in support of universal basic income and the disadvantages and/or the arguments against universal basic income. Be alert for parallel points—related or matching characteristics—to use for analyzing the advantages and disadvantages.

America's Real "Freedom Dividend": Hard Work and Pro-Business Policies

By Larry Elder

The Epoch Times, 29 December 2019

Larry Elder is a nationally syndicated conservative radio talk show host, author, and filmmaker. In this opinion piece, Elder uses the term "freedom dividend," which was coined by Democratic presidential candidate Andrew Yang to refer to a universal basic income.

Democratic presidential candidate Andrew Yang is on to something: Americans could use a big "freedom dividend"—that is, a guaranteed source of income on which they can rely month after month, free from the uncertainties of the job market and employment. 1

But like many Democrats' ideas, Yang's otherwise brilliant insight is corrupted by an ideology that strangely sees the government as the engine of wealth creation and distribution. 2

Yang's plan to provide a universal basic income of $1,000 per month to every American over age 18 sounds pretty good. All that money could go toward education, health care, job retraining, or even housing assistance for everyday Americans. It also could be wasted with mindless consumer spending on things like clothing, electronics, or even drugs. 3

Yes, average American families need more money. But what they don't need is yet another government bureaucracy that will tax and administer this so-called dividend, which would really be a loan. The United States is sinking under the weight of financial obligations that have burgeoned over the years from a commonsense approach to helping aging citizens—Social Security and Medicaid—into a gargantuan system of bureaucracy and debt our nation no longer can afford. 4

In fact, entitlement spending has become so politically sacrosanct that even modest attempts to reform the system by, for example, enacting sliding age requirements to Social Security based on the increasing life expectancy of retirees, have been met with howls of opposition. Once someone believes the government "owes" them something, it creates a sense of ownership and entitlement—and, ultimately, dependency—that prevents them from making rational choices about how to work, how to save, and how to make healthier choices that ultimately could reduce the need for catastrophic health care. 5

A better idea would be for Americans to create their own dividend by working hard, saving, and ultimately investing their money in a way that provides them with a constant income. For example, about $240,000 invested at a relatively "safe" rate of 5 percent per year—achievable without incurring undue investment risk—would provide a dividend of about $12,000 per year. But more importantly, the work and discipline it would require 6

for the average person to save that amount would provide far more personal security than a government handout. Furthermore, the productive capacity that it would take to earn more than $200,000 would greatly aid our nation in terms of overall economic growth.

Contrary to popular belief, and even current Federal Reserve policy, government money doesn't grow on printing presses. It comes from taxes paid by workers and businesses on their earned income. If people are disincentivized to work because of a guaranteed handout from the government, there will be fewer people available to actually pay the tens of billions of dollars in new taxes it would take to fund this new entitlement Yang envisions. 7

Proponents claim that guaranteeing basic income would create an economic multiplier that could grow GDP. 8

"Overall, the cost of the freedom dividend will be offset by new revenue, fiscal savings, and economic growth. Areas where we'll see fiscal savings include the reduction of health care costs, lower incarceration rates, reduced homelessness, and bureaucratic downsizing. Additionally, the freedom dividend will boost GDP, increase consumer spending, create jobs, and lead to more tax revenue," said S.Y. Lee, national press secretary for the Yang campaign. 9

It's obvious that Lee's argument rests on a sleight of hand. What proponents of universal basic income claim is that when the government actually gives people money, it saves what it would have to spend down the line curing the ills of poverty—bad health, incarceration, and government assistance in other forms. But this rests on a major assumption: that the government should be in the business of providing expensive social services in the first place. 10

Government health care, for example, has proven to be a major fiasco in this country. Despite spending more on health care than any other country—more than $1 trillion in 2018—U.S. health outcomes, including life expectancy, have declined in recent years. More importantly, our "health span," or the amount of time people can maintain healthy, productive lives, has declined in the age of massive health care bureaucracies fed by government spending. 11

A real American freedom dividend would involve putting in place probusiness policies, such as deregulation and lowering taxes, and labor market policies, such as reducing illegal immigrant labor competition. These policies don't require the government to spend a thing—or require it to spend less—while at the same time removing barriers to employment and economic growth. 12

Investing in business and job growth produces actual dividends, not, like Yang's proposal, tens of billions of dollars of new government debt. 13

After Reading: Summarize

Refer to the preceding Reading Selection as you answer the following questions. Follow the instructions for each exercise.

4. Identify at least three parallel points in the reading that you could use to compare or contrast the advantages and disadvantages of a universal basic income, or to compare and contrast the arguments for or against a universal basic income.

5. In your own words, write a summary of the advantages and disadvantages of universal basic income, or the arguments for or against universal basic income from the article, using the parallel points you identified in question 4.

Engage with the Reading

1. Which advantages cited in the article might make you want to support universal basic income? Explain.
2. Which disadvantages cited in the article might make you *not* want to support universal basic income? Explain

Organizational Methods

Juggling more than one subject in a single piece of writing can be tricky. For example, writing about two (or more) subjects requires presenting the similarities and differences in a balanced and clear way. Two traditional formats for organizing comparison or contrast essays can help:

- The block method
- The point-by-point method

Block Method. The **block method** of organization focuses on one subject (such as arguments in favor of universal basic income), including all the supporting information; this discussion would be "block" number 1. Then the process switches to writing about the second subject (such as arguments in opposition to universal basic income), including all the supporting information; this discussion would be "block" number 2. A block could be one paragraph or several paragraphs depending on the number of parallel points and the length of the discussion needed for each.

To create continuity between the two blocks, parallel points (such as cost to the government and impact on work) would be discussed within each block. This creates a logical, consistent connection between the subjects. An outline of the body of an essay using the block method would deal first with one subject and then with the next (Figure 9.2).

An advantage of the block method is that one topic is discussed thoroughly and then the other topic is also discussed in depth. A disadvantage is that the essay could end up seeming like unconnected lists of details about each topic. To ensure continuity, use transitions when discussing the second topic, such as "In the same way . . ." or "In contrast to. . . ." This will help readers remember information about the first topic and understand how the two topics are related.

Point-by-Point Method. The **point-by-point method** moves back and forth between the two subjects throughout the essay. For instance, within one paragraph the writer may focus on comparisons or contrasts between parallel points, or a writer might compose one paragraph about one point, then in the following paragraph compare the same parallel point. In this way, the parallel points are discussed close together in the essay, before moving on to a new parallel point. Figure 9.3 shows a sample outline for a point-by-point comparison or contrast of arguments for and against universal basic income.

FIGURE 9.2 **Block Method: Sample Outline**

I. Introduction
   A. Thesis statement
II. Arguments in Favor of Universal Basic Income
   A. Reduce poverty
   B. Improve people's health
   C. Enable workers to retrain
   D. Allow for home care
   E. Reduce government programs
III. Arguments against Universal Basic Income
   A. Create an underclass
   B. Increase laziness
   C. Devalue work
   D. Increase taxes on workers
   E. Increase government spending
IV. Conclusion

FIGURE 9.3 **Point-by-Point Method: Sample Outline**

I. Introduction
   A. Thesis statement
II. Body Paragraph 1: First Parallel Point: Poverty
   A. Against: Creates an underclass
   B. For: Raises people out of poverty
III. Body Paragraph 2: Second Parallel Point: Health
   A. Against: Increases laziness
   B. For: Improves health
IV. Body Paragraph 3: Third Parallel Point: Value of Work
   A. Against: Devalues work
   B. For: Enables workers to retrain
V. Paragraph 4: Fourth Parallel Point: Work Burden
   A. Against: Workers must support nonworkers
   B. For: Allows people to care for family members
VI. Body Paragraph 5: Fifth Parallel Point: Government Spending
   A. Against: Increases government spending
   B. For: Eliminates government entitlement programs
VII. Conclusion

An advantage of the point-by-point method is that the similarities and differences between the subjects are instantly clear to readers because the writer moves back and forth between them throughout the writing, noting the similarities or differences each time. Some disadvantages are that continually switching back and forth between subjects might be confusing to readers or that the subjects might not be addressed in depth.

When Should You Use the Block Method and When Should You Use Point-by-Point?

While there is no "right answer," here are two suggestions:

- For a short assignment (one to three pages) or when you have few points (one to three) of comparison, often the block method is preferable because readers can recall the points about the first subject as the second subject is discussed.
- For longer assignments (three or more pages) or cases in which there are multiple points of comparison (three or more), the point-by-point method may be preferable, as readers can more easily see the points of comparison when they are presented next to each other.

PREPARING AND DRAFTING A COMPARE-CONTRAST ESSAY

When writing a compare-contrast essay, remember this key point: you not only want to identify similarities and differences between your two (or more) subjects, you also must have a *reason* or purpose for making the comparison or contrast. The objective might be to sharpen your understanding of the subjects, to form a judgment about them, or to reach a conclusion. For example, a student who compares the advantages and disadvantages of attending a two-year college to a four-year college might use the comparison to decide which type of school is a better fit. A student who compares the advantages and disadvantages of taking classes online versus in a traditional classroom might better understand what it takes to succeed in either learning environment. A student who compares the arguments for and against a universal basic income might decide whether or not to vote for a candidate who supports or opposes such a program. As you plan your essay, think carefully about what you want to say about the subjects, and why.

From Notes to Outline

You might begin your comparison or contrast essay by doing the following:

- Organize your reading notes, including your annotations, plus any lists, charts, or diagrams you have created.

- Consider which method—block or point-by-point—would more effectively organize your ideas.
- Take your notes from the various readings and select important parallel points. Arrange the points in the most logical order to build an outline for your essay.

Developing a Compare-Contrast Thesis Statement

The thesis statement of a compare-contrast paper is critical, as it sums up not only *what* is being compared and contrasted but also *why*. Rather than simply providing a list of similarities and differences, the thesis statement should give readers reasons to care about the subjects. The thesis statement should

- Include the *two (or more) subjects* being compared or contrasted.
- Describe *specifically how* the subjects will be compared or contrasted.
- Suggest why it is *interesting or meaningful* to compare or contrast the subjects.

To avoid writing a weak thesis statement, ask yourself, so what? Why is it interesting or meaningful to compare or contrast these subjects? Why should readers care? Think about your audience and the purpose for your comparison.

Avoid writing a weak thesis statement like the following:

WEAK THESIS: There are many arguments for and against a universal basic income.

COMMENT: This generic thesis statement simply identifies the two subjects. It says nothing interesting about them. The fact that the writer could substitute just about any two subjects into this thesis shows that it does not say anything meaningful.

Instead, write a specific thesis statement that explains why the topic is important, like the following:

STRONG THESIS: A universal basic income (UBI) is a program the United States should implement because it promises to lift people out of poverty and provide dignity and opportunities to all citizens, even if opponents of UBI worry that it can become an expensive bureaucracy that disincentivizes work.

COMMENT: This thesis statement is more specific about the two subjects. It also suggests an argument: that UBI is a program worth pursuing because of its benefits to individuals, despite the concerns of its detractors.

DRAFTING A COMPARE-CONTRAST ESSAY

With your outline and thesis statement in hand, you are prepared to draft your essay. A good place to begin is with the body paragraphs, which will include the most important ideas and supporting information. In addition, you should already have notes, annotations, lists, charts, and so on with which to develop the body paragraphs. Depending on your outline, you can write paragraphs using the block method (Figure 9.4) or point-by-point method (Figure 9.5).

FIGURE 9.4 **Paragraphs Using the Block Method**

Some people argue that because a universal basic income (UBI) provides every person a guaranteed income, this payment will disincentivize people to work. For instance, one opponent of UBI, Larry Elder, who is a conservative talk show host and author, claims, "Once someone believes the government 'owes' them something, it creates a sense of ownership and entitlement—and ultimately dependency." In other words, no one would be motivated to work if they didn't have to and if the government provided them with money. Oren Cass, a Senior Fellow at the Manhattan Institute, a conservative think tank, also claims that UBI would make work seem optional, because "[m]any recipients might prefer to live on the free income rather than get a job." These opponents believe that without the motivation of a salary, people would rather not work.

In contrast, supporters of UBI suggest that with a basic income people might become more independent and motivated to work or improve their careers. For instance, Andreas Kluth, writing for the *Economist*, points out that workers who lose their jobs could with a UBI "retrain for different careers," or "invest in their own skills" and therefore "reenter the workforce at a higher level." That is, UBI would provide a cushion against unemployment or an opportunity to advance. Moreover, many UBI supporters note that UBI subsidies would barely support someone to live. Andrew Yang's proposed $1,000 per month or $12,000 per year for American citizens—the Freedom Dividend that Elder argues against—is still below the poverty level of $12,760, as estimated by the United States Health and Human Services Department. In fact, Andrew Yang argues that UBI would encourage and enable people to seek work. As he explains on his website, recipients of welfare often lose their benefits if they become employed, but with UBI, "recipients are free to seek additional income, which most everyone does."

FIGURE 9.5 Paragraph Using the Point-by-Point Method

One of the more contentious arguments in the debate over universal basic income (UBI) is whether providing every person with a guaranteed income will disincentivize people to work. One opponent of UBI, Larry Elder, who is a conservative talk show host and author, claims, "Once someone believes the government 'owes' them something, it creates a sense of ownership and entitlement—and ultimately dependency." In other words, no one would be motivated to work if they didn't have to and if the government provided them with money. In contrast, supporters of UBI, like Andreas Kluth, who writes for the *Economist* magazine, suggest that with a basic income, workers who lose their jobs could "retrain for different careers," or "invest in their own skills" and therefore "reenter the workforce at a higher level." That is, UBI would provide a cushion against unemployment or an opportunity to advance. In contrast to this optimistic view Oren Cass, a Senior Fellow at the Manhattan Institute, a conservative think tank, makes a more pessimistic claim that UBI would make work seem optional, because "[m]any recipients might prefer to live on the free income rather than get a job." However, while the opponents' arguments seem logical, they are not grounded in reality since many UBI subsidies would barely support someone to live. Andrew Yang's proposed $1,000 per month or $12,000 per year for American citizens—the Freedom Dividend that Elder argues against—is still below the poverty level of $12,760, as estimated by the United States Health and Human Services Department. In fact, Andrew Yang argues that UBI would encourage and enable people to seek work. As he explains on his website, recipients of welfare often lose their benefits if they become employed. With UBI, "recipients are free to seek additional income, which most everyone does."

After developing the body paragraphs, you will want to compose an introduction and a conclusion. Review "The Writing Project" chapter to recall strategies for writing introductions and conclusions. Use the Checklist for a Comparison Paper to ensure that all parts of the paper are strong.

Checklist for a Comparison Paper

- **Is there an interesting or meaningful reason for the comparison or contrast?**
- **Does the introduction provide background on the topic, get the reader's interest, and lead into the subject of the paper?**
- **Does the thesis statement include at least two subjects being compared or contrasted and state specifically how they will be compared?**
- **Are body paragraphs logically organized?**

continued

- **Are there clear transitions between paragraphs?**
- **Is there support, such as quotations or summarized information from readings, for the ideas in the body paragraphs?**
- **Are the subjects treated equally?**
- **Does the conclusion bring the paper to a satisfying close?**

Academic Style: Creating Transitions

In writing, making a transition means moving from one main idea to another or moving from a main idea to an example. In an essay, transitions create logical connections between sentences, paragraphs, and sections. Transitions help readers make sense of the information. A transition can be a word, phrase, or even a complete sentence.

This style box focuses on creating effective transitions from one paragraph to another. Here are three tips:

1. Sum up and set up.

One strategy for moving from one paragraph to the next is to use the topic sentence to briefly sum up the main idea of the previous paragraph and then to set up the main idea of the next paragraph. This type of transition works well if there is a strong, logical relationship from one paragraph to the next, such as in a cause-effect or problem-solution situation.

Example:

Although research on UBI is not conclusive, some evidence suggests that

sum up previous paragraph

a steady, monthly wage will not discourage people from working, from seeking employment or from retraining for a new job.

set up main idea of paragraph

continued

2. Focus on an example.

Sometimes a new paragraph continues the idea from the preceding paragraph. In such a case, a transitional device may indicate the new paragraph focuses on an example illustrating the previous paragraph's main idea or on a specific aspect of that main idea. In Larry Elder's article, he uses government health care (in one paragraph) as an example of how government should not be "providing expensive social services" (idea of the previous paragraph).

Example: "Government health care, for example, has proven to be a major fiasco in this country.

transitional phrase indicates example

3. Use key words to create continuity.

Sometimes writers develop ideas about a topic over several paragraphs. Using key words related to the topic as transitional elements indicates to readers that the writer is staying on the same topic. Notice the repetition of the word work in the topic sentences in "A Universal Basic Income: What Difference Might It Make?" to extend a discussion of how UBI can improve working conditions and resolve problems currently existing in the workplace.

Example: The precarious nature of work . . .

introduces the topic of problems with work

Example: . . . a BI could also potentially insulate workers against the poverty resulting from . . .

continues discussion of how UBI can solve problems with work

Example: Moving beyond right-to work initiatives, which frame "work" narrowly . . .

more discussion of how UBI can solve problems with work

Example: This definition of work . . .

final discussion of how UBI can solve problems with work

Activity 9.1 Selecting a Prompt

Review the essay prompts, rate them in order of interest to you, and select one.

Solid Prompts

1. Based on the Selected Readings in this chapter, explain the arguments for and against a universal basic income. Then draw a conclusion as to whether supporting a universal basic income makes sense.
2. Compare the views of the authors in the first Reading Selection to the views of Larry Elder in the second about universal income. Then determine which article makes a more compelling argument about universal basic income.
3. Select an issue about which you are undecided and examine the arguments for and against. Arrive at a conclusion about that issue.

Challenge Choices *These prompts are more challenging because they require research and engagement with multiple sources.*

1. Conduct research and do more reading on the arguments for and against a universal basic income. Then write an essay in which you compare the arguments for and against and determine whether supporting a universal basic income program makes sense.
2. Imagine that Christine Morley and Larry Elder are invited to debate the topic of universal income on your college campus. Recreate that debate by presenting their arguments for or against a universal basic income. As the debate moderator, explain which person won the debate by making a more compelling argument and why.
3. Conduct research and do more reading on the research examining universal basic income programs. Compare the findings of various research studies. Then reach a conclusion as to whether or not there is sufficient evidence to support or not support universal basic income.

Activity 9.2 Listing Ideas

Answer the following questions, being sure to follow the directions for each.

1. Review Figure 9.1. Notice that the table includes side-by-side *cells,* or boxes, that compare arguments for and against universal basic income. Using key words or phrases, name each parallel point of comparison for each set of cells. For instance, the first parallel point might be named "earning money."
2. Consider the essay prompt you chose in Activity 9.1 and create a list, chart, or diagram comparing the topics you will write about in your essay.

Pair and Share

3. With a partner, compare your answers to exercise 1. Determine which key words or phrases best represent the points of comparison for each set of cells.

4. With a partner, compare your answers to exercise 2. Check that your partner's list has parallel points.

Activity 9.3 Reading to Synthesize Information

Answer the following questions, being sure to follow the directions for each.

1. Do some further reading and research on your topic (from Activity 9.3). Add quotes, summarized information, or examples from the readings to your list (from Activity 9.2).
2. Review your list (from exercise 1) and consider revising it by adding to existing parallel points of comparison, creating new parallel points, and revising existing parallel points or information, or by applying any combination of these strategies.

Activity 9.4 Drafting a Compare-Contrast Outline

Answer the following questions, being sure to follow the directions for each.

1. Review your work in Activities 9.2 and 9.3, along with your annotations and notes. Identify parallel points. Select the points most important for your topic.
2. Consider how you want to organize the essay: block method or point-by-point. Select one organizational pattern and explain why you chose it.
3. Create an outline to show the main parallel points of the paper. Organize it according to the method you chose in exercise 2.

Pair and Share

Exchange your outline with a classmate. Have your classmate check your outline by identifying the organizational pattern of your essay and the parallel points of comparison or contrast.

Activity 9.5 Drafting a Compare-Contrast Thesis Statement

Answer the following questions, being sure to follow the directions for each.

1. Write a thesis statement for your paper. Begin by asking yourself, so what? What is interesting or meaningful about the subjects?
2. Examine your thesis statement by considering the bulleted suggestions for a thesis statement. Revise your thesis as needed.

Pair and Share

Exchange your revised thesis statement (from exercise 2) with a classmate. Have your classmate identify its strengths and weaknesses by using the bulleted criteria.

Activity 9.6 Drafting a Compare-Contrast Essay

1. Review the outline you created in Activity 9.5. Write body paragraphs for each part of your outline.
2. Review the introductions in both Reading Selections. What strategies do the writers use to start their articles? What strategy could you use for your introduction? Write an opening paragraph for your comparison-contrast paper.
3. Review the conclusions in both Reading Selections. What strategies do the writers use to end their articles? What strategy could you use for your conclusion? Write a conclusion for your comparison-contrast paper.

Pair and Share

4. Exchange your body paragraphs (from exercise 1) with another student in the class. Read each other's paragraphs.
5. Exchange your introduction (from exercise 2) with another student in the class. Read each other's introductions and identify the strategies you used to begin the paper. Is the introduction effective? Why or why not?
6. Exchange your conclusion (from exercise 3) with another student in the class. Read each other's conclusions and identify the strategies you used to end the paper. Is the conclusion effective? Why or why not?

Activity 9.7 Creating Transitions

1. Review your own essay draft. Look at the sentence beginning each body paragraph. Determine whether the sentence provides a logical transition from the previous paragraph and revise if necessary.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

block method An organizational approach for comparing or contrasting that involves writing first about one subject and then about the second subject.

compare To identify the similarities between two subjects.

contrast To identify the differences between two subjects.

parallels Related or matching characteristics.

point-by-point method An organizational approach for comparing or contrasting that involves moving back and forth between the two subjects.

Chapter Summary

- Comparing (noting similarities) and contrasting (noting differences) should help you understand issues, make a judgment, or arrive at a conclusion about the subjects.
- Finding parallel elements between the two or more subjects being compared or contrasted helps create coherence in writing.
- Lists, charts, and diagrams are tools for identifying points of comparison or contrast between two or more subjects when reading or writing to compare and contrast.
- Two common patterns of organizing comparisons and contrasts are the block method, which deals completely with one subject at a time and then shifts to the second subject, and the point-by-point method, which moves back and forth between the two subjects within the same body paragraph.
- Strategies for synthesizing information from your own thinking and reading include adding to or revising existing parallel points and creating new parallel points of comparison.
- The thesis statement of a compare-contrast essay sums up not only *what* is being compared and contrasted but also *why*.
- Body paragraphs of a compare-contrast essay should reflect a logical organizational method.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Write an essay comparing the advantages and disadvantages of two educational majors you might be interested in pursuing. In your paper, explain which major you would choose and why. (Note: If you are currently "undeclared" then consider two majors that appeal to you; if you have declared a major, then compare your declared major to another possible field of study.)
2. Research two careers you are considering. Then write an essay comparing the two careers. Arrive at a conclusion as to which one you would prefer and why.

Credits

pp. 226–230: Morley, Christine, Phillip Ablett, and Jenni Mays. "Universal Basic Income: What Difference Might It Make?" *Social Alternatives* 38, no. 2 (2019): 11–18. Used with permission; **pp. 232–233:** Elder, Larry. "America's Real 'Freedom Dividend': Hard Work and Pro-Business Policies." *The Epoch Times,* 29 December 2019. https://www.theepochtimes.com/americas-real-freedom-dividend-hard-work-and-pro-business-policies_3187992.html. Used with permission.

CHAPTER 10

Synthesizing Texts

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Take notes to synthesize information from various readings.
- Write a synthesis thesis.
- Compose a body paragraph that synthesizes information from multiple sources.
- Plan a synthesis paper.

Theme: How Will Climate Change Affect Us?

Reading forms the basis for much of college writing, and indeed you will often be called on to think about and write about texts you read. When you write about what you read, you are basically saying, "This is what I read and learned; this is what I understand about the topic." But also, your instructors may expect you to do more than simply repeat what you learned from assigned readings. They assume you will be able to explain ideas in the readings or relate these to other situations. They may require you to evaluate or give your opinion about what you read. They may want you to synthesize or organize information in original ways.

In this chapter, you will read texts to synthesize information about the effects of climate change. Climate change is a well-established phenomenon: major scientific organizations, such as the United States National Academy of Sciences (USNAS); important government agencies, such as the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA); and international groups, like the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC), all agree that climate change is happening now. These organizations also study climate change to understand how to slow the progress of global warming and to learn how climate change affects the natural environment, the economies of nations, and the lives of human beings. One area of research examines the unequal impacts of climate change on communities and countries, which is the focus of this chapter's readings.

PURPOSE OF SYNTHESIZING SOURCES

To **synthesize** means to combine different ideas into a new whole. If you have ever written a research paper, you have most likely written a synthesis. That is because the purpose of a research paper is to explore and understand a topic, then present the researched information in a clear, coherent, and original way. In other words, writing a research paper involves reading multiple sources (with different ideas on a subject), then presenting these in a new way (as a new whole piece of writing).

A synthesis can be **explanatory** or **argumentative**. The goal of an explanatory synthesis is to explain information from various sources, while an argumentative synthesis takes a position on a topic and uses various sources for support. In this chapter, we will focus on explanatory synthesis. The chapter "Arguing with Texts" focuses on writing an argumentative synthesis.

Synthesizing requires drawing on skills discussed in previous chapters, such as active reading and annotating ("Active Reading") and summarizing and quoting from sources ("Summarizing Texts"). Synthesizing builds on strategies used to compare sources, such as understanding parallel points or related ideas ("Comparing Texts"). Although the goal of a synthesis is to explain a topic, you must use your ability to make judgments and see connections between various sources. A synthesis should not be a serial summary of sources, but rather a reasoned explanation of the important issues about a topic.

Synthesis paper = combining different ideas or information into an original paper

- **Explanatory synthesis = explains a topic and uses various sources to illustrate the topic**

  Example: A research paper that details the causes for the rise in global temperatures over the last 200 years, supported by facts and evidence

- **Argumentative synthesis = takes a position on a topic and uses various sources for support**

  Example: A paper that proposes prohibiting the sale of gas-burning vehicles by the year 2030 to significantly reduce carbon emissions in the United States, supported by experts and scientific data

READING TO SYNTHESIZE

When you read to understand a topic and synthesize information, you should have a specific purpose in mind. For instance, imagine you are assigned to write an essay explaining the impacts of fossil fuel emissions on the natural environment, including human beings and animals. It would make sense to pay attention to facts and statistics related to burning coal, oil, and natural gas, and look for examples showing how these energy sources have impacted ecosystems, individuals, and animals. Suppose, instead, that the assignment is to write an essay proposing ways to slow climate change. In your reading, you would look for examples of strategies to curb global warming and evidence that these strategies

work. The essay prompt and your purpose for writing will determine the parts of a reading to which you pay the most attention.

Additionally, consider your audience when reading and looking for evidence. If writing for community members, predictions about the effects of climate change on the local land and regional weather may be relevant to their interests. If speaking to an elected official at the national level, evidence that climate change will disrupt the economy or increase unemployment may engage their attention.

Once you select the parts of a reading that are most relevant to your purpose and audience, you will want to take notes from those parts. One way to take notes is to annotate the text. This way your ideas and the information you may include in a paper are on the text and you can easily find and refer to these as you plan and write your paper.

Consider summarizing information from the reading, as well as marking quotations. As you read and take notes, also consider ways to connect information to the essay topic and relate it to other information. Figure 10.1 illustrates how you can take notes on a reading by summarizing key ideas in the margin, marking quotations, and jotting down ideas that connect information in the reading to the topic.

FIGURE 10.1 Annotated Article

Source: Nestel, M.L. American Refugees: How Climate Change Might Force U.S. Migration North and Where They Could Go. *Newsweek,* 22 March 2019. Copyright ©2019 by EnVeritas Group. Used with permission.

Summaries and Quotes

Connections

American Refugees: How Climate Change Might Force U.S. Migration North and Where They Could Go
By M.L. Nestel

***Newsweek*, 22 March 2019**

Summary: Climate change could force many U.S. citizens to move north.

Climate change is sometimes pouring down or boiling above. But it's not always obvious. And for a segment of the population throughout the United States, climate change could be the culprit that displaces them, creating a new wave of American refugees. Rising sea levels and temperatures are already uprooting residents and leading some experts to question if we'll see a mass migration north.

The barrage of big storms (known as "heavy precipitation events") the last half century and the rising mercury levels atomizing the polar ice caps and scorching so many states may one day force Americans to make a tough choice: either become weather refugees and migrate to cooler Northern Hemisphere domains, or suffer the consequences of staying.

In Duluth, Minnesota, this week, Jesse Keenan, a faculty member of the Graduate School of Design at Harvard College, opened the floodgates to the

idea that certain places may be prime to hordes of people fleeing Mother Nature's wild side.

He touched on how humans may soon have to follow the lead of other creatures.

Quote: "[E]verything else in the Northern Hemisphere [is] moving north slowly . . . So why wouldn't people also do that?"

"What we understand is the northern migration of flora and fauna, fisheries and everything else in the Northern Hemisphere. . . . They're moving north slowly," he said. "So why wouldn't people also do that?" Keenan said, according to *The Duluth News Tribune,* before partaking in the panel discussion for "Our Climate Futures: Meeting the Challenge in Duluth."

It's not just fish that are being watched and heading for cooler dwellings, but caribou, birds, insects and even plants. "Every organism has a certain set of conditions where it's comfortable to live and reproduce," Patrick Schoff, a biologist at the University of Minnesota Duluth told *Newsweek*.

That means it's only natural to go where those conditions are met. And with the depletion of polar ice caps, dark sun-absorbing rocks are causing more heat and the changes are happening at warp speed.

"Biology is used to moving, but it's not used to moving at the speed that we're forcing it to," he said.

This situation makes finding homes away from homes all the more crucial.

Lovely Warren, the mayor of Rochester, New York, described her city, where around 210,000 live, as "one of the snowiest cities in the country." With 99 inches dumping a year, it competes on that score with big cities like Chicago or Minneapolis.

But the summers are easy living. And the year-round average temperature is 48.4-degrees Fahrenheit.

Summary: Rochester, New York, had an influx of climate refugees after Hurricane Maria struck Puerto Rico.

The city had already welcomed "a significant number" of displaced residents from Puerto Rico after Hurricane Maria tore through the island, and the mayor encourages the numbers in a city already hit with population decreases as manufacturing giants left and their workers with them. What she hopes for is a resurgence the likes of Kodak, Xerox and Bausch & Lomb—which all got their start in Rochester.

Some cities, like Rochester, New York, may welcome climate refugees, but other cities, like South Burlington, Vermont, may not have the infrastructure to handle lots of new residents.

"Increasing our tax base will lead to more jobs and a more vibrant community for our businesses and residents, and we welcome an influx of citizens for any reason," she wrote.

But how are they going to manage to house a potential endless amount of transplants?

"Rochester was a city that had over 300,000 residents at one point—so we have ample housing stock to handle this," she stated.

Summary: Large migrations of people can be detrimental.

The movement of a species—be it human or bird or insect—can cause adverse effects.

Quote: "If you increase a population . . . you increase the stress on everything. . ."

"If you increase a population by a certain amount, you increase the stress on everything including the food deliveries, infrastructure, water, streets and transportation," Kristy Dahl, a senior climate scientist at the Union of Concerned Scientists, told *Newsweek*.

Dahl is seeing telltale signs of migration to the Northern Hemisphere. But some folks living in particularly vulnerable places are going to have a tough time selling a home whose worth is already sinking under water.

Summary: It will be harder to sell a home in a flood zone or your home may end up worth less money.

"Homeowners who have a home that is at risk to frequent flooding in the near term may be able to find a buyer," she said. But after so many years pass, "eventually some unlucky homeowner is going to be left holding the bag."

She pointed to Miami, where scientists are studying residential homes "exposed to flooding and appreciating at lower rates than those that don't have that same flood risk."

"There will be places within the next 30 years or so that would be significantly impacted by sea level rise," she said.

This could render into dead zones some parts of the country where it's too hot or too wet to stay.

Summary: Hurricanes, like Sandy, also kill people.

Superstorm Sandy struck over Halloween in 2012. And it was a monster. The East Coast was decimated by biblical storm surges that killed 117 people. Twenty-two of those deaths were in Staten Island.

Climate change causes terrible personal loss, from loss of lives (117 killed by Sandy) to loss of homes and possessions, to loss of entire communities.

Denise English, her husband and two daughters survived the superstorm, escaping with their lives from their two-story home on Fox Beach Avenue as the shifting shoreline (already hampered by erosion)

quickly swallowed up most of the homes in their Oakwood Beach neighborhood.

"We were petrified," she recalled to *Newsweek,* of the whipping gusts and rising waters.

In the wake of the storm, the English family permanently evacuated, as did so many of their neighbors, literally leaving the borough's once tight enclave to the birds.

Summary: Hurricanes will force people to leave their homes.

Patricia Snyder, whose house was on the same street as the Englishes', left behind the home she had lived in since she was an 8-year-old girl when Sandy delivered 6 feet of gushing water.

"Everything was gone from my childhood," Snyder said. "It's all a memory, including the antique furniture that belonged to my grandfather."

Summary: Some people may be killed by climate change disasters.

Snyder's husband managed to scale up a neighbor's rooftop to ride out the flooding. Her brother Leonard, who was also her neighbor, did not manage to escape.

"He couldn't get out of the house," she said. "He had gone downstairs in the basement—and there's speculation as to why he went down there—and that's when a 15-foot wave came through."

Summary: Property is lost as are people's possessions.

Real estate agent Joe Tirone's investment property was totaled. But he was concerned about the tenants, "who lost everything they owned," as the stormwaters rose to 11 feet outside the home and 8 feet inside.

Quote: People "lost everything they owned."

"The only things they were able to salvage were stuff on their mattresses that floated up and floated down," he said.

Summary: The government has to pay to help people impacted by climate change.

Tirone led scores of fellow Staten Island stakeholders to get help and secured 185 homes to be purchased outright by appealing to Governor Andrew Cuomo and utilizing the state's and Federal Emergency Management Association's (FEMA) Hazard Mitigation Grant Program, which cut checks for prestorm sums.

The program boasts taking "sustainable action taken to reduce or eliminate long-term risk to people and property from future disasters" and touts "every $1 spent equals $4 of future damages mitigated."

Climate change doesn't only affect those individuals impacted by loss, but also our state and federal government.

Summary: Whole communities are devasted and people have to go elsewhere.

Save for a few stragglers, the Oakwood Beach community is virtually gone. Many relocated out of New York and their homes razed, transformed into open space.

"Anyone who sold a home to the state, [it's] back to nature forever," said Tirone.

This back-to-the-land transformation witnessed in Oakwood Beach is repeating itself in southern swaths of Louisiana and Maryland's Eastern Shore, which scientists believe are also becoming tough places to live.

There have been migrations in the past. There was the massive movement of people West to escape from the Dust Bowl of the 1930s. And throughout the earlier 20th century, millions of African-Americans fled the South in the Great Migration North.

Summary: Climate change will force people to move to safer communities.

Dahl doesn't think that the next chapter will be so extreme that people may end up trekking to the Yukon. But the appeal of a safer haven is going to become more alluring as human populations grow and resources become more fleeting.

"It could make places that people haven't been seeing as destination cities more desirable," she said.

Kevin Dorn is city manager in South Burlington, Vermont. Climate change could wreak havoc for his some 19,000 denizens because of the city's reliance on maple syrup production, which is climate sensitive.

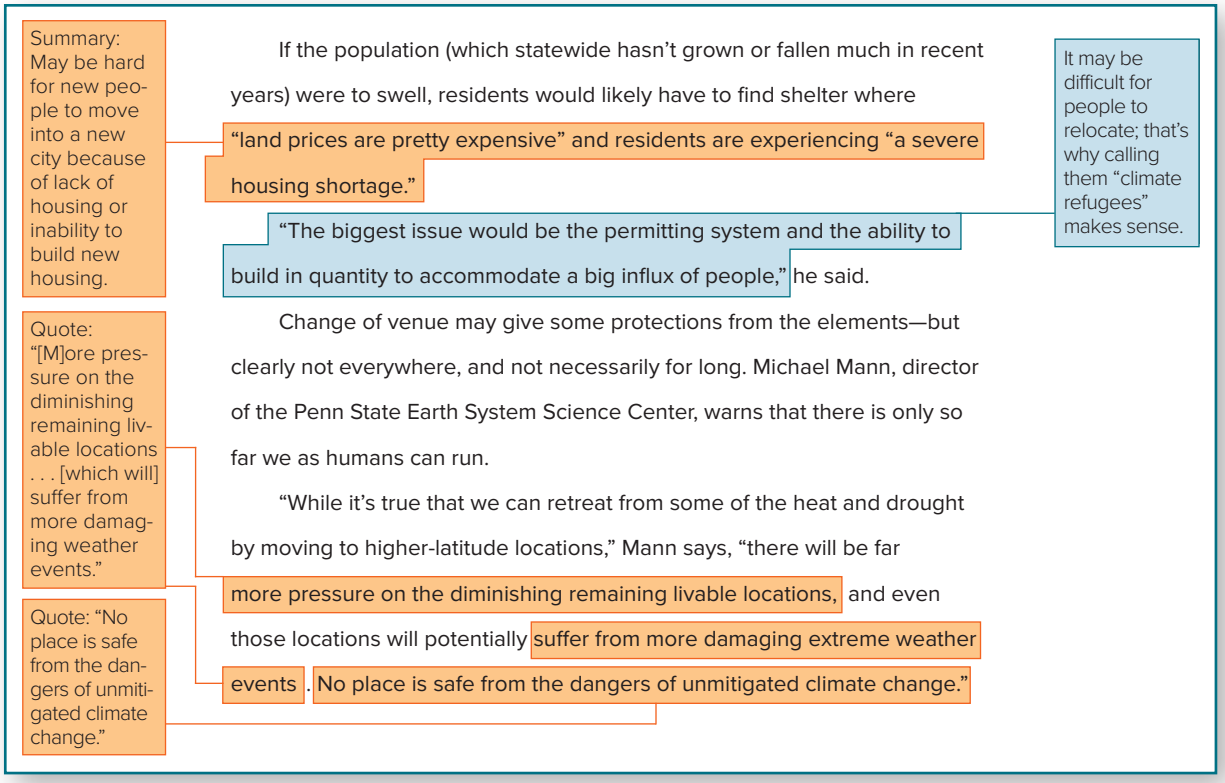
Dorn gets why South Burlington would become a bigger draw for climate refugees. Its schools are top notch and its summers are "pretty cool." The city gets about 81-inches of annual snow, but its winters don't dip too far below 35 degrees Fahrenheit.

Summary: May be hard for new people to move into a new city because of lack of housing or inability to build new housing.

But as for a rush for refuge by outsiders—whom locals refer to suspiciously, and as "Flatlanders"—Dorn has some concerns.

Housing is a consideration. Specifically, if more people come to live in South Burlington, the city will face a logjam of issues getting building permits approved.

"The permit process is arduous," he said. "It can take years or even decades depending on the project."



KEEPING TRACK OF YOUR READING NOTES

There can be more than one way to collect information from your reading, but the most important strategy is to have a system. As you read more sources on the topic, you may find it useful to consolidate your notes into one document. This way, you can also start to see connections between information in various sources and begin to organize your synthesis.

For instance, using a graphic organizer can enable you to not only collect notes from various sources into one document, but also to relate the information between sources. The graphic organizer can enable you to focus on the essay prompt, then look for answers to the prompt (if the prompt is a question) or to develop original ideas on the topic, if you do not have a prompt. As you locate information, you can input that information into the graphic organizer in the form of summaries or quotations, and group-related ideas from different readings. Figure 10.2 shows a generic graphic organizer that can allow you to keep the essay prompt or topic in mind as you read and develop original ideas based on the readings. In the left column, record bibliographic information about the source itself, such as the author and title, that will be needed to create a Works Cited or Reference page. In the middle row, record quotations and write summaries from the source related to various ideas that will help you to address the prompt. Most importantly, along the

topic row will be your own ideas connecting information from various sources.

FIGURE 10.2 Graphic Organizer for Note-Taking

Essay Prompt or Topic	Original Idea Connecting Sources	Original Idea Connecting Sources	Original Idea Connecting Sources	Original Idea Connecting Sources
Source 1	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries
Source 2	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries
Source 3	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries
Source 4	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries	Quotes and summaries

After completing the two Reading Selections in this chapter, we can see how such a generic graphic organizer will work.

READING SELECTION

"BLACK LIVES MATTER: THE LINK BETWEEN CLIMATE CHANGE AND RACIAL JUSTICE"

Before Reading: Recognize Prior Knowledge; Predict

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. What do you know about the Black Lives Matter movement? Explain.
2. Skim the reading, looking at the title and subheadings. What do you think might be a link between climate change and racial justice?

During Reading: Annotate; Summarize

Complete the following exercise.

3. Chunk the reading according to the subheadings; then write a one- or two-sentence summary of each section of the article.

Black Lives Matter: The Link between Climate Change and Racial Justice

By Adelle Thomas and Rueanna Haynes

Climate Analytics, 22 June 2020

Climate Analytics is an international organization formed in 2008 and dedicated to using science to impact policy on climate change. Before working for Climate Analytics, the first author, Adelle Thomas, was an Assistant Professor at the University of the Bahamas, as well as a lead author in the IPCC (Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change) Sixth Assessment Report. The second author, Rueanna Haynes, participated in the UNFCCC (United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change) on behalf of Trinidad and Tobago. Note that the authors use British spelling conventions.

The global movement in support of the rights of Black people highlights the systemic and institutionalised racism that has resulted in the murders of Black people as a result of police brutality and the suppression of economic and social development of Black communities in America. 1

The many videos and accounts of horrific incidents of police violence have spurred protests from diverse groups around the world. People of all ethnicities are joining together to demand an end to these appalling acts of violence, including cries to defund the police and allocate resources to community development, education, and other programs that would uplift Black communities. 2

But, what does Black Lives Matter have to do with climate change? Everything.

In any crisis it is the poorest and most vulnerable that suffer the greatest impacts. 3

This has been most recently demonstrated by the telling statistics of deaths caused by COVID-19, in particular in the United States where Black and Native American people are dying at disproportionately higher rates. The impacts of the pandemic have laid bare the striking inequality in the US and its racist dimensions. 4

As summed up by Patrisse Cullors and Nyeusi Nguvu, members of the Black Lives Matter movement, "Racism is endemic to global inequality. This means that those most affected—and killed—by climate change are Black and poor people". It is for this reason that calls are now being made to centre racial equity and justice in seeking meaningful solutions for the climate crisis. 5

The direct linkages between environmental justice and racial justice have long been areas of research and activism, and the relationship between climate justice and racial justice builds on these connections. Long-standing racist policies and practices—such as residential segregation, unequal educational opportunities, and limited prospects for economic advancement—have led to increased vulnerability of Black people to climate change impacts and by extension other global crises that may emerge. 6

In the United States, disproportionate percentages of people of colour live in places that are polluted with toxic waste, leading to negative health effects such as cancer, asthma, degraded cardiac function and high blood pressure. Research has also highlighted that race has a stronger influence on exposure to pollutants than poverty. This means it is likely that polluters not only site their activities in low income areas, but in some cases are actively selecting locations where there are high percentages of Black people in particular. 7

Climate change intensifies the health impacts of pollution in these communities. For example, higher air temperatures due to global warming traps air pollutants close to the ground, further reducing air quality and exacerbating existing health issues. A recent study of 32 million US births found that women exposed to high temperatures or air pollution are more likely to have premature, underweight or stillborn babies and that Black mothers are most affected. 8

Black communities are also disproportionately located in areas that are physically vulnerable to climate hazards, such as hurricanes and flooding. Moreover, they are often afforded unequal levels of protection from the government as compared to protection provided for other groups. For example, Hurricane Katrina highlighted the legacy of unequal flood protection in New Orleans, where racially biased distribution of government funding resulted in subpar levee protection for Black neighborhoods. 9

Over 80% of the homes that were lost belonged to Black people and Black people made up over half of total fatalities. Even after Black people bore the brunt of impacts of Katrina, initial plans for redevelopment of New Orleans privileged white communities. Subsequent hurricanes have exemplified the racial disparity in disaster recovery aid issuance and prioritisation, with Black people being significantly less likely to have access to assistance for household or business recovery. 10

Climate justice and racial justice are global issues.

Just as the Black Lives Matter movement is not solely about police brutality, it's not just in America where these climate and racial injustices play out. The linkages between racial and climate justice can be seen around the world. 11

In the climate change sphere, it is well understood that those who will suffer the most from climate change impacts (Small Island Developing States and Least Developed Countries) have contributed the least to the global crisis. But just as in developed countries, for developing countries this inequality in distribution of impacts is also relevant at the community level. 12

For example, in Latin America, the most unequal region in the world, it is clear that environmental justice is certainly also a racial justice issue. Issues concerning Indigenous land, the rights of rural landowners, and expansion of energy, agribusiness and other industries are central to racial and environmental justice struggles. 13

Globally, the linkages between climate and racial justice have not gained the recognition they should in the broader climate change movement. At the level of international climate negotiations, the rate of progress on these fronts is still too slow. The human rights lens on climate change in the global discussion has only gained limited traction with some minor progress on the gender and climate change front. 14

In addition to this, systemic racism in the climate movement also results in the marginalisation of Black expertise including scientists and practitioners, as European perspectives are generally supported, prioritised and magnified. Black climate experts face the additional burdens of operating within racist structures while also trying to address climate change. The climate movement simply does not have a good track record of handling issues of equity or understanding climate change in dimensions beyond strictly environmental. 15

However, the Black Lives Matter movement is bringing much needed attention to these issues and will hopefully continue to spur positive change. Due to the movement, climate activists around the world are increasing their support for climate justice and racial justice. 16

These are complex issues and there are no simple fixes. The task of dismantling systemic and institutionalised racism requires more than superficial gestures, but instead entails assessing, changing and even eliminating long-standing systems that lead to inequality. Supporting organisations committed to racial and climate justice and eradicating policies that marginalise Black people and communities of colour are just a few of the widespread changes that must happen. The time has come for the climate change community to recognise and act upon the racial injustices that increase the risks of climate change for Black people and other communities of colour. 17

After Reading: Summarize the Text

Write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

4. The first subheading in the reading asks, "What does Black Lives Matter have to do with climate change?" How would you summarize the authors' answer to that question?
5. The second subheading in the reading states that "climate justice and racial justice are global issues." How would you summarize the authors' explanation of that statement?

Engage with the Reading

1. Locate a piece of information in the reading that sounds unlikely. Summarize or quote that information and explain why you are not convinced by it.
2. Locate a piece of information in the reading that you believe to be true. Summarize or quote that information and explain why you believe it to be true.

CATEGORIZING AND ORGANIZING INFORMATION

Before you draft a synthesis essay, it is crucial that you review and organize your notes with your writing purpose and audience squarely in mind. Take care to create your own organizational plan rather than simply repeating the structure of the readings or writing a summary of each article. In this way, you can convincingly tell readers what you have learned about the essay topic and make your writing your own.

Categorizing Information

One effective way to start planning a synthesis essay is to create your own categories of information and to group related ideas within those categories.

First, review your annotations and notes on the Reading Selections to identify information that addresses the essay prompt. Second, look over your graphic organizer to recall the categories created and the summaries and quotations collected. Let's say your prompt directs you to write about how climate change creates inequities. You might begin by organizing information from the Reading Selections into the two broad categories, say "Inequities among People" and "Inequities among Countries," based on information from your reading. Then, within each category, you can group related ideas. For instance, some inequities among people may have to do with income level and could be grouped in that general way; other inequities may have to do with ethnicity and may be grouped accordingly. Note that not everyone will categorize the inequities in the exact same ways.

Always be sure your classification of information includes separate and distinct categories. For instance, creating one category about how climate change impacts are unequally distributed in minority communities and another category about how climate change impacts are racially biased might not be ideal because the categories are closely related.

Figure 10.3 shows how a student might categorize notes by categorizing information from different sources. The student could then add numbers to reflect the order of ideas to be used in the paper.

FIGURE 10.3 Graphic Organizer Synthesizing Notes

How does climate change impact people?	Creates loss of lives	Creates loss of property	Forces people to move	Magnifies inequities
Nestel, M.L. "American Refugees: How Climate Change Might Force U.S. Migration North and Where They Could Go." *Newsweek,* 22 March 2019.	Hurricane Sandy killed 117 people (Para 23)	Property is lost (example: Joe Tirone's investment property and Patricia Snyder's home), as are people's possessions (tenants "who lost everything they owned") (Para 31)	Climate change could force many US citizens to move north (Para 1) For example, Rochester, New York, had an influx of climate refugees after Hurricane Maria struck Puerto Rico (Para 12)	In the past, poor people during the Dust Bowl or Black people in the Great Migration were impacted by climate changes and lack of opportunities (Para 38)
Thomas, Adelle, and Rueanna Haynes. "Black Lives Matter: The Link between Climate Change and Racial Justice." *Climate Analytics,* 22 June 2020.	Many people died in Hurricane Katrina in New Orleans and over 50% of those people were Black (Para 12)	During Hurricane Katrina in New Orleans, over 80% of homes lost were occupied by Black people (Para 10)	Black people are less likely to receive government assistance for housing or business recovery (Para 9)	"Racism is endemic to global inequality. This means that those most affected—and killed—by climate change are Black and poor people" (Para 5)

Creating an Outline or Paper Plan

After categorizing your notes, you may want to develop a blueprint for your paper by planning or outlining your essay.

Most important when creating a plan or outline for a synthesis paper is to organize the essay around ideas, not by sources. As stated in the beginning of this chapter, a synthesis should not be a sequential summary of sources, but rather an explanation of the important ideas about a topic. This is where your graphic organizer will be invaluable. You can use the ideas along the top row of the organizer to structure the paper. The information from various sources in that column will therefore go into that section of the paper to explain and support that idea. The paper will be controlled by your ideas and by the connections you see among the sources.

An outline is one way to create a writing plan (Figure 10.4). Writers use different types of outlines. Outlines can be as informal as a bulleted list of ideas. Informal outlines often include some phrases and incomplete sentences to express ideas and support, such as the accompanying paper plan. Formal outlines will be discussed later in the chapter "Writing a Research Paper."

FIGURE 10.4 Paper Plan

Thesis: Climate change is predicted to have serious impacts on Americans, including losing lives and property, dislocating people from their homes and communities, and magnifying existing inequities in our country.

- *Section 1: Creates loss of lives*
  - *Source 1: Hurricane Sandy killed 117 people*
  - *Source 2: Many people died in Hurricane Katrina in New Orleans and over 50% of those people were Black*
- *Section 2: Creates loss of property*
  - *Source 1: Property is lost (example: Joe Tirone's investment property and Patricia Snyder's home), as are people's possessions (tenants "who lost everything they owned")*
  - *Source 2: During Hurricane Katrina in New Orleans, over 80% of homes lost were occupied by Black people*
- *Section 3: Forces people to move*
  - *Source 1: Climate change could force many US citizens to move north*

FIGURE 10.4 Paper Plan (*continued*)

For example, Rochester, New York, had an influx of climate refugees after Hurricane Maria struck Puerto Rico

Source 2: Black people are less likely to receive government assistance for housing or business recovery

Section 4: Magnifies inequities

Source 1: In the past, poor people during the Dust Bowl or Black people in the Great Migration were impacted by climate changes and lack of opportunities

Source 2: "Racism is endemic to global inequality. This means that those most affected—and killed—by climate change are Black and poor people"

Note that the paper plan is simply a start as it includes notes on only two sources. With more reading, the plan will include more sources and more quotes and summaries. Moreover, you may add, revise, or delete main ideas of sections depending on the quality and quantity of information to support each main point.

WRITING A THESIS STATEMENT FOR A SYNTHESIS

As we have seen in previous chapters, different types of writing may necessitate different types of thesis statements. For instance, a thesis statement for an informative essay might describe the specific focus of the paper's topic, whereas a persuasive thesis would state the writer's position on the topic ("The Writing Product"). Moreover, a thesis statement for a summary should identify the overall main idea of another piece of writing ("Summarizing Texts"). A compare-contrast thesis statement would include both subjects of the paper and how exactly they will be compared or contrasted ("Comparing Texts"). Clearly there is more than one way to write an effective thesis statement. Consider the assignment, the purpose, and the audience as important factors when composing a thesis.

When drafting a thesis for an explanatory synthesis paper, you might write a general thesis or a more specific thesis. A general thesis, sometimes called an "umbrella thesis," covers the big picture of the paper. That is, it provides readers with an overall sense of what to expect in the paper. In contrast, a more specific

thesis would provide not only the big picture of the paper but also some specific issues or evidence the paper will include.

EXAMPLE OF A GENERAL THESIS STATEMENT

- People of color and low-income communities are disproportionately negatively impacted by climate change.

  Comment: This thesis statement is general because it states the topic of the paper (how climate change negatively impacts poor communities) but does not state how exactly communities are affected or why, or what the solution should be to this problem.

EXAMPLE OF A SPECIFIC THESIS STATEMENT

- People of color and low-income communities are disproportionately negatively impacted by climate change, because they live in areas more susceptible to climate-induced disasters and have fewer resources to recover from such disasters.

  Comment: This thesis statement is specific because it states the topic of the paper (how climate change negatively impacts poor communities) and specifies two reasons why low-income people are more at risk.

SYNTHESIZING INFORMATION IN BODY PARAGRAPHS USING PIE STRUCTURE

A body paragraph typically includes a topic sentence, supporting information, and a closing sentence. When writing an essay to synthesize readings, the topic sentence or main idea should be your unique assessment of the information. It will be an idea you developed based on the reading. The supporting information in a body paragraph comes from those readings in the form of quotations or summaries. Because the support comes from readings, you may need to explain to your readers *how* the information supports the main point of each paragraph. The PIE paragraph structure is a useful model to follow because the PIE paragraph structure helps readers understand what a writer is saying and why.

PIE = Point, Information, Explanation

Point: The main idea of the paragraph, usually revealed in the topic sentence

Information: The support for the main idea, such as quotations and summaries

Explanation: The connection between the point and the information, usually an explanation of how the information supports the main idea

FIGURE 10.5 **PIE Paragraph**

Source: Anne Marie Salgado. "How Climate Change Disproportionately Impacts Low-Income Communities in the United States and What We Can Do About It." 9 Nov. 2020. Used with permission.

Paragraph	Annotations
Additionally, those affected by climate change are likely to suffer from mental health issues. A report released in 2012 by the National Wildlife Federation's Climate Education Program and the Robert Wood Johnson Foundation predicts that climate change will be the catalyst for a steep rise in mental disorders, including depression, anxiety, and posttraumatic stress disorder (PTSD) (Cimons). Natural disasters exacerbate preexisting stressors for those affected by them as well as add new stressors, including stress related to loss of capital and stress from PTSD caused by the disaster. Low-income people suffer disproportionate amounts of distress related to poverty and higher rates of depression, so not only do low-income people suffer more mentally, but they also lack access to coping mechanisms for mental disorders and stressors ("Greater Impact: How Disasters Affect People of Low Socioeconomic Status"). A universal health care plan that covers treatment for mental health, including psychiatric treatment as well as therapy, will alleviate the mental stress for low-income communities, and the alleviation of other health-related stressors will inadvertently improve the overall mental health of individuals within these same communities.	*Point of Paragraph: Climate change impacts mental health.* *Information: Climate change is predicted to increase mental disorders.* *Explanation: Why climate change would increase mental stress* *Information: Low-income people are more likely to be affected mentally.* *Explanation: Need health care that supports mental health*

Figure 10.5 provides an example of a body paragraph written according to the PIE format.

STARTING A SYNTHESIS PAPER

Your reading notes, including annotations on the readings and a graphic organizer, along with a strong thesis statement and a paper plan, will allow you to start to write a synthesis paper. Understanding how to synthesize sources within each body paragraph should furthermore provide a template for developing the rest of the paper.

Figure 10.6 demonstrates how a student introduces the topic of the inequities of climate change and states her thesis (in the first paragraph) and begins to explain the impacts (in the second paragraph) by synthesizing information from various sources.

FIGURE 10.6 **Introduction and First Body Paragraph Synthesis Paper**

Anne Marie Salgado
Prof. Alison Kuehner
ENGL 101C-03
9 Nov. 2020

How Climate Change Disproportionately Impacts Low-Income Communities in the United States and What We Can Do about It

Climate change is inevitable. The world is just beginning to observe the effects climate change is having on Earth's people, these effects including destructive hurricanes, detrimentally hot heatwaves, as well as the destruction of crops, homes, and other public and private property. However, the effects of climate change will not impact people equally. Unfortunately, people with more wealth are more likely to survive the effects of climate change than those with less. Even within a wealthy country such as the United States, there is a great disparity between people of different socioeconomic status. Poor and low-income communities (the majority of which are occupied by Black folks and people of color) are disproportionately negatively impacted by climate change, and while passing policy to attack climate change will indirectly help these communities, a direct solution that is guaranteed to aid these communities is to establish universal health care.

Climate change has, and will continue to have, dire economic consequences for the United States. Hurricane Sandy, for example, wreaked havoc on the U.S. east coast, destroying an estimated 1.8 million structures and homes, as well as racking up over $65 billion in economic losses (Liverman and Glasmeier). Within this disaster one observes a microcosm of the disparity of loss caused by climate change between people of varying levels of socioeconomic status.

While large corporations, such as Home Depot, saw sales go up by hundreds of millions of dollars, small-medium scale businesses were decimated by the hurricane, and over 10,000 people lost jobs in the tourism industry (Liverman and Glasmeier). People living in public housing in New York lost power, heat, and hot water for times ranging from several weeks to several months after the hurricane ravaged the city (Huang). Poor and low-income communities, especially poor communities of color, are more vulnerable to natural disasters and other effects of climate change for several reasons, some of those being: low-income Americans are more likely to live in neighborhoods less insulated against natural disasters, poor families and individuals have less economic security and access to resources, and these same people have less ability to relocate after a natural disaster than affluent people (Krause and Reeves). *[paper continues . . .]*

Checklist for a Synthesis Paper

- _____ Is there a clear thesis statement that identifies the topic of the paper?
- _____ Is the synthesis organized by ideas, rather than by sources?
- _____ Is information in the body paragraphs properly summarized or correctly quoted? Are sources sufficiently identified?
- _____ Is information in the body paragraphs synthesized so that more than one source is used to support main ideas of paragraphs?
- _____ Is the writing clear and concise?

Academic Style: Conciseness

Writing with **concise language** means using as few words as possible to communicate ideas effectively. A sentence is concise when every word serves a purpose. Readers appreciate concise writing because it conveys ideas tightly and clearly.

How can you create concise sentences? Here are three tips:

1. Eliminate empty phrases—words that do not say much and thus are unnecessary.

   Wordy: It seems that there are many effects of climate change on the environment.

   Concise: Climate change has many effects on the environment**.**

2. Avoid repetition.

   Wordy: By studying and researching climate change, scientists have predicted and determined that an average global temperature rise of 2 degrees Celsius will be catastrophic.

   Concise: By studying climate change, scientists have determined that an average global temperature rise of 2 degrees Celsius will be catastrophic.

3. Where possible, use adjectives or adjective phrases before nouns instead of lengthy subordinate clauses.

   Wordy: The climate agreement that happened in Paris in 2016 included 55 countries that account for over 55% of greenhouse gas emissions.

   Concise: The 2016 Paris climate agreement included 55 countries that account for over 55% of greenhouse gas emissions.

Activity 10.1 Evaluate Essay Prompts for a Synthesis Paper

The essay prompts that follow will help you plan and write a synthesis essay. Evaluate the writing topics by marking how interesting you find each one. Check "Interesting topic," "Maybe I could write on this topic," or "Cannot relate to this topic" for each prompt.

Solid Prompts

1. Using the readings in this chapter, explain how climate change will impact people and communities in the United States.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

2. Using the readings in this chapter, explain how climate change will affect inequities among racial and ethnic groups in the United States.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

Challenge Choices *These prompts are more challenging because they require research.*

3. Using the readings in this chapter as well as researched information, describe how climate change affects inequities among countries, especially developing countries vs. developed nations.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

4. Conduct research to determine what solutions have been proposed to mitigate the effects of climate change and how these will work.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

5. Think about a problem in your community, one that you could research and that has various proposed solutions. In an essay, describe the problem and the solutions.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

Activity 10.2 Prewrite on a Topic

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Select one of the essay topics from Activity 10.1 and do some prewriting on the topic. In your prewriting, consider possible answers to the prompt.
2. Reread your prewriting and select the ideas you think are most likely to appear in your reading as answers to the prompt question. Create a graphic organizer, like the one shown in Figure 10.1, to prepare to take notes as you read about the topic.

Pair and Share

Exchange your graphic organizers from Activity 10.2 (exercise 2) with a partner and answer the questions.

1. Do the answers on the graphic organizer seem reasonable and likely to address the essay prompt? If not, which ones might you eliminate or revise, and how?
2. Can you think of other ideas to include on the graphic organizer? If so, add these to the graphic organizer on the top row.

Activity 10.3 Taking Notes on Sources

Review your responses to Activity 10.2 and look again at the graphic organizer you created. Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Select one of your sources and include information about the source needed to create a complete Works Cited entry in the graphic organizer.
2. As you read your source (from exercise 1) take notes, including summarized and quoted information in the middle of the graphic organizer.
3. Consider whether to add or delete or revise categories along the top row on your graphic organizer.
4. Read as many other sources as necessary, following the procedures in exercises 1, 2, and 3.

Pair and Share

Exchange the graphic organizer you created in Activity 10.3 with a partner and evaluate them.

1. Do the ideas along the top row of the graphic organizer address the prompt?
2. Do the notes in the graphic organizer relate to the prompt? Is there a balance of summarized and quoted information?

Activity 10.4 Create a Paper Plan and Thesis Statement

Review the graphic organizer you created in Activity 10.3 and the notes from your reading. Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Create a plan for your synthesis paper, including what you will write in each section.
2. Review the plan for your synthesis paper (from exercise 1) and write a general thesis statement.
3. Review the plan for your synthesis paper (from exercise 1) and write a specific thesis statement.
4. Consider the thesis statements you wrote for exercises 2 and 3; then select the one you feel will work best in your paper. Add this to your paper plan.

Pair and Share

Exchange the thesis statement and paper plan you wrote in Activity 10.4 (exercise 4) with a partner.

1. Review your partner's thesis statement. Do you think the thesis statement covers all the main ideas in the paper?
2. Review your partner's plan. Do you think the ideas are arranged in the outline in a logical order?

Activity 10.5 Draft a Synthesis Paper

Review the chapter text about synthesizing information from readings into a paper, and use your work from Activities 10.1 through 10.4 to complete the following exercises.

1. Using your thesis statement and plan from Activity 10.4, as well as your graphic organizer from Activity 10.3, draft the start of your synthesis paper, including an introduction and body paragraph.
2. Continue writing the body of the paper. Consider using the PIE method of paragraph development to synthesize sources.

Pair and Share

With a partner, follow the instructions for each exercise.

1. Exchange your introduction and first body paragraph of your synthesis paper (from Activity 10.5, exercise 1). Have that classmate evaluate your introduction and body paragraph.
2. Exchange the draft of your synthesis paper (from Activity 10.5, exercises 1 and 2). Have that classmate evaluate your draft using the Checklist for a Synthesis Paper.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

argumentative synthesis Takes a position on a topic and uses various sources for support.

concise language Uses as few words as possible to communicate ideas effectively.

explanatory synthesis Explains a topic and uses various sources to illustrate that topic.

synthesis Combining different ideas or information into a new or original whole.

Chapter Summary

- College students often write about what they read; they read multiple sources and demonstrate their understanding of a topic by synthesizing information.
- When reading to write a synthesis paper, select the parts of the readings most relevant to the paper's purpose and take notes with the essay prompt or topic in mind.
- One strategy to start planning a synthesis essay is to create categories of information, to group related ideas within them, and to use this information to create a paper plan.
- The PIE (point-information-explanation) paragraph structure is one effective structure to include information from various readings in an organized way to support a main idea.
- An effective synthesis paper is organized around ideas, rather than a source-by-source summary, and includes multiple sources to support those ideas.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Imagine a friend asks for advice about writing an explanatory synthesis paper. Give this person your top three tips for writing a strong paper, as well as three things to avoid.
2. Write a PIE paragraph that explains one important idea you learned about climate change from reading the articles in this chapter.

Credits

pp. 255–257: Thomas, Adelle and Rueanna Haynes. Black Lives Matter: The Link Between Climate Change and Racial Justice. *Climate Analytics,* 22 June 2020. https://climateanalytics.org/blog/2020/black-lives-matter-the-link-between-climate-change-and-racial-justice/. Used with permission.

CHAPTER 11

Arguing with Texts

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Identify the parts of an argument, including claim, reasons, and support.
- Introduce controversial issues.
- Organize arguments in essays, whether deductively or inductively.
- Assess arguments for logical fallacies.
- Respond to counterarguments by conceding or rebutting.
- Evaluate an argument.

Theme: How Free Is Speech on College Campuses?

For some people the word *argument* conjures up negative associations. They may think of an argument as a shouting match between two opponents, or as a bickering row between spouses. But in the academic realm, an argument has rules and serves a purpose: to persuade someone, by giving reasons and support, to accept a particular position.

Giving your opinion on a topic, as well as support for that opinion, is the basis of an **argument**. Many essays you write in college will require you to present an argument, even if the assignment does not specifically say so. That is, rather than simply stating facts and information, you must give your opinion about the topic, as well as reasoning and evidence to support that opinion. For a sociology class, you might write an essay arguing that the United States should abolish the death penalty because it is "cruel and unusual" punishment prohibited by the United States Constitution; in an environmental science class, you might write a report arguing that human activity contributes substantially to climate change.

The ability to read and write arguments is valuable in other ways. For example, you might read the pros and cons of legalizing marijuana before voting on

an initiative, or you might consider arguments for or against enrolling your children in a charter school; you might petition the court to dismiss a traffic ticket, or you might write a letter urging city officials to install a speed bump on a busy street to prevent accidents. This chapter explains how to read and write arguments by considering students' ability to speak freely on college campuses or in their classes.

IDENTIFYING PARTS OF AN ARGUMENT

Knowing how to break down an argument into its parts is a useful start to understanding arguments. Many parts of an argument should be familiar from previous chapters. However, argumentation introduces some new terms:

- Claim
- Reasons
- Support

Figure 11.1 shows how claim, reasons, and support form the structure for an argumentative essay.

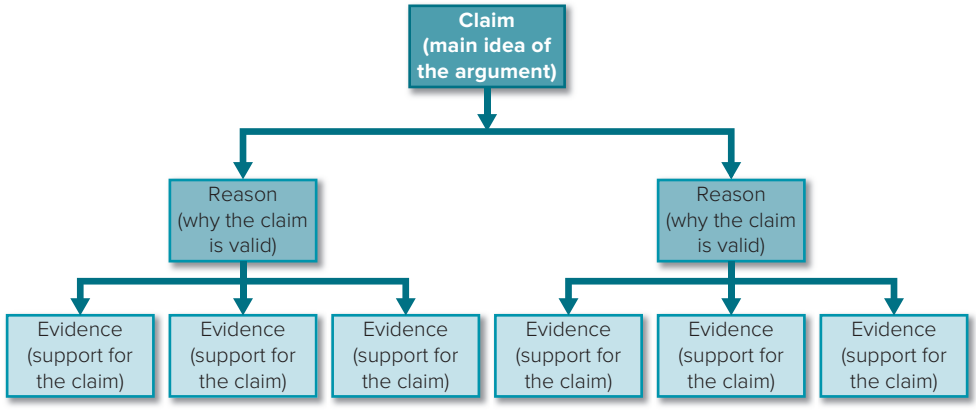
Claim

The main idea of an essay is called a thesis; if the essay is an argument, the main idea may also be called a **claim**. In an argument, the claim takes a *position* on the issue. An **issue** is a topic about which people disagree, and therefore is *debatable*: that is, not everyone would agree. While a thesis may be informative, a claim implies an argument.

Writing a Claim in an Argument

Some examples will clarify how an argumentative claim is different from an informative thesis. To provide context for the first reading in this chapter, the examples focus on the controversy over taking down Confederate statues and monuments.

FIGURE 11.1 Graphic Organizer for Claim, Reasons, and Evidence in an Argumentative Essay



INFORMATIVE THESIS: Over 100 Confederate statues have been removed from public lands since 2015 because of protests and demonstrations against these monuments.

This informative thesis explains two facts: that over 100 Confederate statues and monuments have been taken down since 2015, and these actions happened because of protests over the statues. These facts promise an informative essay explaining the recent history of the movement to remove Confederate symbols from public spaces.

ARGUMENTATIVE CLAIM: Confederate statues should be removed from public lands because these monuments honor men who perpetuated slavery and believed in racism.

This argumentative claim takes a position that Confederate statues should be removed and gives reasons (the statues "honor men who perpetuated slavery and believed in racism") to support the claim's position.

Because an argument is a reasoned judgment, a claim cannot be based solely on the writer's personal opinion or preference. Personal opinion cannot be supported by evidence and logical reasoning. For instance, if you say you like chocolate ice cream better than vanilla, or prefer dogs to cats, no one can argue for or against your statement. Your statement is simply your inclination; it is not an arguable claim. Consider these examples:

OPINION: I feel comfortable allowing Confederate statues to remain in public spaces.

Your feelings about Confederate statues—whether you are comfortable with them or not—cannot be supported with evidence. Only you know whether you are indeed feeling at ease as the statement says.

ARGUABLE CLAIM: Allowing Confederate statutes to remain in public spaces ensures that people will know about and understand American history, including slavery.

This statement implicitly presents a claim (that we should allow Confederate statues to remain in public spaces) and gives reasons why this position is valid (because "people will know about and understand American history, including slavery").

When you are writing the claim, be specific. The first draft of your claim may be general. As you develop your reasons and evidence to support the claim, take care to revisit the claim to qualify it or to revise it so that it accurately reflects your argument. While a general claim may be acceptable in the paper itself to guide the reader, a specific claim can enable you as a writer to determine exactly what you will argue. Look at the following examples.

GENERAL CLAIM: Confederate monuments should be preserved.

Although the preceding claim takes a position in favor of retaining Confederate statues, it is not specific about why this should happen.

MORE SPECIFIC CLAIM: Confederate monuments should be preserved because they are part of American history; removing them would potentially mean forgetting our country's complicated history, whereas retaining them means examining our country's legacy of civil war and slavery.

This claim takes a position in favor of retaining Confederate statues and specifies how that would benefit the public. It also explains how the writer will support the claim—by giving reasons why taking down the statues would be harmful while keeping them up could be beneficial.

As a writer, you can use an effective strategy for determining your claim: take a position based on what the evidence tells you about the topic. In other words, if the evidence suggests Confederate statues are harmful and hurtful, then you can argue that taking down these statues is the right thing to do. Conversely, if the evidence points toward not taking down these statues, you can argue for that policy. Remember that an argument is a reasoned judgment, one that needs to be supported by evidence, so taking a position that can be supported by evidence makes sense.

Qualities of a Claim

- A claim should state the writer's position on an issue.
- The position should be debatable; that is, others might disagree or have a different point of view.
- A claim must go beyond feelings and state a position on the issue based on evidence and solid reasoning.

Reasons

In addition to making a claim that states a position, an argument must be supported by reasons why that position is solid. A **reason** is a statement that explains or justifies. The claim expresses the debatable position on the issue, while the reasons provide the explanation as to why the claim is valid.

Let's examine a specific claim to understand how the claim states a position and gives reasons for that position as well.

ARGUMENTATIVE CLAIM WITH REASONS:

Statues honoring Confederate figures and buildings named after them should be removed from college campuses.

Claim = writer's position on the issue

Reason 1 *to make students, especially Black students, feel welcome and included,*

Reason 2 *to uphold the values of higher education,*

Reason 3 *to take a stand against racism, and*

Reason 4 *to more accurately reflect American history.*

FIGURE 11.2 Sample Outline of an Argumentative Essay

Claim: Statues honoring Confederate figures and buildings named after them should be removed from college campuses.

First reason: Removing Confederate symbols from campus would make students, especially Black students, feel welcome and included.

Second reason: One important purpose of higher education is to think critically; therefore, removing Confederate symbols from campus demonstrates that colleges recognize and have rethought the harm these symbols perpetuate.

Third reason: Renaming buildings and removing statues that represent men who supported slavery would be tangible proof that the college does not support racism.

Fourth reason: Renaming buildings and erecting new monuments would be an opportunity to reflect the diversity of American experiences and to celebrate a variety of achievements.

In an essay, sometimes reasons to support the claim are stated in the claim itself, as in the example. Other times, reasons appear elsewhere in the essay, as in the body paragraphs. For instance, the outline of an essay that states a position early on and gives reasons throughout the essay is shown in Figure 11.2.

Support

Support refers to proof for a claim. The four types of support writers use, as explained in the chapter "Critically Evaluating Texts," are

- Factual evidence.
- Expert testimony.
- Explanations.
- Examples.

The type of support used often depends on what is most appropriate for the audience, purpose, and assignment. Consider the following examples.

- A school newspaper editorial about the impact of offensive language on students' ability to learn might include stories from your own personal experience (examples) to appeal to other students and persuade readers to take action.
- An article in a scholarly journal about biased language in the classroom might feature statistics and researched information to appeal to professors and change their thinking (factual evidence).

As a writer, you will want to consider the context of your argument. Consider the following examples.

- If you are writing an argument for an economics class, you might include a cost/benefit analysis of implementing speech codes on campus versus incurring lawsuits (explanation).
- If you are writing for a history class, you might include evidence that many Confederate statues were built between 1900 and 1920 and quote experts who believe these statues reinforced the Jim Crow era of segregation (facts and expert testimony).

Reading the assignment prompt thoughtfully might provide further clues, such as references to experts or texts that should be consulted in developing your argument. If you need guidance, ask your instructor what constitutes appropriate evidence for the assignment.

In the first Reading Selection, you can analyze an argument: an editorial written by a college student. As you read, look for the parts of the argument: claim, reasons, and evidence.

READING SELECTION

"A COLLEGE LECTURE ON CONFEDERATE STATUES MADE ME REALIZE I'M SQUELCHING FREE SPEECH ON CAMPUS"

Before Reading: Recognize Prior Knowledge; Preview

Write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

1. What do you know about the controversy over taking down Confederate statues? What are the arguments surrounding this issue?
2. Look at the title of the article and the information before the reading. What do you think the author's claim will be?

During Reading: Annotate

3. Annotate the reading by marking the claim, reasons, and support.
4. Identify the types of support: factual evidence, expert testimony, explanation, and examples. (NOTE: Not all articles include all four types of support.)

A College Lecture on Confederate Statues Made Me Realize I'm Squelching Free Speech on Campus

By Kevin Weis

Chicago Tribune, 29 March 2019

When Kevin Weis wrote this article, he was an undergraduate student majoring in history and secondary education at Aurora University in Illinois. At the beginning of his article, Weis references President Donald Trump's signing of an executive order on March 21, 2019, protecting freedom of speech on college campuses.

I am the problem with free speech on college campus. At the very least, I don't help. President Donald Trump took action earlier this month to deal with what he sees as an assault on conservative voices. The squelching of diverse viewpoints and the disinvitation of conservatives to college campuses is a well-documented trend that has led to an increasingly fervent left and fewer and fewer conservative and moderate students who are willing to speak. 1

While this problem largely correlates with a persistent rise in the number of liberal professors, I would argue that much of the blame falls squarely on the shoulders of my peers and me. 2

The day before Trump signed an executive order that threatens to withdraw federal funding from universities that block conservative views, my history class was directed to attend a presentation on Confederate monuments. It was my second time attending it, so I knew what to expect from the discussion. I even took the time to prepare answers from both conservative and liberal perspectives. The professor prefaced his presentation by stating that he was going to involve the 75 or so students in his talk. The most significant question would be: Should the monuments come down? 3

None to my surprise, overwhelmingly students in the auditorium said the monuments should be taken down. One person, a retired English professor, suggested some caution. Her voice, though, was the lone pushback against the many monologues that came from some of my most notably far-left peers. 4

At one point, the professor rhetorically asked the crowd, "If we start taking down Confederate memorials for promoting slavery, do we also take down the Washington Monument and the Jefferson Memorial?" One voice from the crowd said yes. A couple of heads nodded in agreement. Eventually, the professor asked, what about the monuments to nameless Confederate soldiers erected for the families who lost loved ones? The collective voice said: Yes, take them down. 5

I sat there considering whether to raise an objection just to counter the sound of the echo chamber. But I did no such thing. I was sitting behind a student whose opinion I had consulted previously because I knew it was conservative. He believed the monuments should stay up and be used as a learning tool. Yet, he also remained silent. The other students in my section remained quiet, too, though I knew many of them to be liberal-minded, so perhaps they were silently agreeing with the outspoken leftists in the room. 6

The next day, the day Trump signed the executive order, I met with members of the history club I participate in, all of whom had attended the lecture. I asked them their thoughts on taking down the monuments, and many agreed that some, such as a Nathan Bedford Forrest* statue, should be uninstalled. A couple of students, however, argued 7

that all of the monuments should be preserved in some capacity, such as in museums, perhaps. The consensus was to leave the monuments to the nameless soldiers alone. The notoriety of someone like Gen. Robert E. Lee made the hypothetical decision-making more challenging.

I then asked everyone's observations about who spoke up at the lecture. Each person noted it was the classmates we know to hold views furthest to the left. No one really thought that was unusual, since those students express their thoughts most often in class. 8

It was then I realized: I am part of the problem. I could have spoken up during the lecture, but I chose not to. I let the more radical voices rule the day, uncontested. 9

Combating that situation does not require an executive order. It requires those of us who are aware of the problem to speak up and challenge ideas with better ideas. 10

That is what it means to have free speech. 11

* Note: Nathan Bedford Forrest was a Confederate army general during the Civil War and later the first Grand Wizard in the Ku Klux Klan.

After Reading: Respond to the Argument

Write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

5. Do you find Weis's claim and reasons to be persuasive? Why or why not? How could someone argue against them?
6. Which pieces of support in the reading do you find most convincing? Why? Can you think of support that might counter the reading's support?

Engage with the Reading

1. The author writes, "I could have spoken up during the lecture, but I chose not to." Why do you think the writer did not share his opinion?
2. Do you think the professor could have handled the situation differently to encourage more students, especially students with opposing positions, to speak up?
3. Have you ever been in a situation when you did not speak up in class? If so, why did you not voice your opinion?

INTRODUCING CONTROVERSIAL ISSUES

While an argument can begin using strategies that work for any essay (see in "The Writing Product" chapter, "Sensible Strategies for Introductions") an argument may require more background knowledge of the topic to allow readers to understand what the controversy is or why the issue is being debated.

Provide Background Information

In the first Reading Selection, Kevin Weis provides context that free speech is being restricted on college campuses by alluding to President Trump's "action earlier this month," which was to sign an executive order linking federal funding to free speech on college campuses. Weis also cites the "well-documented trend" of "squelching of diverse viewpoints and the disinvitation of conservatives to college campuses." In this way, Weis sets the stage for arguing that exercising one's free speech rights, especially to express conservative views, should be the responsibility of college students.

To introduce a controversial issue in an argument, writers often use the following strategies.

- **Provide a brief history.** To give context to free speech on campus, writers might describe the beginnings of the Free Speech Movement in the 1960s at the University of California at Berkeley when students protested the administration's ban on political activism on campus, then state their claim as to whether (or not) free speech currently exists on college campuses.
- **Describe recent events.** In a discussion about free speech on college campuses, writers may describe how in 2017 students at the University of California at Berkeley protested conservative speakers, such as Milo Yiannopoulos and Ann Coulter, who were invited to speak on campus, before presenting their position on the issue.
- **Explain various views.** To provide context for arguments for (or against) free speech zones on campus, writers may briefly explain why some people support designated free speech areas while others feel free speech areas restrict their rights, before stating their own position.
- **Give illustrative examples.** In an argument questioning whether hate speech is free speech on campus, writers may introduce examples of students who engage in racist speech, such as sporting a swastika tattoo or using derogatory terms to describe racial minorities, before making their claim.

Define Terms

In addition to providing context or background information on the topic of the argument, a writer may need to ensure that readers understand key terms. For instance, a term such as *hate speech* can be important to understanding whether hate speech is protected free speech. Defining terms is also a way to ensure that readers are "on the same page" and understand the issue in the same way.

To define key terms in an argument, writers often use the following strategies.

- **Provide a definition agreed upon by experts or sources.** When clarifying the term *free speech zones*, a writer might cite the American Association of University Professors (AAUP) definition as "areas of a campus to which protests and other contentious political activity are confined." The AAUP would be considered an expert organization in regard to college campus issues.

- **Give examples to illustrate what a term means.** To help readers understand what microaggressions are, the writer may provide examples of microaggressions, such as stating that women are not good at math or that Asians are mathematically inclined, to enable readers to understand that microaggressions are stereotypes, negative or positive, based on gender or race, among other categories.
- **Explain what a term does not mean.** To introduce readers to the term *brave spaces*, a writer might contrast this to the term *safe spaces* to clarify that while safe spaces exist to protect people from discrimination or harassment, in a brave space people may encounter remarks that are hurtful.

STRUCTURING AN ARGUMENT

Identifying the claim, reasons, and support in a text will help you see how arguments are organized. Determining the organizational pattern will further help you follow the author's thinking. Two common ways of organizing arguments are

1. From claim or reason to support, also known as **deductive reasoning**.
2. From support to claim or reason, also referred to as **inductive reasoning**.

You might find the organizational patterns of claim to support or of support to claim used for an entire piece of writing or on a smaller scale, such as in a paragraph or section of a reading.

Deductive Reasoning: Arguing from Claim or Reason to Support

One strategy for organizing an argument is to begin with a claim (in an essay) or a reason (in a paragraph) and then present support for that claim or reason. This pattern is typical of academic writing: to present a thesis or topic sentence and then provide proof for it.

For instance, Kevin Weis begins his essay with his claim that he is "the problem with free speech on college campus," then proceeds to describe an example of a class discussion of Confederate monuments in which he did not speak up to defend his view that some monuments should stay standing. In other words, his argument moves from claim to support.

Figure 11.3 illustrates how a writer might begin with a claim or reason and then give supporting evidence to lead readers to a conclusion.

Inductive Reasoning: Arguing from Support to Reason or Claim

A different organizational strategy is to begin with support and then reach a conclusion. You can think of this organizational structure as moving from support to reason or claim. This organizational strategy can be powerful because the writer seems to lead readers, by force of the evidence, to a logical conclusion. Often scientific writing proceeds in this way.

FIGURE 11.3 Deductive Argument

The following argument about free speech on college campuses was posted on the American Civil Liberties website. The information is organized deductively, because it begins with a general statement that is followed by examples to support that statement.
Source: American Civil Liberties Union

Argument	Annotations
Historically, restrictions on speech have proven at best ineffective, and at worst counter-productive, in the fight against bigotry. Although drafted with the best intentions, these restrictions are often interpreted and enforced to oppose social change. Why? Because they place the power to decide whether speech is offensive and should be restrained with authority figures—the government or a college administration—rather than with those seeking to question or dismantle existing power structures. For example, under a speech code in effect at the University of Michigan for 18 months, there were 20 cases in which white students charged Black students with offensive speech. One of the cases resulted in the punishment of a Black student for using the term "white trash" in conversation with a white student. The code was struck down as unconstitutional in 1989. To take another example, public schools throughout the country have attempted to censor pro-LGBT messages because the government thought they were controversial, inappropriate for minors, or just wrong. Heather Gillman's school district banned her from wearing a shirt that said "I Support My Gay Cousin." The principal maintained that her T-shirt and other speech supporting LGBT equality, such as "I Support Marriage Equality," were divisive and inappropriate for impressionable students. The ACLU sued the school district and won, because the First Amendment prevents the government from making LGBT people and LGBT-related issues disappear. These examples demonstrate that restrictions on speech don't really serve the interests of marginalized groups. The First Amendment does.	*Reason = Speech codes are not effective and do not promote positive change.* *Example = White college students accuse Black college students of offensive speech.* *Example = Student is not allowed to wear a t-shirt supporting a gay person.*

As you will see, Tyrone Fleurizard's "3 Approaches to Confronting Microaggressions" begins with research about stereotypes and unconscious biases, introduces ways to eliminate microaggressions in the college classroom, and then concludes with his claim that "to support the most marginalized students, practitioners should make an effort to address the barriers associated with marginal identity." In this way, his argument proceeds inductively.

Figure 11.4 illustrates how a writer might begin by presenting evidence that leads readers to the claim.

The second Reading Selection again provides an opportunity to analyze an argument written by a college student. Notice the claim, reasons, and evidence, as well as the organization of the argument.

FIGURE 11.4 Inductive Argument

The following argument about free speech on school campuses appears on the Intellectual Freedom blog on the American Library Association *website. The information is organized inductively, because it begins with an example and an expert opinion, then leads to a claim. The blog is titled "Do Student Protestors Have First Amendment Rights?" and this section answers that question.*

Source: Slocum, Rebecca. "Do Student Protesters Have First Amendment Rights?" Intellectual Freedom Blog, 21 March 2018, American Library Association

Argument	Annotations
In 1965, 13-year-old Mary Beth Tinker, along with a group of students at her junior high, wore black armbands to school to protest the Vietnam War.	*Example = Students wearing black armbands to school*
The students were sent home and told not to return until they were no longer wearing armbands. While the students did eventually return to school without the offending armbands, they continued to protest by wearing black clothing for the remainder of the school year. Represented by the American Civil Liberties Union (ACLU), the students and their families sought legal action. The landmark case *Tinker v. Des Moines* is the result. The Supreme Court determined that students do not "shed their constitutional rights to freedom of speech or expression at the schoolhouse gate."	*Expert Opinion = The Supreme Court case ruling*
So the short answer? Yes. Students do indeed have First Amendment rights to free speech even while on school property. But with a few caveats.	*Conclusion = Students have First Amendment rights while at school.*

READING SELECTION

"3 APPROACHES FOR CONFRONTING MICROAGGRESSIONS"

Before Reading: Predict

Write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

1. What do you know about microaggressions? How would you define this term?
2. Look at the title and skim the article. What approaches for confronting microaggressions in the classroom will the writer propose?

During Reading: Annotate

3. Annotate the reading by marking the claim, reasons, and support.
4. Identify the types of support: factual evidence, expert testimony, explanation, and examples. (NOTE: Not all articles include all four types of support.)

3 Approaches for Confronting Microaggressions

By Tyrone Fleurizard

Inside Higher Education, 20 July 2018

When Tyrone Fleurizard wrote this article, he was a doctoral student at the Lynch School of Education at Boston College. His interests include exploring racial disparities in education.

Phil Goodman—a pseudonym—has been teaching the psychology of prejudice for almost a decade. He has every lecture memorized and every punch line down. Throughout the semester, students explore the many ways prejudice manifests, interrogate prejudice research and, at the conclusion of the semester, develop ways to reduce prejudice in their own lives. 1

Goodman's favorite lecture is on stereotypes. His reading for this particular lecture includes an experimental study from Stanford University social psychologist and 2014 MacArthur "Genius" fellow Jennifer Eberhardt and her colleagues. They sought to determine how stereotypic associations influence visual processing and attention. To do that, participants were primed with either black faces, white faces or no faces and then shown images on a computer screen of crime and noncrime objects that started fuzzy and became progressively clearer. 2

The researchers were testing reaction time, so participants were instructed to press a key as soon as they could make out the object. What they found was astonishing: 3

participants took less time to identify a crime-relevant object when primed with black faces than with white faces. When primed with white faces, participants took longer to recognize dangerous objects—so much so that if in a real situation, they could have been in fatal danger. During the class discussion, one student eager to contribute began reciting the study's methodology. When they described the primed faces, however, they referred to the white faces as "white" but the black faces as "colored." After they finished, there was a long pause. Microaggressions like these happen all the time.

Microaggressions are subtle, discriminatory actions and comments toward people of color that may be racist, sexist or ableist. The late Chester Pierce, emeritus professor at Harvard Medical School, first coined the term in the 1970s as "subtle, stunning, often automatic and nonverbal exchanges which are 'put downs'" by offenders. These seemingly trivial slights have been shown to be related to negative health and academic outcomes for black students. 4

In a landmark paper, Derald Wing Sue and his colleagues at Columbia University described microaggressions as taking three forms: microassaults, microinsults and microinvalidations. Microassaults are explicit verbal or nonverbal attacks meant to hurt someone, such as using racial epithets. Microinsults are verbal and nonverbal insults that often carry hidden meaning, including, "You're pretty for a black woman"—the implication being that black women are not attractive. And microinvalidations invalidate the experiences and existence of the victim, such as, "I don't see color. I see people for who they are." While microassaults are typically conscious, microinsults and microinvalidations are often unconscious. That doesn't excuse their use. It means we are not immune. 5

A challenge for education practitioners is how to effectively address such microaggressions in the classroom. While recognizing this is a delicate issue with no absolutely correct answer, I have three suggestions to attempt to address and reduce classroom microaggressions. 6

Use the syllabus to create the classroom culture. Faculty members and university regulations can often overlook the syllabus as a powerful tool for classroom socialization. Beyond outlining guidelines and policies à la carte, it's an opportunity for professors to communicate to students the classroom culture in a meaningful way. 7

Specifically, language plays a critical role in syllabus design. Researchers at Pennsylvania State University found that a syllabus's language influences students' perceptions of the professor, including how approachable and motivated to teach they believed the professor to be. Design a syllabus that lets students, especially those from marginalized backgrounds, know that they are supported and that their existence, experiences and opinions are valid. 8

For example, a possible statement might be "I am committed to affirming the identities, realities and voices of all students, especially those from historically marginalized or underrepresented backgrounds. This course values the use of person-centered language and preferred gender pronouns, and respect for the experiences of others." 9

Use microaffirmations. According to Mary Rowe, adjunct professor of negotiation and conflict management at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology Sloan School of Management, microaffirmations are "small acts, which are often ephemeral and 10

hard-to-see, events that are public and private, often unconscious but very effective, which occur wherever people wish to help others to succeed." She originated the term in 2008 when she was tasked with figuring out ways to improve the workplace for underrepresented MIT students, faculty members and staff members. She saw that the "little issues," what she called microinequalities, could have destructive, long-term effects on an organization. She hypothesized that if microinequalities can have negative effects, then microaffirmations could have positive ones. She was right.

These small affirmations can be done by giving nonverbal cues, such as head nodding when students are speaking, giving credit to students by name, asking for students' valued opinion and endorsing students' ideas, among others. The effects of microaffirmations can be manifold. Not only do they affirm the identities of marginalized students, but, if used consistently, they may also be effective in reinforcing the classroom culture. 11

Address microaggressions when they happen. This is what Goodman did. After the student finished, he chose to address the microaggression by saying, "Before we leave, I want to point out what just happened. I don't think you're aware of what you said. What you said is an inappropriate term to refer to black people. I just want to make sure that you know that it's not OK, and it's hurtful. In the future, use person-centered language." This can be the most challenging way to address microaggressions in the classroom, as doing so involves risk and responsibility. But, regardless of potential conflict, direct but empathetic discussion may be most effective in dealing with microaggressions. 12

The alternative—being passive—may communicate a lack of empathy and concern for the well-being of targets of microaggressions, in addition to communicating that denigration is normal. In one study, professors and students were given vignettes describing incidents of microaggression and asked whether a direct response to the microaggression was more effective than being passive. The researchers hypothesized that teachers would perceive direct responses as more effective than would students. But that isn't what happened. While both teachers and students perceived direct responses as more effective, students did so at a higher rate than professors, suggesting that students may want their professors to confront microaggressions as they happen. 13

To support the most marginalized students, practitioners should make an effort to address the barriers associated with marginal identity. It's hard to contribute and thrive in the classroom when your existence is invalidated and you are made to feel like a bit player. Acknowledgment that microaggressions aren't so micro is key to creating an inclusive learning environment for all students. 14

After Reading: Recognize Parts of an Argument

Write answers to the following questions using complete sentences.

5. Do you find Fleurizard's claim and reasons to be persuasive? Why or why not? How could someone argue against them?
6. Which pieces of support in the reading do you find most convincing? Why? Can you think of evidence that might counter the reading's support?

7. How is the argument organized—inductively or deductively? Explain.
8. Where and how is the term *microaggression* defined in the reading?

Engage with the Reading

1. Have you ever experienced or witnessed a microaggression in a classroom setting or on campus? If so, how was this handled by your classmates or instructor? Explain.
2. Fleurizard concludes, "Acknowledgment that microaggressions aren't so micro is key to creating an inclusive learning environment for all students." Do you agree? Or do you feel that other aspects of the classroom are more important to "creating an inclusive learning environment for all students"?

EVALUATING LOGIC

In addition to analyzing the evidence used in arguments, we can analyze and evaluate the thinking in arguments. This kind of analysis tends to focus on the ways to go wrong when reasoning, or **logical fallacies**. There are many types of logical fallacies with various names. To keep track of them, it is useful to understand why each logical fallacy shows poor reasoning. Here are eight of the most common logical fallacies, grouped by why the thinking is weak.

Avoiding the Issue

Arguments should deal with the issue at hand. Reasoning that avoids the central claim or important evidence in an argument would fall into this category of avoiding the issue.

Ad hominem (Latin for "to the man") is an argument that attacks the person, rather than the issue at hand. Often such "name-calling" is designed to discredit the opponent. For instance, dismissing opponents of free speech restrictions as "extremist bigots" or, conversely, calling supporters of free speech restrictions "radical zealots" would be ad hominem attacks because they seek to discredit the authority of the people who hold those views. In general, ad hominem attacks are not very productive. It is better to argue why free speech codes on college campuses are effective—or not.

A **red herring** is a ploy that distracts attention from the real issue. (By the way, there's no such thing as a red herring; herring are silvery fish.) An article published in *The Journal of Ethics*, titled "'Offensiphobia' Is a Red Herring: On the Problem of Censorship and Academic Freedom," argues that the term *offensiphobia*, which implies that something is offensive if one feels offended, is a red herring because universities and colleges restrict speech based on principles other than an individual's feelings about that speech. In short, offensiphobia, contend the authors, does not truly exist and is therefore a red herring in the argument over censoring speech on campus.

Weak Cause and Effect

Proving that one event causes another is often difficult to do. Some events have many causes and, as in any argument, there needs to be sufficient, relevant, and valid proof of cause and effect to be convincing.

Post hoc ergo propter hoc, Latin for "after this, therefore because of this," is a fallacy that assumes because one event follows another, the first event caused the second. However, just because two events occur in order, or even come at the same time, does not mean one causes the other. A classic example of this principle is that a rooster crows in the morning before the sun rises. But a rooster crowing does not *cause* the sun to rise.

A **slippery slope** argument predicts a "doom and gloom" or worst-case scenario will result with no evidence that one action will lead to the next. For instance, in Kevin Weis's article, he quotes his professor as asking rhetorically, "If we start taking down Confederate memorials for promoting slavery, do we also take down the Washington Monument and the Jefferson Memorial?" This rhetorical question was meant to suggest a slippery slope argument: that taking down monuments to Confederates would lead to taking down monuments to many other Americans.

Pretending to Offer Proof, but Not Really

Claims must be supported by relevant evidence. If the support is not relevant to the argument, then neither is the reasoning.

Faulty use of authority occurs when the person being quoted to support an argument has no authority on the topic. For instance, quoting the President of the United States about the right to free speech on college campuses might be considered a faulty authority. Better to quote the United States Attorney General or a Supreme Court Justice who understands the constitution and laws regarding freedom of speech. Also, be wary of sweeping statements about "experts," as in "many experts believe. . . ." We can believe experts when they are named and when we know why they are experts.

Hasty generalization suggests that a conclusion has been drawn based on too little evidence or too few examples. One needs a sufficient amount of evidence to arrive at a reasonable conclusion. The larger the conclusion, the more evidence is needed. For example, if a student observed a microaggression in one classroom involving one professor of that university, it would be a hasty generalization to conclude that most faculty at that college are insensitive or unwelcoming to underrepresented students. That one faculty member's words may be atypical and not representative of the many other professors.

Oversimplifying the Issue

These fallacies tend to contain errors in logic or reasoning because they express complex ideas in simplistic ways.

A **false dilemma** or **false dichotomy** creates a simple, either/or situation. While these sorts of arguments might be catchy (and often create clever bumper

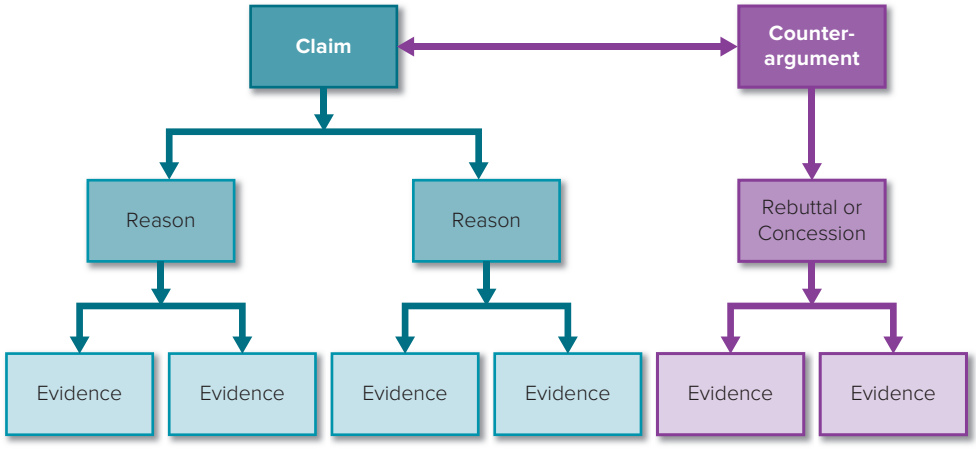
stickers), they are not very thoughtful arguments. For instance, to suggest that either students are allowed unrestricted speech or their First Amendment rights are being violated is an oversimplification of the issue. Even under the First Amendment, the right to free speech can be restricted, such as speech that incites violence or threatens to harm another person.

A **non sequitur** suggests that one idea follows from the previous one, when the relationship between ideas is not logical. Jonathan R. Alger, president of James Madison University in Virginia, noted that President Trump's executive order to withhold federal research funds from colleges that did not allow free speech seemed like a non sequitur. As Alger explained, "Tying grants to something completely different—in this case, tying science to free speech—it seems like mixing apples and oranges."

RESPONDING TO COUNTERARGUMENTS

Because an argument is debatable, there will naturally be other positions on the issue at the center of the argument. A position that is opposed to a writer's claim is called a **counterargument** (Figure 11.5). Often writers anticipate and respond to likely counterarguments in a section of their writing. This strategy strengthens the argument by showing that they understand possible objections and have good reasons and evidence to reject those other positions. There are two main approaches to presenting a counterargument: rebuttal and concession.

FIGURE 11.5 Counterargument in an Argument Essay



Identifying Rebuttal versus Concession

Whether you choose to rebut or concede an opponent's argument depends on the extent to which you agree or disagree with the other side's position.

In presenting a counterargument, writers typically use the SOS (summary, opinion, support) pattern of response, as follows:

1. Writing a brief *summary* of an opposing viewpoint: the counterargument.

   Tip: Use key words and phrases that signal a writer is restating opposing views, such as the following:

   Critics hold the view that . . .

   On the other hand . . .

   Opponents say . . .

   Others sometimes assert that . . .

   Some people might argue . . .

   While it may be true that . . .

   Phrases like these are clues that a writer is summarizing the opposition's perspective.

2. Stating an *opinion* about the opposing viewpoint: concede or rebut.

   - A **rebuttal** is an expression of disagreement with an opponent's position. Basically, you are saying the other side is *wrong* and then giving support as to why that point of view is incorrect or false.

     Imagine a writer who is trying to counter the argument that removing Confederate monuments would be erasing history. Here is an example of how the writer might begin to rebut that argument:

     Example of a rebuttal: Arguing that removing Confederate monuments is erasing American history is flawed because these symbols distort history and celebrate a racist past.

   - A **concession**, in contrast, involves an admission that your opponent has a worthwhile point and is accompanied by an explanation of why your position is still better. Essentially, you are saying, "Good point, but here is why my point is better." In this case, you must explain or demonstrate why your position is stronger than your opponent's position.

     Consider how a writer might concede the argument that removing Confederate monuments would be erasing history in the next example.

     Example of a concession: While it is true that removing Confederate monuments would be altering American history, we can preserve that history in other ways, such as by placing monuments in museums and using them as teaching tools.

3. Offering *support* for that opinion: why the opposing view is wrong or why your position is stronger. For instance, the examples of rebuttal and concession given earlier are just the beginning of counterarguments. Each statement needs more support to convince readers of the position.

If you can deal successfully with compelling counterarguments, you will reinforce your own position. Use "Strategies for Developing Counterarguments" to get started.

Strategies for Developing Counterarguments

Summarize. Review readings that present views on the topic that you disagree with. Summarize the claim, reasons, and evidence of an opposing view.

List. Create a pro/con list of all the arguments you can think of on both sides of a topic, along with evidence to support the arguments. Decide which side you are on, and then select the strongest argument on the other side for the counterargument.

Freewrite. Jot down the main reasons for the claim of your argument and the evidence for those reasons. Then imagine how someone might argue against each of your reasons or be critical of your evidence.

Brainstorm. Explain your claim to a classmate, friend, or family member. Ask the person to respond to you with arguments, reasons, and evidence against your position.

Where to Place a Counterargument

Once you have established the strongest arguments against your claim, consider when to address these. A few basic strategies can be used to position the counterargument in an essay.

1. **Counterargument last.** Present the claim supported by reasons and evidence; then consider the counterarguments last. This can work well if your position is strong; including a refutation or concession at the end of the argument can further convince skeptical readers.
2. **Argument | counterargument.** Present your argument with reasons and evidence; after each reason, present a counterargument and rebut or concede that. This works well if there are several counterarguments against your position, ones that "match up" with your reasons.
3. **Counterargument first.** If the argument against your position is strong, then you may wish to begin with the counterargument. This gets the counterargument out of the way, so you can lay out your position with support.

Academic Style: "Although . . . Because" Claim

Crafting a strong thesis statement can help you, as a writer, focus on your main argument. A clear thesis statement can also help readers understand the logic of your position. One strategy for writing an argumentative claim that includes your position on the issue, supporting reasons, as well as a counterargument, is to use the "although . . . because . . ." model.

continued

Here's how this works:

1. First, state your position (claim) followed by the reasons for the claim. That is, the claim comes first; then "because" introduces the reasons for the claim.

   Example: Trigger warnings should not be used on syllabi because these may keep students from engaging in intellectually challenging material, and because they are not the most effective means to deal with traumatic feelings.

   Claim
   Reason 1
   Reason 2

2. Second, consider the strongest counterargument against your claim. Introduce the counterargument before the claim with the word *although*.

   Example: Although well intentioned to prevent student trauma, trigger warnings should not be used on syllabi because these may keep students from engaging in intellectually challenging material, and because they are not the most effective means to deal with traumatic feelings.

   Claim
   Reason 1
   Reason 2

   Here are a few caveats about the "although . . . because" claim:

   - An "although . . . because" claim may—or may not—actually appear like this in an essay. Use your own good judgment as to whether summing up your argument in one sentence is the most effective means to present it to readers.
   - Not every claim needs to be supported by three reasons. Use as many (or as few) compelling reasons necessary to support the claim.
   - Not every claim has one counterargument. Some may have several.

EVALUATING AN ARGUMENT

The "Checklist for an Argument Essay" is an effective way to apply the criteria for a strong argument to your own or anyone else's work.

Checklist for an Argument Essay

_____ Does the claim take a position on a specific issue? Is the claim argumentative and specific?

_____ Are there convincing reasons to support the claim—reasons that will appeal to the audience?

_____ Is there sufficient and appropriate support? Is it clear how the support proves the reasons or the claim?

_____ Does the argument address strong counterarguments? Are these counterarguments adequately summarized and dealt with through rebuttal or concession?

_____ Is the essay logically organized?

_____ Are the sentences clearly and correctly written? Are they varied and concise?

_____ Has the essay been proofread and the errors kept to a minimum?

Activity 11.1 Evaluate Prompts for Writing an Argument Paper

Evaluate the writing topics by marking how interesting you find each one. Check "Interesting topic," "Maybe I could write on this topic," or "Cannot relate to this topic" for each prompt.

Solid Prompts

1. Have you ever felt that your ability to speak freely on campus was restricted? If so, why? Describe an incident in which you felt you were not able to express your ideas and argue why this was the case. You might use Kevin Weis's essay as a model for your own argument.

☐ Interesting topic
☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
☐ Cannot relate to this topic

2. Have you ever felt that your ability to speak freely in class was restricted? If so, why? Give advice to classroom instructors explaining how they can

ensure free speech among students in a classroom setting. You might use Tyrone Fleurizard's essay as a model for your own argument.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

3. Write a response to Kevin Weis or to Tyrone Fleurizard in which you rebut or concede his main arguments.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

Challenge Choices *These prompts are more challenging because they require reading and research beyond the selections in this chapter.*

4. Do you believe that offensive speech on college campuses should be prohibited and punished? Why or why not?

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

5. Do you believe that faculty should include trigger warnings on syllabi or before lessons that contain potentially disturbing images or ideas? Why or why not?

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

6. Investigate whether your college campus has restrictions on students' speech, such as speech codes or a free speech area. Then craft an argument as to whether these restrictions are reasonable or whether further restrictions are needed and why.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

7. Investigate a controversial issue on your college campus. Then craft an argument by stating your claim, providing reasons and support for your claim, and addressing counterarguments.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

8. Investigate a controversial issue of your choice. Then craft an argument by stating your claim, providing reasons and support for your claim, and addressing counterarguments.

- ☐ Interesting topic
- ☐ Maybe I could write on this topic
- ☐ Cannot relate to this topic

Activity 11.2 Prewrite on a Topic

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Select one of the essay topics from Activity 11.1 and do some prewriting on the topic. In your prewriting, consider all sides of the argument. For instance, you might create a pro (in favor of) and con (against) list as a way to get started.
2. Reread your prewriting and select the side you think is strongest. Write a claim stating your position.
3. Reread your prewriting and look for reasons to support your claim. Either include the reasons in your claim or list them separately.
4. Provide support for your reasons. For each reason, list at least two pieces of support. Include at least two different types of support.
5. Using your ideas from exercises 1 through 4, create a graphic organizer like the one shown in Figure 11.1 to illustrate your argument.

Pair and Share

Exchange your graphic organizers from Activity 11.2 (exercise 5) with a partner and evaluate the argument.

1. Is the claim arguable, as opposed to a personal opinion? Is the claim specific, as opposed to general? Provide specific suggestions to improve the claim, if needed.
2. Do the reasons adequately support the claim? Can you suggest other reasons that might strengthen the claim?
3. Does the support adequately prove the reasons and claim? Can you suggest more support that might strengthen the argument?

Activity 11.3 Develop an Argument

Review your responses to Activity 11.2, look again at the essay prompts in Activity 11.1, and consider the Reading Selections in this chapter (if they are relevant to your topic). Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Review your claim. Do you still hold your original position? If not, how might you revise your claim?
2. Can you think of new or different reasons to support your claim? List any new ideas you find.
3. Can you think of more or different support for your reasons? List any new support you locate.
4. Write a body paragraph in which you develop one of your reasons (from exercise 2) with support (from exercise 3). Organize the paragraph either by starting with a reason and giving support or by starting with support and leading to the reason. In either case, explain how the support proves the reason.

Pair and Share

Exchange the body paragraph you wrote in Activity 11.3 (exercise 4) with a partner and evaluate them.

1. What is strong about the paragraph? For instance, is the reason clear? Is it supported with sufficient evidence and logical thinking?
2. What suggestions do you have to improve the paragraph? For instance, could the writer add more evidence? Do you see any logical fallacies?

Activity 11.4 Develop a Counterargument

Review your responses to Activity 11.3. Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Use the "Strategies for Developing Counterarguments" to think of arguments against your claim or reasons. List as many counterarguments as you can think of.
2. Review your counterarguments from exercise 1. Then select the strongest argument or arguments to include as the beginning of a counterargument.
3. Write a paragraph to add to your draft in which you (a) summarize an argument against your position, (b) either rebut or concede that argument, and (c) provide support for your position.

Pair and Share

Exchange the body paragraph you wrote in Activity 11.4 (exercise 3) with a partner.

1. Consider the counterargument. Is the counterargument accurately summarized?

2. Check that the writer's position is clear. Can you determine if the writer is making a rebuttal or a concession?
3. Examine the support for the writer's response to the counterargument. Is there sufficient and convincing support for the writer's position?

Activity 11.5 Draft an Argument Essay

Review the information about reading and writing arguments in this chapter and use your work from the previous activities to complete the following exercises.

1. Using your answers from Activity 11.3, draft a complete argumentative essay, including a claim and body paragraphs with reasons and support.
2. Add the counterargument you developed in Activity 11.4 to your draft. Consider placing the counterargument toward the end or at the beginning of the essay, or after one of the reasons.

Activity 11.6 Evaluate an Argument Essay

1. Review the information about reading and writing arguments in this chapter; then use your work from the previous activities in this chapter to apply the "Checklist for an Argument" to your essay draft. Evaluate your draft and revise it in areas where it is weak.

Pair and Share

Exchange your argument essay draft with a classmate. Have that classmate apply the "Checklist for an Argument" to your essay draft.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

ad hominem A fallacious argument that attacks the person, rather than the issue at hand.

argument An attempt to persuade someone by giving reasons and support (evidence) for accepting a particular position.

claim The main idea of an argument; a claim takes a position on an issue.

concession An admission that an opponent in an argument has made a strong point, accompanied by an explanation of why one's own position is better.

counterargument A position opposed to a writer's or speaker's claim.

deductive reasoning Arguing from a claim (in an essay) or a reason (in a paragraph) and then presenting support for that claim or reason.

evidence Support for a claim.

false dilemma (or **false dichotomy)** To create a simplistic, either/or situation.

faulty use of authority When the person being quoted to support an argument has no authority on the topic.

hasty generalization An invalid conclusion drawn based on too little evidence or too few examples.

inductive reasoning Arguing from evidence to reason (in a paragraph) or claim (in an essay).

issue A topic about which people disagree.

logical fallacy Faulty reasoning in an argument.

non sequitur Wrongly suggest that one idea follows from the previous one, when the relationship between ideas is not logical.

post hoc ergo propter hoc Wrongly assume because one event follows another, the first event caused the second.

reason A statement that explains or justifies an opinion, event, or action.

rebuttal An expression of disagreement with an opponent's position, supported by evidence that the opposing argument is incorrect or false.

red herring A ploy that distracts attention from the real issue.

slippery slope A faulty argument that predicts a "doom and gloom" or worst-case scenario will result with no evidence that one action will lead to the next.

support Proof for a claim.

Chapter Summary

- An argument is not just a disagreement or a statement based on a personal opinion; it is a judgment supported by reasons and evidence for accepting a particular position.
- Being able to identify the various parts of an argument—claim, reasons, support, and counterarguments—is the first step in understanding or writing an argument.
- Recognizing the organizational pattern of an argument in paragraphs and in essays will help you follow the author's reasoning.
- Including a counterargument strengthens your argument by showing that you understand possible objections and have sound reasons and evidence to reject those other positions.

- The same criteria that apply to arguments that you read also apply to the arguments you write. Using a checklist is an effective way to review those criteria.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Imagine your friend in college is assigned a paper that must be an argument. That friend believes that by including a claim and convincing support, the argument will be effective. Write one or two paragraphs explaining to your friend why including counterarguments will strengthen the paper and how your friend can incorporate these into the paper.
2. Locate a blog or newspaper opinion piece that presents an argument on a current topic. Create a graphic organizer that identifies the author's claim, reasons, and evidence. Then in a paragraph, identify and explain any logical fallacies the author makes.

Credits

pp. 277–278: Weis, Kevin. "A College Lecture on Confederate Statues Made Me Realize I'm Squelching Free Speech on Campus." *Chicago Tribune,* Digital Edition, 29 March 2019. https://digitaledition.chicagotribune.com/tribune/article_popover.aspx?guid=21137841-7ade-463b-a691-255a36f0dba5. Used with permission; **pp. 283–285:** Fleurizard, Tyrone. "3 Approaches for Confronting Microaggressions." *Inside Higher Ed,* 20 July 2018. https://www.insidehighered.com/advice/2018/07/20/how-deal-microaggressions-class-opinion. Used with permission.

SPOTLIGHT ON
STUDENT WRITING

Argumentative Synthesis Essay

In Part 3, the chapters focused on reading and writing about multiple texts, such as to compare texts, to synthesize readings, and to argue with sources. These chapters also discussed how to summarize and quote from sources and integrate information into your own writing.

In this Spotlight chapter, you will focus on reading to

- Analyze how students develop essays with a thesis. (Is the claim clear?)
- Analyze how students use support. (Is the claim supported with reasons and evidence?)
- Analyze how students use quotations and summaries from various sources. (Are the sources used well and properly cited?)

ANNOTATING AND ANALYZING STUDENT ESSAYS

What follows are two sample student papers for you to read and think about. First, you will read a successfully annotated student paper. Then you will have a chance to read and annotate a second student paper.

To explore the topic of sleep (the theme of the chapter "The Writing Product") students were encouraged to develop a research question, locate and read various articles related to their research question, then prepare a short report explaining their findings.

> ***Writing Prompt:*** *In your essay, you will explore and explain some aspect of sleep. This paper requires you to develop a research question and locate at least two reliable sources to answer your question. Then you will write your findings up in a paper. You should draw on* ***at least two sources*** *to support your answer. You may also include your own or other people's experiences. Your essay should not simply be a narrative; it should include ideas from researched sources in addition to your own ideas.*

The essay directions include these additional requirements.

> ***Requirements:***
>
> - *Properly cite and document the sources you use in your paper using MLA format.*
> - *Write 750–1,000 words (4–5 pages).*

As the title suggests, Xiaoyan Huo's essay, "The Two Way Correlation Between Sleep Disturbances and Dementia," examines the relationship

between sleep disorders and mental health problems. Renee Burke's essay, "Segmented Sleep: Nature vs. Nurture," also deals with the issue of sleep disturbances but looks at this problem from a fresh angle. Burke investigates whether what we currently think of as disturbed sleep, such as waking up in the middle of the night, is actually a natural sleep pattern.

As you read, notice how each student focuses on and explains the main idea of their paper; uses evidence, including examples, explanations, summaries, and quotes, to support the main idea; and cites and documents their sources.

STUDENT PAPER

Before Reading: Predict

Complete the following exercises.

1. Review the "Writing Prompt." What does the writer need to do to create a successful paper?
2. Read the "Requirements" for the essay assignment. What does the writer need to do, in addition to addressing the prompt, to create a successful paper?

Annotations for Analysis:

How effective is the writing? How can the writing be improved?

Annotations for Comprehension:

Identify the Thesis, Main Ideas, and Support

Burke 1

Renee Burke
English 151RW
Professor Kuehner
11 December 2020

Heading in MLA format

Segmented Sleep: Nature vs. Nurture

Title suggests writer's topic and focus.

Opening details and descriptions get reader's interest.

First paragraph is the introduction.

You open your eyes and glance at your phone. It's 12:58 a.m. and in your groggy half-asleep thought, you curse to yourself in your mind that you are awake. Well, might as well go to the bathroom and get a sip of water, you tell yourself. 15 minutes after that, you decide to pet your cat on the way back to bed. You get back to bed just before the warm spot no longer exists and before you lose too much sleepiness. As you lay down, before you drift off again, you have thoughts that cross your mind. Yesterday was a beautiful

day. Pancakes sound great, can't wait for breakfast. What woke me, you think as you doze off into an epic dream. Everyone has had this kind of night, but why? Our ancestors had a different sleep pattern than we do today. Perhaps these occasional nights are remnants of these old patterns, or maybe this is our natural circadian rhythm. While diving into the research, I found a historian who dedicated his life to 16 years of research into pre-industrial sleep patterns, a psychiatrist who studied Seasonal Affective Disorder (SAD), and some writers who attempted to segment sleep.

Effectively focuses the paper on sleep patterns by asking a question, then stating the answer

Thesis: States why some people have sleepless nights

Prepares readers for the evidence coming up in the paper

Roger Ekirch is a historian from Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University who researched sleep patterns throughout history. He wrote "At Day's Close: Night in Times Past" and a paper that preceded this book, "Sleep We Have Lost: Pre-industrial Slumber in the British Isles." In this paper, he quotes a gentleman, Louis Stevenson, in 1878 who wrote in his journal during his hour of wakefulness between his first and second sleep, "At what inaudible summons," he wondered, "are all these sleepers thus recalled in the same hour to life?" (Ekirch). Stevenson goes on pondering about the wakefulness in the night and implies prayers to his God. Ekirch continues to dig into more journals, documents and navigate through the data that history has scattered for us to find and piece it together. He writes during this hour not only were people awake writing in journals and praying, but he finds records they used the restroom, smoked tobacco, visited neighbors, made love, but what was the most important thing he found was the importance of recording and discussing their dreams (Ekirch). Ekirch read hundreds of authors from poetry by Sir Philip Sidney to *The Odyssey* by Homer and everything in between to understand the way of segmented sleep in the earlier centuries. Ekirch noticed that as the industrial revolution continued to boom and thrive, the desire to practice segmented sleep dwindled. He quoted author Joseph Lawson of 1887, "Society is now influenced more by facts of art and science than dreams" (Ekirch). The dreams that were vital and important to our ancestors, were nothing more than just that, dreams.

Effective introduction of a source

Paragraph relies primarily on one source; quotes and summarizes that source to illustrate the history of segmented sleep

Good mix of quotations and summaries from the source

Main idea: segmented sleep is no longer a way of life

A smoother transition would be helpful.

Psychiatrist Thomas Wehr performed a study in the early 1990's on photoperiods to understand Seasonal Affective Disorder, or SAD for short. For 30 days during this study, he subjected 18 volunteers to 14 hours of darkness and 10 hours of daylight to mimic the winter months. The first three weeks of the study, the volunteers were having trouble grappling with their sleep schedule. By the fourth week, Wehr noticed something that shocked both him, his colleagues, and sleep scientists. The volunteers' sleep schedule split into two sleeping blocks with a one- to three-hour wake period in between. Wehr's research showed that the circadian rhythm was "modified by the change in photoperiod."

Interesting summary of research

Main idea: evidence suggests segmented sleep is natural

This is a strong transition because it helps readers understand the flow of the ideas.

Tumbling down the rabbit hole of segmented sleep, I found David Allegretti from *The Sydney Morning Herald* and Jesse Barron of *The New York Times*. They both have experienced segmented sleep; one forcing themself into the routine while the other slowly transitioned into the routine brought on by the intense city life. Barron, who lives in New York City, carries you through his transition of insomniac-fueled nights to a more quiet, peaceful rest. His journey and in return of the research he did in why he was falling into this sleep cycle was interesting and opened the doors to dive into Roger Ekirchs' research. Barron explains this mid-night wakefulness as "having a superpower" and being able to write, read and be at peace. His story made me want to attempt the forgotten sleep cycle, then I read David Allegretti's story and all future challenges were called off. Allegretti's journey was everything short of peacefulness during the mid-night wakefulness. He brings you through his first week of mid-night feet dragging, where he had all these goals he wanted to accomplish, but just scrolled through social media, curry recipes and coronavirus videos (Allegretti). Halfway through his first week feeling defeated he contacted Australian-American Sleep Physician Dr. David Cunnington who expressed that biphasic sleep isn't for everyone. Cunnington goes on to explain to Allegretti that some people are naturals, and some people must put in a lot of effort into this sleep pattern. Allegretti essentially gave up after his first seven days and went back to a normal sleep schedule.

Main idea that both men have experience segmented sleep

Strong use of multiple sources in one paragraph

Engaging transition that includes your reactions

Is it necessary to use "you"?

Effective use of question (to sum up) and answer (to set up) to create a transition

So, historians say it has happened, doctors researched it, and we have a couple of writers who took on the challenge, but is segmented sleep good for you? It depends on what you do in those waking hours. Doctors suggest avoiding it if you intend to, or find yourself on your phone, computer, or watching television during the waking hours. You want to stimulate your brain, but just slightly. Plenty of research shows reading a book before bed, meditating, and low stimulating activities are best before bed, and it's the same for the hours between your sleeping blocks.

Summarizes the research in the paper up to this point

Main idea: segmented sleep is good or bad depending on how the wake time is used

Is there a source to cite for the doctors or the research?

Ekirch found that journaling dreams was most important, and perhaps we can bring back journaling our dreams during segmented sleep. The four sleep cycles will be split into two groups causing your body to be more regenerative after the first block of sleep, and your brain being more repaired after your second block of sleep. This leaves you to remember more dreams and to be able to describe them in more vivid detail. Not only did Ekirch's research suggest that segmented sleep can enhance dream journaling, but also conception. Doctors in the early 18th century claimed having sex during the waking hours between first and second sleep led to higher rates of conception due to restfulness. Studies today show they were right. The hormone prolactin, which is the hormone that enables female mammals to produce breast milk, produces better at night. Releasing prolactin at night encourages the estrogen and testosterone hormones to release increasing the passion, and in turn increasing the conception rates. In short, perhaps having sex in the middle of the night can help with couples who struggle conceiving.

Two interesting advantages of segmented sleep explained

Remind readers of the four sleep cycles

Main idea: explains the positive aspects of segmented sleep

While segmented sleep is no longer as common as it once was, there are dozens of bloggers and YouTubers trying to tackle the challenge of segmented sleep. There is a whole subreddit on Reddit dedicated to tips and tricks, reasons as to why people want to change their sleep schedule, and just curiosity into this unknown world of sleep. Maybe we sometimes wake in the middle of the night because that is what our brain has been hardwired to do for centuries until the Industrial Revolution came and we

Clever strategy to bring segmented sleep into the 21st century

Concluding paragraph

Sums up research findings: two possible answers to why we sometimes experience segmented sleep

rewired our own brains. Is it possible that in today's age of technology, chaotic fast paced lifestyle, and restless nights, can segmented sleep bring us a sense of tranquility?

Concise and accurate summary of the information and research in the paper

Works Cited

Works Cited starts on a new page.

List of sources alphabetized and written in MLA style

Allegretti, David. "The Eight-Hour Sleep Myth? I Tried Our 'Default' Way and This is What I Learnt." *The Sydney Morning Herald,* 2 May 2020, www.smh.com.au/lifestyle/health-and-wellness/the-eight-hour-sleep-myth-i-tried-our-default-way-and-this-is-what-i-learnt-20200417-p54kun.html.

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"Is Segmented (Polyphasic) Sleep Healthy – 6 Things That You Should Know." *Sleep Advisor,* 3 June 2020, www.sleepadvisor.org/segmented-sleep/

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After Reading: Evaluate the Paper

5. What is the writer's thesis? Is it clearly written?
6. Examine the body paragraphs. Are the main ideas effectively supported with evidence, such as factual evidence, quotes from experts, explanations, and examples? Do you think the student uses too much of her own experience or opinions and not enough research?
7. Examine the use of quotations and summaries from the readings. Does the writer use quotes and summaries effectively to support the main

ideas? Are the sources of quotes and summaries identified and correctly cited?

8. What do you think are the most effective aspects of the student's essay? Be specific by referencing words or sentences, examples, or paragraphs that you feel are especially strong and explaining why.
9. Are there any parts of the essay you feel could be improved? If so, identify these specifically by referencing words or sentences, examples, or paragraphs and explaining how these could be stronger.
10. What aspects of this essay might you emulate in your own writing?

STUDENT PAPER

Now it is your turn to read and annotate a student paper. Read Xiaoyan's paper twice, using the annotation strategies you have learned (summarized as follows) and the example of annotations on Burke's paper to guide you.

First Reading: Annotating for Comprehension: Note the title, highlight main ideas, mark support, and write brief summaries in the margin.

Second Reading: Annotating for Analysis: Write comments evaluating the effectiveness of the title, introduction, thesis, topic sentences, support, and conclusion. Notice, too, whether sources are used well and properly cited, and whether the paper is correctly formatted.

Before Reading: Predict

Write answers to these questions using complete sentences.

1. Look at the essay title. What aspects of sleep do you think the paper will focus on?
2. Review the "Writing Prompt." Then consider the following questions: How much of the essay should be devoted to explaining other people's ideas? How much of the essay should be the student's opinions, experiences, or observations?

During Reading: Annotate; Analyze

3. As you read, underline the writer's thesis, main ideas, and supporting evidence. Identify the introduction, body paragraphs, topic sentences, and the conclusion. Analyze how effective the different parts of the paper are.
4. As you read, notice where the writer introduces and cites quotes or examples from the readings and how she creates a Works Cited page. Consider whether the citations and documentation are correct and whether the paper is properly formatted.

Xiaoyan Huo
Professor Kuehner
English 151RW
10 November 2020

The Two Way Correlation Between Sleep Disturbances and Dementia

A few years ago, when I read Lisa Genova's novel *Still Alice*, it was my first time closely observing what life looks like for an Alzheimer's patient. Alice, a cognitive psychology professor at Harvard, had a perfect life until she was diagnosed with early-onset Alzheimer's in her late 40s. As her illness progressed, she couldn't recognize her loved ones, and she had excessive daytime sleepiness and frequent nighttime awakenings. Indeed, poor sleep is especially common among people with dementia, and as many as 70% of patients in early-stage dementia have sleep issues (Wennberg). This connection raises the question of how disrupted sleep is linked to cognitive decline and dementia. In the article "Sleep and Mild Cognitive Impairment," the authors state "Sleep disturbances in quality and quantity of sleep, as well as disruption of the sleep-wake rhythm, occur frequently in older adults with cognitive impairment and there is growing support for a bidirectional relationship" (Cassidy-Eagle and Siebern). In short, sleep disturbances and cognitive impairment among older adults have a strong and "bidirectional" correlation, and they go hand in hand.

When people get older, they often suffer from sleep disorders. Along with the body, the inner master biological clock in the brain also ages, which is in charge of forming the suprachiasmatic nucleus (SCN). The SCN controls circadian rhythms that signal the body when to undergo certain biological processes. As biological clocks get older, circadian rhythms are altered (Newson). Furthermore, older adults generally have insufficient exposure to daylight and less secretion of melatonin, one of the hormones related to sleep, and thus, normal circadian rhythms become harder to maintain (Newson). Certain heart,

blood pressure, and asthma medications can also make it difficult for the elderly to sleep. As a result, about 40% to 70% of older adults have chronic sleep problems such as insomnia, daytime drowsiness, sleep apnea, restless leg syndrome, and rapid eye movement sleep behavior disorder (Newson).

Disturbed sleep contributes to impaired thinking and declines in memory. According to Courtney Roberts' article "To Sleep or not to Sleep: That is the College Student's Eternal Question," sleep not only has a "restorative function" which removes neurotoxic waste from the brain and restores the mental state, but also has "memory consolidation" function during slow-wave sleep and REM sleep, which are the stages of essential deep sleep (122). In other words, sleep plays a crucial role in learning and memory across the lifespan. A study tested memory performance in older adults after simulation increased their slow-wave sleep, and found that they had significant improvements in memory tests (Cassidy-Eagle and Siebern). This result proves that longer slow-wave sleep benefits memory; lack of it hurts memory. In fact, not only is memory struck by poor sleep. Researchers also study consequences of sleep disturbances and cognitive decline, such as loss of memory, lack of attention, worse executive functioning, and impaired problem solving skills. They reveal that there is a strong connection observed between sleep disturbances and mild cognitive impairment (MCI), regardless of MCI subtype (Cassidy-Eagle and Siebern). It is clear that all the subtypes of MCI are impacted by disrupted sleep. Moreover, another convincing research studied the association between cognitive decline and sleep duration among 100,000 middle-aged and older-aged individuals. The groups sleeping four hours or less and 10 hours or more were found to have an accelerated cognitive decline than the group sleeping seven hours (Gramigna). This finding confirms that both insufficient and excessive sleep have a negative effect on reasoning.

Poor sleep may increase the risk of cognitive decline and dementia. Conversely, people with cognitive decline and dementia "exhibit an elevated rate of sleep disturbances" (Wennberg). Scientists do not completely understand the underlying mechanisms of dementia's impact

on sleep disorders. Neurodegenerative brain diseases have the potential to worsen patients' sleep disturbances because they could either damage brain cells or change brains to disrupt sleep. A study shows that one indication of Alzheimer's patients is a higher level of deposition of a harmful chemical named Amyloid Beta in the brain. This chemical can make slow-wave sleep shorter and more fragmented (Cassidy-Eagle and Siebern). Therefore, sleep disruptions could result from the damage of Alzheimer's on the brain. Similarly, because MCI could cause change in the part of a patient's brain responsible for maintaining sleep pattern, MCI patients share the common symptom of abnormal Circadian (Cassidy-Eagle and Siebern). Thus, sleep disruptions also could result from the change of sleep pattern caused by MCI. Furthermore, different dementia subtypes are directly linked to a different sleep disorder; for instance, daytime drowsiness and rapid eye movement sleep behavior disorder are associated with Lewy Body and Parkinson's, accordingly (Cassidy-Eagle and Siebern). This finding is indirect evidence that dementias possibly interfere with sleep. Consequently, sleep disturbances associated with dementias tend to get worse over time, similar to how dementia's other symptoms get worse during later stages.

Sleep disturbances and cognitive impairment have a strong association, and each play a part in fueling the other. As a result, poor sleep may be an early sign of cognitive decline; poor sleep also could be an inevitable symptom of late stage dementia. Alice happened to fall into the second category because her disease is genetic and gradually invaded her brain. Hence, her early marker was only memory loss, but ultimately and unfortunately, she suffered from both cognitive decline and sleep disturbance.

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After Reading: Evaluate the Paper

5. What is the writer's thesis? Is it clearly written?
6. Examine the body paragraphs. Are the main ideas effectively supported with evidence, such as factual evidence, quotes from experts, explanations, and examples? Do you think the student uses too much of her own experience or opinions and not enough research?
7. Examine the use of quotations and summaries from the readings. Does the writer use quotes and summaries effectively to support the main ideas? Are the sources of quotes and summaries identified and correctly cited?
8. What do you think are the most effective aspects of the student's essay? Be specific by referencing words or sentences, examples, or paragraphs that you feel are especially strong and explaining why.
9. Are there any parts of the essay you feel could be improved? If so, identify these specifically by referencing words or sentences, examples, or paragraphs and explaining how these could be stronger.
10. What aspects of this essay might you use in your own writing?

Spotlight Activities

1. Did you feel that one of the sample student papers was more effectively written than the other, or were they equally effective? Explain your answer.
2. If you are currently working on a piece of writing for your English class or for any other subject, annotate and analyze the writing. Identify the main ideas and examples; then review the writing to examine the introduction, body paragraphs, use of support, conclusion, and citations. Use your annotations to help you evaluate and improve the writing.
3. What have you learned about analyzing student writing from reading this chapter, examining the annotated student paper, and annotating a student paper?
4. What have you learned about writing an effective essay synthesizing sources from studying the two student papers in this chapter?

Credits

pp. 300–304: Burke, Renee. "Segmented Sleep: Nature vs. Nurture." 11 December 2020. Used with permission; **pp. 306–309:** Huo, Xiaoyan. "The Two Way Correlation Between Sleep Disturbances and Dementia." 10 November 2020. Used with permission.

PART FOUR

Research and Documentation

12 Planning a Research Paper

13 Writing a Research Paper

14 Reading Visuals

15 MLA and APA Documentation

Spotlight on Student Writing: Revising and Editing a Research Paper

CHAPTER 12

Planning a Research Paper

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Write a research question.
- Locate academic sources that are relevant to your research question.
- Prepare to research your question with background reading.
- Evaluate researched sources.
- Compose an annotated bibliography.

Theme: What Is Real News and What Is Fake News?

At some point in your academic career, you are likely to write a research paper. A **research paper** is typically similar to other college essays that ask you to synthesize information, such as an explanatory synthesis paper or an argumentative essay. The primary difference is that a research paper requires you to find information about a topic from outside sources. Moreover, because you must locate, read, and evaluate sources (the focus of this chapter), as well as take notes, plan, draft, revise, and format a research paper (the focus of the next chapter), you must give yourself a substantial amount of time, several weeks or even several months, to both plan and write a research paper.

Finding reliable information (the focus of this chapter) can be problematic. You have probably heard the term *fake news*. It is real: fake news is a term for information that appears to be true but in fact may be misleading, manipulated, or simply fabricated. Sometimes the purpose of fake news is to persuade readers to take an action, such as buy a product or sign a petition or support a particular political candidate. Other times the purpose is more benign, such as to entertain or to parody. In your academic career and in your personal life, you will want to learn strategies for determining whether information is valid and reliable, so you can make informed, sound decisions. A good place to begin identifying

credible sources is with the tips given by the International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions in Figure 12.1. This chapter will provide further details about how to find and assess valid sources of information.

FIGURE 12.1 How to Spot Fake News

Source: International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions

WRITING A RESEARCH QUESTION

Depending on the research paper assignment, you may be given a specific prompt to address, or you may be free to explore a topic of your choice. Either way, it is helpful to begin with a *research question*, because a question can do the following:

- Point you to appropriate sources.
- Help you read your sources effectively and efficiently.
- Encourage you to keep an open mind and develop a well-informed point of view on the topic.

If you are writing from a prompt, you can often use the prompt to develop a research question. First, annotate the prompt to determine its PAS—Purpose, Audience, and Subject. The most common purposes for a research paper are these:

- To inform (for example, an essay explaining the impacts of fake health information)
- To instruct (for example, an essay describing how to identify fake health news)
- To argue (for example, an essay giving reasons why fake health news is a serious problem)
- To persuade (for example, an essay presenting evidence to convince social media companies to take action to halt the spread of fake health news)

Then focus on the subject of the prompt. Turn the subject into a question. Figure 12.2 shows an example of an annotated prompt.

FIGURE 12.2 Sample Annotated Prompt

Paper Prompt	Annotations
Using the following prompt, write a research paper from which your classmates and instructor can learn more about fake health news. Explain how consumers can identify and avoid fake health news, including how to prevent the spread of false information.	*Audience: fellow students and instructor* *Purpose: to explain; informative* *Subject: fake health news*

To create a research question from the annotated prompt, focus on key words in the prompt related to the subject and purpose. Then, using words such as *how*, *why*, and *what*, create one (or more) questions related to the subject. Here is an example of a research question based on the annotated prompt:

RESEARCH QUESTION: How can consumers spot fake health news and prevent its spread?

LOCATING ACADEMIC SOURCES

To research a topic, you must locate sources that are appropriate for the assigned prompt and for the specific class. For instance, in a history class, you may be required to use original sources from a particular period in history, such as speeches by Martin Luther King, Jr., and newspaper accounts written at the time of the Civil Rights March in Washington, DC. In a nursing class, you might be required to locate scholarly articles written by health care professionals describing the most effective procedures for drawing blood. Understanding different

types of sources can help you to select the most appropriate ones. Figure 12.3 lists and describes common sources used in academic research.

FIGURE 12.3 Types of Sources

Type of Source	General Description	Examples
Nonscholarly sources	Newspapers, general-interest magazines, and popular books	• *The New York Times* newspaper • *The Atlantic* magazine • *Omnivore's Dilemma: A Natural History of Four Meals* by Michael Pollan
Scholarly sources	Academic journals, university-affiliated databases, and books from academic presses	• *JAMA (Journal of the American Medical Association)* • *Project Muse* • *Superbugs: An Arms Race against Bacteria* by William Hall, Anthony McDonnell, Jim O'Neill (Harvard University Press)
Government publications	Reports, fact sheets, websites, data, and statistics collected and published by government agencies	• National Climate Assessment report • Bureau of Labor Statistics • NIH (National Institutes of Health) website
Nontext sources or original material	Speeches, conferences, art exhibits, music, theater performances, interviews, and so on	• "The Gettysburg Address" by Abraham Lincoln • Interview with Maya Angelou on *The Oprah Winfrey Show* • TEDxTalk: *The Danger of a Single Story* by Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie

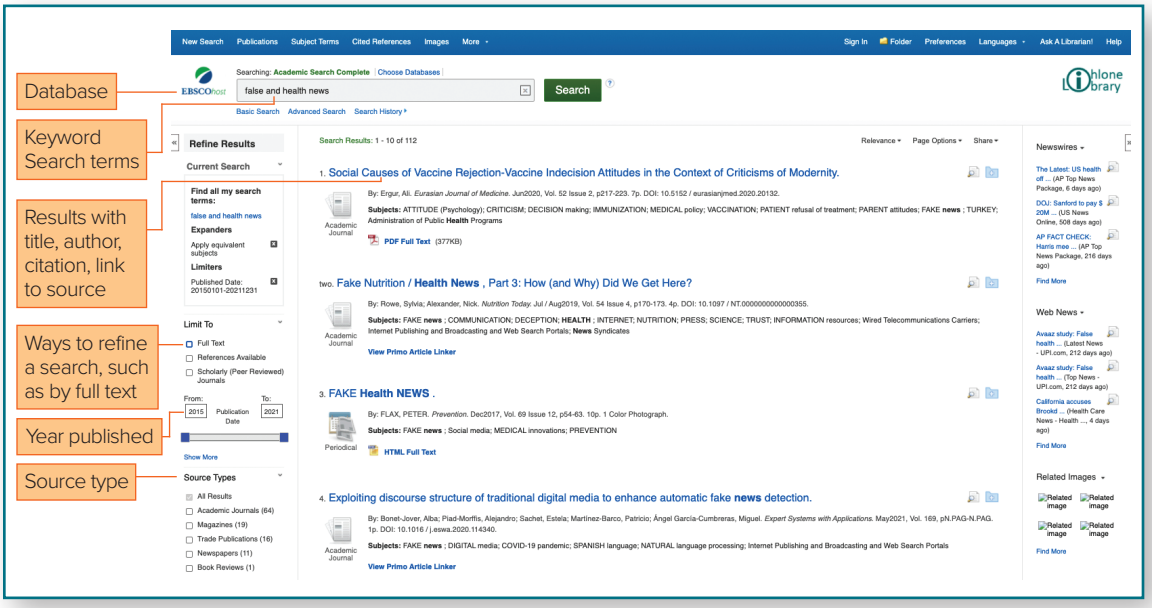
Find Information in the College Library

With a specific research question in mind, you can begin to search for information. Your college library should be the first place you go. A college library's *home page*, the first page viewers see when going to a website, is designed to help students get started searching for quality information for academic purposes.

Moreover, you can be confident that most of the materials in the college library are appropriate for academic use because the readings have been selected by college librarians, usually in consultation with faculty and others who are knowledgeable in subject fields. This guarantee of credibility is true, too, for online materials you find through the college's website because the library staff also screens electronic books and electronic journal articles. In fact, most college libraries have subscriptions to a variety of electronic **databases** (see Figure 12.4, for example), collections of information that can be searched by a computer. These databases contain links to books and e-books, as well as references to newspaper, magazine, and journal articles, in both print and downloadable formats. By using key words to search your research topic, you should find relevant, reliable sources in the library database. Figure 12.4 demonstrates one such search using a database called EBSCOhost. Consult a librarian or ask your instructor for advice about which databases would be most advantageous to search given your research question.

FIGURE 12.4 Annotated Database Search Result

Source: EBSCO Information Services



Search the Internet

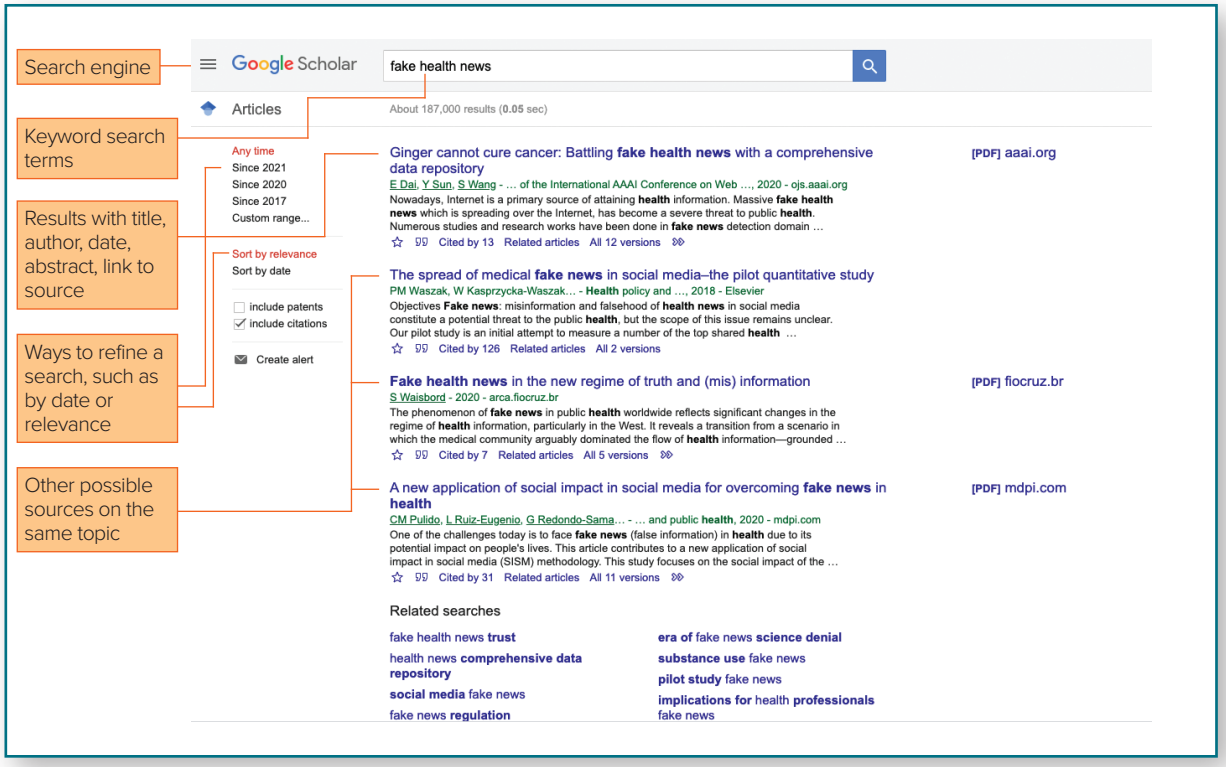
According to the Pew Research Center, more than 98% of adults in the United States aged 18 to 49 use the Internet. Thus it is not surprising that many students first look on the Internet for information for their papers ("Internet/Broadband Fact Sheet"). Using a **search engine**—a computer program that locates documents on the web—such as *Google*, *Bing*, or *Yahoo*—to find information online is easy, quick, familiar, and convenient. If you find what you are looking for, you can often read it online or download it to your own computer.

However, what you find when using a search engine to locate information online is not necessarily academic in nature. In other words, there is no guarantee that the information has been checked by recognized experts or by an editor to ensure quality control. In fact, some professors (and colleges) forbid students from using Internet search engines to locate sources. They believe that students do not think critically when they use search engines to find topics and do not sufficiently practice evaluative skills to select quality information.

A better alternative to a general search engine, such as *Google* or *Bing*, is a search engine designed to locate academic materials online, such as *Google Scholar* (Figure 12.5) or *Microsoft Academic Search*. These search programs are specifically devised to find reliable scholarly information, such as that in books and journal articles. Some college libraries include links to *Google Scholar* on their home page. Just as when searching library databases, using keywords to

FIGURE 12.5 Annotated Scholarly Search Result

Source: Google Scholar



search online can yield relevant, reliable results but only if you check sources carefully. See Figure 12.5 to understand online search results.

Wikipedia as a Source

If you do a *Google* search for a topic, chances are a *Wikipedia* entry on that subject will appear in the top 10 results. Despite its popularity, *Wikipedia*, the self-described "free online encyclopedia that anyone can edit" ("Welcome to *Wikipedia*"), is a controversial information source. The articles are written collaboratively by anonymous volunteers, and just about anyone can write and post information to a *Wikipedia* entry. *Wikipedia* articles vary in length, quality, and accuracy. Even *Wikipedia*'s founder, Jimmy Wales, has said that students should not use *Wikipedia* for college work: "You're in college; don't cite the encyclopedia" (qtd. in Young).

Rather than being a main source, an encyclopedia such as *Wikipedia* might be a starting point for research—a resource for an overview of a topic.

Moreover, at the bottom of most *Wikipedia* pages is a list of references cited, such as newspaper or magazine articles, journal articles, books, and interviews. These sources might be worth looking up and reading or using in an academic paper. Remember, though, that whatever information you find or read on *Wikipedia* itself should be evaluated with a critical eye and documented in a second, academic source before you use it in your paper. See Figure 12.6 for a summary of the pros and cons of *Wikipedia* as a source of reliable information.

An alternative to *Wikipedia* might be a specialized online encyclopedia, such as a medical encyclopedia, or a government website that publishes information for citizens. For instance, *PubMed Health*, run by the National Institutes of Health, provides health information and research to the public. This site is a reliable resource when researching a health-related topic, because the information is hosted on a government-supported website and therefore is likely to be accurate and up to date.

FIGURE 12.6 Pros and Cons of Using *Wikipedia* as a Source

Pros	Cons
Information in a *Wikipedia* article can provide an overview on a topic.	Information in a *Wikipedia* article is not written by experts and not fact checked.
List of sources at the end of a *Wikipedia* article may include links to reliable information.	Instructors typically do not allow *Wikipedia* articles to be used as a source.

Use Key Words in an Online Search

Whether searching for information on the web or through the college's electronic databases, a **key word search** is the most common method to use. A **key word** is a word, often a noun, that identifies the topic. For instance, if you are searching for information about the safety of vaccinations, *vaccination* is a key word. You may need to narrow or restrict your search by using more than one key word to find sources on your particular topic. For example, if you want to find out about misinformation about the safety of vaccinations, using the key words *vaccinations* and *misinformation* might yield more relevant results than simply using the key word *vaccinations.* You could focus your search even more precisely by using the key words *vaccinations* and *misinformation* and *safety.*

Notice that a key word search does not consist of a phrase or sentence such as "How does misinformation about vaccine safety impact children's health?" but rather of single words. Searches that respond to phrases and sentences, including questions, are called **natural language searches**.

PREPARING WITH BACKGROUND READING

When researching a topic, background reading can be useful. Background reading means reading to get an overview of a topic: to understand the topic, to learn its history, to familiarize yourself with key terminology and important concepts, and to become aware of issues or controversies surrounding the topic. Researchers and scholars traditionally have consulted encyclopedias to gain an overview. Written by experts in a field, encyclopedia entries give readers general knowledge about a specific subject. Other useful sources of information include government and research websites that provide information to a general audience. For instance, the government often funds research for the public good. Then it becomes the government's job to keep citizens informed of the research findings.

To gain basic information about fake health news, you will do some background reading in the following Reading Selection. Read to understand how people can be misled by false health advertisements, why false health news items appear online, and how to spot misinformation.

READING SELECTION

HOW TO SPOT FAKE HEALTH NEWS

Before Reading: Predict; Preview

Write answers to these questions using complete sentences.

1. What strategies might websites or social media posts use to make viewers believe untrue claims?
2. What strategies might social media users employ to spot untrue claims?

During Reading: Annotate

Read the selection twice. Write answers to these questions using complete sentences.

3. On your first reading, read for comprehension of the topic and mark the main ideas and supporting information.
4. On your second reading, look for information related to your research question.

How to Spot Fake Health News, According to Experts

Dozens of websites peddle false information on diseases, treatments, weight loss plans, and more, hoping to profit from it. Here's what you need to know.

By Peter Flax

Prevention Magazine, 29 November 2017

The following article appeared in Prevention.com, *an online magazine focused on health and lifestyle. The author describes how social media can trick users into believing false health claims and then spending money for products they don't need or following advice that is harmful to their health. Four tips at the end help readers identify fake health news.*

The trip down the rabbit hole begins innocently enough with a video on Facebook. In the engaging 3-minute, 40-second clip, a bariatric physician named Amy Lee explains with unusual clarity why people looking to shed pounds should limit their intake of salt and sugar, eat more whole foods, and combine good fats with fiber. It's the kind of smart- and helpful-sounding advice that people tend to share, which probably helps explain why the video already has been viewed 120,000 times on Facebook. 1

The first hint of intrigue comes with a click on the accompanying link, which leads to an infomercial for a supplement maker named Nucific, promoting a probiotic product called Bio-X4, which promises to boost metabolism, reduce gas and bloating after eating, and control food cravings. There is no mention of pills in the Facebook video, but this page links to an offer for a 30-day supply of Bio-X4, which Lee created, for $99 (a discounted 180-day supply has a price tag of $487.08), as well as glowing customer reviews. 2

Another page features a professionally produced 46-minute documentary detailing the efficacy of Bio-X4, backed by a list of journal citations. Given the polished quality of the video, the apparent authority of Lee (who, according to her LinkedIn profile, earned her MD at the University of Illinois and did a fellowship in clinical nutrition at UCLA), and the supposed merits of the product, a careful consumer might then seek confirmation of Bio-X4's benefits from a real authority—you know, Google. 3

A search turns up numerous reviews on sites—with names like dietpillswatchdog.com, healthwikinews.com, and supplementpolice.com—that seem focused on consumer advocacy. But there's an odd sameness to the reviews, most of which are written in similar conversational and unpolished language. Some are cautiously positive, while others, like those on dietpillswatchdog.com, criticize Bio-X4 and lead the consumer to another site selling a different line of weight loss pills. 4

Jack and Gayle (who asked us not to use their last name) stumbled into this disorienting online ecosystem when Jack opened an e-mail from Nucific in September. It appeared to be a note from Lee containing a link to a groundbreaking and controversial article on fats that was part of a series of articles titled "The Food Truth Letters." 5

Although Jack, 63, has no idea how Nucific obtained his e-mail address, he would receive two more dispatches from Lee in the next week, both linking to articles—one about integrating exercise into your life and another about sugar. The articles were engaging and informative, and though none of them made a hard sell for Nucific's products, the marketing push now had Jack's full attention. Forty 6

pounds overweight and interested in slimming down quickly, Jack clicked a link. One thing led to another.

Gayle, 64, had never heard of Bio-X4 until she opened a package a week later and found a big bottle of pills and a receipt for a $106 purchase. “Jack didn’t tell me anything about it,” she says. “I was so upset. He was scheduled to get a hip replacement in a week.” 7

Jack thought the supplement might be useful—both to help him shed pounds and to help Gayle deal with chronic stomach issues. “But I told him there was no way he was taking it before his procedure,” she says. “And I told him we needed to get more information.” 8

That’s because, while there’s plenty to read about Bio-X4, all the information resides within a certain bubble. There are no medical studies examining the weight loss claims, no credentialed medical experts (aside from Lee) weighing in on the ingredients. Few major retailers or pharmacy chains are selling it. No well-known health sites have reviewed it. And yet on social media and in this vibrant online subculture, Bio-X4 seems like a big deal. 9

Unproven, expensive, and slickly marketed weight loss supplements have been around since the days of roving snake-oil salesmen. “People have been creating dubious news, and arguing about how to detect it, for centuries,” says Brian Southwell, Ph.D., director of science in the public sphere at the Center for Communication Science at RTI International, tracing the problem back to the rise of so-called yellow journalism in the 19th century, when partisan newspapers published editorial content not always rooted in facts. 10

But technology has changed the game. As Southwell observes, social media enables sensational stories to spread fast and furiously. In the past year, the term fake news has flooded the national consciousness, but most of the references relate to political content. Little has been written about the proliferation of health information that is neither credible nor well regulated. 11

“The circulation of really hyperbolic and misleading health and medical information is one of the biggest problems in the fake news era,” says Melissa Zimdars, Ph.D., an assistant professor of communications at Merrimack College and a leading scholar on the fake-news phenomenon. “Bad health information can actually manipulate people into making bad medical decisions.” 12

Southwell points out that unreliable health news and advice can cause the worst kind of harm. “It can have dire consequences if followed, both for individuals and for whole communities,” he says. As an example, he points to poorly substantiated stories written to dissuade people from vaccinating their children, despite advice to the contrary from every major medical organization. This kind of misinformation has been linked to breaches in many communities’ immunity to diseases such as measles and whooping cough, leading to new outbreaks. And in a 2016 case in China that earned global attention, a 21-year-old college student with a rare form of cancer clicked on a promoted link on the nation’s top search engine that led him to pursue an expensive and controversial treatment. He subsequently died. 13

When asked to assess the scope of the problem, Zimdars pauses. “It’s bad,” she says. “It’s really bad.” The fake-news forces that created scandals like Pizzagate are part of a national conversation, but the depth of the problem in health and wellness remains a public mystery. 14

Experts agree that almost all the untrustworthy online wellness advice is created and promoted with one or more of three goals in mind: to generate profits by selling 15

products, to promote an agenda, or to make money by using sensationalized stories to generate traffic and sell advertising.

To see how that third category plays out, consider an article published in September 2016 on healtheternally.com with this attention-grabbing headline: "Scientists Find Root That Kills 98% of Cancer Cells in 48 Hours." The story touted the cancer-fighting properties of dandelion root without citing any recent published studies and linking only to a 4-year-old news story about a biochemist who had received a grant to study the root. Despite the lack of substantiated evidence, the article, which has since been roundly dismissed by medical experts and fact-checking entities like snopes.com, was shared 1.4 million times on social media. That's a lot of traffic for a piece of questionable journalism that might encourage someone to abandon proven conventional treatments like chemotherapy. 16

"There's money to be made by garnering an audience," observes Southwell, editor of the book *Misinformation and Mass Audiences*. "But in other cases, these dubious stories are agenda driven, published by people or organizations that have an ax to grind." 17

Many of the stories in that latter category are rooted in an antiestablishment view that opposes pharmaceutical drugs, GMOs, vaccines, mass-produced foods, and such. There's nothing wrong with consumers considering alternative health approaches, but there's cause for concern when publishers exploit those consumers with misleading or false information. 18

The roster of fake-health-news perpetrators is largely made up of harmless, holistic-sounding, and seemingly interchangeable names—naturalnews.com, healthnutnews.com, naturalblaze.com—with no brand recognition and poor track records. Zimdars's list of top offenders includes greenmedinfo.com, which published a story breathlessly touting the health benefits of black cumin seed—citing ancient literature that called it a "remedy for everything but death"—that got more than 140,000 shares on Facebook and Pinterest (and included a link to buy a 250 mL bottle of Panaseeda Black Cumin Oil for $49.99). 19

The $50 cumin oil hits the holy trifecta in fake health news: aggressively selling products while pushing an agenda and snagging traffic. Perhaps no one has perfected the model better than Alex Jones, the well-known conspiracy theorist whose site, infowars .com, averages about 9 million visitors a month, according to ComScore. Infowars has famously publicized stories claiming that 9/11, the Boston Marathon bombing, and Hurricane Katrina involved government conspiracies. In its bustling Health News section, the site typically takes on the pharmaceutical industry, mainstream medicine, the nation's water supply, and the food industry with strongly worded and poorly sourced "news" that often supports products sold in its store. 20

"The whole MO at Infowars is to scare people into believing that you can't trust doctors, you can't trust what's in your water, you can't even trust other manufacturers of supplements and health products," says Zimdars. "And therefore you need to buy Infowars products, which have a huge markup—consumers wind up buying something for $40 that they could buy at a local store for 10 bucks. There's a weird combination of ideology and financial imperatives aligning." 21

Infowars has also published poorly sourced articles and videos that assert that widespread overuse of pesticides, supported by the government and big corporations, has led to a worldwide crisis in which people lack vitamin B12. And as luck would have it, the Infowars store sells a product called Secret 12, which is basically liquid B12. Though the National Institutes of Health says that most Americans get plenty of B12 from their 22

normal diets and estimates that only between 1.5 and 15% of the population needs supplementation, Secret 12 offers 1,000% of the recommended daily intake. A 1 oz, 30-dose bottle costs $24. Meanwhile, a quick search indicates that a bottle of liquid B12 twice the size costs less than $8 on Amazon. And none of this factors in the potential health consequences of that megadose, which could be significant for people with type 1 or 2 diabetes or advanced kidney disease.

23 Policing this is tricky. While the Federal Communications Commission aggressively patrols and enforces strict standards to prevent false claims from appearing on television (and fines rule breakers), no single regulatory agency has similar enforcement power over fake news on the web. “The FTC and FDA comment on marketing initiatives, but no agency regulates user-generated content,” Southwell says.

24 For the time being, much of the burden falls on individual social media companies to regulate content. Facebook, which has roughly 183 million American users, has faced the most criticism regarding fake news, particularly after real news accounts described how Russian web robots and other shady players affected the 2016 presidential election. In response, the social media giant announced several initiatives to combat the problem—third-party fact-checking, allowing users to flag content they suspect is fake, and cracking down on financially motivated spam.

25 A Facebook spokesperson says the company has no specific policies related to fake health content but that the site is making progress on weeding out made-up stories. Told about the dandelion root story, the spokesperson said that such content would perform differently if it were published today. “Our machines and people are getting better at identifying and down-ranking clickbait,” he says. “It’s part of the apparatus now.”

26 Still, it won’t be an easy problem to eradicate. “Facebook is trying hard to distinguish this kind of information and news, but there’s so much to sort out,” notes Miao Feng, Ph.D., a research scientist at the University of Illinois at Chicago who is studying how public health misinformation spreads through social media. “Even as a researcher, I often have to click links to see what’s real and what’s fake. You don’t know until you see the story. Sometimes it looks like real news, but then you get to the site and there’s dubious information or the publisher is selling health and wellness products.”

27 “Fixing the problem rests on the whims of the social media platforms,” says Southwell. “That’s a black box—a process in which too much is hidden.”

28 As Jack and Gayle pondered what to do with their order of Bio-X4, Gayle decided to call a family friend for advice. Luckily for Gayle, her friend is Tod Cooperman, a physician who is the founder and president of ConsumerLab, one of the few reputable independent organizations that test health and nutrition products.

29 “I honestly had never heard of Bio-X4 before,” says Cooperman, who scrutinized the supplement’s ingredient list, study citations, and alleged benefits.

30 He was not impressed. “It seems pretty clear that they didn’t test the formula themselves, that they just borrowed evidence related to some of the ingredients blended in there,” says Cooperman. “A well-labeled supplement would have more clarity. They’re not being clear on how much of the individual ingredients are in the pills—blend is a wiggle word, and this is a blend of blends. In a real, high-quality probiotic, the manufacturer would identify the exact amount of each one in there. And usually there’s more detail about the individual enzymes.”

Cooperman has multiple concerns about the ingredients blended into Bio-X4, such as the evidence linking green-tea extracts to liver toxicity; studies suggesting that one of the ingredients, caralluma—a plant that allegedly tamps down appetite—has no effect on weight loss but can cause GI distress; and the dearth of research demonstrating that probiotics can help people lose weight. He also notes that consumers can buy a high-quality probiotic for as little as 20 cents a day. "I told her that I didn't think this was the best idea," he says of his conversation with Gayle. 31

Lee declined to be interviewed by *Prevention* but issued a statement defending the supplement: "I stand behind the Bio-X4 product and its ingredients. Bio-X4 has been third-party tested and approved to meet supplement content claims. I am pleased to provide a product to consumers that can help to improve their digestive health." 32

Even more disapproving than Cooperman is Eliseo Guallar, a professor of epidemiology and medicine at Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health. After studying the ingredient list and journal studies that Nucific and Lee cite to support Bio-X4's weight loss benefits, Guallar is unsparing in his assessment. "If these substances worked, there would be papers in major medical journals," he says, noting that probiotics have no proven impact on weight loss. "A weight loss supplement that did this would be an actual revolution, a major coup. There would be well-designed trials—you wouldn't learn about it on some company's website." 33

Such criticism is of little comfort to Gayle, staring at the bottle and receipt on her kitchen table. "I'm glad neither of us took the pills," she says. "But still, that's $100 down the drain." 34

How to avoid health scams

How can you avoid fake health news? Four tips:

Read the fine print.

Many deceptive sites post disclaimers saying they're not providing medical advice, says Zimdars. This may be an attempt to sidestep regulation and accountability.

Don't be impressed by a million Facebook views.

Companies that want a big audience can pay to get the word out, says Southwell. Videos that appear to go viral may have been promoted with ad dollars or paid viewers.

Fact-check it.

See what snopes.com says. Ask yourself: Is the site reputable and familiar? Are facts attributed to an expert? If so, Google that person's credentials. Finally, is the site selling something you just read about? If so, proceed cautiously, Southwell says.

Remember that cost doesn't denote quality.

Market research shows that people see a high price as evidence that something works, says Eliseo Guallar, M.D., M.P.H., a Johns Hopkins medical professor. Savvy sales sites set their prices accordingly.

After Reading: Summarize and Respond

When you have finished the reading selection, write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

5. Why did the health news Jack received seem true? Why was he convinced to spend money to buy a product?
6. How were Jack and Gayle able to figure out that the health information they were sent was "fake news"?
7. How can fake health news be harmful to consumers? What examples are given in the reading?
8. What tips are given at the end of the article and throughout the reading to help users spot fake health news online?

Engage with the Reading

When you have finished the Reading Selection, write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Have you or someone you know been the victim of or encountered fake health news? If so, how does your experience compare to Jack and Gayle's experience?
2. Do you think that social media companies, such as Facebook, should be responsible for ensuring that fake news or fake health news does not appear on their sites?

EVALUATING RESEARCHED SOURCES

When you search a college's electronic databases or the Internet for sources, you will need to not only find sources that answer your research question but also high-quality sources. Specifically, sources should be *relevant*, *reliable*, *accurate*, *timely*, and *unbiased* to ensure they are suitable for a research paper. "Strategies for Evaluating Sources" shows how to apply these five criteria to create questions about the source.

Strategies for Evaluating Sources

To evaluate a source, ask these questions:

- *Relevance:* Is the source's information directly related to the research question?
- *Reliability:* Is the source authored by authorities or knowledgeable people? Does it appear in a credible publication such as a **peer-reviewed journal**?
- *Accuracy:* Can the information be verified or checked?
- *Timeliness:* Is the information recent or appropriate for the topic?
- *Bias* (or appropriate bias): Does the source represent a legitimate point of view on the topic?

Let's consider these strategies in more detail.

1. **Is the source's information relevant?** *Relevant* in this case means related to the topic.

   Selecting a source with information relevant to the research question is crucial, especially given the overwhelming amount of information available through electronic databases and online. For instance, a search using the key word *health information* will yield a large number of articles and websites. A website explaining how to read and understand health information found online might not be directly related to the specific question, "What are solutions to the problem of the spread of misinformation about health care online?" In contrast, the online article "How to Spot Fake Health News" is more directly related to the problem of misinformation about health care.

2. **Is the source reliable?** *Reliable* means having credibility to speak or write on a topic or to advance one's ideas.

   Most print and online newspapers, for example, are considered reliable sources because the job of a news reporter is to get the facts and write accurately about the world. Furthermore, reputable newspapers employ editors who check a reporter's facts. Scholarly articles, such as those published in journals, are also generally reliable because the information has been peer reviewed—that is, reviewed by other scholars in the field before being published.

   Be aware, however, that you must carefully check the credibility of any sources you find via a general search engine, such as *Google* or *Yahoo*. Although reliable sources such as newspapers and journals can often be found online, a website (for example, a blog) created by an individual may not be a reliable source—unless you find convincing evidence (usually on the site itself) that the individual is an expert on the topic. However, even if the person is an expert—for example, a doctor at a major hospital—remember that the information on the person's site probably has not been reviewed and verified by an outside authority.

3. **Is the information accurate?** *Accurate* means true and correct.

   Accurate information usually comes from an identifiable, reliable spokesperson or organization. Accurate information often is accompanied by a citation that clarifies the source of that information. Accurate information also tends to be specific—for instance, statistics or other details that can be checked. For example, a personal blog that says antibiotics should not be taken at all because they are not "natural," without giving reliable support for its claim, is giving inaccurate information. A journal article that includes citations to research studies showing the effectiveness of antibiotics for treating bacterial infections could be considered an accurate source.

4. **Is the information timely?** *Timely* means recent or appropriate for the topic.

   Timeliness depends a great deal on the topic itself. For instance, if you are writing about a topic that changes rapidly, such as how fast computers can process information, then an article that is even just a few years old may be out of date. However, if you are dealing with a topic that does not change as quickly, you may be able to use sources from a greater date range. In addition, if you are focusing on

a historical topic like the assassination of President Abraham Lincoln, you might actively seek out older sources, such as news articles from Lincoln's time. Also, sometimes you may wish to quote from the important works in a field. For example, for a psychology paper, you could quote from Sigmund Freud, the founder of psychoanalysis, who worked and wrote early in the twentieth century.

5. **What is the source's point of view or bias?** To have a *bias* means to harbor a preference or belief that might prevent impartial (fair) judgment.

   Many biases—for instance, cultural and political biases—can influence a person's or an organization's judgment or affect how information is presented. In truth, the answer to whether a source is biased is usually "yes." A more appropriate question is, "What exactly is the source's bias or point of view?"

   When assessing bias, ask yourself whether the source has a preference or belief that might compromise neutrality on the topic. If you are unsure, ask your instructor or classmates what they think. When conducting research, it is good practice to include a variety of sources with different perspectives to ensure a balanced view.

Figure 12.7 summarizes questions you can use to evaluate sources and gives examples of sources that may or may not be acceptable to use in a research paper exploring a specific research question.

FIGURE 12.7 Strategic Questions to Evaluate Sources

Research question: What can be done to prevent antibiotic resistance in the future?			
Questions to Evaluate Sources	**Explanation**	**Example: Not OK to Use**	**Example: OK to Use**
1. Are the source and its information *relevant*?	Related to the topic	Fact sheet explaining physical side effects of antibiotics	Fact sheet explaining how overuse of antibiotics can lead to resistance
2. Is the source *reliable*?	Having credibility to speak or write on a topic	A web page with no author or organization cited on a *.com* website (a commercial website); a web page created by an individual and not associated with, or verified by, a reputable organization	An article by a scientist about antibiotic resistance on an *.edu* website (a college or university website); an article on antibiotic resistance in a peer-reviewed journal
3. Is the information *accurate*?	True and precise	General statement that there is lots of antibiotic resistance worldwide	Documented information that 700,000 people worldwide died in 2017 from antibiotic resistant infections
4. Is the information *timely*?	Recent for the topic	An article written in 1990 about antibiotic use	An article written within the last three years about antibiotic use
5. What is the source's *bias*?	Belief that might prevent fair judgment	Research on a drug that is paid for by the drug's manufacturer	Research on a drug by a university or national laboratory

LOCATING CITATION INFORMATION

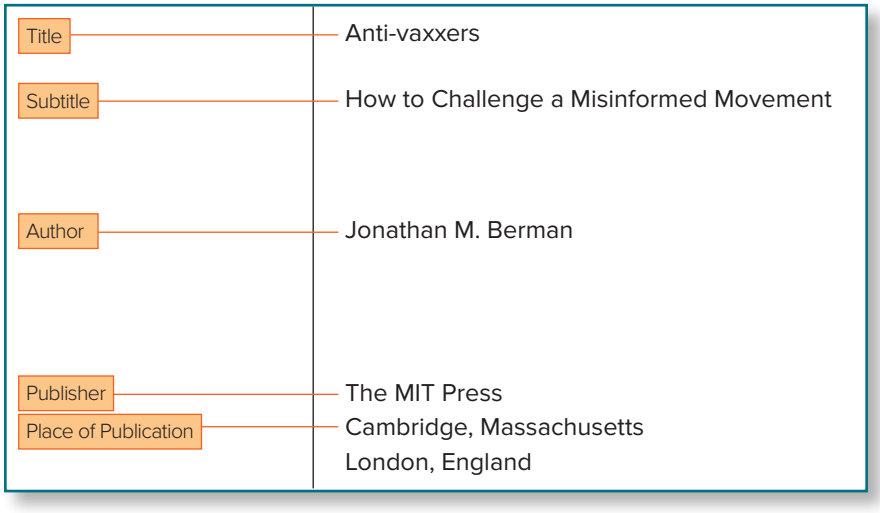
As you locate and evaluate sources, identify those you will read and incorporate into your research paper. Know, too, that any sources used in your paper should be credited. It is good practice to record the information needed to properly cite sources as you find these, since backtracking to rediscover citation information can be a laborious process.

Following are examples from some typical sources used in research papers showing where to find citation information. No matter which citation style you use, some common information, such as author, title, and date of publication, will be necessary.

Books and e-Books

When citing a book, look for information on the title page, which appears near the beginning of the book and before the text itself. The title page should list the title of the book, author name(s), and publishing information, all of which are needed for a citation. On the copyright page, which comes right after the title page, is the date of publication, also needed for a citation. See Figures 12.8 and 12.9 to understand where to locate information necessary for a citation of a book or e-book.

FIGURE 12.8 Book or e-Book Title Page



Journal Articles

When citing a journal article, you will need to locate the author name(s), title of the article, title of the journal, as well as volume and issue number, date of publication, and page numbers of the article. If you locate an article online, include the URL. If you find an article through a database search, record the name of the database and when you accessed the article. Also, if the article includes a DOI (digital object identifier), then record that information; a DOI

FIGURE 12.9 Book or e-Book Copyright Page

Copyright/Publication Year

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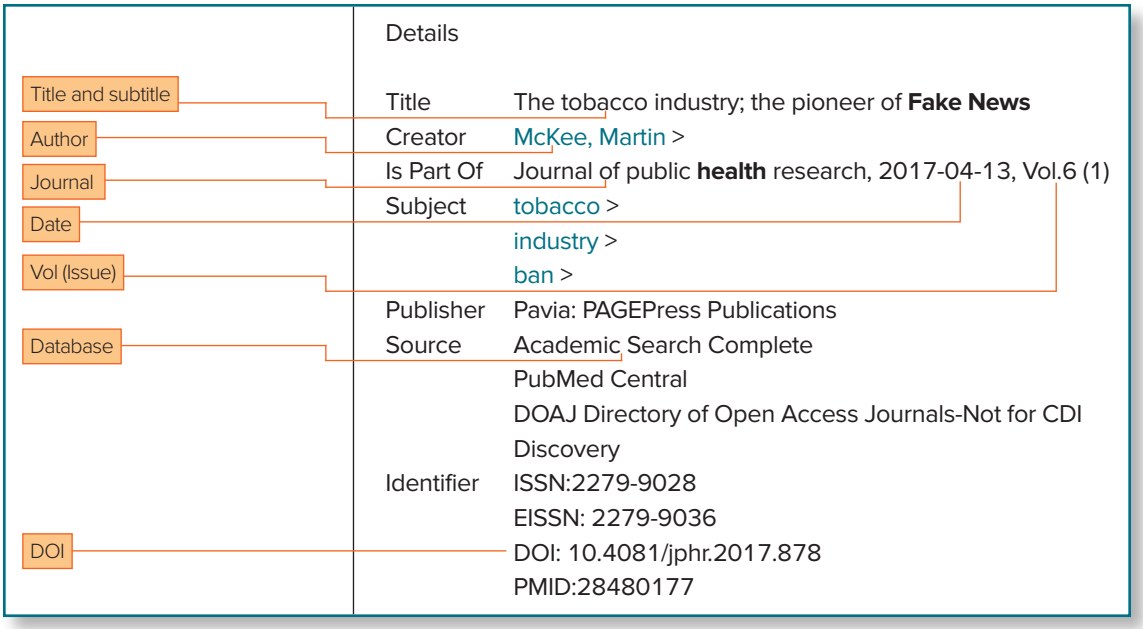
LC record available at https://lccn.loc.gov/2019057058

is a unique, permanent string of letters and numbers that refers to that specific article. Note: Some databases and even online sources provide preformatted citations in MLA or APA style. See Figures 12.10 and 12.11 to understand where to locate information necessary for citation of journal articles.

FIGURE 12.10 Journal Article Online

FIGURE 12.11 Journal Article Database



Web Page

Websites can provide reliable information in the form of government statistics, research reports, or educational information produced by reputable organizations. When citing a web page, you will need to identify the author(s) of the page or, more typically, the organization that sponsors the site. The title of the web page, the date, and the URL are also necessary. See Figure 12.12 to understand where to locate information necessary for a citation of a web page.

FIGURE 12.12 Web Page

PREPARING AN ANNOTATED BIBLIOGRAPHY

One way to keep track of and to evaluate sources is to create an annotated bibliography. An **annotated bibliography** is a list of sources, formatted correctly in documentation style, with comments about the scope and reliability of each source. An annotated bibliography can be useful to you as you locate and evaluate sources, or may be required by your instructor to demonstrate you have selected reliable sources. Most annotated bibliographies include at least three parts: (1) the source information, (2) a summary of the source, and (3) an evaluation of the source. Additionally, an annotated bibliography may include comments on how the source will be useful in addressing your research question.

To create an annotated bibliography entry (see Fig. 12.13), do the following:

- Include the source information in the appropriate documentation style, such as MLA or APA.
- Summarize the source.
- Evaluate the source by explaining its relevance, its reliability, and the author's credibility.
- Reflect on the usefulness of the source in your research.

FIGURE 12.13 Sample Annotated Bibliography Entry in MLA Style

Flax, Peter. "How to Spot Fake Health News, According to Experts." *Prevention*, 19 Nov. 2017, https://www.prevention.com/health/a20508493/fake-health-news-what-to-look-out-for/ Accessed 13 Mar. 2021.

Peter Flax, a journalist who writes on health- and sports-related topics, explains how consumers can be duped into believing false information about health care or tricked into buying products they do not need. The article relies on a real-life example and quotes from experts to demonstrate that being skeptical, asking questions, consulting experts, and fact checking sources can effectively evaluate online information. The article provides four tips at the end to "avoid health scams." This source includes quotes and examples that can be used to demonstrate what to do and what not to do when encountering health-related information on websites or via social media posts.

To sum up, as you research a topic and read sources, you are doing several things at once:

- Reading to understand the topic
- Reading to find information relevant to answering your research question
- Critically evaluating sources to assess reliability and bias, accuracy and timeliness
- Keeping track of sources with an annotated bibliography

Activity 12.1 Choose a Prompt for a Research Paper on Fake Health News

Select one of the numbered prompts for a research paper. Notice that some prompts call for an informative paper, while others suggest an argumentative or persuasive approach.

Solid Prompts

1. Explain how consumers can identify and avoid fake health news, particularly when searching for information online. For instance, what should individuals look for and how would they know fake news when they see it?
2. Research the problem of fake health news and propose a solution or solutions. In particular, discuss the main reasons why false information about health spreads online or via social media and what interventions can solve these problems.
3. Consider the impacts of fake health care news. For instance, does fake health information cost consumers money? Does it detrimentally impact their health? Assess to what degree false online information negatively impacts people's health.
4. Some people argue that monitoring social media is the responsibility of social media companies, others insist that social media companies cannot possibly check every post, and still others may believe that speech posted online should be free speech. Take a position as to who is responsible for the reliability of information found online.
5. Imagine you are in a class designed to prepare health professionals to work with patients. The instructor assigns a paper asking you to research how patients locate information about their own health and how to handle a situation when patients come to their appointment with inaccurate information.

Challenge Choices

In addition to (or in lieu of) writing a research paper, use an alternative medium to communicate your researched information. Select one of the following suggested activities. Whichever activity you choose, be sure to acknowledge sources of information and create a Works Cited or Reference list.

1. Create an illustration or diagram that allows your target audience to visualize key ideas from your research.
2. Prepare a graphic organizer that describes the relationship among main ideas and supporting ideas or facts and data from your research.
3. Develop an infographic that highlights the main findings of your research, including significant data, facts, or quotes from experts.

Activity 12.2 Create a Research Question

Complete the following exercises.

1. Review Activity 12.1. Which paper prompt did you select, and why? Write your answer using complete sentences.
2. Annotate the prompt you selected to identify its PAS—purpose, audience, and subject.
3. Create a research question based on your annotations of the prompt.

Activity 12.3 Locate Sources

Use the information from this chapter to determine a strategy for searching for information about your research question (from Activity 12.2) for an academic paper. Writing in complete sentences, explain which are the best places to find sources and how you would go about locating sources.

Activity 12.4 Search for Sources Using Key Words

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Review the topic you selected in Activity 12.1 and the research question for Activity 12.2. Make a list of key words that you can use to search for sources on your topic.
2. Use the strategy you identified in Activity 12.3 and your list of key words to locate two sources that could help answer your research question. Explain how you searched for sources by including the places searched and the key words, and submit a copy of the sources to your instructor.

Activity 12.5 Use Information from a Source

Review your work from Activity 12.2. What information in the Reading Selection "How to Spot Fake Health News, According to Experts" can help answer your research question? Either quote or summarize information from the reading. Write your response using complete sentences.

Activity 12.6 Evaluate Sources

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Review your work from Activity 12.4, exercise 2. Use Figure 12.1 (How to Spot Fake News) and Figure 12.7 (Strategic Questions to Evaluate Sources) to evaluate the two sources you located.

2. Review your answers to exercise 1 and decide whether each source is appropriate for use in an academic paper. Explain your reasons.
3. Keeping Figure 12.7 in mind, locate two additional sources related to your research question. Read and evaluate each source. Submit a list of all four sources to your instructor.

Pair and Share

With a classmate, review the sources you located (from Activity 12.6) and evaluate each other's sources. Try to come to a consensus as to whether your sources are acceptable for use in an academic paper.

Activity 12.7 Prepare an Annotated Bibliography for Your Research Paper

Follow the instructions in each exercise. Save your work to use in the next chapter, "Writing a Research Paper."

1. Review your work from Activity 12.6. Make a list of the sources you located and create a Works Cited entry for each one using MLA style.
2. Review your work from exercise 1 and include a summary and evaluation of each source.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

annotated bibliography A list of sources that includes the source information plus a summary and evaluation of each source.

database A collection of information that can be searched by a computer.

key word A word, often a noun, that identifies a topic.

key word search A type of search that uses key words to find documents containing those key words.

natural language search A type of search that uses phrases or sentences to find documents.

peer-reviewed journal A journal in which articles are assessed by experts in a field of study before being published.

research paper An academic essay that synthesizes information about a topic from outside sources.

search engine A computer program that locates documents on the web.

Chapter Summary

- Starting a research assignment with a question can help you locate appropriate sources and read your sources with an open mind to answer that question honestly.
- You can find high-quality sources appropriate for academic use in a college library by using key word searches.
- Doing background reading before researching a question can provide an overview of the topic and help you identify key terms and important concepts, as well as relevant issues or controversies.
- Determining whether sources are academically appropriate involves evaluating their relevance, reliability, accuracy, timeliness, and bias.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Imagine your friend has to research a report on locating reliable health information for a health class. Your friend asks you for advice on locating information sources and determining whether the sources are academically appropriate. Explain to your friend how best to find academic sources, how to determine whether the sources will be appropriate to use, and what to avoid in the search.
2. List at least three specific sources that would be effective to use in a research paper about a health-related topic, such as how to prevent diabetes or how to treat high blood pressure. Locate at least one such source using your college library database, one source using a general search engine, and one source using an academic search engine. In your list, include the author and title of the source, the database or search engine by which you located it, and an explanation of why the source is appropriate.
3. List at least three specific sources that would *not* be useful for a research paper about a health-related topic, such as how to eat a balanced diet or how to maintain a healthy weight. Locate at least one such source using your college library database, one source using a general search engine, and one source using an academic search engine. In your list, include the author and title of the source, the database or search engine by which you located it, and an explanation of why the source is *not* appropriate.

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Credits

pp. 320–324: Published on Prevention.com, November 29, 2017. Written by Peter Flax. Used with permission.

CHAPTER 13

Writing a Research Paper

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Read and take notes on sources.
- Recognize and avoid plagiarism.
- Synthesize information from sources.
- Develop an outline and a thesis.

Theme: What Is Real News and What Is Fake News?

The previous chapter, "Planning a Research Paper," describes how to locate, read, and evaluate sources. This chapter focuses on taking notes from sources, organizing those notes to create a plan for the paper, and then drafting and revising a research paper.

READING AND TAKING NOTES ON SOURCES

A research paper typically requires you to read and synthesize information from various sources, which means to combine different ideas into a new whole. In a history class, for example, you might be asked to explain various arguments for or against the United States' dropping of the atomic bomb on Hiroshima during World War II. In a psychology class, you might be assigned to research different treatments for depression and determine which is most effective. You might synthesize the information you read by comparing or contrasting different points of view, by highlighting important ideas from various readings, by pulling together particular information about a topic from a range of sources, and by developing your own opinion on the topic.

Importance of Taking Notes

To write an effective synthesis paper based on sources, be prepared to take notes, revise your notes, and consult them as you read and write. Annotating the reading is an excellent start on note-taking, but transferring your annotations into notes will pay off with a more effective paper. Students who take extensive notes and who process the information in original ways write higher-quality papers than those who take few notes or copy directly from sources. Moreover, students report that taking notes on their reading helps them organize their thinking, see issues and complexities clearly, make connections across the readings, and document their sources properly. Think of notes as an opportunity to learn from your sources and to reflect on the information in the readings.

Taking notes means not only recording information from the readings related to your topic but also understanding *why* you are reading and what you will ultimately do with your notes. For instance, you may be asked to report objectively about the information you have read on your topic or to present an original argument. You may need to explain the various viewpoints on a topic or determine which viewpoint is most valid. To clarify your purpose, you must understand the final assignment—the end goal—before you begin reading and keep that goal in mind as you take notes.

Note-Taking Methods

There are several ways to read, take notes, and think about your sources. Knowing your options may help you understand—and better accomplish—your goal. Each of the following strategies is more or less appropriate depending on the purpose of your assignment. We will examine these strategies for use with the topic of marijuana legalization.

Gist and List Method. The gist and list approach serves well if your purpose is to demonstrate that you have understood the content of your readings, for instance, by writing an explanatory synthesis paper. With this method, you systematically look for main ideas (identifying the *gist*) as you read and take notes (making a *list*) on those ideas.

Let's say your instructor assigns the paper topic "Explain different views on whether marijuana should be legalized." Using the gist and list method, you would read to discover the main reasons why some people support legalizing marijuana and why others do not, and you would take notes by listing those reasons. For instance, whenever a source gives a reason or explanation why marijuana should or should not be legalized, you could create a bullet-point list by summarizing or quoting that reason and identifying the source. If more than one source gives the same or similar reasons, you could include those as one reason.

If you discovered four reasons in favor and four reasons against legalization, you would make two lists and group the in-favor reasons together and the against reasons together. Then, in your paper, you would present the arguments for and against legalization, organizing each section around the explanation of a particular viewpoint.

TIA Method. The TIA approach is useful if your instructor assigns a response paper. TIA stands for "True, Important, I Agree." So, using the TIA strategy, you would concentrate on looking for ideas in the readings that seem true and important to you or ideas that you find agreeable. You would also identify ideas that seem untrue or trivial or that you find disagreeable. In your response paper, you could then present the strongest reasons in support of or in opposition to the topic.

For instance, suppose your assignment is to take a stand on whether marijuana should be legalized. You would read not only to find out why some people support legalizing marijuana and others do not, but also to evaluate each side's reasoning and evidence. You would ask yourself which reasons and evidence on each side are *true and important* and which are *untrue or trivial*. Finally, you would note whether you agree or disagree with the ideas on both sides. In your paper, you could present the arguments for and against legalization, as well as an analysis of the strengths and weaknesses of each side's position.

The Dialogue Method. The dialogue approach is useful when your goal is to develop an argument. It involves actively questioning your readings and critically evaluating them. So, as you read the sources, you might ask yourself questions such as What is the author's claim? What is the author's evidence? Is the evidence sufficient and convincing? Is the reasoning sound? If sources disagree, ask yourself whose thinking and evidence are more convincing. This process might lead you to evaluate and to reject or accept certain opinions, to qualify (or limit or restrict) some arguments, and/or to propose your own ideas.

For example, if you are reading to develop your own position on legalizing marijuana, you would read with an open mind, asking yourself questions to determine which arguments make the most sense and have the best support. You might also think about new ways to approach the topic—for instance, arguing that legalizing marijuana is valid for medical but not recreational use. Your reading and critical evaluation of the sources should lead you to develop an opinion that can be effectively supported by evidence. Figure 13.1 summarizes these three note-taking methods.

FIGURE 13.1 Note-Taking Methods

Purpose of Paper	Note-Taking Method	Example of How to Apply Method
To explain or inform	Gist and List	Summarize pro and con arguments on legalizing marijuana, and list reasons for both sides' views.
To respond	TIA (True, Important, Agree)	Record ideas that are true or important about legalizing marijuana; then explain whether you agree or disagree.
To argue	Dialogue	Examine and evaluate authors' claims and support for why marijuana should or should not be legalized to develop your own argument.

TAKING EFFECTIVE NOTES

As you read more and more sources and accumulate more and more ideas, you will need a sound note-taking system to ensure you stay organized and accurately represent the ideas from your sources in your own writing. Some researchers use note cards, some use a notebook, and still others use computer files. Whatever method you choose, "Strategies for Effective Note-Taking" will help you create useful notes.

Strategies for Effective Note-Taking

As you take notes, make sure that you do the following:

- **Accurately reflect ideas from the reading.** Correctly restate ideas when summarizing and quote precisely when taking words directly from the reading.
- **Include summaries of ideas.** Use your own words to restate important points.
- **Include quotations.** Select quotes from authorities or particularly well-expressed ideas.
- **Keep track of sources.** Record on each note card or after each entry in a notebook or computer file the source of the information to ensure proper citation and to prevent unintentional plagiarism when writing your paper.
- **Record your own ideas and thinking.** Evaluate sources, make connections across readings, or note how to use information in your paper.

Study the examples of notes in Figures 13.2 and 13.3. If you take careful notes like these, you will have all the important details to include in the body of your paper, as well as the information needed to properly cite sources, such as the author and title of the article and the details of publication.

FIGURE 13.2 Sample Note with Summary and Quotation

Argument against legalizing marijuana

The American Medical Association has recommended against legalization, stating, "Cannabis is a dangerous drug and as such is a public health concern" (qtd. in Marcus).

"The Perils of Legalized Pot" by Ruth Marcus, The Washington Post, 2 Jan. 2014, www.washingtonpost.com/opinions/ruth-marcus-the-perils-of-legalized-pot/2014/01/02/068cee6e-73e9-11e3-8b3f-b1666705ca3b_story.html?noredirect=on&utm_term=.68ba07054c5b.

FIGURE 13.3 Sample Note with Summary, Quotation, and Original Ideas

Argument against legalizing marijuana
The American Medical Association has recommended against legalization, stating, "Cannabis is a dangerous drug and as such is a public health concern" (qtd. in Marcus).

COMMENT: This is an important recommendation because the AMA is a well-respected doctors' organization. If doctors believe marijuana is "dangerous" and a "public health concern," that is strong evidence against legalization.

"The Perils of Legalized Pot" by Ruth Marcus, The Washington Post.

The note in Figure 13.2 has a heading identifying its topic. The note itself records a main idea from an article—that the American Medical Association (AMA) is opposed to legalization of marijuana—along with a quote supporting the AMA's position. At the bottom is information about the source: the article's title and author, the name of the publication, the publication date, and the URL because the article was retrieved online.

Like the first sample note in Figure 13.2, the note in Figure 13.3 summarizes the AMA's position, includes a quote, and gives information about the source. Since the full information needed to cite this source was recorded previously, this note includes only the author, article title, and publication. In addition, the note comments on why this idea is important and credible. Notice how the notetaker's opinion—original idea—is set off from the note with the label "Comment" so as not to confuse the source's information with the notetaker's opinion. This note could be used as part of an argument against legalizing marijuana or even to explain the arguments on both sides of the issue.

RECOGNIZING AND AVOIDING PLAGIARISM

The word *plagiarism* comes from the Latin word *plagiarius*, which means "kidnapper." This word origin makes sense because plagiarism involves stealing another person's words or ideas. Plagiarism is a serious academic offense. Students who plagiarize may fail their assignment, fail their class, or even be expelled from college, depending on the extent of the plagiarism.

Why is plagiarism considered such a serious offense and punished with severe consequences? For one thing, getting an education is an opportunity to learn and to develop new skills. Students are expected to do their own writing and thinking and to acknowledge when they use the ideas of others. Plagiarizing suggests that a student does not care about higher education or value learning. Faculty question whether a student who plagiarizes is willing to put in the time and effort needed to learn. Plagiarism also cheats readers. Readers believe and

trust that writers present their own ideas or explain someone else's research in a paper—*not* take credit for that research. Readers and instructors may feel angry or betrayed when students do not present their own ideas or use their own writing. Moreover, original thinking is highly valued in the academic community, and professors' careers are built on conducting original research and crediting others who have done research prior to their own contribution. In short, honesty, effort, and hard work are important components of earning an education. Plagiarism undermines all these qualities.

Plagiarism can be intentional, as when students knowingly use information from other sources and pretend it is their own ideas or words. Plagiarism can also be unintentional, as when students inadvertently fail to credit sources properly.

Examples of *intentional plagiarism* include the following:

- Copying and pasting information from the Internet into your own paper.
- Buying a paper online and turning it in as your own work.
- Having a friend write a paper for you or submitting a friend's previously written paper as your own.
- Asking a family member to substantially rewrite or "correct" your paper to improve the writing.

Examples of *unintentional plagiarism* include the following:

- Not putting quotation marks around words or phrases copied from another source, even if the borrowed information is cited.
- Changing the wording but not the sentence structure of the source material.
- Reproducing the ideas from a source without clearly acknowledging they are someone else's ideas.

The following examples clarify what is and is not considered plagiarized writing. The original quotation is from the chapter's Reading Selection, "Fake Medical News: Avoiding Pitfalls and Perils."

> **ORIGINAL SOURCE:** Before the age of internet, the news that was broadcast was produced and distributed by a few organisations or private companies like the British Broadcasting Corporation, the American Broadcasting Corporation or the National Broadcasting Corporation (Kanekar and Thombre).
>
> **PLAGIARIZED:** Before the internet era, news was produced by a few reputable organizations, such as the American Broadcasting Corporation.

Comment: The plagiarized sentence uses wording (underlined) that is very similar to the wording of the original source and does not acknowledge the original source.

> **PLAGIARIZED:** According to the article "Fake Medical News," before the internet era, news was produced by a few reputable organizations, such as the American Broadcasting Corporation (Kanekar and Thombre).

Comment: Although the preceding sentence correctly cites the source, the wording of the sentence is still too similar to the wording of the original source.

> **NOT PLAGIARIZED:** According to the article "Fake Medical News," before most people found information online, they turned to reliable news organizations that "checked for any fake news" (Kanekar and Thombre).

Comment: The preceding sentence, which does not plagiarize, acknowledges the original source and uses quotation marks around the exact words from the source. Moreover, it summarizes the information using original wording and sentence structure.

One strategy to guard against plagiarism is to effectively quote or summarize information. For instance, always use quotation marks in your notes when copying down exact words, and use your own words when summarizing. Importantly, precisely record information—such as the author and title of the work, the publisher, the publication place and date, and the page number—about each source you may use in your paper. Record that information on each note, after each entry in a notebook, or in a computer file, as you will need this information to document the sources used in your paper.

The following Reading Selection provides more information about fake health news.

READING SELECTION

"FAKE MEDICAL NEWS: AVOIDING PITFALLS AND PERILS"

Before Reading: Preview; Recognize Prior Knowledge

Answer these questions using complete sentences.

1. Read the title of the article and the information immediately preceding the reading. How do you think readers can avoid fake medical news?
2. What might be some reasons for the prevalence of fake medical news online and on social media?

During Reading: Annotate

Read the selection twice. Follow the directions for each exercise.

3. On your first reading, read for comprehension of the topic and mark the main ideas and supporting information.
4. On your second reading, look for information you find agreeable or disagreeable.

Fake Medical News: Avoiding Pitfalls and Perils

By Amar Shireesh Kanekar and Avinash Thombre

Family Medicine and Community Health, 2019

The authors, who are affiliated with the University of Arkansas at Little Rock, describe the prevalence of false medical information, especially on social media, and how to filter and vet online content to find reliable information. The article was originally published in the BMJ (British Medical Journal) *and therefore uses British, rather than American, spelling and is targeted at health care professionals. The citation style is APA.*

In the present-day digital world, it is challenging to function comprehensively, given our increasing reliance on the internet, which has touched every aspect of our lives, including healthcare. We are constantly inundated by false information, including medical information—purposefully deployed—that spreads so quickly and persuades so effectively (Armstrong et al., 2019). Some of this online health information includes interactive websites, internet-based games, online health press rooms, disease symptoms simulations, opinion polls, Twitter feeds, and doctor–patient online consultations (Dosemagen & Aase, 2017; Rohampton, 2017; Storino et al., 2016; Winker et al., 2000). The professional and personal blogs, podcasts, chat rooms and forums are hallmarks of today's medical care and a prominent source of health information among different kind of audiences, including the present group of general practitioners. 1

Hence, there is an ever-increasing need to check and evaluate data sources, particularly news items related to health and disease. It is imperative that online communities on social media platforms, such as Facebook, YouTube and Twitter, are aware of the authenticity of posted materials (Ventola, 2014). Some of the vivid examples of this widespread dissemination of 'fake news' claim statements such as 'birth control makes women unattractive and crazy' (Rohampton, 2017) or 'curing cancer using carrots' (Cameron et al., 2015). 2

In September 2017, a website called eternally.com, registered in Phoenix, Arizona, published an article with the headline 'Dandelion weed can boost your immune system and cure cancer'. It was the most popular article on Facebook with the word 'cancer' in the headline last year, receiving more than 1.4 million shares, likes and comments, according to two separate web analysis tools. This potent root has no clinical evidence to support its miraculous characteristics (Dosemagen & Aase, 2017). A PEW Foundation survey in 2013 in the USA revealed that 6 out of 10 Americans go online to find the cause for their medical condition (Armstrong & Naylor, 2019). Of those who found a diagnosis online, 35% of respondents said they did not follow this up with a visit to a professional medical provider. The online medical advice can reinforce inaccurate views or biases, particularly when lay people follow online bloggers with false and inauthentic health-promoting or disease-alleviating claims. The Food and Drug Administration in the past decade issued 90 warning letters to companies for producing products claiming to cure cancer. People who are suffering from such life-threatening diseases can fall prey to such claims or scams. Unfortunately, fake medical news can be written very persuasively, and it is easy to be seduced by false promises. 3

Before the age of internet, the news that was broadcast was produced and distributed by a few organisations or private companies like the British Broadcasting Corporation, the American Broadcasting Corporation or the National Broadcasting Company. These companies had a rigorous editorial process that checked for any fake news (minimised or eliminated unverifiable news). However, now, with the advent of the internet, any individual who has access to the internet is able to broadcast news online without being subjected to a rigorous editorial process. 4

In the last two decades, with the heralding of the World Wide Web and millions of websites on health issues, we have an explosion of varied information leading to information overload, according to Seymour, an assistant professor of oral health policy and epidemiology at Harvard University (Fernández-Luque & Bau, 2015; Forster, 2017; Ontario Public Health, n.d.). As a result, we as health information consumers are faced with the conundrum of distinguishing between objective facts and personal opinions. In this atmosphere of information overload, objective facts are less influential in shaping public opinion than appeals to emotion and personal belief. For example, a personal account of battle with cancer using alternative therapies might have worked for an individual, but a personal narrative is used as an instrument to advocate for questionable therapies. 5

Seymour opines that we have reached this situation in the present era because the balance of influence has shifted from broadcasters to individuals. Traditional broadcasters who used to provide authentic filtered information have been currently replaced by individual broadcasters who can put out information on the internet with similar ease as traditional broadcasters. The problem of fake news gets more exacerbated with connected networks that quickly reject any dissenter or contradictory piece of evidence. 6

Fake news consists of deliberate misinformation spread via traditional print and broadcast news media or on social media. Furthermore, fake news, particularly medical news, is written and published with the specific intent to mislead in order to damage an organisation and/or a person, often with sensationalist, exaggerated or patently false eye-catching headlines. 7

There are several types of fake news. The first consists of inadvertent reporting of mistakes. These happen because of errors and gaps in the editorial process. Second, sometimes rumours lead to fake news. The third consists of conspiracy theories; these are, by definition, difficult to verify as true or false, and they are typically originated by people who believe them to be true. Fourth, satire that is likely to be misconstrued as factual also leads to fake news. Fifth, false statements by medical professionals or pharma companies in order to make profits add to fake news. Lastly, the most problematic fake news consists of reports that are slanted or misleading but not outright false (Merchant et al., 2016). 8

The conception of present-day information sharing is based on the historical marketplace of ideas metaphor (Hesse et al., 2005). According to this metaphor, the internet is akin to a vast market where any individual can sell and buy his or her produce. In the context of medical news, this idea applies as any individual can post medical information on the internet; however, in this open marketplace of medical information, the consumer has to use his or use personal discretion to choose the best information that he or she wants. The underlying philosophy behind this is that robust engagement of ideas in a marketplace deals with an opportunity of offering diverse valid 9

ideas (Vogel, 2017). Additionally, the assumption is that multiple ideas on medical information should be the corrective to bad ideas and falsehoods. In this vision, regulation of medical information is not advocated, given the logic that any editorial intervention would harm the marketplace's natural and dynamic progression.

10 Inherently, Syed (2017) plays a devil's advocate and argues that this vision has two fundamental flaws, depending on how much information is available in a society: she questions that, what happens when individuals do not interact with contrary medical information because they are easy to avoid? Moreover, what happens when medical information is not heard at all because there is too much of it? Furthermore, the marketplace of ideas (Hesse et al., 2005) philosophy is based on the premise that the best and most accurate medical information wins. However, it fails to acknowledge, let alone address, questions of power irrevocably relevant in the present-day internet era, particularly with social media.

11 As mentioned earlier, the original marketplace metaphor sprang forth a couple centuries ago when the capacity to reach the general population through 'more speech' was restricted to a powerful few. In that era, few individuals truly had monopoly over information (like a pulpit or a pamphlet), but communicating to the masses was unattainable to most. For example, a person such as a preacher was listened to and believed by the majority of people. Thus, the marketplace never needed to address these power differentials when only the powerful had the technology to speak at scale.

12 In the present-day era, the internet, particularly social media platforms, has radically improved the capabilities of many individuals to put out medical information, but the marketplace theory lags behind (Hesse et al., 2005). For example, the marketplace theory is not able to address powerful individuals who post medical information and drown out other voices. These include pharmaceutical companies who flood Twitter posts critical of their drug with unrelated content and hashtags to obscure the offending post.

13 Added to this dilemma is the present situation in which there is intense competition for legitimate medical information, given the easy access to online advertising revenue, increased political polarisation and the popularity of social media, primarily the Facebook News Feed. These play a major role in the spread of fake medical news. Anonymously hosted fake medical news websites lacking known publishers have also been guilty because they make it difficult to prosecute sources of fake news for libel. With the expansion of easy hosting technology, the need for views and ratings has been increasingly higher. For medical news outlets, the ability to attract viewers to their websites has become a bigger necessity in order to please advertisers that pay for advertising on their websites. Publishing medical information with false content has become an easy way to produce a big caption and attract viewers in order to benefit advertisers and ratings.

14 There are several questions that are faced by individuals who want to obtain authentic medical information. According to Syed (2017), when we consume medical information on the internet, we should ask: how do digital technologies change the social conditions in which individuals put out medical information? Further, in the context of theorising for better trustworthy medical information, we modify and apply Syed's suggestions, arriving at five conspicuous ways to sort and help us filter fake medical news (Solon, 2015; Stone, 2016; Syed, 2017).

Apply multiple checks with online information

While searching for medical information, it is advisable to use multiple checks. Since there is far too much information to consume in an online environment, there is a need to weed out authentic factual information from fiction. Thus, there is a necessity to provide information filters. It is important to use actual typed filters that explicitly consist of search terms or hashtags on Twitter. These can filter out misinformation: for example, if one searches 'cancer cures', one will receive very different results than if one searches 'fake cancer'. Typed medical dedicated filters can also include trained individuals who curate what is accessible on social media, like the concept of medical information editors or moderators (Solon, 2016; Stone, 2016). 15

Additionally, medical authorities hosting information should employ less visible implicit filters. These obvious filters consist of mathematical equations that either watch your movements automatically or change based on how you filter by typing specific words. These filters explain how websites decide a particular content helps an individual user, with the goal of increasing that user's attention to the medical website. Let us see how this applies to an individual using the internet. If an internet user glances at a 'miracle cure' or a 'weight loss programme', the internet predicts his/her search as a specific cue to look for cure and weight loss. Multiple such searches cue these frantic attempts and accordingly supply false medical information. Similarly, viewing a fake medical article that provides information about a miracle health cure continues to supply similar content to the internet user applying the mathematical formula, even though a filter is used. In essence, apply as many filters as possible to narrow down your search when seeking health information. 16

Enhancing digital communities

Just like information filters assist in weeding out false medical content, we, as informed consumers of health information, need 'digital community-based interpersonal filters'. An essential skill is to ask for suggestions from your immediate social network for places to look before seeking medical information. In this case, trusted information that has been found useful by your 'closed in person group' is tested. Likewise, if you find any information online that looks interesting, share it first with your immediate colleagues and get their opinions. The personal digital community that you belong to can easily overcome any problems of distances. Build your own trustworthy group of individuals; for example, one can have a closed Facebook online community network with a moderator who controls and appraises the information communicated via this network. In this way, there is a good filter, especially for fake information. Through developing these social networks, these groups can produce their own methods to create, put out and avoid fake medical information. Your personal online group—consisting of friends you trust—can provide you with different choices that are authentic based on their personal experiences. This mechanism will provide a grounds-up approach that is full of personal trust as opposed to conventional confusing flow of information from the wide-open World Wide Web (Solon, 2015; Stone, 2016; Syed, 2017). 17

Detecting and avoiding information growth

Information on the internet spreads like wildfire, in part due to the 'amplification' process. During amplification (information growth or multiplication), fake medical 18

information rotates through filters and reaches groups because of the immense capacity of the internet. There are a couple ways by which this happens: (1) to start with, untrustworthy medical news is generated in isolated areas of the internet, and (2) second, this medical information floods into traditional journalism outlets where it is accessible to everyone. It is here that this untrustworthy medical information overcomes the typed filters that we put in. After this process, individuals attach a hashtag that leads to more quick spread on Twitter, thus increasing the viewpoint that a specific medical story is good. It is here that the acceleration helps in perpetuating the viewpoint that a particular medical news story is authentic or not. The literature in personal psychology explains that we as consumers of information evaluate information logically and, more importantly, by a process of outside cues that point out if the information can be believed. The pointers of trust are related to if the information provider is trustworthy and also the information consumer's earlier thoughts and a person's familiarity with the information. The familiarity is most important here as we are more prone to believe the information that is told to us again and again. Avoiding the traps of amplification could help falling in the trap of consuming fake medical information (Solon, 2015; Stone, 2016; Syed, 2017).

Recognise and counter profit-related motives

19 During each search for medical information, it is important to recognise that profit motive drives the social media platforms, and this makes fake medical news all the more prone to manipulation. Each online visit to a medical article results in adding to the popularity of the article thus helping raise the ad revenue generated. This is the incentive which fuels the desire to produce medical information which does not involve much editorial cross checking. Any popular medical information that is made up to further the profits is preferred by social media platforms. It can again happen in two ways: The advertising dynamics leads to adding to false content as unlike the traditional printing process, the online distribution does not involve the production and distribution efforts. The online production further fuels this process. Second, it is difficult to distinguish between advertising platforms disguised as medical websites. It leads to conflict between the authenticity of information and external monetary incentives. Computer-based algorithms can now filter 'false advertisements' on the internet (Solon, 2015; Stone, 2016; Syed, 2017; Tang & Chen, 2014).

Practical tips and proposed solutions for managing fake medical information

20 In conclusion, we have three suggestions for medical and healthcare practitioners:

1. Each one of us has to empower ourselves with informed tools to navigate health information.
2. Healthcare practitioners need to use the following criteria for evaluating internet resources (particularly websites): applying multiple checks with online information, enhancing digital communities, detecting and avoiding information growth, and recognising profit-related motives (Solon, 2015; Tang & Chen, 2014).
3. The previously mentioned filters should greatly assist general practitioners as well as lay people in weeding out false information and news.

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After Reading: Summarize; Reflect

When you have finished the Reading Selection, write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

5. According to the authors, why is fake medical news more easily spread via the Internet?
6. According to the article, why is fake medical news spread online?
7. What are some ways to ensure that medical information found online is reliable?

Engage with the Reading

1. The authors discuss the "historical marketplace of ideas metaphor." Explain this concept and why it fails to allow quality information to outweigh fake information online.
2. The authors argue that "increased political polarisation and the popularity of social media . . . play a major role in the spread of fake medical news." Do you agree? If so, can you give specific examples for support? If you disagree, provide evidence for your view.

SYNTHESIZING INFORMATION FROM SOURCES

Reading sources and taking notes on them are the first steps toward synthesizing your findings in a research paper. It is also important to consider the purpose of your paper, since how you incorporate information and organize your paper will depend on the paper's purpose.

Informative versus Argumentative Paper

An informative paper involves combining information from different sources and restating it in your own words to explain what you have learned from your reading. The gist and list method of note-taking is particularly suited to writing an informative paper—a paper that educates readers. For an informative paper, consider how best to select and arrange source information from around key ideas, then develop an informative thesis to guide the paper.

In contrast, an argumentative paper involves combining information from different sources with the goal of presenting your own views on the content of the readings. The TIA and dialogue methods of note-taking are particularly suited to an argumentative paper. In an argumentative paper, the writer takes a position on a topic and uses the information from different sources to support a thesis. Think about having an angle or a point of view on what you have learned from your sources. You will want to craft an argumentative thesis to guide the paper.

Organizing Notes to Create a Writing Plan

An important aspect of writing a strong paper is creating an organizational plan. Rather than using your notes to write a summary of each source, organize notes around key ideas related to the paper topic. To do this, identify ideas that are present in more than one source and focus paragraphs on those important ideas.

One strategy for organizing notes is to group related ideas and related information into categories. Suppose, for example, that you are writing an informative research paper explaining the arguments against and for legalizing marijuana. You could start to organize notes by grouping ideas from the readings into two broad categories: (1) arguments against legalization and (2) arguments for legalization.

You could then narrow these categories into subcategories. For instance, let's say you find that the American Medical Association calls marijuana "a dangerous drug" and "a public health concern." You also discover that the federal government considers marijuana a "Schedule I substance," meaning the drug puts users at high risk for abuse. You might group these related pieces of information in a chart by specifically modifying the broad category "Arguments against legalization" to include the qualifier "Marijuana is an unsafe drug."

Similarly, you could modify the general category "Arguments for legalization" to include the qualifier "Marijuana is a safe drug." Figure 13.4 is a chart-in-progress that begins to group related information. With additional reading and note-taking, the chart would expand (see color rows at the end) to include further arguments against and for legalizing marijuana.

FIGURE 13.4 Charting to Organize Notes

Paper Prompt: Explain the arguments for and against legalizing marijuana.	
Arguments against and For	**Support from the Readings**
Argument against legalization: Marijuana is an unsafe drug	• The American Medical Association has recommended against legalization, stating, "Cannabis is a dangerous drug and as such is a public health concern" (qtd. in Marcus). • The federal government considers marijuana a Schedule I substance, meaning it puts users at high risk for abuse.
Argument for legalization: Marijuana is a safe drug	• In 2010 there were no reported drug overdose deaths for marijuana, compared with 22,134 lethal overdoses of pharmaceutical drugs (reported in the *Journal of the American Medical Association*). • According to the American Cancer Society, marijuana can help AIDS and cancer patients by relieving pain, controlling nausea, and increasing appetite.
Argument against legalization: . . .	• *Support from reading . . .*
Argument for legalization: . . .	• *Support from reading . . .*

When grouping information, be sure each subcategory constitutes a separate and distinct classification. In this way, you can use groupings of related ideas and information to represent different issues in the readings. This strategy might be especially helpful if your goal is to restate the information from the readings or to write an informative paper.

DEVELOPING AN OUTLINE AND A THESIS

If you have been reading sources and taking notes related to your paper topic, and if you have been using a chart to group related ideas and information, you should have a solid start on your paper. In fact, your chart can form the basis of an outline from which you can develop a tentative thesis statement. This initial thesis statement can be refined later as you develop and clarify your understanding of the topic.

For instance, if your goal is to write an informative research paper, you may write a tentative thesis that sums up the gist of your paper.

> **TENATIVE INFORMATIVE THESIS:** Advocates of legalizing marijuana say that using marijuana is a personal choice, whereas opponents of legalization argue that marijuana is a dangerous drug.

If your goal is to write an argumentative research paper, you may write a tentative thesis that expresses your position on the topic.

> **TENATIVE ARGUMENTATIVE THESIS:** Although some people believe marijuana is a dangerous drug and therefore should not be legalized, marijuana can be used responsibly.

Once you have a tentative thesis, you can outline the rest of the paper.

Moving from Charting to Outlining Main Ideas

If you have organized your notes into categories or gathered related ideas in a chart, you can use these groupings to form the major sections of your paper. For instance, if you are writing an informative paper, you could review your chart (see Figure 13.4) and decide to create one section in the paper explaining that supporters of legalization feel marijuana is a safe drug and another section explaining that opponents feel marijuana is an unsafe drug. These sections can be one paragraph or multiple paragraphs, depending on how much supporting information you find for each viewpoint.

After determining the major sections of the paper, you can write topic sentences for each paragraph. To write effective topic sentences, use your own words to make explicit connections between the information in the sources and the purpose of the paper. If your purpose is to explain the arguments for and against legalization of marijuana, you would indicate in each topic sentence whether the focus of the paragraph is on the arguments for or against legalization and what exactly the supporting or opposing arguments are.

TOPIC SENTENCE FOR AN INFORMATIVE RESEARCH PAPER: Supporters of legalizing marijuana believe that marijuana is a drug that can be used responsibly for pleasure and for medical reasons.

Now imagine writing an argumentative paper about the legalization of marijuana based on many of the same sources. If you have collected ideas in a chart, you must decide on sections. Then, to develop a topic sentence for each section, determine your position regarding legalization and be sure you can defend it with supporting information and logical reasoning.

TOPIC SENTENCE FOR AN ARGUMENTATIVE RESEARCH PAPER: Legalization of marijuana to relieve the suffering of patients and for other medical reasons is justified.

To start an outline for an informative paper, you could proceed through your chart, *summing up* the arguments for or against marijuana and writing these as topic sentences. Likewise, to start an outline for an argumentative paper, you can proceed through your chart, deciding *your position* about the information from the readings and creating topic sentences. Writing topic sentences for each section of the paper forms the basis of an outline.

Now you must decide in what order to place the topic sentences that identify the sections of the paper. For guidance, you can rely on your knowledge of essay patterns. For instance, if you are explaining two points of view, you might use either a block or a point-by-point essay structure (as described in the chapter "Comparing Texts") to clarify the arguments for and against legalization. The block method of organization describes one subject first and then switches to describing the second subject, so that the paper is divided into "blocks." The point-by-point method of organization moves back and forth between the two subjects and is organized around ideas, or "points," about those subjects.

In contrast, if you are writing an argumentative paper, you might organize topic sentences in several different ways:

- Building from the weakest to the strongest reasons for your argument, including a counterargument at the end. This strategy allows you to present a strong case and then to respond to opposing views.
- Presenting reasons and then raising and refuting counterarguments for each reason. This organization can work well if for each reason there is a clear opposing viewpoint.
- Organizing the reasons for your argument in response to a counterargument. This order might be especially appropriate if you feel you are taking an unpopular position, such as arguing for marijuana's legalization.

Based on your writing purpose and the subject matter, decide how best to arrange the paragraphs in the body of the paper. Let's say you choose the point-by-point method and therefore plan to move back and forth throughout the paper to present the arguments for and against legalization of marijuana. As a way to get started organizing the ideas, you could create an informal outline (Figure 13.5).

FIGURE 13.5 Informal Outline of Informative Paper with Topic Sentences (Point-by-Point Organization)

Section 1: Supporters point out that legalizing marijuana could provide tax revenues from the manufacturing and sale of the drug.

Section 2: Opponents believe that raising tax revenues by potentially getting people addicted to drugs is immoral.

Section 3: Supporters of legalizing marijuana believe that marijuana is a drug that can be used responsibly for pleasure and for medical reasons.

Section 4: Opponents of legalizing marijuana argue that cannabis is an addictive and dangerous drug and therefore should be illegal.

Section 5: Supporters argue that adults should have the personal choice to use marijuana, which is similar to alcohol, a legal drug.

Section 6: Opponents assert that it is the duty of the government to protect the health and welfare of its citizens, and therefore the state should not allow the production and distribution of harmful drugs.

Moving from Outlining Main Ideas to Adding Support

If you organize your paper by creating an outline with topic sentences, your next step is to incorporate support for each section. If you have taken precise notes or created a detailed chart, adding support for each section of the paper involves going back over your notes or chart and including the relevant information at the most logical point in the outline.

For instance, if you are writing an informative paper, you could review your chart (Figure 13.4) and then refer to your informal outline (Figure 13.5) to decide where to place the support from each reading. In this way, you could create a formal outline that includes the topic sentences and the supporting information for each section (Figure 13.6). Taking this step will help you to develop your thinking and more fully organize your notes into a paper plan.

Moving from Formal Outlining to Finalizing a Thesis Statement

Once you have drafted a formal outline, you are ready to revise and finalize your thesis statement. The thesis statement should convey the purpose of your paper—whether it is, say, informative or argumentative—and state the main points the paper will cover.

FIGURE 13.6 Sample Formal Outline for an Informative Paper, with Topic Sentences and Supporting Information

I. Introduction: Thesis

II. Supporters of legalizing marijuana believe that marijuana is a drug that can be used responsibly for pleasure and for medical reasons.
   A. In 2010 there were no reported drug overdose deaths for marijuana, compared with 22,134 lethal overdoses of pharmaceutical drugs (reported in the *Journal of the American Medical Association*).
   B. According to the American Cancer Society, marijuana can help AIDS and cancer patients by relieving pain, controlling nausea, and increasing appetite.
   C. *Forbes* magazine reports that crime drops in states with legalized marijuana.

III. Opponents of legalizing marijuana argue that cannabis is an addictive and dangerous drug and therefore should be illegal.
   A. The American Medical Association has recommended against legalization, stating "Cannabis is a dangerous drug and as such is a public health concern."
   B. The federal government considers marijuana a Schedule I substance, meaning it puts users at high risk for abuse.
   C. *Psychology Today* reports a link between marijuana use and increased violent behavior.

Continue with main ideas and support for sections 3, 4, 5, and 6 of informal outline.

Conclusion

A thesis statement for an informative paper should be fair, accurate, and objective, as in this example.

> **INFORMATIVE THESIS:** Advocates for legalizing marijuana claim that marijuana is a drug that can be used responsibly for pleasure and therefore should be regulated and taxed, while opponents of legalization argue that marijuana is a dangerous drug, and therefore legalization can lead to more addiction and social problems.

A thesis statement for an argumentative paper should give the writer's opinion on the topic, as well as capture the main points of the paper. Let's say you decide that a strong argument will focus exclusively on the legalization of

marijuana for medicinal use. For a thesis statement, you can use the "although . . . because" thesis statement, which allows you to state the opposing arguments that your paper will address (in the *although* clause), as well as your position and then (after *because*) the reasons for your position.

ARGUMENTATIVE THESIS: Although marijuana is a potentially addictive, dangerous drug and therefore should not be widely available, legalizing marijuana for some medical reasons is justified because the drug can relieve pain and suffering for patients.

DRAFTING, REVISING, EDITING, AND PROOFREADING YOUR RESEARCH PAPER

With a formal outline and a thesis statement in hand, you have what you need to draft your research paper. As you write, follow your outline.

- Compose an introductory paragraph that sparks the reader's interest, gives background on your topic, and states the thesis.
- Write one or more body paragraphs for each topic sentence and include supporting information from your sources.
- Add a conclusion that wraps up the paper and brings it to a satisfying end.

After drafting your paper, set it aside for a little while. When you return to your work, revise your paper for content and organization, edit the sentences for clarity, and proofread for errors.

DOCUMENTING SOURCES

If you have drafted, revised, and edited your research paper, you have a solid start on your paper but are not yet finished. A critical component of a research paper is documenting, or acknowledging, all source information in two places: (1) within the body of the paper and (2) at the end of the paper. **Documentation** of sources in the body of the paper is called *in-text citation* or *parenthetical citation.* Documentation of source information at the end of a paper may be called *Works Cited*, *References*, or *Bibliography* depending on the documentation style.

How you record source information in the body of the paper and at the end depends on the *documentation style.* The documentation style required in most English courses is MLA (Modern Language Association) style, whereas many social sciences, such as psychology, use APA (American Psychological Association) style. Always check with your instructor as to the required documentation style. The chapter "MLA and APA Documentation" provides guidelines for both MLA and APA style, or, for more comprehensive coverage, refer to the ninth edition of the *MLA Handbook* or to the seventh edition of the *Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association*.

FORMATTING A RESEARCH PAPER

Style guides, such as those for MLA or APA style, not only include rules for citing sources in the body and at the end of a research paper but also have conventions for formatting a paper. It is important to follow these guidelines carefully and correctly to fulfill your readers' expectations. For instance, the heading of the paper must include certain information in a particular arrangement, the title needs to be centered and placed on a certain page, and the paper itself should be double-spaced consistently throughout and typed in an approved font. Review the information in the "MLA and APA Documentation" chapter to understand how to properly format your paper, or consult the ninth edition of the *MLA Handbook* or the seventh edition of the *Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association*.

Activity 13.1 Review Your Research Paper Plan

Review the work you did for the previous chapter, "Planning a Research Paper." Then follow the instructions in each exercise here.

1. Restate the prompt that you chose for your paper. If you have not chosen a prompt, do so now.
2. Restate the research question that you developed from the prompt. If you have not written a research question, do so now.
3. State the paper's PAS—purpose, audience, and subject. If you have not identified the paper's PAS, do so now.
4. Retrieve the list of the sources you identified and evaluated for your paper. You should have at least four sources. If you have not researched a list of sources, do so now.

Activity 13.2 Take Notes on Sources

Write responses to the following exercises using complete sentences.

1. Review your work from Activity 13.1 and your notes from this chapter's Reading Selection, "Fake Medical News: Avoiding Pitfalls and Perils" What information in the Reading Selection can help answer your research question?
2. Which of the three note-taking strategies described in the text—gist and list, TIA, and dialogue—would be most appropriate for developing a paper on the topic you selected? Why?
3. Take notes on this chapter's Reading Selection, "Fake Medical News: Avoiding Pitfalls and Perils," using the note-taking strategy you identified in exercise 2.

Pair and Share

Compare your response to exercise 3 in Activity 13.2 with a classmate's response. Can you find more information from the reading that would help to answer either your or your classmate's research question? If so, add to your notes.

Activity 13.3 Create a Chart to Organize Notes

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Review the purpose you identified in Activity 13.1. What will be your purpose for writing your research paper? For instance, will you write an informative or an argumentative paper?
2. Review your work from Activities 13.1 and 13.2, including your notes on your research prompt and your annotated sources. Then create a chart like the one in Figure 13.4 to organize your ideas.

Activity 13.4 Create an Informal Outline

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Review your work from Activity 13.3. What organizational pattern might you use for your paper? For instance, for an informative paper, would the point-by-point or block method be effective? For an argumentative paper, would (a) weak-to-strong reasons, (b) reasons then counterarguments, or (c) counterargument then reasons be most effective?
2. Create an informal outline by organizing your paper into sections according to the organizational pattern you chose for exercise 1. Write a topic sentence for each section.

Activity 13.5 Create a Formal Outline and Add Support

Review your informal outline from Activity 13.4. Create a formal outline for your paper by including supporting information for each topic sentence for each section of the paper.

Pair and Share

With a classmate, exchange formal outlines with support. Review each other's outlines and give feedback on whether the organizational pattern makes sense and whether the writer could add more support to the main ideas.

Activity 13.6 Write a Thesis Statement

Review your formal outline with support from Activity 13.5. Write a thesis statement that sums up the main ideas, gives your point of view, and reflects the organizational pattern of your paper. You may choose to use the "although . . . because" format or another format.

Pair and Share

Exchange thesis statements with a classmate. Read your classmate's thesis statement and tell your classmate what you think will be the main ideas of the paper, the writer's point of view, and the paper's organization.

Activity 13.7 Draft, Revise, Edit, and Proofread a Research Paper

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Using your notes and your formal outline with support and thesis statement from Activities 13.2, 13.3, 13.5, and 13.6, write an introduction for your research paper.
2. Using your notes and formal outline from Activities 13.2, 13.3, and 13.5, write the body paragraphs for your research paper.
3. Write the conclusion for your research paper.
4. Revise, edit, and proofread your paper.

Pair and Share

Exchange your draft with a classmate. Read and evaluate the paper for content and organization.

Activity 13.8 Cite and Document Sources

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Check with your instructor as to what style guide you should use to create a research paper—MLA, APA, or another guide. Then locate a resource you can use to help you cite and document your sources, such as the information in the "MLA and APA Documentation" chapter in this book or an appropriate handbook.
2. For every sentence in your research paper in which you include information from sources, whether summarized, paraphrased, or quoted, include in-text citations.
3. Create entries for a list of sources based on your response to exercise 2. Be sure to include an entry for each parenthetical citation in the body of the paper and properly format the list of sources as per MLA or APA style.

Pair and Share

- Exchange your research paper draft that includes in-text citations (from Activity 13.8, exercise 2) with a classmate. Check that you have correctly formatted the citations and that you have not unintentionally plagiarized from the sources.
- Exchange your entries for a list of sources (from Activity 13.8, exercise 3) with a classmate. Check that you have correctly formatted the list of sources.

Activity 13.9 Format a Research Paper

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Review your draft from Activity 13.8. Format the first page of your research paper draft, including the page number, heading, title, and text, all properly formatted.
2. Create a Works Cited page for your research paper draft, properly formatted.

Pair and Share

Exchange formatted drafts (from Activity 13.9) with a classmate. Check the in-text citations, the list of sources, and the formatting of the first page.

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Term

documentation Acknowledgment of source information in a research paper within the body of the paper and at the end of the paper.

Chapter Summary

- To write an effective research paper based on sources, take notes by recording information related to your topic while keeping your writing purpose in mind.
- The note-taking system you develop should reflect your paper's purpose and include accurate summaries and quotations from the readings, carefully documented information on your sources, and your own ideas.
- Plagiarism is a serious offense. Writers must understand what constitutes plagiarism and must take measures to avoid it by always properly crediting their sources.
- Strategies for synthesizing sources include grouping related ideas and information into categories or a chart.
- Organizing your notes can help you create an informal outline from which you can develop a formal outline and tentative thesis statement.
- Writing a formal outline with a thesis statement, topic sentences, and information from sources will help you draft your paper.
- When you cite sources in the body and at the end of a research paper, it is important to follow the guidelines for the required citation style, such as MLA or APA style.
- When you format a research paper, it is important to follow the guidelines for the required formatting style, such as MLA or APA style.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. Review the arguments in the examples throughout this chapter about legalizing marijuana. Then conduct your own research on the legalization of marijuana and write an argumentative research paper, taking a position on whether marijuana should be legalized.

2. Focus on issues in your community or at your college, such as improving public transportation to campus, installing bike lanes and bike racks, or making the food on campus healthier or less expensive, and conduct research on the issue. Find at least five sources that address different ideas on the topic. Then write a research paper in which you explain the various viewpoints on that topic.

Credits

pp. 344–349: Kanekar, Amar Shireesh and Avinash Thombre. "Fake Medical News: Avoiding Pitfalls and Perils." *Family Medicine and Community Health 7,* no. 4 (2019); http://dx.doi.org/10.1136/fmch-2019-000142. Used with permission.

CHAPTER 14

Reading Visuals

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Interpret tables and graphs, including pie graphs, bar graphs, and line graphs.
- Decode visual information, including maps, illustrations, diagrams, sidebars, graphic organizers, and infographics.
- Analyze visual narratives, including cartoons, advertisements, and photographs.

Written texts are important means to communicate information. However, information can be presented not only in text form but also in visual formats, such as images or numbers that convey meaning. Visual representation of information often occurs in academic contexts, for instance, when journal articles incorporate tables to display research data or textbooks include illustrations to depict complicated concepts. As a reader, you must understand this information, as it is often integral to the written text. You might also use visual information as a source in your own writing. For instance, you may summarize the data from a graph to support your thesis, or restate processes represented in diagrams to explain key concepts. In turn, you may create visuals to ensure your readers understand important concepts or can see the data upon which you are building your argument.

This chapter focuses on reading visuals with an eye toward comprehending them. Moreover, understanding visuals will enable you to bring visual information into your own writing. The visuals throughout this chapter represent themes from other chapters.

INTERPRETING GRAPHS AND TABLES

This section of the chapter focuses on graphs and tables, which are visuals that show relationships between data, typically expressed in terms of numbers or percentages. Graphs and tables can also be used to illustrate trends, to reveal patterns, or to show relationships between sets of data. Because graphs and tables organize and clearly display data, they can present information in ways that are easy to comprehend and to remember.

Tables

A **table** contains textual or numerical information that is typically organized in columns and rows. Tables appear frequently in research articles, in government reports, and sometimes in textbooks. Their purposes include presenting raw data that are discussed in a main reading and providing information to supplement such a reading. For example, a table might display data from a study, statistics from research, or factual information.

Tables are useful tools for clarifying and supporting a main idea in a reading and therefore can aid reading comprehension. They can also serve as a source of supporting information in a paper and can therefore serve as evidence for a thesis.

The table in Figure 14.1 appears on the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) website and provides data about the relationship between chronic health conditions and sleep duration in adults. The table can help readers understand the connection between getting an adequate amount of sleep in relation to long-term physical health. Such information might provide support in your own writing to explain the connection between getting a good night's sleep and maintaining good health.

To read a table, do the following:

- First, look at the title to understand the focus of the content.
- Next, study the organization. Note that headings usually run across the top of the table and labels (if present) often appear on the sides or at the bottom.
- Then, read the information in the table.

FIGURE 14.1 **Table: "Chronic Health Conditions by Sleep Duration"**

Table 3. Age-Adjusted[a] Percentage Reporting Chronic Health Conditions by Sleep Duration—Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System, United States, 2014

	Short sleep (<7 hours)	Sufficient sleep (≥7 hours)
Chronic condition	%	%
Heart attack	4.8	3.4
Coronary heart disease	4.7	3.4
Stroke	3.6	2.4
Asthma	16.5	11.8
COPD (chronic obstructive pulmonary disease)	8.6	4.7
Cancer	10.2	9.8
Arthritis	28.8	20.5
Depression	22.9	14.6
Chronic kidney disease	3.3	2.2
Diabetes	11.1	8.6

[a]Age-adjusted to the 2000 U.S. standard population.

The prevalence of each condition is significantly higher ($p<0.05$) for persons reporting short sleep compared with those reporting sufficient sleep.

Source: Sleep and Sleep Disorders, Centers for Disease Control and Prevention

By examining the table shown in Figure 14.1 and reviewing the steps for reading a table, you should be able to understand the information in the table.

- The *title* indicates that the table shows the percentage of chronic health conditions by sleep duration.
- The *organization* of the table is that chronic health conditions (such as heart attack or stroke) are listed in the left-hand column while sleep duration (less than seven hours or more than seven hours) is in the right-side columns, as well as the percentages of people with those chronic conditions according to whether they get "short sleep" (less than seven hours) or "sufficient sleep" (seven hours or more).
- The *footnotes* explain that the age has been adjusted to represent the average age for people in the United States as of 2000 and that the difference between the two percentages is significantly higher.
- The *information* shows that for each chronic condition, people who sleep less are more likely to have that condition than people who sleep longer. For instance, 11.1% of individuals with diabetes sleep less than seven hours per night, while 8.6% of those who sleep more than seven hours have diabetes.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.1

Assess your comprehension of the table in Figure 14.1 by answering the questions.

1. Which chronic health condition is most associated with short sleep when compared to sufficient sleep?
2. Which chronic health condition is least affected by short-sleep duration when compared to sufficient sleep?

Pie Graphs

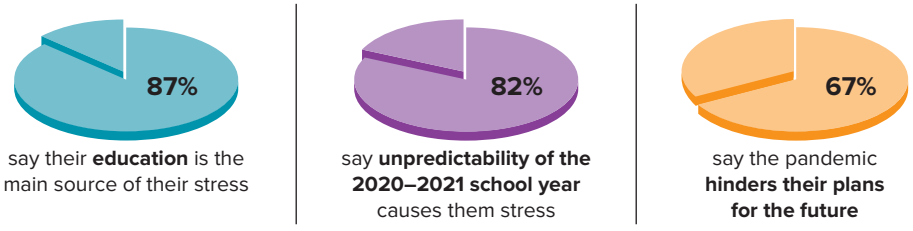
A **pie graph** (or circle graph) is so named because it looks like a pie that has been sliced up. Each "slice" in the pie graph represents a percentage or a numerical value. The size of a given slice corresponds to the fraction of the whole. So, a smaller slice represents a smaller percentage or number than a larger slice. By comparing the slices of the pie, readers can visualize the relationships among the values. Like other graphics, a pie graph can be a source of information to use when writing an essay, just as written texts are used.

The pie graphs in Figure 14.2 use data from the American Psychological Association's (APA) website and provide information about the levels of stress for adult college students, specifically Generation Z (born after 1997) during the COVID pandemic. These graphs can help readers understand the connection between stress levels and various aspects of a college student's education. Such information might enable you to understand the impact of the COVID pandemic on you or your classmates and provide support in your own writing to explain how the pandemic has impacted college students' mental health.

FIGURE 14.2 Pie Graph: "Disruption to Education Causing Stress for GenZ Adult College Students"

Today's college students report that education is the main source of their stress: 82% say that the unpredictability of the upcoming school year causes stress; 67% believe the pandemic hinders their ability to plan for the future.

Source: American Psychological Association



To read a pie graph, do the following:

- Start with the title or caption to identify what overall information the graph is presenting.
- Read the information pertaining to each slice of the graph and compare the numerical values.
- Review the key or other explanatory information often located at the bottom of the graph.

Look closely at the pie graphs in Figure 14.2 and review the following steps for reading a pie graph:

- The *title* reveals that the pie graphs indicate how much Generation Z adult college students feel that the disruption to their education (caused by the pandemic) has caused them stress.
- The *slice* and the *percentage* in each pie graph show the various levels of stress in relation to different aspects of their education. For instance, readers can easily visualize that the graph on the left represents more stress in students' lives than the graph on the right, by looking at the size of the blue "slice" and the percentage.
- The *explanatory information* under each graph explains the different aspects of education in relation to stress level. For instance, 87% of adult college students report that "education is the main source of their stress" and 82% express "the unpredictability of the 2020–2021 school year causes them stress."

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.2

Assess your comprehension of the pie graph in Figure 14.2 by answering the questions.

1. What is the most significant source of stress for Generation Z adult college students?
2. What percentage of adult college students do not feel that their education is a significant source of stress?

Bar Graphs

A **bar graph** compares related data in a visual display by using the height or length of rectangles to represent numerical values or characteristics. A bar graph has an **x axis** (information labels across the bottom of the graph) and a **y axis** (information labels along the side of the graph). It might also have a *key* that explains information in the graph, such as the meaning of different colors.

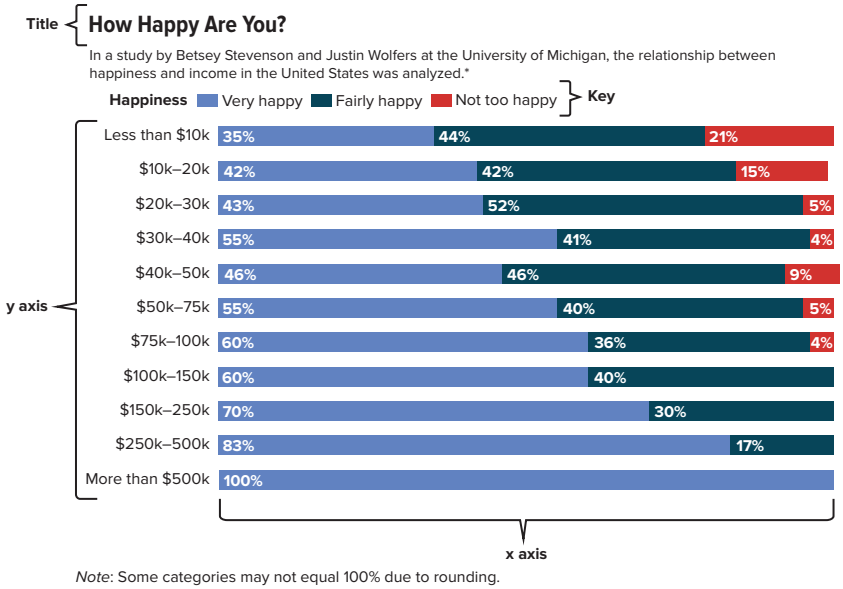
To read a bar graph, follow these steps:

- Start with the title to identify the graph's focus.
- Read the labels on each axis.
- Review the key, if available.
- Look at the bars to understand the amount or quantity of each set of information.
- Read any footnotes, if present, to understand the context of the graph.

The bar graph in Figure 14.3 represents data from a research study done at the University of Michigan in which people were surveyed about their happiness levels, and these happiness levels were correlated with income levels. A graph such as this can enable readers to see the connection between reported happiness and wealth. Such information might provide support in your own writing to explain the connection between money and happiness.

FIGURE 14.3 Bar Graph: "How Happy Are You?"

Source: Data from "Subjective Well-Being and Income: Is There Any Evidence of Satiation?" paper by Betsey Stevenson and Justin Wolfers, University of Michigan. Graph: The Wall Street Journal.



Note: Some categories may not equal 100% due to rounding.

By studying the bar graph in Figure 14.3 and reviewing the steps for reading a bar graph, you should be able to understand the information in the graph, as follows:

- The *title* "How Happy Are You?" suggests the graph is focused on people's happiness levels.
- The *label on the y axis* indicates the income range, such as $30k–40k ($30,000–$40,000), while the numbers on the bars represent the percentage of happiness level, such as 55%, 41%, and 4% for those whose income ranges between $30k and $40k.
- The *key* reveals that the three different colors on the bars represent three levels of happiness: "very happy" (light blue), "fairly happy" (dark blue), and "not too happy" (red). So, for example, one could say that of the people whose income ranges from $30,000 to $40,000, 55% report feeling "very happy," while 41% say they are "fairly happy," and only 4% are "not too happy."
- The *footnote* explains that the graph was derived from a paper written by Betsey Stevenson and Justin Wolfers, titled "Subjective Well-Being and Income: Is There Any Evidence of Satiation?" One could locate the original paper and read it to better understand the information in the graph.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.3

Assess your comprehension of the bar graph in Figure 14.3 by answering the questions.

1. At what income level do all people report being "very happy" or "fairly happy"?
2. At what income level do all people report being "very happy"?

Line Graphs

A **line graph** uses lines, which are points that are connected to show how something changes in value. A line graph may be used to show how much a value has changed over a period of time. For example, a line graph can show how temperature has gone up or down over several weeks or how enrollment at your college has varied over several years. Like other types of graphs, line graphs can reveal trends over time or compare data sets.

To read a line graph, do the following:

- Read the title and any captions to determine the subject of the graph.
- Check the labels along the x axis of the graph. Do the labels indicate time periods or some other factor?
- Check the labels along the y axis of the graphic. What factors do these labels indicate—amounts of money? numbers of people? quantities of goods?

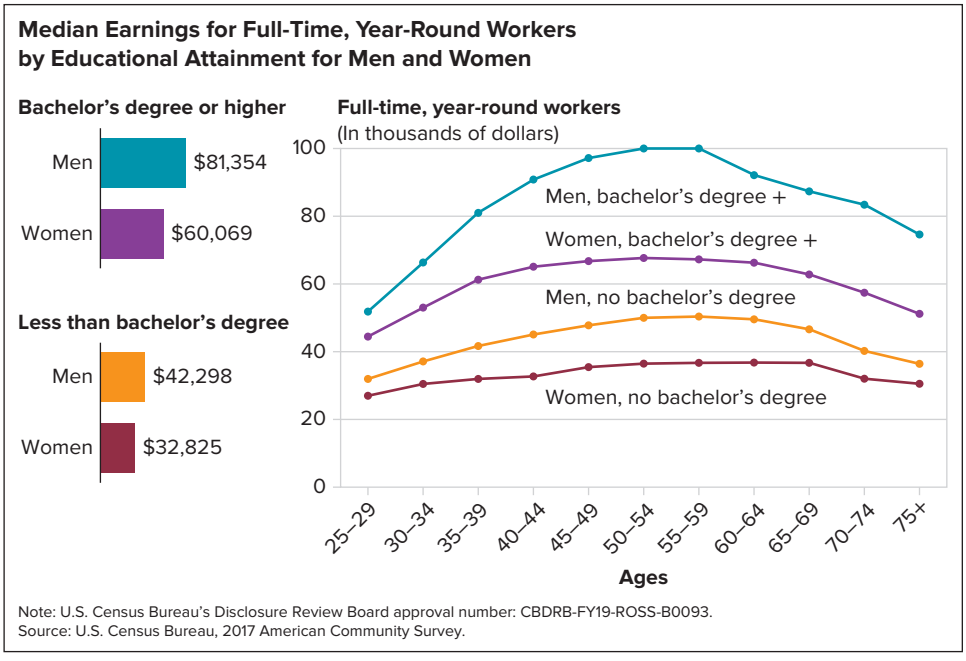
- Construct a "how" question that incorporates the labels on the x and y axes. For example, ask, "How did *enrollment* [y axis label] at my college change from *2015* to *2019* [x axis labels]?"
- Find the spot on the line graph that provides the information you seek.
- Read any key, if available, to understand the information.

The line graph in Figure 14.4 appears on the U.S. Census Bureau website and shows the relationship between educational attainment and median earnings (*median* means the number in the middle of the range). Furthermore, the information includes separate statistics for men versus women. A graph such as this can help readers not only see the relationship between income and degree status but also compare men's income and education levels to women's. Such information might provide support in your own writing to explain the connection between education and income, or the differences between men's incomes and women's incomes.

Look closely at the line graph in Figure 14.4 and review the steps for reading a line graph; this way you should understand the content of the line graph.

- The *title* indicates the graph focuses on median earnings for full-time workers by educational attainment for men and women.
- The *x axis* shows the age ranges of workers, such as 25 to 29 years old, while the *y axis* shows the income in thousands of dollars, such as 80, which would be $80,000.

FIGURE 14.4 Line Graph: "Median Earnings for Full-Time, Year-Round Workers by Educational Attainment for Men and Women"



Note: U.S. Census Bureau's Disclosure Review Board approval number: CBDRB-FY19-ROSS-B0093.
Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2017 American Community Survey.

- The *key* reveals that colors represent earning a bachelor's degree or higher versus less than a bachelor's degree and that men and women in these categories are also represented by different colors. For instance, men with less than a bachelor's degree are orange, while women with a bachelor's degree or higher are purple.
- To answer a "how" question, one could ask, "How much money does a man aged 45 to 49 with a bachelor's degree or higher earn as compared to a similarly aged man with less than a bachelor's degree?" The answer would be that a 45- to 49-year-old man with a bachelor's degree earns close to $100,000, while a similarly aged man with less than a bachelor's degree earns around $50,000.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.4

Assess your comprehension of the line graph in Figure 14.4 by answering the questions.

1. How much money does a woman aged 25 to 29 with a bachelor's degree or higher earn as compared to a similarly aged woman with less than a bachelor's degree?
2. How much money does a man aged 25 to 29 with a bachelor's degree or higher earn as compared to a similarly aged man with less than a bachelor's degree?

VISUAL INFORMATION

This section of the chapter is concerned with visual information that may include data, that might represent complicated ideas, or that may provide information in conjunction with images. Like graphs and tables, visual information—including maps and diagrams, graphic organizers, and infographics—can be used to illustrate trends, to reveal patterns, or to show relationships between data sets.

When information is presented in a visual format or when text has accompanying visuals, the data or ideas can be made attractive and informative, memorable and revealing. Visuals are ways to get readers' attention as well as communicate effectively.

Maps

A **map** represents physical features of an area, such as lands or oceans. Maps allow readers to visualize not only what information is being displayed but also where that information appears. A classic example of a map used to visually represent information is the map of the United States used during the presidential election to show when states go "red" or "blue," depending on whether most voters supported the Republican candidate or the Democratic candidate. Similarly, a map can show whether certain states have legalized recreational marijuana, or which countries are experiencing a drought. Maps often make use of colors or numbers to represent content and allow readers to take in information quickly and easily.

To read a map, do the following:

- Consider the title to understand what area the map covers and what information the map contains.
- Check labels or keys for information about the content of the map.
- Review the map, looking at the information presented to understand the relationship between different areas on the map and the specific content.

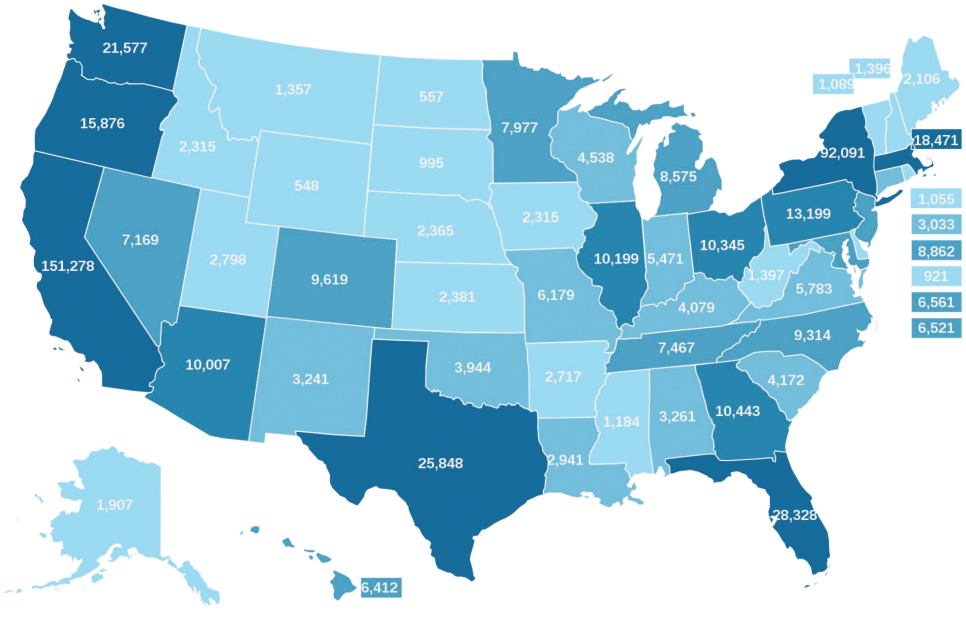
The map in Figure 14.5 illustrates the number of homeless people in each state in the year 2019. The information on the map clarifies which states have the largest number of unhoused people, which might be useful information for investigating policies to assist the homeless. For instance, one could concentrate on the states with the largest homeless populations and research what these states are doing to support unhoused people and how effective these policies are.

Look closely at the map in Figure 14.5, and review the following steps for reading a map to understand the map's content:

- The *title* indicates the map focuses on the total number of people who are unhoused ("population") in each state.
- *Reviewing the map* indicates that the map uses both colors and numbers to represent information visually. For instance, states with more homeless people are colored dark blue, such as Texas with 25,848 people without housing; states with the fewest number of people who are unhoused are in light blue,

FIGURE 14.5 **Map: "Total Population of People Who Are Unhoused, by State—2019"**

United States Interagency Council on Homelessness



such as Montana with 1,357 people. States in the midrange are in medium blue, such as Hawaii with 6,412 people, or medium light blue, such as Louisiana with 2,941 people who are unhoused.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.5

Assess your comprehension of the map in Figure 14.5 by answering the questions.

1. Which state has the greatest number of people who are unhoused?
2. Which state has the least number of people who are unhoused?

Illustrations

An **illustration** (for example, a drawing) can help readers understand an idea or concept. For instance, an illustration, even one that uses simple drawings, can show an important concept or bring an idea to life.

The illustration in Figure 14.6 represents one's thoughts in the brainstorming or prewriting stage of the writing process. The illustration suggests what is happening inside one's head to generate ideas.

FIGURE 14.6 Illustration: "Prewriting"

mhatzapa/Getty Images

To read an illustration, do the following:

- Start with the title, if the illustration has one, to understand what overall information or idea the illustration is presenting.
- Study the picture and consider what it means, especially in relation to the title.
- Read any text and consider how the text relates to the illustration.
- Review any captions (writing that explains the illustration).

Examine the illustration in Figure 14.6 and use the steps for reading an illustration to determine the meaning:

- The *title* "Prewriting" indicates the illustration represents the early stage of the writing process.
- The *picture* of a head with a brain inside suggests thinking, while the drawings around the head indicate different methods for prewriting, such as writing ideas on a notepad or asking questions.
- The *words* in the illustration, such as "creativity" and "inspiration," suggest that prewriting involves being creative or finding inspiration.
- *Captions* are not present.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.6

Assess your comprehension of the illustration in Figure 14.6 by answering the questions.

1. What might the lightbulb represent?
2. What might the gears represent?

Diagrams

A **diagram** is a kind of illustration used to convey information. Functions of diagrams include showing a process, revealing steps in a procedure, or representing the relationship between ideas.

Diagrams usually consist of geometric shapes—such as squares, rectangles, circles, and ovals—connected by lines or arrows. The shapes may contain explanatory text, and sometimes they contain illustrations. For example, in Figure 14.7 both words and images are used to convey information about Maslow's hierarchy of needs. (Abraham Maslow was a psychologist who developed a theory about the relationship among human needs.) In this case, the words and images work to reinforce each other and provide readers with the same information in two different formats.

To read a diagram, do the following:

- Read the title to understand what the diagram represents.
- Ask yourself whether the diagram represents a process, a structure, or some other idea.

FIGURE 14.7 Diagram: "Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs"

- Look for clues as to what path to take when reading. Some diagrams are best read from top to bottom; others, from left to right; still others follow a circular pattern.
- Consider the relationship between the diagram and the text: typically, the diagram visually represents a concept discussed in the text.

Study the diagram in Figure 14.7 and follow the steps for reading a diagram to understand the information.

- The *title* of the diagram, "Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs," indicates the image explains Maslow's theory about human needs.
- The *diagram is a triangle*, which suggests the hierarchical relationship between needs, with more basic needs, such as physiological needs, at the bottom and more advanced needs, such as the need for esteem, closer to the top.
- *One could read the diagram* from bottom to top, since the basic needs must be met before higher-order needs can be realized.
- *The relationship between the diagram and the text and images* clarifies each need. For instance, at the bottom the word "physiological," which relates to physical needs, identifies the need itself while the images of a covered dish of food and a bed suggest that eating and sleep are physiological needs.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.7

Assess your comprehension of the illustration in Figure 14.7 by answering the questions.

1. According to Maslow's hierarchy, what are some of our most basic needs?
2. According to Maslow's hierarchy, what is our highest need?

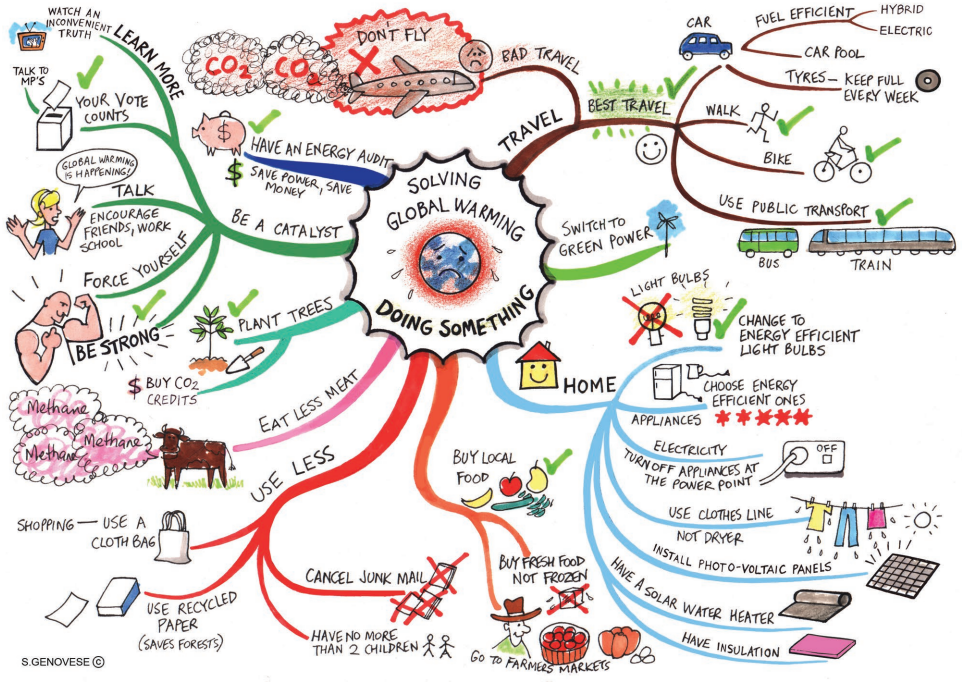
Graphic Organizers

A **graphic organizer** is the visual representation of the relationship among ideas. It typically uses shapes and lines to show these connections, with a central idea in the middle of the organizer and related ideas moving out from the center. Graphic organizers use key words and phrases to represent ideas, and may include pictures or images.

Writers may use graphic organizers as a prewriting strategy (see the chapter "The Writing Process" and "Spotlight on Student Writing: One Student's Writing Process"). Graphic organizers can also be an engaging and creative way to convey information about a topic, such as the graphic organizer in Figure 14.8 that suggests different ways people take action to prevent global warming and how those actions can reduce greenhouse gas emissions.

FIGURE 14.8 Graphic Organizer: "Solving Global Warming: Doing Something"

Jane Genovese/Learning Fundamentals



To read a graphic organizer, do the following:

- Read the title to understand what the organizer represents.
- Look for a main idea, which is often in the middle of the organizer but may appear at the top.
- Study the lines radiating from the main idea and consider how these branches are related to the central idea.
- Read any text, look at any shapes or images, and notice colors or sizes to understand what the other ideas are and how these are related to the main idea.

Study the graphic organizer in Figure 14.8 and review the steps for reading a graphic organizer. The graphic organizer illustrates the following:

- The *title* indicates a focus on "doing something" to solve the problem of global warming.
- The *main idea* is in the middle in a circle, and the words repeat the title, "Solving Global Warming: Doing Something."
- The *lines* radiating out from the main idea are different colors and labeled with text to indicate various ways to "do something" to help with global warming, such as "eat less meat" or "switch to green power."
- *Colors* organize the different strategies; for instance, "home" is on a light blue line that links to specific ways, such as "have insulation" or "appliances: choose energy efficient ones," that one can fight global warming at home. *Images*, for example of a refrigerator and electric kettle, reinforce the words.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.8

Assess your comprehension of the graphic organizer in Figure 14.8 by answering the questions.

1. What are the best ways to travel to help solve the problem of global warming?
2. What are ways to shop for food that can help solve the problem of global warming?

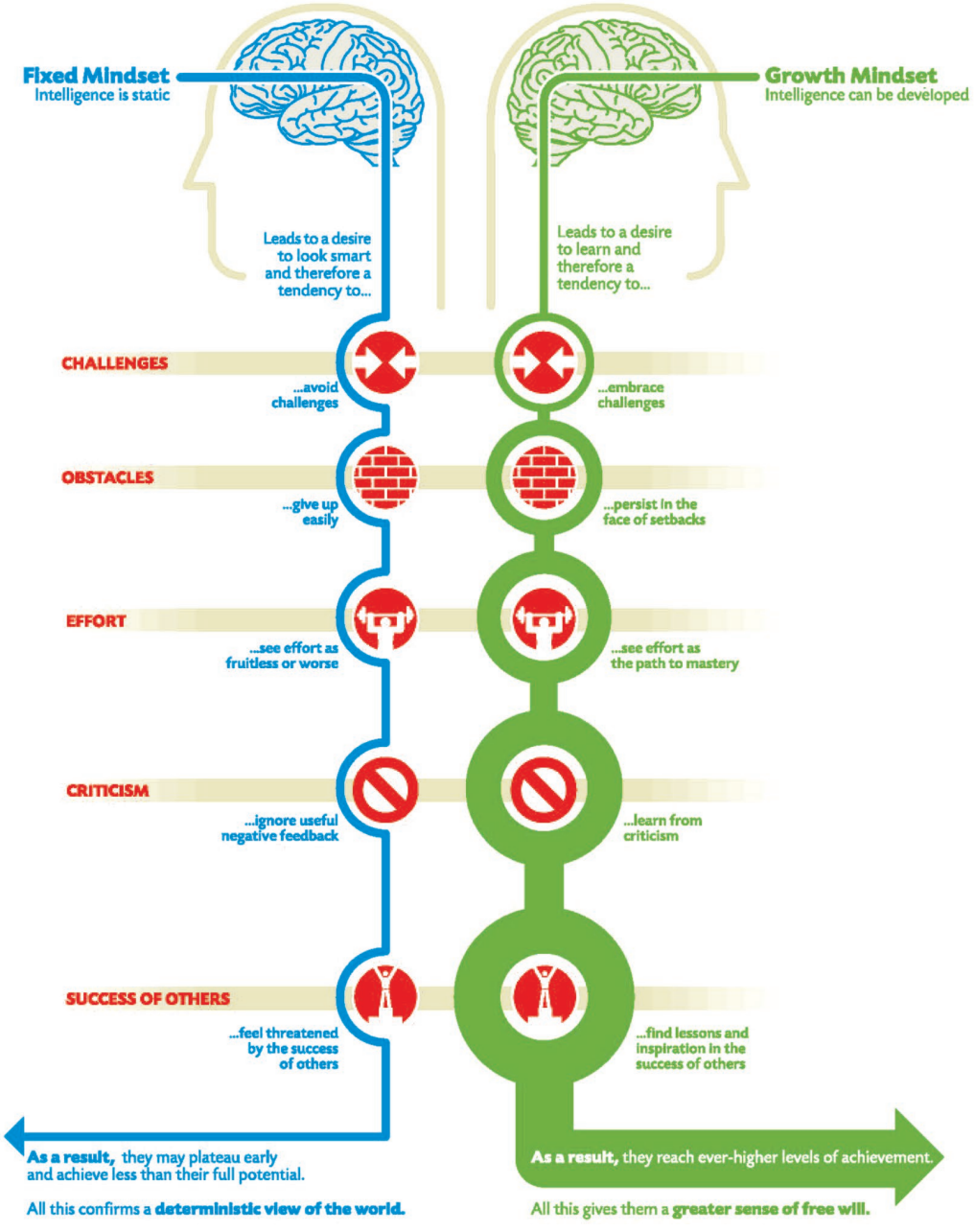
Infographics

An **infographic** is a visual presentation combining text and pictures. Infographics add interest to the explanation of a technical topic and make the subject easy to understand. Infographics use visual elements, such as lines, arrows, photographs, diagrams, and graphs, as well as words, phrases, and sentences to communicate information.

For a writer, studying an infographic from a reliable source can provide information that is useful to include in written work. For a reader, an infographic embedded in a text can aid comprehension, as it may condense, focus, and thus clarify the main ideas. For example, the infographic in Figure 14.9 summarizes

FIGURE 14.9 **Infographic: "Two Mindsets"**

©Carole Dweck. Used with permission.



some important differences between a fixed and a growth mindset and appeared on the *Mindset Works* website to explain Carol Dweck's research into how different mindsets lead to differences in behavior and thinking.

To read an infographic, do the following:

- Read the title to determine what the infographic represents.
- Look for clues as to what path to take when reading. Some infographics are best read from top to bottom; others, from left to right.
- Consider the relationship between the graphic and the text: typically, the graphic visually represents a concept discussed in the text.

Study the infographic in Figure 14.9 and review the steps for reading an infographic. The infographic illustrates the following:

- The *title* indicates a focus on the two mindsets.
- The *path to reading* is top to bottom, since the two mindsets—"Fixed Mindset" and "Growth Mindset"—are named in large, bold print at the top of the infographic and defined (in smaller font below), with arrows running vertically down to the bottom of the infographic.
- The *relationship between the illustration and text* reveals that colors represent the two mindsets: blue for fixed mindset and green for growth mindset. In red font along the left side are major areas of mindsets, such as "Challenges" (at the top) and "Success of Others" (at the bottom). Underneath yellow bars running horizontally, the two mindsets are contrasted, such as a fixed mindset "gives up easily" versus a growth mindset "persists in the face of setbacks."

  Moreover, as the arrows progress toward the bottom of the infographic, the green growth mindset arrow gets thicker while the blue fixed mindset arrow remains the same width. This suggests a growth mindset gains in power and "As a result, they reach ever-higher levels of achievement" as compared to the fixed mindset.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.9

Assess your comprehension of the infographic in Figure 14.9 by answering the questions.

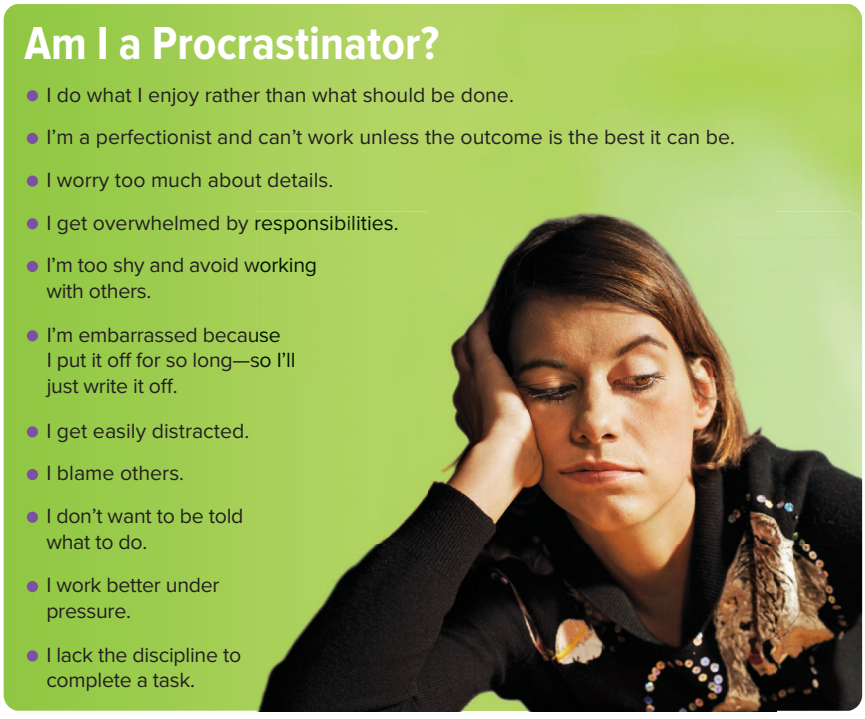
1. What does a person with a fixed mindset believe as compared to a person with a growth mindset?
2. What is the result of having a fixed mindset as compared to having a growth mindset?

Sidebars

A **sidebar** presents information in a box that appears alongside a more detailed discussion of a particular topic. Sidebars are common in textbooks and magazine articles. Their purpose is to provide information to supplement or to highlight aspects of the main reading, including examples, research, and illustrations, that can aid understanding. Sidebars can be useful sources of support in written work.

FIGURE 14.10 Sidebar: "Am I a Procrastinator?"

(photo): Henrik Sorensen/Getty Images; (text): Ferrett, Sharon K. Peak Performance: *Success in College and Beyond,* 11e. McGraw-Hill Education, 2021. Used with permission.



The sidebar in Figure 14.10 is from the textbook *Peak Performance: Success in College and Beyond* by Sharon Ferrett (2021). Reading the sidebar will gives readers a concrete sense of what characteristics define a procrastinator. You might find information in the sidebar with which to describe a procrastinator in your writing or even to determine if you fit the definition of a procrastinator.

To read a sidebar, do the following:

- First consider how the information relates to the primary reading.
- Read the sidebar as you would any other text: from top to bottom and from left to right.
- Consider the relationship between the sidebar text and any featured illustrations, such as graphs, diagrams, and photographs.

Read the sidebar in Figure 14.10 and review the steps for reading a side bar. This way, you should be able to understand the content.

- The *title* indicates that the sidebar will answer the question "Am I a Procrastinator?"

- *Reading from left to right and top to bottom*, one can understand the characteristics of a procrastinator, which are written as a bulleted list, such as "I do what I enjoy rather than what should be done" or "I worry too much about details."
- The *photograph* of a person looking down, hand on cheek, suggests the person is thinking. Moreover, the position of the question "Am I a Procrastinator?" above the head indicates this person might be thinking about how to answer the question; the bullet points to the left provide the answers.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.10

Assess your comprehension of the sidebar in Figure 14.10 by answering the questions.

1. Name one characteristic of a procrastinator.
2. Answer the question "Am I a Procrastinator?" by stating whether you agree or disagree with each statement, then arriving at a conclusion.

VISUAL NARRATIVES

Previous sections of this chapter focused on visuals that present information in ways that summarize data or represent concepts. Reading and comprehending the relation of the visual to the information it represents are important to deciphering the content. Other means of presenting information visually, such as cartoons, photographs, or advertisements, however, require readers to go beyond summarizing information from the visual to interpreting, analyzing, or even drawing inferences about that content. In other words, "reading" cartoons, advertisements, and photographs requires greater thought and insight from readers. How the information is presented, as well as what the information is, becomes important to understanding the message.

Cartoons

A **cartoon** is a drawing, usually humorous, that typically exaggerates or caricatures an action or a subject or a well-known person. While some cartoons are created merely to entertain, the types of cartoons you are most likely to encounter in an academic setting are political cartoons or cartoons with messages about current events. A cartoon can be a single illustration or a comic strip. It can convey a political or social message, for instance, about a current event (such as raising the minimum wage) or about a well-known person (such as the president of the United States). Political cartoons or cartoons with social commentary messages are written to make a point: they express an opinion or present an argument.

To understand a cartoon, follow these guidelines:

- *Look at the pictures.* Identify what the pictures mean—literally as well as symbolically. Cartoonists often use certain strategies, such as exaggeration or caricature, to get their message across to viewers.

- *Read the text.* Remember that cartoons are often meant to be humorous and to make a point. To achieve these effects, a cartoonist might use *irony*, which means saying one thing but meaning the opposite. For instance, it would be ironic for a fat businessman dressed in a suit to say to a skinny worker in tattered clothes that his request for a raise is greedy. In this case, not only the words but also the images would convey the irony of the situation.

Examine the cartoon in Figure 14.11 and review the steps for understanding a cartoon. This way, you should be able to understand the content.

- The *picture* shows a person holding books and looking at a campus map. The person is most likely a student and looks perplexed.
- The *text* on the campus map states, "You are here" and "You are supposed to be here." This implies that the person looking at the map, the student, has not achieved certain goals, because the person is not in the correct location. The cartoon's title, "Education 10," and the student's puzzled face and the impersonality of the map all imply, ironically, that education is not getting this person to the desired location in life.

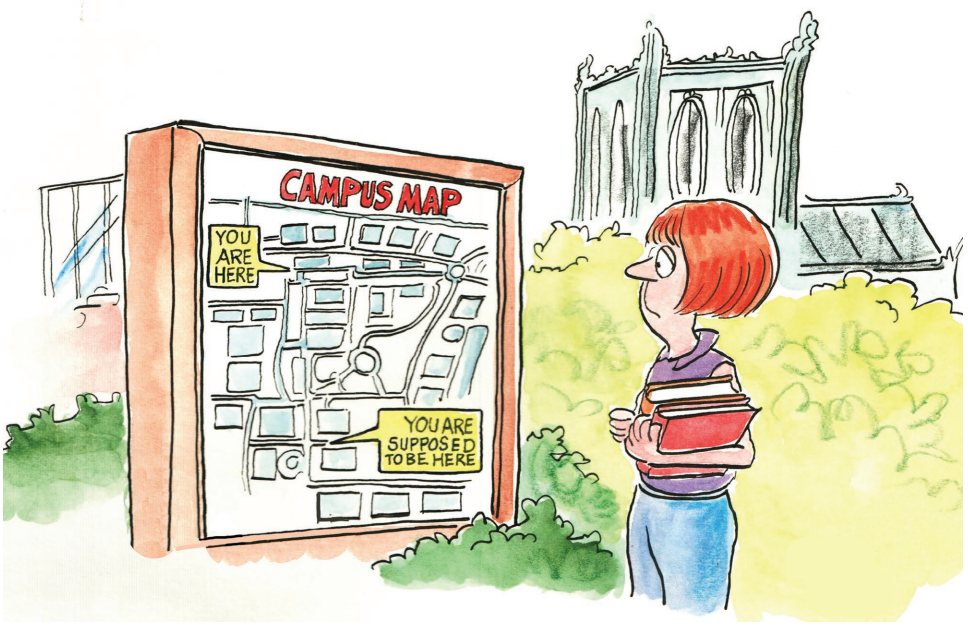
Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.11

Assess your comprehension of the cartoon in Figure 14.11 by answering the questions.

1. What details in the cartoon indicate the setting is a college?
2. What details in the cartoon indicate the person is a student?

FIGURE 14.11 Cartoon: "Education 10"

Andrew Grossman/Cartoon Resource



Advertisements

An **advertisement** is a public notice or announcement that promotes a product or service.

Advertisements are designed for a primary purpose: to get viewers to buy a product or endorse a service. Advertisements may use many means to entice viewers to spend their money or support a cause, such as humor, appeals to emotional needs, or appeals to desires. In fact, one can use Maslow's human hierarchy of needs (see Figure 14.7) to understand how advertisements work on viewers: an advertisement might appeal to basic needs, such as safety, or to higher needs, such as belonging or self-actualization.

While you may not encounter advertisements in your studies, you certainly will in your life outside college. Moreover, analyzing an advertisement is a typical college assignment, since this requires you to make inferences about appeals and understand how appeals can be used to manipulate viewers.

The advertisement in Figure 14.12 encourages viewers to support an organization: Earthjustice, a nonprofit law organization fighting in court for a healthy environment. The advertisement uses words, as well as visuals, to persuade the audience to support its cause.

To understand an advertisement, follow these guidelines:

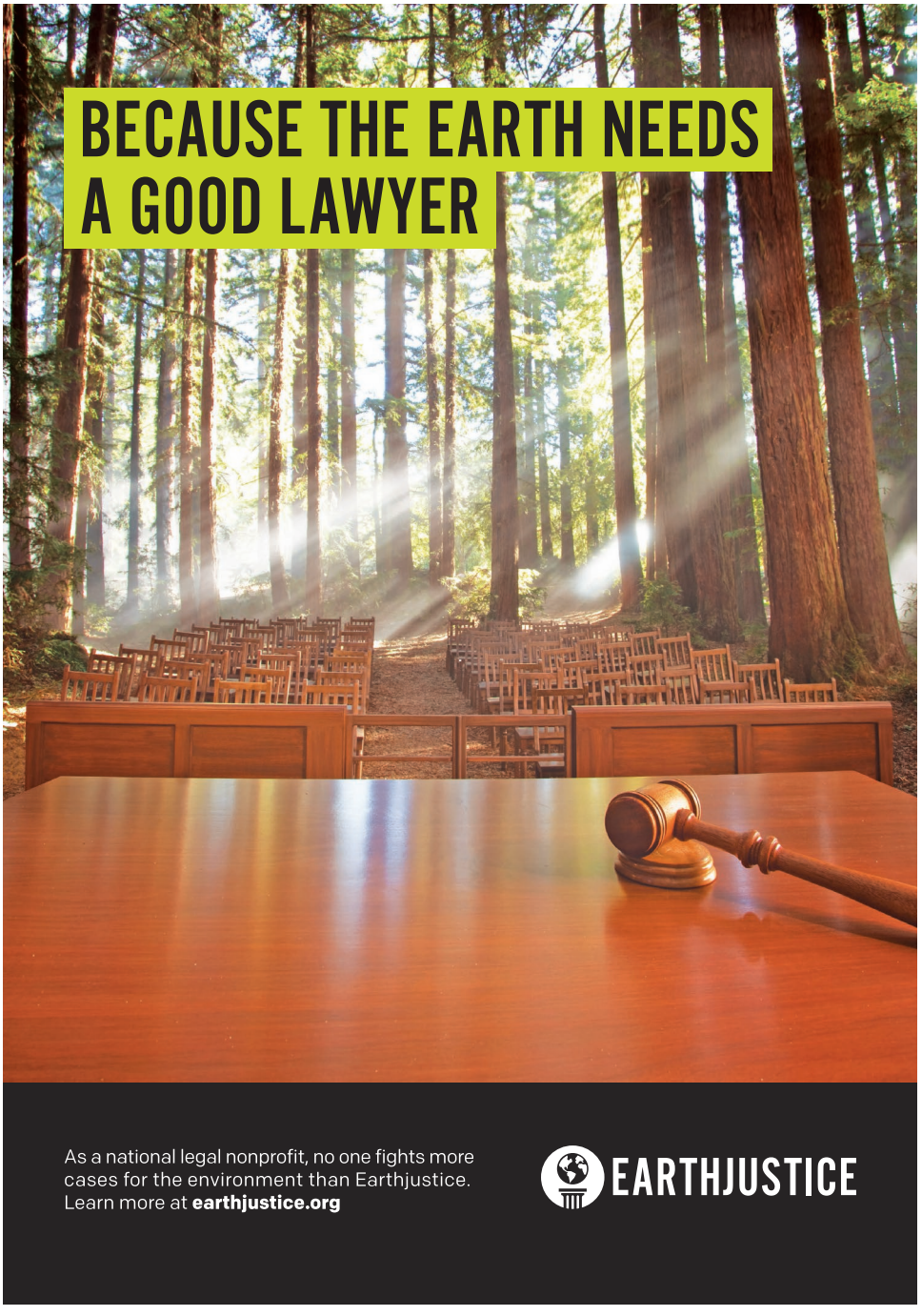
- *Look at the pictures or images.* Identify what the pictures mean—literally as well as symbolically.
- *Read the text.* Understand the literal message—what the text states explicitly—and what the text implies. Consider appeals to logic or emotion, to needs or values.
- *Consider the audience.* Understand the likely target of the advertisement and how the advertisement is intended to persuade that group.

Study the advertisement in Figure 14.12 and review the steps for understanding an advertisement. This way, you should be able to understand the content.

- The *picture* shows a courtroom set in a redwood forest. This suggests the organization is engaged in representing the natural world, using the law as the tool for change. The presence of chairs reflects the role that the public plays in this fight.
- The *text* "because the earth needs a good lawyer" accurately indicates that Earthjustice represents environmental causes, but it also implies that the natural world needs support from the human beings who rely on it, particularly in the courtroom. There are appeals to fairness and justice, in the phrase "a good lawyer," as well as to preserving nature in the word "earth." The text at the bottom of the ad gives a simple explanation of the organization and directs the audience to a website where they can learn more.
- The *audience* would most likely be people who care about the environment and believe the courts can be an effective way to preserve nature and wildlife. This group would be most sympathetic to appeals to protect the natural world.

FIGURE 14.12 **Advertisement: "Because the Earth Needs a Good Lawyer"**

Earthjustice. Used with permission.



Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.12

Assess your comprehension of the advertisement in Figure 14.12 by answering the questions.

1. How do the images reinforce the text in the advertisement?
2. Why do you think there are no people in the advertisement?

Photographs

A **photograph** is a picture or image taken with a camera and can include people, scenes, or even more abstract images. Indeed, photographs include a wide range of subject matter and styles. Some photographs are designed to communicate information, such as a picture of a famous person; other photographs may be intended to inform, such as images of the devastation after a natural disaster; while other photographs might be considered art, as they depict people or the natural world in ways that make viewers reassess their thinking.

To understand a photograph, follow these guidelines:

- *Read the title and caption.* A photograph may have a title that explains the content of the image. Captions (descriptions) provide context for the image. Look above or below a photograph for information about the photograph, such as the subject matter, the date, the location, or the occasion for the image.
- *Look at the images.* Ask yourself, what is being depicted? Consider the literal representation, such as people or places, and understand the situation and what is happening or is being depicted.
- *Consider the composition.* Ask yourself, how is the image arranged and to what effect? Consider the relationship among different parts of the photograph. Consider how the photograph makes you feel. Like a painting, a photograph is often intended to appeal to viewers' emotions and communicate information about the subject.

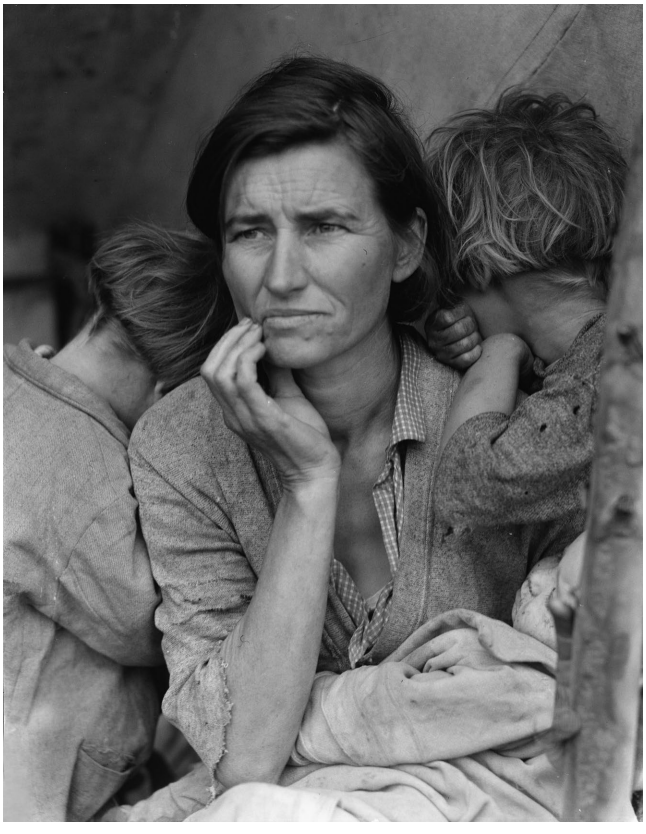
Look carefully at the photograph in Figure 14.13; then review the steps for understanding a photograph. This way, you should be able to understand the content.

- The *title* is "Migrant Mother" and the *caption* below the photograph explains the picture depicts a woman and her children in a camp for field workers in California during the Great Depression of 1936.
- The *image* shows a woman resting her head on her hand. She holds a small baby, while two young children lean on each of her shoulders facing away from the camera. Their tattered and worn clothing suggest they are poor.
- The *composition* with the mother staring off into the distance, her brow furrowed, indicates the hardships of her life. The children, turned away from the camera with heads bent down, imply they are unhappy or ashamed to be photographed. The mother holding one child with two others leaning on her suggests she struggles to care for her children during these hard times.

FIGURE 14.13 Photograph: "Migrant Mother"

Nipomo, Calif. Mar. 1936. Migrant agricultural worker's family. Seven hungry children. Mother aged 32, the father is a native Californian. Destitute in a pea pickers camp, because of the failure of the early pea crop. These people had just sold their tent to buy food. Most of the 2,500 people in this camp were destitute. Photo by Dorothea Lange.

Library of Congress Prints and Photographs Division [LC-DIG-fsa-8b29516]



The image evokes feelings of empathy for this mother and her children; viewers may infer they are poor and hard-working but have a sense of dignity and worth.

Check Your Understanding: Reading Figure 14.13

Assess your comprehension of the photograph in Figure 14.13 by answering the questions.

1. How does the caption help viewers understand the scene in the photograph?
2. Why do you think the woman is not looking at the camera but rather staring off into the distance?

CHAPTER REVIEW

Key Terms

advertisement A public notice or announcement that promotes a product or service.

bar graph A graph that compares related data by using the height or length of rectangles to represent numerical values or characteristics.

cartoon A drawing, usually humorous, that exaggerates or caricatures an action, a subject, or a well-known person.

diagram A kind of illustration used to convey information, such as show a process or steps in a procedure.

graphic organizer An image that is a visual representation of the relationship among ideas.

illustration A drawing that represents an idea or concept.

infographic A visual presentation combining text and pictures.

line graph A graph in which points are connected by lines to show how something changes in value.

map A drawing that represents physical features of an area, such as lands or oceans.

photograph A picture or image taken with a camera.

pie graph A graph that looks like a pie, in which each "slice" in the graph represents a percentage or a numerical value.

sidebar Information presented in a box that appears alongside a more detailed discussion of a particular topic.

table Textual or numerical information that is typically organized in columns and rows.

x axis Information labels across the bottom of the graph.

y axis Information labels along the side of the graph.

Chapter Summary

- Graphs and tables can be used to illustrate trends, to reveal patterns, or to show relationships between sets of data. Because graphs and tables organize and clearly display data, they can present information in ways that are easy to comprehend and to remember.
- Visual information, including maps and diagrams, graphic organizers, and infographics, can be used to illustrate trends, to reveal patterns, or to show relationships between data sets. When information is

presented in a visual format or when text has accompanying visuals, the data or ideas can be made attractive and informative, memorable and revealing.

- Visual narratives, such as cartoons, photographs, or advertisements, require readers to interpret, analyze, or draw inferences about that content, considering how the information is presented, as well as what that information means, to understand the message.

Chapter Activities

Follow the instructions in each exercise.

1. If you are writing a paper that includes data, create a table or graph to display that data. Select a graph or table style that clearly presents the data. Be sure to properly credit the source of the data.
2. If you are writing a paper that includes key concepts or complicated processes, create a visual representation of those complicated ideas or processes, such as an infographic or diagram. Be sure to properly credit the source of any information in the visual that comes from a source.
3. Locate a visual narrative, such as a cartoon or photograph, related to your writing topic. Analyze the cartoon or photograph; then explain what message it conveys and how it does so with words or with images. You may also consider taking a photograph or creating a cartoon to represent your writing topic.

CHAPTER 15

MLA and APA Documentation

After reading this chapter, you will be able to

- Create in-text citations using MLA style.
- Construct a Works Cited page in MLA style.
- Format a paper in MLA style.
- Create in-text citations using APA style.
- Construct a Reference list in APA style.
- Format a paper in APA style.

Much of your writing will be your own thinking and your own words. However, in college you will frequently engage with other people's ideas through lectures and discussions, via readings and research. When you use other people's ideas or their words, you must acknowledge them. You can give credit to your sources by mentioning the source in the sentence, by providing a citation after the sentence, and by creating a list of citations at the end of the paper. This chapter will demonstrate how to properly acknowledge source material by reviewing two major citation styles for college papers: MLA (Modern Language Association) and APA (American Psychological Association).

DOCUMENTING SOURCES AND FORMATTING PAPERS CORRECTLY

Different academic disciplines have different citation styles. For instance, most English courses require students to use MLA (Modern Language Association) style, while many social sciences, such as psychology, use APA (American Psychological Association) style. Always check with your instructor as to the required documentation style. This chapter presents basic guidelines for MLA style. To understand MLA style in depth, consult the ninth edition of the *MLA Handbook*. Since APA is a commonly used style in college writing, the basic guidelines for this style will be explained as well. To understand APA style in depth, consult the seventh edition of the *Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association.*

Both MLA and APA have guidelines for citing sources in the text of the paper itself, in parentheses following quoted or summarized information. These are *in-text citations,* since they occur within the text of the paper. Both styles also have guidelines for creating a list of sources used in the paper. This chapter will review the basic guidelines for in-text citations and list of sources, as well as how to format a paper according to first MLA and then APA style.

MLA Style: In-Text Citations

Whenever you use information in your essay—whether you quote, paraphrase, or summarize—you should include a citation for the source. An in-text citation serves the important purpose of clearly separating your ideas from the ideas or information of sources. An in-text citation should appear for *each and every* piece of information taken from a source.

MLA style for in-text citation typically requires the author's last name and a page number to appear in parentheses after a quote, summary, or paraphrase from a source. In-text citations in MLA style are sometimes referred to as parenthetical citations because the author and page number appear in parentheses. Following is a general guide for in-text citations as well as examples that illustrate MLA style for in-text citations for different situations.

General Guidelines for MLA In-Text Citations

1. Place the in-text citation (usually the author's last name and the page number) in parentheses at the end of the sentence. If the source does not list an author, use the name of the source (its title or the name of the web page) in the parenthetical reference.
2. If you use the author's name in your sentence, do not use the name in the parenthetical citation; if you do not use the name in your sentence, use it in the in-text citation.
3. Leave a space between the last word in the sentence and the parenthetical citation. Place a period at the end of the sentence, after the parenthetical citation.
4. Do not use a comma or *p* or *pg* before the page number. Simply leave a space between the author's last name and the page number.

Example: Because bacteria are so numerous and multiply so rapidly, "resistance is inevitable" (Del Mar 285).

5. When page numbers are not used in a source, omit page numbers from the citation. Instead, include the first words that appear in the Works Cited entry (such as the author's name, article title, or website title).

The following examples illustrate MLA style for in-text citations for different situations. Because an in-text citation is an abbreviated version of the full citation that appears in a Works Cited list, the corresponding Works Cited entry is included for easy reference.

Summary with in-text citation

One study found that participants who spent their extra compensation on other people said they were happier than those who spent that money on themselves (Grohol 206).

Quote with in-text citation

One study found that participants who "spent more of their bonus money on others, or on charity, reported greater general happiness levels than those who spent more of it on themselves" (Grohol 206).

A source with two authors

Quotation:

One study showed that "[n]early 60 percent of people living in the UK [United Kingdom] rate their happiness as at least 7 out of 10, higher than most other rich countries" (Zolfagharifard and Gillman).

Summary:

Zolfagharifard and Gillman found that the majority of people living in the United Kingdom report greater happiness than individuals in other rich countries.

Works Cited entry:

Zolfagharid, Ellie, and Ollie Gillman. "More Money Does Make You Happier." *MailOnline,* 31 Oct. 2014, www.dailymail.co.uk/sciencetech/article-2813751/Survey-Asia-finds-money-brings-happiness.html.

A source with three or more authors

Quotation:

Researchers studied the pervasiveness of fake news surrounding the COVID-19 pandemic, including "false claims, half baked conspiracy theories and pseudoscientific therapies" (Bin Naeem et al.).

Summary:

Bin Naeem et al. studied fake news surrounding the COVID-19 pandemic, including "false claims, half baked conspiracy theories and pseudoscientific therapies."

Works Cited entry:

Bin Naeem et al. "An Exploration of How Fake News Is Taking Over Social Media and Putting Public Health at Risk." *Health Information and Libraries Journal*, Health Libraries Group, 12 July 2020. *Wiley Online Library,* https://doi.org/10.1111/hir.12320.

A source with no named author

Quotation:

While older adults are at greater risk of heat-related illness, "even young and healthy people can be affected if they participate in strenuous physical activities during hot weather" ("About Extreme Heat").

Summary:

> While older adults are at greater risk of heat-related illness, young, healthy people are also at risk when temperatures rise ("About Extreme Heat").

Works Cited entry:

> "About Extreme Heat." *CDC.gov*, Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, 19 June 2017, www.cdc.gov/disasters/extremeheat/heat_guide.html.

Indirect quotation

When a source is cited or quoted in another source, it is called an indirect quotation. For example, if an article provides information from the World Health Organization but that article is not written by the World Health Organization, the quotation would be considered an indirect quotation.

> According to the World Health Organization, with the increasing spread of fake news, the COVID-19 pandemic has likewise brought on an "infodemic" (qtd. in Bin Naemm et al.).

Long quotations

When a quotation runs four or more lines, MLA style requires a block quote. Start the quote on a new line and indent the entire quotation one-half inch from the left margin (the same as for a new paragraph). Double-space the quotation, but do not put quotation marks around the words. For block quotations, end punctuation appears at the end of the quotation, followed by the appropriate in-text citation.

> Higher income allowed participants to spend more money on others, which led to greater happiness:
>
> > Although past research has been inconsistent in its finding that people who are rich generally are happier than people who are less well off, more recent research finds that wealthy people are indeed considerably happier than those with average or poor incomes. (Lucas and Schimmack 76)

MLA: Works Cited List

A list of sources should appear at the end of a paper that includes information taken from those sources. This way, readers can look up and read the sources if they choose or determine whether the sources are academically appropriate. In MLA style, the sources list is called "Works Cited." The list includes all the sources cited in the paper, arranged alphabetically by the author's last name or, if there is no author, by the first word in the Works Cited entry.

Depending on the type of source—book, newspaper or magazine article, website, or journal article, for example—the content, order, and arrangement of the information needed to complete each entry may be different.

To identify the core elements of a Works Cited entry, the *MLA Handbook* recommends using a template (Figure 15.1). Doing so will help you gather the information you will need to create a Works Cited entry for any source type and

FIGURE 15.1 MLA Template of Core Elements

Who is the author?
What is the title of the source?
What is the title of the container? (This is the journal, or website, or book or other "container" in which the source appears.)
Who are the contributors (such as editors or translators) to the source?
What version is the source?
What number does the source have?
Who is the source's publisher?
When was the source published?
What is the source's location (page numbers, DOI or URL, etc.)?

provide that information in the correct order in which it should appear. Realize that you may not be able to answer each question for every source or each question exactly as posed; for instance, some sources do not have an author, while other sources have multiple authors. In the next section of this chapter, you will find examples of specific source types and guidance as to how to format them.

The *MLA Handbook* is your complete guide to citing various types of sources correctly and accurately. Following are general guidelines for each entry in a Works Cited list. What follows are examples of the most common sources.

General Guidelines for MLA Works Cited List Entries

1. Begin the entry with the author's name: last name, first name. Place a comma between the last and first name and a period after the first name.
2. Place quotation marks around the titles of articles, short stories, poems, songs, and web pages; italicize the titles of periodicals, books, websites, and full-length works such as movies.
3. Write dates as day, month, year (e.g., *25 May 2021*). Spell out *May, June,* and *July*, but abbreviate other months: *Jan., Feb., Mar., Apr., Aug., Sept., Oct., Nov., Dec.*
4. Place a period after the author's name and a period after the title of the article. Place a comma after the name of the publication and after the publication date. Introduce page numbers with *p.* or *pp.*
5. Indent the second line of the entry one-half inch. This is referred to as a *hanging indent*.

One author

Dweck, Carol. *Mindset: The New Psychology of Success*. Random House, 2006.

Two authors

Cassidy-Eagle, Erin, and Allison Siebern. "Sleep and Mild Cognitive Impairment." *Sleep Science and Practice,* 18 July 2017, https://doi.org/10.1186/ s41606-017-0016-5.

Three or more authors

Fabbri, Marco, et al. "Measuring Subjective Sleep Quality." *International Journal of Environmental and Public Health,* vol. 18, no. 3, 2021, p. 1082.

No known author

Centre for Contemporary Cultural Studies. *Women Take Issue: Aspects of Women's Subordination*. Routledge, 2007.

The third row in this template asks for the source's container, or the place or publisher that "holds" it. Note that a source may have two containers (for example, if you are citing an article that appears in a scholarly journal [container 1], which also appears in an online database [container 2]). In your Works Cited entry, you will need to provide information for both containers. See the second entry below, a book in an online database.

The last row in Figure 15.1 asks for the source's location. For journal articles accessed online, the location element will consist of a DOI or a URL. DOIs (Digital Object Identifiers) are stable strings of letters and numbers that correspond to a specific article or work. DOIs are always preferred because they do not change.

- MLA strongly recommends listing a DOI whenever one is available.
- A stable URL (permalink) is also acceptable, if no DOI is available.
- Note that traditional URLs are subject to change and often break, so they are not ideal for use in source citations, although sometimes they are the only location information that is available.

1. Print book or e-book

Dweck, Carol. *Mindset: The New Psychology of Success*. Random House, 2006.

If you are citing the e-book version, include that information after the title.

Dweck, Carol. *Mindset: The New Psychology of Success*. E-book ed., Random House, 2006.

2. Book in an online database. If you accessed the article through a database, include the name of the database in italics as the second container, followed by a URL.

Gaskell, Elizabeth Cleghorn. *North and South*. Harper and Brothers, 1855. *Google Books*, books.google.com/books?id=yMNHwH4hT7AC&pg=PP1#v=onepage&q&f=false.

3. Work in an anthology. After the author and title of the work list any contributors, such as editors or translators, with a phrase that describes the nature of their contribution (*edited by* or *translated by*).

Giovanni, Nikki. "At the Evening of Life." *The Golden Shovel Anthology*, edited by Peter Kahn et al., Arkansas UP, 2017, p. 13.

4. **Volume in a multivolume work**

   Manning, Martin J., and Clarence R. Wyatt. *Encyclopedia of Media and Propaganda in Wartime America*. Vol. 1, ABC-CLIO, 2010.

5. **Work by a corporate author or government agency.** List the corporation or agency first as the author. The first example here shows a print book by a corporate author; the second is an online article by a government agency.

   Centre for Contemporary Cultural Studies. *Women Take Issue: Aspects of Women's Subordination*. Routledge, 2007.

   "Anorexia Nervosa." *MentalHealth.gov*, U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, 22 Aug. 2017, www.mentalhealth.gov/what-to-look-for/eating-disorders/anorexia.

6. **Newspaper article**. When a print edition is cited, include the page range for the article (preceded by *p.* or *pp.*), as in the first example. For an article accessed online, include the URL.

   Harris, Elizabeth A. "Fans of the Late le Carré Will Get One More Spy Novel This Fall." *The New York Times*, 22 May 2021, p. C6.

   Blackman, Andrew. "Can Money Buy You Happiness?" *The Wall Street Journal*, 10 Nov. 2014, www.wsj.com/articles/can-money-buy-happiness-heres-what-science-has-to-say-1415569538.

7. **Magazine article.** The following shows an article accessed online. If the article is accessed in print, list the page range (with no *p.* or *pp.* preceding it) instead of the URL.

   Treuer, David. "Return the National Parks to the Tribes." *The Atlantic*, May 2021, https://www.theatlantic.com/magazine/archive/2021/05/return-the-national-parks-to-the-tribes/618395/.

8. **Journal article.** The first example shows an article accessed in print. The second shows an article accessed online. Note that a DOI is listed for the online article, instead of a URL.

   Fabbri, Marco et al. "Measuring Subjective Sleep Quality." *International Journal of Environmental and Public Health,* vol. 18, no. 3, 2021, p. 1082.

   Cassidy-Eagle, Erin, and Allison Siebern. "Sleep and Mild Cognitive Impairment." *Sleep Science and Practice,* 18 July 2017, https://doi.org/10.1186/s41606-017-0016-5.

   If an article is accessed through a database, include the name of the database in italics (e.g., *ResearchGate*) as the second container, and a URL.

   Cassidy-Eagle, Erin, and Allison Siebern. "Sleep and Mild Cognitive Impairment." *Sleep Science and Practice,* 18 July 2017, *ResearchGate,* https://www.researchgate.net/publication/318504593_Sleep_and_mild_cognitive_impairment.

9. **Review**

   Nussbaum, Emily. "Review of *Work in Progress,*" by Abby McEnany. *The New Yorker*, 23 Dec. 2020, pp. 92–93.

10. **Reference works.** Note that a publication date is not available for this source. In such cases, include a date access at the end of the citation.

Green, Brian R. "String Theory." *Encyclopedia Britannica,* www.britannica.com/science/string-theory. Accessed 12 June 2021.

11. Dissertation or thesis. After the name of the institution, include a short description of the type of thesis or dissertation.

Fraser, Wilmot Alfred. *Jazzology: A Study of the Tradition in Which Jazz Musicians Learn to Improvise*. 1983. U of Pennsylvania, PhD dissertation. UMI, 1987.

12. Editorial or letter to the editor. Follow the format for newspaper articles, but include a brief description (*Editorial* or *Letter*) following the title.

Quammen, David. "A Few Words on Behalf of Bats." Editorial. *The New York Times,* 13 Dec. 2020, p. 4.

13. Article or short work on a website

Grohol, John. "Can Money Really Buy Happiness?" *PBS,* Corporation of Broadcasters and Reviewers, 14 May 2014, www.pbs.org/thisemotionallife/blogs/can-money-really-buy-happiness.

14. Social media post. Include the full text of the post, in quotation marks as the source's title (first example). If citing a posted photo or other media, include a brief description, not enclosed in quotation marks (second example).

American Psychological Association. "How can you intervene when you see a friend, colleague, or stranger targeted by a microaggression? Here's evidence-based advice from psychologists on how to move from being a passive witness to an active ally." *Twitter*, 27 May 2021, 9:31 a.m., twitter.com/APA/status/1397908382808514562.

Seco, Francisco. Photo of a man swimming in Oslo Norway. *Instagram,* 25 Apr. 2021, www.instagram.com/p/COGpz9wjOLS/.

If the author's handle differs from the account name, or if your citation does not include a URL, consider including the handle in brackets (e.g., Jai Hamid Bashir [@JaiofEARTH]).

15. Wiki entry. Include the date the page was last updated. If no date is available, end with the date of access.

"Arches National Park." *Wikipedia*, 25 May 2021, en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Arches_National_Park.

16. Interview. For a published interview, follow the title with the name of the interviewer.

Gates, Bill. "We Need an Energy Miracle." Interview by James Bennet. *The Atlantic*, Nov. 2015, www.theatlantic.com/magazine/archive/2015/11/we-need-an-energy-miracle/407881/.

For a personal interview, indicate whether the interview was conducted in person, by e-mail, or by telephone.

Stoehr, Taylor. E-mail interview with the author. 13 Sept. 2012.

17. Personal communication. Follow this format to cite letters, e-mails, text messages, and online chats.

Hatton, Ian. Text message to E. Murphy. 30 July 2021.

Burger, Carrie. E-mail to A. Kuehner. 12 Feb. 2021.

18. Live performance or oral presentation. End the citation with the location of the performance or presentation.

Fierstein, H., and Cyndi Lauper. *Kinky Boots*. Directed by Jerry Mitchell, 18 July 2013, Al Hirschfeld Theatre, New York City.

Russell, David R. "Teacher's Perception of Genre across the Curriculum: Making Classroom/Culture Connections Visible." Conference on College Composition and Communication Convention, 26 Mar. 1999, Atlanta Hilton.

19. TED talk

Smith, Emily Esfahani. "There's More to Life Than Being Happy." *TED: Ideas Worth Spreading*, 2017, www.ted.com/talks/emily_esfahani_smith_there_s_more_to_life_than_being_happy.

20. Podcast

"The Seven Things You're Not Supposed to Talk About." *This American Life*, hosted by Ira Glass, 8 Nov. 2013. *WEBZ Chicago*, www.thisamericanlife.org/511/the-seven-things-youre-not-supposed-to-talk-about.

21. *YouTube*, *Vimeo*, or other online video

"Richard Ford and Colm Toíbín Conversation: Narrators are Unreliable." 23 Nov. 2016, www.youtube.com/watch?v=gTs9pPhzcmg.

22. Film or DVD. The first example shows a film viewed in DVD format; the second, a film viewed through a streaming service. Note that the streaming service is named and italicized, followed by the URL.

Lawrence of Arabia. Directed by David Lean, Sony Pictures, 2012. DVD.

Sorry We Missed You. Directed by Ken Loach, Sixteen Films, 2019. *Criterion Channel*, www.criterionchannel.com.

23. Television episode. List the episode title, the program or series title, the name of any important contributors (such as writers, directors, producers, performers), the network, the broadcast date, and a URL, if viewed online. If the program was accessed through a streaming service or app, that information should precede the URL.

"Beyond the Elements: Life." *Nova*, narrated by David Pogue, season 47, episode 19, *PBS*, 17 Feb. 2021, https://www.pbs.org/video/beyond-the-elements-life-234qj4/.

24. Advertisement. Because advertisements are typically not titled, include a brief description in place of a title.

Advertisement for the Howland Cultural Center. *The Highlands Current.* 17 Jan. 2020, p. 12.

25. Work of visual art. If the work is an original that was viewed in person, follow the first example. If the work is a reproduction, follow the second.

Adams, Ansel. *Monolith, Face of Half Dome, Yosemite Valley, California.* 1980, Getty Museum, Los Angeles.

Lange, Dorothea. *Migrant Mother*, 1936. Prints and Photographs Division, Library of Congress, lccn.loc.gov/2017762891.

26. Cartoon

McNair, Elisabeth. Cartoon. *The New Yorker,* 24 May 2021, p. 29.

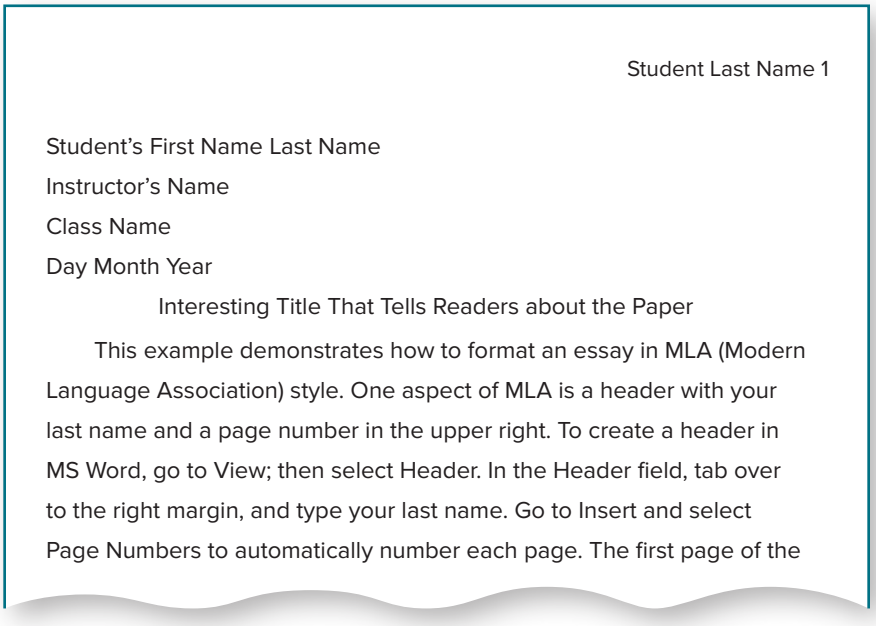
27. Map, chart, or diagram

MTA New York City Subway. Map. *Metropolitan Transit Authority,* 2013, web.mta.info/nyct/maps/subwaymap.pdf.

MLA: First Page

The first page of a paper in MLA style consists of a heading on the upper left that includes information on four lines: (1) the name of the writer of the paper, (2) the instructor's name, (3) the class, and (4) the date. In the upper right of the page should be the writer's last name and the page number. The title of the paper is centered after the heading; it is not bold or underlined or quoted. The first line of the text and all paragraphs in the paper are indented one-half inch. The entire paper is double-spaced. The example in Figure 15.2 both explains and demonstrates how to properly format the first page and the body paragraphs of a paper using MLA style, including how to integrate and cite quotations.

FIGURE 15.2 Example: First Page in MLA



Student Last Name 1

Student's First Name Last Name
Instructor's Name
Class Name
Day Month Year

Interesting Title That Tells Readers about the Paper

This example demonstrates how to format an essay in MLA (Modern Language Association) style. One aspect of MLA is a header with your last name and a page number in the upper right. To create a header in MS Word, go to View; then select Header. In the Header field, tab over to the right margin, and type your last name. Go to Insert and select Page Numbers to automatically number each page. The first page of the

paper should be numbered 1. In the body of the paper, use 12-point font: Times New Roman is a good choice. Double-space the paper including the heading, the title, and the body of the paper.

When you include researched information, often you will be quoting from the sources. If you include words exactly from the readings—maybe because an expert said those words, maybe because those words say exactly what you need to prove a point—then put quotation marks around them. Also, you will want to acknowledge the source of the quotation. MLA requires citing the author and page number for quotations. For instance, if commenting on Mike Rose's Introduction to his book *Back to School,* one might write something like this: In his book *Back to School,* Mike Rose explains the importance of a community college as a place where students "could acquire knowledge and skill, develop a sense of competence as readers and writers and thinkers" (6). If Mike Rose's name is not included in the sentence, then write the author's name and page number after the quotation, like this: One scholar notes that community colleges are important places where students "could acquire knowledge and skill, develop a sense of competence as readers and writers and thinkers" (Rose 6). Notice that only the author's last name is used and there is simply a space between the author's name and the page number.

If you want to use a long quote (one that runs over three lines), create a block quote. A block quote is indented two tabs from the left margin and is written without any quotation marks around it. A page number in parentheses follows the quotation. For example, to use a long quotation from Mike Rose's book *Back to School,* one might write something like this: In his book *Back to School,* Mike Rose explains how important attending a community college is for Henry, Jesus, and Jeremy:

> this college for these three young men proved to be a place where they could acquire knowledge and skill, develop a sense of

> competence as readers and writers and thinkers, channel desire into productive activity, come to terms with inner and outer demons, bridge social divides, take on a new way of being in the world (6).

Notice how the quotation is introduced with the author and title of the book and by a complete sentence before the quote followed by a colon. Finally, the page number is cited after the quoted words. There are no quotation marks around the words; the indentation signals to readers that the words are taken from a source.

Sometimes you will want to paraphrase or summarize information from the reading. If the information is unique, specific, or you want to establish credibility by referencing a source, you might include a parenthetical citation with the author's name and page number after the information. For instance, if you wanted to lend credibility to the idea that a community college education can change people's lives, you might write something like this: In his book, *Back to School,* Mike Rose explains how attending a community college profoundly improved the life of one former gang member (6). Be sure to format your paper and cite quotes correctly—attending to these details will make your writing strong.

MLA: Works Cited List

The list of works cited begins on a new page at the end of the paper. The title of the page, "Works Cited," is centered; it is not underlined, placed in quotation marks, or bold. Entries for the sources cited in the paper are arranged in alphabetical order by the author's last name or by the first words in the entry, if there is no author. After the first line, all other lines for each entry are indented. The entries are double-spaced, as shown in Figure 15.3.

FIGURE 15.3 **Example: Works Cited List in MLA**

Works Cited

Blackman, Andrew. "Can Money Buy You Happiness?" *The Wall Street Journal,* 10 Nov. 2014, www.wsj.com/articles/can-money-buy-happiness-heres-what-science-has-to-say-1415569538.

Grohol, John. "Can Money Really Buy Happiness?" *PBS,* Corporation of Broadcasters and Reviewers, 14 May 2014, www.pbs.org/thisemotionallife/blogs/can-money-really-buy-happiness.

Killingsworth, Matthew A. "Experienced Well-Being Rises with Income, Even Above $75,000 per Year." *Proceedings for the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America,* vol. 118, no. 4, 2021, https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2016976118.

Lama, Dalai, and Howard C. Cutler. *The Art of Happiness*. Riverhead Books, 2009.

Park, Jane. "What Makes Us Happier Than Money?" Greater Good Science Center, 20 Aug. 2020, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=foqi_S-6XPo.

Smith, Emily Esfahani. "There's More to Life Than Being Happy." *TED: Ideas Worth Spreading,* 2017, www.ted.com/talks/emily_esfahani_smith_there_s_more_to_life_than_being_happy.

APA Style: In-Text Citations

In APA style, the in-text citation typically includes the author's last name followed by the year of publication in parentheses after a summary or paraphrase from a source. For a quotation from a source, APA style requires the author's last name, year of publication, and a page number in parentheses immediately following the quotation.

As an alternative, you can provide the author's name in front of a summary or paraphrase, followed immediately by the date in parentheses and a page number for a quotation.

General Guidelines for APA In-Text Citations

APA uses the author-date method of in-text citations. If the author is not named in the sentence, then in parentheses after a summary or quotation, include the author's last name and date of publication.

continued

1. After a summary, place the author and date of publication in the parenthetical citation, separated with a comma.

   Example: According to an article in *The Guardian,* antibiotic resistance is a serious threat to human health that causes tens of thousands of deaths worldwide every year (Del Mar, 2014).

2. After a quotation, place the author, date of publication, and the page number, if page numbers are used, in the parenthetical citation. The page number is preceded by *p*.

   Example: According to an article in *The Guardian,* "the central weapon against antibiotic resistance must be to discourage antibiotic use" (Del Mar, 2014, p. 286).

The following examples illustrate APA style for in-text citations for different situations.

Summary with in-text citation

One study found that participants said they were happier after spending their extra compensation on other people compared with those who spent that money on themselves (Grohol, 2014).

Quote with in-text citation

One study found that participants who "spent more of their bonus money on others, or on charity, reported greater general happiness levels than those who spent more of it on themselves" (Grohol, 2014, p. 206).

A source with two authors

Quotation:

One study found that "Nearly 60 percent of people living in the UK [United Kingdom] rate their happiness as at least 7 out of 10, higher than most other rich countries" (Zolfagharifard & Gillman, 2014, p. 2).

Summary:

Zolfagharifard and Gillman (2014) found that "Nearly 60 percent of people living in the UK [United Kingdom] rate their happiness as at least 7 out of 10, higher than most other rich countries" (p. 2).

Reference entry:

Zolfagharid, E., & Gillman, O. (2014, October 31). More money does make you happier. *MailOnline.* https://www.dailymail.co.uk/sciencetech/article-2813751/Survey-Asia-finds-money-brings-happiness.html

A source with three or more authors

Quotation:

Researchers studied the pervasiveness of fake news surrounding the COVID-19 pandemic, including "false claims, half baked conspiracy theories and pseudoscientific therapies" (Bin Naeem et al., 2020).

Summary:

Bin Naeem et al. (2020) studied fake news surrounding the COVID-19 pandemic, including "false claims, half baked conspiracy theories and pseudoscientific therapies."

Reference entry:

Bin Naeem et al. (2020, July 12). An exploration of how fake news is taking over social media and putting public health at risk. *Health Information and Libraries Journal*, Health Libraries Group. *Wiley Online Library.* https://doi.org/10.1111/hir.12320

A source with no named author

Quotation:

According to the CDC (2017), while older adults are at greater risk of heat-related illness, "even young and healthy people can be affected if they participate in strenuous physical activities during hot weather."

Summary:

According to the CDC (2017), while older adults are at greater risk of heat-related illness, young, healthy people are also at risk when temperatures rise.

Reference entry:

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2017, June 19). *About extreme heat*. https://www.cdc.gov/disasters/extremeheat/heat_guide.html

Indirect quotation

When a source is cited or quoted in another source, it is called an indirect quotation. For example, if an article quotes from the World Health Organization but that article is not written by the World Health Organization, the quotation would be considered an indirect quotation. The abbreviation "qtd. in" precedes the source in the parenthetical citation.

According to the World Health Organization, with the increasing spread of fake news, the COVID-19 pandemic has likewise brought on an "infodemic" (as cited in Bin Naemm et al., 2020).

Long quotations

When quoting forty or more words, APA requires a block quotation. Start the quotation on a new line one-half inch from the left margin (the same indentation as a new paragraph). Double-space the quotation, but do not put quotation marks around the words. Include the appropriate in-text citation following the quotation.

Higher income allowed participants to spend more money on others, which led to greater happiness:

> Although past research has been inconsistent in its finding that people who are rich generally are happier than people who are less well off, more recent research finds that wealthy people are indeed considerably happier than those with average or poor incomes. (Lucas & Schimmack, 2009, p. 76)

APA: References List

A list of sources should appear at the end of a research paper so that readers can look up and read the sources if they choose or determine the reliability of sources. In APA style, the source list is titled "References." Depending on the type of source—book, newspaper or magazine article, website, or journal article, for example—the information, order, and arrangement of the information needed to complete each entry may be different.

You can use the template provided in Figure 15.1 to keep track of the information you will need to gather for citing sources in APA, as well as in MLA. You may recall that the first row of that template asks for the author of the source. The following examples demonstrate APA's guidelines for citing sources with one or more authors, or with no known author.

One author

Dweck, C. (2006). *Mindset: The new psychology of success*. Random House.

Two authors

Cassidy-Eagle, E., & Siebern, A. (2017, July 18). Sleep and mild cognitive impairment. *Sleep Science and Practice.* https://doi.org/10.1186/s41606-017-0016-5

Three to twenty authors

Fabbri, M., Beracci, A., Martoni, M., Meneo, D., Tonetti, L., & Natale, V. (2021). Measuring subjective sleep quality. *International Journal of Environmental and Public Health, 18*(3), 1082. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph18031082

Twenty-one or more authors. If there are more than twenty-one authors, use ellipses (. . .) after the nineteenth author. Following the ellipses, list the name of the last author.

No known author

Centre for Contemporary Cultural Studies. (2007). *Women take issue: Aspects of women's subordination*. Routledge.

Following are the general guidelines for reference entries, followed by examples for a few of the most common sources.

General Guidelines for APA References List Entries

1. Begin the entry with the author's last name followed by initials. Place a comma between the last name and initials and a period after the initials.
2. Include the date of publication in parentheses after the author's name.
3. Capitalize all major words in a journal or magazine title; however, when referencing books, chapters, articles, or web pages, capitalize only the first letter of the first word of a title or subtitle.
4. Italicize titles of longer works, such as books or journals or magazines.
5. End with a hyperlinked URL or DOI for the source, if available.

A Note about DOIs and URLs in APA References

- Many books and articles have a digital object identifier (DOI), a unique, stable string of numbers and letters that help readers locate a source.
- APA requires that a DOI be included in all citations, whether the source is accessed online or in print, whenever one is available.
- If a print source has no DOI, it is not necessary to include a URL in its place.
- If a digital source has no DOI, do include a URL in your citation.
- DOIs and URLs should be live-linked.
- Do not place a period after a DOI or URL, when citing in APA.

1. **Print book or e-book.** Note that the first example, a print book, includes a DOI. The second example is an e-book that includes an optional descriptive label that identifies the type of e-book ("[Kindle]") and a URL where the source can be downloaded.

   Hoffmann, S. G., & Doan, S. N. (2018). *The social foundations of emotion: Developmental, cultural, and clinical dimensions.* American Psychological Association. https://doi.org/10.1037/00000098-000

   Wolfe, T. (1998). *A man in full* [Kindle]. Farrar, Straus, and Giroux. https://www.amazon.com/Man-Full-Novel-Tom-Wolfe-ebook/dp/B004TNHAXY

2. **Work in an anthology**. Begin with the author of the work you are citing. After the title, include the names of any other contributors followed by the appropriate abbreviations: Ed. (editor), Eds. (editors), or Trans. (translator or translators).

   Giovanni, N. (2017). At the evening of life. In P. Kahn et al. (Eds.), *The golden shovel anthology* (p. 13). Arkansas University Press.

3. **Volume in a multivolume work**

   Manning, M. J., & Wyatt, C. R. (2010). *Encyclopedia of media and propaganda in wartime America* (Vol. 2). ABC-CLIO.

4. **Work by a corporate author or government agency**

   U.S. Department of Health and Human Services. (2017, August 22). *Anorexia nervosa*. www.mentalhealth.gov/what-to-look-for/eating-disorders/anorexia

5. **Newspaper article**. If you accessed the print edition, include the page numbers.

   Blackman, A. (2014, November 10). Can money buy you happiness? *The Wall Street Journal.* https://www.wsj.com/articles/can-money-buy-happiness-heres-what-science-has-to-say-1415569538

6. **Magazine article.** The following shows an article accessed online. If the article is accessed in print, list the page range (with no *p.* or *pp.* preceding it) instead of the URL.

   Treuer, D. (2021, May). Return the national parks to the tribes. *The Atlantic.* https://www.theatlantic.com/magazine/archive/2021/05/return-the-national-parks-to-the-tribes/618395/

7. **Journal article.** The first example shows an article accessed in print. The second shows an article accessed online, and the third an online database.

Note that DOIs are listed for all three sources, even the one accessed in print.

Lucas, R. E., & Schimmack, U. (2009). Income and well-being: How big is the gap between the rich and the poor? *Journal of Research in Personality, 43*(1), 75–78. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jrp.2008.09.004

Wehr, T. (1992, June). In short photoperiods, human sleep is biphasic. *Journal of Sleep Research, 1*(2). https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1365-2869.1992.tb00019.x

Cassidy-Eagle, E., & Siebern, A. (2017, July 18). Sleep and mild cognitive impairment. *Sleep Science and Practice.* https://doi.org/10.1186/s41606-017-0016-5

8. Review

Nussbaum, E. (2020, December 23). [Review of the book *Work in Progress*, by A. McEnany]. *The New Yorker*, 92–93.

9. Reference works

Merriam-Webster. (1993). Express mail (p. 411). *Merriam-Webster's new collegiate dictionary*.

10. Dissertation or thesis

Fraser, W. A. (1987). *Jazzology: A study of the tradition in which jazz musicians learn to improvise* [Unpublished doctoral dissertation]. University of Pennsylvania. UMI.

11. Editorial or letter to the editor

Quammen, D. (2020, December 13). A few words on behalf of bats [Editorial]. *The New York Times,* 4.

12. Article or short work on a website

Grohol, J. (2014, May 14). *Can money really buy happiness?* Public Broadcasting Service. https://www.pbs.org/thisemotionallife/blogs/can-money-really-buy-happiness

13. Social media post. Include the handle, enclosed in brackets, after the author's account name. If citing a posted photo or other media, include a brief description, enclosed in brackets. Note that APA allows for shortened URLs (see first example) when they are long or unwieldy.

LGBTQNation [@lgbtqnation]. (2019, November 9). *The American Psychological Association now requires researchers to use 'they' for non-binary people* [Tweet]. Twitter. http://tinyurl.com/vkfgyyq

Seco, Francisco [@francisco_seco]. (2021, April 25). [Photo of a man swimming in Oslo, Norway]. Instagram. https://www.instagram.com/p/COGpz9wjOLS/

14. Wiki entry

Arches National Park. (2019, December 13). In *Wikipedia.* https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Arches_National_Park

15. Interview

Gates, B. (2015, November). We need an energy miracle [Interview by J. Bennet]. *The Atlantic.* www.theatlantic.com/magazine/archive/2015/11/we-need-an-energy-miracle/407881/

16. Personal communication. Because personal communications cannot be recovered by readers, APA does not require that you include an entry for these sources in a reference list. Instead, cite such communications (including personal interviews, e-mails, and text messages) in the body of the text as "personal communication."

17. Live performance or oral presentation

Saunders, G. (2013, May 11). *Becoming kinder* [Commencement address]. Syracuse University, Syracuse, NY, United States.

18. TED talk

Smith, E. E. (2017). There's more to life than being happy [Video]. TED Conferences. http://www.ted.com/talks/emily_esfahani_smith_there_s_more_to_life_than_being_happy

19. Podcast

Glass, I. (Host). (2013, November 8). The seven things you're not supposed to talk about. *This American Life* [Audio podcast episode]. WEBZ Chicago. https://www.thisamericanlife.org/511/the-seven-things-youre-not-supposed-to-talk-about

20. *YouTube*, *Vimeo*, or other online video

Louisiana Channel. (2016, November 23). *Richard Ford and Colm Toíbín conversation: Narrators are unreliable*. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gTs9pPhzcmg

21. Film or DVD

Lean, D. (Director). (2012). *Lawrence of Arabia* [DVD]. Sony Pictures.

Loach, K. (Director). (2019). *Sorry we missed you*. Directed by Ken Loach, Sixteen Films, 2019. *Criterion Channel*, www.criterionchannel.com

22. Television episode

Pogue, D. (Narrator). (2021, February 17). Beyond the elements: Life. [TV series episode]. *Nova*, Public Broadcasting Service. https://www.pbs.org/video/beyond-the-elements-life-234qj4/

23. Advertisement

Howland Cultural Center. (2020, January 17). The Howland Cultural Center, Beacon, New York [Advertisement]. *The Highlands Current,* 12.

24. Map, chart, or diagram

Pemaquid Peninsula Heritage Group. (2016). *Bristol area* [Map].

APA: Title Page

The first page of a paper in APA style is the title page. In the header at the top right is the page number. Centered at the top of the page is the title of the paper in bold font. Below the title is the author's name, the institution, the course number and name, the professor's name, and the date, each on a separate line and all double-spaced (Figure 15.4).

FIGURE 15.4 Example: APA Title Page

1

Interesting Title That Tells Readers about the Paper

Student First Name Middle Initial Last Name

Institution

Course Number and Title

Professor's Full Name

Day Month Year

APA: Body of Paper

The body of a paper in APA style begins on a new page after the title. The title of the paper is centered and in bold font; it is not underlined, or quoted. The first line is indented and the paper is double-spaced (Figure 15.5).

FIGURE 15.5 Example: APA Body of Paper

2

Interesting Title That Tells Readers about the Paper

This example demonstrates how to format a paper in APA (American Psychological Association) style. One aspect of APA is a header with a page number in the upper right. To create a header in MS Word, go to View; then select Header. In the Header field, go to Insert and select Page Numbers to automatically number each page. The title page should be numbered 1 and the body of the paper should be numbered 2. In the body of the paper, use 12-point font: Times New Roman is a good choice. Double-space the paper including the heading, the title, and the body of the paper.

When you include researched information, often you will be quoting from the sources. If you include words exactly from sources—maybe because an expert said those words, maybe because those words say exactly what you need to prove a point—then put quotation marks around them. Also, you must acknowledge the source of the quotation. APA requires citing the author and date, as well as a page number for

quotations. For instance, if commenting on Mike Rose's Introduction to his book *Back to School,* one might write something like this: In his book *Back to School,* Mike Rose (2015) explains the importance of a community college as a place where students "could acquire knowledge and skill, develop a sense of competence as readers and writers and thinkers" (p. 6). If Mike Rose's name is not included in the sentence, then write the author's name and date in parentheses after the quotation with the page number, like this: One scholar notes that community colleges are important places where students "could acquire knowledge and skill, develop a sense of competence as readers and writers and thinkers" (Rose, 2015, p. 6). Notice that only the author's last name is used; that a comma separates the author's name and the date, and the date from the page number; and that *p.* appears before the page number.

3

If you use a long quote (one that runs over three lines), create a block quote. A block quote is indented two tabs from the left margin and is written without any quotation marks around it. A page number in parentheses follows the quote. For example, to use a long quote from Mike Rose's book *Back to School,* one might write something like this: In his book *Back to School,* Mike Rose (2015) explains how important attending a community college is for Henry, Jesus, and Jeremy:

> this college for these three young men proved to be a place where they could acquire knowledge and skill, develop a sense of competence as readers and writers and thinkers, channel desire into productive activity, come to terms with inner and outer demons, bridge social divides, take on a new way of being in the world (p. 6).

Notice how the quotation is introduced with the book title, the author's name, and the date in parentheses after the author, and a complete sentence followed by a colon. The page number is cited in parentheses after the quoted words. There are no quotation marks around the words; the indentation signals to readers that the words are taken from a source.

4

Sometimes you will want to paraphrase or summarize information from the reading. If the information is unique, specific, or you want to establish credibility by referencing a source, you might include a parenthetical citation with the author's name and date after the information. For instance, if you wanted to lend credibility to the idea that a community college education can change people's lives, you might write something like this: One professor and scholar explains how attending a community college profoundly improved the life of one former gang member (Rose, 2015). Be sure to format your paper and cite quotes correctly; attending to these details will make your writing strong.

APA: Reference List

The reference list begins on a new page at the end of the paper. It includes all the sources cited in the paper in alphabetical order by the author's last name or by the first word in the entry, if there is no author. All lines after the first line of an entry should be indented one-half inch. Title the page "References." Center the title and use bold font; do not underline or use quotation marks on the title. Double-space the list (Figure 15.6).

FIGURE 15.6 Example: APA References List

References

Blackman, A. (2014, November 10). Can money buy you happiness? *The Wall Street Journal*. https://www.wsj.com/articles/can-money-buy-happiness-heres-what-science-has-to-say-1415569538

Dalai Lama, & Cutler, H. C. (2009, October 1). *The art of happiness*. Riverhead Books.

Grohol, J. (2014, May 14). Can money really buy happiness? *PBS,* Corporation of Broadcasters and Reviewers. https://www.pbs.org/thisemotionallife/blogs/can-money-really-buy-happiness

Killingsworth, M. A. (2021, January 26). Experienced well-being rises with income, even above $75,000 per year. *Proceedings for the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America, 118*(4). https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2016976118

Park, J. (2020, August 20). *What makes us happier than money?* Greater Good Science Center. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=foqi_S-6XPo

Smith, E. E. (2017). There's more to life than being happy [TED talk]. https://www.ted.com/talks/emily_esfahani_smith_there_s_more_to_life_than_being_happy

SPOTLIGHT ON
STUDENT WRITING

Revising and Editing a Research Paper

Part 4 focused on planning and writing a research paper. Writing a strong research paper requires considerable time and effort, from developing a research question, locating appropriate sources, reading and taking notes on those sources, to organizing the notes, creating a thesis and paper plan, then drafting, revising, and editing the paper. Additionally, the paper must properly cite and document source information and be correctly formatted.

In this Spotlight chapter, you will focus on creating a strong research paper by

- Evaluating a draft for organization and development of ideas.
- Assessing a draft for proper documentation and in-text citations.
- Reviewing a draft for correct formatting.

EVALUATING A RESEARCH PAPER DRAFT

To understand the process of revising and editing a research paper you will first examine an annotated research paper draft. These annotations highlight how the draft could be improved, including how ideas can be better supported and explained, and how to ensure that documentation, citation, and formatting of the paper are correct. Then you will see a final research paper, one that incorporates the suggestions for improvement.

The research paper was written in response to the following prompt.

> ***Writing Prompt:*** *Research a problem at your college, in your community, or around the country. This should be a significant and recent problem. Your paper should be an informative essay that explains and analyzes the problem.*
>
> ***Requirements:*** *Your essay should be five to six pages and must use at least five sources as well as a visual element. Sources should be timely, relevant, and reliable. Format the paper in MLA style.*

Before examining the annotated research paper draft, you may wish to

- Review the chapter "Writing a Research Paper" to recall how to develop a thesis statement, organize ideas in the paper, and support those ideas with source information. Annotations on the left side of the draft focus on the development and support for ideas in the draft.

- Review the "MLA and APA Documentation" chapter to understand how to correctly cite sources in the body of the paper, create a list of sources at the end of the paper, and correctly format the paper. Annotations on the right side of the draft assess the citations, documentation, and formatting of the paper.

The research paper draft went through the processes described in the chapter "Planning a Research Paper" to locate sources and in the "Writing a Research Paper" chapter to draft a paper. The draft represents many hours of reading, writing, and thinking and is the final stages of the writing process: revising, editing, and proofreading.

Before Reading: Predict

Complete the following exercises.

1. Review the "Writing Prompt" given earlier. What does the writer need to do in the writing to create a successful paper?
2. Read the "Requirements" for the essay assignment. What does the writer need to do, in addition to addressing the prompt, to create a successful paper?

Annotations for Developing and Supporting Ideas

RESEARCH PAPER DRAFT

Annotations for Citations, Documentation, and Formatting

Dramatic opening but give more context for the wildfires

In 2020, wildfires in Colorado burned over 650,000 acres, a new record for the state. The same year there were more named storms (tropical depressions, hurricanes, or storms deemed severe enough to be named by the National Weather Service) than in any previous year on record. Flooding from these storms contributed to loss of life, power, and property across the gulf coast states, particularly in Louisiana, where five of the storms made landfall (Machemer). A continuing drought in the Western U.S. threatens food production in that region (Lustgarten). Weather events such as wildfires, floods, and droughts are becoming more extreme due to conditions created by global warming.

Paper needs a heading and title; number pages

Provide an in-text citation for statistics

A stronger thesis would include details about climate migration

These two sentences are correctly cited.

Add more support to this paragraph about other parts of the country?

Paragraph could more clearly focus on climate migration

Hotter temperatures mean longer and more dangerous fire seasons like those in our state of Colorado; heat can adversely affect the health of a

population. By century's end, a Southwestern city like Tempe, Arizona, could have average summer temperatures of 100-degrees and many people around the country might suffer heatstroke. Southeastern cities are particularly at risk, especially since the number of days with nighttime temperatures above 75 degrees Fahrenheit is increasing (USGCRP). "Exposure to high nighttime minimum temperatures reduces the ability of some people to recover from high daytime temperatures, resulting in heat-related illness and death." Scientists imagine that climate migrants will head north to escape the heat, mostly to the Northeast and Northwest, to places such as Vermont, upstate New York, Minnesota, and the Seattle area (Lustgarten).

Provide an in-text citation for factual information

Use the first words in the Works Cited entry in the parenthetical citation

Integrate quotation and cite it

Strong topic sentence

One of the most obvious factors that could prompt climate migration is food scarcity. As temperatures continue to rise, wildfires become larger and more common and the wildfire season becomes longer. As well, the Colorado River has been drying up. Much of the nation's vegetable farming is threatened by this declining flow. In the central Midwest, which is considered the breadbasket of the United States, heavy rain and cyclone seasons create flood conditions that ruin crops because of soil erosion. Farming will probably move north to states such as North Dakota where the growing season has increased by 30 days during the last century (EPA). Climate migrants, especially agricultural workers, will follow.

Provide more information about how the Colorado River is drying up

EPA is not included in the list of sources

Create a more logical transition from the previous paragraph

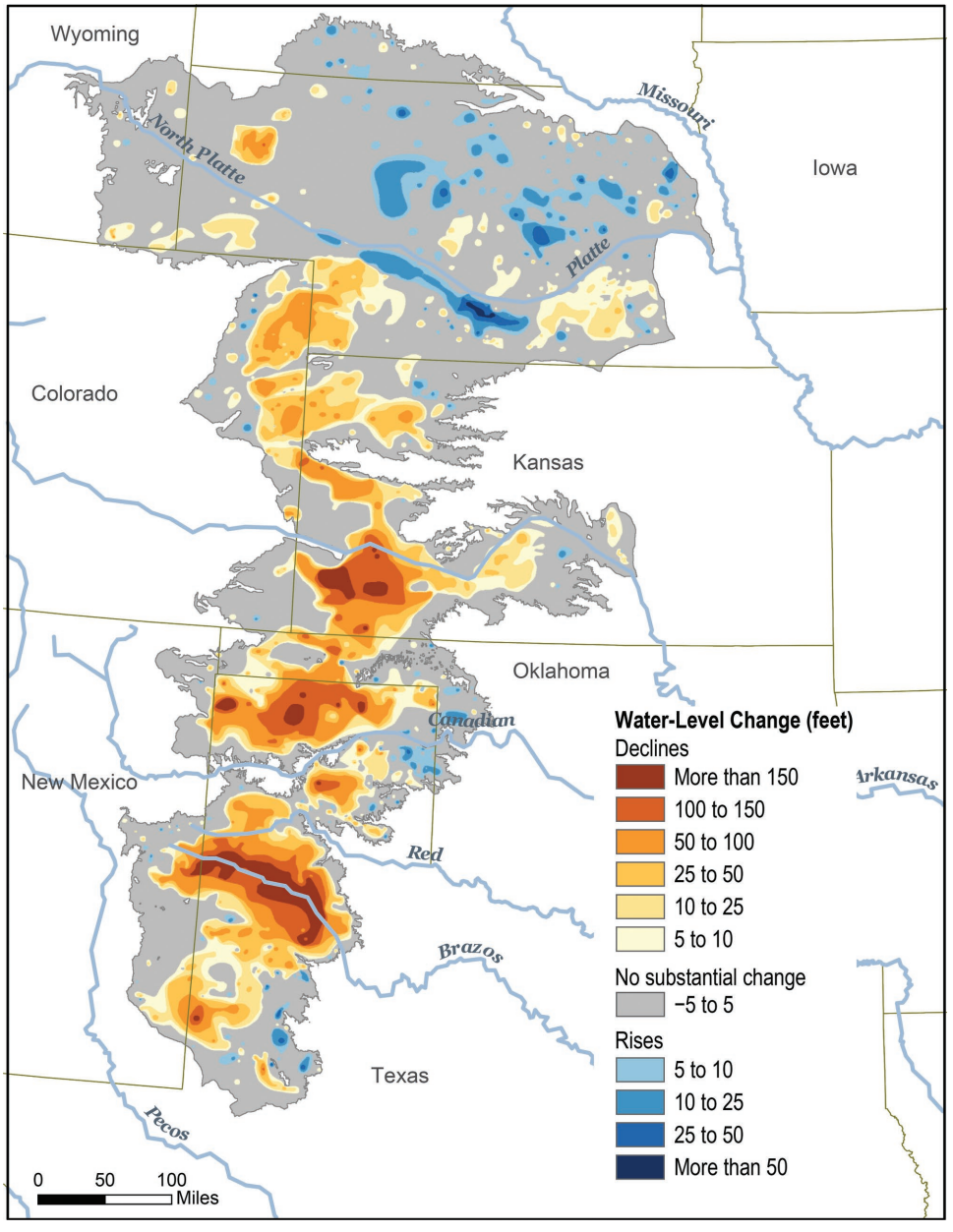
The *Fourth National Climate Assessment* mentions that rising temperatures coupled with less precipitation and reduced snowpack contribute to intense droughts. Drinking water and water for irrigation will become scarce as heavily populated cities in the South and Southwest deplete their aquifers, or underground water supplies. "The Memphis Sands Aquifer, a crucial water supply for Mississippi, Tennessee, Arkansas and Louisiana, is already overdrawn by hundreds of millions of gallons a day. Much of the Ogallala Aquifer—which supplies nearly a third of the nation's irrigation groundwater could be gone by the end of the century" (see fig. 1).

Integrate quotation and cite it

Appropriate reference to the figure, and a clear caption below

Fig. 1 Levels of water decline in the Ogallala Aquifer. The Aquifer provides irrigation to "one of the most productive farm belts in the world" (USGCRP).

Effective use of a visual—more support for the main ideas



U.S. Global Change Research Program. Adapted from McGuire, V. L., 2017: Water-level and recoverable water in storage changes, High Plains aquifer, predevelopment to 2015 and 2013-15. 2017-5040. Scientific Investigations Report 2017-5040. U.S. Geological Survey, Reston, VA, 24 pp. doi:10.3133/sir20175040

Develop this paragraph with more information, such as a quote from Nathan or factual information

The Colorado River Basin, which supplies agriculture and cities in the Southwest, including Los Angeles, is at dangerously low levels (Robbins). As water supplies diminish, climate migrants may move to cities such as Buffalo, New York, or Duluth, Minnesota, along the Great Lakes, which are the largest source of freshwater in North America.

Clear focus on climate migrants

Coastal erosion will also displace millions of U.S. citizens within the next century.

Explain who Colette Pichon Battle is to add credibility

Colette Pichon Battle describes the first time she saw a flood map detailing how the coastline of southern Louisiana will erode: "The graphic showed massive land loss in south Louisiana and an encroaching sea, but more specifically, the graphic showed the disappearance of my community and many other communities before the end of the century . . . Friends, neighbors, family, my community: I just assumed it would always be there. Land, trees, marsh, bayous: I just assumed it would be there as it had been for thousands of years. I was wrong." While larger cities such as New York and Miami might have the resources to build sea walls to keep the rising ocean at bay, residents of smaller coastal communities may be forced to move inland. After Hurricane Sandy, New York state offered buyouts to the residents of the decimated Oakwood Beach neighborhood on Staten Island. Around 80 percent of residents took the buyouts, understanding that storms like Sandy will become more common.

Indent long quotation

Provide a citation for statistics

As people begin to flee rising sea levels, wildfires, and dangerous heat indices, a new question has arisen: What role does economics play in climate migration? Aparna Nathan, who blogs about science for Harvard University, notes that better areas may see rising prices as storms influence where we live. In Miami, climate gentrification is already happening. Neighborhoods on higher ground are being displaced by affluent residents moving away from the waterfront.

Develop the conclusion more

Northern cities may be transformed and some are already preparing for an influx of climate migrants from the south. While climate gentrification is a troubling issue, if we work together and turn our attention to saving our planet, we can weather the storm of climate migration.

Works Cited

List of Works Cited should begin on a separate page, entries should be double-spaced and alphabetized, and entries should be formatted with hanging indents

Ingold, John. "Five Charts That Show Where 2020 Ranks in Colorado Wildfire History." *The Colorado Sun*, 23 Oct. 2020, coloradosun.com/2020/10/20/colorado-largest-wildfire-history/. Accessed 18 Nov. 2020.

Lustgarten, Abrahm. "How Climate Migration Will Reshape America." *The New York Times*, 15 Sept. 2020, www.nytimes.com/interactive/2020/09/15/magazine/climate-crisis-migration-america.html. Accessed 13 Nov. 2020.

Machemer, Theresa. "The 2020 Atlantic Hurricane Season Officially Has the Most Named Storms on Record." *Smithsonian Magazine*, 11 Nov. 2020, www.smithsonianmag.com/smart-news/2020-atlantic-hurricane-season-has-most-named-storms-record-180976272/. Accessed 14 Nov. 2020.

Nestel, M.L. "American Refugees: How Climate Change Might Force U.S. Migration North and Where They Could Go." *Newsweek*, 22 Mar. 2019, www.newsweek.com/american-climate-change-refugees-flooding-moving-north-duluth-1372203. Accessed 12 Nov. 2020.

Robbins, Jim. "On the Water-Starved Colorado River, Drought Is the New Normal." *Yale Environment 360*, 22 Jan. 2019, e360.yale.edu/features/on-the-water-starved-colorado-river-drought-is-the-new-normal. Accessed 15 Nov. 2020.

Pichon Battle, Colette. "TEDTalks: Colette Pichon Battle—Climate Change Will Displace Millions. Here's How We Prepare." *Films On Demand*, Films Media Group, 2020, avod.infobase.com/PortalPlaylists.aspx?wID=237224&xtid=209733. Accessed 9 Nov. 2020.

United States Environmental Protection Agency. "What Climate Change Means for North Dakota." Aug. 2016, 19january2017snapshot.epa.gov/sites/production/files/2016-09/documents/climate-change-nd.pdf. Accessed 16 Nov. 2020.

United States Global Change Research Program (USGCRP). *Impacts, Risks, and Adaptation in the United States: Fourth National Climate Assessment, Volume II*, edited by David Reidmiller, et al., U.S. Global Change Research Program, 2018, nca2018.globalchange.gov/. Accessed 12 Nov. 2020.

Check that each source on the Works Cited page is used in the paper and, conversely, that each cited source in the paper corresponds to an entry on the Works Cited page

APPLYING COMMENTS TO IMPROVE A RESEARCH PAPER DRAFT

While the research paper draft has many strengths, it could be improved in several areas. After receiving feedback—whether from another reader or from your own assessment of the draft—a sound strategy is to make a list of ways to improve the paper, then use that list to guide the revision and editing processes.

To sum up the comments about the organization and development:

- The thesis statement could be more specific about the impacts of weather events on climate migration, which is the focus of the paper.
- The focus on climate migration could be clearer in topic sentences and in closing sentences in paragraphs.
- Some paragraphs could be developed with more factual information from sources or quotes from experts.
- The introduction and conclusion could be developed to be more engaging and to include important ideas covered in the paper.

To sum up the comments about the citations, documentation, and paper formatting:

- Paper needs a heading and title; pages should be numbered in the upper right corner with last name and page number.
- In body paragraphs, sentences that include factual information and statistics from sources must have in-text citations.
- In-text citations should correspond to an entry on the Works Cited page.
- Short quotations must be integrated and cited; long quotations should be indented.
- The Works Cited page needs to begin on a separate page and be titled “Works Cited”; entries should be double-spaced and alphabetized and formatted with hanging indents.

With a list, you can tackle each area one-by-one, starting with the organization and development, then proceeding to the citations, documentation, and formatting. Do not feel you must improve all aspects of the paper in one pass; a more reasonable strategy is to focus on one (or two) key areas, make changes or additions, then return to the list to focus on other areas of improvement. This will make the revision process more manageable and thorough.

What appears next is a revised and edited research paper that takes into account the comments for improvement. As you read the research paper final draft, pay close attention to the following:

- How the writer edited the introduction, improved the focus of topic sentences, developed the content of body paragraphs, and revised the conclusion
- How the writer cites and integrates quotes, revised the Works Cited page, and formatted the paper in MLA style

Jamie Ferrante
Professor Estes
English 101
4 Dec. 2020

Taking Refuge: Climate Migration in the United States

Summertime in Northern Colorado means hiking in the foothills with friends, tubing down the Poudre River, and hanging out at backyard barbeques. But last summer, as the Cameron Peak Fire raged just west of Fort Collins, these fun activities were overshadowed by hazardous air quality and the need to help those fleeing the fire. Many residents who lost homes in the mountains said they would not rebuild, but would relocate to less fire-prone regions. In 2020, wildfires in Colorado burned over 650,000 acres, a new record for the state (Ingold). The same year there were more named storms (tropical depressions, hurricanes, or storms deemed severe enough to be named by the National Weather Service) than in any previous year on record. Flooding from these storms contributed to loss of life, power, and property across the gulf coast states, particularly in Louisiana, where five of the storms made landfall (Machemer). A continuing drought in the Western U.S. threatens food production in that region (Lustgarten). As weather events such as wildfires, floods, and droughts become more extreme due to conditions created by global warming, scientists predict that citizens in affected areas of the country will move to more hospitable locales. Severe climate events will create a new class of citizen: the climate migrant.

Climate migration in the United States will be caused by many factors, one of which is heat. Not only do hotter temperatures mean longer and more dangerous fire seasons like those in our state of Colorado, heat can adversely affect the health of a population. *The New York Times* reports that by century's end, a Southwestern city like Tempe, Arizona, could have average summer temperatures of 100-degrees (Lustgarten). As well, the report indicates "100 million Americans—largely in the Mississippi River Basin from Louisiana to Wisconsin—will increasingly face humidity so extreme that working

outside or playing school sports could cause heatstroke" (Lustgarten). Southeastern cities are particularly at risk, especially since the number of days with nighttime temperatures above 75 degrees Fahrenheit is increasing (USGCRP). The *Fourth National Climate Report* goes on to note: "Exposure to high nighttime minimum temperatures reduces the ability of some people to recover from high daytime temperatures, resulting in heat-related illness and death" (USGCRP). Scientists imagine that climate migrants will head north to escape the heat, mostly to the Northeast and Northwest, to places such as Vermont, upstate New York, Minnesota, and the Seattle area (Lustgarten).

One of the most obvious factors that could prompt climate migration is food scarcity. The ecosystems that support livestock and crop production are at risk in different ways. As temperatures continue to rise, wildfires become larger and more common and the wildfire season becomes longer. According to the *Fourth National Climate Assessment*, grasslands, rangeland, and forests that support livestock account for over half the land in the U.S., and wildfires are a normal occurrence in these ecosystems (USGCRP). A longer wildfire season puts livestock at risk, threatening a major source of sustenance for many people. As well, Abrahm Lustgarten of *The New York Times* reports that "the average flow of the Colorado River . . . has declined for most of the last 33 years." Much of the nation's vegetable farming is threatened by this declining flow. In the central Midwest, which is considered the breadbasket of the United States, heavy rain and cyclone seasons create flood conditions that erode the precious topsoil on which farmers depend for their crops. When topsoil erodes, not only are crops reduced, but large stocks of carbon and nutrients stored in the topsoil are lost (USGCRP). As soil erosion takes its toll and temperatures rise past acceptable levels for prime growing conditions, farming of the nation's most prevalent crops, corn and soy, may move north to states such as North Dakota where the growing season has increased by 30 days during the last century (EPA). Climate migrants, especially agricultural workers, will follow.

Drought, or water scarcity, could also play a role in climate migration. The *Fourth National Climate Assessment* mentions that rising temperatures coupled with less precipitation and reduced snowpack

contribute to intense droughts (USGCRP). Drinking water and water for irrigation will become scarce as heavily populated cities in the South and Southwest deplete their aquifers, or underground water supplies. *The New York Times* notes: "The Memphis Sands Aquifer, a crucial water supply for Mississippi, Tennessee, Arkansas and Louisiana, is already overdrawn by hundreds of millions of gallons a day. Much of the Ogallala Aquifer—which supplies nearly a third of the nation's irrigation groundwater could be gone by the end of the century" (see fig. 1).

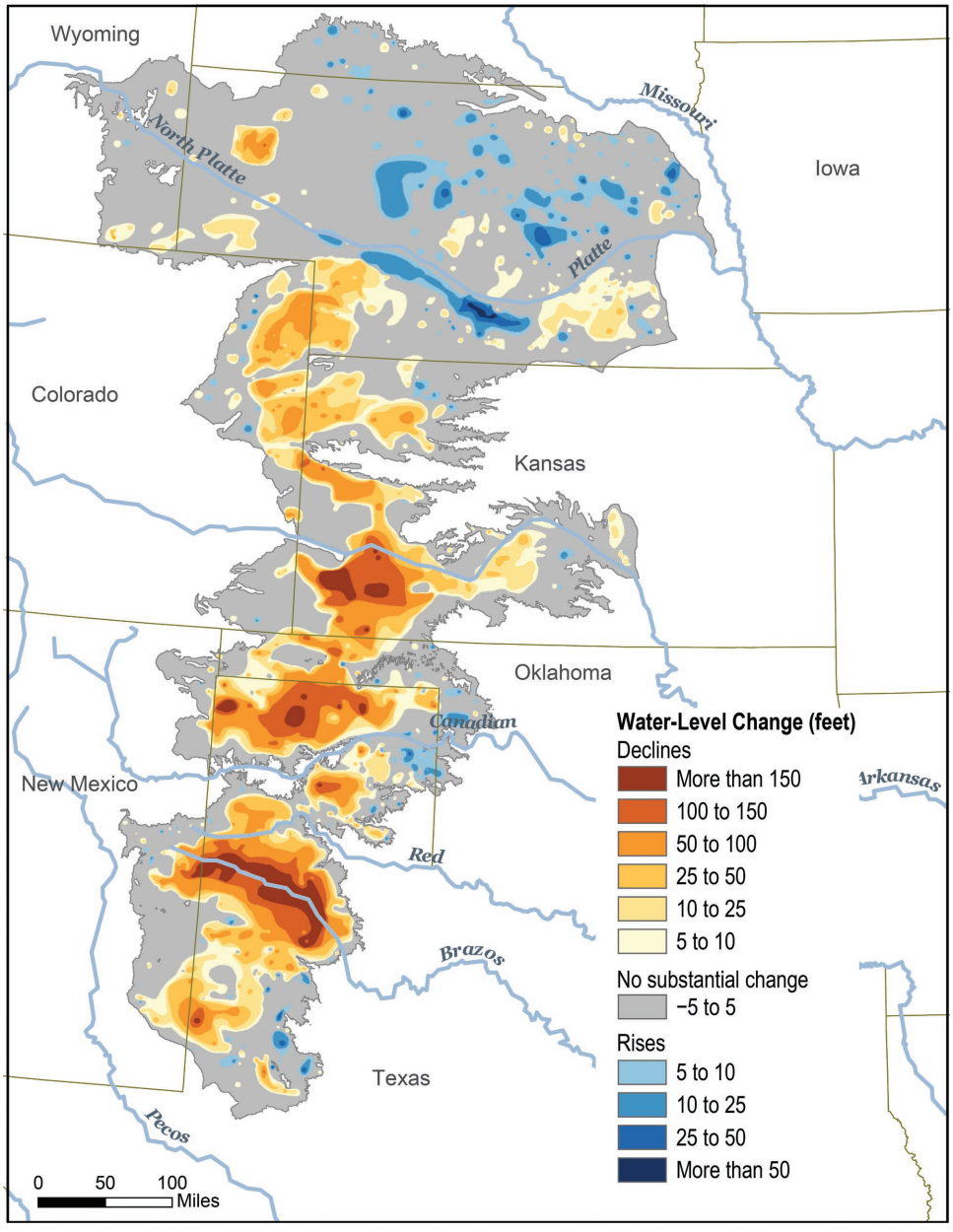
The Colorado River Basin, which supplies agriculture and cities in the Southwest, including Los Angeles, is at dangerously low levels (Robbins). As water supplies diminish, climate migrants may move to cities such as Buffalo, New York, or Duluth, Minnesota, along the Great Lakes, which are the largest source of freshwater in North America.

Coastal erosion, or the loss of land to rising ocean waters, will also displace millions of U.S. citizens within the next century. Climate activist Colette Pichon Battle describes the first time she saw a flood map detailing how the coastline of southern Louisiana will erode:

> The graphic showed massive land loss in south Louisiana and an encroaching sea, but more specifically, the graphic showed the disappearance of my community and many other communities before the end of the century . . . Friends, neighbors, family, my community: I just assumed it would always be there. Land, trees, marsh, bayous: I just assumed it would be there as it had been for thousands of years. I was wrong.

While larger cities such as New York and Miami might have the resources to build sea walls to keep the rising ocean at bay, residents of smaller coastal communities may be forced to move inland. According to the *Fourth National Climate Assessment*, an economic analysis shows that by 2050 between $66 billion and $106 billion worth of real estate will be below sea level (USGCRP). Some island towns have already been abandoned, and the federal and some local governments are buying out homeowners in areas that are predicted to consistently flood as water levels rise. After Hurricane Sandy, New York state offered buyouts to the residents of the decimated Oakwood Beach neighborhood on Staten Island. Around 80 percent of residents took the buyouts, understanding that storms like Sandy will become more common (Nestel).

Fig. 1 Levels of water decline in the Ogallala Aquifer. The Aquifer provides irrigation to "one of the most productive farm belts in the world" (USGCRP).



U.S. Global Change Research Program. Adapted from McGuire, V. L., 2017: Water-level and recoverable water in storage changes, High Plains aquifer, predevelopment to 2015 and 2013-15. 2017-5040. Scientific Investigations Report 2017-5040. U.S. Geological Survey, Reston, VA, 24 pp. doi:10.3133/sir20175040

As people begin to flee rising sea levels, wildfires, and dangerous heat indices, a new question has arisen: What role does economics play in climate migration? Aparna Nathan, who blogs about science for Harvard University, notes that climate resilient areas may see rising real estate prices as weather events start to influence where we live. She writes, "This phenomenon, known as 'climate gentrification,' will not only exacerbate inequality in cities already plagued by housing shortages and socioeconomic inequity, but also puts vulnerable populations right in the path of impending natural disasters." In a city like Los Angeles, which suffers from sea-level rise and wildfires, the working class might be squeezed out of Eastside neighborhoods that are less affected by climate events (Nathan). In Miami, climate gentrification is already underway as communities in neighborhoods on higher ground in that city are being displaced by affluent residents moving away from the waterfront. This displacement forces people to leave the social economic systems they are used to; minority communities who want to return home after a disaster are disproportionately affected by climate gentrification (Pichon Battle). "Mobility itself, global-migration experts point out, is often a reflection of relative wealth, and as some move, many others will be left behind," Lustgarten notes. On the other hand, "Those who stay risk becoming trapped as the land and the society around them ceases to offer any more support," explains Lustgarten.

Climate migration will become more and more common as the nation experiences an increase in severe weather events. Northern cities may be transformed and some are already preparing for an influx of climate migrants from the south. Cities that have experienced declines in the past decades such as Detroit, Rochester, Buffalo and Milwaukee will "see a renaissance, with their excess capacity in infrastructure, water supplies and highways once again put to good use" (Lustgarten). While climate gentrification is a troubling issue, as Pichon Battle suggests, "we must establish a new social attitude to see migration as a benefit, a necessity for our global survival, not as a threat to our individual privilege." In Colorado, that might mean welcoming our neighbors from the mountains and building sustainable, conservation-minded cities on the plains. If we work together and turn our attention to saving our planet, we can weather the storm of climate migration.

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Every stage in the writing process requires time and careful attention to the task at hand. When revising, editing, and proofreading a research paper, using a checklist can help you assess the writing as well as the citations and documentation.

Research Paper Checklist

Checklist for Writing	Checklist for MLA Format
___ Does the thesis reflect the main ideas and purpose of the paper?	___ Is there a heading on the left margin and a title centered before the text of the paper?
___ Do topic sentences accurately represent the focus of body paragraphs and sections of the paper?	___ Is the paper double-spaced and are pages numbered with last name and page number at the top right header?
___ Is the paper logically organized, such as by the point-by-point or block method, or moving from weakest to strongest points, or argument and counterargument?	___ Is information from sources properly cited in the body of the paper with in-text citations? Does each sentence that contains source information include a citation on the Works Cited page?
___ Are main ideas supported with sufficient, relevant, and varied information, such as quotes and factual information, from sources?	___ Are short quotations integrated into sentences and long quotations indented as a block?
___ Do the introduction and conclusion effectively set up and sum up the paper?	___ Is there a Works Cited page that includes all the sources used in the paper listed in alphabetical order, double-spaced with hanging indents?

Chapter Activites

1. What do you feel are the most significant changes in the final research paper that improved the draft?
2. If you are currently writing a research paper for your English class or for any other subject, annotate and analyze the paper. Identify the thesis and topic sentences; note the topic sentences and support for

the main ideas; then examine the introduction and conclusion. Finally, check that the in-text citations, the list of references, and the format of the paper comply with the expected documentation style. Use your annotations to evaluate and improve the paper.

3. If you are currently writing a research paper for your English class or for any other subject, exchange your paper with a classmate. Use the checklist for writing and for MLA format to provide feedback on areas where the draft could be improved. Use the comments on the checklist to improve the paper.
4. What have you learned about writing an effective research paper from studying the draft and final draft in this chapter?

PART FIVE

Anthology of Theme-Based Readings

Theme: What Barriers Do College Students Face?

Theme: How Can We Help People Who Are Unhoused?

Theme: What Makes Life Meaningful?

Theme: America: Land of the Free?

Theme: What Makes a Persuasive Argument?

THEME: WHAT BARRIERS DO COLLEGE STUDENTS FACE?

College students begin their higher educational journeys anticipating completing a certificate or degree, finding a meaningful career, and improving their lives. The unfortunate reality is that a significant number of students drop out, step away, or do not graduate from college. Their reasons for leaving are diverse, from financial pressures to health concerns, family obligations or failing grades, or not being familiar with the college system.

In this section, you will explore various perspectives on the barriers college students face, including internal pressures, such as anxiety, depression, and self-doubt, as well as external pressures, such as race-based discrimination or challenging classes or a bewildering bureaucracy. As you read, you may also consider ways to overcome these barriers.

READING SELECTION

"SURVEY: SELF-DOUBT IS A BARRIER TO COLLEGE"

Before Reading

1. The title of the Reading Selection states that "self-doubt is a barrier to college." What do you think is meant by self-doubt and how could this be a barrier to college?
2. Have you, or someone you know, ever felt as though you do not belong at college? Describe that feeling and why it exists.

During Reading

3. As you read, record the main findings of the survey mentioned in the reading selection, focusing on the barriers students face.
4. Consider which barriers reported in the survey you recognize in yourself or in college students you know.

Survey: Self-Doubt Is a Barrier to College

By Madeline St. Amour

Inside Higher Ed, 15 July 2020

This article reports on the results of a nationwide survey by the Strada Education Network, an organization that researches and supports links between education and careers.

Nearly half of adults who responded to a national survey said self-doubt is one of the largest challenges they would face if they enrolled in a postsecondary education or training program. 1

Self-doubt was one of the top three challenges respondents cited, below time and above cost. 2

The new data are included in the findings from the latest "Public Viewpoints" report from Strada Education Network, which surveyed American adults on their motivations for pursuing more education, as well as the barriers they face. 3

The importance of mental barriers was one of the findings that stuck out the most, said Nichole Torpey-Saboe, director of research at Strada. It's yet another layer colleges have to consider when trying to attract people without degrees for enrollment. 4

"As important as it is to make it affordable, they also have to think about how they can make students feel like they belong," Torpey-Saboe said. 5

Nearly half of respondents said it would be challenging to pursue more education because they fear they won't succeed or that they've been out of school too long, or both. 6

"I think the finding on self-doubt as a major barrier is one we should be paying closer attention to in higher ed," said Sarah Horn, CEO of ReUp Education. 7

Through her work with people who have some college credits but no degree, Horn has found that about 80 percent are motivated to improve their family's life or set an example. 8

"If learners don't see a way that they can become successful, they start to question if it's worth it—and that has large ripple effects," Horn said. 9

Paul Dosal, vice president for student success at the University of South Florida, also was surprised to see how high self-doubt ranked. The finding shows that institutions need to focus on students' emotional well-being, in addition to their academic and financial needs, he said. 10

Time and cost also are concerns, however. Nearly 40 percent of respondents said it would be difficult to get time away from work, and 35 percent said schedules and course times were a barrier. More than one-quarter also said balancing school and childcare would be a problem. 11

More than half of respondents said they would face at least one logistical barrier if they pursued further education, and about one-quarter said they would face at least three barriers related to time. 12

Equity Gaps With Technology 13

Other challenges flagged by respondents highlighted the digital divide. Urban residents and Latinx adults were most likely to say access to a computer or the internet would be a significant barrier in pursuing further education, followed by Black adults and rural residents. Suburban residents and white adults were least likely to say those things are a significant barrier.

"That's particularly timely right now," Dosal said. "We all suspect there is a digital divide, and this certainly confirms it." 14

The survey also found that one-quarter of adults plan to enroll in an education or training program in the next six months, but they would prefer to enroll in a nondegree program. 15

A combined 63 percent of respondents said that, if they were to enroll in a program in the next six months, they would prefer it to be a certification program or just a few courses to gain skills for work or to pursue personal interests. 16

Sixty percent or more of the respondents said advancing their careers and earning more money were the biggest factors in their decisions for pursuing further education. 17

This reflects a disconnect in what people know about which programs are most valuable, said Wil Del Pilar, vice president of higher education policy and practice at the Education Trust. 18

"Research shows that shorter-term credentials have very little to no financial impact," he said, adding that the greatest value is at the bachelor's degree level. It's possible that people also view these programs as cheaper, easier and faster compared to traditional degree programs. If they have self-doubt, they may be more inclined to take the program with less risk attached and that they perceive as less rigorous, Del Pilar said. 19

Of those who said they were not likely to enroll in a program in the next five years, many—42 percent—said they wouldn't get any real benefits at work from doing so. Another 19 percent cited health or disability reasons for not pursuing further education, and 13 percent said they couldn't make the time commitment. 20

The survey also looked at respondents' expectations around education. Slightly more than 40 percent said they were very interested in pursuing higher education after graduating high school. Only 36 percent of those without degrees or credentials said they felt they had a good understanding of their options for paying for further education when they left high school. 21

Adults without degrees who are now considering education also underestimate the time and costs to complete a degree, compared to national averages. They estimated it would take 2.5 years to complete an associate degree, while the average enrollment time is 3.3 years. They estimated the degree would cost about $18,000, but the average cost to complete is about $21,000. 22

The underestimation is even more pronounced for bachelor's degrees. Respondents estimated it would take 3.5 years to complete this degree program, while the average enrollment time is 5.1 years. They also estimated it would cost about $33,000. The average cost to complete is about $106,000. 23

Adults who don't have degrees also are torn on whether or not further education is valuable. Half think that further education would help them get stable jobs in times of uncertainty, 62 percent think it would advance their career and about half think it would be worth the cost. 24

This reflects a messaging problem in higher education, according to Del Pilar. The industry needs to message more around affordability and financial aid, he said, so people understand their options. Colleges also need to improve transferability and stackability, so if people pursue a certificate first, they can put that work toward a degree later on. 25

Del Pilar also emphasized alignment with workforce demands. If people feel higher education wouldn't help them in their careers, perhaps colleges should help people explore other careers where they can get more opportunities, he said. 26

After Reading

5. Write a brief summary of the reading selection, including the barriers students face.

Engage with the Reading

1. How might colleges combat self-doubt among students or potential students?

READING SELECTION

"SIX LESSONS TO SUCCEED AS A FIRST-GENERATION COLLEGE STUDENT"

Before Reading

1. Look at the title of the reading selection "Six Lessons to Succeed as a First-Generation College Student," and skim the article. What lessons do you anticipate the author will share?
2. Are you, or anyone you know, a first-generation college student? What advice might you give to students who are first in their families to attend college?

During Reading

3. As you read, mark the six lessons that Stefanco outlines for first-generation college students.
4. Consider which of the lessons resonate the most with you and why, whether or not you are a first-generation college student.

Six Lessons to Succeed as a First-Generation College Student

By Carolyn J. Stefanco

Diverse Issues in Higher Education, 14 November 2018

In this article, written as a letter to first-generation college students, Dr. Carolyn J. Stefanco, president of The College of Saint Rose in Albany, New York, shares her advice for being a successful student, based on her own experience as the first person in her family to attend college.

Dear First-Generation College Student, 1

More than 35 years ago, I packed everything I could fit into the old Pontiac 2
Catalina my grandparents helped me buy and drove halfway across the country to attend

the University of Colorado at Boulder (CU Boulder). I did not know what I was doing. My parents had not gone to college. Three of my grandparents had not even graduated from high school. No one in my extended family could advise me about choosing or preparing for college, let alone navigating a large university once I got there. I had to figure college out on my own because I believed that I could become the first in my family to earn a degree, and I had to find it in myself to be brave enough to try.

Coming from New Jersey, I knew I needed to become an in-state resident in order to afford the tuition in Colorado. So, I got a new driver's license, rented a tiny apartment and picked up three parttime jobs—working at Taco Bell, as a receptionist for an eye doctor and selling Avon door-to-door. This was my dream come true? 3

Many of you may have similar feelings, especially those of you who stepped onto campus for the very first time this semester. Your last few months have been filled with new experiences and emotions, lots of questions and maybe even a little doubt and apprehension as to whether you belong. 4

You do. 5

So as many of you prepare to return home to see your families for Thanksgiving and winter break, I urge you to reflect on what you have achieved during your first semester. Build on those accomplishments and continue to grow, keeping in mind that college is a learning experience for all students, particularly those like you and me—the first in our families to pursue a college education. 6

Here are six important lessons that I wish someone had shared with me when I arrived at CU Boulder. I encourage all first-generation college students to remember each of these points, especially during the first year: 7

- **Sometimes, college is a slog**. I was tired most of the time from working, going to classes, studying and commuting. See this as a short-term problem. Without an education, you may work at a job that will make you tired the rest of your life. 8

  Because there was no one in my family who could tell me the difference between a registrar and a bursar, I had to read things like the catalog myself (a paper document in those days) carefully and ask a lot of questions. With all the information I gathered, I made detailed plans for each semester. I ultimately managed to complete my major, a teaching credential, and a certificate in three and a half years.

- **You must ask for assistance**. Today, there are entire offices at colleges and universities with the sole purpose of helping students like you. Find the places where you can have every question answered and the people who will help you on your path. 9

  Higher education attracts faculty and staff who are serious about their work, and who believe in the transformational power of education. Trust me, they notice students who work hard. This does not mean that they expect you to be perfect.

- **Prioritize your studies**. If you put in the effort, you will succeed, despite the mistakes you will make along the way. 10

  As an undergraduate, there were times I doubted myself and worried. I routinely put off starting homework and assignments until shortly before they were due, probably because of self-doubt. I read a lot and took copious notes to prepare for projects, but I took a long time to get started on them. Always remember that you are in school to learn.

- **Be careful about developing bad habits**. The pattern I described above took me years to break. You will at times lack confidence. Talk to a professional, rather than finding ways to avoid a situation that makes you uncomfortable. 11
- **It is absolutely okay to be yourself**. You were offered admission to your college or university for who you are—with your strengths and your weaknesses, and the fullness of your experience. Today, higher education is more accessible to a wider array of people, and diversity and inclusion is practiced and celebrated on campus. Feel good about what you add to the community. 12
- **Think big about your future**. Be open to new opportunities, consider the suggestions of others and take advantage of study abroad and programs to learn about cultures not your own, and yourself, in the process. Because of the encouragement from others, I went from pointing myself toward secretarial school to envisioning myself in graduate school and, eventually, earning my Ph.D. 13

College is an exciting experience, one that will likely transform your life. Take it from me—a first-generation college student who went on to become a college president—your possibilities are limitless. I am rooting for you. 14

Sincerely,
Dr. Carolyn J. Stefanco

After Reading

5. Write a brief summary of the letter, including the six lessons Stefanco advocates for success.

Engage with the Reading

1. Write a response to Stefanco, explaining which lessons you agree or disagree with and why, or adding more lessons to the ones Stefanco proposes.

READING SELECTION

"ACADEMIA, LOVE ME BACK"

Before Reading

1. Consider the image before the blog post. What do you think will be the topic of the reading?
2. Have you, or any students you know, felt discriminated against by an instructor or teacher because of your race or ethnicity?

During Reading

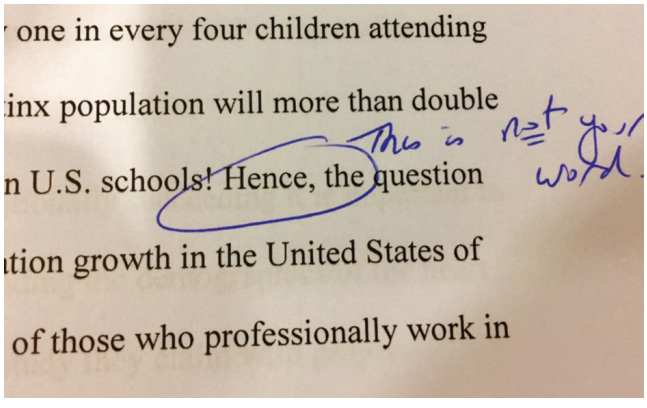
3. As you read, mark the main ideas and examples.
4. Briefly summarize the main point of each paragraph.

Academia, Love Me Back

By Tiffany Martinez

WordPress, 27 October 2016

Tiffany Martinez posted this commentary on her blog "words & art from an optimist" when she was an undergraduate student at Suffolk University in Boston.



Tiffany C. Martinez

My name is Tiffany Martínez. As a McNair Fellow and student scholar, I've presented at national conferences in San Francisco, San Diego, and Miami. I have crafted a critical reflection piece that was published in a peer-reviewed journal managed by the Pell Institute for the Study of Higher Education and Council for Opportunity in Education. I have consistently juggled at least two jobs and maintained the status of a full-time student and Dean's list recipient since my first year at Suffolk University. I have used this past summer to supervise a teen girls empower program and craft a thirty page intensive research project funded by the federal government. As a first generation college student, first generation U.S. citizen, and aspiring professor I have confronted a number of obstacles in order to earn every accomplishment and award I have accumulated. In the face of struggle, I have persevered and continuously produced content that is of high caliber. 1

I name these accomplishments because I understand the vitality of credentials in a society where people like me are not set up to succeed. My last name and appearance immediately instills a set of biases before I have the chance to open my mouth. These stereotypes and generalizations forced on marginalized communities are at times debilitating and painful. As a minority in my classrooms, I continuously hear my peers and professors use language that both covertly and overtly oppresses the communities I 2

belong to. Therefore, I do not always feel safe when I attempt to advocate for my people in these spaces. In the journey to become a successful student, I swallow the "momentary" pain from these interactions and set my emotions aside so I can function productively as a student.

3 Today is different. At eight o'clock this morning, I felt both disrespected and invalidated. For years I have spent ample time dissecting the internalized racism that causes me to doubt myself, my abilities, and my aspirations. As a student in an institution extremely populated with high-income white counterparts, I have felt the bitter taste of not belonging. It took until I used my cloud of doubt and my sociological training to realize that my insecurities are rooted in the systems I navigate every day. I am just as capable if not more so than those around me and my accomplishments are earned.

4 This morning, my professor handed me back a paper (a literature review) in front of my entire class and exclaimed "this is not your language." On the top of the page they wrote in blue ink: "Please go back and indicate where you cut and paste." The period was included. They assumed that the work I turned in was not my own. My professor did not ask me if it was my language, instead they immediately blamed me in front of peers. On the second page the professor circled the word "hence" and wrote in between the typed lines "This is not your word." The word "not" was underlined. Twice. My professor assumed someone like me would never use language like that. As I stood in the front of the class while a professor challenged my intelligence I could just imagine them reading my paper in their home thinking *could someone like her write something like this?*

5 In this interaction, my undergraduate career was both challenged and critiqued. It is worth repeating how my professor assumed I could not use the word "hence," a simple transitory word that connected two relating statements. The professor assumed I could not produce quality research. The professor read a few pages that reflected my comprehension of complex sociological theories and terms and invalidated it all. Their blue pen was the catalyst that opened an ocean of self-doubt that I worked so hard to destroy. In front of my peers, I was criticized by a person who had the academic position I aimed to acquire. I am hurting because my professor assumed that the only way I could produce content as good as this was to "cut and paste." I am hurting because for a brief moment I believed them.

6 Instead of working on my English paper that is due tomorrow, I felt it crucial to reflect on the pain that I am sick of swallowing. My work is a reflection of my growth in a society that sees me as the other. For too long I have let others assume I am weak, unintelligent, and incapable of my own success. Another element of this invalidation is that as I sit here with teary eyes describing the distress I am too familiar with, the professor has probably forgotten all about it. My heartache can not be universally understood and until it is, I have to continue to fight. At this moment, there are students who will never understand the desolation that follows an underlined "not." **There are students who will be assumed capable without the need to list their credentials in the beginning of a reflective piece.** How many degrees do I need for someone to believe I am an academic?

7 At this moment, I am in the process of advocating for myself to prove the merit of my content to people who will never understand what it is like to be someone like me. Some of you won't understand how every word that I use to describe this moment was

diligently selected in a way that would properly reflect my intellect. I understand that no matter how hard I try or how well I write, these biases will continue to exist around me. I understand that my need to fight against these social norms is necessary.

In reality, I am tired and I am exhausted. On one hand, this experience solidifies my desire to keep going and earn a PhD but on the other it is a confirmation of how I always knew others saw me. I am so emotional about this paper because in the phrase "this is not your word," I look down at a blue inked reflection of how I see myself when I am most suspicious of my own success. The grade on my paper was not a letter, but two words: "needs work." And it's true. I am going to graduate in May and enter a grad program that will probably not have many people who look like me. The entire field of academia is broken and erases the narratives of people like me. We all have work to do to fix the lack of diversity and understanding among marginalized communities. We all have work to do. 8

Academia needs work. 9

After Reading

5. Why does Martinez begin the blog by describing her accomplishments? How does information help her credibility or bolster her argument?
6. Why does Martinez end her post by stating "Academia needs work"? What does she mean by this?

Engage with the Reading

1. Do you feel that Martinez was wrongly accused of plagiarism because she is Latina? Why or why not?
2. Do you think her instructor handled the situation professionally? If not, what might the instructor have done differently?

READING SELECTION

"LAZINESS DOES NOT EXIST: BUT UNSEEN BARRIERS DO"

Before Reading

1. The title of the reading selection is "Laziness Does Not Exist." Do you believe that "laziness" is real or that this does not exist?
2. The subtitle of the reading selection mentions "Unseen Barriers." What "unseen barriers" might exist for college students?

During Reading

3. As you read, mark the main ideas of the reading and the examples used to support the main ideas.
4. During your reading, make notes as to which ideas or examples resonate with you and which you find disagreeable.

Laziness Does Not Exist: But Unseen Barriers Do

By Devon Price

Human Parts, 23 March 2018

Dr. Devon Price (they/them) is a social psychologist at Loyola University in Chicago. They have written a book, also titled "Laziness Does Not Exist," about the "laziness lie": the false belief that people do not work hard enough or students do not try hard enough.

I've been a psychology professor since 2012. In the past six years, I've witnessed students of all ages procrastinate on papers, skip presentation days, miss assignments, and let due dates fly by. I've seen promising prospective grad students fail to get applications in on time; I've watched PhD candidates take months or years revising a single dissertation draft; I once had a student who enrolled in the same class of mine two semesters in a row, and never turned in anything either time. 1

I don't think laziness was ever at fault. 2

Ever. 3

In fact, I don't believe that laziness exists. 4

I'm a social psychologist, so I'm interested primarily in the situational and contextual factors that drive human behavior. When you're seeking to predict or explain a person's actions, looking at the social norms, and the person's context, is usually a pretty safe bet. Situational constraints typically predict behavior far better than personality, intelligence, or other individual-level traits. 5

So when I see a student failing to complete assignments, missing deadlines, or not delivering results in other aspects of their life, I'm moved to ask: what are the situational factors holding this student back? What needs are currently not being met? And, when it comes to behavioral "laziness," I'm especially moved to ask: what are the barriers to action that I can't see? 6

There are always barriers. Recognizing those barriers—and viewing them as legitimate—is often the first step to breaking "lazy" behavior patterns. 7

It's really helpful to respond to a person's ineffective behavior with curiosity rather than judgment. I learned this from a friend of mine, the writer and activist Kimberly Longhofer (who publishes under the name Mik Everett). Kim is passionate about the acceptance and accommodation of disabled people and homeless people. Their writing about both subjects is some of the most illuminating, bias-busting work I've ever encountered. Part of that is because Kim is brilliant, but it's also because at various points in their life, Kim has been both disabled and homeless. 8

Kim is the person who taught me that judging a homeless person for wanting to buy alcohol or cigarettes is utter folly. When you're homeless, the nights are cold, the world 9

is unfriendly, and everything is painfully uncomfortable. Whether you're sleeping under a bridge, in a tent, or at a shelter, it's hard to rest easy. You are likely to have injuries or chronic conditions that bother you persistently, and little access to medical care to deal with it. You probably don't have much healthy food.

10 In that chronically uncomfortable, over-stimulating context, needing a drink or some cigarettes makes [. . .] sense. As Kim explained to me, if you're laying out in the freezing cold, drinking some alcohol may be the only way to warm up and get to sleep. If you're under-nourished, a few smokes may be the only thing that kills the hunger pangs. And if you're dealing with all this while also fighting an addiction, then yes, sometimes you just need to score whatever will make the withdrawal symptoms go away, so you can survive.

11 Few people who haven't been homeless think this way. They want to moralize the decisions of poor people, perhaps to comfort themselves about the injustices of the world. For many, it's easier to think homeless people are, in part, responsible for their suffering than it is to acknowledge the situational factors.

12 And when you don't fully understand a person's context—what it feels like to be them every day, all the small annoyances and major traumas that define their life—it's easy to impose abstract, rigid expectations on a person's behavior. *All homeless people should put down the bottle and get to work. Never mind that most of them have mental health symptoms and physical ailments, and are fighting constantly to be recognized as human. Never mind that they are unable to get a good night's rest or a nourishing meal for weeks or months on end. Never mind that even in my comfortable, easy life, I can't go a few days without craving a drink or making an irresponsible purchase. They have to do better.*

13 But they're already doing the best they can. I've known homeless people who worked full-time jobs, and who devoted themselves to the care of other people in their communities. A lot of homeless people have to navigate bureaucracies constantly, interfacing with social workers, case workers, police officers, shelter staff, Medicaid staff, and a slew of charities both well-meaning *and* condescending. It's a lot of [. . .] work to be homeless. And when a homeless or poor person runs out of steam and makes a "bad decision," there's a damn good reason for it.

14 If a person's behavior doesn't make sense to you, it is because you are missing a part of their context. It's that simple. I'm so grateful to Kim and their writing for making me aware of this fact. No psychology class, at any level, taught me that. But now that it is a lens that I have, I find myself applying it to all kinds of behaviors that are mistaken for signs of moral failure—and I've yet to find one that can't be explained and empathized with.

15 Let's look at a sign of academic "laziness" that I believe is anything but: procrastination.

16 People love to blame procrastinators for their behavior. Putting off work sure looks lazy, to an untrained eye. Even the people who are actively doing the procrastinating can mistake their behavior for laziness. You're supposed to be doing something, and you're not doing it—that's a moral failure right? That means you're weak-willed, unmotivated, and lazy, doesn't it?

17 For decades, psychological research has been able to explain procrastination as a functioning problem, not a consequence of laziness. When a person fails to begin a

project that they care about, it's typically due to either a) anxiety about their attempts not being "good enough" or b) confusion about what the first steps of the task are. Not laziness. In fact, procrastination is more likely when the task is meaningful and the individual cares about doing it well.

When you're paralyzed with fear of failure, or you don't even know how to begin a massive, complicated undertaking, it's damn hard to get [it] done. It has nothing to do with desire, motivation, or moral upstandingness. Procrastinators can will themselves to work for hours; they can sit in front of a blank word document, doing nothing else, and torture themselves; they can pile on the guilt again and again—none of it makes initiating the task any easier. In fact, their desire to get the damn thing done may worsen their stress and make starting the task harder. 18

The solution, instead, is to look for what is holding the procrastinator back. If anxiety is the major barrier, the procrastinator actually needs to walk away from the computer/book/word document and engage in a relaxing activity. Being branded "lazy" by other people is likely to lead to the exact *opposite* behavior. 19

Often, though, the barrier is that procrastinators have executive functioning challenges—they struggle to divide a large responsibility into a series of discrete, specific, and ordered tasks. Here's an example of executive functioning in action: I completed my dissertation (from proposal to data collection to final defense) in a little over a year. I was able to write my dissertation pretty easily and quickly because I knew that I had to a) compile research on the topic, b) outline the paper, c) schedule regular writing periods, and d) chip away at the paper, section by section, day by day, according to a schedule I had pre-determined. 20

Nobody had to teach me to slice up tasks like that. And nobody had to force me to adhere to my schedule. Accomplishing tasks like this is consistent with how my analytical, Autistic, hyper-focused brain works. Most people don't have that ease. They need an external structure to keep them writing—regular writing group meetings with friends, for example—and deadlines set by someone else. When faced with a major, massive project, most people want advice for how to divide it into smaller tasks, and a timeline for completion. In order to track progress, most people require organizational tools, such as a to-do list, calendar, datebook, or syllabus. 21

Needing or benefiting from such things doesn't make a person lazy. It just means they have needs. The more we embrace that, the more we can help people thrive. 22

I had a student who was skipping class. Sometimes I'd see her lingering near the building, right before class was about to start, looking tired. Class would start, and she wouldn't show up. When she was present in class, she was a bit withdrawn; she sat in the back of the room, eyes down, energy low. She contributed during small group work, but never talked during larger class discussions. 23

A lot of my colleagues would look at this student and think she was lazy, disorganized, or apathetic. I know this because I've *heard* how they talk about under-performing students. There's often rage and resentment in their words and tone—*why won't this student take my class seriously? Why won't they make me feel important, interesting, smart?* 24

But my class had a unit on mental health stigma. It's a passion of mine, because I'm a neuroatypical psychologist. I know how unfair my field is to people like me. The class & I talked about the unfair judgments people levy against those with mental illness; how 25

depression is interpreted as laziness, how mood swings are framed as manipulative, how people with "severe" mental illnesses are assumed incompetent or dangerous.

26 The quiet, occasionally-class-skipping student watched this discussion with keen interest. After class, as people filtered out of the room, she hung back and asked to talk to me. And then she disclosed that she had a mental illness and was actively working to treat it. She was busy with therapy and switching medications, and all the side effects that entails. Sometimes, she was not able to leave the house or sit still in a classroom for hours. She didn't dare tell her other professors that this was why she was missing classes and late, sometimes, on assignments; they'd think she was using her illness as an excuse. But she trusted me to understand.

27 And I did. And I was so, so angry that this student was made to feel responsible for her symptoms. She was balancing a full course load, a part-time job, and ongoing, serious mental health treatment. And she was capable of intuiting her needs and communicating them with others. She was a badass, not lazy. I told her so.

28 She took many more classes with me after that, and I saw her slowly come out of her shell. By her Junior and Senior years, she was an active, frank contributor to class—she even decided to talk openly with her peers about her mental illness. During class discussions, she challenged me and asked excellent, probing questions. She shared tons of media and current-events examples of psychological phenomena with us. When she was having a bad day, she told me, and I let her miss class. Other professors—including ones in the psychology department—remained judgmental towards her, but in an environment where her barriers were recognized and legitimized, she thrived.

29 Over the years, at that same school, I encountered countless other students who were under-estimated because the barriers in their lives were not seen as legitimate. There was the young man with OCD who always came to class late, because his compulsions sometimes left him stuck in place for a few moments. There was the survivor of an abusive relationship, who was processing her trauma in therapy appointments right before my class each week. There was the young woman who had been assaulted by a peer—and who had to continue attending classes with that peer, while the school was investigating the case.

30 These students all came to me willingly, and shared what was bothering them. Because I discussed mental illness, trauma, and stigma in my class, they knew I would be understanding. And with some accommodations, they blossomed academically. They gained confidence, made attempts at assignments that intimidated them, raised their grades, started considering graduate school and internships. I always found myself admiring them. When I was a college student, I was nowhere near as self-aware. I hadn't even begun my lifelong project of learning to ask for help.

31 Students with barriers were not always treated with such kindness by my fellow psychology professors. One colleague, in particular, was infamous for providing no make-up exams and allowing no late arrivals. No matter a student's situation, she was unflinchingly rigid in her requirements. No barrier was insurmountable, in her mind; no limitation was acceptable. People floundered in her class. They felt shame about their sexual assault histories, their anxiety symptoms, their depressive episodes. When a student who did poorly in her classes performed well in mine, she was suspicious.

32 It's morally repugnant to me that any educator would be so hostile to the people they are supposed to serve. It's especially infuriating, that the person enacting this terror was a

psychologist. The injustice and ignorance of it leaves me teary every time I discuss it. It's a common attitude in many educational circles, but no student deserves to encounter it.

33 I know, of course, that educators are not taught to reflect on what their students' unseen barriers are. Some universities pride themselves on refusing to accommodate disabled or mentally ill students—they mistake cruelty for intellectual rigor. And, since most professors are people who succeeded academically with ease, they have trouble taking the perspective of someone with executive functioning struggles, sensory overloads, depression, self-harm histories, addictions, or eating disorders. I can see the external factors that lead to these problems. Just as I know that "lazy" behavior is not an active choice, I know that judgmental, elitist attitudes are typically borne out of situational ignorance.

34 And that's why I'm writing this piece. I'm hoping to awaken my fellow educators—of all levels—to the fact that if a student is struggling, they probably *aren't choosing to*. They probably want to do well. They probably are trying. More broadly, I want all people to take a curious and empathic approach to individuals whom they initially want to judge as "lazy" or irresponsible.

35 If a person can't get out of bed, something is making them exhausted. If a student isn't writing papers, there's some aspect of the assignment that they can't do without help. If an employee misses deadlines constantly, something is making organization and deadline-meeting difficult. Even if a person is actively choosing to self-sabotage, there's a reason for it—some fear they're working through, some need not being met, a lack of self-esteem being expressed.

36 People do not choose to fail or disappoint. No one wants to feel incapable, apathetic, or ineffective. If you look at a person's action (or inaction) and see only laziness, you are missing key details. There is always an explanation. There are always barriers. Just because you can't see them, or don't view them as legitimate, doesn't mean they're not there. Look harder.

37 Maybe you weren't always able to look at human behavior this way. That's okay. Now you are. Give it a try.

After Reading

5. What does the author mean by "the situational and contextual behaviors that drive human behavior"?
6. Write a summary of the reading, including why Price believes that laziness does not exist and what unseen barriers they believe do.

Engage with the Reading

1. The author begins with an example of how people might judge a homeless person "for wanting to buy alcohol or cigarettes." What is the author's point and how does this example relate to college students?
2. Later in the article, the author describes a "quiet, occasionally-class-skipping student" who was dealing with a serious mental health issue. Why does the author include this student and what point do they make by describing her experience in their class, as well as in their colleague's class?

Writing Prompts for "What Barriers Do Students Face?"

1. Literacy narrative: Write a blog post in which you describe your experiences attending college. Consider including any barriers you have faced, as well as how you have overcome these. Model your writing on Tiffany Martinez's post "Academia, Love Me Back."
2. Literacy narrative: Write a letter to incoming students at your college giving them advice about how to be successful students. Model your writing on Carolyn J. Stefanco's piece "Six Lessons to Succeed as a First-Generation College Student."
3. Synthesis essay: Imagine the student association at your college has asked you to write an informational report on the challenges faced by college students. Based on the readings in Part 5, explain what barriers college students face and how students might overcome these.
4. Synthesis essay: Imagine the faculty association at your college has asked you to write an informational report on the challenges faced by college students. Based on the readings in the chapter, explain what barriers college students face and how faculty might alleviate these.
5. Research paper: Conduct your own research by surveying students at your college about the barriers they face. Compare your results with the evidence, examples, and conclusions in the various readings in Part 5.
6. Research paper: In your college library, locate three or more academically appropriate articles on the barriers faced by college students. Read the articles, compare the information and findings in those articles with the various readings in this section, then draw a conclusion about the barriers faced by college students.

THEME: HOW CAN WE HELP PEOPLE WHO ARE UNHOUSED?

Although the number of people experiencing homelessness may be hard to count, the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development released its annual assessment on homelessness in January 2021, estimating that 580,000 people in the country were experiencing homelessness. This number reflects a steady increase in unhoused people over the previous four years. Moreover, the report found that more individuals were unsheltered than were sheltered and that the number of unsheltered individuals in families with children increased.

For many of these unhoused people, lacking a permanent home or shelter is a problem. In this section, you will read different perspectives on how to assist people who are unhoused. Many of the solutions consider the reasons why people are without houses so as to better match the underlying problems with the proposed solutions.

READING SELECTION

"TO HOUSE THE UNHOUSED, HEAR THE UNHOUSED"

Before Reading

1. What do you believe are the primary reasons people experience homelessness?
2. What might be solutions to helping unhoused individuals?

During Reading

3. As you read, be alert for unfamiliar words. Mark these; then use context clues, word analysis, and the dictionary to define the words.
4. Identify the causes the author cites as to the reasons people are unhoused, and the solutions suggested.

To House the Unhoused, Hear the Unhoused

By Julia Irwin

Street Spirit, 1 December 2018

Street Spirit *is a monthly newspaper sold by homeless people in the neighboring cities of Berkeley and Oakland in California. The newspaper's mission is to give unhoused people a voice, as articles are often written by unhoused persons, as well as by their supporters. When the author, Julia Irwin, wrote this article, she was a recent graduate from the University of California at Berkeley.*

A new report confirms what many of Oakland's unhoused residents already knew: The scale of Oakland's homeless crisis stretches far beyond the 2,761 unhoused people that the city officially acknowledges. "Housing Oakland's Unhoused," published in October by the Housing and Dignity Project, reports that Oakland is home to as many as 9,297 unhoused individuals, a number derived from Alameda County's HealthCare for the Homeless analysis. 1

Three organizations tackling Oakland's housing crisis—The Village, the East Oakland Collective (EOC), and the Dellums Institute for Social Justice—comprise the Housing and Dignity Project, which collaborated with UC Berkeley's Goldman School of Public Policy to produce "Housing Oakland's Unhoused." The report seeks on the one hand to demonstrate the urgency and feasibility of immediate redress, and on the other hand, to dismantle misconceptions about homelessness, overwriting pejorative narratives with assertions of unhoused leadership. 2

The report cites Oakland's current median rent as over $3,200 per month. A renter making the median income and paying rent at this rate would spend 75 percent of each paycheck on housing—a significant jump from the 55 percent reported in 2014, and far 3

over the 30 per cent that the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development considers financially sustainable.

Increasingly, Oakland's unhoused residents are struggling with the unpredictability of a city in flux—not just with mental illness or addiction, as is commonly assumed. Candice Elder, the EOC's founder and executive director, points out that addiction and mental illness do not preclude the right to shelter and safety. 4

"That said, this isn't Reagan's chronic homelessness," said Elder. "It's a new wave. It's our brothers and sisters, our neighbors, our coworkers. People with jobs step out of tents well-dressed, go off to work, and no one knows they're homeless." 5

Needa Bee, the founder of The Village, was housed when she began her social justice work. Now, she is unhoused. 6

"I have a 30-year-old cannery business here in Oakland, and I'm a salaried program director of the Meiklejohn Civil Liberties Institute," said Needa. "I can't afford to live here." 7

As the report notes, Oakland's present-day unaffordability disproportionately affects African Americans—a state of affairs undergirded by a long history of racism and exploitation. The report traces Oakland's history along racial lines, from redlining in the 1930s to the racial targeting of subprime loans in the mid-2000s to the color of homelessness today. 8

African Americans represent 28 percent of Oaklanders, but 68 percent of the city's unhoused. Older Black adults face double the risk of losing their housing compared with other ethnicities, and African American families with children are the fastest growing homeless population. 9

Race also changes the lived experience of homelessness. Oakland's 14 anti-homeless laws—which, according to the report, "criminalize the homeless 'sometimes even for sleeping and eating'"—make unhoused people vulnerable to police intervention. When Needa and her daughter lived in their camper, police would frequently come to enforce an Oakland law that prohibits living in cars. 10

"My daughters look Black," Needa said. "To have the cops called puts them at a greater risk than me." 11

These interactions were so stressful for Needa's 16-year-old daughter that she pulled out of Berkeley City College, unable to concentrate on her homework. 12

If homelessness is an unsustainable hardship but Oakland's exorbitant rents put housing out of reach, why do unhoused people stay in the area? As Elder points out, unhoused people often rely on local support systems, networks of friends and family that may extend back for generations. Indeed, the report states that 86 percent of unhoused people in Oakland were living in Alameda County before they were forced to the streets—not "bussed in" from other parts of California, as many seem to believe. And because their lives are so locally rooted, in another sense, many unhoused people cannot afford to leave. 13

"Why should they?" said Elder. "Why should they be further displaced and traumatized, forced out of the city that they love, away from the people they love?" 14

Listening to unhoused voices was a practice that grounded the report. 15

"We shouldn't be deciding how people should live without their input," said Elder. "We made sure that we centered unhoused voices." 16

In their research, The Housing and Dignity Project held monthly "community listening sessions," inviting unhoused individuals to share their stories and voice their perspectives. The reported priorities—such as access to public services, options for healthcare, humane living conditions, etc.—come directly from these meetings. 17

The report's concluding proposals for actionable solutions are similarly grounded in the lived expertise and ingenuity of Oakland's unhoused residents. The most immediate proposal involves tiny home villages built on public land to host autonomous micro-communities. 18

While the ideas came from the bottom up, Margaretta Lin, Executive Director of the Dellums Institute, points out that the funding must come from the top down. 19

"The work cannot be done without government love," said Lin, "because government has the power to put their resources on the table." 20

According to the report, the tiny home villages could house 1,200 people for three to five years, and would cost around $9 million. And as the report reveals, Oakland's resources—government and donor money, as well as 50 public land parcels suitable for building new housing units—are, in fact, sufficient for implementing the solutions suggested in the report. For Lin, this came as a welcome surprise. 21

"I didn't know if the resources were going to be available," she said. "Turns out, there is enough money and sufficient public land. So if we just looked at the problem and solutions differently, we could provide housing for all our unhoused brothers and sisters right now." 22

After Reading

5. According to the article, what are the main reasons people in Oakland are unhoused?
6. What are the proposed solutions to helping unhoused people in Oakland?

Engage with the Reading

1. Are you convinced by the evidence that one reason for homeless is lack of affordable housing? Why or why not?

2. At the end of the article, it is suggested that tiny homes could house 1,200 people at a cost of around $9 million. Do you believe this would be a wise use of taxpayer money? Explain.

READING SELECTION

"FOOD, SHOWERS, TENTS: DOES THE HELP, HELP THE HOMELESS?"

Before Reading

1. Based on the title of the reading, what do you think the article will discuss as solutions to homelessness?
2. What do you think is the answer to the question posed in the title: does the help, help the homeless?

During Reading

3. Identify reasons why some people want to provide "food, showers, tents" to homeless people.
4. Identify reasons why some people object to providing "food, showers, tents" to homeless people.

Food, Showers, Tents: Does the Help, Help the Homeless?

By Amy Taxin and Geoff Mulvihill

Associated Press, 4 January 2018

California has more homeless people than any other state in the country. Southern California, known for its beaches and year-round warm weather, is a place where unhoused people can live outdoors, creating tensions in communities.

ANAHEIM, Calif. (AP)—Mohammed Aly does not see any reason why he shouldn't try to ease the lives of Orange County's homeless. But the authorities—and many of his neighbors—disagree. 1

Aly, a 28-year-old lawyer and activist, has been arrested three times as he campaigned on behalf of street people. Recently, he was denied permission to install portable toilets on a dried-up riverbed, site of an encampment of roughly 400 homeless. 2

"Put yourself in their position: Would you want a toilet, or would you not want a toilet?" he asked. "It is a question of basic empathy." 3

But his detractors—engaged in a dispute that rages up and down America's West Coast, as the region struggles to cope with a rising tide of homelessness—say Aly and other dogooders are doing more harm than good. However well-meaning, critics say, those who provide the homeless with tents and tarps, showers and toilets, hot meals and pet food, are enabling them to remain unsheltered. 4

And not coincidentally, they note, nuisances of homelessness like trash and unsanitary conditions fester and aberrant behavior continues. 5

In California, the San Diego County community of El Cajon passed a measure that curtails feeding the homeless, citing health concerns. In Los Angeles, city officials have closed and reopened restrooms for those on Skid Row amid similar controversies. 6

The issue is hotly debated across Orange County, a cluster of suburbs and small cities known more for surf culture and Disneyland than its legions of poor. 7

In the tony seaside enclave of Dana Point, neighbors fear a nightly meal is drawing homeless to a popular state beach where teens play beach volleyball and families picnic and surf. 8

On the dusty riverbed 30 miles north, a van furnished with shower stalls parks alongside the homeless encampment; those living in the string of tattered tents add their names to a list of dozens waiting to bathe. While the mobile unit aims to help those living on the trash-strewn strip, neighbors worry the 2 mile-long encampment is becoming more entrenched in an area where they once jogged and biked. 9

"If the ultimate goal is to get them under a roof, why on Earth are you giving all the advantages you would have under a roof on the riverbed?" asked Shaun Dove, a 10

46-year-old soon-to-be retired policeman from Anaheim, who lives less than a mile from the riverbed in a palm-tree lined neighborhood of three bedroom homes.

"There's no doubt that giving them stuff there prevents them from a desire to move." 11
The number of homeless living in Orange County has climbed 8 percent over the last two years. In the United States, homelessness rose slightly in the last year to nearly 554,000, pushed up largely by increases on the West Coast, federal data shows. The increase is driven by soaring housing costs, though a drug addiction crisis and need for mental health services are also factors.

Advocates say the homeless population has become more visible as police have 12
cracked down on rules barring camping, driving people from parks and bus benches to a few centralized locations, such as the flood control channel along the Santa Ana River in Anaheim.

Everybody knows that the only solution is more housing; there aren't enough beds 13
available in a county where the median home price hovers near $700,000. Until there are, many well-meaning residents want to try to alleviate what they feel is a humanitarian crisis by bringing food and other assistance to the homeless.

In a small community like Dana Point, there is no shelter. The nightly meals began 14
more than two decades ago at local churches but were moved to Doheny State Beach after a late night stabbing between two homeless residents.

The picturesque city on bluffs overlooking the Pacific Ocean is known for its million 15
dollar homes and scenic harbor. But homeless have long been drawn to Dana Point and other beach communities which offer public access and wide open spaces—and the beauty and sunshine that lure so many people to California's shores.

In the late afternoon, volunteers arrive at the beach parking lot with folding tables 16
and trays of chicken or beef or fish and fruit. They often also hand out a sack lunch for the next day to several dozen homeless, day laborers and poor who line up to eat after bowing their heads in a brief prayer.

The homeless say as much as they appreciate it, the food isn't keeping them on the 17
streets.

Gholamreza Haghighi, 59, said he has been sleeping in the nearby brush for more 18
than two decades—well before meals were served there—and has nowhere else to go.

Jose Luis Gonzalez, 60, said he has been living in his motor home since splitting 19
with his wife and sometimes stops by the suppers to see friends and have a meal. Another homeless man who refused to give his name said he heads there simply to eat.

"I come here because it's a Band-Aid," the 55-year-old said. "It doesn't help me 20
tomorrow. It doesn't. But it helps me today."

Volunteers say the homeless are drawn to the beaches because of the open space 21
and access to water and restrooms—not the meals. They feel that feeding people can build trust and lead the homeless to additional services, including housing.

After Reading

5. According to the article, what are some reasons to provide food or other amenities to people living outside?
6. According to the article, what are some reasons not to provide food or other amenities to people living outside?

Engage with the Reading

1. Pick a line from the reading that you find agreeable, quote it, and explain why you agree.
2. Pick a line from the reading that you find disagreeable, quote it, and explain why you disagree.

READING SELECTION

"COMMENTARY: WE NEED RENTAL ASSISTANCE AND SERVICES, NOT PUNITIVE POLICIES, TO END HOMELESSNESS"

Before Reading

1. Based on the title of the reading, what do you think the author will argue is the solution to homelessness?
2. What might be "punitive policies" targeting unhoused individuals?

During Reading

3. Identify the causes the author cites as to the reasons people are unhoused, and the solutions suggested.
4. Identify where the author anticipates objections to her arguments and counters these.

Commentary: We Need Rental Assistance and Services, Not Punitive Policies, to End Homelessness

By Peggy Bailey

Center on Budget and Policy Priorities, 27 January 2020

The Center on Budget and Policy Priorities is a nonpartisan research organization focusing on government policies to reduce poverty and inequality in fiscally responsible ways. Peggy Bailey has worked for the National Alliance to End Homelessness and as of January 2021 is a Senior Advisor at U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development under the Biden administration. This report uses Chicago Style, which relies on numbered notes, to cite sources.

The Trump Administration seemingly intends to abandon strategies for housing services and rental assistance that have been proven to help reduce homelessness and connect people to the health and social services they need. Among other steps, it recently appointed a proponent of punitive and counterproductive policies to lead its 1

homelessness agenda, and its proposal for addressing homelessness in Los Angeles seems to favor emphasizing criminalization and increased law enforcement over community-based health and social services. If proposals like this were implemented, it could result in unnecessarily detaining or arresting large numbers of people experiencing homelessness, confining them to shelters disconnected from community support services, and halting progress on declines in the number of people who successfully exit homelessness.

2 The Administration's shift in strategy ignores both the causes of and solutions to homelessness. Most people are homeless because they can't afford housing, so the best way to address the problem is to help them afford a place to live.[1] People experiencing homelessness can also have serious physical or mental health conditions or substance use disorders, but we have learned that, to address these challenges, most people first need stable housing to improve their health and thrive. The Administration should re-commit to interventions that work: well-funded rental assistance to close the gap between income and rent costs for those at risk of homelessness,[2] and programs that couple stable, affordable housing with community-based supports such as mental health and substance use recovery services for those who need it.[3]

3 For over 20 years the Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD) has taken a "Housing First" approach that has reduced homelessness by helping people find safe, affordable housing and connecting them to support services. This approach—which does not require people to meet pre-conditions to qualify for housing assistance—is based on evidence showing that people experiencing homelessness face serious obstacles to successfully reducing drug or alcohol use, managing mental health, or saving money for upfront rent costs, such as security deposits, while living on the street. This strategy, along with investments in key rental assistance programs, has contributed to declines in homelessness among veterans and other populations in recent years.[4] But more remains to be done, especially because some 3 out of 4 low-income households that pay more than 30 percent of their income on rent don't get the rental assistance they need due to limited federal funding, putting them at risk for housing instability, homelessness, and other hardships.[5]

4 The Trump Administration is taking steps in the wrong direction, supporting costly policies that keep people homeless longer, or worse, increase the number of people who experience homelessness overall. In December, the Administration appointed Robert Marbut as the new executive director of the U.S. Interagency Council on Homelessness (USICH), which is charged with coordinating how the federal government deploys resources to combat homelessness. Marbut is a longstanding critic of the successful Housing First strategy and proponent of punitive measures such as denying access to showers, food, or shelter beds to those struggling with substance use or exhibiting symptoms of mental health conditions. Such punitive measures fail to recognize that denying people these basic needs can exacerbate behavioral health conditions,[6] unlike Housing First strategies, which give people access to housing and community-based behavioral health services so they feel safe and get the help they need to manage their health conditions.

5 Another concerning step the Administration has taken is HUD Secretary Ben Carson's recent proposal asking Los Angeles to shift local policy and funding to support shelter construction and policing of people experiencing homelessness.[7] While details of

the plan are unclear, Carson offered the city access to federal property and unspecified federal resources for onsite services if it agreed to devote local law enforcement resources to address homelessness and build a centralized shelter on federal land, potentially diverting city resources away from strategies to permanently house people.

The plan raises concerns about wasting government resources and unnecessarily keeping people homeless for longer periods. Local law enforcement strategies might effectively criminalize homelessness by outlawing activities such as sleeping outside, sitting in public, living in cars, or panhandling, subjecting people to fines or jail time for not being able to afford a place to live. We know that criminalizing homelessness makes it harder for people to access housing. Public housing agencies and landlords typically screen out people for past involvement in the criminal justice system.[8] A person arrested for simply sleeping on a bench might have difficulty finding someone to rent to them because of the arrest, perpetuating their need to sleep outdoors and making another such arrest likely. 6

Moreover, significant investments in shelters and transitional housing[9] would be a first step in the Administration's apparent move away from the longstanding approach of using homelessness and housing funding for rent subsidies and community-based services. Emergency shelters, which help people in crisis and protect them from the dangers of living outside, are a necessary component of every communities' homelessness response system. But they are a temporary solution. Communities must dedicate resources to long-term housing assistance and community support services, otherwise people will remain homeless longer than necessary. The Administration's proposal would provide no additional federal resources for these permanent solutions and likely would result in Los Angeles shifting funding out of these areas to finance shelters and law enforcement. 7

"Housing First" Ends Homelessness for People and Is Cost-Effective 8

When emergency or transitional housing alone failed to stem decades of rising homelessness, practitioners in the early 1990s, starting in New York City, began experimenting with investments in long-term rental assistance coupled with community-based support services targeted to people who had experienced homelessness for over a year or had several recent periods of homelessness.[10] Programs that provided housing free from unproductive restrictions such as time limits and sobriety requirements were shown to be an effective long-term solution to homelessness, successfully housing people including those who had been without a home for years. State and local governments began to invest more in these programs, which showed that housing stability is a first step toward a job, better health, and improved quality of life. Both the George W. Bush and Obama administrations supported such policies, allowing homeless service providers, policymakers, public housing agencies, and other stakeholders to shift away from punitive practices that made housing a reward for people achieving certain behavioral markers[11] and toward helping people access housing first.

These efforts have contributed to significant declines in the projected number of people who experience homelessness on any given night, from over 647,000 in 2007, when HUD began reporting to Congress on homelessness, to about 568,000 people in 2019.[12] 9

HUD has examined the ways communities help people experiencing homelessness, including transitional housing programs.[13] A 2016 evaluation,[14] which studied the effects 10

of different housing and services interventions for families with children that were experiencing homelessness, provided guidance on the best ways to use limited resources, finding that:

- Transitional housing reduced the number of days families spent in emergency shelters but had no impact on other outcomes such as family stress, children being separated from families, food security, or adult and child well-being. 11
- Long-term rental assistance had the largest impact on families' housing stability, reducing by more than one-half the number of families that spent at least one night experiencing homelessness.[15] 12
- Other benefits of long-term rental assistance include reductions in food insecurity, psychological stress, alcohol or drug use, child separations from the family, intimate partner violence, and school days missed among children. 13
- Long-term rental assistance is also significantly less expensive than transitional housing and emergency shelters. Among studied sites, rental assistance costs were $1,172 per month per family—less than half of the costs for transitional housing ($2,706) and less than a fourth of emergency shelters ($4,819). 14

More research and program innovations are needed to address at all levels of government the systemic causes of homelessness, such as structural racism and its role in intergenerational poverty.[16] People of color are typically over-represented among people experiencing homelessness.[17] In 2019, Black people made up 40 percent of those experiencing homelessness on any given night, Hispanic people 22 percent, and Native Americans over 3 percent, all disproportionate to their U.S. populations (13 percent, 18 percent, and 1.6 percent respectively). Addressing homelessness and its disproportionate impact on low-income people of color will not only require significant new investments in rental assistance and other policies that raise incomes and educational outcomes. But it also requires undoing the continued effects of policies and practices—including redlining and exclusionary zoning—that excluded people of color and sometimes low-income people generally from high-opportunity, often majority-white, communities that have experienced better local investments in schools, job opportunities, and transportation.[18] It is notable that the Administration's recent attempts to unravel the nation's fair housing rules move decidedly in the wrong direction.[19] 15

Rental Assistance Is Needed 16

Unemployment, racial injustice, serious mental health conditions, chronic health conditions, and substance use can all factor into homelessness, but many people who experience homelessness are employed, and don't have serious health conditions. The one unifying factor is the inability to afford a place to live, and for most people with low incomes that means paying rent. Along with services calibrated to people's needs, any successful effort to end homelessness requires investing in rental assistance.

Since 2001, rent costs nationally have increased by 13 percent but median incomes for renter households increased by only about 0.5 percent.[20] Even in states with relatively flat rental markets, incomes haven't kept pace. In Ohio, for example, rent costs have only risen 1 percent but incomes fell by 9 percent.[21] 17

We know that rental assistance can fill the gap between rent and incomes and reduce homelessness.[22] However, there's not enough to go around: only 25 percent of those who need rental assistance get it, leaving everyone else likely struggling to pay their 18

rent. The housing affordability gap isn't due to a problem with rental assistance programs, but to a lack of federal funding.[23]

There is no reason to reverse course on federal homelessness policy. Instead, policymakers should invest further in what works: permanent housing, rental assistance, and strong community support services tailored to meet people's individual needs. USICH Director Marbut is right when he says there's a homelessness crisis, but the answer for it is scaling up what we know works, not repeating past mistakes.

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After Reading

5. According to the article, what are the main reasons people in the United States are unhoused?
6. What are the proposed solutions to helping unhoused people and why does the author believe these will work?

Engage with the Reading

1. What does the author mean by the term "criminalize homelessness"? Do you agree that certain behaviors should not be illegal because unhoused people are more likely to engage in those actions?

2. At the end of the article, the author claims that "the one unifying factor [of homelessness] is the inability to afford a place to live." Do you feel she makes a persuasive argument that this is true? Why or why not?

READING SELECTION

"SOLVE HOMELESSNESS BY ADDRESSING ITS ROOT CAUSES: MENTAL-HEALTH AND SUBSTANCE-ABUSE ISSUES UNDERLIE THE PROBLEM"

Before Reading

1. Based on the title of the reading, what do you think the author will argue is the cause of homelessness?
2. Based on the problems suggested by the title, what solutions to the problem of homelessness might the author propose?

During Reading

3. Identify the causes the author cites as to the reasons people are unhoused, and the solutions suggested.

Solve Homelessness by Addressing Its Root Causes: Mental-Health and Substance-Abuse Issues Underlie the Problem

By Richard Bebout

The Washington Post, 20 May 2016

The author is chief executive of Green Door Behavioral Health, a community organization that provides treatment and support services, particularly for mental health. The article was published in the Washington Post *and "the District" means the District of Columbia (Washington, D.C.).*

The District is full of examples of how the system is failing residents. 1

Last summer, The Post chronicled the story of Alfred Postell, a Harvard Law School classmate of Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. who experienced undiagnosed mental illness for years and ended up living on the streets. But that notoriety did not translate into more funding to address the problem. 2

More common are stories like that of Karl, who was referred to my agency, Green Door Behavioral Health, just before his release from the D.C. Jail. Green Door helped him find and furnish an apartment, and he recently slept in his own bed for the first time in 15 years. Karl has a stable home life and a supportive network around him, and that is a better predictor for his future than being in and out of shelters. It's also less expensive for the community. 3

The proposed budget from D.C. Mayor Muriel E. Bowser (D) includes a much-needed $100 million investment in affordable housing. And Bowser recently unveiled a 30-year, $660 million plan to provide new shelters for homeless families. 4

But Bowser's budget falls significantly short in addressing root causes of homelessness in the District: mental-health issues and substance abuse. 5

The 2017 budget for the Department of Behavioral Health, the agency that funds and regulates provider organizations, including Green Door, is essentially flat, resulting in a Band-Aid approach to problems that could be solved: ending homelessness, reducing incarceration rates, controlling health-care spending and closing the achievement gap in schools. 6

People with persistent mental illness and substance-use disorders make up a disproportionately high percentage of the District's homeless population. These are the people you probably think of when someone says "homeless." 7

Green Door's evidence-based programs move people off the streets and help them live productive lives despite being burdened with brain-based illnesses. But these programs need a baseline of funding that accommodates changes in care and costs that rise approximately 3 percent every year. Current rates are based on 2012 costs. 8

Thanks to a federal Medicaid match, an additional investment of $1.25 million from the District would put about $4 million in the hands of providers to serve District consumers. These dollars are spent on front-line services that take people off the streets and get them the help they need. An appropriate solution would tie reimbursement rates to inflation. 9

The D.C. Council has been addressing mental-health issues in recent years, and that's encouraging. 10

Also helpful is that the District recently received a $5.5 million, three-year federal grant to increase outreach and engage chronically homeless individuals. One successful model is Housing First, which is based on ordinary requirements of tenancy, such as paying rent and fulfilling standard lease terms, rather than participation in treatment. Research shows that people get better and accept recommended treatment sooner once housed, as opposed to making housing contingent on mandated treatment participation. In concert with supportive community service programs, the Housing First model has a phenomenal success rate. Lamp Community in Los Angeles reports that 95 percent of its clients stay housed for one year or more, and that is less expensive than incarceration or homelessness. 11

Additionally, the District participates in the Medicaid Health Homes program, a provision of the Affordable Care Act. The District's program is designed to improve health outcomes by increasing the coordination of health care for people with serious mental illness, who nationally have a life expectancy 14 to 32 years shorter than other Americans. Successfully implemented, Health Homes will provide another lifeline for those who have been shuffled through the system in the past. 12

Those living with persistent mental-health issues and substance-use disorders face daily challenges many of us could never imagine. As Bowser, the D.C. Council and the community work toward long-term solutions for the District's homeless, they need to remember that housing the mentally ill sets off a chain reaction of positive developments by helping them become productive, tax-paying citizens. 13

Housing this population now is an investment today with a real bottom-line impact tomorrow. 14

After Reading

4. According to the article, what are the main reasons people in Washington, D.C., are unhoused?
5. What are the proposed solutions to helping unhoused people and why does the author believe these will work?

Engage with the Reading

1. What evidence does the author provide that Green Door can improve the experiences for unhoused individuals? What more evidence might you like to see?
2. Are you convinced by the author's conclusion that "housing the mentally ill" is the solution to the homeless problem? Why or why not?

Writing Prompts for "How Can We Help People Who Are Unhoused?"

1. Response essay: Select one of the reading selections in this section and write a response to it, stating whether you agree with the author's explanations as to why people are without homes and the solutions to help unhoused individuals. If you choose, write your response in the form of a letter to the author.
2. Critique essay: Select one of the reading selections in this section and write a critique of it, focusing particularly on the explanations and evidence as to why people are without homes and the solutions to help unhoused individuals.
3. Comparison paper: Select two of the reading selections in this section and compare them, focusing particularly on the explanations as to why people are without homes and the solutions to help unhoused individuals. Determine whether both, or one, or none of the readings suggest viable solutions.
4. Synthesis essay: Based on the readings in Part 5, explain what problems homeless individuals face and what should be done to support them.
5. Synthesis essay: Based on the readings in Part 5, as well as the readings in the chapter "Critically Evaluating Texts," identify what problems homeless individuals face and what should be done to support them.
6. Research paper: Imagine a community group has asked you to examine the issue of homelessness in your area and present a report explaining what can be done to support unhoused individuals. Conduct your own research in the college library on the causes and solutions to the homeless problem in your community. Then draw a conclusion about the causes of homelessness and how best to support unhoused individuals.

THEME: WHAT MAKES LIFE MEANINGFUL?

The theme of the chapter "Responding to Texts" posed the question "What Makes People Happy?" While happiness may be an important goal in life, some people question whether happiness should be a priority, or whether having a

meaningful life is more rewarding. For instance, some researchers who study happiness note that happiness is more about immediate gratification and feeling good in the moment, whereas meaning provides long-term satisfaction and a purpose for living.

In this section, you will explore various perspectives on what makes life worth living. These perspectives include the belief that happiness is important to promote physical, mental, and emotional well-being: the idea that locating meaning, which is different for each person, provides a purpose for living. Finally, people, like other creatures, need to experience the world as a park, not a cage, to experience a full life.

READING SELECTION

"COMPASSION AS THE SOURCE OF HAPPINESS"

Before Reading

1. The title of the reading selection suggests that "compassion" is "the source of happiness." How would you define "compassion"?
2. What do you know about the Dalai Lama or about Buddhism?

During Reading

3. As you read, mark the main ideas of each section; use the subheadings as a guide to the main ideas.
4. Consider what evidence is provided for the main ideas.

Compassion as the Source of Happiness

By His Holiness the 14th Dalai Lama of Tibet

The Dalai Lama is the spiritual head of Tibetan Buddhism. Buddhism is a faith based on the teachings of the Buddha, who lived in India over 2,500 years ago. Buddhists do not believe in a supreme being, but instead strive to achieve enlightenment.

We are here; we exist and we have the right to exist. Even non-sentient beings like flowers have the right to exist. If negative force is exerted against them, then, on a chemical level, flowers repair themselves to survive. But more than that, we human beings including insects, even amoebas, the smallest beings are considered sentient beings. And as sentient beings, we have even more mechanisms to help us survive. 1

Things that can move under their own will or desire, that's what a "sentient being" means, according to the discussions that I've had with scientists. "Sentient" doesn't 2

necessarily mean being conscious or being human on a conscious level. Actually it's difficult to define what "consciousness" or "conscious" means. Usually it means the clearest aspect of the mind, but then, is it that there is no consciousness when we are semiconscious or unconscious? Do insects have it? Maybe it's better to speak of "cognitive faculty" rather than consciousness.

3 In any case, the main point that we are referring to here by cognitive faculty is the ability to experience feelings: pain, pleasure, or neutral feelings. Actually, pleasure and pain, and happiness and unhappiness, are things that we need to examine in more depth. For example, every sentient being has the right to survive and, for survival, this means having a desire for happiness or comfort: that's why sentient beings strive to survive. Therefore, our survival is based on hope—hope for something good: happiness. Because of that, I always conclude that the purpose of life is happiness. With hope and a happy feeling, our body feels well. Therefore, hope and happiness are positive factors for our health. Health depends on a happy state of mind.

4 Anger, on the other hand, is based on a sense of insecurity and brings us fear. When we encounter something good, we feel safe. When something threatens us, we feel insecure and then we become angry. Anger is a part of the mind that defends itself from what harms our survival. But anger itself makes us feel bad and so, ultimately, it is bad for our health.

5 Attachment is an element that is helpful for survival. So, even a plant, without any conscious element, still has some chemical aspect that causes it to protect itself and helps its growth. Our body, on a physical level, is the same. But, as humans, our body also has a positive element on the emotional level that brings us to have attachment to someone or attachment to our own happiness. Anger, on other hand, with its element of causing harm, pushes us away from things including happiness. On a physical level, the pleasure that happiness brings is good for the body; while anger and the unhappiness it causes is harmful. Therefore, from the perspective of the pursuit of survival, the purpose of life is to have a happy life.

6 This is the basic human level that I am speaking about; I am not speaking about the religious, secondary level. On the religious level, of course there are different explanations of the purpose of life. The secondary aspect is actually quite complicated; therefore, it is better to talk just on the basic human level.

What Is Happiness? 7

Since our goal and the purpose of life is happiness, what is happiness? Sometimes physical suffering can even bring a deeper sense of satisfaction like with an athlete after a grueling workout. So "happiness" means mainly a sense of deep satisfaction. The object of life or our goal, then, is satisfaction.

8 Happiness, sadness or suffering—for these, there are two levels: a sensorial level and a mental level. The sensorial level is common with tiny mammals, even insects—a fly. In a cold climate, when the sun comes out, a fly shows a happy aspect: it flies around nicely. In a cold room, it slows down: it shows a sign of sadness. But, if there is a sophisticated brain, then there is even a stronger sense of sensorial pleasure. In addition, though, our sophisticated brain is the largest in size and, therefore, we also have intelligence.

9 Consider the case of humans who feel no physical threats. They have a happy, comfortable life, good friends, salary, and name. But, even then, we notice that some

millionaires, for example—they feel that they are an important part of society, but often these people as persons are very unhappy persons. On a few occasions I have met very rich, influential people who showed a very troubled sense that, deep inside, they had a feeling of loneliness, stress and worry. So, on the mental level, they have suffering.

10 We have a marvelous intelligence, so the mental level of our experience is more dominant than is the physical level. Physical pain can be minimized or subdued by it. As a small example, some time ago I developed a serious illness. It was very painful in my intestines. At that time, I was in Bihar, the poorest state of India and I passed through Bodh Gaya and Nalanda. There, I saw many very poor children. They were collecting cow dung. They had no education facilities and I felt very sad. Then, near Patna, the capital of the state, I had a lot of pain and sweating. I noticed one old sick person, one sick man, wearing white cloth, very, very dirty. No one was taking care of that person; it was really very sad. That night in my hotel room, my physical pain was very severe, but my mind was thinking of those children and that old man. That concern greatly reduced my physical pain.

11 Take for example those who train for the Olympic Games. They do very vigorous training, and no matter how much pain and hardship they experience, on the mental level they have happiness. Therefore, the mental level is more important than physical experience. Therefore, what is really important in life is happiness and satisfaction.

The Causes of Happiness

12 Now, what are the causes of happiness? I think that since this body element goes well with a calm mind, not with a disturbed mind, therefore a calm mind is very important. It doesn't matter our physical situation, mental calmness is most important. So, how can we bring about a calm mind?

13 Now, to get rid of all problems, that would be impractical; and to make the mind dull and forget about our problems, that doesn't work either. We have to look clearly at our problems and deal with them, but at the same time keep a calm mind so that we have a realistic attitude and we are able to treat them well, deal with them well.

14 As for those who take tranquillizers—well, I have no experience. I don't know if, at the time when people take tranquillizers, their intelligence is sharp or dull; I have to ask. For example, in 1959, when I was in Mussoorie, my mother or maybe it was somebody else was disturbed and had a lot of anxiety: the sleep was disturbed. The doctor explained that there were some drugs that they could take, but this would make the mind a little dull. I thought at that time that that's not good. On one side, you have a little calmness of mind, but on the other side, if the effect is dullness, this is no good. I prefer another way. I prefer having the intelligence fully functional and attentive and alert, but not disturbed. Undisturbed mental calmness is best.

15 For this, compassionate human affection is really important: the more compassionate our mind is, the better our brain functions. If our mind develops fear and anger, then when that happens, our brain functions more poorly. On one occasion I met a scientist who was over eighty years old. He gave me one of his books. I think it was called We Are Prisoners of Anger, something like that. While discussing his experience, he said that when we develop anger toward an object, the object appears very negatively. But ninety per cent of that negativeness is in our mental projection. This was from his own experience.

16 Buddhism says the same. When negative emotion develops, we can't see reality. When we need to make a decision and the mind is dominated by anger; then chances

are, we will make the wrong decision. No one wants to make a wrong decision, but at that moment, the part of our intelligence and brain that functions to differentiate right from wrong and make the best decision, that works very poorly. Even great leaders experience it like that.

17 Therefore, compassion and affection help the brain to function more smoothly. Secondarily, compassion gives us inner strength; it gives us self-confidence and that reduces fear, which, in turn, keeps our mind calm. Therefore, compassion has two functions: it causes our brain to function better and it brings inner strength. These, then, are the causes of happiness. I feel it is like that.

18 Now other faculties, of course, are also good for happiness. Everybody likes money, for example. If we have money, then we can enjoy good facilities. Usually, we consider these the topmost important things, but I think it's not like that. Material comfort can come through physical effort, but mental comfort has to come through mental effort. If we go to a shop and offer money to the shopkeeper and say that we want to buy peace of mind, they will say they have nothing to sell. Many shopkeepers will feel that this is something mad and they will laugh at us. Some injection or pill can maybe bring temporary happiness or calmness of mind, but not at the fullest level. We can see with the example of counseling that we need to tackle emotions through discussion and reasoning. Thus, we must use a mental approach. Therefore whenever I give talks, I say that we modern people think too much of external development. If we pay attention only to that level, that's not enough. Genuine happiness and satisfaction must come from within.

19 The basic elements for that are compassion and human affection, and these come from biology. As an infant, our survival depends solely on affection. If affection is there, we feel safe. If it's not there, we feel anxiety and insecure. If we become separated from our mother, we cry. If we are in our mother's arms and held tight, warmly, then we feel happy and we're quiet. As a baby, this is a biological factor. One scientist for instance, my teacher, a biologist who is involved with anti-nuclear violence—he told me that after birth, a mother's physical touch for several weeks is very important for enlarging the baby's brain and development. It brings a feeling of safety and comfort and this leads to proper development of physical growth, including the brain.

20 So, the seed of compassion and affection is not something that comes from religion: it comes from biology. We each came from our mother's womb and each of us survived due to our mother's care and affection. In the Indian tradition, we consider birth from a lotus in a pure land. That sounds very nice, but perhaps the people there have more affection for lotuses than for people. So being born from a mother's womb is better. Then we are already equipped with the seed of compassion. So, those are the causes of happiness.

After Reading

5. Why, according to the Dalai Lama, should happiness be the purpose of life?
6. What does the Dalai Lama mean by "genuine happiness and satisfaction must come from within"?

Engage with the Reading

1. Do you accept the opening premise that "We are here; we exist and we have the right to exist"? Do you agree with the later premise that "every sentient being has the right to survive and, for survival, this means having a desire for happiness or comfort"? Why or why not?
2. The Dalai Lama explained how thinking about other people's suffering alleviated his own physical pain and how athletes who train hard might suffer physically but are mentally happy. Can you think of other examples that support, or contradict, the ideas in the reading?

READING SELECTION

"A REFLECTION ON THE MEANING OF LIFE: REMEMBERING VIKTOR FRANKL IN THE AFTERMATH OF ANTHONY BOURDAIN'S DEATH"

Before Reading

1. The title of the reading selection mentions "the meaning of life." What would you say gives our lives meaning?
2. Reflect on the title and read the head note. What did you learn and what did you already know about Anthony Bourdain?

During Reading

3. As you read, mark the main ideas.
4. Record any questions you have about the reading.

A Reflection on the Meaning of Life: Remembering Viktor Frankl in the Aftermath of Anthony Bourdain's Death

By Mirsad Serdarevic

Psychology Today, 8 June 2018

Mirsad Serdarevic is an Associate Professor and Associate Chair of Applied Clinical Psychology at The Chicago School of Professional Psychologists, San Diego campus. He posted this piece on June 8, 2018, the day that Anthony Bourdain, an American chef, author, and television personality, committed suicide.

I was only an 11-year-old child when I first stumbled upon Viktor E. Frankl's book, *Man's Search for Meaning*, although the first edition of the same book in my native language was titled, *And Why Didn't You Commit Suicide That Time?* 1

Beyond its approachable thin frame, which was attractive to my 11-year-old intellect and reflective of my reading capacity, I was completely caught off guard by such a direct and profound question on a cover of the book. Of course, what I got out of Dr. Frankl's work as a child was a great sense of admiration for this incredible human being who found a way to survive years in Nazi concentration camps, where, as a young man, he was subjected to the worst kinds of abuse. 2

Reading *Man's Search for Meaning* as an adult, many years later, I realized just how important and relevant Frankl's message was to us all. Frankl argued that, while we cannot control what happens to us in some circumstances, that we can—through acceptance and search for meaning—cultivate an attitude that will enable us to endure the most difficult of life's situations. 3

According to Frankl, the meaning of life is different for each individual. For some, it may be found in close relationships; for others, it may be work or a hobby, while others may find meaning in small, daily activities and interactions. 4

Throughout his work, Frankl's tone is always very human and non-judgmental, which is best observed in his treatment of those who took their lives—in other words, he is always simultaneously providing us with insights on how finding one's own meaning in the direst of situations can save lives, while recognizing complex contexts and mental health issues that may contribute to one's suicide. 5

We are all equal in our humanity. We may suffer for different reasons, but suffering is something that is experienced by all: rich and poor, young and old, urban and rural, "ordinary folk" and famous people. Celebrities, however, often reflect larger societal struggles. Recent losses of Anthony Bourdain and Kate Spade are reminders that even those fortunate enough to enjoy successful and creative lives are not immune to mental health problems nor are they immune to the multitude of other factors that constitute our often stressful and complex daily lives. 6

As evident by the outpouring of emotion by those who knew them, it appears that both Bourdain and Spade were artistic, driven, giving and loving individuals who strived to create and bring goodness into the world. It is certain that the world will miss their presence. 7

While I didn't follow Spade's work, I still remember watching Bourdain's early food TV shows and his unique ability to merge the food with smart and sophisticated commentary on culture and society. I remember watching Bourdain with my late father who was just thrilled that someone came up with such a smart idea of telling us about foods from all over the world, while also reminding us that food is more than just our basic need, but also a way of connecting, socializing, better understanding each other. 8

I loved watching Bourdain's shows because of his humanity and his ability to connect and relate to people from all walks of life, from every culture. Bourdain had that rare talent to make you feel like you knew him—you may have watched him on a TV set, but he made you feel like you were right there with him enjoying whatever dish he was eating. He was always genuinely interested in what people had to say—a quality that I, as a psychologist, especially appreciated. 9

We need to keep talking about Bourdain, Spade, and many others who left us too soon. We need to keep talking about it so that we better understand this issue and know the best ways to help. 10

We frequently hear reports of an increase in suicide rates in the U.S. Over the past several years, we've also been introduced to the growing problem of suicide among helping professions, as physicians, medical students, and other caring individuals in helping professions are taking their lives at alarming rates. 11

What we know from some early qualitative studies (e.g., Rosen, 1975) of those who survived serious suicide attempts, such as jumping off the Golden Gate Bridge, is that all of the survivors reported some form of "spiritual rebirth" experience, "a sense of oneness or unity with other human beings and the entire universe" (Rosen, 1975, p. 293), and none of the seven survivors attempted suicide again. 12

These studies certainly provide some important insights. For instance, one survivor "realized that halfway down he was going to hit a concrete piling and he remained conscious to solve this problem," and survived by maneuvering "his body so that he only grazed the concrete piling" (Rosen, 1975, p. 291). In other words, when given a few seconds to reflect, the person wanted to live. 13

While this is a very complex problem, with a lot of individual variabilities, findings like those have implications for prevention efforts. For example, these findings highlight how important it is to remove access to firearms for those at risk, as firearms are the most common method of death by suicide—a method that does not leave any time to reflect or ask for help. 14

As a society, we need to be better at talking about mental health in general and about suicide in particular. While we made strides to reduce the stigma associated with mental health issues, it is important to stay active, continue this discussion and advocate for public health policies that will save lives. 15

Dr. Frankl, as I mentioned earlier, argued that the meaning of life is a key motivator to our survival. While it differs for each individual, finding meaning is important to each individual. One may argue that the current era of information overload, with many of us spending long hours alone and isolated on our iPhone, laptop and iPad islands, faced with multiple pressures to be efficient and productive, makes it easy for us to disconnect from each other and walk around silently with accumulated stressors too often even unaware of it. In such circumstances, holding on to one's own meaning or reclaiming it can be challenging to say the least. 16

Today we lost Anthony Bourdain. For too long, too many have lost their fathers, mothers, brothers, sisters, sons, daughters, and friends too early. It is time for all of us to help create a society that will promote more time to cultivate close relationships, that will allow us to reach out to each other, and that will provide us with opportunities to get help and support when needed. 17

I hope we all can play a part in building a culture that will empower every individual to find her or his meaning in life and offer help during those dark moments in which we all may find ourselves at some point. Together, as a community of connected family members, friends, colleagues and neighbors we can make our society kinder and stronger. 18

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After Reading

5. Why does the author write about Victor Frankl's book before commenting on Anthony Bourdain's death?
6. Why does the author include research about people who survived jumping off bridges in suicide attempts? What does this show?

Engage with the Reading

1. Why do you think that suicide rates in the United States might be rising, especially among those in the "helping professions"?
2. Do you agree with the author's conclusion that creating a society in which we can "cultivate close relationships" and find meaning in life is the answer to preventing suicides? Why or why not?

READING SELECTION

"EMILY ESFAHANI SMITH MELDS WISDOM AND PSCYHOLOGY ON A JOURNEY TOWARD MEANING"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and headnote, and skim the article. What do you anticipate the author will explain makes for a meaningful life?
2. What do you think is the difference, if any, between a happy life and a meaningful life?

During Reading

3. As you read, mark the main ideas.
4. As you read, identify ideas in the text you find agreeable or that resonate with you, or ideas that you find disagreeable or cause confusion.

Emily Esfahani Smith Melds Wisdom and Psychology on a Journey Toward Meaning

By Catherine Yang

The Epoch Times, 18 August 2020

Emily Esfahani Smith, who has written a book titled The Power of Meaning, *believes that finding meaning in one's life is more important than pursuing happiness. She has developed four "pillars"–belonging, purpose, storytelling, and transcendence–that she argues are the foundations of a meaningful life.*

Emily Esfahani Smith had never felt the need to embark on a great quest for happiness, but when she began college, she soon saw that it was this very quest that was making so many people on campus unhappy. 1

"I'd just never been as oriented toward happiness as I was toward meaning," said Esfahani Smith, who wrote the bestseller "The Power of Meaning." 2

Esfahani Smith has said her early experiences growing up in a Sufi meetinghouse in Toronto primed her search for meaning: it was a place of meditation, singing, and sugared tea; it was also a place of great connection and love and compassion. And though many who came through the meetinghouse had lived very difficult lives, she remembered they were forward-looking and lived a deep and meaningful existence. 3

When Esfahani Smith's family left the meetinghouse and moved to the United States, daily life was instead filled with a sort of "busyness." So Esfahani Smith turned to the great thinkers of the past in her search for meaning, and ended up studying philosophy and psychology. 4

'Crisis of Meaning' 5

What traditional wisdom offers, the social sciences are now just starting to catch up with, and her research and writing, Esfahani Smith melds the humanities and psychology in a fruitful way. Our modern way of life has brought unprecedented prosperity and more ways of life to choose from than ever, but it has also brought unique modern ills, which necessitate new and intentional remedies.

As we eschew traditional ways of life, Esfahani Smith also explores the organizations created as "cultures of meaning," such as the oral history project StoryCorps and Encore .org, which helps people reframe retired life as a time of using "the skills and experiences they've accumulated over a lifetime to improve society." 6

We don't need to look far to see that there is a "real crisis of meaning," as she puts it, and it has been one that has been growing for decades. The outcomes are things like the loneliness epidemic, plaguing both older and now younger generations, as well as something more sinister, such as radicalization, as some people turn to extremist groups as cultures of meaning. 7

Esfahani Smith defines happiness as it is defined in psychology, as a state of positive emotion. Happiness is fleeting, but a life worth living must have meaning—which may actually necessitate many moments of unhappiness (consider caregivers, for instance). 8

In her research, as she details in her book, Esfahani Smith came to differentiate between four sources of meaning. She calls them pillars, and we can think of them as foundational support structures. 9

"You don't have to have all four of the pillars for your life to be meaningful," she said. "I definitely think the more pillars you have, the more stable your sense of meaning is." 10

Meaning is what inoculates us from crumbling under adversities, as researchers studying why some people move forward and others can't after traumatic events have also found. 11

Think of adversity as an earthquake, she said. If the building is strong, "if you have more, richer sources of meaning in your life," the building doesn't come down. 12

Four Pillars of Meaning 13

The four pillars are belonging, purpose, storytelling, and transcendence. Esfahani Smith found these universally present in philosophy, psychology, literature, film, religion, and popular culture.

Belonging ranks as the most important driver of meaning according to research, whether it is with strong familial ties or a created community based on shared values. In her book, Esfahani Smith travels from the Tangier Islands to the Society for Creative Anachronism, a community of people who study and recreate medieval arts, and explores how belonging can happen by chance or by intentional effort. There are different levels of social bonds as well, from knowing you have a place in a community to instances of intimacy, "high-quality connections," that can happen in the day-to-day even between passing strangers. 14

The dangers of not having this pillar of belonging are serious: Chronic loneliness compromises the immune system and leads to early death, as she writes, detailing a study of mid-century orphanages where babies were literally dying from despair. 15

The second pillar is purpose, which includes both a long-term goal and a contribution to the world. When people have purpose, the mundane and day-to-day have meaning in moving them toward that purpose, even if to the outside world, cleaning out animal waste (zookeepers rank high in having a sense of purpose among professions) or being sleep-deprived with a newborn seems far from glamorous. When people don't have purpose, they drift through life unmoored, and statistically tend to engage in "risky behavior" that's detrimental to their health—mental or physical—and society. 16

The third pillar is storytelling, which is how we as humans make sense of our lives. If we view our lives as a collection of disparate facts, we live with the belief that our existence is incoherent and lacking meaning. 17

Esfahani Smith explores the different stories we tell ourselves about ourselves, including how these stories change. When one man's story went from being about how an accident put an end to his life of high-flying success, to how an injury woke him up from how adrift he had been and showed him a path of light and service, his life changed accordingly. Likewise, when our stories change from positive to negative, we as a result start to live our lives that way. Stories are how we create our identities. 18

The last pillar is transcendence—a pillar Esfahani Smith is particularly drawn to. 19

Transcendence is the feeling of being in awe and connected to something much greater; you simultaneously feel a sense of unity with something beyond, and feel very small and likely humbled. Some people attain this through intensive deep meditation, or hallucinogens, as Esfahani Smith writes, but also through more accessible experiences such as staring up at the starry night sky. People who have experienced transcendence talk about a "high" that doesn't last, but the experience almost inevitably changes the person in a deep way, and they carry that change with them for the rest of their lives. 20

"That being said, you can definitely live a meaningful life without all four pillars," Esfahani Smith said. The pillars we lean on also change throughout our lives as circumstances change, and different people naturally "lean toward certain pillars for meaning more than others." 21

"Some people just have something in them that draws them toward transcendence and spirituality and awe and wonder. Someone else might not be at all turned on spiritually speaking by those instances," she said. "Some people really need rich relationships as part of their daily lives, others are a little bit more introverted or just need less time with others in order to fulfill their need for belonging." 22

Our Pursuit of Happiness

Esfahani Smith, who is pursuing a doctorate in clinical psychology, is now researching the changing views of success in our culture.

Before her research on meaning, Esfahani Smith had even wondered whether there was something wrong because she didn't experience that constant state of happiness that advertising would have her believe she should. Our quest for happiness goes back quite a ways, and though it is possibly by necessity that man naturally gravitates toward the positive, perhaps there are pertinent answers to meaning if we look at how our definition of happiness and success has evolved.

"Aristotle said that the ultimate end of man was eudaimonia; that gets translated as happiness today, but actually a better translation is flourishing, or meaning," she said. "But the point is, [eudaimonia] is what the ultimate end of man is—everything that we do lies in the service of that one goal . . . the implicit assumption is that pursuing these different forms of success is in the service of happiness."

Even the founding document of our country includes a line that says human beings have an inalienable right to life, liberty, and the "pursuit of happiness."

"And interestingly, Jefferson was kind of echoing the philosopher John Locke who wrote that humans beings have the right to life, liberty, and property," she said. "There's ambiguity there, does the pursuit of happiness involve material prosperity? . . . That's just something that I've always wondered about."

"At the same time, part of what the founding project was about was offering people an opportunity to come somewhere where the old distinctions of class and rank weren't going to determine their future the way they did in the old world of Europe," she said. "Here you could come and you could really be your own person, you could strive to make a life for yourself and the way that was becoming defined was through the pursuit of success."

Her recent reading brought her attention to three "strands" of success, defined in different ways, each promising a different type of happiness.

"One was this kind of acquisitive strand, that success lies in these extrinsic goals like, wealth, status," she said. "And I think that's been the dominant strand today, when we think of success."

"The other strand goes back to the Puritan Protestant roots of many of the colonies," she said. "The idea of success was that you lived out a calling, where you serve mankind and God through the work that you did and fulfilling your duties and playing a certain role."

"On the one hand it was socially rigid because it suggested that your place on earth, your role in life was ordained by God, so you shouldn't be ambitious because that would be hubris and sinful. On the other hand, it was pretty democratic and hopeful because it gave everyone a chance to experience this form of success, of living out a calling because it affirmed the dignity of all work, all labor you put forth in the world, whether it was paid work or unpaid work, and it dignified those," she said.

"There are remnants still, in psychology today, meaningful work and the research on calling. It's been very secularized but it's kind of this outgrowth of this Protestant conception of success."

The third strand was one that Thomas Jefferson was a proponent of, as was Ralph Waldo Emerson, and writer and historian James Truslow Adams, Esfahani Smith said.

"He [Adams] was the one who actually coined the term 'the American dream,' and the way he defined it was that it was a dream of reaching, becoming the person you were meant to be, reaching your potential."

"I think that each of these different strands promised a sort of happiness," Esfahani Smith said. "The first strand was a kind of material happiness, the second strand was this sort of spiritual happiness, and the third was also this spiritual and psychological fulfillment. There was this promise that if you pursued these things you would become fulfilled." 35

Sometimes "happiness" and "meaning" are conflated, but Esfahani Smith says research shows that though there is overlap, there are also important differences, and she points out many in her book. Psychologist Viktor Frankl famously wrote about surviving the Holocaust because he had something to live for, and no one would assume those were times of happiness. 36

Esfahani Smith discusses the rise of positive psychology in recent decades, along with the "happiness frenzy" in recent years. Thousands of books are published promising happiness every year, and society isn't happier for it. 37

As a result, many positive psychologists and writers stress the importance of meaning, but wrap their messages up in happiness. 38

"The word happiness is a word that's really alluring to people," she said. "There is this real happiness zeitgeist in our culture." 39

After Reading

5. Summarize the four pillars of meaning and include an explanation or example to illustrate each concept.
6. How does Smith explain the difference between happiness and meaning?

Engage with the Reading

1. Which of the four pillars, if any, resonate most with you?
2. Do you agree with Smith that there is a "crisis of meaning" in American culture, including a "loneliness epidemic" and more people joining extremist groups to find meaning?

READING SELECTION

"NARRATIVE OF THE LIFE OF FREDERICK DOUGLASS, AN AMERICAN SLAVE"

Before Reading

1. What do you know about the genre of slave narratives? For instance, what was the purpose and who was the intended audience?

2. What do you know about Frederick Douglass or about slavery in the United States?

During Reading

3. As you read, mark where Douglass describes his life as being meaningless vs. when it becomes meaningful.
4. Consider what details show that Douglass had a meaningless life vs. a meaningful life.

Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass, an American Slave
Excerpt from CHAPTER X

By Frederick Douglass, 1845

Frederick Douglass was born into slavery in 1817 and escaped in 1838 to freedom. Douglas taught himself to read and write while enslaved, and after he was free became an orator and author advocating against slavery. His autobiography, from which this reading selection is excerpted, is a description of his life as a slave, testimony to the brutality of slavery, and an argument opposing slavery.

I left Master Thomas's house, and went to live with Mr. Covey, on the 1st of January, 1833. I was now, for the first time in my life, a field hand. In my new employment, I found myself even more awkward than a country boy appeared to be in a large city. I had been at my new home but one week before Mr. Covey gave me a very severe whipping, cutting my back, causing the blood to run, and raising ridges on my flesh as large as my little finger. The details of this affair are as follows: Mr. Covey sent me, very early in the morning of one of our coldest days in the month of January, to the woods, to get a load of wood. He gave me a team of unbroken oxen. He told me which was the in-hand ox, and which the off-hand one. He then tied the end of a large rope around the horns of the in-hand ox, and gave me the other end of it, and told me, if the oxen started to run, that I must hold on upon the rope. I had never driven oxen before, and of course I was very awkward. I, however, succeeded in getting to the edge of the woods with little difficulty; but I had got a very few rods into the woods, when the oxen took fright, and started full tilt, carrying the cart against trees, and over stumps, in the most frightful manner. I expected every moment that my brains would be dashed out against the trees. After running thus for a considerable distance, they finally upset the cart, dashing it with great force against a tree, and threw themselves into a dense thicket. How I escaped death, I do not know. There I was, entirely alone, in a thick wood, in a place new to me. My cart was upset and shattered, my oxen were entangled among the young trees, and there was none to help me. After a long spell of effort, I succeeded in getting my cart righted, my oxen disentangled, and again yoked to the cart. I now proceeded with my team to the place where I had, the day before, been chopping wood, and loaded my cart pretty heavily, thinking in this way to tame my oxen. I then proceeded on my way home. I had now consumed one half of the day. I got out of the woods safely, and now felt out of danger, I stopped my oxen to open the woods gate;

1

and just as I did so, before I could get hold of my ox-rope, the oxen again started, rushed through the gate, catching it between the wheel and the body of the cart, tearing it to pieces, and coming within a few inches of crushing me against the gate-post. Thus twice, in one short day, I escaped death by the merest chance. On my return, I told Mr. Covey what had happened, and how it happened. He ordered me to return to the woods again immediately. I did so, and he followed on after me. Just as I got into the woods, he came up and told me to stop my cart, and that he would teach me how to trifle away my time, and break gates. He then went to a large gum-tree, and with his axe cut three large switches, and, after trimming them up neatly with his pocket-knife, he ordered me to take off my clothes. I made him no answer, but stood with my clothes on. He repeated his order. I still made him no answer, nor did I move to strip myself. Upon this he rushed at me with the fierceness of a tiger, tore off my clothes, and lashed me till he had worn out his switches, cutting me so savagely as to leave the marks visible for a long time after. This whipping was the first of a number just like it, and for similar offences.

I lived with Mr. Covey one year. During the first six months, of that year, scarce a week passed without his whipping me. I was seldom free from a sore back. 2

[. . .] 3

If at any one time of my life more than another, I was made to drink the bitterest dregs of slavery, that time was during the first six months of my stay with Mr. Covey. We were worked in all weathers. It was never too hot or too cold; it could never rain, blow, hail, or snow, too hard for us to work in the field. Work, work, work, was scarcely more the order of the day than of the night. The longest days were too short for him, and the shortest nights too long for him. I was somewhat unmanageable when I first went there, but a few months of this discipline tamed me. Mr. Covey succeeded in breaking me. I was broken in body, soul, and spirit. My natural elasticity was crushed, my intellect languished, the disposition to read departed, the cheerful spark that lingered about my eye died; the dark night of slavery closed in upon me; and behold a man transformed into a brute! 4

Sunday was my only leisure time. I spent this in a sort of beast-like stupor, between sleep and wake, under some large tree. At times I would rise up, a flash of energetic freedom would dart through my soul, accompanied with a faint beam of hope, that flickered for a moment, and then vanished. I sank down again, mourning over my wretched condition. I was sometimes prompted to take my life, and that of Covey, but was prevented by a combination of hope and fear. My sufferings on this plantation seem now like a dream rather than a stern reality. 5

Our house stood within a few rods of the Chesapeake Bay, whose broad bosom was ever white with sails from every quarter of the habitable globe. Those beautiful vessels, robed in purest white, so delightful to the eye of freemen, were to me so many shrouded ghosts, to terrify and torment me with thoughts of my wretched condition. I have often, in the deep stillness of a summer's Sabbath, stood all alone upon the lofty banks of that noble bay, and traced, with saddened heart and tearful eye, the countless number of sails moving off to the mighty ocean. The sight of these always affected me powerfully. My thoughts would compel utterance; and there, with no audience but the Almighty, I would pour out my soul's complaint, in my rude way, with an apostrophe to the moving multitude of ships:– 6

"You are loosed from your moorings, and are free; I am fast in my chains, and am a slave! You move merrily before the gentle gale, and I sadly before the bloody whip! You are freedom's swift-winged angels, that fly round the world; I am confined in bands of iron! O that I were free! O, that I were on one of your gallant decks, and under your protecting wing! Alas! betwixt me and you, the turbid waters roll. Go on, go on. O that I could also go! Could I but swim! If I could fly! O, why was I born a man, of whom to make a brute. The glad ship is gone; she hides in the dim distance. I am left in the hottest hell of unending slavery. O God, save me! God, deliver me! Let me be free! Is there any God? Why am I a slave? I will run away. I will not stand it. Get caught, or get clear, I'll try it. I had as well die with ague as the fever. I have only one life to lose. I had as well be killed running as die standing. Only think of it; one hundred miles straight north, and I am free! Try it? Yes! God helping me, I will. It cannot be that I shall live and die a slave. I will take to the water. This very bay shall yet bear me into freedom. The steamboats steered in a north-east course from North Point. I will do the same; and when I get to the head of the bay, I will turn my canoe adrift, and walk straight through Delaware into Pennsylvania. When I get there, I shall not be required to have a pass; I can travel without being disturbed. Let but the first opportunity offer, and, come what will, I am off. Meanwhile, I will try to bear up under the yoke. I am not the only slave in the world. Why should I fret? I can bear as much as any of them. Besides, I am but a boy, and all boys are bound to some one. It may be that my misery in slavery will only increase my happiness when I get free. There is a better day coming." 7

Thus I used to think, and thus I used to speak to myself; goaded almost to madness at one moment, and at the next reconciling myself to my wretched lot. 8

I have already intimated that my condition was much worse, during the first six months of my stay at Mr. Covey's, than in the last six. The circumstances leading to the change in Mr. Covey's course toward me form an epoch in my humble history. You have seen how a man was made a slave; you shall see how a slave was made a man. On one of the hottest days of the month of August, 1833, Bill Smith, William Hughes, a slave named Eli, and myself, were engaged in fanning wheat. Hughes was clearing the fanned wheat from before the fan, Eli was turning, Smith was feeding, and I was carrying wheat to the fan. The work was simple, requiring strength rather than intellect; yet, to one entirely unused to such work, it came very hard. About three o'clock of that day, I broke down; my strength failed me; I was seized with a violent aching of the head, attended with extreme dizziness; I trembled in every limb. Finding what was coming, I nerved myself up, feeling it would never do to stop work. I stood as long as I could stagger to the hopper with grain. When I could stand no longer, I fell, and felt as held down by an immense weight. The fan of course stopped; every one had his own work to do; and no one could do the work of the other, and have his own go on at the same time. 9

Mr. Covey was at the house, about one hundred yards from the treading-yard where we were fanning. On hearing the fan stop, he left immediately, and came to the spot where we were. He hastily inquired what the matter was. Bill answered that I was sick, and there was no one to bring wheat to the fan. I had by this time crawled away under the side of the post and rail-fence by which the yard was enclosed, hoping to find relief by getting out of the sun. He then asked where I was. He was told by one of the hands. He came to the spot, and, after looking at me awhile, asked me what was the matter. I told him as well as I could, for I scarce had strength to speak. He then gave me a savage kick 10

in the side, and told me to get up. I tried to do so, but fell back in the attempt. He gave me another kick, and again told me to rise. I again tried, and succeeded in gaining my feet; but, stooping to get the tub with which I was feeding the fan, I again staggered and fell. While down in this situation, Mr. Covey took up the hickory slat with which Hughes had been striking off the half-bushel measure, and with it gave me a heavy blow upon the head, making a large wound, and the blood ran freely; and with this again told me to get up. I made no effort to comply, having now made up my mind to let him do his worst. In a short time after receiving this blow, my head grew better. Mr. Covey had now left me to my fate. At this moment I resolved, for the first time, to go to my master, enter a complaint, and ask his protection. In order to this, I must that afternoon walk seven miles; and this, under the circumstances, was truly a severe undertaking. I was exceedingly feeble; made so as much by the kicks and blows which I received, as by the severe fit of sickness to which I had been subjected. I, however, watched my chance, while Covey was looking in an opposite direction, and started for St. Michael's. I succeeded in getting a considerable distance on my way to the woods, when Covey discovered me, and called after me to come back, threatening what he would do if I did not come. I disregarded both his calls and his threats, and made my way to the woods as fast as my feeble state would allow; and thinking I might be overhauled by him if I kept the road, I walked through the woods, keeping far enough from the road to avoid detection, and near enough to prevent losing my way. I had not gone far before my little strength again failed me. I could go no farther. I fell down, and lay for a considerable time. The blood was yet oozing from the wound on my head. For a time I thought I should bleed to death; and think now that I should have done so, but that the blood so matted my hair as to stop the wound. After lying there about three quarters of an hour, I nerved myself up again, and started on my way, through bogs and briers, barefooted and bareheaded, tearing my feet sometimes at nearly every step; and after a journey of about seven miles, occupying some five hours to perform it, I arrived at master's store. I then presented an appearance enough to affect any but a heart of iron. From the crown of my head to my feet, I was covered with blood. My hair was all clotted with dust and blood; my shirt was stiff with blood. My legs and feet were torn in sundry places with briers and thorns, and were also covered with blood. I suppose I looked like a man who had escaped a den of wild beasts, and barely escaped them. In this state I appeared before my master, humbly entreating him to interpose his authority for my protection. I told him all the circumstances as well as I could, and it seemed, as I spoke, at times to affect him. He would then walk the floor, and seek to justify Covey by saying he expected I deserved it. He asked me what I wanted. I told him, to let me get a new home; that as sure as I lived with Mr. Covey again, I should live with but to die with him; that Covey would surely kill me; he was in a fair way for it. Master Thomas ridiculed the idea that there was any danger of Mr. Covey's killing me, and said that he knew Mr. Covey; that he was a good man, and that he could not think of taking me from him; that, should he do so, he would lose the whole year's wages; that I belonged to Mr. Covey for one year, and that I must go back to him, come what might; and that I must not trouble him with any more stories, or that he would himself *get hold of me*. After threatening me thus, he gave me a very large dose of salts, telling me that I might remain in St. Michael's that night, (it being quite late,) but that I must be off back to Mr. Covey's early in the morning; and that if I did not, he would *get hold of me*, which meant that he would whip me. I remained all night, and, according to his orders, I started

off to Covey's in the morning, (Saturday morning,) wearied in body and broken in spirit. I got no supper that night, or breakfast that morning.

[. . .] 11

All went well till Monday morning. [. . .] Long before daylight I was called to go and 12
rub, curry, and feed, the horses. I obeyed, and was glad to obey. But whilst thus engaged, whilst in the act of throwing down some blades from the loft, Mr. Covey entered the stable with a long rope; and just as I was half out of the loft, he caught hold of my legs, and was about tying me. As soon as I found what he was up to, I gave a sudden spring, and as I did so, he holding to my legs, I was brought sprawling on the stable floor. Mr. Covey seemed now to think he had me, and could do what he pleased; but at this moment–from whence came the spirit I don't know–I resolved to fight; and, suiting my action to the resolution, I seized Covey hard by the throat; and, as I did so, I rose. He held onto me, and I to him. My resistance was so entirely unexpected, that Covey seemed taken all aback. He trembled like a leaf. This gave me assurance, and I held him uneasy, causing the blood to run where I touched him with the ends of my fingers. Mr. Covey soon called out to Hughes for help. Hughes came, and, while Covey held me, attempted to tie my right hand. While he was in the act of doing so, I watched my chance, and gave him a heavy kick close under the ribs. This kick fairly sickened Hughes, so that he left me in the hands of Mr. Covey. This kick had the effect of not only weakening Hughes, but Covey also. When he saw Hughes bending over with pain, his courage quailed. He asked me if I meant to persist in my resistance. I told him I did, come what might; that he had used me like a brute for six months, and that I was determined to be used so no longer. With that, he strove to drag me to a stick that was lying just out of the stable door. He meant to knock me down. But just as he was leaning over to get the stick, I seized him with both hands by his collar, and brought him by a sudden snatch to the ground. By this time, Bill came. Covey called upon him for assistance. Bill wanted to know what he could do. Covey said, "Take hold of him, take hold of him!" Bill said his master hired him out to work, and not to help to whip me; so he left Covey and myself to fight our own battle out. We were at it for nearly two hours. Covey at length let me go, puffing and blowing at a great rate, saying that if I had not resisted, he would not have whipped me half so much. The truth was, that he had not whipped me at all. I considered him as getting entirely the worst end of the bargain; for he had drawn no blood from me, but I had from him. The whole six months afterwards, that I spent with Mr. Covey, he never laid the weight of his finger upon me in anger. He would occasionally say, he didn't want to get hold of me again. "No," thought I, "you need not; for you will come off worse than you did before."

This battle with Mr. Covey was the turning-point in my career as a slave. It rekindled 13
the few expiring embers of freedom, and revived within me a sense of my own manhood. It recalled the departed self-confidence, and inspired me again with a determination to be free. The gratification afforded by the triumph was a full compensation for whatever else might follow, even death itself. He only can understand the deep satisfaction which I experienced, who has himself repelled by force the bloody arm of slavery. I felt as I never felt before. It was a glorious resurrection, from the tomb of slavery, to the heaven of freedom. My long-crushed spirit rose, cowardice departed, bold defiance took its place; and I now resolved that, however long I might remain a slave in form, the day had passed forever when I could be a slave in fact. I did not hesitate to let it be known of me, that the white man who expected to succeed in whipping, must also succeed in killing me.

After Reading

5. Where does Douglass state that his life was without meaning? Select a phrase or sentence and quote that; then explain why you selected that quotation.
6. Where does Douglass state that his life had meaning? Select a phrase or sentence and quote that; then explain why you selected that quotation.

Engage with the Reading

1. One purpose of a slave narrative is to argue against slavery. How does this excerpt achieve that purpose?
2. Slave narratives were intended to be read by literate people, including educated white people unaware of the impacts of slavery. How is Douglass's writing crafted so as to reach his intended audience?

READING SELECTION

Before Reading

1. The following selection is a comic. Comics are stories that are told with a combination of words and images arranged in a sequential order. What do you think is important when reading a comic?
2. What do you think might make people addicted to drugs? For instance, are the drugs addictive or do people have addictive personalities, or do social forces encourage addiction?

During Reading

3. As you read, identify the main ideas.
4. As you read, identify ideas in the text you agree with or that resonate with you, or ideas that you disagree with or are confused by.

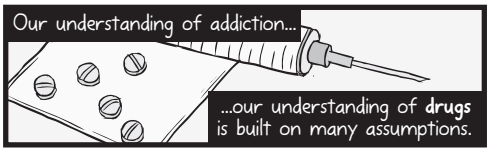
Rat Park

By Stuart McMillen

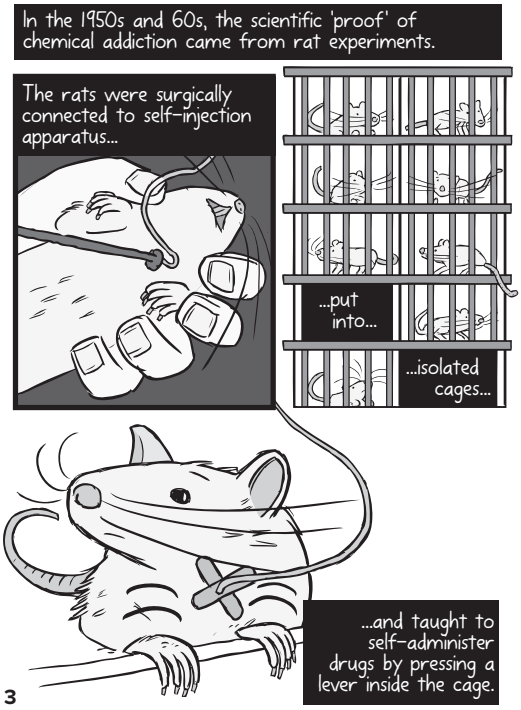
Stuart McMillen is an Australian cartoonist who creates long-form comics explaining environmental and social issues. In Rat Park, *McMillen summarizes an experiment by Bruce Alexander that questioned whether drugs, such as heroin and morphine, are inherently addictive or whether social forces, such as isolation and boredom, encourage drug-taking behaviors.*

https://www.stuartmcmillen.com/comic/rat-park/

RAT PARK
BY STUART MCMILLEN


Our understanding of addiction...
...our understanding of **drugs** is built on many assumptions.

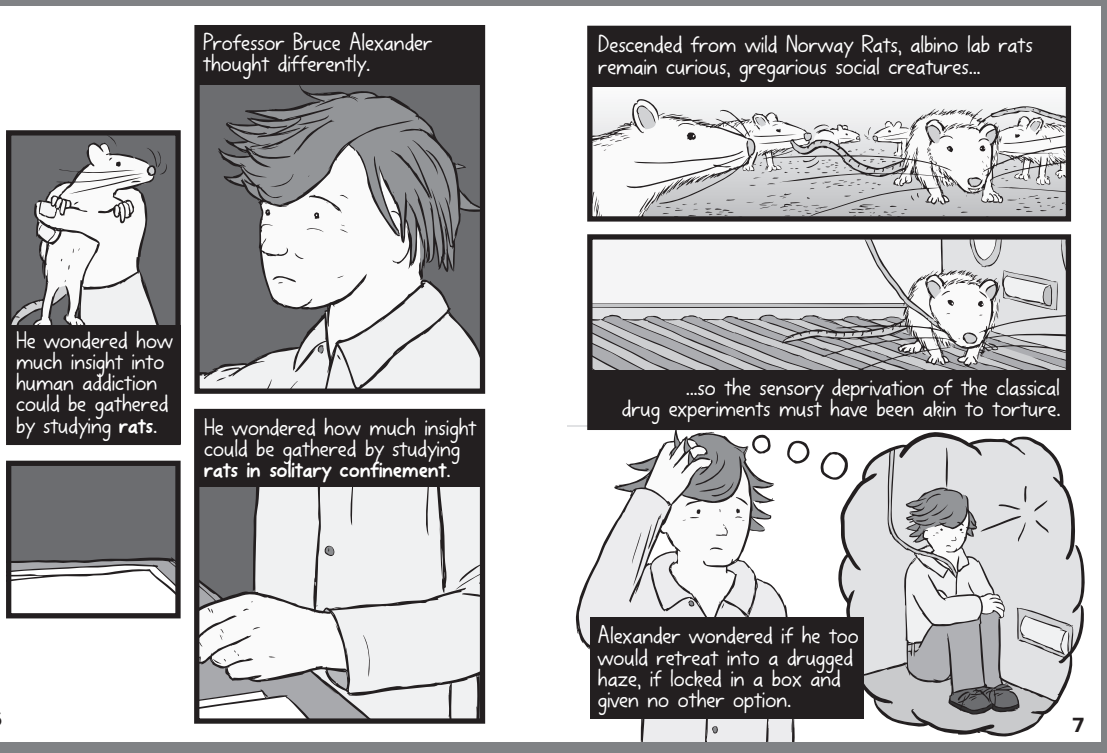
One of the biggest assumptions is that drugs are seductively addictive...
...with drug addiction caused by **mere exposure** to these bewitching substances.
2

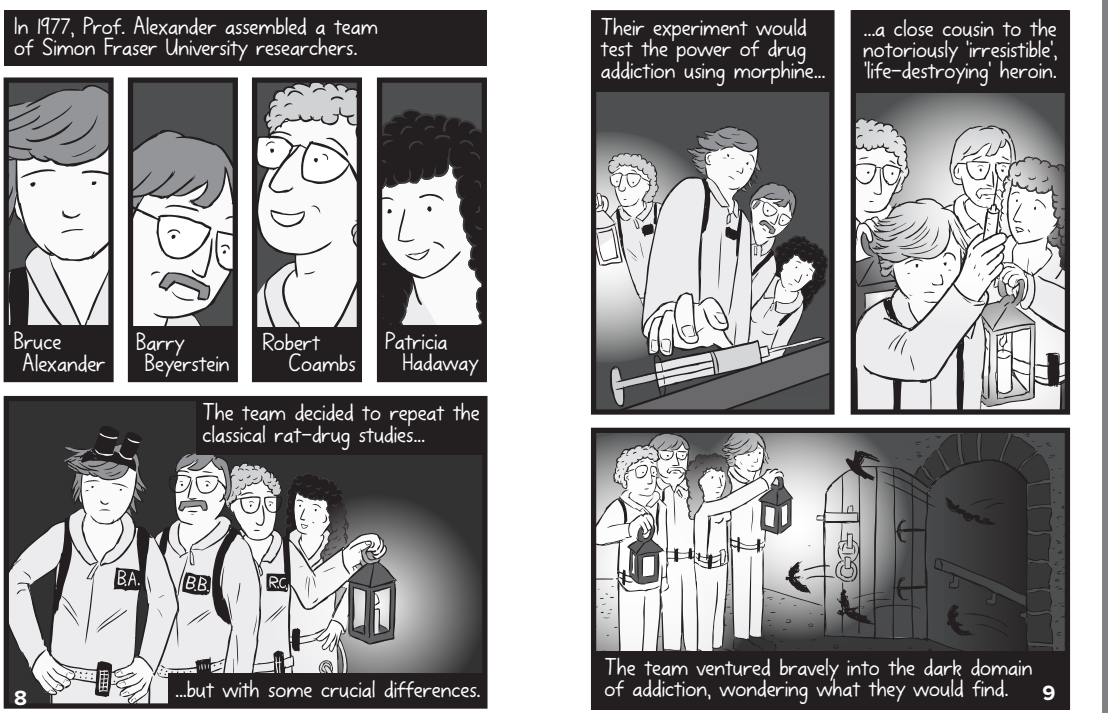

In the 1950s and 60s, the scientific 'proof' of chemical addiction came from rat experiments.
The rats were surgically connected to self-injection apparatus...
...put into...
...isolated cages...
...and taught to self-administer drugs by pressing a lever inside the cage.
3

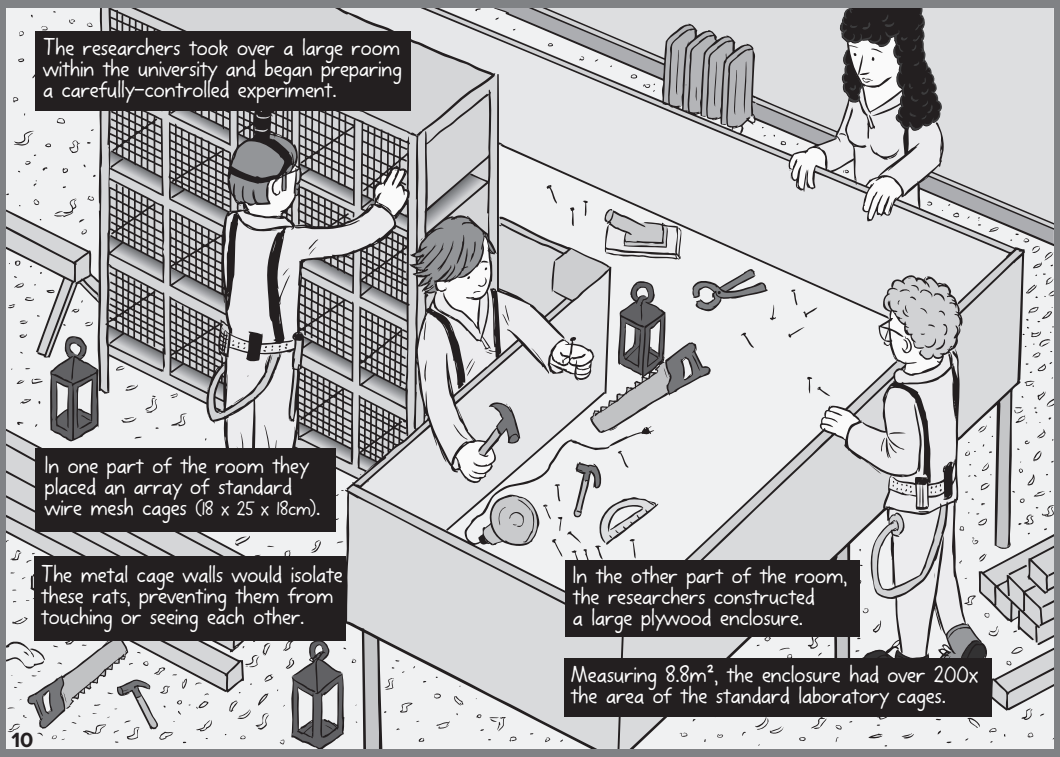
The researchers watched on as the caged rats self-injected powerful psychoactive drugs.

Dominated by their habits, some of the rats would choose drug injections in preference to food and water.
Killing themselves through neglect.
4

The implications were bleak and worrying.
It seemed that drugs were capable of ruinous harm to individuals' self-control...
...and if drugs were available to people as freely as they were to the lab rats...
...mass-addiction and social crisis would be the certain result.
5

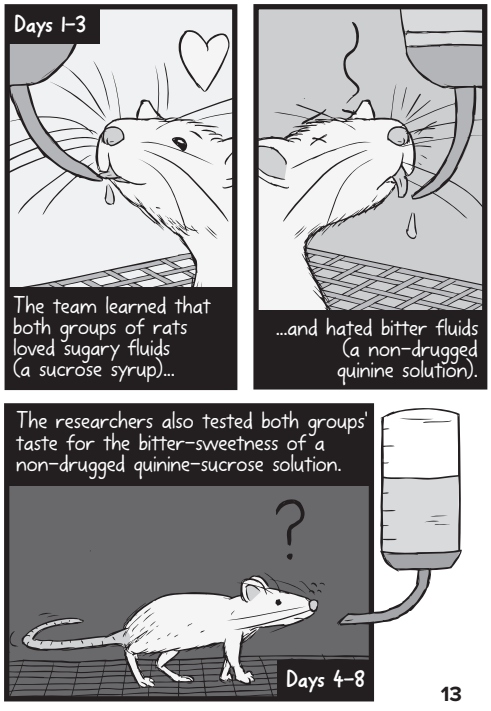

He wondered how much insight into human addiction could be gathered by studying **rats**.
Professor Bruce Alexander thought differently.
He wondered how much insight could be gathered by studying **rats in solitary confinement**.
6
Descended from wild Norway Rats, albino lab rats remain curious, gregarious social creatures...
...so the sensory deprivation of the classical drug experiments must have been akin to torture.
Alexander wondered if he too would retreat into a drugged haze, if locked in a box and given no other option.
7


In 1977, Prof. Alexander assembled a team of Simon Fraser University researchers.
Bruce Alexander
Barry Beyerstein
Robert Coambs
Patricia Hadaway
The team decided to repeat the classical rat-drug studies...
B.A.
B.B.
R.C.
...but with some crucial differences.
8
Their experiment would test the power of drug addiction using morphine...
...a close cousin to the notoriously 'irresistible', 'life-destroying' heroin.
The team ventured bravely into the dark domain of addiction, wondering what they would find.
9


The researchers took over a large room within the university and began preparing a carefully-controlled experiment.
In one part of the room they placed an array of standard wire mesh cages (18 x 25 x 18cm).
The metal cage walls would isolate these rats, preventing them from touching or seeing each other.
In the other part of the room, the researchers constructed a large plywood enclosure.
Measuring 8.8m², the enclosure had over 200x the area of the standard laboratory cages.
10

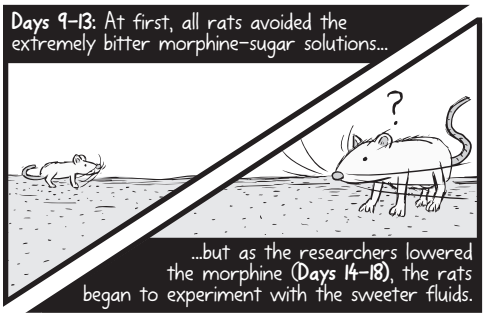
The researchers painted the walls with scenes of woodlands, and natural environments.
They covered the floor with fragrant cedar shavings for the rats to nest in...
...and scattered boxes and cans for the rats to hide and play in.
P.H.
B.B.
Importantly: the researchers gave the rats **other rats** to play, fight, mate, and interact with.
Satisfied they had created a rodent paradise...
...they named the enclosure '**Rat Park**'...
...and began experimenting on the rats.
11

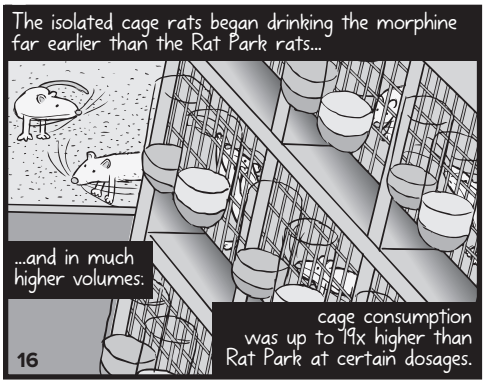
The 'seduction' experiment
P.H.
32 rats (16 male / 16 female) were randomly assigned into isolated cages, or colony housing in Rat Park.
The researchers gave both groups of rats the choice of two liquids...
...and measured their intake.
12


Days 1–3
The team learned that both groups of rats loved sugary fluids (a sucrose syrup)...
...and hated bitter fluids (a non-drugged quinine solution).
The researchers also tested both groups' taste for the bitter-sweetness of a non-drugged quinine-sucrose solution.
Days 4–8
13

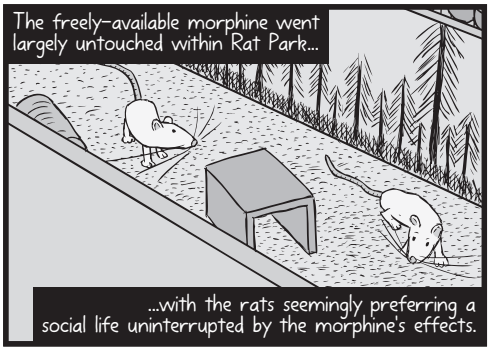
Now understanding the rats' taste buds, the researchers began trying to seduce the rats into drinking morphine.
(Morphine: an opiate drug similar to heroin.)
B.A.
Wondering if the rats would avoid the drug because of its bitter taste, the team 'sweetened the deal'...
H_2O
MHCl
...adding various ratios of sugar to tempt the rats into drinking the morphine.
14

The researchers 'stepped down' the mixtures every 5 days.
Sugar water / Morphine
Gradually transforming the bitter narcotic fluid into a sweeter, but nonetheless drugged brew.
Alexander and team keenly observed how much the rats would tolerate this bad taste in order to experience the effects of the morphine drug.
B.A.
R.G.
B.H.
Would the two groups of rats consume the drugs at different rates?
15

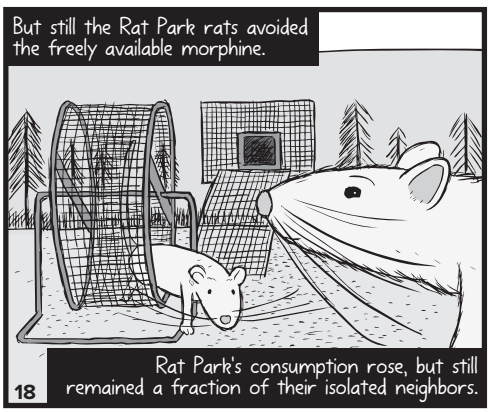

Days 9–13: At first, all rats avoided the extremely bitter morphine–sugar solutions...
?
...but as the researchers lowered the morphine (**Days 14–18**), the rats began to experiment with the sweeter fluids.


The isolated cage rats began drinking the morphine far earlier than the Rat Park rats...
...and in much higher volumes:
cage consumption was up to 19x higher than Rat Park at certain dosages.
16

While the caged rats seemed happy to drift into a drugged haze...
...the Rat Park rats resisted.


The freely-available morphine went largely untouched within Rat Park...
...with the rats seemingly preferring a social life uninterrupted by the morphine's effects.
17

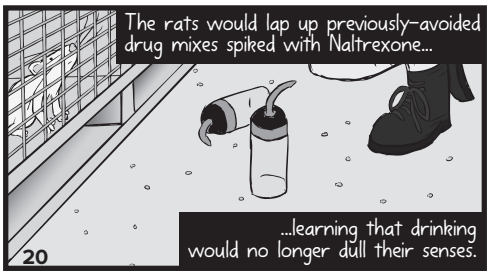
Days 19–23
The researchers upped the sugar...
...and the caged rats slipped further into their narcosis.


But still the Rat Park rats avoided the freely available morphine.
Rat Park's consumption rose, but still remained a fraction of their isolated neighbors.
18

Finally, Alexander's team tipped the sugar/drug ratio to a cocktail that none of the rats could resist.
Days 24–28
The rats which had avoided the heavily-drugged brews began drinking the sweet syrup with 'light' narcotic content.
The researchers were confident the rats had been avoiding the **effects** of the drugs, not the taste.
19

In a side-experiment, the team found that rats' aversion to morphine-sugar water could be reversed by adding Naltrexone to the liquid.

The additive worked as an antidote to the morphine: counteracting the effects of the drugs, while sparing the sugary taste.



The rats would lap up previously-avoided drug mixes spiked with Naltrexone...

...learning that drinking would no longer dull their senses.

20

'Kicking the habit'

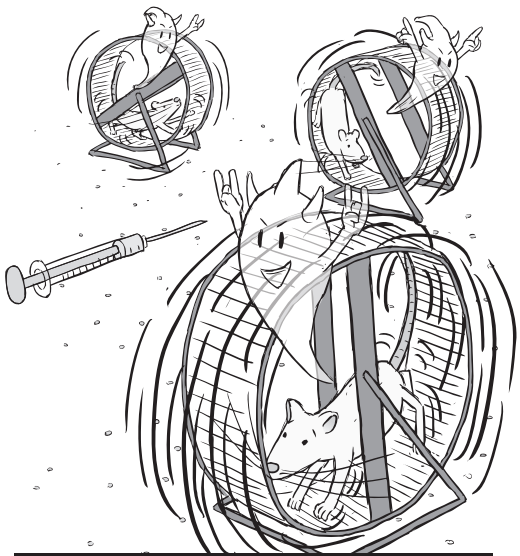
Another Rat Park experiment tested the 'addictive' nature of opiates from the opposite direction.

Rather than trying to tempt the rats into voluntarily **beginning** morphine habits...

...the researchers deliberately made junkies out of the rats, and then watched what happened when given choice again.

21

The researchers were testing the 'withdrawal symptoms' of drug dependence...



...a notion which suggests that the physiological effect of quitting opiate use is so unbearable that users cannot stop their drug habits.

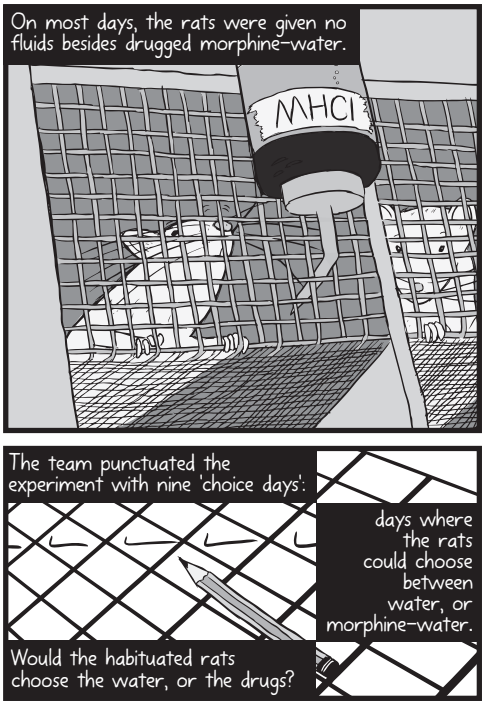
22

The researchers took 32 new rats...

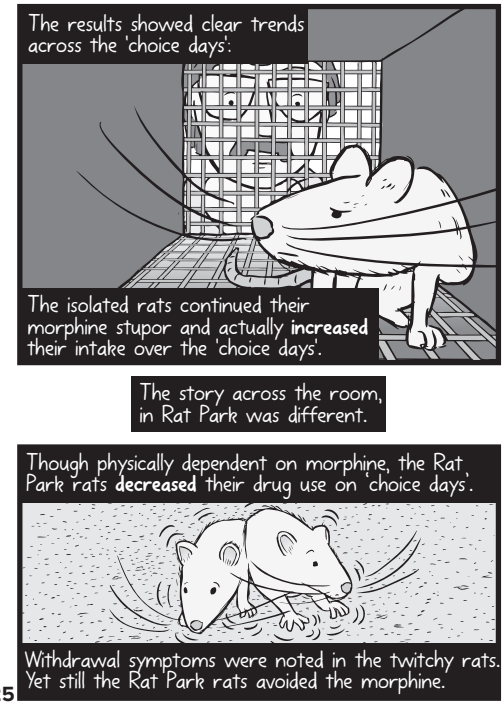
(10 in isolation, 22 in Rat Park)

...and put them on a fluids regime designed to produce physical tolerance and physical dependence in each and every rat.

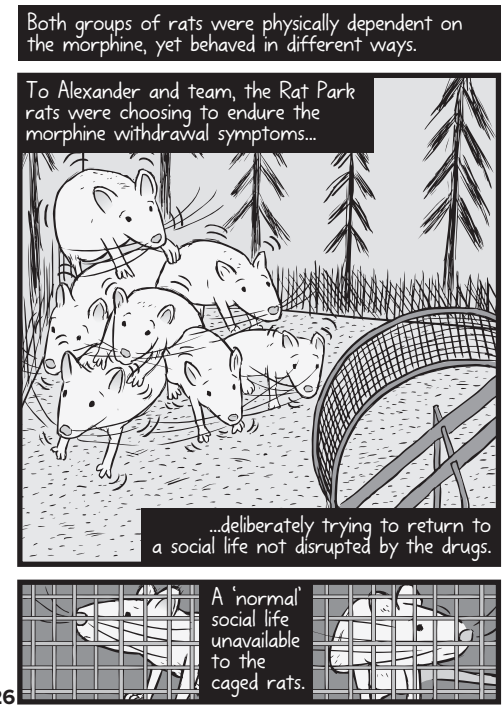
23


On most days, the rats were given no fluids besides drugged morphine–water.
MHCI
The team punctuated the experiment with nine 'choice days':
days where the rats could choose between water, or morphine–water.
Would the habituated rats choose the water, or the drugs?

24


The results showed clear trends across the 'choice days':
The isolated rats continued their morphine stupor and actually **increased** their intake over the 'choice days'.
The story across the room, in Rat Park was different.
Though physically dependent on morphine, the Rat Park rats **decreased** their drug use on 'choice days'.
Withdrawal symptoms were noted in the twitchy rats. Yet still the Rat Park rats avoided the morphine.

25

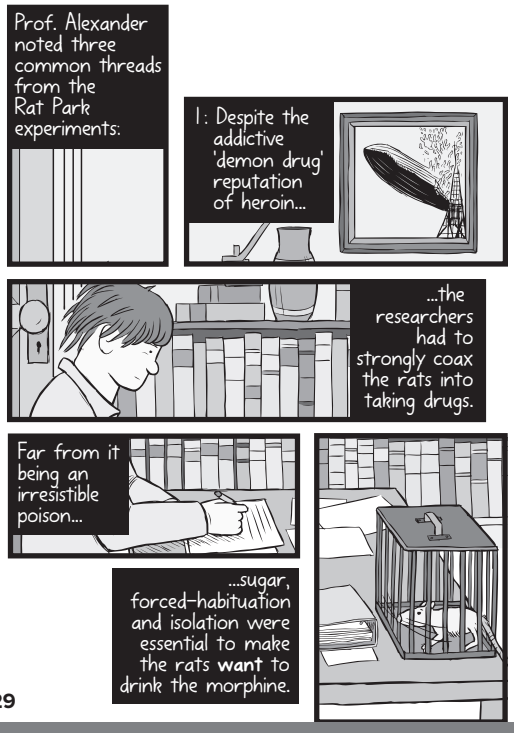

Both groups of rats were physically dependent on the morphine, yet behaved in different ways.
To Alexander and team, the Rat Park rats were choosing to endure the morphine withdrawal symptoms...
...deliberately trying to return to a social life not disrupted by the drugs.
A 'normal' social life unavailable to the caged rats.

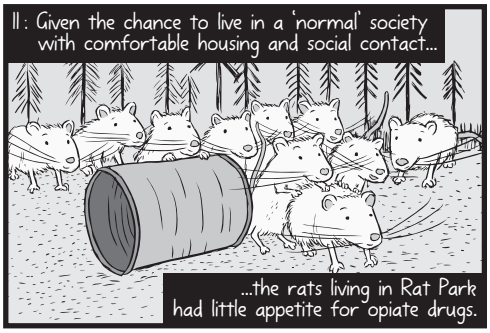
26

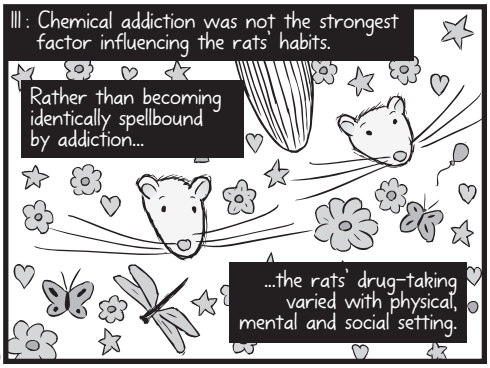
Bruce Alexander and his colleagues ran multiple experiments within Rat Park.
RC
PH
BB
Together the team swept their searchbeams across dark corners at the foundations of drug addiction theory...
?
BA
PH
BB
...trying to corner and confront the evidence at the heart of the arguments to criminalize drug use.

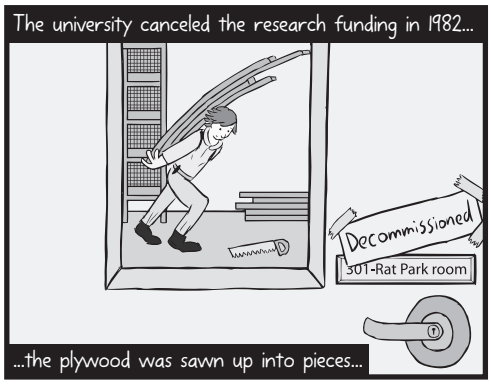
27

Trapped in the scrutinizing glare of the researchers' spotlights...
...the basic fears behind drug prohibition arguments looked a lot less scary.
The Rat Park studies were part of a turning tide of evidence away from boogeyman tales of 'demonic drugs'...
...toward a more nuanced understanding of drugs and addiction.
28

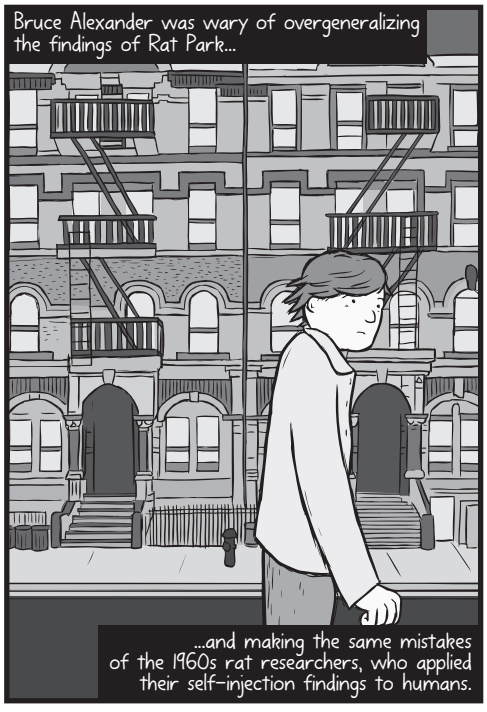

Prof. Alexander noted three common threads from the Rat Park experiments:
I: Despite the addictive 'demon drug' reputation of heroin...
...the researchers had to strongly coax the rats into taking drugs.
Far from it being an irresistible poison...
...sugar, forced-habituation and isolation were essential to make the rats **want** to drink the morphine.
29


II: Given the chance to live in a 'normal' society with comfortable housing and social contact...
...the rats living in Rat Park had little appetite for opiate drugs.


III: Chemical addiction was not the strongest factor influencing the rats' habits.
Rather than becoming identically spellbound by addiction...
...the rats' drug-taking varied with physical, mental and social setting.
30


The university canceled the research funding in 1982...
Decommissioned
301-Rat Park room
...the plywood was sawn up into pieces...

...the rats were taken from their paradise...
...and the researchers found other projects.
31

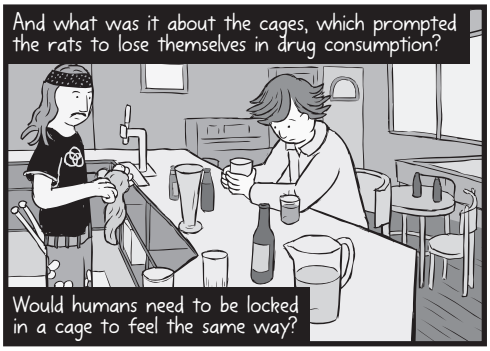

Bruce Alexander was wary of overgeneralizing the findings of Rat Park...
...and making the same mistakes of the 1960s rat researchers, who applied their self-injection findings to humans.

32

Yet, he remained haunted by the study's findings.

What was it about 'Rat Park', which allowed its residents to avoid addiction...
RIO THEATRE
...despite drugs being readily available?

33

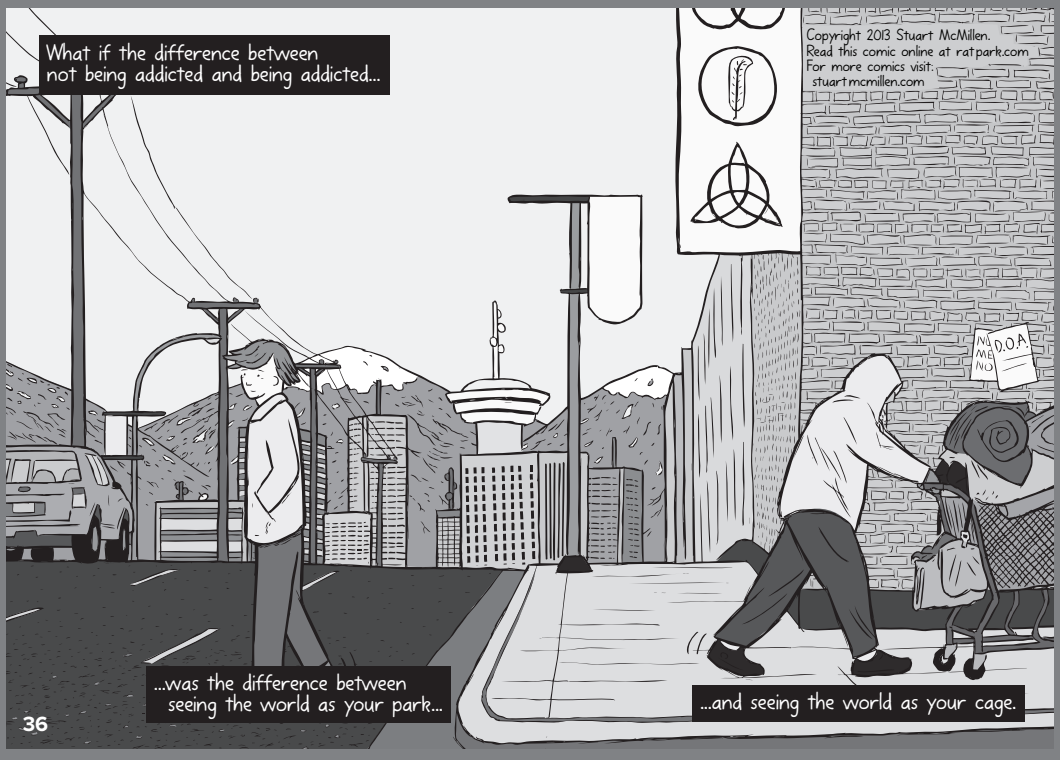

And what was it about the cages, which prompted the rats to lose themselves in drug consumption?
Would humans need to be locked in a cage to feel the same way?

Or are there other types of isolation which might lead to addiction?

34

Bruce Alexander's work moved beyond the world of rats...
...to the world of people...
HOME-LESS
...but was shadowed by a question lingering from the Rat Park experiments:

35



Stuart McMillen is a cartoonist based in Canberra, Australia. Stuart draws long-form comics inspired by social issues involving science, ecology, sustainability, psychology and economics. **Rat Park,** and all of Stuart's other comics can be read online at http://www.stuartmcmillen.com/

After Reading

5. Summarize the Rat Park experiment.
6. What evidence is there for Alexander's conclusion that "chemical addiction was not the strongest factor influencing the rat's habits"?

Engage with the Reading

1. Do you think that the Rat Park findings might hold relevance for human beings? If yes, how so?
2. In the Rat Park study, the caged rats were physically isolated from the other rats. Can you think of non-physical ways that human beings might feel isolated from others? How might a person feel integrated with other people, and able to live a Rat Park–style meaningful life?

Writing Prompts for "What Makes Life Meaningful?"

1. Visual narrative: Create an infographic, a graphic organizer, or a graphic comic that answers the question "What Makes Life Meaningful?" Draw on ideas and evidence from the readings in Part 5, as well as your own examples and explanations, to present your answer with support. You may wish to use Stuart McMillen's "Rat Park" as a model for your visual narrative.
2. Summary: Select the reading you found most intriguing and write a summary of the author's main ideas and important examples.
3. Response essay: Select one of the reading selections in this section and write a response to it, stating whether you agree with the author's explanations as to what creates meaning in life. If you choose, write your response in the form of a letter to the author.
4. Critique essay: Select one of the reading selections in this section and write a critique of it, focusing particularly on the explanations and evidence for what makes life meaningful.
5. Comparison paper: Select two of the reading selections in this section and compare them, focusing on the theories and evidence as to what makes life meaningful. Determine whether both, or one, or none of the readings suggest viable solutions.
6. Informative synthesis essay: Imagine you are enrolled in a psychology course and you must explain various theories about the meaning of life. Create a presentation or write a paper aimed at your classmates and based on the readings in Part 5 describing different ways that people find meaning in life and why this is important.
7. Argumentative synthesis essay: Imagine a discussion among the four authors in Part 5 with yourself as the moderator. Record the discussion, including probing questions that reveal the strengths and weaknesses, similarities and differences of the authors' views. Conclude the paper by explaining which theories about what makes life meaningful are most convincing and why.

THEME: AMERICA: LAND OF THE FREE?

In 1776 when the American colonies declared their separation from the King of England and Great Britain, Thomas Jefferson penned the Declaration of Independence, based on the following premise: "We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights, that among these are Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness." These guiding principles led Jefferson to further declare that "it is the Right of the People . . . to institute new Government, laying its foundation on such principles and organizing its powers in such form, as to them shall seem most likely to affect their Safety and Happiness." In other words, Americans believed in each person's right to equality and freedom, and formed a new government to ensure those basic human rights.

In the over 245 years since the founding of the United States of America, some have questioned whether all American citizens have equal rights, the ability to live freely, or the freedom to pursue the goals that would make them happy. In this section, we look specifically at documents that promise to uphold the right to freedom in America, and authors who question the limits of freedom, specifically for immigrants and for people perceived to be foreigners in our country.

READING SELECTION

"THE NEW COLOSSUS"

Before Reading

1. Have you seen the Statue of Liberty, in person or in images? What does the statue represent?
2. What is the "colossus" of the title a reference to? If you do not know, research to find the answer.

During Reading

3. On the first reading of the poem, understand the literal message of the poem—what each line says.
4. On subsequent readings of the poem, consider how the author uses words and imagery to communicate ideas.

The New Colossus

By Emma Lazarus

In 1883, Emma Lazarus, one of the first successful Jewish American poets, wrote a sonnet to raise money for a pedestal on which to place the Statue of Liberty. In 1903, a plaque was added to the pedestal to recognize Lazarus's poem.

Not like the brazen giant of Greek fame, 1
With conquering limbs astride from land to land;
Here at our sea-washed, sunset gates shall stand
A mighty woman with a torch, whose flame
Is the imprisoned lightning, and her name
Mother of Exiles. From her beacon-hand
Glows world-wide welcome; her mild eyes command
The air-bridged harbor that twin cities frame.
"Keep, ancient lands, your storied pomp!" cries she

With silent lips. "Give me your tired, your poor,
Your huddled masses yearning to breathe free,
The wretched refuse of your teeming shore.
Send these, the homeless, tempest-tost to me,
I lift my lamp beside the golden door!"

After Reading

5. In your own words, explain the message of the poem.
6. The poem is fourteen lines long and contains five sentences. What is the purpose of each sentence?

Engage with the Reading

1. Why do you think the lines "Give me your tired, your poor, / Your huddled masses yearning to breathe free" are some of the best recognized parts of the poem?

2. Why do you think the poem encourages "the homeless, tempest-tost" to come to America, but not the "storied pomp"?

READING SELECTION

"TRUMP OFFICIAL REPHRASES STATUE OF LIBERTY POEM TO DEFEND TARGETING OF LEGAL MIGRANTS"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this article?
2. What do you know about legal immigration to the United States? For instance, can anyone become an immigrant to the United States? If you are unsure, do some research on the topic.

During Reading

3. As you read, identify the main ideas.
4. As you read, identify ideas in the text you find agreeable and ideas you consider disagreeable.

Trump Official Rephrases Statue of Liberty Poem to Defend Targeting of Legal Migrants

By Zachary Small

Hyperallergic, 14 August 2019

Over the last 100 years, immigration to the United States has often been restricted by the U.S. government typically by capping the number of migrants from certain countries. The Trump administration also sought to limit immigrants to those who could be self-supporting and would not need government assistance.

"Give me your tired, your poor, your huddled masses yearning to breathe free . . . " says a famous line from the Emma Lazarus poem etched into the Statue of Liberty's plaque. 1

". . . Who can stand on their own two feet and who will not become a public charge," added Ken Cuccinelli, the Trump administration's acting head of Citizenship and Immigration Services, during an interview with NPR's [National Public Radio] Rachel Martin on Tuesday. 2

He failed to include the second half of the original passage, which reads, ". . . The wretched refuse of your teeming shore. Send these, the homeless, tempest-tost to me, I lift my lamp beside the golden door!" 3

A day earlier on Monday, the White House announced a new regulation targeting legal immigrants who want to remain in the United States but whose lack of financial resources would likely make them a burden on taxpayers. Starting in mid-October, an aggressive wealth test will determine whether those immigrants have the means to support themselves. Those deemed likely to use government benefit programs like food stamps and subsidized housing will have their applications for green cards denied. 4

Trump officials are calling this a "public charge rule," which they say will reinforce "ideals of self-sufficiency," according to the BBC [British Broadcasting Corporation]. 5

When asked during his NPR interview if the 1883 poem, titled "The New Colossus," still applied to today's migrant situation, Cuccinelli agreed but also added that the "plaque was put on the Statue of Liberty at almost the same time as the first public charge [law] was passed. Very interesting timing." He claimed that public charge rules are a "140-year-old part of our legal immigration system." 6

(That's not exactly true. He was likely referring to the Immigration Act of 1882, which allowed immigration authorities to turn away applicants suspected of being a "convict, lunatic, idiot, or any person unable to take care of himself or herself without becoming a public charge." The Trump rule is different in that it targets immigrants who haven't committed any legal acts and pose no threat to the public.) 7

Martin followed up by asking if the new policy would change the definition of the American dream. The Trump official said, "We invite people to come here and join us as a privilege," adding, "No one has a right to become an American who isn't born here as an American." 8

In a later interview with CNN [Cable News Network], Cuccinelli rejected the idea that he was trying to amend the famous Statue of Liberty poem. He accused people on the left of "twisting" his comments. 9

When the news outlet's anchor Erin Burnet asked what America stands for, he responded: "Of course that poem was referring back to people coming from Europe—where they had class-based societies where people were considered wretched if they weren't in the right class." 10

The new public charge rule is reported to be the brainchild of Trump's advisor, Stephen Miller. A November 2018 report from the nonpartisan think tank called the Migration Policy Institute found that the policy would "disproportionately affect women, children, and the elderly." The proposal is already being challenged in California, where San Francisco and the county of Santa Clara argue that the rule intimidates thousands of migrants and their families out of critical federally funded programs. 11

Critics from the left have been quick to denounce the Trump official and the public charge policy he was promoting. 12

"This administration finally admitted what we've known all along," tweeted Beto O'Rourke, the Democratic presidential hopeful from Texas. "They think the Statue of Liberty only applies to white people." 13

The Democratic-led House Homeland Security Committee also condemned Cuccinelli's revision in a tweet, calling the words "vile and un-American." 14

When reached by reporters for comment on Tuesday about Cuccinelli's remarks, President Donald Trump did not directly respond to the Statue of Liberty poem. 15

"I don't think it's fair to have the American taxpayer pay for people to come into the United States," he said. "I'm tired of seeing our taxpayer paying for people to come into the country and immediately go onto welfare and various other things." 16

"So I think we're doing it right." 17

After Reading

5. Summarize the arguments made by the Trump administration to limit legal immigration to those who will not use government benefit programs.
6. Summarize the arguments against the Trump administration's proposal to limit legal immigration to those who will not use government benefit programs.

Engage with the Reading

1. Pick a line from the reading that you agree with, quote it, and explain why you agree.
2. Pick a line from the reading that you do not agree with, quote it, and explain why you disagree.

READING SELECTION

"IMMIGRANTS IN OUR OWN LAND"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this poem?
2. What do you know about the immigration process? For instance, what happens to immigrants when they first come to the United States? If you are unsure, do some research on the topic.

During Reading

3. On the first reading of the poem, understand the literal message of the poem—what each stanza (section) says.
4. On subsequent readings of the poem, consider how the author uses words and imagery and tone to communicate ideas.

Immigrants in Our Own Land

By Jimmy Santiago Baca

Immigrants in Our Own Land, 1977

Jimmy Santiago Baca is an American poet and author of Chicano descent. At age 21, he was sentenced on drug charges to five years in prison, where he learned to read and to write poetry. His poems focus on themes of social justice, especially for Latinx people.

We are born with dreams in our hearts, 1
looking for better days ahead.
At the gates we are given new papers,
our old clothes are taken
and we are given overalls like mechanics wear.
We are given shots and doctors ask questions.
Then we gather in another room
where counselors orient us to the new land
we will now live in. We take tests.
Some of us were craftsmen in the old world,
good with our hands and proud of our work.
Others were good with their heads.
They used common sense like scholars
use glasses and books to reach the world.
But most of us didn't finish high school.

The old men who have lived here stare at us, 2
from deep disturbed eyes, sulking, retreated.

We pass them as they stand around idle,
leaning on shovels and rakes or against walls.
Our expectations are high: in the old world,
they talked about rehabilitation,
about being able to finish school,
and learning an extra good trade.
But right away we are sent to work as dishwashers,
to work in fields for three cents an hour.
The administration says this is temporary
So we go about our business, blacks with blacks,
poor whites with poor whites,
chicanos and indians by themselves.
The administration says this is right,
no mixing of cultures, let them stay apart,
like in the old neighborhoods we came from.

We came here to get away from false promises, 3
from dictators in our neighborhoods,
who wore blue suits and broke our doors down
when they wanted, arrested us when they felt like,
swinging clubs and shooting guns as they pleased.
But it's no different here. It's all concentrated.
The doctors don't care, our bodies decay,
our minds deteriorate, we learn nothing of value.
Our lives don't get better, we go down quick.

My cell is crisscrossed with laundry lines, 4
my T-shirts, boxer shorts, socks and pants are drying.
Just like it used to be in my neighborhood:
from all the tenements laundry hung window to window.
Across the way Joey is sticking his hands
through the bars to hand Felipé a cigarette,
men are hollering back and forth cell to cell,
saying their sinks don't work,
or somebody downstairs hollers angrily
about a toilet overflowing,
or that the heaters don't work.

I ask Coyote next door to shoot me over 5
a little more soap to finish my laundry.
I look down and see new immigrants coming in,
mattresses rolled up and on their shoulders,
new haircuts and brogan boots,
looking around, each with a dream in their heart,
thinking they'll get a chance to change their lives.

But in the end, some will just sit around 6
talking about how good the old world was.

Some of the younger ones will become gangsters.
Some will die and others will go on living
without a soul, a future, or a reason to live.
Some will make it out of here with hate in their eyes,
but so very few make it out of here as human
as they came in, they leave wondering what good they are now
as they look at their hands so long away from their tools,
as they look at themselves, so long gone from their families,
so long gone from life itself, so many things have changed.

After Reading

5. In your own words, explain the message of the poem.
6. Reread the first sentence in the poem and the last sentence in the poem. How do these two sentences compare and how do they communicate the theme of the poem?

Engage with the Reading

1. Select a line from the poem that is especially powerful or evocative. Quote the line and explain why you feel it is powerful.

2. Do you feel that the experiences of immigrants have changed since Bacca wrote this poem in 1977? Explain and give specific examples from the poem and from current events to support your answer.

READING SELECTION

"CRAFTING THE 'DAY OF INFAMY' SPEECH"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this reading selection?
2. What do you know about the bombing at Pearl Harbor? If you are unsure, do some research on the topic.

During Reading

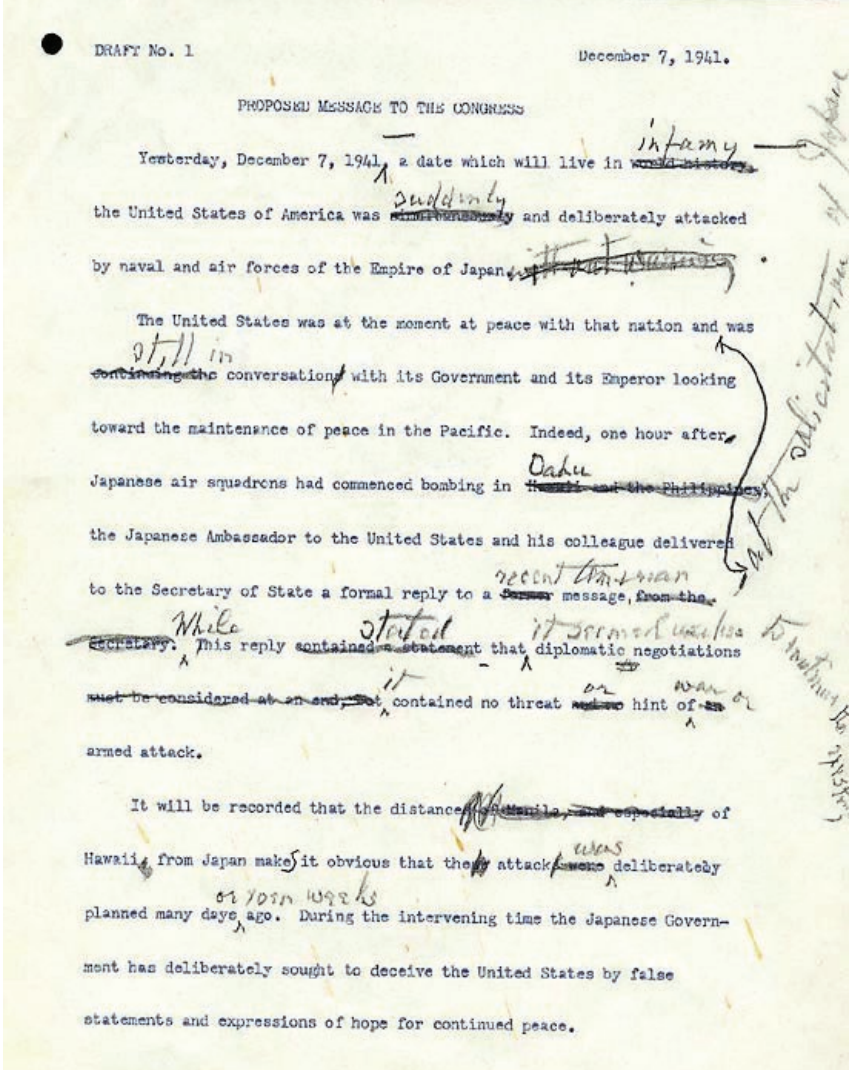
3. On a first reading, understand the text of the reading selection.
4. On a second reading, pay attention to the images of Roosevelt's speech and the changes he made on the drafts.

Crafting the "Day of Infamy" Speech

US National Archives, 7 December 2014

On December 7, 1941, Japanese fighter planes dropped bombs on the Pearl Harbor Navy base in Hawaii. Over 2,400 Americans were killed, including civilians. President Franklin D. Roosevelt asked Congress to declare war on Japan immediately after the bombing, prompting him to write a speech, the process of which is described here.

Early on a quiet Sunday afternoon in December 1941, the President of the United States was in his study at the White House working on his stamp album. It was a favorite activity and one that allowed him to shut out the troubles of the world, if only for a little while. 1



DRAFT No. 1 December 7, 1941.

PROPOSED MESSAGE TO THE CONGRESS

Yesterday, December 7, 1941, a date which will live in ~~world history~~ infamy

the United States of America was ~~simultaneously~~ suddenly and deliberately attacked

by naval and air forces of the Empire of Japan ~~in the Hawaiian Islands~~.

The United States was at the moment at peace with that nation and was

~~continuing the~~ still in conversations with its Government and its Emperor looking

toward the maintenance of peace in the Pacific. Indeed, one hour after

Japanese air squadrons had commenced bombing in ~~Hawaii and the Philippines~~ Oahu,

the Japanese Ambassador to the United States and his colleague delivered

to the Secretary of State a formal reply to a ~~former~~ recent American message, ~~from the~~

~~Secretary.~~ While this reply ~~contained a statement~~ stated that it seemed useless to

~~must be considered at an end, but~~ it contained no threat ~~and no~~ or hint of war or

armed attack.

It will be recorded that the distance ~~of Manila, and especially~~ of

Hawaii from Japan makes it obvious that the attack ~~was~~ were deliberately

planned many days ago. During the intervening time the Japanese Govern-

ment has deliberately sought to deceive the United States by false

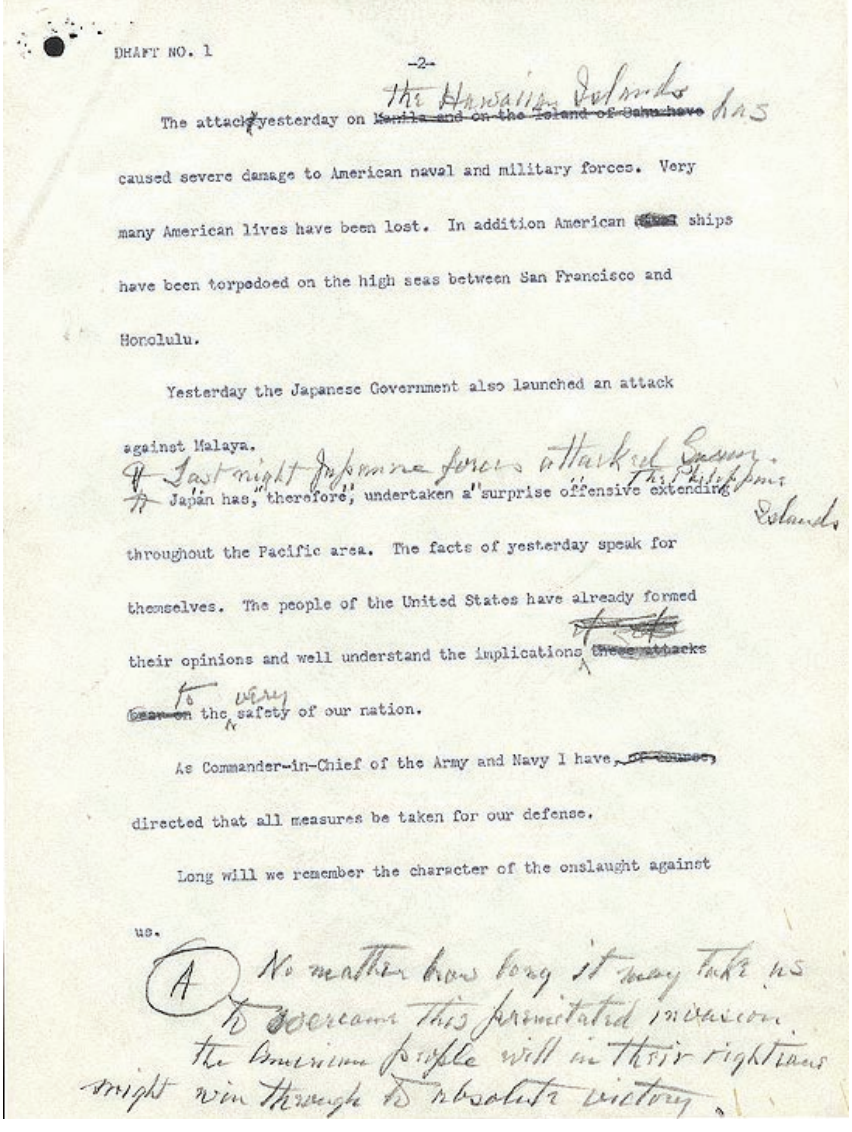
statements and expressions of hope for continued peace.

National Archives and Records Administration

The telephone rang, and the White House operator put through the call. Franklin D. Roosevelt learned that the Japanese had attacked Pearl Harbor, Hawaii, just before 8 a.m. Hawaii time (1 p.m. in Washington). 2

It was still unclear what the loss was in lives and ships and planes, but it would be high. Hawaii was the home of the Pacific fleet, along with thousands of soldiers and sailors to man them. 3

Two of Roosevelt's speechwriters were out of town, so the President summoned his secretary, Grace Tully, to take down dictation as he "drafted" one of the most famous speeches of the 20th century to deliver to Congress the next day. 4



DRAFT NO. 1

-2-

The attack yesterday on the Hawaiian Islands has caused severe damage to American naval and military forces. Very many American lives have been lost. In addition American ships have been torpedoed on the high seas between San Francisco and Honolulu.

Yesterday the Japanese Government also launched an attack against Malaya.

Last night Japanese forces attacked Guam, the Philippine Islands. Japan has, therefore, undertaken a surprise offensive extending throughout the Pacific area. The facts of yesterday speak for themselves. The people of the United States have already formed their opinions and well understand the implications to the very safety of our nation.

As Commander-in-Chief of the Army and Navy I have directed that all measures be taken for our defense.

Long will we remember the character of the onslaught against us.

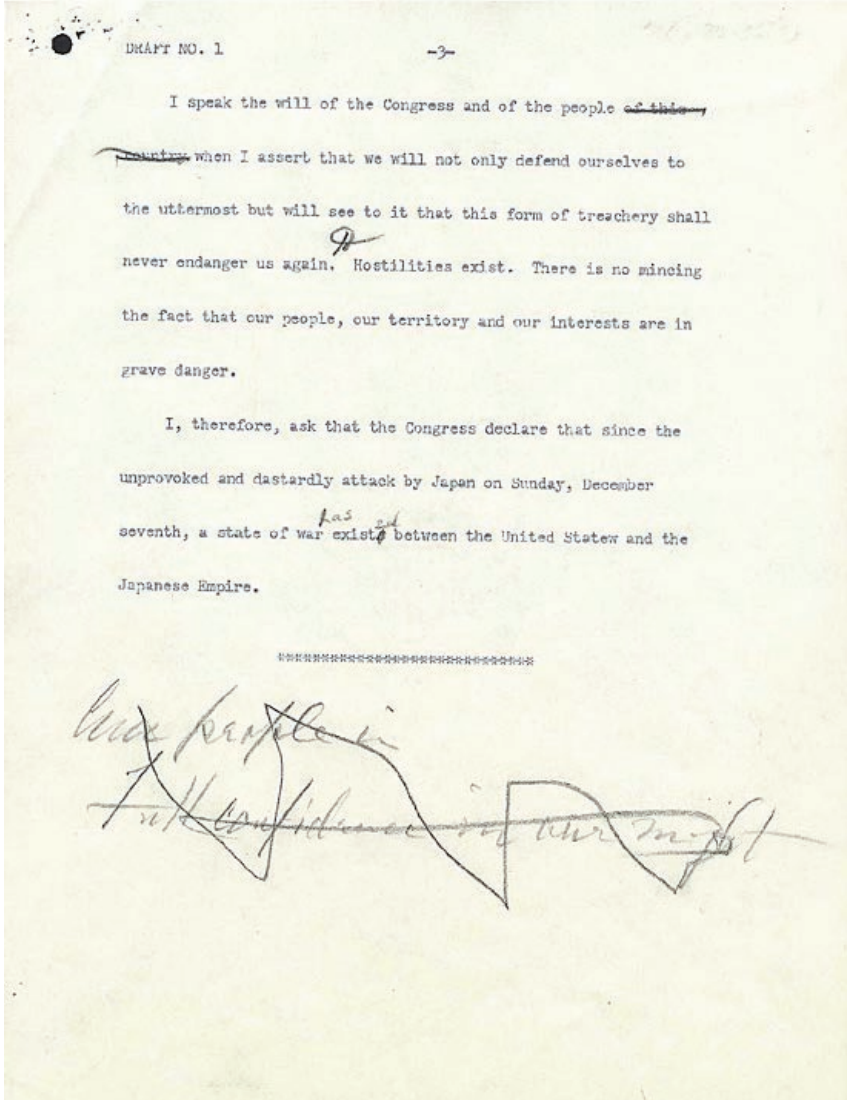
A No matter how long it may take us to overcome this premeditated invasion, the American people will in their righteous might win through to absolute victory.

National Archives and Records Administration

"Yesterday, December seventh, 1941, a date which will live in world history," he began, "the United States was simultaneously and deliberately attacked by naval and air forces of the empire of Japan." 5

Franklin Roosevelt's changes to the first draft of his speech are clearly visible on "Draft No. 1." In the opening sentence, he changed "world history" to "infamy" and "simultaneously" to "suddenly." At one point, he considered putting the words "without warning" at the end of the sentence but later crossed them out. (Franklin D. Roosevelt Library) 6

Slowly and carefully, he dictated the rest of the speech, and Tully typed up the first draft for his review. 7



DRAFT NO. 1 -3-

I speak the will of the Congress and of the people ~~of this country~~ when I assert that we will not only defend ourselves to the uttermost but will see to it that this form of treachery shall never endanger us again. Hostilities exist. There is no mincing the fact that our people, our territory and our interests are in grave danger.

I, therefore, ask that the Congress declare that since the unprovoked and dastardly attack by Japan on Sunday, December seventh, a state of war has existed between the United States and the Japanese Empire.

****

National Archives and Records Administration

We know, of course, that when FDR finished his wordsmithing of the speech that the first line, the one best remembered, turned out a little different: "Yesterday, December 7, 1941, a date which will live in infamy, the United States of America was suddenly and deliberately attacked by the naval and air forces of the Empire of Japan." 8

Prologue, the Quarterly of the National Archives, takes you through the various drafts of FDR's so-called "Day of Infamy" speech, with images of pages with his hand-written changes in wording and updates on Japanese attacks on other U.S. installations in the Pacific. And there's even a "deity" paragraph inserted by top Presidential assistant Harry Hopkins. 9

The six-minute speech ended with a request for a declaration of war, which Congress approved within hours. 10

In "FDR's 'Day of Infamy' Speech: Crafting a Call to Arms," Prologue shows you pages from all the drafts, as well as the transcribed version of his actual delivery to Congress on December 8, 1941. 11

And for the record, Roosevelt never used the term "Day of Infamy;" he said "a date which will live in infamy." 12

After Reading

5. Summarize the process President Roosevelt engaged in to write this speech.
6. Summarize the arguments made by President Roosevelt that justify America declaring war on Japan.

Engage with the Reading

1. President Roosevelt revised the phrasing in the opening sentence from "world history" to "infamy." Look up the word *infamy*; do you agree that this revision makes the speech stronger?

2. Consider other revisions Roosevelt made to his speech. Select an example of one edit or revision you feel is particularly effective and explain why.

READING SELECTION

"TO THE LADY"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this poem?
2. What do you know about Executive Order 9066 or about the internment of American citizens of Japanese descent during World War II? If you are unsure, do some research on the topic.

During Reading

3. On the first reading of the poem, understand the literal message of the poem—what each stanza (section) says.
4. On subsequent readings of the poem, consider how the author uses words and imagery and tone to communicate ideas.

To the Lady

By Mitsuye Yamada, 1976

Mitsuye Yamada is an author of stories and poems. Her parents were Japanese immigrants to the United States and in 1942 she and her family were relocated to a camp in Idaho under Executive Order 9066, which allowed the U.S. government to detain American citizens of Japanese descent in internment centers.

The one in San Francisco who asked: 1
Why did the Japanese Americans let
the government put them in
those camps without protest?

Come to think of it I 2
should've run off to Canada
should've hijacked a plane to Algeria
should've pulled myself up from my
bra straps
and kicked 'm in the groin
should've bombed a bank
should've tried self-immolation
should've holed myself up in a
woodframe house
and let you watch me
burn up on the six o'clock news
should've run howling down the street
naked and assaulted you at breakfast
by AP wirephoto
should've screamed bloody murder
like Kitty Genovese

Then 3
YOU would've
come to my aid in shining armor
laid yourself across the railroad track
marched on Washington
tattooed a Star of David on your arm
written six million enraged
letters to Congress

But we didn't draw the line 4
anywhere
law and order Executive Order 9066
social order moral order internal order
You let'm
I let'm
All are punished.

After Reading

5. The poem includes allusions to many events during the 1970s, when the poem was written and before. Select two allusions and research these to understand why the author included them.
6. Summarize the main idea of each stanza (section) of the poem.

Engage with the Reading

1. Consider the structure of the poem. Why are there four stanzas? How does the organization create an argument?
2. Do you feel that Japanese Americans should have done more to resist the internment camps? If so, what might have been effective means of protest? If not, why not?

READING SELECTION

"REMARKS ON SIGNING THE BILL PROVIDING RESTITUTION FOR THE WARTIME INTERNMENT OF JAPANESE-AMERICAN CIVILIANS"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this reading selection?
2. What does the word "restitution" mean? Why might Japanese Americans be entitled to restitution by the U.S. government for internment during World War II?

During Reading

3. On a first reading, understand the main ideas of the reading selection.
4. On a second reading, note the rhetorical devices used by President Reagan, including ethos, pathos, and logos.

Remarks on Signing the Bill Providing Restitution for the Wartime Internment of Japanese-American Civilians

By President Ronald Reagan, 10 August 1988

Forty-four years after Executive Order 9066 allowed for the relocation of Japanese Americans, the House of Representatives passed H.R. 442, or "An Act to implement recommendations of the Commission on Wartime Relocation and Internment of Civilians," which awarded $20,000 to Japanese Americans who had been interned in camps during World War II. Then President Ronald Reagan spoke on the occasion of signing the bill into law.

The Members of Congress and distinguished guests, my fellow Americans, we gather here today to right a grave wrong. More than 40 years ago, shortly after the bombing of Pearl Harbor, 120,000 persons of Japanese ancestry living in the United States were forcibly removed from their homes and placed in makeshift internment camps. This action was taken without trial, without jury. It was based solely on race, for these 120,000 were Americans of Japanese descent. 1

Yes, the Nation was then at war, struggling for its survival, and it's not for us today to pass judgment upon those who may have made mistakes while engaged in that great struggle. Yet we must recognize that the internment of Japanese-Americans was just that: a mistake. For throughout the war, Japanese-Americans in the tens of thousands remained utterly loyal to the United States. Indeed, scores of Japanese-Americans volunteered for our Armed Forces, many stepping forward in the internment camps themselves. The 442d Regimental Combat Team, made up entirely of Japanese-Americans, served with immense distinction to defend this nation, their nation. Yet back at home, the soldiers' families were being denied the very freedom for which so many of the soldiers themselves were laying down their lives. 2

Congressman Norman Mineta, with us today, was 10 years old when his family was interned. In the Congressman's words: "My own family was sent first to Santa Anita Racetrack. We showered in the horse paddocks. Some families lived in converted stables, others in hastily thrown together barracks. We were then moved to Heart Mountain, Wyoming, where our entire family lived in one small room of a rude tar paper barrack." Like so many tens of thousands of others, the members of the Mineta family lived in those conditions not for a matter of weeks or months but for 3 long years. 3

The legislation that I am about to sign provides for a restitution payment to each of the 60,000 surviving Japanese-Americans of the 120,000 who were relocated or detained. Yet no payment can make up for those lost years. So, what is most important in this bill has less to do with property than with honor. For here we admit a wrong; here we reaffirm our commitment as a nation to equal justice under the law. 4

I'd like to note that the bill I'm about to sign also provides funds for members of the Aleut community who were evacuated from the Aleutian and Pribilof Islands after a Japanese attack in 1942. This action was taken for the Aleuts' own protection, but property was lost or damaged that has never been replaced. 5

And now in closing, I wonder whether you'd permit me one personal reminiscence, one prompted by an old newspaper report sent to me by Rose Ochi, a former internee. The clipping comes from the Pacific Citizen and is dated December 1945. 6

"Arriving by plane from Washington," the article begins, "General Joseph W. Stilwell pinned the Distinguished Service Cross on Mary Masuda in a simple ceremony on the porch of her small frame shack near Talbert, Orange County. She was one of the first Americans of Japanese ancestry to return from relocation centers to California's farmlands." "Vinegar Joe" Stilwell was there that day to honor Kazuo Masuda, Mary's brother. You see, while Mary and her parents were in an internment camp, Kazuo served as staff sergeant to the 442d Regimental Combat Team. In one action, Kazuo ordered his men back and advanced through heavy fire, hauling a mortar. For 12 hours, he engaged in a singlehanded barrage of Nazi positions. Several weeks later at Cassino, Kazuo staged another lone advance. This time it cost him his life. 7

The newspaper clipping notes that her two surviving brothers were with Mary and her parents on the little porch that morning. These two brothers, like the heroic Kazuo, had served in the United States Army. After General Stilwell made the award, the motion picture actress Louise Allbritton, a Texas girl, told how a Texas battalion had been saved by the 442d. Other show business personalities paid tribute—Robert Young, Will Rogers, Jr. And one young actor said: "Blood that has soaked into the sands of a beach is all of one color. America stands unique in the world: the only country not founded on race but on a way, an ideal. Not in spite of but because of our polyglot background, we have had all the strength in the world. That is the American way." The name of that young actor—I hope I pronounce this right—was Ronald Reagan. And, yes, the ideal of liberty and justice for all—that is still the American way. 8

Thank you, and God bless you. And now let me sign H.R. 442, so fittingly named in honor of the 442d. 9

Thank you all again, and God bless you all. I think this is a fine day. 10

After Reading

5. Summarize the reasons given by President Reagan to support restitution for Japanese Americans.
6. Explain the appeals made by President Reagan that provide emotional support for restitution for Japanese Americans.

Engage with the Reading

1. Why does President Reagan include the experiences of Congressman Norman Mineta's family and of the Masuda family in his speech? How are the examples similar and different and how does each contribute to the message of the speech?

2. Were you convinced by President Reagan's speech that Japanese Americans deserve restitution for internment? Why or why not?

Writing Prompts for "America: Land of the Free?"

1. Rhetorical analysis: Select one of the speeches in Part 5 and explain the speaker's use of ethos, pathos, and logos and any other rhetorical devices to appeal to the audience and to effectively communicate a message.

2. Rhetorical analysis: Select one of the poems in Part 5 and explain the speaker's use of denotation, connotation, tone, and any other rhetorical devices to effectively communicate a message.
3. Response essay: Select one of the reading selections in Part 5 and write a response to it, stating whether you agree with the author's message and/or were persuaded by their words and ideas.
4. Poem response: Select one of the reading selections in this section and write a poem in response to it. Your poem might be a reflection on the theme or an update to the original work. Before the poem, include a paragraph that explains the purpose of the poem: what message you are communicating and how you use words, imagery, or any other rhetorical devices to do so.
5. Comparison paper: Compare President Roosevelt's speech advocating that America declare war on Japan to President Reagan's speech advocating for restitution for Japanese Americans interned during World War II. Consider how each president uses appeals and word choice to effectively communicate and convince the audience of the main idea of the speech.
6. Comparison paper: President Ronald Reagan was called the "Great Communicator" because of his ability to speak effectively to audiences. Using details from President Reagan's speech advocating for restitution for Japanese Americans interned during World War II (in this section) and his speech commemorating the 40th anniversary of the Normandy invasion (in the chapter "Rhetorically Analyzing Texts"), explain how Reagan uses appeals and word choice to communicate effectively to his audience.
7. Argumentative synthesis essay: Answer the question "Is America the Land of the Free?" by drawing on examples and evidence from the various texts in this chapter.
8. Research paper: Conduct research on the current state of immigrants to this country. Come to a conclusion as to whether immigrants are treated fairly upon arrival and whether they are able to achieve their goals when coming to the United States.

THEME: WHAT MAKES A PERSUASIVE ARGUMENT?

For centuries, arguments have been used to persuade readers to think in different ways, to motivate people to engage in difficult actions, or to right wrongs. For instance, the Greek philosopher Aristotle (385–323 BCE) developed the principles of ethos, pathos, and logos to explain what constitutes a persuasive argument, while the British philosopher Stephen Toulmin (1922–2009) developed the argumentative model of claim, grounds, and warrants to enable people to clarify their thinking and defend their stance. These argument models tend to focus on advocating for a position while refuting opposing views. However, Carl Rogers (1902–1987), a psychologist and therapist, developed a model of argument that seeks to reach common ground by understanding opposing views and arriving at a mutually satisfactory solution.

In this section, you will read arguments past and present that exemplify strong thinking and a variety of writing strategies. These arguments deal with controversial subject matter. It will be important to understand the context of the time when the argument was created, the background of the intended audience, as well as the message and medium of the argument to appreciate its impact and effectiveness. You can learn much from examining the rhetorical skill of persuasive arguments.

READING SELECTION

"A MODEST PROPOSAL"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this reading selection?
2. Why do you think the title is a "modest" proposal? What does this tell readers about the speaker?

During Reading

3. On a first reading, understand the main ideas of the reading selection.
4. On a second reading, note the organization of the reading, including where the author describes the problem and where he proposes a solution.

A Modest Proposal
For preventing the children of poor people in Ireland, from being a burden on their parents or country, and for making them beneficial to the public.

By Dr. Jonathan Swift, 1729

Jonathan Swift was an Irish author of essays, pamphlets, and books, including Gulliver's Travels. *"A Modest Proposal" is recognized as a classic example of satire, which uses humor, irony, exaggeration, or ridicule to expose and criticize people's stupidities or vices. In this case, the speaker suggests an unrealistic solution to the very real problem of the poor Irish: sell their children as food to the rich, thus calling attention to the suffering of the Irish and the callousness of the rich.*

It is a melancholy object to those, who walk through this great town, or travel in the country, when they see the streets, the roads, and cabbin-doors crowded with beggars of the female sex, followed by three, four, or six children, all in rags, and importuning every passenger for an alms. These mothers, instead of being able to work for their honest livelihood, are forced to employ all their time in stroling to beg sustenance for their 1

helpless infants who, as they grow up, either turn thieves for want of work, or leave their dear native country, to fight for the Pretender in Spain, or sell themselves to the Barbadoes.

2 I think it is agreed by all parties, that this prodigious number of children in the arms, or on the backs, or at the heels of their mothers, and frequently of their fathers, is in the present deplorable state of the kingdom, a very great additional grievance; and therefore whoever could find out a fair, cheap and easy method of making these children sound and useful members of the commonwealth, would deserve so well of the publick, as to have his statue set up for a preserver of the nation.

3 But my intention is very far from being confined to provide only for the children of professed beggars: it is of a much greater extent, and shall take in the whole number of infants at a certain age, who are born of parents in effect as little able to support them, as those who demand our charity in the streets.

4 As to my own part, having turned my thoughts for many years upon this important subject, and maturely weighed the several schemes of our projectors, I have always found them grossly mistaken in their computation. It is true, a child just dropt from its dam, may be supported by her milk, for a solar year, with little other nourishment: at most not above the value of two shillings, which the mother may certainly get, or the value in scraps, by her lawful occupation of begging; and it is exactly at one year old that I propose to provide for them in such a manner, as, instead of being a charge upon their parents, or the parish, or wanting food and raiment for the rest of their lives, they shall, on the contrary, contribute to the feeding, and partly to the clothing of many thousands.

5 There is likewise another great advantage in my scheme, that it will prevent those voluntary abortions, and that horrid practice of women murdering their bastard children, alas! too frequent among us, sacrificing the poor innocent babes, I doubt, more to avoid the expence than the shame, which would move tears and pity in the most savage and inhuman breast.

6 The number of souls in this kingdom being usually reckoned one million and a half, of these I calculate there may be about two hundred thousand couple, whose wives are breeders; from which number I subtract thirty thousand couple, who are able to maintain their own children, (although I apprehend there cannot be so many under the present distresses of the kingdom) but this being granted, there will remain a hundred and seventy thousand breeders. I again subtract fifty thousand, for those women who miscarry, or whose children die by accident or disease within the year. There only remain a hundred and twenty thousand children of poor parents annually born. The question therefore is, How this number shall be reared and provided for? which, as I have already said, under the present situation of affairs, is utterly impossible by all the methods hitherto proposed. For we can neither employ them in handicraft or agriculture; they neither build houses, (I mean in the country) nor cultivate land: they can very seldom pick up a livelihood by stealing till they arrive at six years old; except where they are of towardly parts, although I confess they learn the rudiments much earlier; during which time they can however be properly looked upon only as probationers; as I have been informed by a principal gentleman in the county of Cavan, who protested to me, that he never knew above one or two instances under the age of six, even in a part of the kingdom so renowned for the quickest proficiency in that art.

7 I am assured by our merchants, that a boy or a girl, before twelve years old, is no saleable commodity, and even when they come to this age, they will not yield above three

pounds, or three pounds and half a crown at most, on the exchange; which cannot turn to account either to the parents or kingdom, the charge of nutriments and rags having been at least four times that value.

I shall now therefore humbly propose my own thoughts, which I hope will not be liable to the least objection. 8

I have been assured by a very knowing American of my acquaintance in London, that a young healthy child well nursed, is, at a year old, a most delicious nourishing and wholesome food, whether stewed, roasted, baked, or boiled; and I make no doubt that it will equally serve in a fricasee, or a ragoust. 9

I do therefore humbly offer it to publick consideration, that of the hundred and twenty thousand children, already computed, twenty thousand may be reserved for breed, whereof only one fourth part to be males; which is more than we allow to sheep, black cattle, or swine, and my reason is, that these children are seldom the fruits of marriage, a circumstance not much regarded by our savages, therefore, one male will be sufficient to serve four females. That the remaining hundred thousand may, at a year old, be offered in sale to the persons of quality and fortune, through the kingdom, always advising the mother to let them suck plentifully in the last month, so as to render them plump, and fat for a good table. A child will make two dishes at an entertainment for friends, and when the family dines alone, the fore or hind quarter will make a reasonable dish, and seasoned with a little pepper or salt, will be very good boiled on the fourth day, especially in winter. 10

I have reckoned upon a medium, that a child just born will weigh 12 pounds, and in a solar year, if tolerably nursed, encreaseth to 28 pounds. 11

I grant this food will be somewhat dear, and therefore very proper for landlords, who, as they have already devoured most of the parents, seem to have the best title to the children. 12

Infant's flesh will be in season throughout the year, but more plentiful in March, and a little before and after; for we are told by a grave author, an eminent French physician, that fish being a prolifick dyet, there are more children born in Roman Catholick countries about nine months after Lent, than at any other season; therefore, reckoning a year after Lent, the markets will be more glutted than usual, because the number of Popish infants, is at least three to one in this kingdom, and therefore it will have one other collateral advantage, by lessening the number of Papists among us. 13

I have already computed the charge of nursing a beggar's child (in which list I reckon all cottagers, labourers, and four-fifths of the farmers) to be about two shillings per annum, rags included; and I believe no gentleman would repine to give ten shillings for the carcass of a good fat child, which, as I have said, will make four dishes of excellent nutritive meat, when he hath only some particular friend, or his own family to dine with him. Thus the squire will learn to be a good landlord, and grow popular among his tenants, the mother will have eight shillings neat profit, and be fit for work till she produces another child. 14

Those who are more thrifty (as I must confess the times require) may flay the carcass; the skin of which, artificially dressed, will make admirable gloves for ladies, and summer boots for fine gentlemen. 15

As to our City of Dublin, shambles may be appointed for this purpose, in the most convenient parts of it, and butchers we may be assured will not be wanting; although I 16

rather recommend buying the children alive, and dressing them hot from the knife, as we do roasting pigs.

A very worthy person, a true lover of his country, and whose virtues I highly esteem, 17
was lately pleased in discoursing on this matter, to offer a refinement upon my scheme. He said, that many gentlemen of this kingdom, having of late destroyed their deer, he conceived that the want of venison might be well supplied by the bodies of young lads and maidens, not exceeding fourteen years of age, nor under twelve; so great a number of both sexes in every county being now ready to starve for want of work and service: and these to be disposed of by their parents if alive, or otherwise by their nearest relations. But with due deference to so excellent a friend, and so deserving a patriot, I cannot be altogether in his sentiments; for as to the males, my American acquaintance assured me from frequent experience, that their flesh was generally tough and lean, like that of our schoolboys, by continual exercise, and their taste disagreeable, and to fatten them would not answer the charge. Then as to the females, it would, I think, with humble submission, be a loss to the publick, because they soon would become breeders themselves: and besides, it is not improbable that some scrupulous people might be apt to censure such a practice, (although indeed very unjustly) as a little bordering upon cruelty, which, I confess, hath always been with me the strongest objection against any project, how well soever intended.

But in order to justify my friend, he confessed, that this expedient was put into his 18
head by the famous Psalmanaazor, a native of the island Formosa, who came from thence to London, above twenty years ago, and in conversation told my friend, that in his country, when any young person happened to be put to death, the executioner sold the carcass to persons of quality, as a prime dainty; and that, in his time, the body of a plump girl of fifteen, who was crucified for an attempt to poison the Emperor, was sold to his imperial majesty's prime minister of state, and other great mandarins of the court in joints from the gibbet, at four hundred crowns. Neither indeed can I deny, that if the same use were made of several plump young girls in this town, who without one single groat to their fortunes, cannot stir abroad without a chair, and appear at a playhouse and assemblies in foreign fineries which they never will pay for, the kingdom would not be the worse.

Some persons of a desponding spirit are in great concern about that vast number 19
of poor people, who are aged, diseased, or maimed; and I have been desired to employ my thoughts what course may be taken, to ease the nation of so grievous an incumbrance. But I am not in the least pain upon that matter, because it is very well known, that they are every day dying, and rotting, by cold and famine, and filth, and vermin, as fast as can be reasonably expected. And as to the young labourers, they are now in almost as hopeful a condition. They cannot get work, and consequently pine away from want of nourishment, to a degree, that if at any time they are accidentally hired to common labour, they have not strength to perform it, and thus the country and themselves are happily delivered from the evils to come.

I have too long digressed, and therefore shall return to my subject. I think the 20
advantages by the proposal which I have made are obvious and many, as well as of the highest importance.

For first, as I have already observed, it would greatly lessen the number of Papists, 21
with whom we are yearly overrun, being the principal breeders of the nation, as well as our most dangerous enemies, and who stay at home on purpose with a design to deliver the kingdom to the Pretender, hoping to take their advantage by the absence of so many

good Protestants, who have chosen rather to leave their country, than stay at home and pay tithes against their conscience to an episcopal curate.

Secondly, The poorer tenants will have something valuable of their own, which by law may be made liable to a distress, and help to pay their landlord's rent, their corn and cattle being already seized, and money a thing unknown. 22

Thirdly, Whereas the maintainance of a hundred thousand children, from two years old, and upwards, cannot be computed at less than ten shillings a piece per annum, the nation's stock will be thereby encreased fifty thousand pounds per annum, besides the profit of a new dish, introduced to the tables of all gentlemen of fortune in the kingdom, who have any refinement in taste. And the money will circulate among our selves, the goods being entirely of our own growth and manufacture. 23

Fourthly, The constant breeders, besides the gain of eight shillings sterling per annum by the sale of their children, will be rid of the charge of maintaining them after the first year. 24

Fifthly, This food would likewise bring great custom to taverns, where the vintners will certainly be so prudent as to procure the best receipts for dressing it to perfection; and consequently have their houses frequented by all the fine gentlemen, who justly value themselves upon their knowledge in good eating; and a skilful cook, who understands how to oblige his guests, will contrive to make it as expensive as they please. 25

Sixthly, This would be a great inducement to marriage, which all wise nations have either encouraged by rewards, or enforced by laws and penalties. It would encrease the care and tenderness of mothers towards their children, when they were sure of a settlement for life to the poor babes, provided in some sort by the publick, to their annual profit instead of expence. We should soon see an honest emulation among the married women, which of them could bring the fattest child to the market. Men would become as fond of their wives, during the time of their pregnancy, as they are now of their mares in foal, their cows in calf, or sows when they are ready to farrow; nor offer to beat or kick them (as is too frequent a practice) for fear of a miscarriage. 26

Many other advantages might be enumerated. For instance, the addition of some thousand carcasses in our exportation of barrel'd beef: the propagation of swine's flesh, and improvement in the art of making good bacon, so much wanted among us by the great destruction of pigs, too frequent at our tables; which are no way comparable in taste or magnificence to a well grown, fat yearling child, which roasted whole will make a considerable figure at a Lord Mayor's feast, or any other publick entertainment. But this, and many others, I omit, being studious of brevity. 27

Supposing that one thousand families in this city, would be constant customers for infants flesh, besides others who might have it at merry meetings, particularly at weddings and christenings, I compute that Dublin would take off annually about twenty thousand carcasses; and the rest of the kingdom (where probably they will be sold somewhat cheaper) the remaining eighty thousand. 28

I can think of no one objection, that will possibly be raised against this proposal, unless it should be urged, that the number of people will be thereby much lessened in the kingdom. This I freely own, and was indeed one principal design in offering it to the world. I desire the reader will observe, that I calculate my remedy for this one individual Kingdom of Ireland, and for no other that ever was, is, or, I think, ever can be upon Earth. Therefore let no man talk to me of other expedients: Of taxing our absentees at 29

five shillings a pound: Of using neither clothes, nor houshold furniture, except what is of our own growth and manufacture: Of utterly rejecting the materials and instruments that promote foreign luxury: Of curing the expensiveness of pride, vanity, idleness, and gaming in our women: Of introducing a vein of parsimony, prudence and temperance: Of learning to love our country, wherein we differ even from Laplanders, and the inhabitants of Topinamboo: Of quitting our animosities and factions, nor acting any longer like the Jews, who were murdering one another at the very moment their city was taken: Of being a little cautious not to sell our country and consciences for nothing: Of teaching landlords to have at least one degree of mercy towards their tenants. Lastly, of putting a spirit of honesty, industry, and skill into our shopkeepers, who, if a resolution could now be taken to buy only our native goods, would immediately unite to cheat and exact upon us in the price, the measure, and the goodness, nor could ever yet be brought to make one fair proposal of just dealing, though often and earnestly invited to it.

30 Therefore I repeat, let no man talk to me of these and the like expedients, till he hath at least some glympse of hope, that there will ever be some hearty and sincere attempt to put them into practice.

31 But, as to myself, having been wearied out for many years with offering vain, idle, visionary thoughts, and at length utterly despairing of success, I fortunately fell upon this proposal, which, as it is wholly new, so it hath something solid and real, of no expence and little trouble, full in our own power, and whereby we can incur no danger in disobliging England. For this kind of commodity will not bear exportation, and flesh being of too tender a consistence, to admit a long continuance in salt, although perhaps I could name a country, which would be glad to eat up our whole nation without it.

32 After all, I am not so violently bent upon my own opinion, as to reject any offer, proposed by wise men, which shall be found equally innocent, cheap, easy, and effectual. But before something of that kind shall be advanced in contradiction to my scheme, and offering a better, I desire the author or authors will be pleased maturely to consider two points. First, As things now stand, how they will be able to find food and raiment for a hundred thousand useless mouths and backs. And secondly, There being a round million of creatures in humane figure throughout this kingdom, whose whole subsistence put into a common stock, would leave them in debt two million of pounds sterling, adding those who are beggars by profession, to the bulk of farmers, cottagers and labourers, with their wives and children, who are beggars in effect; I desire those politicians who dislike my overture, and may perhaps be so bold to attempt an answer, that they will first ask the parents of these mortals, whether they would not at this day think it a great happiness to have been sold for food at a year old, in the manner I prescribe, and thereby have avoided such a perpetual scene of misfortunes, as they have since gone through, by the oppression of landlords, the impossibility of paying rent without money or trade, the want of common sustenance, with neither house nor clothes to cover them from the inclemencies of the weather, and the most inevitable prospect of intailing the like, or greater miseries, upon their breed for ever.

33 I profess in the sincerity of my heart, that I have not the least personal interest in endeavouring to promote this necessary work, having no other motive than the publick good of my country, by advancing our trade, providing for infants, relieving the poor, and giving some pleasure to the rich. I have no children, by which I can propose to get a single penny; the youngest being nine years old, and my wife past child-bearing.

After Reading

5. Summarize the reasons given by the speaker as to why it makes sense to sell poor children for food.
6. Summarize the alternative proposals or objections the speaker raises and rejects.

Engage with the Reading

1. How does the speaker use organization and language to appear to present a reasonable argument? How does this organization help his satire?

2. Did you find Swift's satire effective at raising concerns about the poor Irish? For instance, what strategies does Swift use to evoke sympathy for the poor and to propose viable solutions?

READING SELECTION

"AIN'T I A WOMAN?"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this reading selection?
2. What do you know about the antislavery movement or about the women's rights movements around 1850 in America?

During Reading

3. On a first reading, understand the main ideas of the reading selection.
4. On a second reading, note the appeals used by Truth to gain her audience's attention and advance her argument.

Ain't I a Woman?

By Sojourner Truth

Akron, Ohio, 1851

Sojourner Truth was born a slave in 1797 but escaped from her master and became involved in both the antislavery and the women's rights movements. At the 1851 Women's Rights Convention in Akron, Ohio, Sojourner Truth delivered her speech "Ain't I a Woman?" arguing that women deserved rights just as men do.

Well, children, where there is so much racket there must be something out of kilter. I think that 'twixt the negroes of the South and the women at the North, all talking about rights, the white men will be in a fix pretty soon. But what's all this here talking about? 1

That man over there says that women need to be helped into carriages, and lifted over ditches, and to have the best place everywhere. Nobody ever helps me into carriages, or over mud-puddles, or gives me any best place! And ain't I a woman? Look at me! Look at my arm! I have ploughed and planted, and gathered into barns, and no man could head me! And ain't I a woman? I could work as much and eat as much as a man—when I could get it—and bear the lash as well! And ain't I a woman? I have borne thirteen children, and seen most all sold off to slavery, and when I cried out with my mother's grief, none but Jesus heard me! And ain't I a woman? 2

Then they talk about this thing in the head; what's this they call it? [member of audience whispers, "intellect"] That's it, honey. What's that got to do with women's rights or negroes' rights? If my cup won't hold but a pint, and yours holds a quart, wouldn't you be mean not to let me have my little half measure full? 3

Then that little man in black there, he says women can't have as much rights as men, 'cause Christ wasn't a woman! Where did your Christ come from? Where did your Christ come from? From God and a woman! Man had nothing to do with Him. 4

If the first woman God ever made was strong enough to turn the world upside down all alone, these women together ought to be able to turn it back, and get it right side up again! And now they is asking to do it, the men better let them. 5

Obliged to you for hearing me, and now old Sojourner ain't got nothing more to say. 6

After Reading

5. Summarize the reasons given by Truth as to why women deserve equal rights to men.
6. Explain how Truth anticipates and counters arguments against women's rights.

Engage with the Reading

1. How does the speaker use humor and other appeals to engage her audience?
2. Which parts of Truth's speech do you feel are most effective and why?

READING SELECTION

"THE GETTYSBURG ADDRESS"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this reading selection?
2. What do you know about the American Civil War? For instance, why was America at war and why was the country divided?

During Reading

3. On a first reading, understand the main ideas of the reading selection.
4. On a second reading, note the appeals used by President Lincoln.

The Gettysburg Address

By Abraham Lincoln

Gettysburg, Pennsylvania, 19 November 1863

At the dedication of the National Cemetery at Gettysburg, Pennsylvania, the site of one of the most decisive and bloodiest battles of the American Civil War, President Abraham Lincoln delivered an address honoring the soldiers who died. Approximately 23,000 Union soldiers (and 28,000 Confederate soldiers) lost their lives over the course of a three-day battle and the country was still at war.

Four score and seven years ago our fathers brought forth on this continent, a new nation, conceived in Liberty, and dedicated to the proposition that all men are created equal. 1

Now we are engaged in a great civil war, testing whether that nation, or any nation so conceived and so dedicated, can long endure. We are met on a great battle-field of that war. We have come to dedicate a portion of that field, as a final resting place for those who here gave their lives that that nation might live. It is altogether fitting and proper that we should do this. 2

But, in a larger sense, we can not dedicate—we can not consecrate—we can not hallow—this ground. The brave men, living and dead, who struggled here, have consecrated it, far above our poor power to add or detract. The world will little note, nor long remember what we say here, but it can never forget what they did here. It is for us the living, rather, to be dedicated here to the unfinished work which they who fought here have thus far so nobly advanced. It is rather for us to be here dedicated to the great task remaining before us—that from these honored dead we take increased devotion to that cause for which they gave the last full measure of devotion—that we here highly resolve that these dead shall not have died in vain—that this nation, under God, shall have a new birth of freedom—and that government of the people, by the people, for the people, shall not perish from the earth. 3

After Reading

5. Summarize the opening sentence of Lincoln's speech.
6. Summarize the closing sentence of Lincoln's speech.

Engage with the Reading

1. Why does President Lincoln say that "we here highly resolve that these dead shall not have died in vain"? How do these words support the North's involvement in the Civil War?
2. Why do you think Lincoln's speech, as brief as it is, is so powerful and recognized as one of the greatest speeches in history?

READING SELECTION

"SAYING HER NAME: WHAT MONUMENTS TO SOJOURNER TRUTH CAN TEACH US ABOUT MEMORIALIZING BLACK LIVES"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What will be the topic of this reading selection?
2. How can the way a person is depicted in a work of art, such as in a painting or on a statue, influence the viewer's perception of that person?

During Reading

3. On a first reading, understand the main ideas of the reading selection.
4. On a second reading, note the details and evidence the author uses to support the main ideas.

Saying Her Name: What Monuments to Sojourner Truth Can Teach Us About Memorializing Black Lives

By Frances Cathryn

Social Text Online, 5 November 2020

Frances Cathryn is a scholar, museum worker, and community organizer in Kingston, New York. Her work focuses on understanding the context of objects and images, particularly in art and history. In her examination of two statues depicting the antislavery and pro-women's rights activist Sojourner Truth, Cathryn suggests "visual vocabulary" communicates important messages to viewers about the worth of the subject.

In Esopus, a small town in upstate New York, a monument dedicated to Sojourner Truth was erected in 2009 (fig. 1). Truth was born in the area then known as Swartekill, some time in 1797, and lived in bondage in Ulster County for three decades. The memorial depicts Truth as an enslaved child to serve as a reminder of the institution of slavery in New York, according to a member of the commission tasked with putting it together. Truth self-emancipated in 1826 and won her son's freedom in court against her former enslaver two years later, the first instance of a Black woman successfully suing a white man in United States history. Truth was a renowned abolitionist, fervent women's rights advocate, and accomplished public speaker. She recruited Black troops for the Union Army during the Civil War. She lobbied for reparations for formerly enslaved Black Americans. What are the implications, then, of casting Truth actually and figuratively into bondage? 1

Public monuments are by necessity conservative because they are meant to stand unchanged; therefore, they are rarely able to tell a complicated story about past events or people. How we depict historical Black figures in public spaces is important because it either reinforces or undermines cultural stereotypes about Black lives now. Reducing Truth to an enslaved child in the cultural narrative is thus an indirect but still pernicious form of historical erasure; her full life and achievements are irrelevant to the story told by and through this monument to her. Writer Saidiya Hartman calls this a failure to look outside a "racial calculus" of enslavement. While the intention to humanize the figure by depicting her in girlhood is clear, important parts of Truth's life and work are lost to the viewer. But by positioning the Sojourner Truth memorial within a larger conversation around commemorative gestures, we can better understand how a lack of imagination keeps us from seeing a Black figure beyond the reductive narrative of supremacy. Doing so can even help us understand, from a historical perspective, how we misrepresent Black life today and continue to devalue it.

FIGURE 1. 2

***Sojourner Truth Memorial* in Esopus, New York. Courtesy of the author.**
Frances Vigna

Contemporary monuments must often play two roles: engage the public in a larger 3
dialogue about site-specific histories *and* correct a biased historical record. The Sojourner Truth memorial in Esopus fails to achieve the latter, reinforcing her oppressed status and thereby diminishing her power in our collective memory. The monument's sculptor, New Paltz-based Trina Greene, depicts her around age twelve, cast in bronze. The artwork stands about five feet and six inches high and is installed on a small granite plinth. The girl is barefoot with her right heel planted firmly in front of her left foot mid-stride. She carries two jugs—one of liquor and the other full of molasses—in her left hand and under her right arm at her hip (fig. 2). The hatched markings on her dress lend it the appearance of coarse material, and the garment's open back exposes deep scars cut into her shoulders (fig. 3). As noted by reporters covering the memorial's unveiling ceremony, children reached out to touch the detailed grooves on the girl's back. The research committee, comprising local historians, scholars, public officials, and citizens, was instrumental in unearthing Truth's childhood story and establishing locations as sites of historical significance. Looking at this monument to her, however, it is hard to see what the woman was able to accomplish in her lifetime. We focus instead on the physical marks of bondage: her bare feet, coarse dress, and scarred body. This means that more than a century and a half after emancipation in the United States, the Black figure is still effectively subjugated in the historical imagination.

FIGURE 2.

The statue depicts Truth mid-stride, carrying two jugs. Courtesy of the author.
Frances Vigna

Because we still cannot imagine what freedom looks like, we do not have the vocabulary (visual or otherwise) to define it, let alone to begin to articulate it in public space. And the commemorative artistic tradition does not offer a comprehensive visual vocabulary to begin. This problem isn't new: art historian Kirk Savage's work shows us how the imagery of enslavement in nineteenth-century public monuments maintains the subjugation of Black people in the American narrative. In his book *Standing Soldiers, Kneeling Slaves,* Savage argues that the "logic of commemoration" constrained the imagery of emancipation in public

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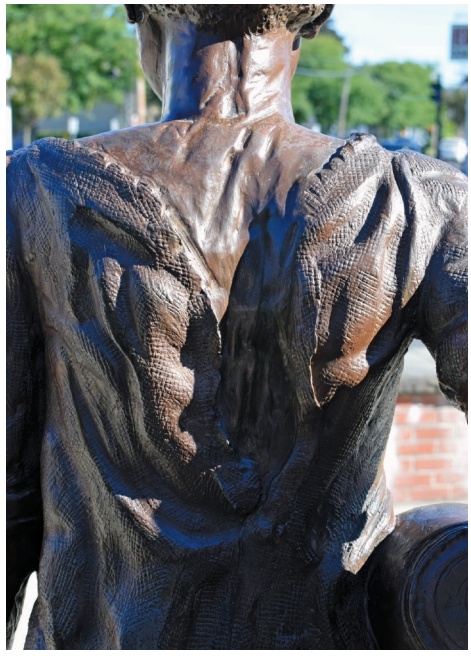

FIGURE 3.

Trina Greene's statue in Esopus includes representations of scars on Sojourner Truth's back. Courtesy of the author.
Frances Vigna

monuments. While sculptors attempted to innovate a centuries-old genre that traditionally idealized the European form, most could not successfully imagine what would "speak to what the nation was in the process of becoming." This perennial challenge is due in most part to the abandonment of the goals of Reconstruction in the crucial period after the Civil War.

5 Looking back, much of the nineteenth-century imagery meant to commemorate the hard-won fight for freedom depicted Black figures in poses that deny them their agency. The most common representation modeled an antislavery medallion known for its phrase "Am I Not a Man and a Brother," showing a supplicant Black figure to elicit sympathy for the abolitionist movement. This popular pose reinforced the stereotype of Black men and women as helpless and childlike, a stereotype that abolitionists and anti-abolitionists alike used to support their causes. Another prevailing image of emancipation that made its way into the postwar consciousness was an enslaved Black man kneeling before a white savior figure, usually Abraham Lincoln. One of the better-known public monuments depicting this relationship is the Emancipation Memorial in Boston, which the city's arts commission voted unanimously to have removed in July. The monument, designed by Thomas Ball and installed in 1879, creates a physical hierarchy that strengthens a social one. The manacled and half-clothed man, whose face turns up toward Lincoln's outstretched hand, forever relies on the emancipator's beneficence to imagine freedom.

6 Societal expectations of ownership over Black people strengthen a current sense of entitlement to view those people in all instances and leads to their ongoing surveillance and policing. If we compare nineteenth-century monuments to modern-day memorials to Black Americans, questions about representation and purpose continue to bubble to the surface. There has been a strong push in recent years to circulate media of murdered Black Americans in life, not to depict their deaths. But the desire to raise awareness of the everyday brutality and state-sanctioned violence against Black Americans in the public consciousness cuts both ways, no matter how those Black Americans are depicted. Artist Amy Sherald's portrait of Breonna Taylor on the September cover of *Vanity Fair* was lauded for its artistic value but criticized by some for commodifying the death of the Louisville woman. Many viewers, including Taylor's family, appreciate seeing Taylor's name and image in the media six months after she was murdered by officers Jonathan Mattingly, Brett Hankison, and Myles Cosgrove. (At the time of writing, none has been arrested and charged with her death.) But as she grows as a symbol of the movement for Black lives, Breonna Taylor's actual life story becomes less relevant. And, as many critics have pointed out, memorials to Breonna Taylor do not seem to have a significant effect on bringing about justice.

7 This type of trauma laundering is not new, but it's important to distinguish *who* is sharing contemporary images of Black suffering and to what purpose. In an interview on the history of Black-death-as-spectacle titled "'What Does It Mean to Be Black and Look at This?' A Scholar Reflects on the Dana Schutz Controversy," Christina Sharpe explains that Mamie Till Mobley published photographs of her son's body in a national magazine to make the violent details of his death real and unobscured. By comparison, Dana Schutz's painting of Till's open casket, included in the 2017 Whitney Biennial, solicits a different response. Her relationship to the violence that ended Till's life is abstract, according to Sharpe, but, as a white artist, Schutz felt entitled to depict it. More recently, Samaria Rice has problematized the use of her son's image in ways meant to commemorate him. She protested representations of Tamir Rice in a since-canceled show, "The Breath of Empty

FIGURE 4.

Sculpture of Sojourner Truth by Vinnie Bagwell, Highland, New York. Courtesy of the author.

Frances Vigna

Space," at the Museum of Contemporary Art Cleveland. Members of the community expressed concern that the museum would not be able to "support the show responsibly" and center the lived experiences of those impacted most by anti-Black state-sanctioned violence. The artist, Shaun Leonardo, has decried censorship, but Samaria Rice has publicly criticized Leonardo for portraying the pain and trauma surrounding Tamir's death and has requested that he no longer exhibit the images.

Public monuments rely on a consensus view (however slippery that term might be) of a fixed interpretation of the past. A newly erected bronze by Yonkers-based artist Vinnie Bagwell depicts Truth as she should be seen: powerful. The seven-foot-tall work of public art was installed in Highland, New York, in August 2020 (fig. 4). In Bagwell's depiction, Truth is older and fully 8

FIGURE 5.

Sojourner Truth's walking cane in Bagwell's rendering. Courtesy of the author.

Frances Vigna

FIGURE 6.

Sojourner Truth's outstretched hand in Bagwell's rendering. Courtesy of the author.
Frances Vigna

clothed in a simple dress, woolen shawl, cap, and her signature glasses. She holds a cane in her left hand (evoking another common motif of the abolitionist movement, the liberty pole), and extends her right upturned palm (fig. 5 and fig. 6). In the commemorative tradition, allegorical motifs tell a story that is often too complicated to represent in a single form. We see this in representations of emancipation, when a scroll does the heavy lifting to narrativize the fight for freedom in the United States. Likewise, Bagwell relies on easily recognizable symbols to convey pivotal moments in Truth's life. In the drapery of her skirt are bas-reliefs including a young enslaved mother and child, a poster for a women's suffrage march, lines from her speeches, words in Dutch and braille, and her name at birth, Isabelle Baumfree (fig. 7).

Despite best intentions, we see time and again how attempts at commemoration can dehumanize the victims at the center of the stories, including historical figures. "Public art reflects the values of a community," Bagwell explained to me recently in an interview. "And because we've been

9

FIGURE 7.

Bas-reliefs in the drapery of the skirt. Courtesy of the author.
Frances Vigna

marginalized, Black people want to see ourselves reflected in public art." Tamika Palmer is grateful her daughter has not disappeared from the larger conversation around police brutality. Cory McLiechey, Sojourner Truth's sixth-great-grandson, appreciates that his ancestor's legacy is being fully recognized in the history of movements for social justice. (And similar to the children at the unveiling of the Truth memorial in Esopus, McLiechey felt compelled to reach out to touch the monument and hold his grandmother's bronze hand.) Artist Grace Lynne Haynes, whose portrait of Truth was featured on the cover of the *New Yorker* in July, explained in an interview for the magazine that there is a "lack of nuance in portrayals of Black womanhood." Bagwell echoes that sentiment: "We don't want to see caricatures or representations," she told me. "We want to see Black people as people."

One possible way to move beyond caricatured versions of the past is by paying attention to what has already been done. Art historian Renée Ater has been compiling contemporary interpretations of enslavement and emancipation in an ongoing project, "Contemporary Monuments to the Slave Past," to understand how modern societies engage with these histories through public space. Ater has laid out a series of questions at the heart of her archive, among them how to define the visual vocabularies that artists utilize in their depictions. This type of repository can serve as an invaluable resource of information as we attempt to reconcile these brutal histories in our public representations of them, and it's a good place to start. But finding the visual language to articulate the brutality of chattel slavery is only one small part of the larger social project. As Ater explains, documenting the representations of slavery's past is important because "slavery continues to shape the world we inhabit." Without first reconciling the failed experiment of Reconstruction and ending the current everyday violence against Black Americans, we cannot memorialize racial equality because it doesn't yet exist in the present. We march, we protest, we "say her name" because the list of Black Americans murdered with impunity continues to grow. 10

After Reading

5. At the end of the first paragraph, the author asks, "What are the implications . . . of casting Truth actually and figuratively into bondage?" How does the author answer her own question?
6. Summarize the differences between the two statues of Sojourner Truth and what the author feels those differences represent.

Engage with the Reading

1. Do you agree with the author's claim that "How we depict historical Black figures in public spaces is important because it either reinforces or undermines cultural stereotypes about Black lives now"?
2. Did reading Cathryn's essay make you look at public art in a different way? Explain.

READING SELECTION

"OP-ED: LET'S PUSH THE LANGUAGE OF JOURNALISM PAST ITS LIMITS"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. What do you think it means to "push the language of journalism past its limits"?
2. What are different ways that people might get news or information? How do you receive information or news?

During Reading

3. On a first reading, understand the main ideas of the reading selection.
4. On a second reading, note the details and evidence the author uses to support the main ideas.

Op-ed: Let's Push the Language of Journalism Past Its Limits

By Alissa Quart

Columbia Journalism Review, 6 September 2019

Alissa Quart is the executive director of the Economic Hardship Reporting Project, a nonpartisan, nonprofit organization that uses creative journalism to raise awareness about income inequities in the United States. In this piece, Quart argues that liberal journalists should use inventive writing to counter the messages of conservative voices.

Two years past Donald Trump's presidency, journalists and pundits seem hard-pressed for new, effective ways to describe each fresh outrage. That may be because we've reached the limits of journalism's typical lingo and genres—of the blaring 24-hour news cycle, in which news outlets endlessly refresh their coverage of a worsening incident, framed by "BREAKING NEWS" chyrons that repeat our president's racist Twitter commentary. No matter what Trump says, and no matter what we write, the results are often the same—indignation or repulsion from the resistance, a shrug or smirk or dismissal from the cult of Donald. The recent mass shooting in El Paso led to coverage of the use of the word "invasion" by both Trump and the killer to characterize immigration; this language seeps into our imaginations, and defines public debate. When words and traditional genres fail us, what other techniques might journalists deploy to break through the thicket of bigoted remarks and familiar stories of misery? 1

So here's a modest proposal: let's take the forms we use to the brink. And let's also reach for unexpected genres, and fresh modes of expression (and if we are going to use the written word utilize unexpected language). Let's turn to activist and reported poetry, 2

create tweetstorms as journalism and protest, assemble more unedited audio clips of utter societal cruelty—children crying when removed from their parents. We could even project information onto buildings.

Without new forms, we can get stuck in certain frameworks; as linguist George Lakoff has warned, when one political party becomes trapped in another party's field of reference, the former can act as stenographers—or worse, publicists—for the latter's worldview. 3

Unadulterated expression—such as the recent video clips of kids whose parents were arrested by ICE in Mississippi, or audio posted by ProPublica of children crying for their undocumented parents—can loosen the grip that Trump clichés and critiques place on news coverage. The rawness of such recordings places them, in some sense, beyond language; helps them maneuver around audience apathy; and repels accusations of "fake news." 4

If we are going to use the written word, we need to be more imaginative about the modes we are using. What about poetry? Don't laugh. Compared to news coverage, you might think of poetry as marginal, or ineffective, or obscure. But Danez Smith's videos of their poems about race and gender, which have been viewed hundreds of thousands of times on YouTube, are anything but. Student and immigrant activist also Jose Bello made waves with his poem, "Dear America," which he read in front of the Kern County Board of Supervisors in Bakersfield, California, shortly before his arrest by ICE. 5

I am also thinking of "documentary poetry," which is reported poetry based on interviews, newspaper accounts, or oral histories. In one such project, taxi drivers and waiters collaborate on poems with titles such as "Instruction Manual" that come directly from language used by their customers and bosses, and clarify the struggle of the American working class in a way that today's supposedly sunny employment numbers never do. And, given recent revision of poet Emma Lazarus's "The New Colossus" by Ken Cuccinelli, acting director of US Citizenship and Immigration Services, in a radio interview ("Give me your tired and your poor who can stand on their own two feet and who will not become a public charge"), we might also consider revising classic poems in the positive, to make contemporary political expressions. 6

We could also try to reproduce the power of some recent, unintentional news ventures, such as the tweetstorm that sprouted organically in response to a US Army tweet exhorting veterans to share their military experience on social media. Thousands did, creating a horrifying list-poem of mutilation, PTSD, familial alcoholism, abuse, and the damages inflicted on our "enemies" and their children—a virtual mile of human catastrophe. The tweetstorm forced the suffering of veterans back into people's minds, nearly two decades after the beginning of the war in Afghanistan. Unconventional expressions of dissent can blow up unexpectedly, communicating a world of suffering and history far better than a conventional news story could. 7

Some media makers are also gaining traction by effectively going "Banksy" on the news—using protest signs, physical theater, light-shows, emojis, and billboards, among other things, to export their concerns. Their materials are not printed pages or binary code but rather the sides of buildings or the walls of subway stations. Artist and activist Robin Bell has projected protest messages on the side of the Trump International Hotel and the FBI and a Washington, DC courthouse, among other buildings. While his illuminated words aren't exactly journalistic—the word "shithole" is projected—might 8

journalists use this same technique for more measured information distribution and expression? The artist Jenny Holzer has made such work from documents obtained through records requests and pertaining to detention and interrogation. New York artist Jonathan Allen "edits" the subway posters for Hollywood and TV fare—*Pretty Little Liars*, say—turning them into disturbing and hilarious images of Trump and Vladimir Putin. For now, he's doing this in bluer-than-blue Brooklyn. But this sort of subversive signage could just as well tout reported information, and could emblazon hotels and bus stops around the country.

9 The Far Right understands this kind of nouveau messaging is part of what cuts through the informational kudzu. A gun-shop billboard ad in Murphy, North Carolina, featured a photo of the "squad"—Reps. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez, Ilhan Omar, Ayanna Pressley, and Rashida Tlaib—with an overheated reference to the "4 Horsemen" of the biblical apocalypse, then dubbing them, less biblically, "idiots." This was inciting and dopey. It did, however, get me thinking of what could happen if journalists and others started renting billboards, especially in Red States, using this signage to get true news further out there. At the Economic Hardship Reporting Project, the organization I run, we have supported some of these methods, from assigning poets to create reported documentary poetry to underwriting a film that used FOIA-ed footage, from police dashboard cameras, of undocumented people being dragged from their cars. We have been investigating launching billboards in 2020. I've also written a collection of poetry, *Thoughts and Prayers*, which contains a number of reported poems, and which is out this month. (A poem from *Thoughts and Prayers* follows.)

10 One could argue that quirky techniques like using billboards or projectors may seem too small-fry, or just another cool way to preach to the converted. Given our current rhetorical depletion, however, what else can we do? If we stay in our traditional journalistic lanes, we will continue to be twisted up in our own outrage, regurgitating the terrible phrases of those in power, perhaps unintentionally making them only more powerful.

After Reading

5. At the end of the first paragraph, the author asks, "When words and traditional genres fail us, what other techniques might journalists deploy to break through the thicket of bigoted remarks and familiar stories of misery?" How does the author answer her own question?
6. Identify some examples given in the reading of new genres of expression. Do you feel these are compelling proof of the ability of new media to communicate to their audiences?

Engage with the Reading

1. Do you agree with the author that "unexpected genres, and fresh modes of expression" are needed to communicate ideas? Or are traditional forms of media also effective?

2. Describe an example of a message, whether written, visual, or audio, that communicates news or politics that you found effective and explain why it is effective. Assess whether this example meets Quart's criteria for pushing "the language of journalism past its limits."

READING SELECTION

"CALL IT COVID"

Before Reading

1. Read the title and the headnote. Why might the poem be titled "Call It COVID"?
2. What do you know about the rise in hate crimes against people of Asian descent as a result of the COVID pandemic? If you don't know, research to find the answer.

During Reading

3. On a first reading, understand the main ideas of the reading selection.
4. On a second reading, note the rhetorical devices used to convey the poem's message.

Call It COVID

By Tatiana Tran, March 2021

Tatiana Tran, creative director for the advertising agency Wieden + Kennedy, helped write and produce "Call It Covid-19" in response to the rise in hate crimes against people of Asian descent as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic. This poem was printed in the New York Times *and recorded on YouTube.*

---

a word, please. 1
a word is just a word.
is just a word.
is just a word.
is—
not just a word.
not once it's been heard.
it becomes a belief.
a reason for someone's grief,
fear, confusion
causes actions:
a sign on a restaurant window:

“Chinese not welcome here.”
a slur on a car door:
“f---ing chink. go home. disappear.”
a clenched fist meets her back, her arms,
her face.
get out of our United States.
her face.
her face.
her.
face.
a face coughed on.
spit on.
kicked on.
disinfectant, sprayed on.
acid, splashed on.
knife, slashed on.
no, no — you’re right.
you weren’t holding that knife.
how could you have known?
how could you possibly know
what a word could do,
unless it was said
about you?
how could you know
that negative comments
about people of Asian descent
increased one hundred sixty-seven per cent
a week after a word was said.
now, it’s too late to take it back.
now, we’re just barely keeping track
of over a thousand reports
of discrimination.
and counting.
and that’s just counting
the ones that were reported.
what about the ones that were left unsaid?
how many thought,
this can’t be happening.
and if it is,
should i even say anything?
i’m just grateful to be here.
so what actually happened?
how could you know?
how could you know
what it feels like
to call your parents,
not just to talk,

not to ask them,
hey, how was your walk?
but to ask them—please,
don't go outside.
there's something happening
worldwide.
Mom, cover up.
not just your nose, your mouth,
but your eyes.
your hair.
your voice.
you.
hide.
everything about yourself.
don't let them see you.
don't let them recognize you.
this virus does not discriminate.
people do.
but hey.
it's just a word, right?
how could you know
what a word could do,
unless it was said
about you?
unless,
you were me.
then,
maybe
you'd
call it Covid-19.

what will you say
when you can't say
you didn't know?

2

After Reading

5. What would you say is the message of the poem? Summarize the poem in one or two sentences.
6. What evidence does the poem include of discrimination against Asians because of COVID-19?

Engage with the Reading

1. What do you feel is the purpose of this poem and the intended audience? Do you think the poem achieved its purpose and reached the intended audience?

2. Which parts of the poem did you find powerful and why? Which parts were least effective and why?

Writing Prompts for "What Makes a Persuasive Argument?"

1. Rhetorical analysis: Select one of the essays or speeches in Part 5 and explain the author's use of rhetorical devices to appeal to the intended audience and to effectively communicate a message.
2. Rhetorical analysis: Analyze the poem "Call It COVID" to explain the speaker's use of denotation, connotation, tone, and any other rhetorical devices to effectively communicate a message. Assess to what degree the poem achieves its intended purpose or reaches its intended audience.
3. Response essay: Select one of the reading selections in Part 5 and write a response to it, stating whether you agree with the author's message and/or were persuaded by their words and ideas.
4. Poem response: Select one of the reading selections in this section and write a poem in response to it. Your poem might be a reflection on the theme or an update to the original work. Before the poem, include a paragraph that explains the purpose of the poem: what message you are communicating, who is your audience, what is the purpose, and how you use words, imagery, or any other rhetorical devices to achieve the purpose.
5. Comparison paper: Compare President Abraham Lincoln's "Gettysburg Address" honoring Civil War soldiers to President Reagan's speech commemorating the 40th anniversary of the Normandy invasion (in the chapter "Rhetorically Analyzing Texts"). Explain how each president uses appeals and word choice to communicate effectively to his audience.
6. Argumentative synthesis essay: Alissa Quart argues that journalists should "push the language of journalism past its limits." Do you feel that any of the other reading selections in this section exemplify pushing the limits of journalism that Quart advocates? Provide examples from the various readings showing how they do or do not push journalistic limits.
7. Research paper: Conduct research on public monuments in your community or city. Locate a particular monument and analyze it in the same way that Frances Cathryn does, paying close attention to the visual details and what these suggest about the subject and theme of the work.
8. Research paper: Conduct research on hate crimes against Asians in the aftermath of the COVID pandemic. Determine whether discrimination against Asians increased because of COVID and, if so, the causes of that discrimination.

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